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Mission Mutual

Proverbs

Proverbs - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of Proverbs

1. Introduction and purpose for Proverbs (1:1-7)
2. A father teaches his son about wisdom (1:8-9:18)
3. Proverbs from Solomon (10:1-22:16)
4. Sayings from wise men (22:17-24:22)
5. More sayings from wise men (24:23-34)
6. Hezekiah's proverbs from Solomon (25:1-29:27)
7. Sayings from Agur (30:1-33)
8. Sayings from Lemuel (31:1-9)
9. Description of a good and capable wife (31:10-31)

What is the book of Proverbs about?

The book of Proverbs is a collection of proverbs. A proverb is a saying that gives wise advice or teaches something that is generally true about life. Most societies have their own proverbs and may use specific language that indicates something is a proverb. (See: Proverbs)

How should the title of this book be translated?

The title of this book is often translated as "Proverbs." A more general translation would be "Sayings for Wise People," "Wise Sayings," or something similar.

Who wrote the book of Proverbs?

Proverbs begins with the words, "The Proverbs of Solomon, son of David and King of Israel." However, Solomon did not write all of the proverbs in this book. Unnamed wise men wrote the proverbs in 22:17-24:34. Agur the son of Jakeh wrote the proverbs in 30:1-33 and King Lemuel wrote the proverbs in 31:1-31.

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

What is meant by "wisdom" in the book of Proverbs?

"Wisdom" refers to understanding and doing what is true and morally right. A wise person understands and does what Yahweh considers to be right. Anyone living in this way will also learn to live well with other people and to make good practical decisions in life. (See: [\[\[rc://*/tw/dict/bible/kt/wise\]\]](#))

What types of fools are mentioned in the book of Proverbs?

Proverbs contains three different Hebrew words for a person who lacks sense. Many Bible translations

translate all three of these as "fool." However, most scholars think there is a slight difference in meaning between each of these words, each one depicting a different degree of seriousness of the foolish condition.

To reflect this difference, the ULT translates each of these Hebrew words with a different English word. For the most frequently occurring and perhaps mildest word in this group, such as in 1:22, 8:5, 29:20, and many other places, the ULT uses forms of the word "stupid." While a lack of intelligence may be implied by this word, in Proverbs it primarily refers to someone lacking common sense and morality. In Proverbs, a "stupid one" is someone who is lazy and thoughtless, but may be capable of learning to be wise.

The next word refers to a condition of thoughtlessness that many scholars consider to be worse than "stupid." For this, the ULT uses forms of "fool." This word refers to someone who is insolent and stubbornly continues to act thoughtlessly and immorally, such as in 1:7, 7:22, and 29:9.

Lastly, the ULT uses the phrase "worthless one" for the most negative word in this group. This third term only occurs three times in Proverbs (17:7, 21; 30:22) and refers to someone who is especially disgraceful and lacks any sense of morality whatsoever. This "worthless one" is someone who completely rejects God and refuses to do what pleases God (Psalm 14:1). The UST uses forms of the term "fool" for the two most frequently used terms and uses "worthless people" for the third term. (See: [\[\[rc://*/tw/dict/bible/kt/foolish\]\]](#))

My Son

Several parts of the book of Proverbs contain a series of proverbs addressed to "my son" or "sons" (1:8-9:18; 19:27; 23:15-24:22; 27:11; 31:2-31) This does not mean that all the lessons in those proverbs only apply to males. Rather, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son. Whenever the lesson of such proverbs is not specifically about common temptations of young men, the UST uses more general language that could refer to both male and female children. (See: When Masculine Words Include Women)

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

Proverbs

Most of this book consists of individual proverbs. A proverb is a short saying about something that is generally true in life. Proverbs often use parallelism and metaphors to teach a lesson by referring to something or some event that would be familiar to the readers. These proverbs say as much as they can in as few

words as possible. Because of that, it is often necessary to supply words from the context in order for the sentences to make sense in translation. The Notes will suggest words that can be used where necessary. If possible, translate each proverb in a way that will be recognized as a proverb and be meaningful in your language and culture. (See: Proverbs)

Parallelism

Many proverbs consist of two parts that have a relationship to each other. The second part may strengthen the first part, give more details about the first part, or say something that is a contrast to the first part. The two parts are meant to be read as a whole so that together they say more about the subject than either part says by itself. Sometimes the second part seems to say the same thing again in different words. In this case, the second part reinforces the truth of the first part by repeating the message; It is not trying to say something different. Translators should also take into account that each proverb is also part of a larger group of proverbs. (See: Parallelism)

Personification

In Proverbs, certain qualities such as wisdom and stupidity are often represented as if they were human. Proverbs 1:20-33, 3:15-18, 4:6-9, and 8:1-9:12 refer to wisdom as if it were a woman. Proverbs 9:13-18 might also refer to stupidity as if it were a woman. In languages where it is possible for a female figure to represent these qualities, the translator can translate directly. However, if direct translation does not work in your language, consider translating these personifications as similes instead. In that case, wisdom or stupidity would be presented as being like a wise or stupid woman. Alternatively, consider translating these passages without using figurative language, as in the UST. (See: Personification)

Generic Nouns

Proverbs contains many generic noun phrases that refer to people or things in general even though they may appear to refer to specific individuals or things. This type of noun occurs frequently in this book because proverbs tell about things that are true about people in general. Most of the cases of generic nouns will be addressed in the notes. (See: Generic Noun Phrases)

Nominal Adjectives

Throughout this book, Solomon uses adjectives that describe characteristics of people to refer to those kinds of people. For example, he refers to wicked people as “the wicked” and to righteous people as “the righteous.” When he seems to be referring to an individual rather than to a group, the ULT will represent

this as “a wicked {one}” or “a righteous {one}.” Your language may work in the same way, or you may want to translate these as “wicked people” and “righteous people” or “a wicked person” and “a righteous person” or in some other way. (See: Nominal Adjectives)

Proverbs - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Introduction and purpose for Proverbs (1:1-7)

- Title (1:1)
 - The purpose of Proverbs (1:2-6)
 - Main theme: Fearing Yahweh is essential to being wise (1:7)
- #### 1. A father teaches his son about wisdom (1:8-9:18)
- Avoid evil companions (1:8-19)
 - Do not reject wisdom (1:20-33)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Personification

In 1:20-33, Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a person, specifically, as if it were a woman, because the word “wisdom” is grammatically feminine in Hebrew. In languages where it makes sense for a woman figure to represent an abstract concept like wisdom, the translator can translate the personification directly. If this does not work in your language because the word “wisdom” is grammatically masculine, consider personifying wisdom as a man. If it does not work in your language to represent an abstract concept like wisdom as a person, consider translating these personifications as similes instead. In that case, wisdom would be presented as being like a wise person. Alternatively, consider translating these passages without using figurative language, as in the UST. (See: Personification)

Proverbs 1:1 (#2)

מְחֻשְׁלֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“The proverbs of Solomon”

Here the author is using the possessive form to describe **proverbs** that were written by **Solomon**. If this is not clear in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The proverbs that were written by Solomon]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:1 (#1)

מְחֻשְׁלֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“The proverbs of Solomon”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [These are the proverbs of Solomon]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:2 (#5)

אִמְרֵי בִינָה

“sayings of understanding”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **understanding**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [sayings of people who understand things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:2 (#1)

לְדַעַת חֲכָמָה וּמוֹסָר

“To know wisdom and instruction”

1:2–6 form one long sentence that lacks some of the words that a sentence in many languages would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [The purposes of these proverbs are to know wisdom and instruction]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:2 (#3)

חֲכָמָה וּמוֹסָר

“wisdom and instruction”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom** and **instruction**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [wise and instructive things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:2 (#4)

אִמְרֵי בִינָה

“sayings of understanding”

Here, the author is using the possessive form to describe **sayings** that give a person **understanding**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [sayings that give a person understanding]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:2 (#2)

לְדַעַת & לְהִבְיֵן

“To know & to understand”

To know and **to understand** here indicate two purposes for these proverbs. Use a natural way in your language to introduce purpose clauses. Alternate translation: [These proverbs are for the purpose of knowing ... and they are for the purpose of understanding]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:3 (#3)

מוֹסֵר הַשְׁכֵּל צֶדֶק וְיִשְׁרָאֵל וּמִשְׁפָּט וּמִיִּשְׁרָיִם

“instruction of insight, righteousness and justice and integrity”

Here, the author is using the possessive form to describe **instruction** that is characterized by **insight**, **righteousness**, **justice**, and **integrity**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [instruction in how to have insight, righteousness, justice, and integrity]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:3 (#2)

לְקַחַת מוֹסֵר הַשְׁכֵּל צֶדֶק וְיִשְׁרָאֵל וּמִשְׁפָּט וּמִיִּשְׁרָיִם

“to receive instruction of insight, righteousness and justice and integrity”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **instruction**, **insight**, **righteousness**, **justice**, and **integrity**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [to be instructed in ways that are insightful, righteous, just, and honest]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:3 (#1)

לְקַחַת מוֹסֵר

“to receive instruction of”

Here, **to receive** indicates a third purpose for these proverbs. Use a natural way in your language to introduce a purpose clause. You may want to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [These proverbs are for the purpose of receiving instruction of]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:4 (#2)

עֲרֹמָה & דִּדְעַת וּמִזְמָה

“prudence & knowledge and discretion”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **prudence**, **knowledge**, and **discretion**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [what is prudent ... what he should know and how he can be discreet]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:4 (#3)

לְלִנְיָוֶר

“to a young man”

Although the term **young man** is masculine, these proverbs are beneficial for both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [to young men and women]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 1:4 (#1)

לְתַתֵּן לַפְתָּאִיִּים עֲרֻמָּה

“to give to naive ones prudence”

Here, **to give** indicates a fourth purpose for these proverbs. Use a natural way in your language to introduce a purpose clause. You may want to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [These proverbs are for the purpose of giving naive ones prudence]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:5 (#1)

יִשְׁמַע הַחֲכָם וַיִּזְכֹּךְ לְלֶקַח וְיִנְבֹּן תְּחִבֵּלּוֹת יָקֹנָה

“may a wise one hear and increase learning, and an understanding one acquire guidance”

This verse interrupts the list of purposes for the proverbs in 1:2–6 to add the idea that those who are already wise might use these to add to their wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could add parentheses, as in the ULT, or use a natural way in your language to indicate a parenthetical or background statement.

See: Background Information

Proverbs 1:5 (#4)

תְּחִבֵּלּוֹת יָקֹנָה

“acquire guidance”

The author implies that this person **will acquire guidance** from these proverbs. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will acquire guidance from these proverbs]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:5 (#5)

תְּחִבֵּלּוֹת יָקֹנָה

“acquire guidance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **guidance**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [know how to live]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:5 (#2)

יִשְׁמַע הַחֲכָם וַיִּזְכֹּךְ לְלֶקַח וְיִנְבֹּן תְּחִבֵּלּוֹת יָקֹנָה

“may a wise one hear and increase learning, and an understanding one acquire guidance”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, so it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [let a wise one hear and increase insight, yes, may an understanding one acquire guidance]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:5 (#3)

יִשְׁמַע הַחֲכָם

“may a wise one hear”

The author is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [let a wise one hear these proverbs]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:6 (#3)

מִבְּשֵׁל וּמִלִּיצָה

“a proverb and a parable”

Here, **a proverb** and **a parable** refer to these things in general, not to a specific proverb and parable.

If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any proverb and any parable]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 1:6 (#1)

לְהַבְרִין מִמֶּשֶׁל וּמִלִּצְעָה דְּבַר־רִי הָחֻקִּים וְהַיִּדְּתִים

“to understand a proverb and a parable, the words of the wise ones and their riddles”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that indicates that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [to understand a proverb and a parable, yes, to understand the words of the wise ones and their riddles]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:6 (#4)

דְּבַר־רִי הָחֻקִּים

“the words of the wise ones”

The author is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [to understand the words of the wise ones]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:6 (#2)

לְהַבְרִין מִמֶּשֶׁל וּמִלִּצְעָה

“to understand a proverb and a parable”

Here, **to** indicates a fifth purpose for these proverbs. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a purpose clause. You may want to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [These proverbs are for the purpose of understanding a proverb and a parable]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:6 (#5)

דְּבַר־רִי

“the words of”

Here, the author uses the term **words** to describe what **the wise ones** say by using **words**. If it would

be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the sayings of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:7 (#3)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **fear**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Being deeply respectful of Yahweh] or [Revering Yahweh]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:7 (#4)

רֵאשִׁית דָּעַת

“is} the beginning of knowledge”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **knowledge**, you could express the same idea in another way. See how you translated **knowledge** in 1:4. Alternate translation: [is what enables you to know what is true] or [allows you to think wisely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:7 (#5)

הַכְּמָה וְהַמוֹסָר אֹיְלִים כִּזּוּ

“fools despise wisdom and instruction”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom** and **instruction**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **wisdom** and **instruction** in 1:2. Alternate translation: [But fools do not care about being wise or learning from others]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:7 (#1)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

Here, the author is using the possessive form to describe **fear** that a person should have for **Yahweh**. If this is not clear in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The fear for Yahweh]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:7 (#2)

רֵאשִׁית דָּעַת

“is} the beginning of knowledge”

Here, **beginning** refers to the basis of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is the prerequisite for acquiring knowledge] or [is what knowledge is based upon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:7 (#6)

הַכְּמָה וְהַמִּסְכָּר אֵינֶלֶלִים בְּזוֹ

“fools despise wisdom and instruction”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [By contrast, fools despise wisdom and instruction]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 1:8 (#6)

וְאַל־תִּתְּשֵׁשׁ

“and do not forsake”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **forsake**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [and heed]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 1:8 (#7)

תּוֹרַת

“the law of”

Here, the word **law** is singular in form, but it refers to several laws as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the rules of]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 1:8 (#3)

בְּרָנִי

“my son”

Although the term **son** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [my offspring]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 1:8 (#2)

שְׁמַע בְּרָנִי מִסְכָּר

“Hear, my son, the instruction of”

Hear in the Bible often means “hear and obey.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language. Alternate translation: [Pay attention, my son, to the instruction of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:8 (#4)

מִסְכָּר

“the instruction of”

See how you translated **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:8 (#5)

מִסְכָּר אֲבִיךָ

“the instruction of your father”

Solomon is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first person form. Alternate translation: [the instruction of me, your father]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Proverbs 1:8 (#1)

שְׁמַע בְּרָנִי מִסְכָּר אֲבִיךָ וְאַל־תִּתְּשֵׁשׁ תּוֹרַת אִמִּיךָ

“Hear, my son, the instruction of your father and do not forsake the law of your mother”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Hear, my son, the instruction of your father, yes, do not forsake the law of your mother]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:9 (#6)

לְרֵיֶת חַסֵּד

“are} a garland of grace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in an-

other way. Alternate translation: [a gracious garland] or [an attractive garland]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:9 (#2)

לְיָלֵיתָ חֶטְוֹן הַחֵם לְרֹאשְׁשֵׁשׁ וְלַעֲנָקִים לְגִרְגָּרִיתִיד

“they {are} a garland of grace for your head and pendants for your neck”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [they are a garland of grace for your head, yes, even pendants for your neck]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:9 (#5)

לְיָלֵיתָ חֶטְוֹן

“are} a garland of grace”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **garland** that is characterized by **grace**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are a gracious garland]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:9 (#3)

הָחֵם

“they”

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to the instruction and teaching of one's parents, as stated in the previous verse. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the instruction and law from your parents are] or [the things your parents taught you are]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:9 (#1)

כִּי

“for”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is

a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Obey these instructions because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:9 (#4)

לְיָלֵיתָ חֶטְוֹן הַחֵם לְרֹאשְׁשֵׁשׁ וְלַעֲנָקִים לְגִרְגָּרִיתִיד

“they {are} a garland of grace for your head and pendants for your neck”

Here Solomon speaks of the rules and instructions that parents teach their children as if they were a **garland** or **pendants**. These two items make a person look more attractive to other people and may cause other people to respect that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. Alternate translation: [they make you look more beautiful and respectable] or [they are like a garland of grace for your head and like pendants for your neck]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:10 (#1)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 1:10 (#3)

אִם-יִפְתָּנוּדָּהּ הַחַטָּאִים אֶל-תִּבָּא

“if sinners entice you, do not consent”

Solomon implies that the **sinners** would **entice** his **son** to sin with them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [if sinners entice you to join them in sinning, do not consent to sin with them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:10 (#2)

אִם-יִפְתָּנוּדָּהּ הַחַטָּאִים

“if sinners entice you”

Solomon is using a hypothetical situation to help his readers understand how important it is to resist temptation from **sinners**. Use the natural form in your language for expressing a hypothetical situation. Alternate translation: [should it happen that sinners entice you]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 1:11 (#5)

לִדְם

“for blood”

Here, **blood** refers to violently murdering someone, which usually causes **blood** to come out of the person who is murdered. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to shed blood] or [to murder someone]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:11 (#4)

נִאָרְכְּבָה & נִצְפְּנָה

“Let us lie in wait & Let us hide to ambush”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a word that shows the connection between these two phrases. Alternate translation: [Let us lie in wait ... Yes, let us hide to ambush]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:11 (#1)

אִם־יֹאמְרוּ

“If they say”

Solomon is using a hypothetical situation to help his readers understand how sinners might entice someone to join them in sinning. Use the natural form in your language for expressing a hypothetical situation. Alternate translation: [Suppose they say]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 1:11 (#6)

לִדְם נִצְפְּנָה

“for blood. Let us hide to ambush”

Here, **for** and **to** introduce the purposes for these actions. The purpose for lying in wait is to shed blood. The purpose for hiding is to ambush someone. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate purposes. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of shedding blood. Let us hide for the purpose of ambushing]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 1:11 (#7)

לִנְקִי

“the innocent one”

The sinners are speaking of an **innocent** person in general, not of one particular **innocent one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [some innocent person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 1:11 (#2)

יֹאמְרוּ

“they say”

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to sinners, as mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those sinners say]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:11 (#3)

אֵלֵינוּ נִאָרְכְּבָה & נִצְפְּנָה

“with us! Let us lie in wait & Let us hide to ambush”

By **us**, the sinners are referring to themselves but not other people, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Proverbs 1:12 (#4)

כְּשֶׁאֵוֹל

“like Sheol”

The sinners are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like Sheol swallows people]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:12 (#9)

כִּי־יֵרְדוּ בֹר

“like those going down to a pit”

The Israelites referred to dying as **going down to Sheol** or a **pit**. Here the sinners are saying that their victims are like **those going down to a pit** because those people will die. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [like those who die]

See: Simile

Proverbs 1:12 (#3)

כְּשֶׁאֲדֹל חַיִּים וְהַכּוֹלִים כִּי יִרְדּוּ בֹר

“the living ones, like Sheol, and the whole ones like those going down to a pit”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [the living ones, like Sheol, yes, the whole ones, like those going down to a pit]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:12 (#2)

נִבְלָעִם

“Let us swallow them”

The sinners speak of murdering people as if they were swallowing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let us destroy them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:12 (#7)

וְהַכּוֹלִים

“and the whole ones”

Here, **whole** refers to being completely healthy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the healthy ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:12 (#6)

וְהַכּוֹלִים

“and the whole ones”

The sinners are leaving out some of the words that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the beginning of the verse. Alternate translation: [and let us swallow the whole ones]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:12 (#8)

כִּי יִרְדּוּ בֹר

“like those going down to a pit”

The sinners are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like those going down to a pit are swallowed]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 1:12 (#1)

נִבְלָעִם

“Let us swallow them”

By **us**, the sinners are referring to themselves but not other people, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Proverbs 1:12 (#5)

כְּשֶׁאֲדֹל

“like Sheol”

Here, **Sheol** is spoken of as if it were a living thing that could **swallow** someone. The idea of **Sheol** swallowing someone refers to how people are completely gone after they die and are buried. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [like Sheol completely covers people]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:13 (#1)

נִמְצָא נִמְלֵא בְּתֵינֵנוּ

“We will find & We will fill our houses”

In this verse, the sinners use **We** and **our** to refer to themselves but not other people. Use the exclusive form of those words in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Proverbs 1:13 (#2)

כָּל

“all”

The sinners say **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [very much]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 1:14 (#1)

גְּוֹרְרֵךְ לִפְסִיל בְּתוֹכֵנוּ

“You must cause your lot to fall in our midst”

This is an idiom. It refers to joining with a group of people that will share the same life or destiny. Alternate translation: [You must join us and share our destiny]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:14 (#3)

בְּתוֹכֵנוּ & לְכָלנוּ

“in our midst & for all of us”

In this verse, the sinners use **our** to refer to themselves but not other people. However, they use **us** to include the person they are addressing. Use the appropriate form of those words in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Proverbs 1:14 (#2)

כִּסִּים אֶחָד יִהְיֶה לְכָלנוּ

“one purse will be for all of us”

Here, **purse** represents the contents of the purse, which would be money and valuables. They are saying that they will share equally whatever they steal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everything that we steal we will share equally]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:15 (#1)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 1:15 (#3)

אֶל־תֵּלֶךְ בְּדֹרֶךְ אֲתָתָם מִנְעֵה רַגְלֶךָ מִנְתִּיבָתָם

“do not walk on the road with them; restrain your foot from their path”

Here Solomon speaks of walking with the sinners as a way to express associating with them, and he uses **road** and **path** to refer to the way that the sinners behave. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have nothing to do with those sinners; keep yourself from behaving like them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:15 (#4)

רַגְלֶךָ

“your foot”

Solomon is using one part of a person, the **foot**, to represent the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [yourself]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 1:15 (#2)

אֶל־תֵּלֶךְ בְּדֹרֶךְ אֲתָתָם מִנְעֵה רַגְלֶךָ מִנְתִּיבָתָם

“do not walk on the road with them; restrain your foot from their path”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases in a way that would show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [do not walk on the road with them; I am saying, restrain your foot from their path]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:16 (#4)

לְשִׁפְךָ דָּם

“to pour out blood”

The phrase **pour out blood** refers to violently murdering people, which usually causes **blood** to come out of the people who are murdered. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to kill others]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:16 (#2)

רַגְלֵיהֶם & יָרֻצוּ

“their feet run”

Here, “feet” represents the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they run]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 1:16 (#1)

כִּי

“for”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not walk with them because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:16 (#3)

רַגְלֵיהֶם לָרָע יָרֻצוּ

“their feet run to evil”

Here Solomon speaks of how eager the sinners are to do evil as if **their feet** were running to do it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they are quick to do evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:17 (#4)

בִּצְעַל כִּנָּר

“owner of wing”

The phrase **owner of wing** refers to a bird. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:17 (#1)

מִזְרָה הִרְגְּשָׁת

“is} the net spread out”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [does someone spread out a net]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 1:17 (#3)

בְּרָעֵינֵי

“in the eyes of”

Here, **eyes** refers to what is seen with the **eyes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in view of] or [in the sight of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:17 (#2)

מִזְרָה הִרְגְּשָׁת

“is} the net spread out”

A **net** is a trap made of woven rope or string that hunters use to catch animals. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of trap, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is the trap set up]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 1:18 (#2)

וְהֵם לְדַמְמָם יֵאָרְבוּ יִצְפְּנוּ לְנַפְשָׁתָם

“but they lie in wait for their blood; they hide in ambush for their lives”

This verse compares the sinners to the birds being hunted in the previous verse. But here it speaks of the sinners as both the hunters and the hunted. Unlike a bird that is smart enough to avoid a net, these sinners destroy themselves by doing sinful things that cause them to be killed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but because they intend to kill others, they will be killed; their attempts to attack others will cost them their lives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:18 (#4)

וְהֵם לְדַמְמָם יֵאָרְבוּ יִצְפְּנוּ לְנַפְשָׁתָם

“but they lie in wait for their blood; they hide in ambush for their lives”

In this verse, the pronouns **they** and **their** refer to the sinners described in 1:10-16. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but those sinners lie in wait for their own blood; those sinners hide in ambush for their own lives]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:18 (#3)

וְהֵם לְדַמְמָם יִצְפְּנוּ לְנַפְשָׁם

“but they lie in wait for their blood; they hide in ambush for their lives”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a word that shows the connection between these two clauses. Alternate translation: [but they lie in wait for their blood; yes, they hide in ambush for their lives]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:18 (#5)

וְהֵם לְדַמְמָם יִצְפְּנוּ לְנַפְשָׁם

“but they lie in wait for their blood; they hide in ambush for their lives”

In this verse, **for** introduces the result of these actions. They **lie in wait** and **hide in ambush** and the result is that it costs them **their blood** and **their lives**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [but they lie in wait, which costs them their blood; they hide in ambush, which costs them their lives]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:18 (#6)

לְדַמְמָם

“for their blood”

See how you translated **blood** in 1:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:18 (#1)

וְהֵם

“but they”

Here, **but** indicates a contrast between the bird mentioned in the previous verse and the sinners who speak in 1:11–14. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. You may want to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [By contrast, they]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 1:19 (#3)

בְּבָצֵעַ בְּבָצֵעַ

“who unjustly gain unjust gain”

Here, **unjustly gain unjust gain** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [who are greedy for unjust gain]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 1:19 (#1)

אֶתְרַחֲוּת

“are} the paths of”

Here Solomon uses **paths** to refer to the destiny of those sinners. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are the destinies of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:19 (#2)

כָּל

“all”

Here Solomon uses the adjective **all** as a noun to mean “every person.” Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [all people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 1:19 (#4)

בְּבָצֵעַ

“unjust gain”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **gain**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what they gain unjustly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:19 (#6)

אֶת־נַפְשׁוֹ בְּעַלְלֵיו יָקָה

“it takes the life of its owner”

Solomon speaks of **unjust gain** as if it were a person who could kill its **owner**. He means that the wicked things that sinful people do to **unjustly gain unjust gain** will cause them to die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly

or use a simile. Alternate translation: [unjust gain results in its owner dying] or [seeking unjust gain kills those who do it] or [it is as if unjust gain takes the life of its owner]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:19 (#7)

אֶת־נַפְשׁוֹ & יָקָח

“it takes the life of”

Here, the phrase **takes the life of** means to kill someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it kills]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:19 (#5)

אֶת־נַפְשׁוֹ בְּעֵלְיוֹ יָקָח

“it takes the life of its owner”

Here, the pronouns **it** and **its** refer to the **unjust gain** that is mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that unjust gain takes the life of the unjust gain’s owner]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:20 (#2)

הַחֲכָמוֹת בַּחֲחוּץ תִּרְגְּנָה בְּבִרְחֵבֹתַי תִּתְּנֵנִי קוֹלָהּ

“Wisdom calls out outside; she gives her voice in the open areas”

In 1:20–33, Solomon speaks of **Wisdom** as if it were a woman speaking to the people. See the discussion of this in the Introduction for this chapter. By saying that **Wisdom calls out** or **gives her voice**, he means that wisdom is available to all people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Wisdom is available openly; it is available freely] or [Wisdom is like a woman who calls out outside, like a woman who gives forth her voice in the open] or [It is as if wisdom calls out outside; it is as if wisdom gives forth its voice in the town square]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:20 (#1)

הַחֲכָמוֹת בַּחֲחוּץ תִּרְגְּנָה בְּבִרְחֵבֹתַי תִּתְּנֵנִי קוֹלָהּ

“Wisdom calls out outside; she gives her voice in the open areas”

These two clauses and the two clauses of the next verse mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a word that shows the connection between these two clauses. Alternate translation: [Wisdom calls out outside, indeed, she gives forth her voice in the open places]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:20 (#3)

הַחֲכָמוֹת

“Wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **Wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:20 (#4)

בַּחֲחוּץ

“outside”

Here, **outside** refers to the public space **outside** of one’s house where there would be many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the streets]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:20 (#5)

תִּתְּנֵנִי קוֹלָהּ

“she gives her voice”

This is an idiom that means **she** spoke very loudly. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she lifts her voice] or [she speaks with a loud voice]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:20 (#6)

בְּבִרְחֵבֹתַי

“in the open areas”

Here, **open areas** refers to large, outdoor public places where there would usually be many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the marketplaces] or [in the plazas]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:21 (#1)

בְּרֹאשׁ הַמִּיּוֹת הַתְּקַרְקָרָא בְּפִתְחוֹתֵי שְׁעָרִים בְּעֵיר אֲמַרְיָה תֹאמַר

“At the head of the tumultuous places she calls out; at the opening of the gates in the city, she says her sayings”

These two clauses and the two clauses of the previous verse mean basically the same thing. These two clauses emphasize the meaning of the first clause of the previous verse by repeating the same idea but naming different places in the city. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that would show that these clauses are repeating the same idea from the previous verse, not saying something different. Alternate translation: [Yes, at the head of the tumultuous places she calls out; yes, at the opening of the gates in the city she says her sayings]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:21 (#3)

הַתְּקַרְקָרָא & אֲמַרְיָה תֹאמַר

“she calls out & she says her sayings”

Here Solomon continues to speak of wisdom as if it were a woman who **calls out** or **says her sayings**. As in the previous verse, he means that wisdom is available to all people. Continue the strategy that you used in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [wisdom is available ... it is available] or [it is as if wisdom calls out ... it is as if wisdom says its sayings]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:21 (#4)

בְּפִתְחוֹתֵי שְׁעָרִים בְּעֵיר

“at the opening of the gates in the city”

Solomon's readers would have understood that the **the opening of the gates in the city** was a crowded place where many people gathered. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [at the opening of the gates in the city, where many people gather]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:21 (#2)

בְּרֹאשׁ

“At the head of”

Here, **head** refers to the place where busy streets intersect. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [At the intersection of streets in]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:21 (#5)

אֲמַרְיָה תֹאמַר

“she says her sayings”

Here, **says her sayings** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis.

See: Poetry

Proverbs 1:22 (#3)

פִּתְיָ & לִלְצוֹן & דַּעַת

“naiveté & mockery & knowledge”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **naiveté**, **mockery**, and **knowledge**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **knowledge** in 1:4. Alternate translation: [thinking naively ... mocking ... knowing things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:22 (#2)

עַד־מַתְנִי | פְּתִים תֹּאמְרוּ בְּפִתְחוֹתֵי שְׁעָרֵי וְלִלְצִים לִלְצוֹן הַמְדַּדוּ לְהֵם
וְכִסְיִלִּים יִשְׂנְאוּ־דַעַת

“Until when will naive ones love naiveté and mockers delight {in} mockery for themselves and stupid ones hate knowledge”

Wisdom is using the question form to emphasize that these types of people should stop acting the way that they do. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [For too long the naive ones have loved naiveté, and mockers have delighted in mockery for themselves, and stupid ones have hated knowledge!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 1:22 (#1)

עַד־מַתְנִי

“Until when”

1:22-33 are one long quotation that Solomon presents as if wisdom itself were speaking. Consider natural

ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [She says, “Until when”] or [It is as if Wisdom says, “Until when”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 1:23 (#6)

לְכֶם & אֶתְכֶם

“to you & you”

In this speech from verse 23 through verse 27, Wisdom addresses foolish people directly as a group. Therefore, use the plural forms of address in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Proverbs 1:23 (#4)

רוּחִי

“my spirit”

Here, **spirit** refers to a person’s thoughts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:23 (#5)

אֶבְיָצֶה לְכֶם רוּחִי

“I shall allow my spirit to gush forth to you”

Wisdom telling the people what she thinks is spoken of as if her thoughts were a liquid that would come flowing out. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I shall freely tell you what I think]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:23 (#7)

דְּבָרִי

“my words”

Here, Wisdom uses the term **words** to describe what she says by using **words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the things that I have to say]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 1:23 (#3)

אֶבְיָצֶה לְכֶם רוּחִי אֲדַבֵּר אֶתְכֶם

“I shall allow my spirit to gush forth to you, I shall cause you to know my words”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that would show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I shall allow my spirit to gush forth to you, yes, I shall cause you to know my words]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:23 (#2)

הִנֵּנָה

“Behold”

Behold is a term meant to focus the attention of the listener on what the speaker is about to say. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use some emphatic term or expression in your language that would have this same effect. Alternate translation: [Note this] or [Listen]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:23 (#1)

תִּשְׁשׁוּבוּ

“Turn”

Turn here implies turning one’s head in order to listen better to what someone is saying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Turn your heads and listen]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:24 (#1)

יֵצֵן

“Because”

Because here indicates that what follows in this verse and the next verse is the reason for the result, which is stated in 1:26–27. Use the most natural way in your language to state a reason. If you divide 1:24–27 into two sentences, then you could either remove **Because** here and add a word to express result at the beginning of 1:26 as in the UST, or you could add the word “because” to each of the clauses of 1:24–25. Alternate translation: [Since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:24 (#2)

קָרָאתִי וְתִמְאַנְנוּ נְטִיתִי יָדַי וְאֵינִן מְקַשְׁיִים

“I have called and you have refused, I have stretched out my hand, and there was no one listening attentively”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that would show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I have called and you have refused, yes, I have stretched out my hand and there was no one listening attentively] or [I have called and you have refused, because I have stretched out my hand and there was no one listening attentively]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:24 (#3)

וְתִקְרָאֲנִי

“and you have refused”

Wisdom implies that people **refused** to listen to what she said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and you have refused to listen to me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:24 (#4)

נִטְטִיתִי יָדִידִי

“I have stretched out my hand”

This phrase **stretched out my hand** is an idiom that refers to beckoning someone or inviting a person to come. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I stretched out my hand to beckon you] or [I beckoned you]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:25 (#1)

וְתִפְרָעוּ כָּל־עֲצָתִי לֹא אָבִיתֶם

“and you have ignored all my counsel, and my rebuke you did not accept”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Both of these clauses continue the reason that was begun in verse 24 with the word “because.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** or you could add the word “be-

cause” to each of the clauses. Alternate translation: [and you have ignored all my counsel, yes, my rebuke you did not accept] or [and because you have ignored all my counsel and because my rebuke you did not accept]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:25 (#2)

עֲצָתִי וְתוֹכַחַתִּי

“my counsel, and my rebuke”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **counsel** and **rebuke**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [that I have counseled, and what I said to rebuke you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:26 (#3)

גַּם־אֲנִי

“I too”

The phrase translated as **I too** shifts the focus from the foolish people mentioned in 1:24–25 to the person speaking, who represents wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I, in turn,] or [I, for my part,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:26 (#4)

בְּאִי־דָכְכֶם & בְּבֹא־פָחַדְכֶם

“at your calamity & when your dread comes”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **calamity** and **dread**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [when you suffer ... when you are scared]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:26 (#1)

גַּם־אֲנִי

“I too”

1:26–27 state the result of what was stated in 1:24–25. If you divided 1:24–27 into two sentences and removed **Because** from 1:24, then you will need to add a word here to express the result of the reasons given in 1:24–25. Alternate translation: [As a result, I too] or [So, I too]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:26 (#2)

גם־אֲנִי בְּאִדְכֶם אֶשְׂחָק אֶלְעֵג בְּבָא פְחַדְכֶם

“I too shall laugh at your calamity, I shall mock when your dread comes”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I too shall laugh at your calamity, yes, I shall mock when your dread comes]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:26 (#5)

בְּבָא פְחַדְכֶם

“when your dread comes”

Here, wisdom speaks of experiencing **dread** as if it were a person who **comes** to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you experience dread]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:27 (#6)

צָרָה וְצוּקָה

“distress and anguish”

The terms **distress** and **anguish** mean similar things. The two terms are used together here for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [distressing events]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 1:27 (#1)

בְּבָא & פְּחַדְכֶם

“when your dread comes”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:27 (#2)

פְּחַדְכֶם וְאִדְכֶם

“your dread & and your calamity”

See how you translated **dread** and **calamity** in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:27 (#5)

צָרָה וְצוּקָה

“distress and anguish”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **distress** and **anguish**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [distressing things that make you anguished]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:27 (#4)

בְּבָא צָרָה וְצוּקָה

“when distress and anguish come upon you”

Here, wisdom speaks of experiencing **distress and anguish** as if they were objects that could **come upon** someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you experience distress and anguish]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:27 (#3)

כְּשֹׁאוּה & כְּסוּפָה

“like a storm & like a whirlwind”

Here, Wisdom compares the manner in which **dread** and **calamity** will happen to the sudden, destructive power of a **storm** or **whirlwind**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [powerfully ... suddenly]

See: Simile

Proverbs 1:28 (#1)

אָמַר יִקְרְאוּנִי וְלֹא אֶעֱנֶה יִשְׁחַרְרֻנִי וְלֹא יִמָּצְאוּנִי

“Then they will call out to me, but I will not answer. They will diligently seek me, but they will not find me”

These two sentences mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the sentences with a word that shows that the second sentence is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Then they will call out to me, but I will not answer. Yes, they will diligently seek me, but they will not find me]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:28 (#3)

יִקְרְאוּנִי

“they will call out to me”

Here, **call out** implies crying out for help. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [they will call out to me for help]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:28 (#2)

יִקְרְאוּנִי & יִשְׁחַרְרוּנִי וְלֹא יִמְצְאוּנִי

“they will call out to me & They will diligently seek me, but they will not find me”

In this verse, the pronoun **they** refers to the foolish people who ignored wisdom, as described in 1:22-27. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those who ignored me will call out to me ... those people will diligently seek me, but they will not find me]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:29 (#2)

דָּעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:29 (#3)

יִירָאֶת יְהוָה

“and the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:29 (#1)

תִּתְחַת כִּי

“for the reason that”

This phrase indicates that what follows in this verse and the next verse are the reasons why the foolish people will not find wisdom, as stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to express reasons. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 1:30 (#3)

לְעִצָּתִי & כָּל־תּוֹכַחְתִּי

“my counsel & my every rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **counsel** and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:30 (#1)

לֹא־אָבְדוּ לְעִצָּתִי וְנִצָּצוּ כָּל־תּוֹכַחְתִּי

“they did not want my counsel, and they despised my every rebuke”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [they did not want my counsel, yes, they despised my every rebuke]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:30 (#2)

לֹא־אָבְדוּ & נִצָּצוּ

“they did not want & and they despised”

In this verse, the pronoun **they** refers to the foolish people who ignored wisdom, as described in 1:22-27. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those who ignored me did not want ... and those people despised]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 1:31 (#2)

וְיֹאכְלוּ מִפְּרִי דֶרֶכָם

“And they will eat from the fruit of their way”

Here, people suffering the consequences of their behavior are spoken of as if they were eating **the fruit of their way**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar idiom from your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they will experience the consequences of their behavior]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 1:31 (#4)

וּמִמַּעַצְתֵּי יִהְיֶהֱם יִשְׁכְּבוּ

“and from their plans they will be satisfied”

Here, the word translated as **satisfied** means “to be made full of.” This word can have either a positive or negative meaning, but here the meaning is negative. It means that these foolish people will suffer the full consequences of **their** foolish **plans**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [they will experience the consequences of their plans]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 1:31 (#1)

וְיֹאכְלוּ מִפִּרְיָ דֶּרֶכָם וּמִמַּעֲצָתֵיהֶם יִשְׂבְּעוּ

“And they will eat from the fruit of their way, and from their plans they will be satisfied”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And they will eat from the fruit of their way, yes, from their plans they will be satisfied]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:31 (#3)

וּמִמַּעֲצָתֵיהֶם יִשְׂבְּעוּ

“and from their plans they will be satisfied”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and their plans will satisfy them]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 1:32 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows in 1:32–33 is the conclusion to what Wisdom stated in 1:22–31. Alternate translation: [In conclusion,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 1:32 (#3)

מִשׁוּבְבַת פְּתִיּוֹם תִּהְרָגָם

“the turning away of the naive ones will slay them”

Here, **turning away** is spoken of as if it were a person who could **slay** someone. This expression means that **the naive ones** will die because of their **turning away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [the naive ones will die because of their turning away] or [the turning away of the naive ones is like someone who will slay them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:32 (#2)

מִשׁוּבְבַת פְּתִיּוֹם תִּהְרָגָם וְשִׁלּוֹת קְסִילָיִם תֵּאַבְדֹּם

“the turning away of the naive ones will slay them and {false} security will lead stupid ones to ruin”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [the turning away of the naive ones will slay them, yes, false security will lead stupid ones to ruin]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 1:32 (#4)

מִשׁוּבְבַת פְּתִיּוֹם

“the turning away of the naive ones”

Here, refusing to listen to wisdom is spoken of as **turning away** from the one who is speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the refusing to listen of the naive ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 1:32 (#6)

וְשִׁלּוֹת קְסִילָיִם תֵּאַבְדֹּם

“and {false} security will lead stupid ones to ruin”

Here, **false security** is spoken of as if it were a person who could **lead** someone. This expression means that **stupid ones** will die because of their **false** sense of **security**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and stupid ones will be ruined because of their false security] or [false security of stupid ones is like someone who will ruin them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 1:32 (#5)

וְשִׁלְנוּת

“and {false} security”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **false security**, you could express the same idea with a different expression. Alternate translation: [wrongly feeling secure]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:33 (#3)

מִפֶּפֶחַד רָעָה

“from the dread of evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **dread** in 1:26 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 1:33 (#2)

מִפֶּפֶחַד רָעָה

“from the dread of evil”

Here, the possessive form describes **dread** that a person has for **evil**. If this is not clear in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from dreading evil]

See: Possession

Proverbs 1:33 (#1)

וְשִׁמְעָה

“But the one who listens”

But here indicates a strong contrast between **the one who listens** and “the naive ones,” who were mentioned in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [However, the one who listens]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

The benefits of wisdom * God watches over those who see wisdom (2:1-11) * Wisdom saves you from wicked men (2:12-15) * Wisdom saves you from adulterous women (2:16-19) * Following wisdom leads to a good life (2:20-22)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My Son

Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that all of those proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Proverbs 2:1 (#1)

בְּבִנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 2:1 (#3)

וְהִמְצֹאתִי תִצְפֹּן אִתְּךָ

“and my commandments you store up with you”

Valuing the father’s **commandments** is spoken of as if the **commandments** were a treasure and the person were a safe place to store that treasure. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and consider my commandments to be as valuable as a treasure]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:1 (#2)

אִם

“if”

Here, **if** indicates the beginning of a conditional sentence that extends from this verse to 2:5. This is the first of three **if** clauses in this long sentence. If it would be clearer in your language, you could divide this long sentence into shorter sentences and indicate the condition along with the result in 2:5, as in the UST.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 2:2 (#4)

תִּטְּהַל לְלִבְךָ

“you incline your heart”

In many languages this sentence would need the word “if” here in order to be complete. You could supply this word from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you incline your heart]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:2 (#3)

לְחָכְמָה & לְתִבְיוֹנָה

“to wisdom & to understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:2 (#1)

לְהַקְשִׁיב לְחָכְמָה אֲזַנְגָּד תִּשְׁטָה לְלִבְדָּךְ לְתִבְיוֹנָה

“to cause your ear to be attentive to wisdom, you incline your heart to understanding”

The word translated as **to** here indicates that what follows in this verse explains the means by which a person can receive the sayings and commandments mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by causing your ear to be attentive to wisdom, and by inclining your heart to understanding]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:2 (#5)

תִּשְׁטָה לְלִבְדָּךְ לְתִבְיוֹנָה

“you incline your heart to understanding”

The phrase **incline your heart** is an idiom that refers to fully committing one’s mind or will to doing something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if you fully commit yourself to gaining understanding]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:2 (#2)

לְהַקְשִׁיב & אֲזַנְגָּד

“to cause your ear to be attentive”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to forcing oneself to listen carefully. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [force yourself to listen attentively]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:3 (#3)

לְלִתְבִּינָה תִתְנֶנּוּ קוֹלְךָ

“for understanding you lift up your voice”

In many languages this sentence would need the word “if” here in order to be complete. You could supply this word from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if for understanding you lift up your voice]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:3 (#2)

לְבִינָה & לְלִתְבִּינָה

“for insight & for understanding”

Here Solomon speaks of calling out to receive **insight** and **understanding** as if they were people whom someone could summon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to receive insight ... to receive understanding]

See: Personification

Proverbs 2:3 (#1)

אֵאָם לְבִינָה תִקְרָא לְלִתְבִּינָה תִתְנֶנּוּ קוֹלְךָ

“if for insight you call out, for understanding you lift up your voice”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [if for insightful understanding you lift up your voice to call out]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:3 (#5)

לְלִתְבִּינָה

“for understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:3 (#4)

לְבִינָה

“for insight”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **insight**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for what should be perceived]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:3 (#6)

תִּתֵּן קוֹלְךָ

“you lift up your voice”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to speaking loudly. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you speak with a loud voice]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:4 (#3)

תִּבְקֹשׁ שֶׁנָּה & תִּחְפְּשֶׁנָּה

“you seek it & you search for it”

In this verse, the pronoun **it** refers to wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you seek wisdom ... search for wisdom]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 2:4 (#1)

אִם־תִּבְקֹשׁ שֶׁנָּה כַּכֶּסֶף וְכַמְטֹמוֹנִים תִּחְפְּשֶׁנָּה

“if you seek it as silver, and as hidden treasures you search for it”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [if you diligently search for it like a valuable hidden treasure]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:4 (#4)

אִם־תִּבְקֹשׁ שֶׁנָּה כַּכֶּסֶף וְכַמְטֹמוֹנִים תִּחְפְּשֶׁנָּה

“if you seek it as silver, and as hidden treasures you search for it”

Solomon is saying that wisdom is like **silver** and **hidden treasures** because those are items that people value greatly and work very hard to find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [if you seek it diligently, like

one seeks silver, and search for it diligently, like one searches for hidden treasures]

See: Simile

Proverbs 2:4 (#2)

אִם־תִּבְקֹשׁ שֶׁנָּה כַּכֶּסֶף וְכַמְטֹמוֹנִים תִּחְפְּשֶׁנָּה

“if you seek it as silver, and as hidden treasures you search for it”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you seek it as if it were silver and search for it as if it were hidden treasures] or [if you seek it as you would seek silver and search for it as you would search for hidden treasures]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:5 (#2)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:5 (#1)

אָז

“then”

Here, **then** indicates that what follows is the result of meeting the conditions that are stated in 2:1–4. If you divided this long sentence in 2:1–5 into shorter sentences, then you will need to indicate the condition before the result here in this new sentence, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [If you do so, then the result will be that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:5 (#3)

וְיָדַעַת אֱלֹהִים תִּמְצָא

“and the knowledge of God you will find”

Obtaining **the knowledge of God** is spoken of as if **the knowledge of God** were an object that a person can **find** by searching for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will have the knowledge of God]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:5 (#4)

וְיִדְעַת אֱלֹהִים תִּמְצָא

“and the knowledge of God you will find”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe knowing **God**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and you will find how to know God]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:6 (#2)

הַכְּמָהָה & הַדָּעַת וְהַבִּינָה

“wisdom & are} knowledge and understanding”

See how you translated **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** and **understanding** in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:6 (#3)

מִמֶּפֶיִי דָעַת וְהַבִּינָה

“from his mouth {are} knowledge and understanding”

Here, **mouth** represents Yahweh himself or what he says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from Yahweh comes knowledge and understanding]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 2:6 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason why what Solomon stated in 2:1–4 is true. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is due to the fact that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:7 (#5)

הֵם

“with} integrity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:7 (#1)

וַצִּפֵּן לַיֹּשְׁרִים תוֹשִׁיָּה

“And he stores up for the upright ones sound wisdom”

Yahweh possessing **sound wisdom** that he gives to people is spoken of as if **sound wisdom** were an item that Yahweh **stores up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he has sound wisdom to provide for the upright ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:7 (#4)

לַהֲלֹכֵי הֵם

“for those walking {with} integrity”

Here, **walking** refers to how people behave. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who conduct themselves with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:7 (#2)

תוֹשִׁיָּה

“sound wisdom”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sound wisdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [soundly wise things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:7 (#3)

מִמֶּגֶן לַהֲלֹכֵי הֵם

“a shield for those walking {with} integrity”

Yahweh protecting his people is spoken of as if he were a **shield**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he shields those walking with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:8 (#1)

לְלִנְצֹר

“to guard”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for Yahweh giving “sound wisdom” and being a “shield,” as stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural

way in your language to indicate a purpose. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Yahweh does these things for the purpose of guarding]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 2:8 (#2)

אַרְחֻחֹת מִשְׁפָּט

“the paths of justice”

Here, **paths** could refer to: (1) the behavior of people, in which case the meaning is similar to the next clause in the verse. Alternate translation: [those who behave justly]; (2) **justice** itself, as if it were **paths**. Alternate translation: [the path that is justice] or [justice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:8 (#3)

וְדֹרֶךְ חֲסִידוֹ יִשְׁמֶר

“and the way of his faithful ones he will preserve”

Here Solomon speaks of the lives of God’s **faithful ones** as if they were a **way** or road. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will preserve the lives of his faithful ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:9 (#3)

כָּל־מַעַלְל־טוֹב

“every good track”

Here Solomon speaks of wise behavior as if it were a **good track**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [every good way of living]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:9 (#1)

אָז

“Then”

Then here indicates that what follows is another result of meeting the conditions stated in 2:1–4. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate the result of meeting conditions. Alternate translation: [If you do those things, then the result will be that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:9 (#2)

צַדִּיק וּמִשְׁפָּט וְיִשְׁרָיִים

“righteousness and justice and integrity”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness**, **justice**, and **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:10 (#2)

תִּבְּרֹא & בְּלִבְּךָ

“will enter into your heart”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to fully knowing something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [will be fully in your mind] or [will become a part of you] or [will be the way that you think]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:10 (#3)

לִנְפֶשְׁךָ יִנָּעַם

“will be pleasant to your soul”

Here, **soul** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be pleasant to you]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 2:10 (#1)

חֵכְמָה & יְדֻעָה

“wisdom & and knowledge”

See how you translated **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:11 (#3)

מִדְּבִינָה & תְּבוּנָה

“Discretion & understanding”

See how you translated **Discretion** in 1:4 and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:11 (#2)

מְחִיזָה תִּשְׁמְרֵם עַל־יָד תְּבוּנָה תִּנְצְרֶכֶּה

“Discretion will watch over you; understanding will guard you”

Here Solomon speaks of **discretion** and **understanding** as if they were people who could **protect** and **guard** someone else. He means that someone who has **discretion** and **understanding** will be safe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [If you have discretion, you will be safe; if you have understanding, you will be secure]

See: Personification

Proverbs 2:11 (#1)

מְחִיזָה תִּשְׁמְרֵם עַל־יָד תְּבוּנָה תִּנְצְרֶכֶּה

“Discretion will watch over you; understanding will guard you”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Discretion will watch over you, yes, understanding will protect you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:12 (#1)

לְהַצִּילֶךָ מִדֶּרֶךְ רָע מִמְּאָאִישׁ מִדְּבַבֵּר תִּהְפֹּכֹת

“to rescue you from the way of evil, from a man speaking perversions”

2:11-17 are one long sentence. If you divide these verses into multiple sentences then you may need to repeat some phrases in order to make the meaning clear, as the UST does.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:12 (#2)

לְהַצִּילֶךָ

“to rescue you”

Here Solomon speaks of “discretion” and “understanding” as if they were people who could **rescue** someone. He means that people who have “discretion” and “understanding” will keep themselves away from harm. If it would be helpful in your language, you could

express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to keep you away]

See: Personification

Proverbs 2:12 (#8)

מִמֶּאִישׁ

“from a man”

The word **man** here represents a type of person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [from any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 2:12 (#3)

לְהַצִּילֶךָ

“to rescue you”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for “discretion” and “understanding” protecting a person, as stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a purpose. Alternate translation: [Discretion and understanding will protect you for the purpose of rescuing you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 2:12 (#6)

רָע

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:12 (#4)

מִדֶּרֶךְ רָע

“from the way of evil”

This phrase **the way of evil** could refer to: (1) the **way** of an **evil** person. This interpretation fits the context of the descriptions of evil people given in 2:12-17. Alternate translation: [from the way of an evil person]; (2) a **way** that is characterized by **evil**. Alternate translation: [from any evil way]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:12 (#7)

מִמֶּאִישׁ

“from a man”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and to rescue you from a man]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:12 (#5)

מִדֶּבֶר

“from the way of”

Here Solomon uses **way** to refer to how people behave. See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:13 (#1)

הַעֲזֹבִים

“the ones who forsake”

See how you translated the same use of **forsake** in 1:8.

See: Personification

Proverbs 2:13 (#2)

אֲרָחֲתוֹת יֵשֶׁר

“the paths of straightness”

Here, **the paths of straightness** refers to behaving in a right manner. The word **paths** refers to human behavior, and **straightness** refers to being righteous. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [doing what is right] or [acting rightly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:13 (#4)

לִלְלֹכַת בְּדֶרֶךְ-יְהוֹשָׁף

“to walk in the ways of darkness”

This phrase refers to behaving in an evil manner. The biblical authors often use **walk** to refer to how someone behaves and they use **darkness** to refer to evil. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to do what is evil] or [to behave in an evil manner]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 2:13 (#3)

לִלְלֹכַת

“to walk”

Here, **to** introduces the purpose for forsaking **the paths of straightness**. Use a natural way in your language to indicate purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of walking]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 2:14 (#1)

רָעָה & רָע

“evil & evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:14 (#2)

בְּתִהְיוֹתָם רָעָה

“in perverse things of evil”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **perverse things** that are characterized by **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [evil perverse things]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:15 (#1)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר אֲרָחֲתֵיהֶם עֲקָשִׁים וְנִלְוִזִּים בְּמַעֲגֻלֹתָם

“whose paths {are} crooked and going astray in their tracks”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [whose paths are crooked, yes, who go astray in their tracks]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:15 (#2)

אֲרָחֲתֵיהֶם עֲקָשִׁים וְנִלְוִזִּים בְּמַעֲגֻלֹתָם

“paths {are} crooked and going astray in their tracks”

Here Solomon refers to people’s wrong behavior as if they were walking on the wrong **paths** and **tracks**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [behavior is dishonest and who do things to deceive others]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:16 (#4)

מִמְּנִכְרִיָּה

“from a foreign woman”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and to rescue you from a foreign woman]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:16 (#5)

אֲמַרְרִיהָ הַחֲלִיקָה

“who makes her sayings smooth”

Here Solomon speaks of this woman speaking seductively as if she were making what she says **smooth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who makes her sayings seductive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:16 (#1)

לְהַצִּילְךָ

“to rescue you”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is another purpose for “discretion” and “understanding” guarding a person, as stated in the 2:11. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a purpose. If you divided up the long sentence in 2:11–17 into shorter sentences, then here, beginning a new sentence, you will need to repeat some information from 2:11. Alternate translation: [Discretion and understanding will guard you for the additional purpose of rescuing you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 2:16 (#2)

מִאִשָּׁשָׁה זָרָה מִמְּנִכְרִיָּה

“from a strange woman, from a foreign woman”

Here Solomon refers to an immoral and adulterous **woman** as if she were a stranger or foreigner. The woman is **strange** or **foreign** not because she is from a different ethnic group, but because she belongs to another man; she is a stranger to the son’s own marriage. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:16 (#3)

מִאִשָּׁשָׁה זָרָה מִמְּנִכְרִיָּה

“from a strange woman, from a foreign woman”

Solomon is speaking of any women who do these things, not of one particular **woman**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [from any strange woman, from any foreign woman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 2:17 (#1)

אֶלְיוֹ

“the companion of”

Here, **companion** refers to the husband of the adulterous woman mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the husband of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:17 (#3)

נְעוּרֶיהָ

“her youth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **youth**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the time when she was young]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 2:17 (#2)

אֶלְיוֹ נְעוּרֶיהָ

“the companion of her youth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the companion** whom this woman married while she was in **her youth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the companion whom she married in her youth]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:17 (#4)

בְּרִית אֵלֶּהָ

“the covenant of her God”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the covenant** that this woman made with **her God**. If

it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the covenant that she made with her God]

See: Possession

Proverbs 2:17 (#5)

בְּרִית אֱלֹהֶיהָ

“the covenant of her God”

Here, **covenant** refers specifically to the **covenant** that a man and woman made with each other and God when they married. This **covenant** included promising not to commit adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the covenant that she made with her God when she married her husband]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:18 (#3)

שִׁשְׁחָה & בֵּיתָהּ

“her house sinks down”

Here, **her house** represents the woman herself and her activities. Alternate translation: [being involved with her takes you down]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 2:18 (#4)

שִׁשְׁחָה אֶל-מָמוֹת

“sinks down to death”

Here Solomon speaks of death as a place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [results in a man dying] or [is a way to die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:18 (#6)

מַעְגְּלֶיהָ

“her tracks”

Here, Solomon speaks of the activities that a man would participate in with this woman as **her tracks**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [becoming involved with her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:18 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason why “discretion” and “understanding” rescue a man from an adulterous woman, as stated in 2:16. Use the most natural way in your language to state a reason. Alternate translation: [Discretion and understanding will rescue you from her because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:18 (#7)

רוּחַ פְּאֵאִים

“the spirits of dead ones”

Here, **the spirits of dead ones** refers to the place where people’s spirits go when they die, which was called “Sheol” in 1:12. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the place where the spirits of dead people dwell] or [the place of the dead]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 2:18 (#5)

וְאֵלֵי-רוּחַ פְּאֵאִים מַעְגְּלֶיהָ

“and her tracks, to the spirits of dead ones”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. If necessary, you could supply these words from the previous clause. Alternate translation: [and her tracks sink down to the spirits of the dead] or [and her tracks lead to the spirits of the dead]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 2:18 (#2)

שִׁשְׁחָה אֶל-מָמוֹת בֵּיתָהּ וְאֵלֵי-רוּחַ פְּאֵאִים מַעְגְּלֶיהָ

“her house sinks down to death and her tracks, to the spirits of dead ones”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [involvement with her will totally destroy you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:19 (#2)

לֹא יָשׁוּבָהּ

“will not return”

Here, Solomon refers to being restored to a righteous life as a **return** from the path that leads to death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will never again have a righteous life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:19 (#3)

וְלֹא־יָשִׁיגוּ אֶרְחֻקֹת תַּיִם

“and they will not reach the paths of life”

Solomon speaks of living in God’s way that leads to life with him as **the paths of life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will never again live happily as God desires]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:19 (#1)

כְּבָאִיהָ

“those who enter her”

Here, **enter** refers to someone having sex with another person. This is a polite way of referring to something that is offensive or embarrassing in some cultures. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different polite way of referring to this act or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [those who have sex with her] or [those who sleep with her]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 2:20 (#3)

תִּתְּלַךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ טוֹבִים וְאֶרְחֻקֹת צְדִיקִים תִּשְׁמֹר

“you shall walk in the way of the good ones and the paths of the righteous ones you shall keep”

Solomon is using a future statement to give an instruction or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command or instruction form. Alternate translation: [walk in the way of the good ones and keep the paths of the righteous ones]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Proverbs 2:20 (#2)

תִּתְּלַךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ טוֹבִים וְאֶרְחֻקֹת צְדִיקִים תִּשְׁמֹר

“you shall walk in the way of the good ones and the paths of the righteous ones you shall keep”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you shall walk in the way of the good ones, yes, keep the path of the righteous ones]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:20 (#4)

תִּתְּלַךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ & וְאֶרְחֻקֹת

“you shall walk in the way of & and the paths of”

Solomon is speaking of how people behave or live their lives as walking along a certain **way** or staying on certain **paths**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you shall behave like ... and the behaviors of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:20 (#1)

לִמְעַן

“So”

So here indicates that what follows is the result of what was stated in 2:11–19 as being true. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [Because this is true,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:21 (#4)

וְהַתְּמִימִים

“and the blameless”

Here, **the blameless** refers to people who do what is right. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the people who do what is right]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:21 (#3)

יִשְׁכְּנוּ אֶצְרָן & יִנָּחְרוּ בָּהּ

“will dwell {in} the land & will remain in it”

Here, **the land** and **it** could refer to: (1) the **land** of Israel, which God had given to the Jewish people and which Solomon was ruling over when he wrote these proverbs. Alternate translation: [will dwell in the land of Israel ... will remain in Israel] or [will dwell in our land ... will remain in our land]; (2) the earth in general,

in which case this would refer to staying alive. Alternate translation: [will dwell on the earth ... will remain alive on the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:21 (#2)

יְשׁוּרִים יִשְׁכְּנוּ אֶרֶץ וְיִתְמִימִים יִנָּתְרוּ בָּהּ

“the upright will dwell {in} the land, and the blameless will remain in it”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [the blameless, upright ones will remain to dwell in the land]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:21 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows in 2:21–22 is the reason for what was stated in 2:11–20. Use an expression for this that is natural in your language. See how you translated a similar use of **For** in 1:32. Alternate translation: [Do this, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 2:22 (#2)

וְרָשָׁעִים מֵאֶרֶץ יִכְרֹתוּ וְכֹפְרֵי דָבָר יִסָּחֲחוּ מִמֶּנָּה

“but wicked ones will be cut off from the land, and treacherous ones will be torn away from it”

These two phrases mean similar things. The author is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [but wicked ones will be cut off from the land, yes, all the treacherous ones will be torn away from it]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 2:22 (#3)

יִכְרֹתוּ & יִסָּחֲחוּ

“will be cut off & will be torn away”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another

way that is natural in your language. The context indicates that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will cut off ... Yahweh will tear away]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 2:22 (#4)

יִכְרֹתוּ & יִסָּחֲחוּ

“will be cut off & will be torn away”

Solomon speaks of Yahweh removing people from **the land** as if he were cutting those people off, like a person cuts a branch from a tree, or as if he were tearing those people away, like a person violently pulls someone off of something. Solomon does not state if these people are removed by being killed or by being forced to leave **the land**, so it is best to use general expressions for these phrases. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be removed ... will be taken away]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 2:22 (#5)

מֵאֶרֶץ & מִמֶּנָּה

“from the land & from it”

See how you translated **the land** and **it** in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 2:22 (#1)

וְרָשָׁעִים

“but wicked ones”

Here, **but** indicates a strong contrast between the **wicked** and **treacherous** people in this verse and the “upright” and “blameless” people, who were mentioned in the previous verse. See how you translated a similar strong contrast in 1:33.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Benefits of wisdom * Humbly trust Yahweh (3:1–12) * The value of wisdom (3:13–20) * Do not act wickedly (3:21–35)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My Son

Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” While some of these proverbs are about common temptations of young men, the proverbs in this chapter apply more generally to people and their relationships with others.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Personification

In 3:15–18, wisdom is referred to as if it were a woman. In languages where it makes sense for a woman figure to represent an abstract concept like wisdom, the translator can translate the personification directly. However, if direct translation does not work in your language, consider translating these personifications as similes instead. In that case, wisdom would be presented as being like a wise woman. (See: Personification)

Proverbs 3:1 (#1)

בְּרִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 3:1 (#5)

וּמִצְוֹתַי

“and my commandments”

See how you translated the abstract noun **commandments** in 2:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:1 (#6)

יִצְעָר לְבָד

“let your heart guard”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:1 (#4)

תּוֹרָתִי

“my law”

Here, the word **law** is singular in form, but it refers to several laws as a group. See how you translated this use of **law** in 1:8.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 3:1 (#2)

תּוֹרָתִי אֶל־תִּשְׁכַּח וּמִצְוֹתַי יִצְעָר לְבָד

“do not forget my law, and my commandments let your heart guard”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [do not forget my law, yes, my commandments let your heart guard]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:1 (#3)

אֶל־תִּשְׁכַּח

“do not forget”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning positively, as in the UST.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 3:1 (#7)

יִצְעָר לְבָד

“let your heart guard”

Here Solomon speaks of a person’s **heart** as if it were a person who could **guard** something, and he speaks of **commandments** as if they were things that could be guarded. He means that he wants his son to remember these **commandments** in order to obey them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remember to obey]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:2 (#3)

אֶאֱרֶךְ יָמִים

“length of days”

Here, **length of days** is an idiom that means “a long life.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language

that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a long life]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:2 (#6)

יוֹסִיפוּ

“they will add”

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to the law and commandments mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [my law and commandments will add]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:2 (#4)

וְשָׁנֹת חַיִּים

“and years of life”

Here, **years of life** is an idiom that means “a long and fulfilling life.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a fulfilling life] or [and years of fulfilling life]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:2 (#7)

יוֹסִיפוּ לְךָ

“they will add to you”

Here Solomon speaks of his commandments as if they could **add length** to a person’s life. He means that obeying his commandments will enable a person to live a long life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [obeying them will add to you] or [by obeying them you will add to yourself]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:2 (#5)

וְשָׁלֹוֹם

“and peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and a peaceful life]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:2 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Remember my commandments because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:2 (#2)

אֲדַרְךָ יָמִים וְשָׁנֹת חַיִּים וְשָׁלֹוֹם יוֹסִיפוּ לְךָ

“length of days and years of life and peace, they will add to you”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [they will add to you length of days and years of life and peace]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 3:3 (#3)

חֲתִיד וְאֱמֻנַת אֱלֹהֵינוּבְרָךְ

“Do not let covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness leave you”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **leave**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [Retain covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 3:3 (#7)

כָּתְבֵם עַל־לִבְּךָ לְבָדָה

“write them on the tablet of your heart”

Here Solomon speaks of the **heart** as if it were a **tablet** upon which someone could **write covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness**. He means that people should always remember to behave with **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [keep these things in your mind] or [always remember them, as if you had written them permanently on a tablet]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:3 (#6)

כָּתְבֵם עַל־לִבְּךָ לְבָד

“write them on the tablet of your heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:3 (#2)

הִתְסַד וְאִמְמַת אֶל־יַעֲזֹבְבְךָ

“Do not let covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness leave you”

Here Solomon speaks of **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** as if they were people who could **leave** someone. He means that a person should not stop being faithful and trustworthy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not stop being faithful and trustworthy]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:3 (#4)

הִתְסַד וְאִמְמַת

“covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [being faithful and trustworthy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:3 (#5)

קְשִׁרָם עַל־גְּרוֹתְתֶיךָ

“tie them on your neck”

Here Solomon speaks of **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** as if they were objects that a person could **tie** around his **neck** like a necklace. He means that these are valuable qualities that people should display outwardly by their behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [show them outwardly by how you behave] or [display them like one would wear a necklace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:3 (#1)

הִתְסַד וְאִמְמַת אֶל־יַעֲזֹבְבְךָ קְשִׁרָם עַל־גְּרוֹתְתֶיךָ כְּתָבֵם עַל־לִבְּךָ לְבָד

“Do not let covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness leave you; tie them on your neck, write them on the tablet of your heart”

These three clauses mean basically the same thing. The second and third clauses emphasize the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a word that shows the connection between these three clauses. Alternate translation: [Do not let covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness leave you, yes, bind them on your throats, indeed, write them on the tablet of your heart]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:4 (#2)

וּמְצָא

“and find”

The word translated **find** is an imperative, but it communicates a good result rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a good result. Alternate translation: [and then you will get]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 3:4 (#3)

וּמְצָא־חֵן וְשִׂכְל־טוֹב

“and find favor and good insight”

Here Solomon speaks of **favor** and **good insight** as if they were objects that a person could find. He means that **God and man** will show **favor** and **good insight** to the person who does what Solomon commanded in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will experience favor and good insight]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:4 (#5)

וְאָדָם

“and man”

Solomon is speaking of people in general, not of one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [and others]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:4 (#4)

בְּעֵינַי

“in the eyes of”

Here, **eyes** refers to seeing, and seeing is a metaphor for knowledge, notice, attention, or judgment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:4 (#1)

וּמָצָא חַסֵּד

“and find favor”

Here the word **and** introduces the result of obeying the commands stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do these things, then you will find favor] or [This will result in you finding favor]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:5 (#1)

לִבְךָ

“your heart”

See how you translated **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:5 (#2)

וְאַל-בְּבִינְתְּךָ אֶל-תִּשְׁעֶן

“and on your understanding do not lean”

Here Solomon speaks of relying on one's own **understanding** as if **understanding** were an object on which a person could **lean**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do not rely on your own understanding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:5 (#3)

בְּבִינְתְּךָ

“your understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:6 (#2)

וְיָהוָה יִשְׁשֶׁר

“and he himself will straighten”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the commands stated in the previous verse and the beginning of this verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do these things, then he himself will straighten] or [This will result in he himself straightening]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:6 (#4)

וְיָהוָה יִשְׁשֶׁר אֶת־דְּרֹכֶיךָ

“and he himself will straighten your paths”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh showing people what they should do as if Yahweh were removing obstacles and smoothing out **paths** that people walk on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he himself will make clear to you what you should do] or [and he himself will guide your actions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:6 (#1)

בְּכָל־דְּרֹכֶיךָ & אֶת־דְּרֹכֶיךָ

“In all your ways & your paths”

Here Solomon speaks of a person's actions as if they were **ways** or **paths** on which that person walks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In all that you do ... how you live]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:6 (#3)

וְיָהוָה יִשְׁשֶׁר

“and he himself will straighten”

For emphasis, Solomon is explicitly stating a pronoun even though the meaning **he** is already there. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **himself**. Alternate translation: [he indeed will straighten]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:7 (#1)

בְּעֵינֶיךָ

“in your eyes”

Here Solomon speaks of a person's opinion as if that person were seeing something with his **eyes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in your own opinion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:7 (#4)

מֶרֶע

“from evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:7 (#3)

וְסָקוֹר מֶרֶע

“and turn away from evil”

Here Solomon speaks of refusing to do **evil** actions as if a person were turning away **from evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and do not commit evil acts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:7 (#2)

יִרְאָה אֶת־יְהוָה וְסָקוֹר מֶרֶע

“fear Yahweh and turn away from evil”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. While the previous clause said what a person should not do, this clause says what that person should do instead. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Rather, fear Yahweh and turn from evil]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 3:8 (#1)

וְשָׂקוֹר לְעֵצְמוֹתַי וְשָׂקוֹר לְעֵצְמוֹתַי

“It will be healing for your navel and refreshment for your bones”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying

something additional. Alternate translation: [It will be healing for your navel, yes, refreshment for your bones]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:8 (#4)

וְשָׂקוֹר לְעֵצְמוֹתַי

“and refreshment for your bones”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and it will be refreshment for your bones]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:8 (#3)

לְשִׁרְרָדָּה & לְעֵצְמוֹתַי

“for your navel & for your bones”

Solomon is using parts of a person, the **navel** and **bones**, to represent a person's whole body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for your body ... for your whole body]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 3:8 (#2)

תִּהְיֶה

“It will be”

The pronoun **It** here refers to following the commands that Solomon stated in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Obeying these commands will be]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:8 (#5)

וְשָׂקוֹר לְעֵצְמוֹתַי

“and refreshment for your bones”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **refreshment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and will cause your bones to be refreshed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:9 (#1)

מהונגד וזמראששית כל־תבואתך

“from your wealth and from the first of all your produce”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [by giving from your wealth and by giving from the first of all your produce]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:9 (#2)

וזמראששית

“and from the first of”

Here, **first** refers to the **first** crops that were harvested at harvest time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and from the first crops harvested of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:10 (#5)

וְתִירֹשׁ יִקְבְּרֶיךָ יִפְרְצוּ

“and with new wine, your wine vats will burst open”

The word **vats** refers to large containers in which the juice of grapes called **new wine** was processed into **wine**. If a very large amount of **new wine** was put in the **vat**, it could flow out and spill over the top of the **vat**. If your readers would not be familiar with **wine** or the way it is produced, you could refer to something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and your storage containers for juice will become so extremely full that they break open]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 3:10 (#3)

אֶסְמִיךָ

“your storehouses”

The word **storehouses** refers to buildings or rooms where crops are stored after farmers have harvested them. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of storage place, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [your barns] or [your place for storing harvested crops]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 3:10 (#4)

שְׂבָבָע

“abundance”

Here, **abundance** refers to a plentiful amount of harvested crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a plentiful amount of harvested crops]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:10 (#2)

וְיִמְלֵאָו אֶסְמִיךָ שְׂבָבָע

“and your storehouses will be filled with abundance”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and your store houses will become abundantly full] or [and Yahweh will abundantly fill your storehouses]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 3:10 (#1)

וְיִמְלֵאָו אֶסְמִיךָ שְׂבָבָע

“and your storehouses will be filled with abundance”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do these things, then your storehouses will be filled with plenty] or [This will result in your storehouses being abundantly full]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:11 (#2)

בְּנִי

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 3:11 (#1)

מוֹסֵר & בְּתוֹכָהּ

“The correction of & his rebuke”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **correction** and **rebuke**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [Being corrected by ... being rebuked by him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:12 (#3)

אֶת־בֶּן יִרְצֶה

“a son in whom he delights”

The phrase **in whom he delights** refers to the father’s affection for his **son**. It does not mean that the father approves of his son’s behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a son for whom he has great affection]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:12 (#2)

וְכַאֲבֹאֵב אֶת־בֶּן יִרְצֶה

“and like a father, a son in whom he delights”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and like a father, he disciplines a son in whom he delights]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:12 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here introduces the reason for obeying the commands stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate reasons. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Do not do these things, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:12 (#4)

אֶת־בֶּן

“a son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 3:13 (#3)

מִצְצֵא חִכְמָה

“who finds wisdom”

Here Solomon speaks of attaining **wisdom** as if it were an object that a person **finds**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who attains wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:13 (#5)

חִכְמָה & תְּבוּנָה

“wisdom & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:13 (#2)

אָדָם & אִישׁ

“is} a man & and a man”

In this verse, **a man** represents a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is a person ... and a person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:13 (#4)

אִישׁ יִפְקִי תְבוּנָה

“and a man who obtains understanding”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and happy is a man who obtains understanding]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:13 (#1)

אִשְׁרֵי אָדָם מִצְצֵא חִכְמָה וְאִישׁ יִפְקִי תְבוּנָה

“Happy [is} a man who finds wisdom and a man who obtains understanding”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Happy is a man who

finds wisdom, yes, happy is a man who obtains understanding]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:14 (#2)

טוב סתרה מסתר-כסף ומהררין תבואתה

“better {is} its profit than the profit of silver, and than gold, its produce”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [better {is} its profit than the profit of silver, yes, better than the produce of gold is its produce]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:14 (#4)

סתרה & תבואתה

“{is} its profit & its produce”

In this verse, **its** refers to wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is wisdom’s profit ... wisdom’s produce]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:14 (#1)

כפי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason what was stated in the previous verse is true. Use the most natural way in your language to state a reason. Alternate translation: [This is due to the fact that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:14 (#7)

והמהררין תבואתה

“and than gold, its produce”

Although the word **produce** usually refers to harvested crops, Solomon uses it here to refer to a benefit in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and than gold, its benefit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:14 (#3)

והמהררין תבואתה

“and than gold, its produce”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and better than the produce of gold is its produce]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 3:14 (#6)

מסתר-כסף

“than the profit of silver”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **profit** or wealth that one gains by having **silver**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [than the benefit one gets from having silver]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:14 (#5)

סתרה מסתר-כסף

“{is} its profit than the profit of silver”

Although the word **profit** usually refers to money that someone earns, Solomon uses it here to refer to a benefit in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is its benefit than the benefit of silver]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:15 (#2)

יקקרה & מפניים

“is more precious than coral pearls”

The word translated **coral pearls** could also refer to precious stones called “rubies.” Either word refers to an item that is extremely valuable. If your readers would not be familiar with **coral pearls** or rubies, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is more precious than valuable stones] or [is more precious than something that is extremely valuable]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 3:15 (#1)

הָיָא & בָּהּ

“She & with her”

In 3:15–18 Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [It ... with it]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:16 (#3)

בְּיָמֶינָהּ בְּבִשְׁמֹאולָהּ עֵשֶׂר

“is} in her right hand; in her left hand {are} riches”

Here Solomon speaks of wise people receiving **length of days**, **riches**, and **honor** as if they were objects received from the **right** and **left** hands of wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is received by those who have wisdom; those who have wisdom receive riches]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:16 (#2)

בְּיָמֶינָהּ בְּבִשְׁמֹאולָהּ

“is} in her right hand; in her left hand”

In this verse, **her** refers to wisdom as if it were a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is in wisdom’s right hand; in wisdom’s left hand]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:16 (#1)

אֶתֶּרֶךְ יָמִים

“Length of days”

See how you translated this idiom in 3:2.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:16 (#4)

וְכָבוֹד

“and honor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **honor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and being honored]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:17 (#3)

דְּרָכָהּ דְּרָכִי & נְתִיבוֹתֶיהָ שְׁלוֹם

“Her ways {are} ways of & her paths {are} peace”

In this verse, **ways** and **paths** refer to how being wise guides a person’s behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Wise behavior is behavior of ... wise behavior brings peace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:17 (#2)

דְּרָכָהּ & נְתִיבוֹתֶיהָ

“Her ways & her paths”

Her and **her** here refer to wisdom as if it were a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Wisdom’s ways ... wisdom’s paths]

See: Personification

Proverbs 3:17 (#4)

דְּרָכֵי־נֶגַעַם

“are} ways of pleasantness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **ways** that result in **pleasantness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [are ways that lead to pleasantness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:17 (#1)

דְּרָכָהּ דְּרָכֵי־נֶגַעַם וְכָל־נְתִיבוֹתֶיהָ שְׁלוֹם

“Her ways {are} ways of pleasantness, and all her paths {are} peace”

These two phrases mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Her way of life is one of peaceful pleasantness]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 3:17 (#5)

שְׁלוֹם

“are} peace”

Here Solomon implies that **peace** is the result of following wisdom's **paths**. Use a natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [lead to being peaceful] or [result in living peacefully]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:17 (#6)

שְׁלום

“are} peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another. Alternate translation: [are what is peaceful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:18 (#4)

לִמְחֹזִיקִים בָּבָהּ וְתִמְכְּכִיהָ

“to the ones who take hold of her, and those who grasp her”

Here Solomon refers to people who persist in being wise as if they **take hold of** or **grasp** wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the ones who obtain wisdom, and those who hold on to wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:18 (#3)

עֵץ־חַיִּים & לִמְחֹזִיקִים בָּבָהּ

“is} a tree of life to the ones who take hold of her”

Here Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a **tree** that gives **life** to those who eat its fruit. He means that wisdom causes a person to live a long and happy life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [results in a good life for the ones who take hold of her] or [is like a tree that sustains the lives of the ones who take hold of her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:18 (#2)

עֵץ־חַיִּים

“is} a tree of life”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **tree** with fruit that sustains **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is a tree that gives life] or [is a tree with fruit that sustains life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:18 (#1)

הִיא & בָּבָהּ וְתִמְכְּכִיהָ

“She & of her, and those who grasp her”

She and **her** here refer to wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Wisdom ... of wisdom, and those who grasp wisdom]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:19 (#1)

יָסַד־אֶרֶץ

“founded the earth”

Here Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** creating **the earth** as if he were laying the foundation of a building. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [created the earth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:19 (#2)

בְּחָכְמָה & בְּתִבּוּנָה

“by wisdom & by understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2 and **understanding** in 2:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:20 (#1)

בְּדַעְתּוֹ

“By his knowledge”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **knowledge**, you could express the same idea as in the UST.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:20 (#3)

נִבְקָעָהּ

“broke open”

Here, **broke open** refers to: (1) the water from **the depths** bursting out from under the ground and coming to the surface of the earth. Alternate translation: [burst forth water onto the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:20 (#2)

תְּהוֹמֹת

“the depths”

Here, **depths** refers to bodies of water that were deep under the earth’s surface. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the underground bodies of water]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:21 (#4)

נִצָּר

“guard”

Here Solomon speaks of **prudence** and **discretion** as if they were things that could be guarded. He means that he wants his son to remember these qualities in order to practice them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remember to practice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:21 (#1)

בְּבִנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 3:21 (#5)

תְּחָשִׁיָּה וּמְזִמָּה

“prudence and discretion”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **prudence** and **discretion** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:21 (#3)

אַל-יִלְּזוּ מֵעֵינֶיךָ

“do not let them depart from your eyes”

Here Solomon speaks of someone not forgetting something as if he were always able to see that thing with his **eyes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do not forget them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:21 (#2)

אַל-יִלְּזוּ מֵעֵינֶיךָ נִצָּר תְּחָשִׁיָּה וּמְזִמָּה

“do not let them depart from your eyes; guard prudence and discretion”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [guard prudence and discretion, do not let them depart from your eyes]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 3:22 (#2)

וְהָיָה

“and they will be”

Here, **they** refers to the “prudence” and “discretion” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and prudence and discretion will be]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:22 (#5)

וְחֶסֶד לְגִרְתְּךָ

“and grace for your neck”

Here, **grace** refers to something that looks graceful or attractive to others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and graceful ornaments for your neck]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:22 (#3)

לְנַפְשְׁךָ

“for your soul”

See how you translated the same use of **soul** in 2:10.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 3:22 (#4)

וְהָיָה חַיִּים לְנַפְשְׁךָ

“and they will be life for your soul”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to having a full life, in both quality and length. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will allow you to have a good, long life]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:22 (#6)

וְחֵסֶד לְגֵרְתֶּיךָ

“and grace for your neck”

Here Solomon speaks of “prudence” and “discretion” as if they were objects that a person could wear around their **neck** like a necklace. The image suggests that these are valuable things that the person displays outwardly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. See how you translated a similar expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [and be attractive to others, like a necklace around your neck]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:22 (#1)

וְיָדְיוּ

“and they will be”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the commands stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [and this will result in them being] or [If you do this, then they will be]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:23 (#2)

תִּלְלֶךָ לְבִטָּחָה דְרָכְכָּךְ וְיִרְגְּלֶךָ לֹא תִגְוֶה

“you will walk your way to security and your foot will not stumble”

Here Solomon speaks of living one’s life as if one were walking along a **way**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will live your life in security and you will not do what is wrong]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:23 (#1)

אָז תִּלְלֶךָ

“Then you will walk”

Then here introduces more results, stated in verses 23 and 24, of obeying the commands stated in 3:21. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [Because of having prudence and discretion, you will walk]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:23 (#3)

לְבִטָּחָה

“to security”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **security**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [confidently]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:24 (#1)

תִּשְׁכַּב & וְיָשָׁבְתָּ

“you lie down & You will lie down”

In this verse, **lie down** implies lying down in order to sleep. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:25 (#2)

וּמִשְׁאַחַת רָרִשׁוּעִים

“and of the devastation of the wicked”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the devastation** that is related to **the wicked** in some way. This could mean: (1) the devastation that God will do to the wicked people. Alternate translation: [and of the devastation that happens to wicked people]; (2) the devastation that wicked people do to others. Alternate translation: [and of the devastation that wicked people do]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:25 (#3)

תָּבֵא

“it comes”

Here, **it** refers to **the devastation** mentioned earlier in the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that devastation comes]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 3:25 (#1)

מִפְּתָחַד פְּתָאִים וּמִשְׁאַחַת

“of sudden dread and of the devastation of”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **dread** and **devastation**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation:

[of dreadful things that happen suddenly and of any terrible thing concerning]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:26 (#2)

בְּכַסְלֶיךָ

“your confidence”

Here Solomon uses **confidence** to refer to the source of a person’s **confidence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your source of confidence]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:26 (#5)

וְשָׁמַר רֶגְלְךָ מִלִּכְדּוֹ

“and he will keep your foot from capture”

Here Solomon is referring to the “sudden dread” or “devastation” from verse 25 as being caught in a trap. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will keep you from being caught by devastation as by a trap] or [and he will keep you from harm]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:26 (#4)

וְשָׁמַר רֶגְלְךָ מִלִּכְדּוֹ

“and he will keep your foot from capture”

Here, **foot** represents the whole person. See how you translated the similar use of **foot** in 1:15.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 3:26 (#3)

בְּכַסְלֶיךָ

“your confidence”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **confidence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the one who makes you confident]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:26 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the command in the previous verse. Use a connector in

your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not be afraid of these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:27 (#2)

מִבְּעָלָיו

“from its owners”

Here Solomon speaks of the **good** that people deserve as if they were **its owners**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from those to whom it is due]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:27 (#3)

בְּהִיוֹת לְאֵצֶל יָדְךָ

“when it is in the power of your hand”

Here Solomon speaks of being able to do something as if doing something were **in the power of** one’s **hand**. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you have the ability]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 3:27 (#1)

טוֹב

“good”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **good**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [something that is good]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:28 (#2)

אֶתֵּינְךָ וְיִישׁ

“I will give {it},” and it is”

In this verse, **it** refers to the thing that the **neighbor** needs. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I will give you what you need, yet that thing is]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:28 (#3)

וְיִישׁ

“and it is”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is true at the same time as the speaker is speaking in the previous clause. This means that the person speaking refuses to give something to someone even though he has it with him. You can make this clear in your translation with an appropriate connecting word or phrase. Alternate translation: [when it is]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Proverbs 3:28 (#1)

אַל־תִּתֶּנָּה לְרֵעִיךָ

“Do not say to your neighbor”

Solomon implies that the **neighbor** needs something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When your neighbor needs something, do not say to your neighbor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:29 (#3)

לְבִטָּחָה

“securely”

Here, **securely** implies that this person trusts **you** and does not expect to be harmed by **you**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [trustfully]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:29 (#1)

אַל־תִּתְחַרֵּשׁ & רָעָעָה

“Do not plot evil”

Here, **plot evil** implies someone plotting to do an **evil** action. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do not scheme to do something evil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:29 (#2)

רָעָעָה

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:29 (#4)

אַתָּה

“with you”

Here, **with you** refers to being near someone. It does not mean necessarily that these people dwell in the same house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [nearby]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:30 (#1)

אָדָם & לֹא גָמְלָהּ

“a man & he has not done you”

Here, **man** and **he** represent a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a person ... that person has not done you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:30 (#2)

רָעָה

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:31 (#1)

בְּאִישׁ הַמִּלֵּחַ

“of a man of violence”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [of a violent man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:31 (#2)

בְּאִישׁ

“of a man of”

Here, **man** represents a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [of any person of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:31 (#3)

דַּרְכָּיו

“his ways”

Here Solomon uses **ways** to refer to the behavior of **a man of violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the things he does]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:32 (#4)

וְאֵת־יִשְׁרָרִים סוֹדוֹ

“but with the upright ones {is} his secret counsel”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh giving **secret counsel** to people as if it were an object that could be **with** those people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but to the upright ones he gives his secret counsel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:32 (#5)

סוֹדוֹ

“{is} his secret counsel”

The phrase **secret counsel** refers to confidential conversation between friends. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [his confidential conversation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 3:32 (#2)

תוֹעֲבַבֶּת יְהוָה

“an abomination to Yahweh”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abomination**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [an abominable person to Yahweh]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:32 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the command in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is

a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 3:32 (#3)

נָלָלוֹ

“{is} he who goes astray”

Here Solomon refers to someone who refuses to act righteously, instead deliberately doing what is wicked, as if that person **goes astray** from a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is he who acts wickedly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:33 (#3)

בְּבֵית & וּנְוָה & יְבָרַךְ

“{is} on the house of & but he blesses the abode of”

Here, the words **house** and **abode** represent the families who live in those houses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is on the households of ... but he blesses the households of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 3:33 (#1)

מְאַרְרֶת יְהוָה

“The curse of Yahweh”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **curse** that comes from **Yahweh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The curse from Yahweh]

See: Possession

Proverbs 3:33 (#2)

בְּבֵית

“{is} on the house of”

Solomon speaks of the **curse of Yahweh** as if it were an object that he placed **on** top of the wicked person's **house**. He means that Yahweh curses that **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is against the house of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:33 (#4)

רָשָׁעַ

“a wicked {one}”

Here, **the wicked one** refers to wicked people in general, not a specific **wicked** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any wicked person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 3:34 (#1)

הוֹאֵלֵל יָצִין

“he himself mocks”

Here, the pronoun **himself** is added to **he** to give greater emphasis to this action of Yahweh. Use a natural way in your language for bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [he indeed mocks]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 3:34 (#2)

יִתֵּן חֵן

“he gives favor”

The writer speaks of Yahweh favoring people as if his **favor** were an object that he gives to people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he acts favorably] or [he gives grace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:35 (#4)

מְרַגִּים קִלּוֹן

“lift up dishonor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **dishonor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [will be dishonored] or [will be shamed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 3:35 (#1)

יִנְהַלּוּ

“will inherit”

Here Solomon speaks of wise people receiving **honor** as if **honor** were property or wealth that they could **inherit** from a family member. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will receive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:35 (#3)

מְרַגִּים

“lift up”

Here Solomon speaks of **stupid** people being dishonored as if their **dishonor** was lifted up for everyone to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will receive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 3:35 (#2)

כְּכֹבֹד & יִנְהַלּוּ

“will inherit honor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **honor**, you could express the same idea in another way. See how you translated **honor** in 3:16. Alternate translation: [will be honored] or [will be respected]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs - Chapter 4 Introduction**Structure and Formatting**

Live wisely and do what is right * Wisdom will benefit you (4:1-9) * Behave wisely and avoid those who do not (4:10-19) * Live righteously (4:20-27)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter**My son**

Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that those proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Translation Issues in This Chapter**Personification**

In 4:6-9, Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a person, specifically, as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this issue in the book introduction.

Proverbs 4:1 (#3)

מְמוֹסֵר & בִּינָה

“the instruction of & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **instruction** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:1 (#1)

שמעו

“Hear”

See how you translated **Hear** in 1:8.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:1 (#4)

אב

“a father”

Here Solomon is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first person form. Alternate translation: [me, your father]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Proverbs 4:1 (#2)

בנים

“sons”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to both male and female children. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [young people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 4:2 (#3)

אל-תעזבו

“do not forsake my law”

This clause is the result of what came before in the previous clause. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [this is why you must not forsake my law]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:2 (#4)

אל-תעזבו

“do not forsake”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:8.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 4:2 (#2)

לכם

“to you”

Here, **you** is plural and refers to the “sons” referred to in the previous verse.

See: Forms of You

Proverbs 4:2 (#5)

תורתתי

“my law”

See how you translated the collective noun **law** in 1:8.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 4:2 (#1)

כי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Hear these instructions because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:3 (#1)

כִּי־בן הָיִיתִי לְאָבִי

“When I was a son of my father”

When here indicates that what follows refers to the time when Solomon was a child and still lived under his father’s care. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When I was still a boy learning from my father]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:3 (#4)

לפני אמי

“to the face of my mother”

Here Solomon speaks of his **mother** considering him to be **the tender and only one** as if he were **before** her **face**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate transla-

tion: [according to my mother] or [in my mother's estimation]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:3 (#3)

וְיָחִיד

“and only one”

Here, **only one** could mean: (1) he was his mother's only child. Alternate translation: [and only child]; (2) he was a unique child of his mother. Alternate translation: [and unique one]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:3 (#2)

רַחֵם וְיָחִיד

“the tender and only one”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **tender** tells what the **only one** was like. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use **and**. Alternate translation: [the tender only one]

See: Hendiadys

Proverbs 4:4 (#1)

וְיָרַנִי

“then he taught me”

Here, **he** refers to Solomon's father. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:4 (#2)

לִבִּי

“your heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:4 (#5)

מִצְוֹתַי

“my commandments”

See how you translated the abstract noun **commandments** in 2:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:4 (#3)

יִתְקַד & לִבִּי

“Let your heart grasp”

Here Solomon speaks of remembering **words** as if the **heart** were holding on tightly to them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let your heart remember]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:4 (#4)

דְּבָרַי

“my words”

See how you translated the similar use of **my words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:4 (#6)

וְחָיָה

“and live”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [and it will result in life for you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:5 (#3)

אַל-תִּשְׁכַּח וְאַל-תִּתֵּן מִאֲמַר־יִפִּי

“do not forget and do not veer from the sayings of my mouth”

Here Solomon speaks of not forgetting something as if a person were not veering off of a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remember and keep obeying the sayings of my mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:5 (#1)

חָכְמָה & בִּינָה

“wisdom & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:5 (#2)

אַל-תִּשְׁכַּח וְאַל-תִּפְּוֹט מֵאֲמַרֵּי-פִי

“do not forget and do not veer from the sayings of my mouth”

Here, the phrases **do not forget** and **do not veer from** are figures of speech that express strongly positive meanings by using a negative word, **not**, together with expressions that are the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meanings. Alternate translation: [remember and keep going in the direction of the sayings of my mouth]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 4:5 (#4)

מֵאֲמַרֵּי-פִי

“from the sayings of my mouth”

Here, **mouth** represents Solomon’s father himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from my sayings]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 4:6 (#2)

וְתִשְׁמְרֶנּוּ & וְתִצְרֶנּוּ

“and she will preserve you & and she will guard you”

Both occurrences of **and** in this verse indicate that what follows are the results of the phrases that precede them. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [and it will result in her preserving you ... and it will result in her guarding you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:6 (#1)

אַל-תִּמְצֹקֶנָּה

“Do not forsake her”

See how you translated **Do not forsake** in 1:8.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 4:6 (#3)

אַל-תִּמְצֹקֶנָּה וְתִשְׁמְרֶנּוּ אֶהְיֶה וְתִצְרֶנּוּ

“Do not forsake her, and she will preserve you; love her, and she will guard you”

In 4:6–9 Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly as in the UST or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Do not forsake wisdom, and wisdom will be like a woman who preserves you; love wisdom, and wisdom will be like a woman who guards you]

See: Personification

Proverbs 4:7 (#4)

וּבְכָל-קִזְוִינֶיךָ

“And with all your acquisition”

Here, **with all your acquisition** could mean: (1) “by using all of your resources” Alternate translation: [And by means of everything that you have,]; (2) “along with the other things that you acquire” Alternate translation: [And as you get other things,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:7 (#3)

וּבְכָל-קִזְוִינֶיךָ

“And with all your acquisition”

The word **acquisition** here is singular in form, but it refers to all of a person’s possessions as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [And with all your acquisitions] or [And with everything that you acquire]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 4:7 (#2)

קִנְיָה חִכְמָה & קִנְיָה בִּינָה

“Acquire wisdom & acquire understanding”

See how you translated these phrases in 4:5.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:7 (#1)

רִאשִׁיט הַחִכְמָה

“Wisdom {is} first”

Here, **first** could refer to: (1) first in importance, the most important thing. Alternate translation: [the most important thing is wisdom] or [wisdom is supreme]; (2) the foundation or basis of something, as it means in 1:7. Alternate translation: [the foundation of wisdom] or [the prerequisite for acquiring wisdom]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:8 (#2)

סלִסְלָהּ וְתִרְוַמְמָהּ

“Cherish her, and she will raise you up”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [If you cherish her, then she will raise you up] or [Cherish her, and it will result in her raising you up]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:8 (#3)

וְתִרְוַמְמָהּ

“and she will raise you up”

Here Solomon speaks of a wise person receiving honor as if wisdom were raising that person **up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she will cause you to be honored]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:8 (#4)

תִּתְכַבֵּדְךָ

“she will honor you”

Here Solomon speaks of a wise person receiving honor as if wisdom were honoring that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wisdom will cause people to honor you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:8 (#5)

תִּחְבְּקֶנָּה

“you embrace her”

Here Solomon speaks of someone valuing wisdom as if he were embracing a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you value wisdom]

See: Personification

Proverbs 4:8 (#1)

סלִסְלָהּ וְתִרְוַמְמָהּ תִּתְכַבֵּדְךָ כְּכִי תִחְבְּקֶנָּה

“Cherish her, and she will raise you up; she will honor you when you embrace her”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Wisdom is like a woman who raises you up when you cherish her; wisdom is like a woman who honors you when you embrace her]

See: Personification

Proverbs 4:9 (#3)

לִוְיַת־חַסֵּד

“a garland of grace”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:9.

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:9 (#1)

תִּתֶּנָּה לְרֹאשׁוֹךְ לִוְיַת־חַסֵּד עֲטֹטֶרֶת תִּפְאָאָרֶת תִּמְנֶנָּה

“She will give for your head a garland of grace; [with] a crown of splendor she will cover you”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [She will give for your head a garland of grace; yes, with a crown of splendor she will cover you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:9 (#4)

עֲטֹטֶרֶת תִּפְאָאָרֶת תִּמְנֶנָּה

“with} a crown of splendor she will cover you”

Here Solomon speaks of the honor that a person will have from gaining wisdom as if wisdom placed a **crown** upon that person's head. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [wisdom will cause people to honor you] or [wisdom will be like someone who puts a crown of splendor on your head]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:9 (#5)

עֲטֹטֶרֶת תִּפְאָאָרֶת

“with} a crown of splendor”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **crown** that is characterized by **splendor**. If it would

be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [with a splendid crown]

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:9 (#2)

תתתן לראשך לנית־חן עטרת תפארת תמגנה

“She will give for your head a garland of grace; [with] a crown of splendor she will cover you”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of wisdom as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Wisdom will be like a woman who gives a garland of grace for your head; wisdom will be like a woman who covers you with a crown of splendor]

See: Personification

Proverbs 4:10 (#1)

שמע

“Hear”

See how you translated the same use of **Hear** in 1:8.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:10 (#2)

בני

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 4:10 (#4)

ורבבו לך שנות חיים

“and they will multiply for you the years of life”

Here Solomon speaks of his **sayings** as if they were able to cause someone to live longer. He means that someone who obeys his **sayings** will live longer than if they did not do so. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and obeying my sayings will multiply for you the years of life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:10 (#5)

שנות חיים

“the years of life”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **years** that a person lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the years that you are alive]

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:10 (#3)

ורבבו

“and they will multiply”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the commands stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do this, then they will multiply] or [The result will be that they will multiply]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:11 (#2)

בדרך חכמה

“In the way of wisdom”

Here, **the way** refers to how people behave or live their lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In wise behavior,] or [How to behave wisely,]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:11 (#3)

הדרך־תמיד במעגלי־ישר

“I caused you to tread in the tracks of uprightness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **tracks** that are characterized by **uprightness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [I caused you to tread in the upright tracks]

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:11 (#4)

הדרך־תמיד במעגלי־ישר

“I caused you to tread in the tracks of uprightness”

Here Solomon refers to how people behave or live their lives as if they **tread in the tracks** of a certain path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I caused you to behave uprightly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:11 (#1)

בְּדֶרֶךְ חָכְמָה

“In the way of wisdom”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **way** that is characterized by **wisdom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [In the wise way]

See: Possession

Proverbs 4:12 (#2)

בְּבִלְכֶתֶךָ לֹא-יִצָּצֵר צִעְדְּךָ וְאִם-תִּתְּרֹץ לֹא תִכָּשֵׁל

“In your walking, your step will not be restricted; and if you run, you will not stumble”

In this verse, Solomon refers to what people do as if they were walking or running along paths, and he refers to their success in what they do as if the paths were free of obstacles that might make the person **stumble**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When you do something, you will not be hindered; and if you attempt big things, you will not fail]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:12 (#1)

בְּבִלְכֶתֶךָ לֹא-יִצָּצֵר צִעְדְּךָ וְאִם-תִּתְּרֹץ לֹא תִכָּשֵׁל

“In your walking, your step will not be restricted; and if you run, you will not stumble”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [When you walk, your step will not be restricted; yes, if you run, you will not stumble]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:12 (#3)

לֹא-יִצָּצֵר & לֹא תִכָּשֵׁל

“will not be restricted & you will not stumble”

Solomon is using a figure of speech in these two phrases that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express

the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will be free ... you will keep going]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 4:13 (#3)

אֶל-תִּתְּרֶנָּה

“do not let go”

Solomon is using a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative idea **let go**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [keep holding on]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 4:13 (#4)

נִצְרָהּ

“guard it”

Here Solomon speaks of **instruction** as if it were an object that someone should **guard**. He means that he wants his son to remember to do what he has taught him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of **guard** in 3:21. Alternate translation: [remember to practice it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:13 (#1)

הִחַזְקִי בְּמוֹסָר אֶל-תִּתְּרֶנָּה

“Grasp on to instruction, do not let go”

Here Solomon speaks of a person remembering **instruction** as if it were an object that the person could **grasp** and **not let go**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **grasp** in 3:18. Alternate translation: [Keep on remembering instruction; do not forget it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:13 (#5)

הִנְיָא חַיִּיד

“it {is} your life”

Here Solomon speaks of **instruction** preserving a person's **life** as if instruction were that person's **life** itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it will preserve your life]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:13 (#2)

בְּמוֹסָר

“to instruction”

See how you translated the abstract noun **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:14 (#1)

בְּאַרְחַת הַרְשָׁעִים אַל-תִּבְּגָא וְאַל-תִּתְאַשֵּׁשׁ בְּדַדְרֹךְ רָעִים

“On the path of wicked ones do not go, and do not advance on the way of evil ones”

These two phrases mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Do not follow the ways of wicked, evil people]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:14 (#2)

בְּאַרְחַת & בְּדַדְרֹךְ

“On the path of & on the way of”

See how you translated the similar use of “paths” and “ways” in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:15 (#1)

פְּרַעְיָהוּ & בָּבוּ & מַעַלְלֵיו

“Avoid it & it & from it”

In this verse, the pronoun **it** refers to “the way of evil ones” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Avoid the way of evil ones ... that way ... from that evil way]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:15 (#2)

פְּרַעְיָהוּ אַל-תַּעֲבֹר-בָּבוּ שְׂטֵטָה מַעַלְלֵיו וְעָבֹר

“Avoid it, do not pass through it; veer from it and pass on”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of behaving wickedly as if wicked behavior were a path that people could **pass through**, **veer from**, and **pass on**. If it would

be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Avoid acting evilly; do not try it; completely avoid doing evil and do not even think about it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:16 (#2)

לֹא יִישְׁנוּ אִם-לֹא יִרְגְּעוּ וְנִגְזְלָה שְׁשֹׁנָתָם אִם-לֹא יִכְשֹׁלוּ

“they do not sleep if they do not do evil and their sleep is robbed if they do not cause stumbling”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [they do not sleep if they do not do evil. Indeed, their sleep is robbed if they do not cause stumbling]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:16 (#6)

וְנִגְזְלָה שְׁשֹׁנָתָם

“and their sleep is robbed”

If your language does not use a passive form like **is robbed**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they are not able to sleep]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 4:16 (#3)

לֹא יִישְׁנוּ אִם-לֹא יִרְגְּעוּ וְנִגְזְלָה שְׁשֹׁנָתָם אִם-לֹא יִכְשֹׁלוּ

“they do not sleep if they do not do evil and their sleep is robbed if they do not cause stumbling”

In this verse, the pronoun **they** refers to the wicked people mentioned in 4:14. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wicked ones do not sleep if they do not do evil, and the sleep of wicked ones is robbed if those wicked ones do not cause stumbling]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:16 (#4)

לֹא יִישְׁנוּ אִם-לֹא יִרְגְּעוּ וְנִגְזְלָה שְׁשֹׁנָתָם אִם-לֹא יִכְשֹׁלוּ

“they do not sleep if they do not do evil and their sleep is robbed if they do not cause stumbling”

In these two clauses, Solomon exaggerates to express how intensely these wicked people desire to do evil actions. Solomon did not literally mean that these people could not **sleep** if they had not done **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [they desire to do evil so much that it is as if they would not be able to sleep unless they did evil]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 4:16 (#5)

וְנִגְזַלְלָהּ שְׁנֵינֶתָם

“and their sleep is robbed”

Here Solomon is speaking of not being able to **sleep** as if **sleep** were an object that someone could rob from someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they are not able to sleep]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:16 (#7)

אִם-לֹא יִכְשׁוּלוּ

“if they do not cause stumbling”

Here Solomon speaks of causing harm to another person as if it were causing that person to **stumble**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if they do not harm someone]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:16 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows are reasons why someone should avoid doing **evil**, as stated in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Avoid acting wickedly because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:17 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows are more reasons why someone should avoid doing evil, as commanded in 4:15. Use a connector in your language that makes

it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Avoid being one who acts wickedly, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:17 (#2)

לֶלְחֶמוֹ & יִשְׁתֵּי

“they eat & they drink”

In this verse, the pronoun **they** refers to the wicked people mentioned in 4:14. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wicked ones eat ... wicked ones drink]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:17 (#3)

לֶלְחֶמוֹ לֶלֶחֶם רָרִשׁ וַיֵּין חֲמָסִים יִשְׁתֵּי

“they eat the bread of wickedness and the wine of violent {acts}, they drink”

These two clauses could mean: (1) these wicked people do acts of **wickedness** and **violence** as regularly as they **eat bread** and **drink wine**. Alternate translation: [wickedness is like the bread that they eat and violence is like the wine that they drink] or (2) these wicked people do acts of **wickedness** and **violence** in order to get their **bread** and **wine**. Alternate translation: [they eat bread that they obtain by doing wicked things and they drink wine that they obtain through violent acts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:18 (#2)

כְּאֹרֶן בְּרֹא

“is} like the light of brightness”

Here, **the light of brightness** could refer to the first sunlight that appears in the morning. In this case, it would contrast with the full light when **the day {is} established**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is like the light of dawn] or [is like the first sunlight in the morning]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 4:18 (#5)

הוֹלֵלֵךְ וְיֵאֱאֹר עַד-יִבְכֹּן הַיּוֹם

“going and shining until the day {is} established”

Here Solomon continues the comparison of **the path of the righteous ones** to **the light** of the sun. Just like

the sunlight shines increasingly brighter from sunrise until the middle of the day, so also **the righteous ones** increase in wisdom and safety as they understand more and more of how God wants them to live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the path of the righteous leading to more and more wisdom and safety just as the path of the sun leads to more and more light until midday]

See: Simile

Proverbs 4:18 (#1)

וְאִתָּהּ צֶדֶק וְיָקִים

“But the path of the righteous ones”

Here, **the path** could refer to: (1) the things that people experience during their lives. Alternate translation: [But what the righteous ones experience]; (2) how people behave, as it does in 1:15. Alternate translation: [But the lifestyle of the righteous ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:18 (#3)

כְּאֹרֶךְ נֶגְמָה

“is} like the light of brightness”

Here Solomon compares **the path of the righteous ones** to **the light** of the sun in the morning. He means that **righteous** people are safe because they understand what God wants them to do during their lives, just like people can walk safely on a path because **the light** enables them to see where they are going. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is safe]

See: Simile

Proverbs 4:18 (#4)

הוֹלֵלֶךְ וְאֹרֶךְ יָדָהּ וְנֶגְמָה הַיּוֹם

“going and shining until the day {is} established”

The phrase **the day is established** refers to the time of **day** when the sun shines the brightest. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [going and shining until the sun shines the brightest] or [going and shining brighter until full daylight]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:19 (#3)

לֹא יִדְעֻם בְּמַה יִּפְשְׁלוּ

“they do not know on what they stumble”

Here Solomon speaks of people experiencing harm as if they were stumbling over an object in the path on which they were walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they do not know why they experience harm]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:19 (#1)

וְדֶרֶךְ

“The way of”

Here, **way** has the same meaning as “path” in the previous verse. See how you translated “path” there.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:19 (#2)

כְּאִפְלָלָהּ

“is} like the darkness”

Here Solomon compares the **way of the wicked** to **darkness**. He means that the wicked people are always in danger, just like people who walk in darkness are in danger because they cannot see where they are going. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is dangerous]

See: Simile

Proverbs 4:20 (#1)

בְּבִנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 4:20 (#3)

לְדִבְרֵי

“to my words”

See how you translated **my words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:20 (#4)

הִטְאֵןְךָ

“incline your ear”

The phrase **incline your ear** is an idiom that refers to listening carefully to what someone is saying as if the listener was turning his **ear** toward the person speaking. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [listen well]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:20 (#2)

לְדַבְּרֵי הַקֹּשֵׁשׁ יָבִיחַ לְלִאמֹרֵי הַטֹּאמָר

“listen attentively to my words; incline your ear to my sayings”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [listen attentively to my words, yes, incline your ear to my sayings]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:21 (#3)

שְׁמֵרֵם בְּתוֹךְ לִבְכֶּם

“keep them in the midst of your heart”

Here Solomon speaks of remembering something as if someone were keeping it **in the midst of his heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [always remember them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:21 (#2)

שְׁמֵרֵם בְּתוֹךְ לִבְכֶּם

“keep them in the midst of your heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:21 (#1)

אַל־יִלְחֲצוּ מֵעֵינֶיךָ

“Do not let them depart from your eyes”

See how you translated this clause in 3:21.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:22 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows are more reasons why someone should pay attention to the father's words, as stated in 4:20–21. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Pay attention to my words, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:22 (#2)

הֵם לְמַצְאֵיהֶם

“they & to those who find them”

In this verse, the pronouns **they** and **them** refer to the “sayings” mentioned in 4:20. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [my sayings ... to those who find my sayings]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:22 (#6)

בְּשָׂרֹךְ

“his flesh”

Although **his** is singular, here it refers to all who remember Solomon's sayings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [their flesh]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 4:22 (#7)

וְלִכְל־בְּשָׂרֹךְ מְרַפָּא

“and healing to all of his flesh”

Here Solomon speaks of his sayings as if they were **healing** for those who remember them. He means that those who remember what he says will have healthy bodies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they preserve their health] or [and they cause their bodies to stay healthy]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:22 (#5)

וְלִכְל־בְּשָׂרֹךְ מְרַפָּא

“and healing to all of his flesh”

Here Solomon uses the word **flesh** to refer to a person's whole body, which is made of flesh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and healing to all of his body]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 4:22 (#3)

הַיָּמִים הָהֵם לַמַּצְאֵיהֶם

“they {are} life to those who find them”

Here Solomon speaks of his sayings as if they were **life** for those who obey them. He means that those who do what he says will have good lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they allow those who find them to have good lives] or [they cause those who find them to live well]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:22 (#4)

לַמַּצְאֵיהֶם

“to those who find them”

Here Solomon speaks of people remembering his sayings as if those people have found them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to those who remember them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:23 (#1)

נִצְרֵךְ לִבְךָ

“Guard your heart”

Here Solomon refers to the **heart** as the container of a person's thoughts and desires, and speaks of it as though it were an object that could be guarded. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Guard your mind] or [Guard your liver] or [Guard your thinking]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:23 (#2)

לִבְךָ

“your heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 4:23 (#5)

מִמֶּנּוּ

“from it”

Here, **it** refers to the **heart**, which refers to a person's mind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from your heart] or [from your mind]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 4:23 (#6)

מִמֶּנּוּ תוֹצְאוֹת הַיָּמִים

“from it {are} the sources of life”

Here Solomon speaks of the influence that a person's **heart** has over what happens in that person's life as if the **heart** supplied **sources** that produce **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from your heart comes what will direct your life] or [your thinking determines what your life will be like]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:23 (#3)

מִכָּל-מַמְשָׁקָר

“more than all {that} is protected”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [more than all that you protect]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 4:23 (#4)

מִכָּל-מַמְשָׁקָר

“more than all {that} is protected”

This phrase is an idiom that means “with all diligence.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with utmost diligence]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:24 (#1)

הַסִּסְרָ מִמֶּמְדְּ עֲקֻשְׁשׁוֹת פִּיָּה וּלְיָצוֹת שִׁשְׁפֹּתֵינִים הָרְחֹק מִמֶּךָ

“Remove from you perversity of mouth, and the deviousness of lips put far away from you”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Remove from you perversity of mouth, yes, the deviousness of lips put far away from you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:24 (#2)

הַסֵּסֶר מִמֶּמֶךְ עֲקֻשָּׁיוֹת פֶּה וְלִזְזוֹת שִׁשְׁפָּתַיִם הַרְחֵק מִמֶּךְ

“Remove from you perversity of mouth, and the deviousness of lips put far away from you”

The phrases **perversity of mouth** and **deviousness of lips** both refer to someone using his **mouth** or **lips** to speak deceitfully. If these phrases do not have that meaning in your language, you could use idioms from your language that do have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Remove from you perverse speech, and devious speech put far away from you]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 4:24 (#3)

הַסֵּסֶר מִמֶּמֶךְ עֲקֻשָּׁיוֹת פֶּה וְלִזְזוֹת שִׁשְׁפָּתַיִם הַרְחֵק מִמֶּךְ

“Remove from you perversity of mouth, and the deviousness of lips put far away from you”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **perversity of mouth** and **the deviousness of lips** as if they were objects that someone could **Remove** or **put far away**. He means that a person should not speak deceitfully. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not speak perversely and do not speak deviously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:25 (#3)

עֲיִינֶיךָ לִנְכַּח יִבְרִיטוּ וְעַפְעַפְיֶיךָ יִשְׁאֲרוּ נִגְדָּד

“Cause your eyes to gaze to the front, and cause your eyelids to be straight in front of you”

In these two clauses, Solomon speaks of committing oneself to behaving wisely and righteously as if those qualities were always **in front** of the person, and perverse or devious behavior is to the right or left. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Keep your

attention on doing what is right, and keep looking straight ahead to doing what is good]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:25 (#2)

עֲיִינֶיךָ לִנְכַּח יִבְרִיטוּ וְעַפְעַפְיֶיךָ יִשְׁאֲרוּ נִגְדָּד

“Cause your eyes to gaze to the front, and cause your eyelids to be straight in front of you”

In this verse, **eyes** and **eyelids** represent the person who is looking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Cause yourself to gaze to the front, and cause yourself to look straight in front of you]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 4:25 (#1)

עֲיִינֶיךָ לִנְכַּח יִבְרִיטוּ וְעַפְעַפְיֶיךָ יִשְׁאֲרוּ נִגְדָּד

“Cause your eyes to gaze to the front, and cause your eyelids to be straight in front of you”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Cause your eyes to gaze to the front, yes, cause your eyelids to be straight in front of you]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 4:26 (#1)

פַּסְלִם מִעֲגָגִל רִגְלֶיךָ

“Make level the track of your foot”

Here Solomon speaks of being careful how one lives as if someone were making the ground in front of them flat for walking on it. See how you translated the same use of **track** in 2:9. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Be careful how you live] or [Take heed to what you are doing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:26 (#4)

דְּרָכֶיךָ

“your ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:26 (#5)

יָכֹנֵן

“will be firm”

Here Solomon speaks of person's life being successful as if that person were walking safely on solid ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be successful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 4:26 (#2)

מַעֲגָל רַגְלֶיךָ

“the track of your foot”

Here, the word **foot** represents the whole person who is walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your track]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 4:26 (#3)

וְכָל

“and all”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do this, then all] or [The result will be that all]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 4:27 (#2)

אַל-תִּטְּ-יָמִינְךָ וּשְׁמָמָאוֹל הַסֵּסֶר רַגְלֶיךָ מִרָע

“Do not veer right or left; cause your foot to turn away from evil”

In this verse, Solomon continues to talk about how a person behaves as though the person is walking on a path. On this path of right living, the person should “gaze to the front” (verse 25), make the track “level” (verse 26), and not **veer** or **turn away** from it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not stop behaving rightly; make yourself avoid doing evil]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

Proverbs 4:27 (#4)

מִרָע

“from evil”

See how you translated **from evil** in 3:7.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 4:27 (#1)

אַל-תִּטְּ-יָמִינְךָ וּשְׁמָמָאוֹל

“Do not veer right or left”

Here Solomon uses **right** and **left** to refer to going in any direction other than straight ahead. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not go in any direction other than straight ahead]

See: Merism

Proverbs 4:27 (#3)

רַגְלֶיךָ

“your foot”

See how you translated the same use of **foot** in the previous verse.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Avoid temptation to commit adultery (5:1-23) * The dangers of adultery (5:1-14) * The joys of marital fidelity (5:15-20) * Yahweh's ways are better (5:21-23)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My son

Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that those proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Adulterous women

This chapter repeatedly warns young men to avoid any adulterous woman, whom Solomon calls “strange” and “foreign.” (See: [[rc://*/tw/dict/bible/kt/adultery]])

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Euphemism

In 5:15-20, Solomon uses several euphemisms to refer to sexual activity between a man and his wife or an adulterous woman. Although the UST expresses the

meaning of these euphemisms plainly, only do so if sexual language would not be offensive in your culture. It is usually best to use a euphemism from your own language that means the same thing.

Proverbs 5:1 (#4)

הַט־אָזְנְךָ

“incline your ear”

See how you translated this idiom in 4:20.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 5:1 (#2)

לְחִכְמָתִי & לְלִבְיוֹנָתִי

“to my wisdom & to my understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:1 (#3)

לְחִכְמָתִי & לְלִבְיוֹנָתִי

“to my wisdom & to my understanding”

Here, **my wisdom** and **my understanding** refer to the wise lessons that Solomon teaches his **son** and what he tells his **son** to understand. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to my wise lessons ... to what I tell you to understand]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:1 (#1)

הַט־אָזְנְךָ לְחִכְמָתִי הַקְשִׁיכָה לְלִבְיוֹנָתִי

“listen attentively to my wisdom; incline your ear to my understanding”

These two phrases mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [listen attentively to my wisdom; apply yourself to learn what I understand]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:2 (#4)

וְיָדָעַת

“and & knowledge”

Here, **knowledge** refers to what the son has learned from his father. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and ... what you have learned]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:2 (#2)

מְזִמָּוֹת

“discretion”

See how you translated the abstract noun **discretion** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:2 (#3)

וְיָדָעַת שְׁפָתֶיךָ יִנְצְרוּ

“and your lips may guard knowledge”

Here, **lips** represents the person who speaks by moving his **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you may guard knowledge by what you say]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 5:2 (#1)

לְשִׁמְרָן מְזִמָּוֹת וְיָדָעַת שְׁפָתֶיךָ יִנְצְרוּ

“in order to keep discretion, and your lips may guard knowledge”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **discretion** as if it were an object that someone should **keep**, and he speaks of **knowledge** as if it were an object that someone's **lips** should **guard**. He means that he wants his son to be wise in his choices and in the things that he says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in order to keep making good choices and speaking with knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:3 (#2)

נִפְתָּ תִתַּשְׁפָּךְ שְׁפָתֵי זָרָה

“the lips of a strange woman drip fresh honey”

Here, **lips** represent the words that the **strange woman** speaks, and they are compared to **fresh honey**. This means that what the strange woman says is sweet and appealing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the words that a strange woman says seem sweet and appealing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:3 (#1)

כָּרִי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason why someone should obey the commands introduced in 5:1. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do what I say, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 5:3 (#3)

זָרָה

“a strange woman”

See how you translated **strange woman** in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:3 (#4)

וְחִלְלֵק מִשְׁשָׁמֶן חֶמֶד

“and smoother than oil {is} her palate”

Here Solomon represents the tempting words that the **strange woman** speaks as **her palate** and he compares them to smooth **oil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and are pleasant and persuasive] or [and are as persuasive as olive oil is smooth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:4 (#5)

הַחֶדְדָּה כְּחֶרֶב פִּיּוֹת

“sharp as a sword of mouths”

The phrase **sword of mouths** refers to a **sword** with a blade that is sharpened on both sides. Each side can cut a person like a mouth that bites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [sharp like a sword with a blade that is sharpened on both sides]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:4 (#4)

הַחֶדְדָּה כְּחֶרֶב פִּיּוֹת

“sharp as a sword of mouths”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [her aftermath is sharp like a sword of mouths]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:4 (#1)

אַחֲרֵיהָ

“but her aftermath”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **aftermath**, or result, of having a sexual relationship with an adulterous woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the outcome of having a sexual relationship with her]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:4 (#3)

מִרְרָה כְּלֶעֱנָה

“is} bitter as wormwood”

Here Solomon compares the disgust that comes after having a relationship with an adulterous woman to tasting bitter **wormwood**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [is disgusting like bitter-tasting wormwood]

See: Simile

Proverbs 5:4 (#6)

הַחֶדְדָּה כְּחֶרֶב פִּיּוֹת

“sharp as a sword of mouths”

Here Solomon speaks of the pain that the adulteress will cause to the one who has a relationship with her as if it were a **sharp sword** that cuts the person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it wounds a person, as if it were a sharp sword of mouths]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:4 (#2)

כְּלֶעֱנָה

“as wormwood”

The word **wormwood** refers to a plant that tastes bitter. People made medicine out of it, but they also believed that it was poisonous in some amounts. If

your readers would not be familiar with this plant, you could use the name of a bitter-tasting plant in your area, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [like a bitter-tasting plant]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 5:5 (#2)

בְּרַגְלֶיהָ יִרְדְּדוֹת מָמוֹת שֶׁשְׂאֵאוֹל צִדְדֶיהָ יִתְמָכוּ

“Her feet are going down {to} death; her steps take hold of Sheol”

Here Solomon speaks of the behavior of the adulterous woman as **her feet** and **her steps**. He speaks of this behavior causing her death and the death of whoever commits adultery with her as if they were walking on a path that leads **down to death** or to **Sheol**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Her lifestyle ends in death; her way of living takes a person straight to Sheol] or [Her behavior results in death; by doing what she does, she will end up dead]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:5 (#1)

בְּרַגְלֶיהָ יִרְדְּדוֹת מָמוֹת שֶׁשְׂאֵאוֹל צִדְדֶיהָ יִתְמָכוּ

“Her feet are going down {to} death; her steps take hold of Sheol”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Her feet are going down to death; yes, her steps take hold of Sheol]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:6 (#2)

אַחַר חַיִּים פֶּן־תִּפְלֹס

“lest she observe the path of life”

Here Solomon speaks of behavior that results in living a good **life** as if it were a **path** that leads to **life** and can be observed. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Lest she care about behavior that leads to life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:6 (#3)

מִמַּעַגְלֶתֶּיהָ

“her tracks”

See how you translated the same use of **tracks** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:6 (#1)

אַחַר חַיִּים פֶּן־תִּפְלֹס

“lest she observe the path of life”

Lest here implies that the adulterous woman has an aversion to **the path of life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She refuses to observe the path of life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:7 (#2)

וְעַתָּה בְּנִים שְׁמַעוּ־לִי וְאַל־תִּתְּסוּרוּ מֵאִמְרֵי־פִי

“And now, sons, listen to me; and do not turn away from the sayings of my mouth”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And now, sons, listen to me; yes, do not turn aside from the sayings of my mouth]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:7 (#5)

וְאַל־תִּתְּסוּרוּ מֵאִמְרֵי־פִי

“and do not turn away from the sayings of my mouth”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [and listen to the sayings of my mouth]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 5:7 (#6)

מֵאִמְרֵי־פִי

“from the sayings of my mouth”

See how you translated **the sayings of my mouth** in 4:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 5:7 (#4)

וְאַל־תִּתְּסוּר וְרוּ מִאֲמַר־יְפִי

“and do not turn away from the sayings of my mouth”

Here Solomon speaks of someone not listening to someone else as if the person physically turned **away** from what he was saying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do not stop listening to the sayings of my mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:7 (#3)

בָּרָנִים

“sons”

See how you translated the same use of **sons** in 4:1.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 5:7 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

And now here indicates a transition from the description of the adulterous woman in 5:3–6 to the call to pay attention, which follows. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a transition. Alternate translation: [Next]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 5:8 (#2)

מִעֲלֵלֶיהָ & בֵּיתָהּ

“from her & her house”

In this verse, **her** refers to the adulterous woman described in 5:3–6. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from an adulteress ... the house of an adulteress]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 5:8 (#1)

הִרְחַתֵּק מִעֲלֵיָהּ דֶּרֶכְךָ

“Keep your way far from her”

Here, **way** represents the person and the person’s daily activities. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Keep yourself far away from her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:8 (#3)

וְאַל־תִּתְּקַרְבַּב

“and do not come near”

In a context such as this, your language might say “go” instead of **come**. Alternate translation: [and do not go near]

See: Go and Come

Proverbs 5:9 (#1)

כִּי

“lest”

The word **lest** here indicates that what follows in this verse is what would happen to young men if they did not obey the commands given in the previous verse. Use a natural form in your language for connecting this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation, beginning a new sentence: [If you fail to obey this, then]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 5:9 (#4)

וְיָשְׁנֶה־יָדָיִךְ

“and your years”

Here, **your years** could refer to: (1) everything that a person achieves during the time in a person’s life when he is his healthiest and strongest. Alternate translation: [and all you have achieved in the best years of your life]; (2) the **years** that a person is alive, meaning that **a cruel one** would kill this person. Alternate translation: [and your life]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:9 (#3)

וְיָשְׁנֶה־יָדָיִךְ

“and your years”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and lest you give your years]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:9 (#2)

תַּתִּתֶּנּוּ לְאַחֲרָיִם הוֹדָדָה

“you give to others your splendor”

Here, **splendor** could refer to: (1) everything that a person achieves during the time in a person’s life when he is the strongest, which would be the same meaning as **your years** in the next clause. This includes the offspring that he is giving up to the adulteress and her husband. Alternate translation: [you give to others your vigor] or [you give to others your achievements from your vigorous time of life]; (2) a person’s reputation, in which case this clause would refer to a person getting a bad reputation. Alternate translation: [you will lose your good reputation with others]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:9 (#5)

לְאִכְזָרִי

“to a cruel one”

Here, **a cruel one** could refer to: (1) one person, possibly the husband of the adulterous woman. Alternate translation: [a cruel person] or [a cruel man]; (2) a group of **cruel** people who are called **others** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [to cruel people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:10 (#1)

כִּן יִשְׂבַּעְעוּ זָרִים

“lest strangers be satisfied”

The word **lest** here indicates that what follows in this verse are more things that will happen to young men if they do not obey the commands in 5:8. Use a natural form in your language to connect this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation: [yes, if you fail to obey my teaching, strangers will be satisfied]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 5:10 (#5)

וְלִעֲצָבָיִךְ בְּבֵית

“and your toils in the house of”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from earlier in the sentence if

it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and your toils be in the house of]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:10 (#6)

נִכְרִי

“a foreigner”

Here, **a foreigner** refers to anyone outside of the young man’s family. It refers to the same kind of people as **strangers** earlier in the verse and “others” in verse 9. This probably refers to the family of the adulterous woman, who will benefit from the young man’s **strength** and **toils**. Alternate translation: [those who are not your family]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:10 (#2)

יִשְׂבַּעְעוּ

“be satisfied”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language, as in the UST.

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 5:10 (#4)

וְלִעֲצָבָיִךְ

“and your toils”

Here, **your toils** refers to everything that a person earns by working hard. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what you gain from toiling]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:10 (#3)

בְּחֹזֶק

“with your strength”

Here, **your strength** refers to everything that a person achieves during the time in a person’s life when he has the most **strength**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with what you achieved when you were strong]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:11 (#2)

וְנִהְיֶינָה

“and you groan”

This verse continues the meaning of the word **lest** in 5:10. What follows in this verse are more things that will happen to young men if they do not obey the commands in 5:8. Use a natural form in your language to connect this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation: [and furthermore, if you fail to obey my teaching, you will groan]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 5:11 (#1)

בְּאַחֲרֵיתֶיךָ בְּכִלְלוֹת בָּבֶשְׂרְךָ וּבְשֶׁאֲרֶךְ

“at your end, when your flesh and your body are finished”

Here Solomon is referring to dying in a polite way by using the word **end** and the phrase **your body and your flesh are finished**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to death in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the time of your death, when your flesh and your body die]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 5:11 (#3)

בְּבֶשְׂרְךָ וּבְשֶׁאֲרֶךְ

“your flesh and your body”

The words **flesh** and **body** mean basically the same thing and represent the whole person. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [you yourself]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 5:12 (#4)

לִבִּי

“my heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:12 (#1)

שֹׁנֵאֲתִי מוֹסֵסָר וְתוֹכִלְחַת נֶאֱמָר לִבִּי

“I hated correction, and my heart despised rebuke”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different

words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I hated correction, yes, my heart despised rebuke]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:12 (#2)

אֲאִידָּ שֹׁנֵאֲתִי מוֹסֵסָר

“How I hated correction”

“How” here is an exclamation that emphasizes how much he **hated correction**. Use an exclamation that would communicate that meaning in your language. Alternate translation: [I hated correction so very much]

See: Exclamations

Proverbs 5:12 (#3)

מוֹסֵסָר וְתוֹכִלְחַת

“correction, and & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** and **rebuke** in 3:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:13 (#3)

לֹא־הִטָּטִיתִי אָזְנִי

“I did not incline my ear”

See how you translated this idiom in 4:20.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 5:13 (#1)

וְלֹא־שָׁמַעְתִּי בְּקוֹל מוֹרְגִי וְלֹא־הִטָּטִיתִי אָזְנִי

“And I did not listen to the voice of my teachers, and to my instructors I did not incline my ear”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And I did not listen to the voice of my teachers, no, to my instructors I did not incline my ear]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:13 (#2)

ולא־שָׁמַעְתִּי בְקוֹלָהּ

“And I did not listen to the voice of”

The phrase **listen to the voice of** is an idiom that refers to obeying someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I did not obey the instructions of]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 5:14 (#1)

כְּכִמְעֻט

“as a little”

Here, **as a little** is a common expression that means “very close to.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the brink of being] or [just about]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 5:14 (#3)

בְּתוֹךְ

“in the midst of”

Here, **in the midst of** refers to the judgment of the people of the assembly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the opinion of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 5:14 (#4)

קְהִלָּה וְעֵדָה

“the assembly and the congregation”

The terms **assembly** and **congregation** mean the same thing and refer to the man’s community. The man is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the entire assembly]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 5:14 (#2)

בְּכָל־רָעָה

“in all evil”

Here, the adulterous man speaks of experiencing complete disgrace as if **all evil** were a location he was **in**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [experiencing total disgrace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:15 (#1)

שָׁתֵּה מַמִּים מִבּוֹרְךָ וְיִנְזְלִים מִתְּנוֹךְ בְּאֶרֶץ

“Drink water from your cistern and flowing waters from the midst of your well”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Drink water from your cistern, yes, drink flowing waters from the midst of your well]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:15 (#2)

שָׁתֵּה מַמִּים מִבּוֹרְךָ וְיִנְזְלִים מִתְּנוֹךְ בְּאֶרֶץ

“Drink water from your cistern and flowing waters from the midst of your well”

Solomon is leaving out a word in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Drink water from your cistern, and drink flowing waters from the midst of your well]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:15 (#3)

שָׁתֵּה מַמִּים מִבּוֹרְךָ וְיִנְזְלִים מִתְּנוֹךְ בְּאֶרֶץ

“Drink water from your cistern and flowing waters from the midst of your well”

In both of these clauses, Solomon is referring in a polite way to a man satisfying his sexual desire with his own wife. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more normal polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. See the discussion of euphemisms in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [Sleep with your own wife only and satisfy yourself only with her] or [Satisfy your sexual desire only with your wife, yes, satisfy your sexual desire only with her]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 5:16 (#2)

יִפְרוּצוּ מִצְיֹנְתֶיךָ חֲרוּצָה בְּבָרְחֵבֹת פְּלִגֵּי־מַיִם

“Should your springs overflow outside, channels of water in the open areas”

Solomon is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. You may need to make a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Should your springs overflow outside? Should your channels of water overflow in the open areas?]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:16 (#1)

יִפְרוּצוּ מִצְיֹנְתֶיךָ חֲרוּצָה בְּבָרְחֵבֹת פְּלִגֵּי־מַיִם

“Should your springs overflow outside, channels of water in the open areas”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize that a man should not commit adultery. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Your springs should not overflow outside, channels of water in the open areas!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 5:16 (#4)

חֲרוּצָה בְּבָרְחֵבֹת

“outside & in the open areas”

Here, **outside** and **open areas** refer to public places where there are many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [outside of your home ... in public places]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 5:16 (#3)

יִפְרוּצוּ מִצְיֹנְתֶיךָ חֲרוּצָה בְּבָרְחֵבֹת פְּלִגֵּי־מַיִם

“Should your springs overflow outside, channels of water in the open areas”

In both clauses, Solomon is using a polite way to refer to a man having sex with women other than his wife by speaking as if that man allowed his **springs** or **water** to flow in public places. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. See the discussion of euphemisms in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [Should you sleep with other women, making something public that should be private]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 5:17 (#2)

לְדָג לְבַדְּלָדָג

“for you, for you alone”

The phrases **for you** and **for you alone** mean the same thing. Solomon is using the two phrases together for emphasis. By **you** he means the man and his wife together. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [only for your marriage alone] or [for you and your wife only]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 5:17 (#1)

יְהִיוּ

“Let them be”

Here, **them** refers to the “springs” and “channels of water” mentioned in the previous verse, which are euphemisms for sexual activity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated those euphemisms in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [Let your sexual activity be]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 5:18 (#2)

וְיִשְׂמַח מֵאֵשֶׁת

“and be glad because of the wife of”

Here the phrase **be glad** refers to experiencing joy or sexual pleasure. If it would be helpful, you could use a natural expression for this in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [take pleasure in the wife of]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 5:18 (#4)

יְעוּרֶךָ

“your youth”

See how you translated the abstract noun **youth** in 2:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:18 (#3)

מֵאֲשֶׁת נְעוּרָיְךָ

“because of the wife of your youth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **wife** whom his son married while he was in his **youth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [with the wife whom you married in your youth]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:18 (#1)

יְהִי־מְקוֹרְךָ בְּרִנָּה

“May your fountain be blessed”

Here Solomon speaks of his son’s wife as if she were a **fountain** that can be **blessed** by Yahweh. This probably refers to the blessing of children. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [May your wife bless you with children]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:19 (#1)

אֵיילת אֲהָבִים וַיְצַלֵּל־חֶתָן

“A doe of loves and a mountain goat of grace”

Here Solomon speaks of how beautiful the “wife of your youth” is as if she were a **doe of loves and a mountain goat of grace**. The Israelites considered these two animals to be symbols of physical beauty and graceful movements. If it would be helpful, you could refer to animals that are more appropriate for this comparison in your language. If it would not be appropriate in your language to compare a woman to an animal, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [She is as beautiful as a doe of loves and as graceful as a goat of grace] or [she is beautiful and graceful, and she loves you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:19 (#5)

תִּשְׁגֶּגֶה תָמִיד

“may you continually stagger”

Here Solomon speaks of the exhilarating delight of the love that a man should have for his wife as if he were staggering like an intoxicated person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may you continually revel] or [may you continually lose yourself]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:19 (#3)

וַיְצַלֵּל־חֶתָן

“and a mountain goat of grace”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe a **mountain goat** that is characterized by **grace**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with a different expression. Alternate translation: [a graceful mountain goat]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:19 (#4)

תִּדְדִיקָ וְרִנָּה

“may her breasts drench you”

Here Solomon speaks of a wife’s **breasts** satisfying her husband’s sexual desires as they would satisfy the thirst of a hungry baby. Here, **drench** refers to giving a baby a satisfying amount of milk. If it would be helpful in your language or if it would be offensive in your language to refer to **breasts**, then you could use a more general expression. Alternate translation: [may her bosom fill you with delight as a mother’s breasts fill her child with food] or [may her body satisfy your sexual desires]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:19 (#2)

אֵיילת אֲהָבִים

“A doe of loves”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe a **doe** that is characterized by **loves**. The word **loves** is plural here, in which form it refers to sexual love. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with a different expression. Alternate translation: [A loving doe] or [A sexy doe]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:20 (#1)

וְלָלְמָה תִּשְׁגֶּגֶה בְּנִי בְּזוֹרָה וַיִּתְחַבֵּבֶךָ חֶמֶק נְכָרִיָּה

“And why would you stagger, my son, with a strange woman, or embrace the bosom of a foreign woman”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize that a man should not commit adultery. If you would

not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And you should not stagger, my son, with a strange woman, or embrace the bosom of a foreign woman!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 5:20 (#4)

בְּזָרָה & נָכְרִיָּה

“with a strange woman & a foreign woman”

See how you translated **strange woman** and **foreign woman** in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:20 (#3)

תִּשְׁגָּגָה

“would you stagger”

See how you translated the same use of **stagger** in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:20 (#2)

וְלָמָּה תִּשְׁגָּגָה בְּנִי בְּזָרָה וְאִתְּחַבֵּץ חֶמֶק נָכְרִיָּה

“And why would you stagger, my son, with a strange woman, or embrace the bosom of a foreign woman”

Solomon is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And why would you stagger, my son, with a strange woman, or why would you embrace the bosom of a foreign woman]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 5:21 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here introduces the reason for obeying the commands stated in 5:15–20. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [Do not commit adultery because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 5:21 (#2)

נִזְכָּח | עֵינֵי יְהוָה דְּרָכֵי־אִשׁ וְכָל־מַעֲגַלְתֵּי מִפְּלִס

“in front of the eyes of Yahweh {are} the ways of a man, and all of his paths he observes”

These two clauses mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that they express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the clauses and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [God observes everyone, so he sees how a man lives]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 5:21 (#4)

דְּרָכֵי & מַעֲגַלְתֵּי

“the ways of & his paths”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** and **paths** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:21 (#3)

נִזְכָּח | עֵינֵי יְהוָה & מִפְּלִס

“in front of the eyes of Yahweh {are & he observes”

Here Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** knowing what people do as if everything people do is **in front of** his **eyes** or is what **he observes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is fully aware of ... he is fully aware of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:21 (#5)

אִישׁ & מַעֲגַלְתֵּי

“a man & his paths”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... that person's paths]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 5:22 (#3)

עוֹנוֹתָיו יִלְכְּדֵנּוּ & וּבְחֶבְלֵי חַטָּאתָתּוֹ יִתְמָד

“His iniquities capture him & and by the cords of his sin he is grasped”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of a wicked person being unable to avoid the consequences of his **iniquities** and **sin** as if those **iniquities** and **sin** were people

who could **capture** or grasp that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He will not escape being punished for his iniquities ... and he is trapped because of the cords of his sin]

See: Personification

Proverbs 5:22 (#2)

עוונותיו ילכדנו את־הרשע ובחבל־י חטאתו יתמד

“His iniquities capture him, the wicked one, and by the cords of his sin he is grasped”

Although the terms **His**, **him**, and **he** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [The wicked person’s iniquities capture that person, and by the cords of that person’s sins that person is grasped]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 5:22 (#6)

ובחבל־י חטאתו

“and by the cords of his sin”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the cords** that are **sin**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and by the cords, that is, his sin,]

See: Possession

Proverbs 5:22 (#5)

ובחבל־י חטאתו יתמד

“and by the cords of his sin he is grasped”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the cords of his sin grasp him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 5:22 (#1)

עוונותיו ילכדנו את־הרשע ובחבל־י חטאתו יתמד

“His iniquities capture him, the wicked one, and by the cords of his sin he is grasped”

His in this verse refers to **the wicked one** mentioned in the first clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The iniquities of the wicked one capture

him, and by the cords of the wicked one’s sin, he is grasped]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 5:22 (#4)

עוונותיו & חטאתו

“His iniquities & his sin”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **iniquities** and **sin**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [The wicked things he does ... the sinful things he does]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 5:23 (#1)

הוא & ובר־ב אולתו ישגה

“He & and in the abundance of his folly he staggers”

Although the terms **He** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [That person ... and in the abundance of that person’s folly that person staggers]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 5:23 (#3)

ישגה

“he staggers”

Here Solomon speaks of a person behaving in a sinful manner that will cause him to die as if he were staggering like an intoxicated person who gets lost. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he loses his way] or [he behaves recklessly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 5:23 (#2)

באֵין מוסר ובר־ב אולתו

“because there is no correction, and in the abundance of his folly”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **correction**, **abundance**, and **folly**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [because he is not corrected; and in how abundantly foolish he is]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

- * Practical warnings ([6:1-19](../06/01.md))
 - Advice on indebtedness ([6:1-5](../06/01.md))
 - Warnings against laziness ([6:6-11](../06/06.md))
 - Things that Yahweh hates ([6:12-19](../06/12.md))
- * Adultery will be punished ([6:20-35](../06/20.md))

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My son

Occasionally, Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that those proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Adulterous women

This chapter repeatedly warns young men to avoid any adulterous woman, who is called “strange” and “foreign.” (See: [[rc://*/tw/dict/bible/kt/adultery]])

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Rhetorical questions

In 6:9, 27, and 28, Solomon uses rhetorical questions to emphasize the importance of what he is saying. (See: Rhetorical Question)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Animals used as examples

In this chapter, the gazelle, bird, and ant have certain characteristics which Solomon uses to teach about wisdom. If your language does not recognize those animals as being wise, you could add a footnote to explain or possibly substitute other animals from your culture that would help explain the same concept.

Proverbs 6:1 (#3)

אִם-עֲרַבְתָּ לְרֵעֶךָ תִּקְרָצֶתָ לְזָרָר כְּפִיד

“if you pledge for your neighbor, you clasp your palms for a stranger”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the clauses into one and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [if you have pledged yourself to pay back a loan for someone else]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:1 (#5)

לְרֵעֶךָ & לְזָרָר

“for your neighbor & for a stranger”

The words **neighbor** and **stranger** here refer to the same person. Therefore, this person is an acquaintance of the **son** whom he does not know well. If possible, use a word or words in your language for this type of person.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:1 (#4)

אִם-עֲרַבְתָּ לְרֵעֶךָ

“if you pledge for your neighbor”

Here Solomon implies that the **pledge** is a promise to pay back a loan of money that a **neighbor** who is a **stranger** is unable to pay back. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [if you promise to pay back the loan for your neighbor when he is unable to pay it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:1 (#1)

בְּבִנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:1 (#7)

תִּקְרָצֶתָ & כְּפִיד

“you clasp your palms”

The function of this action in this culture was to confirm a contractual agreement with someone. If there is a gesture with similar meaning in your culture, you could consider using it here in your translation, or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you shake hands to confirm an agreement] or [you confirm an agreement]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 6:1 (#6)

תִּקְרָצֶתָ לְזָרָר כְּפִיד

“you clasp your palms for a stranger”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could

supply the word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you clasp your palms for a stranger]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:1 (#2)

אם

“if”

Here, **if** indicates that Solomon is using a hypothetical situation to teach his **son**. This verse and the next verse are one long, conditional sentence. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [suppose]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 6:2 (#2)

נוקמת את האמרי־פֿיךְ וְנִלְכַּדְתָּ בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךְ

“you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth”

In both of these clauses, Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the first clause of the previous verse if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, if you are caught by the sayings of your mouth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:2 (#3)

נוקמת את האמרי־פֿיךְ וְנִלְכַּדְתָּ בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךְ

“you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active forms or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the sayings of your mouth have ensnared you, the sayings of your mouth have caught you]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:2 (#4)

נוקמת את האמרי־פֿיךְ וְנִלְכַּדְתָּ בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךְ

“you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth”

In these clauses, Solomon refers to someone getting into trouble because of what he said as if his **sayings** were a trap that could ensnare or catch him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if you get into trouble by the sayings of your mouth, if you encounter difficulty by the sayings of your mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:2 (#1)

נוקמת את האמרי־פֿיךְ וְנִלְכַּדְתָּ בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךְ

“you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [you are ensnared by the sayings of your mouth, yes, you are caught by the sayings of your mouth]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:2 (#5)

בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךְ & בְּאִמְרֵי־פִיךְ

“by the sayings of your mouth & by the sayings of your mouth”

Here, **mouth** represents the words of a promise that the person said with his mouth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by your sayings ... by your sayings]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:3 (#5)

בָּבֹאֶתְךָ בְּכַף־רֵעֶךָ

“you have come into the palm of your neighbor”

Here Solomon speaks of his **son** being controlled by his **neighbor** as if he had **come into the palm** of his **neighbor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your neighbor has power over you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:3 (#3)

וְהִצַּלְתָּ

“and rescue yourself”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is the purpose for doing what Solomon commands his son to do in this verse. Use a connector in your language that

indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of rescuing yourself]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 6:3 (#2)

בְּנִי

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:3 (#6)

וְרֵחֶבֶב

“and press”

Here Solomon speaks of his **son** begging his **neighbor** as if he were pressing him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and plead with]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:3 (#7)

וְרֵחֶבֶב רֵעִיד

“and press your neighbor”

Here Solomon implies that his **son** should **press** his **neighbor** to free him from his obligation to fulfill the promise referred to in 6:1-2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and press your neighbor to release you from your obligation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:3 (#4)

וְהִנָּצִל

“and rescue yourself”

Here Solomon implies that his **son** should **rescue** himself from his obligation to fulfill the promise referred to in 6:1-2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and rescue yourself from your obligation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:3 (#1)

עֲשֵׂה זֶאת אַפְסוּא

“then do this”

Here, **then** indicates that what follows is what someone should do if the hypothetical conditions stated in the previous two verses take place. Use the most natural way to express this in your language. Alternate translation: [then do this in response]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:4 (#1)

אַל־תִּתְּנָן שְׁנֶנָּה לְעֵינֶיךָ וְאִתְּנוּמָהּ לַעֲפָפֶיךָ

“Do not give sleep to your eyes and slumber to your eyelids”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Do not give sleep to your eyes and do not give slumber to your eyelids]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:4 (#3)

אַל־תִּתְּנָן שְׁנֶנָּה לְעֵינֶיךָ וְאִתְּנוּמָהּ לַעֲפָפֶיךָ

“Do not give sleep to your eyes and slumber to your eyelids”

Here Solomon is speaking of allowing oneself to **sleep** and **slumber** as if they were objects that one could **give** to oneself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not let your eyes sleep or your eyelids slumber]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:4 (#5)

לְעֵינֶיךָ & לַעֲפָפֶיךָ

“to your eyes & to your eyelids”

Here Solomon is using **eyes** and **eyelids** to refer to one's whole body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to yourself ... to yourself]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 6:4 (#2)

אַל־תִּתְּנָן שְׁנֶנָּה לְעֵינֶיךָ וְאִתְּנוּמָהּ לַעֲפָפֶיךָ

“Do not give sleep to your eyes and slumber to your eyelids”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first

by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Do not give sleep to your eyes, yes, do not give slumber to your eyelids]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:4 (#4)

אַל־תִּתְּנֶנּוּ שְׁנָנָה

“Do not give sleep”

Solomon implies that this person should not allow himself to **sleep** until he goes to his neighbor to get out of the agreement. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Until you rescue yourself from this problem, do not give sleep]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:5 (#1)

הִתְנַצֵּל כְּצִבְרִי מִיַּד וְאִכְצַפְּפֹר מִיַּד יָקוֹשׁ

“Rescue yourself like a gazelle from a hand and like a bird from the hand of the trapper”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Rescue yourself like a gazelle would rescue itself from a hand, and rescue yourself like a bird would rescue itself from the hand of the trapper]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:5 (#4)

כְּצִבְרִי

“like a gazelle”

A **gazelle** is a land animal that is known for running quickly and gracefully. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [like an animal that runs swiftly]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 6:5 (#2)

הִתְנַצֵּל כְּצִבְרִי מִיַּד וְאִכְצַפְּפֹר מִיַּד יָקוֹשׁ

“Rescue yourself like a gazelle from a hand and like a bird from the hand of the trapper”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Rescue yourself like a gazelle from a hand, yes, rescue yourself like a bird from the hand of the trapper]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:5 (#3)

כְּצִבְרִי & וְאִכְצַפְּפֹר

“like a gazelle & and like a bird”

Solomon is saying that the person should act like a **gazelle** and a **bird** because both of those animals are quick enough to escape from hunters. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [quickly, like a gazelle ... and quickly, like a bird]

See: Simile

Proverbs 6:6 (#5)

דְּרָכֶיהָ

“its ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:6 (#1)

לֵךְ־אַל־נִמְלִלָה

“Go to the ant”

Go here implies going for the purpose of looking at **the ant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Go and observe the ant]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:6 (#4)

רְאֵהָ

“See”

See here means to observe for the purpose of learning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [See and learn]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:6 (#2)

נְמִלָּה

“the ant”

The word **ant** represents ants in general, not one particular **ant**. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [ants]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:6 (#6)

וְחָכָם

“and be wise”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is the purpose for doing what Solomon commands his son to do in this verse. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of becoming wise]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 6:6 (#3)

נְמִלָּה

“the ant”

An **ant** is a small insect that lives underground in large groups. Ants are known for diligently working together to collect food and maintain their nests. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of insect, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the hard-working insect]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 6:7 (#1)

קֹצֵצִין שְׂמִיטָה וּמִשְׁלָל

“a commander, officer, or ruler”

These three words mean basically the same thing and are used to emphasize that no one commands ants to work diligently. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [any ruler whatsoever]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 6:8 (#5)

בְּקִיץ & בְּקֹצֵצִיר

“in the summer & in the harvest”

In the location where this book was written, **summer** is the time of year when people **harvest** crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the time for harvesting crops ... in the harvesting time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:8 (#4)

לְחֵמָה אֲגָרָה & מֵאֲכָלָהּ

“its bread & it gathers its food”

In this verse, **its** refers to “the ant” mentioned in 6:7, which is a collective word for ants in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the ant’s bread ... the ant gathers its food] or [the ants’ bread ... the ants gather their food]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:8 (#2)

תִּכְכֵּן בְּקִיץ לְחֵמָה אֲגָרָה בְּבֹקֶצֶיךָ מֵאֲכָלָהּ

“prepares its bread in the summer; it gathers its food in the harvest”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [prepares its bread in the summer; yes, it gathers its food in the harvest]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:8 (#3)

תִּכְכֵּן & אֲגָרָה

“prepares & it gathers”

Here, **prepares** and **gathers** refer to collecting and storing food for winter, which is the time when food is scarce. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [acquires ... it stockpiles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:8 (#1)

תִּכְכֵּן

“prepares”

The idea in this verse is contrary to what one would expect after knowing the information in the previous

verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [even so, prepares]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 6:9 (#3)

תקקום משנתך

“will you rise from your sleep”

Here Solomon refers to waking up as if a person were rising up from **sleep**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will you wake up]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:9 (#2)

תשכב

“will you lie down”

The phrase **lie down** implies that the person has been lying on a bed to sleep. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will you sleep in your bed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:9 (#1)

עד-מתתי עצצ'ל | תשכב ממתתי תקקום משנתך

“Until when, lazy one, will you lie down? When will you rise from your sleep?”

Solomon is using the question form twice in this verse for emphasis. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Lazy person, you should stop lying down! You should rise from your sleep!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 6:10 (#4)

מעט | חבבק ידדים לשכב

“a little folding of the hands to lie down”

This phrase refers to an action that people often do in order to rest more comfortably when they **lie down** to sleep. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a little folding of the hands comfortably to lie down and sleep]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:10 (#1)

מעט ששנות מעט תנוממות מעט | חבבק ידדים לשכב

“A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to lie down”

This verse is a quotation of what the “lazy one” might say. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Proverbs 6:10 (#3)

מעט ששנות מעט תנוממות

“A little sleep, a little slumber”

These two phrases mean the same thing. The lazy person is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Just a little more sleep]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 6:10 (#2)

מעט ששנות מעט תנוממות

“A little sleep, a little slumber”

The lazy person is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Let me have a little more sleep; let me have a little more slumber]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:11 (#1)

ובא-כמהלך ראשך וימחךך באיש מגן

“and your poverty will come like one who walks and your need like a man of shield”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and your poverty will come like one who walks and your need will come like a man of shield]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:11 (#8)

באיש מגן

“like a man of shield”

Here, the phrase **a man of shield** refers to a robber with weapons. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [like a robber with weapons] or [like an armed man]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:11 (#3)

וּבָא & רָאשִׁיטָה

“and your poverty will come”

Here, **and** introduces the result of what the lazy person does and says in the two previous verses. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [and all this will cause your poverty to come]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:11 (#2)

וּבָא-כְּמַהֲלֵלָהּ רָאשִׁיטָה וְיִמְחָסְרָהּ כְּאִישׁ מְגֹן

“and your poverty will come like one who walks and your need like a man of shield”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [and your poverty will come like one who walks, yes, your need will come like a man of shield]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:11 (#6)

כְּמַהֲלֵלָהּ

“like one who walks”

Here, the phrase **one who walks** refers to a robber. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [like a robber]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:11 (#5)

וּבָא-כְּמַהֲלֵלָהּ רָאשִׁיטָה

“and your poverty will come like one who walks”

Here Solomon speaks of experiencing **poverty** as if it were a person who could **come** walking to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will surely experience poverty]

See: Personification

Proverbs 6:11 (#9)

כְּאִישׁ מְגֹן

“like a man of shield”

Here Solomon speaks of how surely and completely a lazy person becomes needy as if **need** were an armed robber who takes by force everything that the person owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be complete]

See: Simile

Proverbs 6:11 (#7)

כְּמַהֲלֵלָהּ

“like one who walks”

Here Solomon speaks of how certain it is that a lazy person will become poor as if **poverty** were a robber who walks right into his house and steals everything the person owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [without fail]

See: Simile

Proverbs 6:11 (#4)

רָאשִׁיטָה וְיִמְחָסְרָהּ

“your poverty & and your need”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **poverty** and **need**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [you being poor ... and you being needy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:12 (#4)

הֵרוֹלֵלָהּ

“is} one who walks”

See how you translated the similar use of “walking” in 2:7. Alternate translation: [is one who lives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:12 (#2)

אָדָם בְּבַלְיַעַל אִישׁ אָאָן

“A man of worthlessness, a man of iniquity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** that is characterized by **worthlessness** and **iniquity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A worthless man, an iniquitous man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:12 (#3)

אָדָם & אִישׁ

“A man of & a man of”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [A person of ... a person of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:12 (#1)

אָדָם בְּבַלְיַעַל אִישׁ אָאָן

“A man of worthlessness, a man of iniquity”

The phrases **man of worthlessness** and **man of iniquity** mean the same thing. Solomon is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [A completely useless man]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 6:12 (#5)

עֲקֹשׁוֹת פֶּה

“with} perversity of mouth”

See how you translated this phrase in 4:24.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:13 (#3)

קָרַץ בְּבָעִינוּ מִלֵּל בְּרִגְלָיו מִמְרֹרֶה בְּאֶצְבָּעָתָיו

“one who winks with his eye, one who rubs with his foot, one who points with his fingers”

These three clauses refer to actions that someone uses when deceiving people. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of

these actions in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [one who winks with his eye, signals with his foot, and points with his fingers to deceive people]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 6:13 (#2)

קָרַץ בְּבָעִינוּ מִלֵּל בְּרִגְלָיו מִמְרֹרֶה בְּאֶצְבָּעָתָיו

“one who winks with his eye, one who rubs with his foot, one who points with his fingers”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [one who winks with one's eye, one who signals with one's foot, one who points with one's fingers]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:13 (#1)

קָרַץ בְּבָעִינוּ מִלֵּל בְּרִגְלָיו מִמְרֹרֶה בְּאֶצְבָּעָתָיו

“one who winks with his eye, one who rubs with his foot, one who points with his fingers”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous verse if it would be clearer in your language. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [He is one who winks with his eye, one who signals with his foot, and one who points with his fingers]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:14 (#5)

מִדְּנִים יִשְׁלַח

“he sends forth quarrels”

Here Solomon speaks of **quarrels** as if they were objects that a person **sends forth**. He means that this person causes other people to quarrel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he causes people to quarrel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:14 (#3)

בְּלִבּוֹ

“are} in his heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:14 (#2)

בְּלִבּוֹ & יִשְׁלַח

“are} in his heart & he sends forth”

Although the terms **his** and **he** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [are in that person’s heart ... that person sends forth]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:14 (#4)

רָע

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:14 (#1)

תַּהֲפֹכֹת | בְּלִבּוֹ חֲרָשׁ רָע בְּכָל־עֵת

“Perverse things {are} in his heart, plotting evil on every occasion”

These two clauses are describing two situations that are occurring at the same time. You can make this clear in your translation with an appropriate connecting word or phrase. Alternate translation: [Perverse things are in his heart while he plots evil on every occasion]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Proverbs 6:15 (#4)

יִשְׁבֹּר וְאֵין מְרַפָּא

“he will be broken and without healing”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the calamity will break him and he will not heal]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:15 (#1)

אִידֹן & יִשְׁבֹּר

“his calamity & he will be broken”

Although the terms **his** and **he** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that

includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [that person’s calamity ... that person will be broken]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:15 (#2)

אִידֹן

“his calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:15 (#3)

יָבֹוא

“will come”

Here Solomon speaks of **calamity** occurring as if it were a person who could **come** to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will occur]

See: Personification

Proverbs 6:16 (#2)

שֵׁשׁ & חֲשֹׁבֶעַ

“Six & and seven”

Here Solomon is using the adjectives **Six** and **seven** as nouns to mean **six** and **seven** things. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [Six things ... and seven things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 6:16 (#1)

שֵׁשׁ־הַהֲנָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמָר יְהוָה חֲשֹׁבֶעַ תּוֹעֲבוֹת נִפְשׁוֹ

“Six {are} they {that} Yahweh hates, and seven {are} abominations to his self”

To make a comprehensive statement, Solomon is using a rhetorical device in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh absolutely hates these seven things, and they are abominations to his self]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:16 (#4)

נפשו

“his self”

Here, **self** refers to **Yahweh** himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:16 (#3)

תועבות

“are} abominations to”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abominations**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [are abominable to]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:17 (#4)

וידיו

“and hands”

Here, **hands** refers to the whole person who does this action with his hands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and people]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 6:17 (#2)

לשון שקר

“a tongue of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **tongue** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a false tongue] or [lying] or [telling lies]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:17 (#3)

לשון שקר

“a tongue of falsehood”

Here, **tongue** represents what a person says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [telling lies]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:17 (#5)

שפכות דם-נקי

“pouring out innocent blood”

See how you translated a similar phrase in 1:16.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:17 (#1)

עינים רמות

“uplifted eyes”

Here Solomon refers to pride as **uplifted eyes**, which is a characteristic facial expression of proud people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [pride]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:18 (#1)

לֵב & רגלים

“a heart & feet”

Here, **heart** and **feet** refer to the whole person who does these things in his heart or with his feet. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people ... people]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 6:18 (#3)

אָן & לרעה

“iniquity & to evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **iniquity** in 6:12 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:18 (#2)

מחשבות אָן

“plans of iniquity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **plans** that are characterized by **iniquity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [iniquitous plans] or [sinful plans]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:18 (#4)

מִמְהָרָיוֹת לָרֹץ לָרָעָה

“hurrying to run to evil”

Here Solomon speaks of being eager to do **evil** as if **evil** were a place that a person could **run to**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [eager to do evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:19 (#3)

וּמִשְׁלָלָהּ מִמְדַּנְנִים

“and sending forth quarrels”

See how you translated **sends forth quarrels** in 6:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:19 (#1)

עֵיֶד שֹׁשֶׁקֶר

“a witness of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **witness** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a false witness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:19 (#4)

אֶחָיו

“brothers”

Although the term **brothers** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [family members]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:19 (#2)

יִפְתִּיחַ כְּזָבִים

“breathing out lies”

Here Solomon speaks of someone who lies easily and repeatedly as if that person **breathes out lies**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who easily lies]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:20 (#3)

נִצְעֹר

“Guard”

Here Solomon speaks of a **commandment** as if it were an object that someone should **Guard**. He means that he wants his son to remember to do what he has commanded him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of guard in 3:21. Alternate translation: [Remember to practice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:20 (#1)

אָבִיךָ

“your father”

See how you translated the same use of **your father** in 1:8.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Proverbs 6:20 (#4)

בְּרִנִּי

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 6:20 (#5)

וְאַל־תִּתְּשֵׁט׃ תּוֹרַת אִמֶּךָ

“and do not forsake the law of your mother”

See how you translated this clause in 1:8.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 6:20 (#2)

נִצְעֹר בְּרִנִּי מִצְוֹת אָבִיךָ וְאַל־תִּתְּשֵׁט׃ תּוֹרַת אִמֶּךָ

“Guard, my son, the commandment of your father and do not forsake the law of your mother”

These two clauses mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the clauses express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Be careful, son, to follow all of the instructions from your father and mother]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:21 (#2)

קשרם על-לבך

“Bind them on your heart”

Here Solomon is speaking of remembering his commands as if they were objects that people could **bind** on their **hearts**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Remember them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:21 (#1)

קשרם על-לבך תמיד ענדים על-גררתך

“Bind them on your heart continually; tie them around your neck”

These two phrases mean similar things. Solomon is using repetition to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Keep them very close to you at all times]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:21 (#3)

ענדים על-גררתך

“tie them around your neck”

Here Solomon is speaking of remembering his commands as if they were objects that people could **tie around** their **necks**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remember them] or [keep them close to you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:22 (#3)

תהיה

“it will guide”

The pronoun **it** in this verse refers to everything that the parents have taught the son, which can be summarized in the word “wisdom.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use that word here, or you could use a plural pronoun to refer to the parents’ teachings, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [this wisdom will guide you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:22 (#5)

היא תשיחך

“it itself will converse with you”

For emphasis, Solomon is stating the pronoun **it**, whose meaning is already included in the verb translated as **converse**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **itself**. Alternate translation: [it will be the one that converses with you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:22 (#2)

בהתהלךך

“When you walk about”

Here, **walk about** refers to doing one’s daily activities. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When you do your daily activities]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:22 (#1)

בהתהלךך | תנחלה אתך בבשכך תשממר עליך ויהי צוהיה היא תשיחך

“When you walk about, it will guide you; when you lie down, it will preserve you; then you will wake up; it itself will converse with you”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of the lessons he called “the command” and “the teaching” in 6:20 as if they were a person who could **guide**, **preserve**, and **converse with** a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. Alternate translation: [When you walk about, it will enable you to know what to do; when you lie down, it will enable you to be safe; and you will wake up, it will be advice for you] or [When you walk about, it will be like a guide for you; when you lie down, it will be like someone who preserves you; and you will wake up, it will be like someone who converses with you]

See: Personification

Proverbs 6:22 (#4)

בבשכך

“when you lie down”

See how you translated the same use of **lie down** in 3:24.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:23 (#7)

מִצְוָה וְתוֹרָה

“commandment & and law & the & the”

See how you translated this use of **law** in 1:8.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 6:23 (#2)

נֵגֶר מִצְוָה וְתוֹרָה אֶאֱזֹר

“commandment {is} a lamp and law {is} a light & the & the”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [commandment is a lamp, yes, law is a light]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:23 (#6)

נֵגֶר & אֶאֱזֹר

“is} a lamp & is} a light”

Here Solomon refers to **commandment** and **law** enabling people to understand how to live as if they were a **lamp** and a **light** that shows people the path in front of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [enables one to understand ... enables one to perceive the right way to live]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:23 (#9)

תּוֹכַחֲתוֹת מוֹסֵר

“rebukes of instruction”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **rebukes** that are included in the **instruction** process. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the rebukes that come from instruction]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:23 (#3)

מִצְוָה וְתוֹרָה

“commandment & and law & the & the”

Here, **commandment** and **law** could refer to: (1) the commands of the father and mother, which were referred to in the previous two verses. Alternate translation: [each of my commandments ... and your mother’s law]; (2) good commandments and laws in general. Alternate translation: [every good commandment ... and every good law]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:23 (#8)

תּוֹכַחֲתוֹת מוֹסֵר

“rebukes of instruction”

See how you translated the abstract nouns “rebuke” in 1:25 and **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:23 (#10)

וְדֶרֶךְ חַיִּים

“and & are & way of life”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that results in **life**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and ... are the way that results in life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:23 (#4)

מִצְוָה

“commandment & the”

Solomon is speaking of commandments in general, and he is not speaking of one particular **commandment**. If it would be helpful in your language, use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [every commandment]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:23 (#5)

מִצְוָה

“commandment & the”

See how you translated the abstract noun “commandments” in 2:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:23 (#11)

וַיְהִי

“and & are & way of”

Here Solomon uses **way** to refer to how people behave. See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:23 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:24 (#1)

לְשָׁמְרְךָ

“to keep you”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for the “commandments,” “law,” and “rebukes of instruction” referred to in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of keeping you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 6:24 (#4)

נָכְרִיָּה

“a foreign woman”

See how you translated the same use of **foreign woman** in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:24 (#2)

מֵאֵשֶׁת רָרָע

“from a woman of evil”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** who is characterized by **evil**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [from an evil woman]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:24 (#3)

מִמַּחְמַלְקוֹת לְשׁוֹן

“from the smoothness of the tongue of”

Here Solomon refers to the seductive speech of an adulterous woman as if it were **the smoothness of the tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the seductive speech of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:25 (#1)

יְפִיָּהּ

“her beauty”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **beauty**, you could express the same idea in another way, as in the UST.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:25 (#2)

בְּלִבְךָ

“in your heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:25 (#3)

וְאַל-תִּתְּקֶנָּהּ

“and do not let her take you”

Here Solomon refers to a woman seducing a man as if she could **take** him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and do not let her tempt you]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:25 (#4)

בְּעַפְעָפֶיהָ

“with her eyelashes”

This phrase refers to a woman using her **eyelashes** to look more attractive and seduce a man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or use an expression that has the same meaning in your language. Alternate translation: [by batting her eyes] or [by glancing seductively]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:26 (#4)

וְאִשָּׁת אָדָם

“but the wife of a man”

Here Solomon implies that this **wife of a man** is an adulterous woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but a married woman who commits adultery]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:26 (#3)

כֶּבֶד לֶלֶם

“a loaf of bread”

In this culture, **a loaf of bread** was inexpensive daily food. A **loaf of bread** is a lump of flour dough that a person has shaped and baked. If your readers would not be familiar with **bread** you could use the name of an inexpensive food that is commonly eaten in your country or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [inexpensive food]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 6:26 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do those things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:26 (#2)

בְּעַד־אִשָּׁה זֹנִיָּה

“the price of a prostitute woman”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to refer to **the price** that a person pays to have sex with **a prostitute woman**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or use a euphemism for this idea. Alternate translation: [the price to sleep with a prostitute woman]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:26 (#5)

נִנְכַּשׁ יְקָרָהּ תַּצִּוּר

“hunts a precious life”

Here Solomon speaks of a adulterous woman causing the man she commits adultery with to die as if she **hunts** him the way a hunter **hunts** an animal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [kills a precious life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:27 (#2)

הִיחַתְתָּהּ אִישׁ אֶלֶף בְּחִיקָקוֹ וְיִבְגְּדֶיּוֹ לֹלֵא תִשְׂרָפָהּ

“Could a man carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned”

Here Solomon is referring to the negative consequences of committing adultery as if a man were burning himself with **fire**. Since this comparison is explained in 6:29, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Proverbs 6:27 (#3)

אִישׁ & בְּחִיקָקוֹ וְיִבְגְּדֶיּוֹ

“a man & on his chest and his clothes”

Here, **a man** and **his** do not refer to a specific **man**. They refer to any person who does this thing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any person ... on that person's chest and that person's clothes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:27 (#1)

הִיחַתְתָּהּ אִישׁ אֶלֶף בְּחִיקָקוֹ וְיִבְגְּדֶיּוֹ לֹלֵא תִשְׂרָפָהּ

“Could a man carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Surely a man could not carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 6:27 (#5)

וְיִבְגְּדֶיּוֹ

“and his clothes”

Here, **clothes** refers to the person who is wearing those **clothes**. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he] or [and that person]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:27 (#4)

וְהַחֲרִיף אֶת הַתְּשׁוּבָה לֹא תִשְׂרֹף

“and his clothes not be burned”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the fire not burn his clothes]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:27–28 (#1)

הִיחָתְתָהּ אִשׁ אֶל־בְּחִיקָהּ וְהַחֲרִיף אֶת הַתְּשׁוּבָה לֹא תִשְׂרֹף
עַל־הַחֲרִיף אֶת הַתְּשׁוּבָה לֹא תִשְׂרֹף

“Could a man carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned? If a man walks on coals then will his feet not be scorched”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Could a man carry a fire on his chest and his clothes not be burned? Indeed, if a man walks on coals then will his feet not be scorched?]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 6:28 (#4)

הַחֲרִיף

“coals”

Here, **coals** refers to small pieces of burning wood that are often used for cooking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [burning wood pieces]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:28 (#3)

אִשׁ & הַחֲרִיף לֹא תִשְׂרֹף

“a man & then will his feet not be scorched”

Here, **a man** and **his** do not refer to a specific **man**. They refer to any person who does this thing. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that

would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any person ... then will that person’s feet not be scorched]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:28 (#1)

אִם־יֵהָלֵךְ אִישׁ עַל־הַחֲרִיף לֹא תִשְׂרֹף

“If a man walks on coals then will his feet not be scorched”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Surely if a man walks on coals, then his feet will be scorched!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 6:28 (#2)

אִם־יֵהָלֵךְ אִישׁ עַל־הַחֲרִיף לֹא תִשְׂרֹף

“If a man walks on coals then will his feet not be scorched”

Here Solomon is referring to the negative consequences of committing adultery as if a man were burning himself with **coals**. Since this comparison is explained in 6:29, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Proverbs 6:29 (#4)

לֹא יִבְקָעָהּ

“will not remain blameless”

Here Solomon uses **not remain blameless** to refer to the outcome of not being **blameless**, which is being punished for being guilty. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not avoid punishment] or [will not remain unpunished]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:29 (#2)

הַחֲבֵא אֶל & הַנִּגַּע בָּהּ

“is the one going to & one who touches her”

Here, **going to** and **touches** both refer to someone having sex with another person. This is a polite way of referring to something that is offensive or embarrassing in some cultures. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different polite way of

referring to this act or you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of “enter” in 2:19. Alternate translation: [is the one who has sexual relations with ... one who has sexual relations with her] or [is the one who sleeps with ... one who sleeps with her]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 6:29 (#1)

כֵּן

“So”

So here indicates that what follows explains the meaning of the statements made in the previous two verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a fuller expression. Alternate translation: [In the same situation]

See: Simile

Proverbs 6:29 (#3)

לֹא יִנְקָהּ

“will not remain blameless”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [will certainly be guilty]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 6:30 (#4)

לְמַלְאֵת בִּנְפֶשׁוֹ

“to satisfy his appetite”

The expression **to satisfy his appetite** contains extra information that may be unnatural to express in some languages along with **when he is hungry**. If this is true of your language, you could leave this part unexpressed, as in the UST.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Proverbs 6:30 (#2)

לִלְגֹב & יִגְנוֹב & בִּנְפֶשׁוֹ & יִרְעֵב

“the thief & he steals & his appetite & he is hungry”

Here, **the thief**, **he**, and **his** do not refer to a specific **thief**, but any person who steals. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more nat-

ural in your language. Alternate translation: [thieves ... they steal ... their appetites ... they are hungry]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:30 (#5)

בִּנְפֶשׁוֹ

“his appetite”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **appetite**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [his need for food]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:30 (#1)

לֹא יִבְרִיזוּ

“They do not despise”

They here refers to people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [People do not despise]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:30 (#3)

יִגְנוֹב

“he steals”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context, as in the UST.

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:31 (#2)

וְנִמְצָא

“but if he is found”

Here, **found** implies not only discovering the thief but also catching him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [But if he is caught]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:31 (#4)

יְשַׁלֵּם שִׁבְעָתָיו

“he must repay sevenfold”

This clause implies that, as punishment for stealing, the thief **must repay** seven times the amount of what he stole to those from whom he stole it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this

explicitly. Alternate translation: [he must repay to the people from whom he stole, sevenfold the amount of what he stole from them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:31 (#5)

אֶת־כָּל־הָהוֹן בֵּיתוֹ

“all the wealth of his house”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to everything that someone owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all that he has]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:31 (#1)

וְנִמְצָא יִשְׁלַם & בֵּיתוֹ יָתֵן

“but if he is found, he must repay & his house he must give”

Here, **he** and **his** refer to any person who steals, as indicated in the previous verse. If there are more natural expressions in your language, you could use them here. Alternate translation: [But if someone is found ... that person must repay ... that person's house that person must give]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 6:31 (#3)

וְנִמְצָא

“but if he is found”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but if someone finds him] or [but if someone catches him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:32 (#3)

חָסֵר־לֵב

“is} lacking of heart”

Here Solomon refers to the **heart** as the place where a person thinks. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is out of his mind] or [is lacking the ability to think]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:32 (#5)

מִשְׁחָתִית נִנְפֵשׁוּ

“destroying his life”

This clause is the result of what is described in the next clause. Use a natural way in your language to indicate a result. Alternate translation: [his life is destroyed because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:32 (#6)

הָרוּא יַעֲשֶׂנָּה

“he does it”

Here, the pronoun **it** refers to **adultery**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he commits adultery]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 6:32 (#1)

נֹאֲפֵר

“One who commits adultery”

This verse says something that is in contrast to what was said about the thief in the previous two verses. Use a natural way in your language to express a strong contrast. Alternate translation: [However, one who commits adultery]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 6:32 (#2)

נֹאֲפֵר

“One who commits adultery”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **adultery**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [One who enters an adulterous relationship]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:32 (#4)

מִשְׁחָתִית נִנְפֵשׁוּ הָרוּא יַעֲשֶׂנָּה

“destroying his life, he does it”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [what he does will destroy his life]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 6:33 (#6)

לֹא תִמְחָה

“will not be wiped out”

Here Solomon refers to the adulterous man’s **shame** never ceasing as if **shame** were a stain that could **not be wiped** away. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not cease]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:33 (#2)

יִגְעֵ-וְקִלְלוֹן יִמְצָא

“He will find a wound and disgrace”

Here Solomon speaks of the adulterous man receiving **a wound and disgrace** as if they were objects that a person would **find**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He will receive a wound and disgrace] or [He will become wounded and disgraced]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 6:33 (#4)

לֹא תִמְחָה

“will not be wiped out”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he will never wipe out]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 6:33 (#5)

לֹא תִמְחָה

“will not be wiped out”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will always remain]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 6:33 (#1)

יִגְעֵ-וְקִלְלוֹן יִמְצָא וְחִרְפָּתוֹ לֹא תִמְחָה

“He will find a wound and disgrace, and his shame will not be wiped out”

Solomon implies that these things will happen to the adulterous man because he committed adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Because he committed adultery, he will find a wound and disgrace and his shame will not be wiped out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:33 (#3)

וְקִלְלוֹן & חִרְפָּתוֹ

“and disgrace, and his shame”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **disgrace** and **shame**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [and be disgraced, and how shameful he is]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:34 (#2)

קִנְיָאָה & זָקָם

“jealousy & vengeance”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **jealousy** and **vengeance**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [being jealous ... being avenged]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 6:34 (#3)

חֵמֶת-גִּבּוֹר

“is the heat of a man”

Here, **heat** refers to extreme anger, which causes the angry person’s body to become hot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the rage of a man]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 6:34 (#4)

גִּבּוֹר וְלֹא-יִשְׁחַמְּמוֹל

“a man, and he will not spare”

Here, **man** and **he** refer to the husband who has just found out that his wife has committed adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a husband of an adulterous woman, and that husband will not spare]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:34 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason why what Solomon stated in the previous verse is true. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is due to the fact that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 6:34 (#6)

וְלֹא-יִתְּחַמְמוֹל

“and he will not spare”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will not spare the man who slept with his wife]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:34 (#7)

בְּיוֹם נָקָם

“in the day of vengeance”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the day** when **vengeance** occurs. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [when vengeance occurs]

See: Possession

Proverbs 6:34 (#5)

וְלֹא-יִתְּחַמְמוֹל

“and he will not spare”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [and he will be merciless]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 6:35 (#2)

לֹא-יִשָּׂא פָנָיו

“He will not lift up the face of”

Here, the phrase **lift up the face of** is an idiom that means “regard favorably.” If it would be helpful, you could use an idiom with that meaning in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He will not be impressed by] or [He will not regard favorably]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 6:35 (#3)

כִּכְפָּר & שָׁחַד

“ransom & the bribe”

Here, the words **ransom** and **bribe** refer to money that a man would give to the husband of the woman he has committed adultery with in order to avoid harm or stop the man from being angry. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [money offered to appease him ... that money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 6:35 (#4)

וְלֹא-יִזְאָבְדָּה

“and he will not be willing”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will not be willing to be appeased] or [and he will not stop being angry]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 6:35 (#1)

לֹא-יִשָּׂא & וְלֹא-יִזְאָבְדָּה

“He will not lift up & and he will not be willing”

In this verse, the pronoun **he** refers to the man who has just found out that his wife has committed adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The husband of an adulterous wife will not lift up ... and that husband will not be willing]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

More Warnings about Adultery * Being wise keeps you from adultery (7:1-5) * The story of an adulterer (7:6-23) * The lesson of the story (7:24-27)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

My son

Occasionally Solomon addresses a series of proverbs to “my son” or “sons.” This does not mean that those proverbs only apply to males. Instead, these phrases are forms used to pass on advice from a father to his son, and the kind of advice in these proverbs is about common temptations of young men.

Adulterous women

This chapter continues the theme about adulterous women and warns young men to avoid any adulterous woman, who is called “strange” and “foreign.” (See: [\[\[rc://*/tw/dict/bible/kt/adultery\]\]](http://rc://*/tw/dict/bible/kt/adultery))

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The historic present

To call attention to developments in the story, Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in 7:8-13 and 21-22. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. (See: Irregular Use of Tenses)

Proverbs 7:1 (#1)

שמר

“keep”

See how you translated the same use of **keep** in 5:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:1 (#2)

תצפן

“store up”

See how you translated the same use of **store up** in 2:1.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:1 (#3)

ואמצותתי

“and & my commandments”

See how you translated the abstract noun **commandments** in 2:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 7:2 (#4)

כאיששון עיניך

“as the pupil of your eyes”

Here Solomon refers to his **law** as if it were **the pupil of your eyes**. He means that people should value wise rules as much as they value their ability to see and protect their eyes. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language with that meaning or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as the light of your life] or [as supremely valuable to you]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 7:2 (#3)

ואתורתתי

“and my law”

See how you translated **law** in 1:8.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 7:2 (#2)

ואתורתתי כאיששון עיניך

“and my law, as the pupil of your eyes”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and keep my law as the pupil of your eyes]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:2 (#1)

שמר מצותתי וחייה

“Keep my commandments and live”

See how you translated the same clause in 4:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 7:3 (#3)

ככתבם על־לוח לבך

“write them on the tablet of your heart”

See how you translated this clause in 3:3. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [know them by heart] or [continually think about them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:3 (#2)

קשרם & ככתבם

“Tie them & write them”

In this verse, **them** refers to “my commandments,” which are referred to in the previous two verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Tie my commandments ... write my commandments]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 7:3 (#1)

קשרם על-אצבעותיך

“Tie them on your fingers”

Here Solomon speaks of always remembering something as if what should be remembered were an object tied to the person’s fingers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Remember them at all times]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:4 (#2)

אממר ללחכמה אחותי אאת ולמדך לבינה תקרא

“Say to Wisdom, “You {are} my sister,” and call to Understanding, “Kinsman”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express these two clauses as indirect quotations. Alternate translation: [Say to Wisdom that she is your sister, and call to Understanding that she is your kinsman]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 7:4 (#5)

אממדך לבינה תקרא

“and call to Understanding, “Kinsman”

Solomon speaks of **Understanding** as if it were a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and value understanding as if it were someone to whom you would call, “Kinsman”]

See: Personification

Proverbs 7:4 (#6)

אממדך לבינה תקרא

“and call to Understanding, “Kinsman”

Although the term **Kinsman** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to any close relative. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and call to Understanding, “Family member”]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 7:4 (#3)

ללחכמה & לבינה

“to Wisdom & to Understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 7:4 (#4)

אממר ללחכמה אחותי אאת

“Say to Wisdom, “You {are} my sister”

Solomon speaks of **Wisdom** as if it were a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Value wisdom as if it were a woman to whom you would say, “You are my sister”]

See: Personification

Proverbs 7:4 (#1)

אממר ללחכמה אחותי אאת ולמדך לבינה תקרא

“Say to Wisdom, “You {are} my sister,” and call to Understanding, “Kinsman”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Say to Wisdom, “You {are} my sister,” yes, call to Understanding, “Kinsman”]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 7:5 (#3)

מימנכרית אמרית הנחליקה

“from the foreign woman who makes her sayings smooth”

See how you translated the same clause in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:5 (#1)

מאשה זרה

“from the strange woman”

See how you translated **strange woman** in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:5 (#2)

מִמֶּנְקֵרִיָּה

“from the foreign woman”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to keep you from the foreign woman]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:6 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here introduces a story that Solomon tells in 7:6–23 in order to warn his son against committing adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different word or phrase that introduces a story. Alternate translation: [There was a time when]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 7:6 (#2)

בַּחֲלֹן בֵּיתִי

“at the window of my house”

Solomon implies that he was standing **at the window** while looking out of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:6 (#4)

אֲשַׁנְבֵּבִי

“the window lattice”

A **lattice** consists of thin strips of wood that cross one another in a slanted pattern and are placed over a **window** to partially cover it. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of **window** covering, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the window screen] or [the covering on the window]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 7:6 (#5)

נִשְׁקַפְתִּי

“I looked down”

Here Solomon implies that he was standing at a location that was higher than the street outside. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I looked down at the street outside]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:6 (#3)

בַּחֲלֹן בֵּיתִי

“at the window of my house”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **window** that is in the side of his **house**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [at the window that is in the side of my house]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:7 (#1)

וַאֲנִי אֶרְאֶה בְּתוֹכָם אֲנִי אֶחָד בְּבָנִים

“And I saw among the naive ones, I discerned among the sons”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. They are both the first part of a sentence, and the next phrase finishes both sentences. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could supply an object for the first phrase, or you could show that the second phrase is stating the first phrase again. Alternate translation: [And I saw a person among the naive ones; I discerned among the sons] or [And I saw among the naive ones, that is, I discerned among the sons]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 7:7 (#3)

חֲסֵר־לֵב

“lacking of heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:7 (#2)

בְּבָנִים

“among the sons”

Here, **sons** refers to young men. It does not specifically refer to Solomon’s **sons**. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could express the meaning plainly.
Alternate translation: [among the young men]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:8 (#3)

וַיֵּדְרֶה בִּיתָהּ יָצֵד

“and he steps {in} the way of her house”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **way** that leads to **her house**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he steps in the way that leads to her house]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:8 (#2)

פִּנְגָּה

“her corner”

Here, **corner** refers to the place where two roads intersect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [her place at the intersection of two streets]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:8 (#4)

יָצֵד

“he steps {in}”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [he stepped in]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:8 (#1)

פִּנְגָּה & בִּיתָהּ

“her corner & her house”

In this verse, **her** refers to an adulterous woman, as referred to in 7:5. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the corner where an adulterous woman lives ... that woman's house]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 7:9 (#1)

בְּנֶשֶׁף־בַּעֲרֵב יוֹם בְּאִישׁוֹן לַלַּיְלָה וְאֶפְלָה

“in the twilight breeze, in the evening of day, in the pupil of the night and darkness”

In this verse, Solomon provides this background information about the time period when the young man went to the adulterous woman's house. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Now it was the time of the twilight breeze, in the evening of day, in the pupil of the night and darkness]

See: Background Information

Proverbs 7:9 (#2)

בְּנֶשֶׁף־בַּעֲרֵב יוֹם בְּאִישׁוֹן לַלַּיְלָה וְאֶפְלָה

“in the twilight breeze, in the evening of day, in the pupil of the night and darkness”

The phrases **twilight breeze** and **evening of day** refer to the time when **evening** begins, but **the pupil of the night and darkness** refers to the time later in the **night**. Together these phrases indicate that it was getting progressively darker as the young man went to the adulterous woman's house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the twilight breeze, in the evening of day, and even in the pupil of the night and darkness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:9 (#3)

בְּאִישׁוֹן לַלַּיְלָה

“in the pupil of the night”

Here, the middle of **the night** is referred to as a **pupil** because the **pupil** is both the middle and the darkest part of the eye. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the middle of the night]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:10 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold, {there is}”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [And behold, there was]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:10 (#4)

וּנְצִצְרֵת לֵב

“and guarded of heart”

The phrase **guarded of heart** is an idiom that refers to hiding one's intentions or plans from other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an idiom from your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and being wily of heart] or [and she planned to deceive someone]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 7:10 (#2)

וְהִנֵּנָה

“And behold, {there is}”

Here, **behold** is a term meant to focus the attention of the reader on what is about to happen next in the story. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use some emphatic term or expression in your language that would have this same effect. Alternate translation: [And pay attention to this: there was]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:10 (#3)

לִקְרֹאתָתּוֹ

“to meet him”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [who came out to meet him]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:11 (#1)

הַמְּיָהָה & לֹא־יִשְׁכַּנְנוּ

“{is} a loud & do not stay”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [was a loud ... did not stay]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:11 (#2)

בְּבִיתָהָ לֹא־יִשְׁכַּנְנוּ רַגְלֶיהָ

“her feet do not stay in her house”

Solomon is using one part of a person, the **feet**, to represent the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she did not stay in her house]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 7:11–12 (#1)

הַמְּיָהָה הִיא וְסָרְגָרֶת בְּבִיתָהָ לֹא־יִשְׁכַּנְנוּ רַגְלֶיהָ: פְּפֹעַם | בַּחוּץ
פְּפֹעַם בְּרַחֲבֹת וְאַאֲצֵל כָּל־פִּנְנָה תֵּאָרֵב

“She {is} a loud and rebellious one; her feet do not stay in her house. At {one} time in the street, at {another} time in the open areas, and beside every corner she lies in wait”

In these two verses, Solomon provides background information about the adulterous woman. In your translation, present this information in a way that makes it clear that this is background information.

See: Background Information

Proverbs 7:12 (#5)

תֵּאָרֵב

“she lies in wait”

Here Solomon speaks of the adulterous woman looking for a man to persuade to have sex with her as if she were preparing to attack someone by surprise. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she waited to find a man whom she could persuade to have sex with her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:12 (#2)

בַּחוּץ

“in the street”

The word **street** represents streets in general, not one particular street. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in the streets]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 7:12 (#3)

פִּנְנָה

“corner”

See how you translated **corner** in 7:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:12 (#4)

תֹּארוֹב

“she lies in wait”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [she lay in wait]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:12 (#1)

פָּעַם אֶחָד בְּחֹרֵץ פָּעַם בְּרַחֲבֹת וְאֵצֶל כָּל־פִּנְיָה תֹארוֹב

“At {one} time in the street, at {another} time in the open areas, and beside every corner she lies in wait”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She lies in wait at one time in the street, at another time in the open areas, and beside every corner]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 7:13 (#1)

וְהִחְזִיקָהּ

“And she grabs”

And here indicates that what follows is the continuation of the narrative from 7:10, which Solomon had interrupted with background information in 7:11–12. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show reference to earlier events by translating this relationship by using a fuller phrase. Alternate translation: [After she meets him, she grabs]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Proverbs 7:13 (#2)

וְהִחְזִיקָהּ & וְנָשְׂקָהּ & הֶעֱזָהּ & וְהִתְאַמְּרָהּ

“And she grabs & and kisses & she strengthens & and says”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [And she grabbed ... and kissed ... she strengthened ... and said]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:13 (#3)

הֶעֱזָהּ פָּנֶיהָ

“she strengthens her face”

Here, **strengthens her face** means that the woman had a facial expression that showed how shameless or impudent she was. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar expression from your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she has a brazen face] or [she puts a shameless expression on her face]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 7:14 (#2)

הַיּוֹם שָׁלַמְתִּי נִדְרִי

“today I paid my vows”

Here, **vows** refers to the **sacrifices of peace offerings** that the woman promised to sacrifice to God. According to Leviticus 7:16, the woman would have to eat the meat leftover from paying her **vows** by the end of the next day. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [today I made the sacrifices I promised to give to God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:14 (#1)

זִבְחֵי שְׁלָמִים עִלָּי

“The sacrifices of peace offerings {are} with me”

The woman implies that she has meat to eat at her home because someone who made **peace offerings** was allowed to keep some of the meat that was offered to Yahweh in the temple (see Leviticus 7:11–17 and 1 Samuel 9:11–13). If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I have leftover meat from the sacrifices of peace offerings I made to Yahweh in the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:15 (#2)

פָּנֶיךָ

“your face”

Here, **face** refers to being in the presence of the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your presence] or [where you were]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 7:15 (#1)

לִשְׁחַתֵּר

“to diligently seek”

The woman is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I came out to diligently seek]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:16 (#2)

מִמְרֻבָּדִים & הַחֲטָבֹת אֲטָטֹן מִצָּרִים

“with} coverings, colored linen of Egypt”

Here, the woman describes the **coverings** as being **colored linen of Egypt**, which is expensive and luxurious fabric. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [with coverings, which are luxurious colored linen of Egypt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:16 (#1)

עֲרֹשֶׁטִּי

“my couch”

Here, **couch** refers to a platform that wealthy people would sit or lie on in order to rest or sleep. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of furniture, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [my place for resting]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 7:17 (#2)

מִמֶּר אֶאֱהַלְלִים וְקַנְמִין

“with} myrrh, aloes, and cinnamon”

This mixture of **myrrh**, **aloes**, and **cinnamon** consisted of pleasant-smelling substances that were mixed together and used like perfume. If your readers would not be familiar with these substances, you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [with pleasant-smelling substances]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 7:17 (#1)

נִנְסַפְתִּי מִשִּׁכְּבִי

“I have sprinkled my bed”

Alternate translation: [I have scattered on my bed]

Proverbs 7:18 (#1)

נִרְנְנָה לִדְדִים

“let us drink fully of lovemaking”

Here, the woman speaks about satisfying one’s sexual desires as if one were satisfying a thirst. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a more general expression. Alternate translation: [let us satisfy our sexual desires] or [let us satisfy ourselves with sex as a thirsty man drinks wine]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:18 (#2)

לִדְדִים & בְּאֵהָבִים

“of lovemaking & with loves”

The words translated as **lovemaking** and **loves** are plural to indicate an activity rather than a concept. In this verse, both words refer to passionate sexual activity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [of passionate lovemaking ... with lustful activity]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:19 (#2)

הָאִישׁ

“the man”

Here, **the man** refers to the woman’s husband. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the man whom I married]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:19 (#4)

בְּדֶרֶךְ מְרָחֹק

“on a road far away”

Here, **road** refers to a journey that would include traveling on a **road**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on a journey to a faraway place]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:19 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is the reason why the woman thinks that it is safe for the young man to come with her, as she told him in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [We can do this because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 7:19 (#3)

בְּבֵיתוֹ

“in his house”

Here, the woman speaks of the **house** that she lives in with her husband as if it were **his house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in our house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:20 (#4)

בֵּיתוֹ

“his house”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:20 (#3)

הָרֶגֶל כָּלֵקָא

“full moon”

The phrase **full moon** refers to the **moon** when it looks like a perfectly round disk in the sky, shining at its brightest. This occurs at the middle of each month. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the moon shining its brightest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:20 (#2)

צִרְוֵר־הַהַכֶּסֶף

“the bag of silver”

Here, the woman is using the possessive form to describe a **bag** that is full of **silver**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the bag full of silver]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:20 (#1)

צִרְוֵר־הַהַכֶּסֶף לְקַחַת בְּיָדוֹ

“He took the bag of silver in his hand”

This clause implies that the woman’s husband will be gone for a long time because he took a lot of money with him when he left. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [He will be gone for a long time because he took the bag of silver in his hand]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:21 (#4)

בְּרֵב לְקַחָהּ

“with the abundance of her instruction”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to refer to an abundant amount of **instruction**. This word is used elsewhere in Proverbs for good instruction, but here it is bad instruction. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [with her abundant amount of instruction]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:21 (#6)

תְּדִיחָנּוּ

“she compels him”

Here Solomon implies that the adulterous woman compelled the young man to commit adultery with her. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she compelled him to go with her] or [she compelled him to have sex with her]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:21 (#2)

וְהִטְתָּו & לְקַחָהּ & שִׁשְׁפֹּתֶתֶיהָ תְּדִיחָנּוּ

“She leads him astray & her instruction & her lips she compels him”

She and **her** in this verse refer to the adulterous woman who spoke in 7:14–20 and **him** refers to the young man whom she is seducing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The adulterous woman led the young man astray ... that woman’s teaching ... that woman’s lips she compels that man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 7:21 (#3)

הִטְטוּ

“She leads him astray”

Here Solomon speaks of the woman persuading the young man to do something as if she were causing him to change the direction in which he was walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She persuaded him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:21 (#1)

הִטְטוּ & תְּדִיחֶנּוּ

“She leads him astray & she compels him”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [She led him astray ... she compelled him]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:21 (#5)

בְּחִתְלָק שִׁשְׁפֹּתֶיהָ

“with the smoothness of her lips”

Here Solomon refers to the seductive speech of the adulterous woman as if it were **the smoothness of her lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with her seductive speech]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:22 (#5)

וְאִכְעָעָם אֶל־מוֹסֶר אֲוִיל

“and like an ankle chain to the correction of a fool”

Here Solomon compares the man not being able to escape his death as if he were a **fool** who was being led by a **chain** around his **ankle** to his **correction**, which would be some form of severe punishment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the language plainly. Alternate translation: [and like a fool wearing an ankle chain, he goes along to where he will be punished]

See: Simile

Proverbs 7:22 (#3)

יִבְרֹא

“he goes”

Here Solomon uses the present tense in past narration in order to call attention to a development in the story. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense. Alternate translation: [he went]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 7:22 (#6)

מוֹסֶר

“the correction of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **correction** in 3:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 7:22 (#1)

כְּגִשּׁוֹר אֶל־טֹטְבָה

“like an ox to slaughter”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like an ox that is going to slaughter]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 7:22 (#2)

כְּגִשּׁוֹר אֶל־טֹטְבָה יִבְרֹא

“like an ox to slaughter he goes”

Solomon compares the young man who does not know that he was going to die to **an ox** that was unknowingly going to be slaughtered. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [like a dumb ox, he unknowingly goes to be killed]

See: Simile

Proverbs 7:22 (#4)

וְאִכְעָעָם אֶל־מוֹסֶר אֲוִיל

“and like an ankle chain to the correction of a fool”

The ULT is a translation of the Hebrew text for this clause. However, some ancient translations of this clause read “and like a deer to a trap.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible

does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Proverbs 7:23 (#4)

בְּנֶפֶשׁוֹ הוּא

“it {was} for his life”

This phrase is an idiom that means that this person will die as a result of what he did. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an idiom with the same meaning from your language or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it would cost him his life] or [it would kill him]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 7:23 (#2)

כְּמִהָרָה צֶפְפֹּר אֶל־פֶּקֶחַ

“like a bird rushing into a trap”

Solomon compares the young man who is quickly doing something that will kill him to **a bird rushing into a trap**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he quickly goes to be killed like a bird rushing into a trap]

See: Simile

Proverbs 7:23 (#3)

הוּא

“it”

The pronoun **it** here refers to committing adultery. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [committing adultery] or [having sex with a married woman]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 7:23 (#1)

יִפְלֹחַ חֲלִיץ כְּבִדְדֹו

“an arrow splits his liver”

Here, **liver** refers to an organ in one’s body that one needs in order to remain alive. Solomon means that the **arrow** will kill whomever it strikes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [an arrow pierces his vital organs] or [an arrow kills him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 7:24 (#2)

שְׁמַעוּ־לִי וְהִקְשִׁיבוּ לְאִמְרֵי־פִי

“listen to me, and be attentive to the sayings of my mouth”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [listen to me, yes, be attentive to the sayings of my mouth]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 7:24 (#3)

לְאִמְרֵי־פִי

“to the sayings of my mouth”

See how you translated this phrase in 4:5.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 7:24 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

And now here indicates a transition from the story of the adulterous woman and young man in 7:6–23 to the call to pay attention that follows. See how you translated the same clause in 5:7.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 7:25 (#3)

אַל־יִשָּׁט & לִבְבָּךְ

“Do not let your heart turn aside”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [Do not allow yourself to give in]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:25 (#1)

אַל־יִשָּׁט אֶל־דֶּרֶכֶּיהָ לִבְבָּךְ אֶל־תִּתְּמַע בְּנִתְיֹבוֹתֶיהָ

“Do not let your heart turn aside to her ways; do not wander into her tracks”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second

clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Do not let your heart turn aside to her ways; yes, do not wander into her tracks]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 7:25 (#2)

אַל-יִשָּׁט אֶל-דַּרְכֶּיהָ לִבְּךָ אֶל-תַּתְּמַע בְּתִיבוֹתֶיהָ

“Do not let your heart turn aside to her ways; do not wander into her tracks”

Here Solomon speaks of joining oneself to an adulterous woman as if one were turning **aside** to go on **her ways** or wandering **into her tracks**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **ways** in 3:6 and **tracks** in 2:15. Alternate translation: [Do not let your heart want to join yourself to an adulterous woman; do not go along with her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:26 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do those things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 7:26 (#3)

חֲלָלִים

“pierced ones”

Here, **pierced ones** refers to people who have been killed, since people were often killed by being **pierced** by spears or arrows. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [dead ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:26 (#5)

הַרְגִּיהָ

“her slain ones”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones whom she has slain]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 7:26 (#2)

הַפְּגִילָה & הַרְגִּיהָ

“she has caused & to fall & her slain ones”

In this verse, **she** and **her** refer to any adulterous woman, not one specific adulterous wife. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [an adulterous woman has caused ... to fall ... the ones slain by such a woman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 7:26 (#4)

הַפְּגִילָה

“she has caused & to fall”

Here Solomon uses **fall** to refer to dying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she has caused ... to die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:27 (#4)

דַּרְכֵי שְׁאֵוֹל

“is} the ways of Sheol”

Here Solomon is speaking of the woman's **house** as if it were located on a path leading to **Sheol**. He means that going there with this woman will result in death for the man, either physical or spiritual or both. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6. Alternate translation: [is a place where you lose your life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:27 (#6)

יִרְדְּדוּת אֶל-חֲדָרֵי-מָוֶת

“descending to the rooms of death”

Here Solomon is speaking of **death** as if it were a house with **rooms**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [going there will cause you to die]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:27 (#5)

יִרְדְּדוּת אֶל-חֲדָרֵי-מָוֶת

“descending to the rooms of death”

Here Solomon speaks of a man doing something that would result in his death as if he were going on a path that is **descending to the rooms of death**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [resulting in a man dying] or [causing a man to die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 7:27 (#1)

בֵּיתָהּ

“Her house”

See how you translated the same use of **Her house** in 2:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 7:27 (#3)

דֶּרֶכְכִּי שְׁאֵלוֹל

“is} the ways of Sheol”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **ways** that result in someone going to **Sheol**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is the way that leads to Sheol] or [is the way that causes one to go to Sheol]

See: Possession

Proverbs 7:27 (#2)

דֶּרֶכְכִּי שְׁאֵלוֹל

“is} the ways of Sheol”

Although **ways** here is plural, it refers to the singular **house** at the beginning of this verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the singular form here. Alternate translation: [is the way of Sheol]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Wisdom calls out again * Foolish people can choose to be wise (8:1–11) * Characteristics of wisdom (8:12–21) * God used wisdom in creation (8:22–31) * Rewards of wisdom (8:32–36)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Wisdom calls out

In this chapter and the next chapter, wisdom is referred to as if it were a woman who calls out for all to learn from her. Wisdom is also pictured as a person who was with God when he created the universe. These are poetic ways of saying that God offers wisdom to all people and that he created the universe through his wisdom. In languages where it is possible for something like wisdom to be spoken of as if it were a person who speaks, the translator should translate in this way. However, if direct translation is not possible in your language, you may translate the personification as similes instead. In that case, wisdom would be presented as being like a wise woman. When wisdom speaks in 8:4–36, the notes will use the proper noun “Wisdom” to indicate that the personification of wisdom is speaking. See how you translated similar references to wisdom in 1:20–33. (See: Personification)

Proverbs 8:1 (#5)

תִּקְרָא & תִּתֵּן קוֹלָהּ

“call out & give her voice”

In this verse and throughout the chapter, **Wisdom** and **Understanding** are spoken of as if they were a person. See the discussion of such personification in the Introduction for this chapter. Alternate translation: [call out as if it were a woman ... give her voice as if it were a woman]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:1 (#2)

הֲלֹא-הִכְמִימָה תִּקְרָא וְיִתְבַּיֵּן תִּתֵּן קוֹלָהּ

“Does not Wisdom call out, and Understanding give her voice”

Solomon is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Does not Wisdom call out, and does not Understanding give her voice]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:1 (#6)

תִּתֵּן קוֹלָהּ

“give her voice”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:20.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:1 (#4)

חִכְמָה & וְהוֹנָה

“Wisdom & and Understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Wisdom** and **Understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:1 (#1)

הֲלֹא-חִכְמָה תִקְרָא וְהוֹנָה תִתֵּן קוֹלָהּ

“Does not Wisdom call out, and Understanding give her voice”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize that **Wisdom** is available to everyone. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Surely Wisdom calls out, and Understanding gives her voice!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 8:1 (#3)

הֲלֹא-חִכְמָה תִקְרָא וְהוֹנָה תִתֵּן קוֹלָהּ

“Does not Wisdom call out, and Understanding give her voice”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Both **Wisdom** and **Understanding** represent the same imaginary woman. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Does not Wisdom call out, in other words, does not Understanding give her voice] or [Surely Wisdom calls out, yes, surely Understanding gives her voice!]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 8:2 (#4)

בֵּית נְתִיבוֹת

“the house of the paths”

This phrase refers to the place where roads intersect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [where roads intersect] or [the crossroads]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:2 (#5)

נִצָּבָה

“she stations herself”

Here, **she** refers to wisdom as if it were a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [wisdom stations herself] or [wisdom stations itself as if it were a woman]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:2 (#1)

בְּרֹאשׁ-מְרוֹמִים עַל-דֶּגֶר בֵּית נְתִיבוֹת נִצָּבָה

“At the head of the heights beside the road, the house of the paths, she stations herself”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She stations herself at the head of the heights beside the road, the house of the paths]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:2 (#2)

בְּרֹאשׁ-מְרוֹמִים עַל-דֶּגֶר בֵּית נְתִיבוֹת

“At the head of the heights beside the road, the house of the paths”

The phrases **the road** and **the house of the paths** both refer to the same place, which is a place where there would be many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [At the public place at the head of the heights beside the road, the house of the paths]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:2 (#3)

בְּרֹאשׁ-מְרוֹמִים

“At the head of the heights”

The phrase **the head of the heights** refers to the top of a hill or elevated place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [At the top of hill] or [At the highest place]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:3 (#6)

מִבְּוֹא פִתְחוֹתַיִם

“the entrance of the openings”

This phrase refers to the main **entrance** into the city, which had **gates**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the main entrance]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:3 (#7)

תִּרְנָה

“she cries out”

Here, **she** refers to wisdom as if it were a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [wisdom cries out] or [wisdom cries out as if it were a woman]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:3 (#4)

לְפִי־קַקְרֹת

“at the mouth of the city”

Here, **mouth** refers to the entrance to **the city**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:3 (#2)

לִיד־שְׁעָרִים לְפִי־קַקְרֹת מִבְּוֹא פִתְחוֹתִים

“At the hand of the gates, at the mouth of the city, the entrance of the openings”

The phrases **the hand of the gates**, **the mouth of the city**, and **the entrance of the openings** all refer to the same place, which is inside the main gate of the city where there would be many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [At the public place at the hand of the gates, at the mouth of the city, the entrance of the openings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:3 (#3)

לִיד

“At the hand of”

Here, **hand** refers to the place beside **the gates**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [At the side of]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:3 (#5)

קַקְרֹת

“the city”

The word **city** represents cities in general, not one particular **city**. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any city]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 8:3 (#1)

לִיד־שְׁעָרִים לְפִי־קַקְרֹת מִבְּוֹא פִתְחוֹתִים תִּרְנָה

“At the hand of the gates, at the mouth of the city, the entrance of the openings, she cries out”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She cries out at the hand of the gates, at the mouth of the city, the entrance of the openings]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:4 (#1)

אִישִׁים

“men”

Although **men** is masculine, here it refers to people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:4 (#3)

בְּנֵי אָדָם

“the sons of man”

Although **sons** and **man** are masculine, this phrase refers to all human beings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [humankind]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:4 (#2)

וְקוֹלִי

“and my voice”

Here, **voice** refers to what wisdom is saying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what I am saying]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:5 (#2)

לב

“heart”

Here, **heart** refers to the ability to judge things accurately. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [discernment] or [how to judge things well]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:5 (#1)

עֲרֻמָּה

“prudence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **prudence** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:6 (#1)

וּמִפֶּתַח שִׁשְׁפֹּתַי

“and the opening of my lips”

Here, **the opening of my lips** refers to what is said when Wisdom opens her **lips** to speak. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what I will say]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:7 (#3)

אֱמֶת וְתוֹעֵבָה & רָשָׁע

“truth, and wickedness {is} an abomination to”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **truth**, **wickedness**, and **abomination**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **wickedness** in 4:17 and **abomination** in 3:32. Alternate translation: [true things, and wicked things are abominable to]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:7 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows in 8:7-9 are additional reasons why people should listen to Wisdom, as commanded in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows are reasons. Alternate translation: [Listen because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 8:7 (#2)

חֶכְמִי & שִׁפְתֹּתַי

“my palate & my lips”

Here, **palate** and **lips** refer to the person who is speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I ... me]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 8:8 (#5)

וְעִקָּשׁ

“or crooked”

See how you translated the same use of **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:8 (#3)

בְּצִדִּיק

“are} in righteousness”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [are spoken in righteousness] or [are spoken righteously]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:8 (#2)

פִּי

“my mouth”

Here, **mouth** refers to the person who is speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [mine]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 8:8 (#1)

אִמְרֵי

“the words of”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:8 (#4)

נִפְתָּל וְעָקַשׁ

“twisted or crooked”

Here, Wisdom speaks of something that is false as if it were **twisted or crooked**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [untrue or deceptive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:8 (#6)

בְּבִהֵם

“in them”

Here, **them** refers to **the words of my mouth** stated in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in those words] or [in what I say]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 8:9 (#1)

כֻּלָּם

“All of them”

See how you translated **them** in the previous verse.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 8:9 (#4)

דַּעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:9 (#3)

לִמְצֹאֵי דַעַת

“for finders of knowledge”

Here, Wisdom speaks of acquiring **knowledge** as if it were something that people find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for people who acquire knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:9 (#2)

וְיִשְׁרָיִים

“and upright things”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and all of them are upright things]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:10 (#6)

מִחֶרֶץ וּבָחַר

“rather than choice gold”

Here, **choice gold** refers to **gold** that is the best quality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [rather than the best gold]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:10 (#5)

וְאֵל־כֶּסֶף

“and not silver”

Here, **and not** means the same as **rather than** in the next clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [rather than silver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:10 (#1)

קַח-י מוֹסְרִי וְאֵל־כֶּסֶף וְיָדָעַת מִחֶרֶץ וּבָחַר

“Take my instruction and not silver, and knowledge rather than choice gold”

The author is leaving out a word in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Take my instruction and not silver, and take knowledge rather than choice gold]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:10 (#4)

מוֹסְרִי & יָדָעַת

“my instruction & and knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **instruction** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:10 (#3)

קַח

“Take”

Here, Wisdom speaks of acquiring **instruction** and **knowledge** as if they were objects that a person can **Take**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Acquire]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:10 (#2)

קחור-מוסרתי ואל-כסף ודדעת מהררין נבחר

“Take my instruction and not silver, and knowledge rather than choice gold”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Take my instruction and not silver, yes, take knowledge rather than choice gold]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 8:11 (#1)

טובבה החכמה

“wisdom {is} better”

Here, Wisdom, personified as a woman, speaks about the value of having wisdom, so she is, in a way, speaking about herself. See how you translated the introduction of Lady Wisdom in 8:1, and review how that might affect your translation here. If it causes problems in your language for Lady Wisdom to talk about the idea of wisdom, use a verb or other expression here that is different than the name “Wisdom.” Alternate translation: [being wise is better]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:11 (#2)

כה

“with her”

The pronoun **her** refers to **wisdom**. Since the word **wisdom** is grammatically feminine in Hebrew, the pronoun that refers to it is also feminine. Because of this, Lady Wisdom can refer to both the idea of wisdom and herself at the same time. If your language must choose to refer to either the woman Wisdom or the idea of wisdom, we recommend that you choose

the idea of wisdom as what is more important here. Alternate translation: [with it] or [with that]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 8:11 (#3)

מפניגים

“than coral pearls”

See how you translated **coral pearls** in 3:15.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 8:12 (#1)

שכבתי ערממה

“I dwell with Prudence”

Here, **Wisdom** speaks of being associated with **Prudence** as if **Prudence** were a person with whom **Wisdom** dwells. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [am associated with what is prudent] or [I am similar to prudence. We are like two people who live in the same house]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:12 (#2)

החכמה & ערממה ודדעת מזממות

“Wisdom & Prudence, and knowledge of discretion”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Wisdom** in 1:2, and **prudence**, **knowledge**, and **discretion** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:12 (#4)

ודדעת מזממות אמצא

“and knowledge of discretion I find”

Here, **Wisdom** speaks of enabling people to have **knowledge of discretion** as if they were objects that one could **find**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I enable people to acquire knowledge of discretion] or [What is wise enables you to acquire knowledge of discretion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:12 (#3)

ודדעת מזממות

“and knowledge of discretion”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe a **knowledge** that is about **discretion**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and knowledge about discretion]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:13 (#1)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated the **fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:13 (#3)

וַדְּרֹךְ רָרַע

“and the evil way”

See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:13 (#2)

רָרַע גִּלְגָּלִית וְגִלְגָּלִית

“evil. Pride and arrogance”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **evil**, **Pride**, and **arrogance**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **evil** in 1:16. Alternate translation: [evil things. Being proud and arrogant]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:13 (#4)

וּפְּמִי תְהַפְּכוֹת

“and the mouth of perverse things”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe a **mouth** that speaks **perverse things**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and the mouth that speaks perverse things]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:13 (#5)

וּפְּמִי

“and the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** represents the **perverse things** that are said through it. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the action of speaking]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:14 (#3)

אֲנִי בְּיָנִי

“I {am} understanding”

Here Wisdom identifies herself with **understanding**. As in 8:1, we are meant to understand that both wisdom and understanding are two words for the same thing, and thus they are pictured as the same woman who is known by both names. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this clear. Alternate translation: [I am also known as Understanding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:14 (#2)

לִי-עֵצָה וְתוֹשִׁיָּה & לְלִי גְבוּרָה

“Counsel and sound wisdom {are} mine & strength {is} mine”

Here, Wisdom speaks of enabling people to have **Counsel**, **sound wisdom**, and **strength** as if they were objects that belong to Wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I enable you to acquire counsel and sound wisdom ... I enable you to acquire strength] or [What is wise enables you to acquire counsel and sound wisdom ... what is wise enables you to acquire strength]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:14 (#1)

עֵצָה וְתוֹשִׁיָּה & בְּיָנִי & גְבוּרָה

“Counsel and sound wisdom & am} understanding; strength”

See how you translated **Counsel** in 1:25, **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2, and **strength** in 5:10.

Proverbs 8:15 (#2)

צֶדֶק

“righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:15 (#1)

וְרוֹנָנִים יַחְתִּיקוּ צֶדֶק

“and dignitaries decree righteousness”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and by me dignitaries decree righteousness] or [and by what is wise dignitaries decree righteousness]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:16 (#3)

שֹׁפְטֵי צֶדֶק

“judges of righteousness”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe **judges** who are characterized by **righteousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [righteous judges]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:16 (#1)

וְנָדִיבִים

“and nobles”

Wisdom, the speaker, is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and by me nobles rule] or [and by what is wise, nobles rule]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:16 (#2)

כָּל־שֹׁפְטֵי צֶדֶק

“all judges of righteousness”

This phrase applies to **princes** and **nobles** and anyone else who rules by wisdom. It distinguishes all of these **judges of righteousness** from those who do not rule by wisdom and are not righteous. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the relationship between these phrases more clear. Alternate translation: [that is, all of them who are judges of righteousness]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Proverbs 8:17 (#1)

אֲנִי & אֲהֶב

“I myself love”

Here the word **myself** emphasizes that Wisdom has only love for those who love her. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [As for me, I love]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 8:17 (#2)

אֲנִי אֲהִיבָה אֲהֶב

“I myself love those who love me”

Here, wisdom is depicted as if it were a person who can **love** and be loved by people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Wisdom benefits those who value it] or [It is as if wisdom were a woman who loves those who love her]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:17 (#3)

וְאִמְשֹׁרְרִי יִמְצְאוּנִי

“and those who diligently seek me will find me”

Here, wisdom is spoken of as if it were a person whom people can **seek** and **find**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and those who diligently try to become wise will become wise]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:18 (#3)

וְכַבֹּד & וְצִדְקָה

“and honor & and righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **honor** in 3:16 and **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:18 (#2)

הַחַיִּים עֲשֵׂתֶם וְצִדְקָה

“lasting wealth and righteousness”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [surpassing wealth and

righteousness are with me] or [surpassing wealth and righteousness are with what is wise]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:18 (#1)

עֲשֶׂה-וְיָכֵחַ אִתִּי

“Riches and honor {are} with me”

Here, Wisdom speaks of enabling people to have **Riches, honor, surpassing wealth, and righteousness** as if they were objects that were **with** Wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I enable you to have riches, honor, surpassing wealth, and righteousness] or [What is wise enables you to have riches, honor, surpassing wealth, and righteousness]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:19 (#1)

טוֹב פִּרְיִי & וְחֵבְוֹנֵי

“My fruit {is} better & and my produce”

Here, **fruit** and **produce** refer to the benefits that a person receives from having wisdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [My benefits are better ... they are better] or [The benefits I can give you are better ... yes, they are more]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:19 (#2)

מְהֵרָה וּמִפְּנֵי

“than gold and than refined gold”

The terms **gold** and **refined gold** mean similar things. Wisdom is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [than the finest gold]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 8:19 (#3)

מִכֶּסֶף נִבְחָר

“than choice silver”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is better than choice silver]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:19 (#4)

מִכֶּסֶף נִבְחָר

“than choice silver”

Here, **choice silver** refers to **silver** that is the best quality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [than the best silver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:20 (#1)

בְּאַרְח־צְדִיקָה אֶהְלֵךְ

“I walk in the path of righteousness”

Here Wisdom speaks of behaving righteously as if she were walking on a **path**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I behave righteously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:20 (#2)

בְּאַרְח־צְדִיקָה

“in the path of righteousness”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe **the path** that is characterized by **righteousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the righteous path]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:20 (#3)

בְּכֶתֶדֶתֶדֶד נְתִיבֹת מִשְׁפָּט

“in the midst of the pathways of justice”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I walk in the midst of the pathways of justice]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:20 (#4)

נְתִיבֹת מִשְׁפָּט

“the pathways of justice”

Here, Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe **the pathways** that are characterized by **justice**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the just pathways]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:21 (#2)

וְאֶצְרֵתֵיהֶם

“and their treasuries”

The word **treasuries** refers to buildings or rooms where people store valuable things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and their buildings where they store precious things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:21 (#1)

לְהִנְחִיל אֶהֱבִי

“to cause those who love me to inherit”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for what Wisdom does in the previous verse. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a purpose. You may want to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [I do that for the purpose of causing those who love me to inherit]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 8:22 (#3)

קָדַמְנִי

“possessed me”

Some scholars believe that the word translated as **possessed** could also mean “created.” Either way, the point is that **Yahweh** had wisdom before he created the universe. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 8:22 (#2)

יְהוָה קָדַמְנִי רִאשִׁית דְּרַכּוֹ קָדָם מִפְּעֻלָּיו מֵאֵז

“Yahweh possessed me {at} the beginning of his way, before his works from then”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could

connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Yahweh possessed me at the beginning of his way, yes, Yahweh possessed me before his works from then]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 8:22 (#4)

דְּרַכּוֹ & מִפְּעֻלָּיו

“his way & his works”

The phrases **his way** and **his works** both refer to Yahweh creating the universe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [his creating ... his creative works]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:22 (#1)

יְהוָה קָדַמְנִי רִאשִׁית דְּרַכּוֹ קָדָם מִפְּעֻלָּיו מֵאֵז

“Yahweh possessed me {at} the beginning of his way, before his works from then”

Wisdom is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh possessed me at the beginning of his way; Yahweh possessed me before his works from then]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 8:22 (#5)

מֵאֵז

“from then”

Here, **then** refers to **the beginning** mentioned in the previous clause, which refers to when **Yahweh** started creating the universe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from the beginning]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:23 (#4)

וְסֻכִּיתִי

“I was poured out”

Here, Wisdom speaks of being established as if she were a liquid that was **poured out**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I was established]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:23 (#3)

נִסְפָּקְתִּי

“I was poured out”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh did the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh poured me out]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 8:23 (#5)

מֵרֹאשׁ

“from the head”

Here, **head** refers to the first in a series of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the first]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:23 (#2)

מִמְעוֹלָם

“From eternity”

Here, **eternity** refers to the distant past. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [In the distant past]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:23 (#6)

מִקְדָּמֵי-אָרֶץ

“from the ancient times of the earth”

The phrase **the ancient times of the earth** refers to the time when the earth was made. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from when God created the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:23 (#1)

מִמְעוֹלָם נִסְפָּקְתִּי מֵרֹאשׁ מִקְדָּמֵי-אָרֶץ

“From eternity I was poured out, from the head, from the ancient times of the earth”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate transla-

tion: [I was poured out from eternity, from the head, from the ancient times of the earth]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:24 (#2)

הוּלָלְתִּי

“I was brought forth”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh did the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh brought me forth]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 8:24 (#4)

מִמְצֻנּוֹת נִכְבְּדֵי-מַיִם

“springs heavy with water”

Here, Wisdom speaks of **springs** being full of **water** that flows out as if they were **heavy with water**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [springs full of flowing water]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:24 (#1)

בְּאֵין-תְּהִמּוֹת הוּלָלְתִּי בְּאֵין מִמְצֻנּוֹת נִכְבְּדֵי-מַיִם

“When there were no watery depths, I was brought forth, when there were no springs heavy with water”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [I was brought forth when there were no watery depths and when there were no springs heavy with water]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:24 (#3)

הוּלָלְתִּי

“I was brought forth”

Here, Wisdom continues to speak as a person who was **brought forth**, which is a dramatic way to say “born.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I came into existence]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:25 (#4)

לִפְנֵי גִבְעוֹת

“to the face of the hills”

Here, **to the face of** is a common expression that means “before.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before the existence of the hills]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:25 (#5)

חוֹלְלָתִי

“I was brought forth”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:25 (#1)

בְּטֹטֶרֶם הָרִים הִטְבַּעַו לִפְנֵי גִבְעוֹת חוֹלְלָתִי

“Before the mountains were sunk, to the face of the hills, I was brought forth”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [I was brought forth before the mountains were sunk and before the face of the hills]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:25 (#3)

הָרִים הִטְבַּעַו

“the mountains were sunk”

Here Wisdom speaks of the creation of **the mountains** as if their foundations **were sunk** in the earth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the mountains were established]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:25 (#2)

הָרִים הִטְבַּעַו

“the mountains were sunk”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh sunk the mountains]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 8:26 (#2)

וְחוּצוֹת

“or the outside places”

Here, **outside places** refers to the fields in the countryside. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [or the open spaces of the countryside]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:26 (#3)

וְרֹאשׁ

“or the head of”

Here, **the head** refers to the first part of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [or the first of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:26 (#1)

עַד-לֹא עָשָׂה אֲדָמָן וְחוּצוֹת וְרֹאשׁ עֲפָרֹת תֵּבֵל

“before he made the earth or the outside places or the head of the loose soil of the world”

This verse continues the sentence that began in the previous verse. If you divide the previous verse and this verse into separate sentences, then you will need to repeat the main clause from the previous verse. Alternate translation: [I was brought forth before he made the earth or the outside places or the head of the loose soil of the world]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:27 (#1)

בְּהִכְיֵנוּ שָׁמַיִם שָׁשָׁם אֲנִי

“When he established the heavens, I {was} there”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. This verse is the beginning of a sentence that continues through 8:29. If you make each verse a separate sentence, then you will need to repeat the main clause of this verse in each of those verses. Alternate translation: [I was there when he established the heavens]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 8:27 (#2)

בַּחֲזִיקוֹ הָחִיג עַל-פְּנֵי הַהוֹם

“when he inscribed a circle over the face of the watery deep”

This clause refers to Yahweh forming the horizon between the sky and ocean as if he were drawing a **circle** on the ocean’s surface. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he made the horizon between the heavens and the surface of the ocean]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:28 (#2)

בְּבָצְרוֹ עֵינֹת הַהוֹם

“when the springs of the watery deep became strong”

Here Wisdom speaks of the **springs** flowing with much water as if they were people who **became strong**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when the springs of the watery deep flowed strongly]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:28 (#3)

עֵינֹת הַהוֹם

“the springs of the watery deep”

Here Wisdom is using the possessive form to describe **the springs** that supply water to **the watery deep**, which refers to the bottom of the ocean. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the springs that fill the watery deep]

See: Possession

Proverbs 8:28 (#1)

בְּאַמְצָו שָׁחֲקִים

“when he made firm the clouds”

Here, Wisdom speaks of God forming **the clouds** as if he made them **firm**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [when he created the clouds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:29 (#5)

מִמּוֹסְדֵי אֶרֶץ

“the foundations of the earth”

Here **the earth** is spoken of as though it rested on **foundations** such as a building has. These were sometimes thought of as the bottoms of the mountains (see Micah 6:2). If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the lowest parts of the earth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:29 (#1)

בְּשִׁשּׁוּמֹמוֹ & פִּיּוֹ בְּבַחֲזִיקוֹ

“when he set up & his mouth, when he inscribed”

In this verse, **he** and **his** refer to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [when Yahweh set up ... Yahweh’s mouth ... when Yahweh inscribed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 8:29 (#4)

בְּבַחֲזִיקוֹ

“when he inscribed”

This clause refers to Yahweh designating **the foundations of the earth** as if he were drawing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he designated] or [when he decreed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:29 (#3)

פִּיּוֹ

“his mouth”

Here, **mouth** refers to God’s **statute** that was mentioned in the previous clause as if it were a command spoken by God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his command] or [that limit]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:29 (#2)

חֻקּוֹ

“its statute”

Here, **its statute** refers to the limit or boundary of **sea**, where the **sea** ends and the dry land begins. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [its limit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:30 (#3)

משחקת

“frolicking”

Here, **frolicking** refers to dancing or playing in a way that expresses great joy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [acting joyfully]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:30 (#2)

ששששש

“a delight”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **delight**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [delightful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:30 (#4)

לפניו

“before his face”

Here, **face** refers to Yahweh’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in his presence]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:30 (#1)

ואהיה אצלו אאמון

“Then I was beside him {as} a skilled worker”

Here Yahweh’s use of wisdom to create the universe is spoken of as if Wisdom were **a skilled worker** who was **beside him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Then he used wisdom skillfully] or [Then I was like a skilled worker beside him]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:31 (#1)

משחקת

“Frolicking”

See how you translated this word in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:31 (#4)

בני אדם

“the sons of man”

See how you translated this phrase in 8:4

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:31 (#2)

בתבל ארצו

“in the world of his earth”

The phrase **world of his earth** could refer to: (1) the whole **world**. Alternate translation: [his entire world]; (2) the inhabited part of the **world**. Alternate translation: [his inhabited world]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:31 (#3)

ושששש

“and my delights”

See how you translated “delight” in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:32 (#1)

ועתה

“And now”

And now here indicates a transition from what Wisdom has been saying in 8:4–31 to the conclusion of her speech in 8:32–36. See how you translated the same clause in 5:7 and 7:24. Alternate translation: [Therefore] or [In conclusion]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 8:32 (#4)

דרךכי ישמרו

“are} they {who} keep my ways”

Here, someone’s behavior is spoken of as keeping to certain **ways**. See how you translated the similar use of **keep** and “paths” in 2:20. Alternate translation: [are they who behave as I recommend]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:32 (#3)

ואשרי

“and happy”

Here, **and** introduces the reason for obeying the command stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [since happy]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 8:32 (#2)

בְּנֵי־אֱדָמָה

“sons”

See how you translated the same use of **sons** in 4:1.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:33 (#2)

וְאַל־תִּפְרָעוּ

“and do not neglect {it}”

Wisdom is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [be sure to pay attention to it] or [be sure to follow it]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 8:33 (#1)

מוֹסָרָה

“instruction”

See how you translated **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:34 (#4)

לִשְׁקֹקֵד עַל־דַּלְתֵּי יוֹם וָיוֹם לְלִשְׁמֹמֶר מִזִּזְזוֹת פֶּתְחִי

“keeping vigil over my doors day {by} day, keeping watch {over} the doorposts of my entrances”

The author assumes that his readers will understand that **Happy is the man** also applies to this part of the sentence. You could repeat it here if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [happy is the man keeping vigil over my doors day by day, keeping watch over the doorposts of my entrances]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:34 (#5)

לִשְׁקֹקֵד עַל־דַּלְתֵּי יוֹם וָיוֹם לְלִשְׁמֹמֶר מִזִּזְזוֹת פֶּתְחִי

“keeping vigil over my doors day {by} day, keeping watch {over} the doorposts of my entrances”

Here, **doors** and **doorposts of my entrances** implies that Wisdom has a house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [keeping vigil over the doors of my house day by day, keeping watch over the doorposts of the entrances of my house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 8:34 (#2)

לִשְׁקֹקֵד עַל־דַּלְתֵּי יוֹם וָיוֹם לְלִשְׁמֹמֶר מִזִּזְזוֹת פֶּתְחִי

“keeping vigil over my doors day {by} day, keeping watch {over} the doorposts of my entrances”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [keeping vigil over my doors day by day, yes, keeping watch over the doorposts of my entrances]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 8:34 (#1)

אָדָם

“is} the man”

The word **man** represents a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 8:34 (#3)

לִשְׁקֹקֵד עַל־דַּלְתֵּי יוֹם וָיוֹם לְלִשְׁמֹמֶר מִזִּזְזוֹת פֶּתְחִי

“keeping vigil over my doors day {by} day, keeping watch {over} the doorposts of my entrances”

Here Wisdom speaks of someone being eager to listen to her as if that person were vigilantly waiting at the door to her house, waiting for her to come out. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [being extremely eager to hear wise counsel] or [being eager to listen to me as if one were keeping vigil over my doors day by day, keeping watch over the doorposts of my entrances]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 8:35 (#2)

מֵצֵא

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: מֵצֵא”

Here, learning wisdom is spoken of as if wisdom were a person whom someone could find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar phrase in 3:13 and 8:17. Alternate translation: [those who attain wisdom] or [those who become wise]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:35 (#4)

וַיִּפֶּק

“and he obtains”

Although the term **he** is masculine, Wisdom is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and that person obtains]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 8:35 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason why someone who listens to Wisdom will be happy, as stated in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [That man will be happy because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 8:35 (#3)

מֵצֵא חַיִּים

“is} a finder of life”

Having a good **life** is spoken of as if **life** were an object that a person can find by searching for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are those who will have good lives]

See: Personification

Proverbs 8:35 (#5)

רָצוֹן

“favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 8:36 (#1)

וְהָטָא

“But a misser of me”

The phrase translated **a misser of me** refers to someone who misses the goal, which is to find wisdom, as in the previous verse. It does not refer to someone who misses another person in the sense of longing for that person to be present. The phrase could also be translated as “a sinner against me,” since the same word is used both for sinning and for missing the mark or failing to reach a goal. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 8:36 (#4)

אֶהְיֶה מוֹת

“love death”

This phrase is an exaggeration that emphasizes that people who hate wisdom choose to live in a way that will cause them to die. It does not mean that people who hate wisdom actually **love death**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [show by their actions that they choose to die] or [act as if they love death]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 8:36 (#3)

נִפְשׁוֹ

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [himself]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 8:36 (#2)

חַמַּת & מוֹת

“does violence to & death”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **violence** in 3:31 and **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Wisdom and folly (9:1-18) * Wisdom invites naive people to a meal (9:1-6) * Wise men become wiser but mockers will suffer (9:7-12) * Folly invites people to her house (9:13-18)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Wisdom calls out

In this chapter, as in the previous chapter, wisdom is referred to as if it were a woman who prepares a meal and calls out for all to come and learn from her. When wisdom speaks in 9:4-12, the notes will use the proper noun “Wisdom” to indicate that the personification of wisdom is speaking. In languages where it is possible for something like wisdom to be spoken of as if it were a person who speaks, the translator should translate in this way. However, if direct translation is not possible in your language, you may translate the personification as similes instead. In that case, wisdom would be presented as being like a wise woman. See how you translated similar references to wisdom in 1:20-33 and 8:4-36. (See: Personification)

Proverbs 9:1 (#2)

הַצִּבְרָה עֲמוּדֵיהָ שִׁבְעָה

“she has hewn out her seven pillars”

This clause refers to part of the process of building the **house** that was mentioned in the previous clause. A **house** with **seven pillars** would have been very large. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she has hewn out seven pillars to support the roof of her house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:1 (#1)

הַחֲכָמוֹת בְּנִתְתָּהּ בֵּיתָהּ הַצִּבְרָה עֲמוּדֵיהָ שִׁבְעָה

“Wisdom has built her house; she has hewn out her seven pillars”

In 9:1-12, **Wisdom** is spoken of as if it were a woman. See the discussion of this in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [It is as if wisdom were a woman who has built her house and has hewn out her seven pillars]

See: Personification

Proverbs 9:2 (#4)

מִסְכָּכָה יִיגָה

“she has mixed her wine”

In ancient Israel, people often prepared **wine** for special meals by mixing spices into it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she has prepared her wine by mixing spices into it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:2 (#2)

טַבְחָהּ טַטְבָּחָהּ מִסְכָּכָה יִיגָה אֶצֶף עֲרֻכָּהּ שְׁלֻחָהּ

“She has slaughtered her slaughter, she has mixed her wine, also she has arranged her table”

All three of these clauses refer to parts of the process of preparing a special meal for guests. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She has prepared a meal for guests by slaughtering her slaughter, mixing her wine, and arranging her table]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:2 (#1)

טַבְחָהּ טַטְבָּחָהּ מִסְכָּכָה יִיגָה אֶצֶף עֲרֻכָּהּ שְׁלֻחָהּ

“She has slaughtered her slaughter, she has mixed her wine, also she has arranged her table”

In this verse, wisdom is spoken of as if it were a woman. See the discussion of such personification in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [It is as if wisdom were a woman who has slaughtered her slaughter, mixed her wine, and arranged her table]

See: Personification

Proverbs 9:2 (#3)

טַבְחָהּ טַטְבָּחָהּ

“She has slaughtered her slaughter”

Here, **slaughter** refers to the animals that Wisdom has **slaughtered** so that their meat may be eaten at a meal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She has slaughtered the animals so that their meat may be eaten at the meal]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 9:2 (#5)

עֲרֻכָּהּ שְׁלֻחָהּ

“she has arranged her table”

This phrase refers to putting the food and eating utensils on a table in order to prepare for a meal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she has prepared her table for people to eat a meal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:3 (#3)

על־גַּפְפֵּי מִרְמֵי

“on the tops of the heights of”

See how you translated the similar phrase “the head of the heights” in 8:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:3 (#2)

שְׁלַחְתָּהּ נְעוּרֹתֶיהָ

“She has sent out her young women”

Solomon implies that the **young women** were **sent out** in order to invite people to the meal that Wisdom had prepared. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She has sent out her young women to invite people to the meal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:3 (#1)

שְׁלַחְתָּהּ נְעוּרֹתֶיהָ תִּקְרָא

“She has sent out her young women; she calls out”

In this verse, wisdom is spoken of as if it were a wealthy woman who has servants and **calls out** in public. See the discussion of such personification in the Chapter Introduction. Alternate translation: [It is as if wisdom were a woman who has sent out her young women and calls out]

See: Personification

Proverbs 9:4 (#4)

חֹסֶר־לֵלֶב

“lacking of heart”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 7:7.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 9:4 (#2)

יִסְטֵר הַהִנָּה

“let him turn aside here”

Here, Wisdom implies that the **naive** person should **turn aside** and come to her house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [let him leave his path and come to my house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:4 (#3)

יִסְטֵר & לוֹ

“let him turn aside & to him”

Although **him** is masculine, here it refers to any **naive** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [let that person turn aside ... to that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 9:4 (#1)

מִי־פִסְתִּי יִסְטֵר הַהִנָּה חֹסֶר־לֵלֶב אֲמַרְהָ לוֹ

“Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here,” she says to him lacking of heart”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She says to him lacking of heart, “Whoever is naive, let him turn aside here.”]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 9:4-5 (#1)

מִי־פִסְתִּי יִסְטֵר הַהִנָּה חֹסֶר־לֵלֶב אֲמַרְהָ לוֹ: לֵלְכוּ לַחֲמֹמוֹ בְּלֶחֱמִי וּשְׁתוּתוּ בִּיְיִן מִסִּכְתִּי

“Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here,” she says to him lacking of heart. “Come, eat my bread, and drink the wine I have mixed”

In these two verses, Wisdom speaks of people acquiring wisdom as they were turning **aside** from a path to enter Wisdom’s house, **eat** Wisdom’s **bread**, and **drink** Wisdom’s **wine**. Just as **bread** and **wine** are good and keep people alive, so wisdom also is good and something that enables people to live good lives. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the comparison. Alternate translation: [She says to him lacking of heart, “Whoever is naive, benefit your lives by acquiring wisdom. Doing so is like turning aside here, coming to me, eating my bread, and drinking the wine I have mixed]

See: Biblical Imagery — Extended Metaphors

Proverbs 9:5 (#2)

לֵלֶכְךָ לֶחְמֶמְךָ וּשְׁתֵּתְךָ

“Come, eat & and drink”

All three of these commands are plural because Wisdom is addressing all the “naive” people at the same time.

See: Forms of You

Proverbs 9:5 (#1)

כֶּלֶחֱמִי

“my bread”

Here, **bread** is used to refer to food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 9:5 (#3)

בְּיַיִן מְסֻבָּתִי

“the wine I have mixed”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 9:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:6 (#3)

וְחַיִּי

“and live”

Here, **live** refers to living a life that is long and satisfying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and live a good, long life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:6 (#1)

עֲזַבְכֶּם וְחַיִּי וְאַשְׁרֵרִי

“Forsake & and live; and stride”

All three of these commands are plural because Wisdom is addressing all the **naive** people at the same time.

See: Forms of You

Proverbs 9:6 (#5)

בִּינָה

“understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 9:6 (#4)

וְאַשְׁרֵרִי בְּדֶרֶךְ בִּינָה

“and stride on the way of understanding”

Here, Wisdom speaks of a people behaving in a manner that will enable them to acquire **understanding** as if they were striding on a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and behave in a manner that will enable you to acquire understanding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:6 (#2)

וְחַיִּי

“and live”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is the purpose for doing what Wisdom commands people to do earlier in this verse. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of living]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 9:7 (#6)

לְרִשָּׁשׁ

“a wicked {one}”

Wisdom is using the adjective **wicked** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [a wicked person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 9:7 (#4)

קִלְלוֹן

“disgrace”

See how you translated the abstract noun **disgrace** in 6:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 9:7 (#1)

יִסְטֹר | לֵלִיץ לַקָּהָת לֵלִיץ קִלְלוֹן וּמוֹכֵכִיחַ לְרִשָּׁשׁ מוֹמֵן

“The instructor of a mocker receives disgrace for himself, and the rebuker of a wicked {one}, his injury”

Here, the terms **The instructor, a mocker, himself, the rebuker, a wicked one**, and **his** do not refer to specific people, but refer to types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Any instructor of any mocker receives disgrace for that person, and any rebuker of any wicked one, that person's injury]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 9:7 (#3)

לַעֲקוֹתָ לְלוֹ קַלְלוֹן

“receives disgrace for himself”

Here, Wisdom speaks of **disgrace** as if it were an object that a person **receives**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will himself be disgraced]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:7 (#5)

וּמוֹכְרֵיָהּ לְרִשְׁוֹשָׁע מוֹמָיו

“and the rebuker of a wicked {one}, his injury”

Wisdom is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the rebuker of a wicked one receives his injury]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 9:7 (#2)

יִסְעֹר וּלְלִין

“The instructor of a mocker”

Since **a mocker** does not accept instruction, this phrase implies that someone attempted to be an **instructor of a mocker**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The one who attempts to instruct a mocker]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:7 (#7)

מוֹמָיו

“his injury”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **injury**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [becomes injured]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 9:8 (#4)

הוֹכִיכָה לְלֵחָכְכֶם וַיֵּאָהֱבָךְ

“rebuke a wise one, and he will love you”

The word **rebuke** is an imperative, but it communicates a condition under which something will happen, rather than a command. If it is helpful in your language, use a form that communicates a condition. Alternate translation: [if you rebuke a wise one, then he will love you]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 9:8 (#2)

לְלִין פֶּן־יִשְׁנָאֲנֶךָ & לְלֵחָכְכֶם וַיֵּאָהֱבָךְ

“a mocker, lest he hate you & a wise one, and he will love you”

Here, **a mocker, he**, and **a wise one** do not refer to specific people, but refer to types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any mocker, lest that person hate you ... any wise one, and that person will love you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 9:8 (#3)

הוֹכִיכָה לְלֵחָכְכֶם

“rebuke a wise one”

This clause says something that is in contrast to what was said in the previous clause. Use a natural way in your language to express a strong contrast. Alternate translation: [By contrast, rebuke a wise one]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 9:8 (#1)

אַל־תִּתְּנוּכָהּ

“Do not rebuke”

This clause states what Wisdom wants people to do as a result of what Wisdom said in the previous verse. Use the most natural way to express an intended result in your language. Alternate translation: [Therefore, do not rebuke]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 9:8 (#5)

וְיִאֱהָבֶךָ

“and he will love you”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [and it will result in him loving you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 9:9 (#2)

תִּתֵּן & הוֹדִיעַ

“Give & inform”

The words **Give** and **inform** are imperatives, but they communicate a condition under which something will happen, rather than a command. If it is helpful in your language, use a form that communicates a condition, as in the UST.

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 9:9 (#3)

לְלֹחֶקֶם וְיִחַכְם-עוֹד & לְצַדִּיק וְיִזְכָּק

“to a wise {one}, and he will become more wise & a righteous {one}, and he will increase”

Here, **a wise one**, **he**, and **a righteous one** do not refer to specific people but refer to these types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to any wise one, and that person will become more wise ... any righteous one, and that person will increase]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 9:9 (#1)

תִּתֵּן

“Give”

Wisdom is leaving out a word that a clause would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply this word from the context. Alternate translation: [Give instruction] or [Give what is wise]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 9:10 (#2)

הַחִכְמָה & הַדָּעַת & בִּינָה

“wisdom & and knowledge of & is} understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 9:10 (#1)

תְּחִלָּתָא

“The beginning of”

See how you translated the same use of **beginning** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 9:10 (#3)

יִרְאֵאתָ יְהוָה

“is} the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 9:11 (#2)

כִּי-יִבְרַךְ יִרְבּוּ יְמֵי וְיוֹסִיפוּ לָלֶדֶךָ שְׁנֵנוֹת חַיִּים

“Indeed, by me your days will increase, and years of life will be added to you”

These two phrases mean very similar things. Wisdom is repeating the same idea with different words to emphasize the idea that the phrases express. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Indeed, by me you will live a lot longer]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 9:11 (#4)

יִוֹסִיפוּ לָלֶדֶךָ שְׁנֵנוֹת חַיִּים

“and years of life will be added to you”

Here Wisdom speaks of people living for a long time as if the **years** that they are alive were something that could **be added** to their lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will live many more years]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:11 (#5)

שְׁנֵנוֹת חַיִּים

“years of life”

See how you translated this idiom in 3:2.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 9:11 (#3)

יִרְבְּבוּ יָמֶיךָ

“your days will increase”

Here Wisdom speaks of people living for a long time as if the **days** that they are alive were something that could **increase** in number. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will live many more days]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:11 (#6)

וְיוֹסֶפֶת לְלִדְךָ

“and & will be added to you”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and ... I will add to you]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 9:11 (#1)

כִּי

“Indeed”

Indeed here indicates that Wisdom is emphasizing what follows in this verse. Use a connector in your language that makes that emphasis clear. Alternate translation: [Truly]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 9:12 (#1)

לְלִדְךָ

“for yourself”

Here, **for** implies that being **wise** is for the benefit of the **wise** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for the benefit of yourself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:12 (#2)

לְבִדְךָ תִּשָּׂא

“you alone will bear {it}”

Here, Wisdom speaks of someone experiencing the consequences of one's bad behavior as if **it** were a heavy object that one had to carry on one's back. If it

would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you alone will experience the consequences]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:13 (#1)

אִשָּׁתִּי כִכְסִילוֹת הָמְיָה פִּסְתִּיּוֹת וּבִלְיִידָעָה מָה

“The woman of stupidity {is} loud, naive, and she does not know anything”

The **woman of stupidity** is referred to from this verse through verse 18. Translate consistently according to which of the following options that you choose. This phrase could refer to: (1) a **woman** who is characterized by **stupidity**, in which case this phrase would refer to stupid women in general. Alternate translation: [A stupid woman is loud, naive, and she does not know anything] or [Stupid women are loud, naive, and do not know anything]; (2) **stupidity** as if it were a **woman**, which is how wisdom was spoken of in the previous part of this chapter. Alternate translation: [Lady Stupidity is loud, naive, and she does not know anything]

See: Possession

Proverbs 9:13 (#2)

וּבִלְיִידָעָה מָה

“and she does not know anything”

This phrase is an exaggeration that Solomon uses to emphasize how ignorant this **woman** is. It does not mean that **she does not know anything** at all. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she does not know much] or [and she knows very little]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 9:14 (#1)

וְנִשְׁבָּה לַפֶּתַח בֵּיתָהּ עַל-כִּסֵּא מִרְמֵי קִרְתָּ

“And she sits at the opening of her house, on a seat {by} the heights of the city”

If you translated the phrase “woman of stupidity” as a plural form in the previous verse, then you should use plural forms in this verse. Alternate translation: [And they sit at the opening of their houses, on seats by the heights of the city]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 9:14 (#2)

לִפְתָּח בֵּיתָהּ

“at the opening of her house”

See how you translated this phrase in 5:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:14 (#4)

מִרְמֵי קִרְתִּי

“by} the heights of the city”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:3.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:14 (#3)

עַל-כִּסֵּא

“on a seat”

This clause could refer to: (1) the specific location of **the opening of her house**. Alternate translation: [which is on a seat]; (2) a second location where **she sits**. Alternate translation: [or on a seat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:15 (#3)

הַמֵּיִשְׁרִים אֲרֻחָם

“the ones going straight {on} their paths”

This clause is an idiom that describes people who are only thinking of their own affairs. If this clause does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones minding their own business] or [the ones going about their own affairs]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 9:15 (#2)

לְעֹבְרֵי-דָרֶךְ

“to those who pass over the way”

Alternate translation: [to those walking by on the road]

Proverbs 9:15 (#1)

לְקַרֵּא

“to call”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose for the “woman of stupidity” sitting in a public place, as

stated in the previous verse. Use a natural way in your language to express a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of calling]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 9:16 (#1)

מִי-פֶסֶתִי יִסָּר הַנָּהָה וְחִסְרֵי-לֵב וְאִמְרָה לּוֹ

“Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here!” And she says to him, the lacking of heart”

See how you translated the nearly identical clauses in 9:4. If you are translating the “woman of stupidity” as a person, you could use her name here. Alternate translation: [Whoever is naive, let him turn aside here!] And Lady Stupidity says to him, the lacking of heart]

See: Personification

Proverbs 9:16 (#2)

מִי-פֶסֶתִי יִסָּר הַנָּהָה וְחִסְרֵי-לֵב וְאִמְרָה לּוֹ

“Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here!” And she says to him, the lacking of heart”

If it is more natural in your language, you could put the introduction of the speaker first. Alternate translation: [And she says to him, the lacking of heart, “Whoever {is} naive, let him turn aside here!]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 9:17 (#2)

מַיִם-גְּנוּבִים יִמְתְּקוּ וְלֶחֶם סִתְרִים יִנָּעַם

“Stolen waters are sweet, and bread of secrecies is pleasant”

In this verse, the foolish woman refers to the pleasure of having sex with someone to whom one is not married as if it were as **sweet** as **stolen waters** or as **pleasant** as **bread of secrecies**. Water and food are also used as euphemisms for sexual activity in 5:15–19 and 30:20. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile: “Having sex with me is truly enjoyable” or “Having sex with me is as enjoyable as drinking stolen waters or eating bread of secrecies”

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:17 (#3)

וְלֶחֶם סִתְרִים

“and bread of secrecies”

The phrase **bread of secrecies** could refer to: (1) **bread** that a person secretly eats by himself. Alternate translation: [and bread that is eaten in secrecy]; (2) **bread** that one obtains through secret deeds, which implies stealing the **bread**. Alternate translation: [and bread obtained secretly] or [and stolen bread]

See: Possession

Proverbs 9:17 (#1)

מים־גְּנוּבִים יִמְתְּקוּ

“Stolen waters are sweet”

The stupid woman implies that what she says in this verse is the reason why the “naive” should “turn aside” to her. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Turn aside here because stolen waters are sweet]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 9:18 (#3)

קָרָאָהּ

“her called ones”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones whom she called]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 9:18 (#2)

רְפָאִים שָׁמָּה

“the spirits of the dead {are} there”

Here Solomon speaks of those men who died because they went to the stupid woman’s house as if their dead **spirits** were **there**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that the men who have gone to her house are now dead]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 9:18 (#4)

קָרָאָהּ

“her called ones”

This phrase refers to the men who went to the stupid woman’s house to commit adultery with her in response to her calling them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the men whom she called and they

accepted her call] or [the men who went to her house after she called them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 9:18 (#1)

וְלֹא־יָדָעַ

“But he does not know”

Here, **he** refers to any naive man to whom the stupid woman calls. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [But any naive man does not know]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Outline of Proverbs 10

General proverbs from Solomon contrasting the benefits of being righteous and wise with the trouble that comes to those who are wicked and foolish (10:1-32)

Chapter 10 starts a new section of the book, which is mainly filled with short, individual proverbs that were written by Solomon (10:1-22:16).

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism

Except for 10:10, 18, 22, and 26, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Generic use of “righteous” and “wicked”

These proverbs often contrast the behavior of righteous people and wicked people. They usually refer to all righteous people simply as “the righteous” or “a righteous one.” In the same way, these proverbs often refer to all wicked people by saying, “the wicked” or “a wicked one.” Use a natural expression in your language that refers to any people who can be described in this way.

Proverbs 10:1 (#3)

אָבִי

“a father”

Here, **father** refers specifically to the **father** of the **son** mentioned earlier in the sentence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:1 (#1)

משלילי שלל ממה

“The proverbs of Solomon”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:1.

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:1 (#2)

בבן חכם ישמח אב ובבן כסיל תוגת אמו

“A wise son gladdens a father, but a stupid son {is} the grief of his mother”

Although the terms **son** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [Any wise person gladdens that person's father, but any stupid person is the grief of that person's mother]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 10:1 (#4)

תוגת אמו

“{is} the grief of his mother”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grief**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [grieves his mother]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:2 (#3)

ואצדקקה & ממנת

“but righteousness & from death”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** in 1:3 and **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:2 (#2)

לא יועילו

“do not profit”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [do not profit those who possess them]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:2 (#4)

תציל

“delivers”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [delivers a person]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:2 (#1)

אוצרות רשע

“Treasures of wickedness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **Treasures** that someone gained by **wickedness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Treasures gained in wicked ways] or [Treasures obtained by wicked means]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:3 (#2)

יהדף

“he thrusts away”

Here Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** preventing **the wicked ones** from getting what they **desire** as if that **desire** were an object that **Yahweh thrusts away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he denies]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:3 (#1)

נפש צדיק

“the life of the righteous”

Here **life** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the righteous person]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 10:4 (#3)

רואש עששה & תעשיר

“makes poverty & makes rich”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be

complete. You could supply these words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [makes the person poor ... makes the person rich]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:4 (#2)

רָאשׁ

“poverty”

See how you translated the abstract noun **poverty** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:4 (#1)

כַּף־רַמְיָה וְיָד קְרוּצָצִים

“A palm of idleness & but the hand of the diligent ones”

Here, **palm** and **hand** represent the whole person, who works by using a **palm** or **hand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A person unwilling to work ... but a person who works diligently]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 10:5 (#2)

אִגְרָר בְּבֹקֶרֶן & בְּבֹקֶצֶר

“One who gathers in the summer & in the harvest”

In the location where this book was written, **summer** is the time of year when people **harvest** crops. See how you translated the same use of **gathers**, **summer**, and **harvest** in 6:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:5 (#3)

אִגְרָר

“One who gathers”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [One who gathers food]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:5 (#1)

אִגְרָר & נֹדֵם

“One who gathers & but one who sleeps”

One who gathers and **one who sleeps** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who gathers ... but any person who sleeps]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:5 (#4)

מְשַׁכְּלִיל

“who has insight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **insight** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:6 (#2)

וּפְּקִי רִשְׁעָעִים

“but the mouth of the wicked”

Here, **mouth** refers to what **the wicked** say with their mouths. Alternate translation: [but the speech of the wicked ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:6 (#3)

יִכְסֹּם

“covers”

Here, Solomon refers to someone concealing **violence** as if it were an object that someone **covers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [conceals]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:6 (#4)

חֵמָס

“violence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **violence** in 3:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:6 (#1)

לְרֹאשׁ צַדִּיק

“are} for the head of the righteous”

Here, **head** represents the whole person. In Solomon’s culture people would place their hands on top of the **head** of the person whom they were blessing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are given to the righteous person]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 10:7 (#5)

וְשֵׁם

“but the name of”

Here, **name** refers to a person’s reputation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the reputation of] or [but what people think of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:7 (#6)

יִרָקֵב

“will rot”

Here Solomon speaks of people forgetting **the name of the wicked ones** as if that **name** is an object that rots and disappears. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [will be forgotten] or [will be forgotten like something that rots away]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:7 (#2)

צַדִּיק

“the righteous one”

Although **righteous one** here is singular, it refers to all **righteous** people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:7 (#4)

וְשֵׁם

“but the name of”

Although **name** here is singular, it refers to the names of all the **wicked ones** in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but the names of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:7 (#3)

לְבָרְכָהּ

“is} for a blessing”

This phrase indicates that people will be blessed when they remember **the righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will be a blessing to others] or [will bless others]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:7 (#1)

זִכְרֹן צַדִּיק לְבָרְכָהּ

“The memory of the righteous one {is} for a blessing”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **memory** that other people have about **the righteous one**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [The righteous one will be remembered as a blessing]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:8 (#6)

יִלְכָּט

“will be thrown down”

Here Solomon refers to a person’s life becoming ruined or destroyed as if that person were **thrown down** on the ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be destroyed] or [will be made useless]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:8 (#1)

חָכֵם-לֵב

“The one wise of heart”

This phrase refers to a person who thinks wisely. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A wise thinker]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:8 (#4)

וְאִוִּיל שִׁשְׁפָּתַיִם

“but the one stupid of lips”

Here, **the one stupid of lips** refers to someone who speaks foolishly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar expression in your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate

translation: [but a chattering fool] or [but one who speaks stupidly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:8 (#2)

יִקְחָהּ מִצְוֹת

“receives commands”

Here Solomon refers to obeying **commands** as if they were objects that a person **receives**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [obeys commands]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:8 (#3)

מִצְוֹת

“commands”

Solomon implies that **wise** people obey **commands** to do good things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [commands to do good things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:8 (#5)

יִלְכֹּט

“will be thrown down”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will throw themselves down]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 10:9 (#2)

יֵלֶךְ בַּבֶּטָח

“will walk securely”

See how you translated a similar use of **walk** in 3:23.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:9 (#1)

הוֹלֵלֵךְ בְּבִתְּוָם

“One who walks with integrity”

See how you translated the similar phrase “walking with integrity” in 2:7.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:9 (#3)

וּמַעֲקֹשׁ דִּרְכָּיו

“but one who causes his ways to be crooked”

See how you translated the similar use of “paths” and **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:9 (#4)

יֻדָּע

“will be known”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will know] or [God will know]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 10:9 (#5)

יֻדָּע

“will be known”

Here, **known** refers to the **one who causes his ways to be crooked** being discovered or found out. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will be discovered] or [will be found out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:10 (#2)

יִתֵּן עֲצָצָרָה

“gives pain”

Here Solomon speaks of causing people to feel **pain** or grief as if **pain** were an object that someone **gives** to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes pain]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:10 (#3)

וְאִתְּוִיל שִׁשְׁפֹּתָתָיו יִלְכֹּט

“and the one foolish of lips will be thrown down”

See how you translated the nearly identical clause in 10:8.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:10 (#1)

קַהֲרִיז עֵינַי

“One who winks an eye”

See how you translated a similar phrase is 6:13.

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 10:11 (#4)

צַדִּיק

“the righteous one”

The phrase **the righteous one** represents all righteous people in general, not one particular righteous person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:11 (#2)

מִקְקוֹר חַיִּים

“A fountain of life”

Here Solomon is speaking of **the mouth of the righteous one** as if it were a **fountain of life**. He means that what a **righteous** person says is beneficial to the **life** of that person and to others' lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Something that benefits people's lives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:11 (#1)

מִקְקוֹר חַיִּים

“A fountain of life”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **fountain** that gives **life**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A fountain that gives life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:11 (#3)

פִּי

“is} the mouth of”

In this verse, **mouth** refers to what a person says by using his **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the speech of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:11 (#5)

וּפִי רָשָׁעִים יכַסֶּה חֵמָם

“but the mouth of the wicked ones covers violence”

See how you translated the identical clause in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:12 (#2)

וְעַל כָּל-פֶּשַׁעִים תְּכַסֶּה אֲהָבָה

“but love covers over all transgressions”

Here Solomon speaks of **love** as if it were a living thing that could cover over **transgressions**. He means that people who love forgive **transgressions**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but loving others causes one to forgive transgressions]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:12 (#1)

שִׂנְאָה תְּעוֹרְרֵר מִדִּנָּה

“Hatred stirs up quarrels”

Here Solomon speaks of **Hatred** as if it were a living thing that could cause **quarrels**. He means that people who hate others cause such **quarrels**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Being hateful causes one to stir up quarrels]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:12 (#3)

פֶּשַׁעִים

“transgressions”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgressions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Here, **transgressions** refers to crimes committed against people. Alternate translation: [kinds of things that people do to harm others]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:13 (#3)

חֵכְמָה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:13 (#5)

חסר־לב

“the one lacking of heart”

See how you translated **lacking of heart** in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:13 (#4)

וְשֹׁבֶט לַגֵּב

“but a rod {is} for the back of”

The phrase **a rod is for the back** refers to a form of punishment that involved beating a person on **the back** with a **rod**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a general expression for physical punishment. Alternate translation: [but physical punishment is for]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:13 (#1)

בְּשִׁפְתַּי תִּנְבוֹן

“On the lips of the discerning one”

Here Solomon refers to what a **discerning** person says as if it were an object on that person’s **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In what a discerning person says]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:13 (#2)

תִּמְצָצָא חֵכְמָה

“wisdom is found”

Here Solomon refers to the existence of **wisdom** as if it were an object that could be found. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wisdom exists] or [there is wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:14 (#1)

יָצָפוּ

“store up”

See how you translated the same use of **store up** in 2:1.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:14 (#3)

וּפִי

“but the mouth of”

See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 10:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:14 (#4)

מִהֲתַתָּה קִרְבָּה

“is} near ruin”

Here Solomon speaks of what a **fool** says causing **ruin** as if that fool’s **mouth** was **near ruin**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes ruin]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:14 (#2)

דָּעִית

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:15 (#2)

קִרְיַת צִדְדּוֹ

“is} the city of his strength”

Here Solomon refers to **wealth** enabling its owners to be safe as if it were a strong **city** that protects them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is his protection]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:15 (#4)

דְּלִילִים

“lowly ones”

The phrase **lowly ones** refers to poor people as if they were located in a place that is lower than that of people who are not poor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people who are poor]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:15 (#1)

קריית עוזו

“is} the city of his strength”

The phrase **city of his strength** is an idiom that refers to a **city** with walls that protect the people inside the **city**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is a walled city] or [is a city with strong walls]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:15 (#5)

רישם

“is} their poverty”

See how you translated the abstract noun **poverty** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:15 (#3)

מחמת דללים רישם

“the ruin of lowly ones {is} their poverty”

This clause is in strong contrast to the previous clause. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the ruin of lowly ones is their poverty]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 10:16 (#4)

לחיים

“is} to life”

Here, **life** refers to both living well and living long. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is to a good, long life] or [is to living happily for a long time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:16 (#7)

לחטאת

“is} to sin”

Here, **sin** could refer to: (1) the punishment that someone receives for **sin**, which is suggested by the contrasting parallelism between this clause and the previous clause. Alternate translation: [is punishment

for sin]; (2) **sin** itself. Alternate translation: [is to sin more]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:16 (#3)

לחיים & לחטאת

“is} to life & is} to sin”

In this verse, the phrase **is to** indicates that what follows is the result of what was previously stated. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [leads to life ... leads to sin] or [results in life ... results in sin]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 10:16 (#2)

צדיק & רשע

“a righteous {one} & a wicked {one}”

The phrases **the righteous one** and **the wicked one** represent types of people in general, not one particular **righteous one** or **wicked one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any righteous person ... any wicked person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:16 (#5)

תבואת רשע לחטאת

“the income of a wicked {one} {is} to sin”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the income of the wicked one is to sin]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 10:16 (#6)

תבואת

“the income of”

Here Solomon speaks of the recompense or punishment that **the wicked one** receives as if it were **income**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the recompense for]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:16 (#1)

פצללת

“The wage of”

Here Solomon speaks of the reward that **the righteous one** receives as if it were a **wage** that someone pays. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The reward for]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:17 (#2)

אַנְרָה לְלִחְיִים שׁוֹמְרֵי מוֹסֶר

“On} a path to life {is} one who keeps instruction”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who keeps instruction is on a path to life]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 10:17 (#1)

אַנְרָה

“On} a path”

See how you translated the same use of **path** in 8:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:17 (#3)

לְלִחְיִים

“to life”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the result of keeping **instruction**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [that leads to life] or [that results in life]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 10:17 (#4)

מוֹסֶר & תּוֹכַחַת

“instruction & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **instruction** in 1:2 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:17 (#6)

מִתְעָה

“goes astray”

Here Solomon refers to someone deliberately doing wicked things that will result in that person’s destruction as if that person were wandering away from a

good road. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does what will result in that person’s destruction]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:17 (#5)

נְעִיזָב

“but one who forsakes”

See how you translated the same use of “forsake” in 1:8.

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:18 (#2)

שִׁפְתֵי־שֶׁשֶׁקֶר

“has} lips of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **lips** that are characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [has lips that speak falsely]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:18 (#4)

הֵהוּא

“he”

Although the term **he** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 10:18 (#3)

שִׁפְתֵי

“has} lips of”

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by moving their **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [speaks]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:18 (#1)

מְכַסֶּה

“One who covers”

See how you translated the same use of **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:19 (#3)

לֹא יִחַדֵּל

“does not cease”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression, **cease**, that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [piles up] or [multiplies]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 10:19 (#1)

בְּרַב דְּבָרִים

“With a multitude of words”

Here Solomon implies that someone is speaking **a multitude of words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When someone speaks a multitude of words]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:19 (#4)

וְחֹשֶׁךְ שִׁפְתָּיו

“but one who restrains his lips”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to someone who stops himself from speaking. If it would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who keeps his mouth shut] or [but one who prevents himself from speaking]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:19 (#2)

פָּשָׁע

“transgression”

See how you translated “transgressions” in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:20 (#3)

לְשׁוֹן צַדִּיק

“is} the tongue of the righteous one”

See how you translated **the righteous one** in 10:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:20 (#5)

לֵב

“the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:20 (#1)

כֶּסֶף נִבְחָר

“Choice silver”

Here Solomon speaks of the value of what righteous people say as if it were the best quality **silver**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Extremely valuable] or [Like choice silver]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:20 (#6)

כְּמִעֹט

“is} like little”

Here, **like little** refers to having **little** value. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has little value] or [is not valuable]

See: Simile

Proverbs 10:20 (#2)

לְשׁוֹן

“is} the tongue of”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:20 (#4)

לֵב רָשָׁעִים כְּמִעֹט

“the heart of the wicked ones {is} like little”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the heart of the wicked ones is like little]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 10:21 (#2)

צַדִּיק

“the righteous one”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:21 (#1)

שִׁפְתָּי

“The lips of”

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by moving their **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The sayings of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:21 (#5)

לֵב

“heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:21 (#4)

בְּחֶסֶד-לֵב יָמוּתוּ

“die by lack of heart”

Here, **by** indicates that what follows is the reason why **fools die**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [die as a result of lacking heart]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 10:21 (#3)

יִרְעֵעוּ

“shepherd”

Here Solomon speaks of what **righteous** people say benefitting people as if their words were guiding the hearers the way that a shepherd guides sheep. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [guide]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:22 (#1)

וְלֹא-יִוָּסֵף עִנְיָו עִמָּה

“and striving does not add {more} with it”

The word translated as **striving** has a broad meaning. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. It can mean: (1) “excessively hard work.” Alternate translation: [and toil does not add to it] or [and hard work does not add more riches to it]; (2) “pain.” In this interpretation, Yahweh would be the subject of the phrase **does not add** and “pain” would be the object. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh does not add pain to it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:23 (#1)

כְּשֹׂחַחֲזִיק לְלִבְסִיל עֲשׂוֹת זִמְמָה

“Like laughter for a stupid one {is} doing a wicked plan”

Solomon is saying that **doing a wicked plan** is like **laughter** because **a stupid one** enjoys it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [For a stupid one, doing a wicked plan is as much fun as laughing]

See: Simile

Proverbs 10:23 (#2)

וְיִחְכְּמָהּ לְאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

“but wisdom, for a man of understanding”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words in this clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but wisdom is like laughter for a man of understanding]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:23 (#3)

וְיִחְכְּמָהּ & תְּבוּנָה

“but wisdom & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:23 (#5)

לְאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

“for a man of understanding”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **understanding**. If your

language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [for an understanding man] or [for a person who has understanding]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:23 (#4)

לְאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

“for a man of understanding”

Although **man** is masculine, here it refers to any person with **understanding**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for a person of understanding]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 10:24 (#4)

יָתֵן

“will be given”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [will be given to them]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:24 (#5)

יָתֵן

“will be given”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will give]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 10:24 (#2)

כִּי־יִשָּׁע הָרָשָׁה תִּבְוֶאֱמָנוּ

“the wicked one, it will come to him”

In this verse, **the wicked one** and **him** refer to **wicked** people in general. See how you translated **the wicked one** in 3:33. Alternate translation: [any wicked person, it will come to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:24 (#1)

מִגִּזְרֵת

“The terror of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **terror**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [That which terrifies]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:24 (#3)

הָרָשָׁה תִּבְוֶאֱמָנוּ

“it will come to him”

Here Solomon speaks of someone experiencing **terror** as if **terror** were a living thing that could **come** to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it will happen to him]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:25 (#4)

רָשָׁע

“wicked”

Solomon is using the adjective **wicked** as a noun to mean wicked people in general. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [wicked person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 10:25 (#3)

וְאִין רָשָׁע

“then there is no {more} wicked”

Here Solomon implies that the **whirlwind** blew away every **wicked one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and there is no wicked one because the whirlwind blew them away]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:25 (#2)

וְאִין רָשָׁע

“then there is no {more} wicked”

The word translated **then** here indicates that the event it introduces took place as a result of the event stated in the previous clause. Use a natural form in your language for introducing an event that is the result of another event. Alternate translation: [it results in there being no more wicked]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 10:25 (#6)

יִסְכּוּד עוֹלָם

“is} a foundation of eternity”

Here Solomon refers to a **righteous one** being able to endure disasters as if that person were the **foundation** of a building that storms do not damage. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [endures to eternity] or [remains forever]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:25 (#7)

יִסְכּוּד עוֹלָם

“is} a foundation of eternity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **foundation** that lasts to **eternity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is an eternal foundation] or [is a foundation that lasts to eternity]

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:25 (#1)

כַּעֲבֹר סְקֹפָה

“When a whirlwind passes over”

Here, **whirlwind** could refer to: (1) any destructive event. Alternate translation: [At the occurring of a disaster] or [When a disaster occurs]; (2) a storm. Alternate translation: [When a storm occurs]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:25 (#5)

וְצַדִּיק

“but a righteous one”

Solomon is speaking of **righteous** people in general, not of one particular **righteous** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [but any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:26 (#3)

לְשִׁלְחִי

“to one who sends him”

Here Solomon implies that **the lazy one** was sent to do some errand for the person who sent him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to one who sends him to do an errand]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:26 (#2)

הִתְעַצֵּל לְשִׁלְחִי

“is} the lazy one to one who sends him”

In this verse, **the lazy one** and **him** refer to **lazy** people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [is any lazy person to one who sends that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:26 (#1)

כַּחֲמֶזֶן | לְשִׁנַּיִם וְכַעֲשָׁשׁוֹן לְעֵינַיִם

“Like vinegar to the teeth and smoke to the eyes”

Solomon is saying that **the lazy one** is like **vinegar to the teeth and smoke to the eyes** because **vinegar** irritates **teeth** and **smoke** irritates **eyes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Like vinegar is irritating to teeth and smoke is irritating to eyes]

See: Simile

Proverbs 10:27 (#4)

תוֹסִיף יָמִימִים

“will add days”

Here, **days** represents years that are made up of days. It does not imply a shorter amount of life than is meant by **years** in the next clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will add days upon days] or [will add years]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:27 (#1)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated the **fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 10:27 (#3)

תוֹסֶסֶיף יָמִימִים

“will add days”

Here Solomon implies that **days** are added to the length of a person's life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will add days to the length of a person's life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:27 (#5)

וְשָׁנֹת רָשָׁעִים

“but the years of the wicked ones”

Here Solomon uses **years** to refer to the length of time that a person lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the lifetimes of the wicked ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:27 (#2)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה תוֹסֶסֶיף יָמִימִים

“The fear of Yahweh will add days”

Here Solomon speaks as if the **fear of Yahweh** were a person who could **add days** to a person's life. He means that by fearing **Yahweh**, a person will live a long life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [By fearing Yahweh, the days of a person's life will increase]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:28 (#2)

שִׂמְחָה

“is} joy”

Here the thing that **the righteous ones hope** for is referred to by what it produces, which is **joy**. Alternate translation: [results in joy] or [brings joy]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:28 (#3)

וְתִקְוַת רָשָׁעִים תֵּאָבֵד

“but the expectation of the wicked ones will perish”

Here Solomon speaks of **the wicked ones** having unfulfilled expectations as if their **expectation will perish**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the expectation of the wicked ones will remain unfulfilled]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:28 (#1)

תוֹחֻלָּת & שִׂמְחָה

“The hope of & is} joy”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **hope** and **joy**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [What is hoped for by ... is what is joyful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:29 (#3)

דִּבְרֵי יְהוָה

“is} the way of Yahweh”

Here, **the way of Yahweh** refers to the righteous way that Yahweh teaches people to live. This is the “way of wisdom” that Solomon speaks of in 4:11. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is living by Yahweh's instruction]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:29 (#4)

וְיִמְחָה תִּבְנִיהָ

“but ruin”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. The **way of Yahweh** causes ruin for **doers of iniquity** because they walk on a different path, as in 4:14. Alternate translation: [but the way of Yahweh causes ruin]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:29 (#2)

לְאִישׁ & אִינוּקָה

“for the one with integrity & iniquity”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **integrity** in 1:3 and **iniquity** in 6:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:29 (#1)

קַעֲזוּז

“A stronghold”

Here Solomon refers to **the way of Yahweh** protecting people as if it were a **stronghold**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Protection]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:30 (#1)

צַדִּיק

“A righteous one”

See how you translated the same phrase in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 10:30 (#3)

אֶרֶץ

“the land”

See how you translated the same use of **the land** in 2:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 10:30 (#2)

בִּלְי־מָוֶט

“will not falter”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [will remain secure]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 10:31 (#1)

פִּי־צַדִּיק

“The mouth of the righteous one”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:31 (#3)

וּלְשׁוֹן

“but the tongue of”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:31 (#4)

תִּכְרֹת

“will be cut off”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will cut off]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 10:31 (#5)

תִּכְרֹת

“will be cut off”

Here Solomon speaks of **the perverse ones** not being permitted to speak as if someone **cut off** their tongues. This does not mean that someone would literally **cut off** their tongues; it simply means that they will be stopped. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not be allowed to speak] or [will be stopped]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 10:31 (#2)

יִבְנוּב הַקִּמְצָה

“bears the fruit of wisdom”

Here Solomon refers to a **righteous** person saying wise things as if his **mouth** were a plant that **bears wisdom** as a **fruit**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [speaks wisdom] or [speaks wisdom like a plant bears fruit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 10:32 (#1)

שִׁפְתֵי צַדִּיק

“The lips of the righteous one”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 10:32 (#2)

יְדַעְיוּן רָצוֹן

“know favor”

Here Solomon speaks of a **righteous** person saying pleasing things as if that person's **lips** were people who **know favor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [express favor]

See: Personification

Proverbs 10:32 (#4)

וּפְּפִי רָשָׁעִים תִּהְיֶה כָּבוֹד

“but the mouth of the wicked ones, perverse things”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but the mouth of the wicked ones speaks perverse things] or [but the mouth of the wicked ones expresses perverse things]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 10:32 (#3)

רִצְיוֹן

“favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 10:32 (#5)

וּפְּפִי רָשָׁעִים

“but the mouth of the wicked ones”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs - Chapter 11 Introduction**Structure and Formatting**

Chapter 11 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs. These proverbs continue to contrast the benefits of being righteous and wise with the trouble that comes to those who are wicked and foolish (11:1–31).

Translation Issues in This Chapter**Contrasting parallelism**

Except for 11:7, 10, 22, 25, and 11:29–31, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 11:1 (#5)

וְאֶבֶן שְׁלֵמָה

“but a whole stone”

Here, **whole stone** refers to a **stone** people use as a standard weight on a pair of **Scales** that accurately weighs the **whole** amount that people expect it to weigh. Merchants could deceive and cheat their customers by using a stone that was not the correct weight. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but an accurate weight] or [but a stone that weighs the correct weight]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:1 (#1)

מֵאֲזִנֵּי מִדְּבָרִים תוֹעֲבָה וְאֶבֶן שְׁלֵמָה

“Scales of deceit {are} an abomination to & but a whole stone”

Solomon does not mean that **Yahweh** actually hates these **Scales** or has **delight** in this **whole stone**. Rather, he means that **Yahweh** hates it when people use these **Scales** and has **delight** when people use a **whole stone**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The use of scales of deceit is an abomination to ... but the use of a whole stone]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:1 (#6)

רִצְיוֹן

“is} his delight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **delight** in 8:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:1 (#2)

מֵאֲזִנֵּי מִדְּבָרִים

“Scales of deceit”

Scales describes an instrument for determining the weight of an object or comparing the weight of two objects. It consists of a central post with a crossbar

from which two pans are hung. An object may be placed in one pan and known weights placed in the other pan until the crossbar remains level, indicating that both pans contain an equal weight. Or one object may be placed in one pan and a different object in the other pan; the pan that hangs lower contains the heavier object. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of weighing instrument, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a balancing scale of deceit] or [a weighing instrument of deceit]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 11:1 (#4)

תועבבת יהוה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated **an abomination to Yahweh** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:1 (#3)

מאזני מרמה

“Scales of deceit”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **Scales** that are used for **deceit**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Scales used to deceive people] or [Scales people use to deceive others]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:2 (#4)

קללון & חכמה

“disgrace & is} wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **disgrace** in 6:33 and **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:2 (#1)

בא-תודון ויבבא קללון

“When presumptuousness comes, then disgrace comes”

Here Solomon speaks of a person acting with **presumptuousness** and experiencing **disgrace** as if **presumptuousness** and **disgrace** were living things that come to someone. If it would be helpful in your lan-

guage, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When someone acts with presumptuousness, then that person experiences disgrace]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:2 (#3)

ויבבא קללון

“then disgrace comes”

The word translated **then** at the beginning of this phrase indicates that this event happens after the event described in the previous phrase. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the next event in a sequence of events. Alternate translation: [disgrace comes afterward]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Proverbs 11:2 (#2)

בא-תודון

“When presumptuousness comes”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **presumptuousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [When a person is presumptuous]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:3 (#4)

וססלף

“but the crookedness of”

See how you translated a similar use of “crooked” in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:3 (#2)

תמימה

“The integrity of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:3 (#3)

וססלף בוגדים ושדם

“but the crookedness of the treacherous ones will destroy them”

Here Solomon speaks of **crookedness** as if it were a living thing that could **destroy** a person. If it would be

helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. Alternate translation: [but when treacherous ones act with crookedness, doing so will destroy them] or [but the crookedness of the treacherous ones is like a person who destroys them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:3 (#1)

הַמִּמַּת יִשְׁרָיִם מְנַחֵם

“The integrity of the upright ones will guide them”

Here Solomon speaks of **integrity** as if it were a living thing that could **guide** a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [When upright ones act with integrity, doing so will enable them to know what to do] or [The integrity of the upright ones is like a guide for them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:4 (#3)

בַּיּוֹם עֲבָרָה

“in the day of rage”

Here, **the day of rage** refers to any time when God punishes wicked people. It does not necessarily refer to the final Judgment Day. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [when Yahweh punishes wicked people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:4 (#2)

לֹא יִוָּצֵעַ

“will not profit”

See how you translated the same use of **profit** in 3:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:4 (#5)

וְאִצְדָּקָה & מָמוֹת

“but righteousness & from death”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** in 1:3 and **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:4 (#4)

וְאִצְדָּקָה תַּצְצִיל מָמוֹת

“but righteousness will deliver from death”

Here Solomon speaks of **righteousness** enabling a person to escape **death** as if **righteousness** were a living thing that could **deliver** that person **from death**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but righteousness will enable someone to be delivered from death] or [but righteousness is like someone who delivers a person from death]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:4 (#1)

לֹא יִוָּצֵעַ הָהוֹן בַּיּוֹם עֲבָרָה וְאִצְדָּקָה תַּצְצִיל מָמוֹת

“Wealth will not profit in the day of rage, but righteousness will deliver from death”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages both of these clauses would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Wealth will not profit you in the day of rage, but righteousness will deliver you from death] or [Wealth will not profit people in the day of rage, but righteousness will deliver people from death]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:5 (#4)

תִּישָׁר דֶּרֶכְכָּו

“will make his way straight”

Here Solomon refers to enabling someone to live without bad things happening to him as making that person's **way straight**. It is a comparison of a person's life to a path, and righteousness keeps the path from having twists and turns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar idea in 3:6. Alternate translation: [will cause that person to avoid bad things in life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:5 (#1)

צִדְקָה & וְאִבְרִשְׁתָּו

“The righteousness of & but by his wickedness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** in 1:3 and **wickedness** in 4:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:5 (#5)

רָשָׁע

“a wicked one”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:5 (#6)

יפול

“will fall”

Here Solomon speaks of someone experiencing disaster as if that person were falling down. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will experience disaster]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:5 (#2)

תתמים

“a blameless one”

The phrase **a blameless one** represents **blameless** people in general, not one particular **blameless one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any blameless person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:5 (#3)

תתמים

“a blameless one”

Here, **a blameless one** refers to someone whom Yahweh does not blame for acting wickedly. See how you translated the same use of “blameless ones” in 2:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:6 (#3)

ישרים & בגדלים

“the upright & treacherous {ones}”

Solomon is using the adjectives **upright** and **treacherous** as nouns to mean people who are upright and treacherous. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these words with a equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [upright people ... treacherous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 11:6 (#4)

יִלְכְּדוּ

“they will be captured”

The pronoun **they** here refers to **the treacherous ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those treacherous ones will be captured]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 11:6 (#2)

צדקת ישרים תצילם

“The righteousness of the upright will deliver them”

Here Solomon speaks of **righteousness** enabling a person to escape something as if **righteousness** were a person who could **deliver** that person from harm. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated a similar expression in 11:4. Alternate translation: [The righteousness of the upright ones will enable them to be delivered] or [The righteousness of the upright ones is like someone who delivers them]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:6 (#1)

צדקת

“The righteousness of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **righteousness** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:6 (#5)

יִלְכְּדוּ

“they will be captured”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they will end up in captivity]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 11:7 (#3)

תאבד תקווה

“expectation will perish”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **expectation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he can no longer expect anything good]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:7 (#5)

וְתוֹחֵקָלֶת

“and the hope of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **hope** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:7 (#4)

תִּאֲבָד & אָבָדָה

“will perish & perishes”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **expectation** and **hope** remaining unfulfilled as if they were living things that could **perish**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use similes. Alternate translation: [will remain unfulfilled ... remains unfulfilled] or [will be like someone who perishes ... is like someone who perishes]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:7 (#6)

אֹנִיָּה

“strength”

Here, **strength** could refer to: (1) people who rely on their own strength to get what they hope for. Alternate translation: [those who rely on their own strength]; (2) people who rely on their wealth to get what they hope for. Alternate translation: [those who rely on their wealth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:7 (#2)

אֲדָדִים רָרָשָׁע

“a wicked man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a wicked person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 11:7 (#1)

בְּמָוֶת אֲדָדִים רָרָשָׁע

“At the death of a wicked man”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **death**, you could express the same idea

in another way. Alternate translation: [When a wicked man dies]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:8 (#5)

וַיָּבֹא רָשָׁע

“and a wicked {one} enters”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but a wicked one enters distress]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:8 (#1)

צַדִּיק מִצָּרָה נִחְלָץ וַיָּבֹא רָשָׁע תַּחֲתָיו

“A righteous {one} is drawn away from distress, and a wicked {one} enters instead of him”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of avoiding and experiencing **distress** as if **distress** were a place that someone could be **drawn away from** or enter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A righteous one is prevented from experiencing distress, but a wicked one experiences distress instead of him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:8 (#2)

צַדִּיק & רָשָׁע

“A righteous {one} & a wicked {one}”

See how you translated **A righteous {one}** in 9:9 and **a wicked {one}** in 9:7.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 11:8 (#3)

צַדִּיק & נִחְלָץ

“A righteous {one} is drawn away”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh does the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh draws away a righteous one]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 11:8 (#4)

מִצָּרָה

Proverbs 11:10 (#3)

וּבְאַבְבֵּד רְשָׁעִים רִנָּה

“and when the wicked perish, a shout of joy”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and when wicked ones perish, there is a shout of joy] or [and when wicked ones perish, a the people give a shout of joy]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:11 (#4)

וּבִפְּי

“but with the mouth of”

See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 10:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:11 (#5)

תִּהְרָס

“it is torn down”

Here Solomon uses **a city** being **torn down** to refer to it being destroyed, which could include tearing **down** its walls and buildings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a city is destroyed]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:11 (#2)

בְּבִרְכַּת יֹשְׁרִים

“With the blessing of the upright”

Here, **the blessing of the upright** could refer to: (1) **the blessing** that **the upright** give to **a city**. Alternate translation: [With the blessing given by the upright ones]; (2) **the blessing** that God gives **the upright**. Alternate translation: [With the blessing that God gives to the upright ones]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:11 (#3)

תִּרְוֶה קְהָלָה

“a city is raised up”

Here Solomon refers to **a city** becoming great as if it were **raised up**. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a city is made great]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:11 (#1)

בְּבִרְכַּת יֹשְׁרִים תִּרְוֶה קְהָלָה וּבִפְּי רְשָׁעִים תִּהְרָס

“With the blessing of the upright a city is raised up, but with the mouth of the wicked it is torn down”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The blessing of the upright raises up a city, but the mouth of the wicked tears down a city]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 11:12 (#4)

וְאִישׁ יִשׁ תְּבוּנָה

“but a man of understandings”

Solomon is using this possessive form to mean that a characteristic of this man is that he understands many things. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. See how you translated the similar “a man of understanding” in 10:23. Alternate translation: [but a man who understands things]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:12 (#5)

תְּבוּנָה

“understandings”

Here Solomon is using the plural **understandings** where he could have used the singular form. This suggests that he is using the plural form to emphasize the breadth or depth of this person’s understanding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the singular and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [great understanding] or [deep understanding]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

Proverbs 11:12 (#1)

כִּזֹּל־לְרֵעֵהוּ

“One despising his neighbor”

Contrasting this clause with the second clause indicates that Solomon is referring to someone **despising his neighbor** by what he says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who vocally despises his

neighbor] or [One who despises his neighbor in what he says]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:12 (#2)

לְרַעְיָהוּ & נְאֻאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

“his neighbor & but a man of understandings”

Although **his** and **man** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [that person’s neighbor ... but a person of understanding]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 11:12 (#3)

חֲסֵר־לֵב

“is} lacking of heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:13 (#1)

מְגַלֶּה

“uncovers”

Here Solomon refers to revealing **secret** information as if that information were a hidden object that someone **uncovers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [reveals]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:13 (#2)

וְנֶאֱמַן־רֹדֶף

“but one faithful of spirit”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe someone whose **spirit** is characterized by being **faithful**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but a faithful person]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:13 (#3)

מְכַסֶּה

“covers”

See how you translated the same use of **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:14 (#3)

יִפֹּל

“falls”

See how you translated the same use of “fall” in 11:5.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:14 (#1)

בְּאֵין תִּתְּקִבְלוֹת & וְלֹא־תִשְׁוּעָה בְּרֹב יוֹעֵץ

“When there are no directions & but salvation {is} in an abundance of counsel”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **directions**, **salvation**, **abundance**, and **counsel**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **abundance** in 5:23 and **counsel** in 1:25. Alternate translation: [When no one directs ... but many people counseling someone will save that person]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:14 (#2)

עַמִּים

“a people”

In this verse, the word **people** is singular in form, but it refers to multiple people as a group that could also be called a “nation” or “country.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [a group of people] or [a nation]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 11:14 (#4)

וְלֹא־תִשְׁוּעָה בְּרֹב יוֹעֵץ

“but salvation {is} in an abundance of counsel”

Here Solomon is speaking of **salvation** as if it were an object that could be found **in an abundance of counsel**. He means that **an abundance of counsel** can result in **salvation**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but salvation is the result of an abundance of counsel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:15 (#2)

רַע־יִירוֹעַ

“One will be harmed {with} harm”

For emphasis, Solomon is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [One will come to great harm]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 11:15 (#4)

וְשֹׂנְאֵי תִקְעָעִים

“but one hating hand clasps”

By **hating hand clasps**, Solomon means specifically clasping hands to agree to pay a debt for someone. He is not referring to clasping hands in greeting or to make another kind of agreement. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [but one who rejects this kind of agreement]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:15 (#1)

עֲרֵב

“he pledges for”

Although the term **he** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [one pledged for] or [that person pledges for]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 11:15 (#3)

עֲרֵב

“he pledges for”

See how you translated the same use of “pledge” in 6:1.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:15 (#5)

תִּקְעָעִים

“hand clasps”

The function of this action in this culture was to confirm a contractual agreement between people. If there is a gesture with a similar meaning in your culture, you could consider using it here in your translation, or you could express the meaning plainly. See how

you translated the similar phrase “clasp your palms” in 6:1. Alternate translation: [shaking hands to confirm an agreement] or [confirming an agreement]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 11:16 (#2)

אִשְׁת־חַיִּל

“A woman of grace”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** who is characterized by **grace**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A woman who is gracious]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:16 (#5)

וְתִמְכּוּ-עֶשֶׂר

“will grasp riches”

Solomon contrasts this clause with the previous clause in order to imply that **riches** are not as important as **honor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will merely grasp riches]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:16 (#3)

וְתִמְכּוּ & וְתִמְכּוּ

“will grasp & will grasp”

Here Solomon speaks of people obtaining **honor** and **riches** as if they were objects that someone could **grasp**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will obtain ... will obtain]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:16 (#4)

כְּבוֹד

“honor”

See how you translated the abstract noun **honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:16 (#1)

אִשְׁת־חַיִּל

“A woman of grace”

Here, **woman** refers to a type of **woman** in general, not one particular **woman**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any woman of grace]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:17 (#4)

נִפְשׁוֹ & שְׁאָרָיו

“his soul & his flesh”

Here, **soul** and **flesh** refer to people, who have a **soul** and **flesh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 11:17 (#5)

אֶחָד

“a cruel {one}”

The phrase **a cruel {one}** represents cruel people in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any cruel person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:17 (#1)

נִפְשׁוֹ & שְׁאָרָיו

“A man of covenant faithfulness repays his soul & his flesh”

Although **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [A person of covenant faithfulness deals fully with that person’s soul ... that person’s flesh]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 11:17 (#2)

אִישׁ חֶסֶד

“A man of covenant faithfulness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **covenant faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A man who has covenant faithfulness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:17 (#3)

גִּמְלָה

“repays”

Here, **repays** refers to rewarding or benefiting someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [rewards]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:18 (#2)

כְּעֵלֶת-שֹׁטְקָר & שֹׁטְקָר אֱמֶת

“a wage of falsehood & a wage of truth”

In this verse, Solomon is using possessive forms to describe a **wage** that is characterized by **falsehood** and to describe a **wage** that is characterized by **truth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use different expressions. Alternate translation: [a false wage ... a true wage]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:18 (#1)

רָשָׁע

“A wicked {one}”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:18 (#3)

כְּעֵלֶת-שֹׁטְקָר & שֹׁטְקָר אֱמֶת

“a wage of falsehood & a wage of truth”

Here Solomon speaks of results or rewards as if they were a **wage** someone receives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a false reward ... a true reward]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:18 (#4)

וְזֶרַע צִדְקָה שֹׁטְקָר אֱמֶת

“but {one} sowing righteousness, a wage of truth”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but one who sows righteousness makes a wage of truth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:18 (#5)

וּזְרָעַ צְדָקָה

“but {one} sowing righteousness”

Here Solomon refers to doing righteous deeds as if one were sowing seeds in a field. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who does righteous deeds]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:19 (#5)

לְמוֹתוֹ

“{is} to his death”

See how you translated the abstract noun **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:19 (#4)

וּמְרִדֵּה רָעָה

“but one who pursues evil”

Here Solomon refers to someone who constantly does **evil** as if that person were pursuing it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who constantly does evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:19 (#1)

כֹּן־צְדָקָה

“True righteousness”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words in this clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the next clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Pursuing true righteousness] or [Behaving with true righteousness]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:19 (#3)

לְחַיִּים

“{is} to life”

See how you translated the same use of **life** in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:19 (#2)

לְחַיִּים & לְמוֹתוֹ

“{is} to life & is} to his death”

In this verse, **{is} to** indicates that what follows is the result of what preceded. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [leads to life ... leads him to his death]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 11:20 (#1)

תּוֹעֵבָה בְּיְהוָה

“An abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:20 (#6)

דֶּרֶךְ

“way”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:20 (#3)

לֵב

“heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:20 (#5)

תִּמְנִי־מִי דֶּרֶךְ

“{is} the blameless of way”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **way** that is characterized by being **blameless**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is those whose way is blameless]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:20 (#2)

עָקוּשׁ

“{is} the crooked of”

See how you translated the same use of **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:20 (#4)

וְרִצּוֹנוֹ

“but his delight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **delight** in 8:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:21 (#5)

וְזֶרַע

“but the seed of”

Here Solomon refers to all righteous people as though they were **the seed** of a righteous plant, or of all righteous people as though they were all descendants in a line of righteous people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but everyone having the characteristic of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:21 (#2)

רָגַע

“a wicked {one}”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:21 (#4)

וְזֶרַע

“but the seed of”

Here, the word **seed** is singular in form, but it refers to all seeds as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [but the seeds of]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 11:21 (#1)

יָד לְיָד

“Hand to hand”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to something being certain. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [As sure as the sun comes up] or [Assuredly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:21 (#6)

בְּמָלָט

“will safely escape”

Here Solomon implies that the **escape** is from punishment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will escape punishment] or [will not be punished]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:21 (#3)

לֹא יִבְנֶקֶה

“will not remain blameless”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 11:22 (#3)

חֲזִיר

“a pig”

A **pig** is an animal that is considered to be unclean and disgusting by Jews and many cultures of the Ancient Near East. It would be very inappropriate for a **pig** to have a **ring of gold** in its **nose**. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of a disgusting animal in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a disgusting animal]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:22 (#4)

וְסָרַת טָעַם

“turning away {from} discretion”

Here Solomon speaks of refusing to act with **discretion** as if someone were **turning away** from it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who does not act with discretion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:22 (#1)

בְּנִים יִזְקֶה בְּאֶפֶר חֲזִיר אִשָּׁשָׁה יִפְסֹף וְסָרַת טָעַם

“A ring of gold in the nose of a pig {is} a beautiful woman turning away {from} discretion”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation:

[A beautiful woman that turns away from discretion is a ring of gold in the nose of a pig]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 11:22 (#2)

נָנִים וְזָהָב בְּאַף הַזִּזִּיר אִשָּׁשָׁה יִפְסָה וְסָרְתָּ מִטָּעַם

“A ring of gold in the nose of a pig {is} a beautiful woman turning away {from} discretion”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of how inappropriate it is for a **beautiful woman** not to have **discretion**. He speaks as if that **woman** were a **ring of gold** in a pig’s **nose**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [A beautiful woman that turns away from discretion is inappropriate, like a ring of gold in the nose of a pig]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:22 (#5)

טָעַם

“discretion”

See how you translated the abstract noun **discretion** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:23 (#3)

תִּקְנוֹת רָשָׁעִים עֲבָרָה

“the expectation of the wicked {is} rage”

Solomon does not mean to communicate here that **the wicked** do wicked things because they expect **rage**. He means to communicate that it is as though they expect rage, because that is what they get. If a speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [whatever the wicked ones might expect, rage is all that they will get]

See: Irony

Proverbs 11:23 (#5)

עֲבָרָה

“is} rage”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rage**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is being enraged] or [enrages]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:23 (#4)

עֲבָרָה

“is} rage”

Here, **rage** could refer to: (1) Yahweh’s wrath. Alternate translation: [is the wrath of Yahweh]; (2) the wrath of other people. Alternate translation: [is the wrath of other people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:23 (#2)

תִּקְנוֹת רָשָׁעִים עֲבָרָה

“the expectation of the wicked {is} rage”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the expectation of the wicked ones is rage]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 11:23 (#1)

תִּאֲנוֹת צְדִיקִים אֲדִי-טוֹב תִּקְנוֹת רָשָׁעִים עֲבָרָה

“The desire of the righteous {is} only good; the expectation of the wicked {is} rage”

This verse could mean: (1) **The desire** of **righteous** people results in what is **good**, but **the expectation** of **wicked** people results in **rage**. Alternate translation: [The desire of the righteous ones leads only to good; the expectation of the wicked ones leads to rage]; (2) **righteous** people **only desire** what is **good**, but **wicked** people expect anger. Alternate translation: [The righteous ones only desire good things; the wicked ones expect rage]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:24 (#5)

אֲדִי-לְמַחְסוֹר

“yet to poverty”

Here, **yet** introduces the unexpected result of what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate an unexpected result. Alternate translation: [but only comes to poverty as a result]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 11:24 (#6)

אֲדִי-לְמַחְסוֹר

“yet to poverty”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [yet he comes to poverty]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:24 (#1)

יֵשׁ מְמַפֵּזֵר וְנוֹסֵטֶר עֲעוֹד

“There is a scatterer yet being added to more”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. The context is about a person sharing what he has with others. Alternate translation: [There is a person who scatters what he has and yet adds more to what he has]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:24 (#4)

וְחֹשֵׁשׁ מִמֶּיֶשֶׁר

“and {one} withholding more than {what is} right”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. The context is about a person not sharing what they have with others. Alternate translation: [and one who withholds from those in need more of what he has than is right]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:24 (#2)

מְמַפֵּזֵר & וְחֹשֵׁשׁ

“a scatterer & and {one} withholding”

In this verse, the **scatterer** and the **one withholding** are examples of types of people. It does not mean that there is only one person who does each of these two things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [a type of person who scatters ... but a type of person who withholds]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:24 (#3)

וְנוֹסֵטֶר עֲעוֹד

“yet being added to more”

Here, **yet** introduces the unexpected result of what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate an unexpected result. Alternate translation: [even so, it results in that person having more]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 11:25 (#3)

נֶפֶשׁ

“A life of”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:25 (#7)

וְאִמְרָנָה גַּם־הִיא יוֹרָא

“and the one who drenches, he also will be drenched”

Here Solomon refers to someone giving and receiving a generous amount of the good things of life as if the people were plants giving and receiving abundant rain. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the one who freely gives to others will also freely receive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:25 (#5)

תִּדְשֵׁשׁ & יוֹרָא

“will be fattened & will be drenched”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will fatten ... Yahweh will drench]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 11:25 (#2)

נֶפֶשׁ־בְּרִכָּה

“A life of blessing”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **life** that is characterized by **blessing**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A life that blesses]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:25 (#1)

נָפֵשׁ & וְאִמְרוֹנָה & הָהוּא

“A life of & and the one who drenches, he”

In this verse, **A life**, **the one**, and **he** refer to types of people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any life of ... and any person who drenches, that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:25 (#6)

תִּדְשֵׁן

“will be fattened”

Here Solomon refers to a person becoming prosperous as if they were **fattened**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will become prosperous]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:25 (#4)

בְּרִכָּה

“blessing”

Here Solomon implies that the **blessing** is given to other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [blessing other people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:26 (#3)

וְאִבְרִכָּה לְרֹאשׁ

“but a blessing {is} for the head of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 10:6.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 11:26 (#4)

מִשְׁבִּיר

“the seller”

Here Solomon implies that **the seller** sells **grain**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the one who sells his grain]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:26 (#2)

מִמְנֵעַ בֹּרֵר

“One withholding grain”

Here Solomon implies that this person is selfishly **withholding grain** in order to sell it later for a greater profit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who is withholding grain in order to sell it later for a higher price]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:26 (#1)

מִמְנֵעַ & יִקְבֹּהוּ & מִשְׁבִּיר

“One withholding & will curse him & the seller”

In this verse, **One**, **him**, and **the seller** refer to types of people in general. They do not refer to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who withholds ... will curse that person ... any seller]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:27 (#4)

טוֹב

“good”

Solomon is using the adjective **good** as a noun to mean good things. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [to do good things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 11:27 (#3)

טוֹב & רָצוֹן & רָעָה

“good & favor & evil”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **good**, **favor**, and **evil**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [what is good ... to be favored ... what is evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 11:27 (#2)

שֹׁחֵץ & דֹּרֵשׁ

“One diligently seeking & but one searching {for}”

In this verse, Solomon refers to people trying to do **good** and trying to do **evil** as if **good** and **evil** were objects that someone **seeks** or **searches for**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who diligently tries to do good ... but one who tries to do evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:27 (#1)

שֶׁשֶׁקֶר & יִדְרֹשׁ & תְּבוֹאֵנוּ

“One diligently seeking & but one searching {for & it will come {to} him”

In this verse, **One diligently seeking**, **one searching for**, and **him** refer to types of people in general. They do not refer to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who diligently seeks ... but any person who searches for ... it will come to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:27 (#6)

תְּבוֹאֵנוּ

“it will come {to} him”

Here Solomon speaks of someone experiencing **evil** as if **evil** were a person who could **come** to that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will experience it] or [it will happen to him]

See: Personification

Proverbs 11:27 (#5)

יִבְקֹשׁ רֶצֶן

“seeks favor”

Solomon says that someone **diligently seeking good** also **seeks favor** because that is what that person receives from Yahweh and other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [finds favor from Yahweh and people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:28 (#2)

הָהוּא יִפֹּל

“he himself will fall”

In the original, Solomon adds the pronoun “you,” the meaning of which is already included in the verb translated as **fall**. This adds emphasis to what he is saying. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **himself**. Alternate translation: [that very person will fall]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 11:28 (#3)

הָהוּא יִפֹּל

“he himself will fall”

See how you translated the same use of **fall** in 11:5.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:28 (#4)

וְכַעֲלֵלָה צַדִּיקִים יִפְרֹחוּ

“but like a leaf, the righteous will sprout”

Solomon is saying that **the righteous** are like **a leaf** that sprouts out of a plant because they prosper and thrive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [but righteous ones prosper like a leaf that sprouts and grows]

See: Simile

Proverbs 11:28 (#5)

וְכַעֲלֵלָה

“but like a leaf”

Solomon refers to a green **leaf** that is growing, rather than a fallen or withered **leaf**. If it would be helpful in your language, or if your language uses different words for a fresh or withered **leaf**, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but like a healthy leaf]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:28 (#1)

בְּטִיטָה בְּרֶעֱשָׁרוֹ הָהוּא יִפֹּל

“One trusting in his riches, he himself will fall”

One, **his**, and **he** in this verse refer to a type of person in general. They do not refer to a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any

person who trusts in that person's own riches, that person will fall]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:29 (#4)

לְחֵם-לֵב

“to the wise of heart”

See how you translated **wise of heart** in 10:8.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:29 (#3)

יָנַח-לִרְגֵלָהּ

“will inherit wind”

Here Solomon speaks of **wind** as if it were property that someone could **inherit**. He means that someone **who troubles his house** will not **inherit** anything. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will inherit nothing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:29 (#1)

עוֹכֵלֵךְ בְּבֵיתוֹ

“One troubling his house”

One and **his** in this verse refer to a type of person in general. They do not refer to a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Any person who troubles that person's own house]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:29 (#2)

בְּבֵיתוֹ

“his house”

Here, **house** represents the family who lives in **his house**. See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 11:30 (#4)

עֵץ חַיִּים

“is} a tree of life”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:18. Here Solomon speaks of what righteous people say and do as if it were a **tree** that gives **life** to those who eat

its fruit. He means that the actions and teaching of righteous people help others to live a long and happy life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [offers a good life to people] or [is like a fruit tree that sustains the lives of people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:30 (#5)

וְלִקְחָהּ נַפְשׁוֹת

“and one taking souls”

Here, **one taking souls** refers to someone who influences other people. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the one who wins hearts] or [and the one who influences others]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 11:30 (#2)

פְּרִי-צַדִּיק

“The fruit of the righteous”

Here Solomon refers to what **righteous** people do as if it were **fruit** that they produced. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What righteous people do]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:30 (#1)

פְּרִי-צַדִּיק

“The fruit of the righteous”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **fruit** that is produced by **the righteous one**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [The fruit produced by the righteous one]

See: Possession

Proverbs 11:30 (#3)

צַדִּיק & וְלִקְחָהּ נַפְשׁוֹת

“the righteous & and one taking souls”

In this verse, **the righteous** and the **one taking souls** refer to types of people in general. They do not refer to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you

translated **the righteous** in 10:3. Alternate translation: [any righteous person ... and any person who takes souls]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:31 (#7)

רִשְׁוֹשׁ וְחֹטֵא

“a wicked {one} and a sinner”

The terms **a wicked {one}** and **a sinner** mean similar things and refer to the same person, who represents this kind of people. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [a very wicked person]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 11:31 (#1)

הִבֵּן

“Behold”

See how you translated the same use of **Behold** in 1:23.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:31 (#5)

יִשְׁלַם

“will be repaid”

Here Solomon refers to people receiving what they deserve for their actions as if they were being **repaid** for what they have done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will receive what is due to them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 11:31 (#6)

אֵלֶּךְ כִּי־רִשְׁוֹשׁ וְחֹטֵא

“how much more a wicked {one} and a sinner”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [how much more will a wicked one and a sinner be repaid]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 11:31 (#3)

בְּאִרְצְךָ

“in the land”

Here, **the land** refers to the earth in general. It does not refer to the land of Israel, as it does in 2:21-22 and 10:30. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 11:31 (#2)

צַדִּיק & רִשְׁוֹשׁ וְחֹטֵא

“a righteous {one} & a wicked {one} and a sinner”

In this verse, **a righteous {one}**, **a wicked {one}**, and **a sinner** refer to types of people in general. They do not refer to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. See how you translated “a righteous {one}” in 9:9 and “a wicked {one}” in 9:7. Alternate translation: [any righteous person ... any wicked person and any sinner]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 11:31 (#4)

יִשְׁלַם

“will be repaid”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will repay]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 12 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism

Except for 12:7, 14, and 28, all of the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 12:1 (#1)

מְמוֹסֵר & דִּדְעַת & תּוֹכִיחַת

“correction & knowledge & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** in 3:11, **knowledge** in 1:4, and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:2 (#4)

וְאִישׁ קְזָמָמוֹת

“but a man of schemes”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who makes **schemes**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but a man who schemes]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:2 (#3)

וְאִישׁ

“but a man of”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [but a person of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:2 (#2)

רָצוֹן

“favor”

See how you translated the abstract noun **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:2 (#1)

טוֹב

“A good one”

A **good one** here does not refer to a specific person, but refers to this type of person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [Any good person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:3 (#4)

בְּרָשָׁע

“by wickedness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wickedness** in 4:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:3 (#3)

לֹא-יִבְכָּן

“will not be established”

Here the word translated as **established** refers to having a stable and secure life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will not be made stable]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:3 (#5)

וְשֹׁשְׁרֵשׁ צַדִּיקִים בְּלִי-יָמוֹת

“but the root of the righteous will not be shaken”

Here Solomon refers to someone’s life remaining secure as if that person were a tree with a **root** that could **not be shaken**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the righteous will be fully secure] or [but the lives of the righteous will remain stable]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:3 (#2)

לֹא-יִבְכָּן & בְּלִי-יָמוֹת

“will not be established & will not be shaken”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will not establish himself ... nobody will shake]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:3 (#1)

אָדָם

“A man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that could refer to either a man or woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [A person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:4 (#3)

וְכִרְקָבָהּ בַּעֲצָמוֹתֶיהָ מִבִּישָׁה

“but she who causes shame {is} like rottenness in his bones”

Solomon is saying that a woman **who causes shame** for her husband is like **rottenness in his bones** because she gradually ruins his life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but she who causes shame is what makes his life miserable]

See: Simile

Proverbs 12:4 (#1)

אִשָּׁת־חַיִּיל

“A wife of worth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **wife** that is characterized by **worth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A worthy wife]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:4 (#4)

וְכִרְקָקָב בְּעַצְמוֹתָיו

“but & is} like rottenness in his bones”

Here, **rottenness** refers to a disease like cancer that slowly destroys a person’s body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is like cancer in his bones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:4 (#5)

בְּעַצְמוֹתָיו

“in his bones”

Here, the pronoun **his** refers to the husband of the woman **who causes shame**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in her husband’s bones]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 12:4 (#2)

עֲטֹטֶרֶת בַּעֲלָהּ

“is} the crown of her husband”

Here Solomon refers to a woman causing her husband to be honored as if she were his **crown**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [brings great honor to her husband] or [honors her husband as if she were his crown]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:5 (#3)

מְרִמָּה

“are} deceit”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **deceit**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [are deceptive]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:5 (#1)

מִשְׁפָּט

“are} justice”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:5 (#2)

תַּחְבִּילוֹת רְשָׁעִים מְרִמָּה

“the directions of the wicked {are} deceit”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, the directions of the wicked ones are deceit]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 12:6 (#1)

דְּבָרָיו & וּפְּיוֹ

“The words of & but the mouth of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23 and **mouth** in 10:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:6 (#2)

אֲרֵב־דָּמָם

“lie in wait {for} blood”

Here Solomon refers to **the wicked ones** saying things that will cause other people to die as if what they say is a person who waits to ambush someone on the road. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated this phrase in 1:11. Alternate translation: [result in people dying] or [are like someone who lies in wait to murder someone]

See: Personification

Proverbs 12:6 (#3)

יְצִילֵם

“will deliver them”

Here Solomon refers to **the upright** rescuing themselves from trouble through what they say as if what they say were a person who could **deliver them**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will allow them to deliver themselves]

See: Personification

Proverbs 12:7 (#2)

וּבֵרִית

“but the house of”

See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:7 (#1)

הֶפְפוֹךְ

“are overthrown”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The word **overthrown** here refers to being ruined or destroyed. Alternate translation: [Wicked people experience destruction]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:7 (#3)

יַעֲמֵד

“will stand”

Here Solomon refers to the families of **the righteous ones** continuing to exist as if they were a **house** that would continue to **stand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will remain] or [will keep on existing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:8 (#6)

יִהְיֶיָה לְבוֹיז

“will be for contempt”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **contempt**, you could express the same idea in

another way. Alternate translation: [will be considered contemptible] or [will be despised by people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:8 (#2)

שִׁשְׁכָּלוֹ & אִיאִישׁ

“his insight a man”

Although **his** and **man** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [that person's insight that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:8 (#5)

וְנִצְוָה-לֵלֵב

“but {one} twisted of heart”

Here Solomon is speaking of people who think wrongly, as if they have a **twisted heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who thinks wrongly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:8 (#4)

יִהְיֶה לֵל-אִיאִישׁ

“a man will be praised”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will praise that man]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:8 (#3)

שִׁשְׁכָּלוֹ

“his insight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **insight** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:8 (#1)

לִפִּי

“For the mouth of”

For the mouth of is an idiom that means “According to.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In proportion to]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 12:9 (#3)

לֶחֶם

“bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 12:9 (#2)

וְעֶבֶד לָלוֹ & וְחָסֵר-לֶחֶם

“and having a servant & and lacking bread”

In both of these phrases, what follows **and** is in contrast to what people would expect. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate this contrast. Alternate translation: [but has a servant ... but is lacking of bread]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 12:9 (#1)

נִקְלָה וְעֶבֶד לָלוֹ

“is} being disregarded and having a servant”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is the one whom others disregard and has a servant]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:10 (#2)

יֹדֵדֶּה & נֹפֶשׁ

“knows the life of”

Here, the phrase **knows the life** refers to being concerned with the wellbeing of one’s **animal**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is concerned with the wellbeing of] or [cares about the life of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:10 (#3)

בְּהֵמָתָיו

“his animal”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [that person’s animal]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:10 (#1)

צַדִּיק

“A righteous {one}”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:10 (#4)

וְרַחֲמֵי רַף־שֹׁעִים

“but the compassion of the wicked”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **compassion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [but anything compassionate that wicked people do]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:11 (#1)

לֶחֶם

“Bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 12:11 (#3)

אַדְמָתוֹ

“his ground”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [that person’s ground]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:11 (#5)

חָסֵר-לֵב

“is} lacking of heart”

See how you translated **lacking of heart** in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:11 (#2)

עֲבֹד אֶדְמָתוֹ

“one who works his ground”

This phrase refers to a farmer who plants, cultivates, and harvests crops on **his ground**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly or you could use a general expression for working hard. Alternate translation: [a farmer who cultivates his land] or [someone who works hard at his job]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:11 (#4)

רִיקָקִים

“empty things”

Here Solomon refers to worthless things that people do as if they were **empty** containers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [worthless activities]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:12 (#3)

רָעָעִים

“the evil”

Solomon is using the adjective **evil** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [evil people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 12:12 (#1)

רָשָׁע

“A wicked {one}”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:12 (#4)

וְשֹׁשְׂרֵשׁ צְדִיקִים

“but the root of the righteous”

See how you translated this phrase in 12:3.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:12 (#2)

מִצְדּוֹד

“the snare of”

Here Solomon refers to what **the evil** catch in a **snare** as if it were the **snare** itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the plunder of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:12 (#5)

יָתֵן

“will give”

Here Solomon uses **give** to refer to producing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will produce fruit] or [will be productive]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:13 (#4)

רָרַע & צָדִיק

“an evil {one} & a righteous {one}”

See how you translated **a righteous {one}** and **a wicked {one}** in 11:8.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:13 (#2)

שִׁשְׁפֹּתַיִם

“lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:13 (#3)

מִוִּקְקֵשׁ רָרַע

“is} the snare of an evil {one}”

Here Solomon refers to the disasters that **an evil one** experiences because of what he says as if it were a **snare** that he was trapped in. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is what destroys an evil one]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:13 (#5)

וַיֵּצֵא מִצָּרָה צָדִיק

“but a righteous {one} will go out from distress”

Here Solomon refers to avoiding **distress** as if it were a place that one could **go out from**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the righteous one will avoid distress]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:13 (#1)

בִּפְּשֵׁעַ שְׁשֻׁפְתָּיִם

“In the transgression of lips”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **lips** that are characterized by **transgression**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [In the lips that speak transgression]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:13 (#6)

מִצָּרָה

“from distress”

See how you translated the abstract noun **distress** in 1:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:14 (#6)

יָשׁוּב לוֹ

“will return to him”

Here Solomon refers to the benefits that a person receives as a result of working hard as if that **accomplishment** were a person who could **return to him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will help him]

See: Personification

Proverbs 12:14 (#3)

מִפֶּה רִי אִישׁ יִשְׁבַּע-טָטוּב

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man will he be satisfied {with} good”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The fruit of the mouth of a man will satisfy him with good]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:14 (#4)

טָטוּב

“good”

See how you translated the abstract noun **good** in 11:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:14 (#1)

מִפֶּה רִי אִישׁ

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man”

Here Solomon refers to what a person says as if it were **fruit** that was produced by that person's **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [From what a man says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:14 (#2)

אִישׁ יִשְׁבַּע & אֶאֱדָם יָשׁוּב לוֹ

“a man will he be satisfied {with} & a man will return to him”

Although **a man**, **he**, and **him** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person will that person be satisfied with ... a person will return to that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:14 (#5)

וּגְמֻלוֹ יְדֵי-אֶאֱדָם

“and the accomplishment of the hands of a man”

Here Solomon refers to what a person accomplishes through physical labor as if it were the **accomplishment** of that person's **hands**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what a man accomplishes through physical labor]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:15 (#2)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in his eyes”

Solomon is using the expression **in his eyes** to mean “in his judgement” or “in his opinion.” See how you

translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:7. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in his opinion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:15 (#1)

דִּרְךְ

“The way of”

See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:15 (#3)

לְעֵצָה

“to counsel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:16 (#4)

בְּיוֹם

“on the day”

Solomon is using the term **day** to refer to a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the same day] or [right away]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:16 (#6)

קָלָיוֹן

“dishonor”

See how you translated the abstract noun **dishonor** in 3:35.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:16 (#2)

כַּעֲסוֹ

“his anger”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **anger**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when he is angry, it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:16 (#3)

יָדוּעַ

“is known”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people know]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:16 (#1)

כַּעֲסוֹ

“his anger”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [that person's anger]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:16 (#5)

וְכִסָּהּ

“but & covers”

See how you translated the same use of **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:17 (#2)

יִפְתִּיחַ

“He who breathes out”

See how you translated the same use of **breathes out** in 6:19. Here Solomon speaks of someone who easily and habitually tells the truth as if that person **breathes out faithfulness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who easily speaks]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:17 (#4)

וְעֵד שְׁקָרִים מְרִמָּה

“but a witness of falsehoods, deceit”

Solomon is leaving out a word in this clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but a witness of falsehoods tells deceit]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 12:17 (#3)

אֱמוּנָה יִגְדִּיל צֶדֶק & שְׁקָרִים מְרַמֶּה

“faithfulness tells righteousness & falsehoods, deceit”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **faithfulness** and **righteousness, falsehoods**, and **deceit**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [what is faithful tells what is righteous ... false things, what is deceitful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:17 (#6)

וְעֵד שְׁקָרִים

“but a witness of falsehoods”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **witness** who speaks **falsehoods**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but any witness who speaks falsehoods]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:17 (#1)

וְנִפְתָּח

“He who breathes out”

Although the term **He** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [A person who breathes out]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:17 (#5)

וְעֵד שְׁקָרִים

“but a witness of falsehoods”

Although **a witness** here is singular, it refers to any **witness of falsehoods** in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different form. Alternate translation: [but any witness of falsehoods]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:18 (#3)

וְלִשְׁוֹן חֲכָמִים מְרַפֵּא

“but the tongue of the wise ones—healing”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but the tongue of the wise ones causes healing]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 12:18 (#5)

וְלִשְׁוֹן

“but the tongue of”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17. Solomon is using the term **tongue** to represent what people say with their tongues. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the speech of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:18 (#1)

בְּבוֹטָה

“one speaking thoughtlessly”

Here, **one** refers to a type of person. It does not mean that there is only **one** person who does this thing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a type of person who speaks thoughtlessly]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:18 (#2)

כְּמִדְקָרְוֹת הַחֶרֶב

“like the thrusts of a sword”

Solomon is saying that what people who speak **thoughtlessly** say is **like the thrusts of a sword** because it hurts people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and hurting others as if he stabbed them with a sword]

See: Simile

Proverbs 12:18 (#4)

וְלִשְׁוֹן

“but the tongue of”

The word **tongue** represents tongues in general, not one particular **tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but the tongues of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:19 (#2)

שִׁפְתָּ

“A lip of”

Here, **lip** refers to what people say by moving their lips. See how you translated the same use of “lips” in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:19 (#8)

וְעַד־אֶאְרָגְיָעָה

“but & as long as I would blink”

The phrase **as long as I would blink** is an idiom that refers to a short amount of time, such as the time it takes to **blink** an eye. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but ... is gone in the blink of an eye] or [but ... only for a brief time]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 12:19 (#4)

תִּכְפֹּן

“will be established”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will exist]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:19 (#1)

שִׁפְתָּ

“A lip of”

Here, the word **lip** represents lips in general, not one particular **lip**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Lips of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:19 (#7)

לְשׁוֹן שָׁקֶר

“a tongue of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:19 (#6)

וְעַד־אֶאְרָגְיָעָה לְשׁוֹן שָׁקֶר

“but a tongue of falsehood as long as I would blink”

Solomon is leaving out a word in this clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but a tongue of falsehood will be established for as long as I would blink] or [but a tongue of falsehood will exist for as long as I would blink]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 12:19 (#5)

לְעַד

“to perpetuity”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **perpetuity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [perpetually]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:19 (#3)

שִׁפְתָּ־אֱמֶת

“A lip of truth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **lip** that speaks **truth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A lip that speaks truth] or [True sayings]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:20 (#1)

מִדְּמָרָמָה & רָגַע & שְׁלָלוֹם שְׁמֵחָה

“Deceit & evil & joy & peace”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Deceit** in 11:1, **evil** in 1:16, **joy** in 10:28, and **peace** in 3:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:20 (#2)

בְּלֵב

“is} in the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:20 (#3)

וְלִיעֲצָצִי שְׁלֹוֹם שְׁמִיחָה

“but joy {is} for advisers of peace”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **advisers** who advise others to do what results in **peace**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but joy is for people who advise others to do what will result in peace]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:21 (#1)

לֹא־יֵאָנֶנֶה לְצַדִּיק כָּל־אָאֻן

“Any iniquity will not be allowed to happen to the righteous”

Solomon is saying this as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way, as in the UST.

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 12:21 (#4)

לְצַדִּיק

“to the righteous”

See how you translated **the righteous** in 10:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:21 (#2)

אָאֻן

“iniquity”

Here, **iniquity** refers to harm that someone might experience as a result of **iniquity**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [harm]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:21 (#5)

מִמֶּלֶאֱוִי רָע

“are full of evil”

The phrase **full of evil** could mean: (1) the **wicked ones** experience much evil. Alternate translation: [experience much evil]; (2) the **wicked ones** do much evil. Alternate translation: [do much evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:21 (#3)

לֹא־יֵאָנֶנֶה

“will not be allowed to happen”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will not allow to happen]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 12:21 (#6)

רָע

“evil”

Here, **evil** refers to trouble that someone might experience as a result of **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [trouble]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:22 (#1)

תּוֹעֵבָה בְּיְהוָה

“An abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:22 (#2)

שִׁפְתֵי־שֶׁשֶׁקֶר

“are} lips of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:18.

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:22 (#3)

אֱמוּנָה רְצוֹנוֹ

“faithfulness {are} his delight”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **faithfulness** in 12:17 and **delight** in 8:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:23 (#1)

אִדָּדִים עֲעָרוֹם

“A prudent man”

Although **man** is masculine, here it refers to any **prudent** person. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A prudent person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:23 (#4)

וְלֵב סָפְסִילִלִים

“but the heart of the stupid”

Here, **heart** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the stupid one]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 12:23 (#3)

דַּעַת & אִנְלֵת

“knowledge & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:23 (#2)

כִּסְיָה

“covers”

See how you translated the same use of **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:24 (#1)

יַד־הָרוֹצֵצִים

“The hand of the diligent”

See how you translated the same phrase in 10:4.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 12:24 (#2)

אִרְמִיָּה

“but an idle one”

Although **an idle one** here is singular, it refers to all **idle** people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any idle person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:25 (#2)

קֶלֶב

“in the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:25 (#1)

דְּאִגָּה

“Concern”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **Concern**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [That which is concerning]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 12:25 (#4)

יִשְׁחַבֵּה

“weighs it down”

Here Solomon refers to **Concern** making a person depressed as if it were something that **weighs down** a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes the heart of a man to become sad]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:25 (#3)

אָדָם

“a man”

Although **man** is masculine, here it refers to any person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:25 (#5)

וְדִבְרֵי טוֹב

“but a good word”

Here Solomon uses the phrase **good word** to describe something kind that someone says by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but a kind message that someone speaks]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 12:26 (#4)

וְדֶרֶךְ רָשָׁעִים

“but the way of the wicked”

See how you translated **the way of the wicked ones** in 4:19.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:26 (#1)

צַדִּיק

“A righteous {one}”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:26 (#5)

תַּחֲצֵם

“leads them astray”

Here Solomon refers to **wicked ones** deliberately doing wicked things that will result in their destruction as if their behavior is a person who leads them **astray**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar meaning for **astray** in 10:17. Alternate translation: [will cause them to do what will result in their destruction]

See: Personification

Proverbs 12:26 (#2)

יִתְחַר מִרְעֵהוּ

“searches out from his neighbor”

This could mean: (1) **A righteous {one}** guides **his neighbor**. Alternate translation: [guides his neighbor]; (2) **A righteous {one}** carefully examines a person before choosing that person to be **his neighbor**. Alternate translation: [examines carefully whom he chooses to be his neighbor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:26 (#3)

מִרְעֵהוּ

“from his neighbor”

Although the term **his** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [from that person's neighbor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 12:27 (#4)

אָדָם & חַרוּץ

“a man & for} a diligent one”

Here, **a man** and **a diligent one** do not refer to a specific person, but refer to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any person ... for any diligent person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:27 (#3)

וְהוֹן־אָדָם יִקָּר חַרוּץ

“but the wealth of a man {is} precious {for} a diligent one”

This could mean: (1) **a diligent one** considers his **wealth** to be **precious**. Alternate translation: [but a diligent one's wealth is precious to him]; (2) **a diligent one** will acquire precious wealth. Alternate translation: [but a diligent one will acquire precious wealth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:27 (#2)

לֹא־יִחַרְרֹךְ & צִידוֹ

“will not roast his game”

Here, **game** refers to animals that someone has hunted and killed in order to eat their meat. And **roast** refers to cooking food over a fire. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will not use fire to cook the meat from the animals he has hunted]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:27 (#1)

רַמְיָה

“A negligent one”

A negligent one here does not refer to a specific person, but refers to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any negligent one]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 12:28 (#1)

בְּאֶרְח־צִדְקָה חַיִּים וּבְדֶרֶךְ נִתְיָבָה אֵל־מָוֶת

“In the path of righteousness {is} life, and the way of the beaten path {is} no death”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by

repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [In the path of righteousness is life, yes, the way of the beaten path is not death]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 12:28 (#4)

חַיִּים

“is} life”

See how you translated the same use of **life** in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:28 (#6)

וְדֶרֶךְ נְתִיבָהּ

“and the way of the beaten path”

Here, **the way of the beaten path** refers to **the path of righteousness** in the previous clause. Solomon refers to living righteously as if one were walking on a **beaten path** that is safe because it was made well. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and living righteously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 12:28 (#3)

חַיִּים & אֵל-מָוֶת

“is} life & is} no death”

In this verse, **is** indicates that what follows is the result of the preceding phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [results in life ... results in no death]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 12:28 (#7)

אֵל-מָוֶת

“is} no death”

Here, **no death** could refer to: (1) a person not dying earlier than expected, which is the opposite way of saying the same idea used for **life** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [is not dying early]; (2) a person having immortality. Alternate translation: [is immortality]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 12:28 (#5)

וְדֶרֶךְ נְתִיבָהּ

“and the way of the beaten path”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to indicate that **the way** is **the beaten path**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the way that is the beaten path]

See: Possession

Proverbs 12:28 (#2)

בְּאַרְחֵ-צִדִּיקָהּ

“In the path of righteousness”

See how you translated **the path of righteousness** in 8:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs - Chapter 13 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 13 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism

Except for 13:14, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 13:1 (#6)

וְלֵלִיץ

“but a mocking {one}”

Solomon is using the adjective **mocking** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [but a mocker]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:1 (#4)

אָב

“a father”

Here, **father** refers to the **father** of the **son** mentioned earlier in the clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [his father]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:1 (#5)

וְלִלְיָן

“but a mocking {one}”

Here, a **mocker** refers to this type of person in general, not a specific **mocker**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but any mocker]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:1 (#3)

מְמוֹסֵר & גְּעָרָה

“the instruction of & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **instruction** in 1:2 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:1 (#1)

בִּבְנוֹן הַחֶכֶם מִמּוֹסֵר אָבִי

“A wise son, the instruction of a father”

Solomon is leaving out words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A wise son listens to the instruction of a father]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:1 (#2)

בִּבְנוֹן הַחֶכֶם

“A wise son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 13:2 (#2)

יֵאָכֵל טָטוֹב

“he eats good”

Here, Solomon is speaking of a man receiving good things as though he were eating them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he receives good things]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:2 (#3)

טָטוֹב

“good”

Solomon is using the adjective **good** as a noun to mean good things. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [good things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:2 (#4)

וְנִבְכָּשׁ & הָמָס

“but the appetite of & violence”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **appetite** in 6:30, and **violence** in 3:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:2 (#6)

הָמָס

“violence”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply this word from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [eats violence] or [craves violence]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:2 (#5)

וְנִבְכָּשׁ

“but the appetite of”

Here Solomon refers to the desire of **the treacherous ones** as if it were their **appetite**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the desire of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:2 (#1)

מִפֶּה רִי אִישׁ

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man”

See how you translated the same phrase in 12:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:3 (#1)

נֹצֵר פִּי שְׁמֵר נֶפֶשׁוֹ וְשֹׁשֵׁב שֵׁשׁ שְׁפָתָיו מִחַתָּה לּוֹ

“One guarding his mouth keeps his life; one opening his lips, ruin for him”

One guarding his mouth, his, one opening his lips, and **him** here do not refer to specific people, but to types of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Anyone who guards one's mouth keeps one's life; anyone who opens one's lips is ruin for that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:3 (#3)

שֹׁמֵר בִּפְשֵׁוֹ

“keeps his life”

Here Solomon speaks of someone preserving one's **life** as if one's **life** were an object that one **keeps**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [preserves his life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:3 (#2)

נֹצֵר פִּי

“One guarding his mouth”

The phrase **guarding his mouth** is an idiom that refers to being careful about what one says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who speaks carefully]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 13:3 (#6)

פֹּשֵׁק שִׁפְתָּיו

“one opening his lips”

The phrase **opening his lips** is an idiom that could refer to: (1) speaking carelessly, which would be in contrast to the meaning of **guards his mouth** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [one who talks without thinking]; (2) speaking too much. Alternate translation: [one who talks too much]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 13:3 (#5)

פֹּשֵׁק שִׁפְתָּיו מְהַרְהֵר לוֹ

“one opening his lips, ruin for him”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would

be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [one who opens his lips keeps ruin for himself]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:3 (#4)

פֹּשֵׁק שִׁפְתָּיו מְהַרְהֵר לוֹ

“one opening his lips, ruin for him”

This clause is in strong contrast to the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [on the contrary, one who opens his lips, ruin for him]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 13:3 (#7)

מְהַרְהֵר לוֹ

“ruin for him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **ruin**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [ruins himself]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:4 (#5)

וְאֵין

“and there is nothing”

Solomon says **there is nothing** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and often gets nothing]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 13:4 (#2)

נִפְשֵׁוֹ & וְנִבְשֵׁוֹ

“his appetite & but the appetite of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **appetite** in 6:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:4 (#4)

וְאֵין

“and there is nothing”

Here Solomon implies that **there is nothing** to satisfy the **lazy** person's **craving**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and there is nothing to satisfy that craving]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:4 (#3)

מִתְאַוֶּה & נִפְשֵׁן

“his appetite is craving”

Here, **craving** describes the **appetite** of a **lazy** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he has a craving appetite] or [he craves]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:4 (#7)

תִּדְשֵׁן

“will be fattened”

Here Solomon refers to **the appetite of the diligent ones** being satisfied as if **the appetite** were a person who could be **fattened**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be satisfied]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:4 (#1)

נִפְשֵׁן עֲצֵצֵל

“A lazy one, his appetite”

A lazy one and **his** do not refer to a specific person, put to a type of person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Anyone who is lazy, that one's appetite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:4 (#6)

תִּדְשֵׁן

“will be fattened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will become fat]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:5 (#1)

צַדִּיק

“A righteous {one}”

See how you translated **A righteous one** in 9:9.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:5 (#5)

יִבְאֵץ יֵשׁ

“causes a stink”

Here Solomon refers to people causing others to feel disgust for them as if they smell bad. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes others to feel disgust for him] or [disgusts others]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:5 (#2)

דְּבַר-שֶׁשְׁקֶר

“a word of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **word** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a false word]

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:5 (#3)

דְּבַר

“a word of”

See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:5 (#4)

חֹרֶשׁ שֶׁעַ

“but a wicked {one}”

See how you translated **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:6 (#3)

תֵּם-דִּדְרֹךְ

“the blameless of way”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:20.

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:6 (#1)

צַדִּיקוּתָהּ & חֹרֶשׁ שֶׁעַ

“Righteousness & but wickedness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Righteousness** in 1:3 and **wickedness** in 4:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:6 (#2)

צַדִּיקָה תִּצְצָר תִּם־דָּרֶךְ

“Righteousness guards the blameless of way”

Here Solomon refers to people protecting themselves by acting righteously as if **Righteousness** were a person who **guards** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Being righteous enables the blameless of way to be protected] or [Those who live blamelessly protect themselves by being righteous]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:6 (#4)

תִּסְלֶלְךָ חַטָּאת

“leads a sinful one astray”

Here Solomon refers to people deliberately doing wicked things that will result in their destruction as if **wickedness** were a person who **leads** them **astray**. See how you translated the same use of **leads astray** in 12:16.

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:7 (#3)

וְהֵיוֹן רַב

“but much wealth”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but there is much wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:7 (#2)

וְאֵין כֹּל

“but there is nothing {at} all”

Solomon says **nothing at all** here as a generalization for emphasis. He means either that this person has **nothing** valuable or has very few possessions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [but has nothing valuable at all] or [but truly does not have much wealth]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 13:7 (#1)

יֵשׁ מִמְתַּעֲשֵׁר & מִמְתַּרוֹשֵׁשׁ

“There is one pretending to be rich & one pretending to be poor”

The phrases **one pretending to be rich** and **one pretending to be poor** do not refer to specific people, but to types of people. If it would be helpful, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [There are people who pretend to be rich ... people who pretend to be poor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:8 (#4)

לֹא־שָׁמַעַ

“does not hear”

Here Solomon refers to **a poor one** completely ignoring **a rebuke** as if that person did not even hear it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [ignores] or [ignores as if he did not even hear]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:8 (#2)

אִישׁ עֲשָׂרוֹ

“a man {is} his riches”

Although **a man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that could refer to either **a man** or a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person is that person's riches]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 13:8 (#5)

גִּצְרָה

“a rebuke”

Here, the word translated **rebuke** refers to a threat that someone makes against the life of **a poor one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a threat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:8 (#3)

וְיָרִישׁ

“but a poor one”

Solomon is speaking of **poor** people in general, not of one particular **poor one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but any poor person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:8 (#1)

כִּפְּכָר נֶפֶשׁ-אָדָם

“The ransom of the life of a man”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **ransom** that relates to **the life** and **the life** that relates to **a man**. If your language would not use the possessive form for these, you could use different expressions. Alternate translation: [The ransom that must be paid to redeem a man's life] or [What a man must pay to buy back his own life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:9 (#2)

אֹר-צַדִּיקִים יִשְׂמְחָה

“The light of the righteous will be glad”

Here Solomon refers to the lives of **the righteous ones** being enjoyable as if their lives were a **light** that could be **glad**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [The lives of the righteous ones will be enjoyable] or [The lives of the righteous ones will be enjoyable like a brightly shining light]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:9 (#3)

וְנֵגֶר רָשָׁעִים יִדָּעַר

“but the lamp of the wicked goes out”

Here Solomon refers to the death of **the wicked ones** as if their lives were lamps that stop burning to produce light. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but the life of the wicked ones will end] or [but the life of the wicked ones is like a lamp that will be extinguished]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:9 (#1)

אֹר & וְנֵגֶר

“The light of & but the lamp of”

The light and **the lamp** refer to lights and lamps in general, not one particular **light** and **lamp**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [The lights of ... but the lamps of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:10 (#2)

רִק-בְּבִדּוֹן יִתְּנוּ מִצָּחָה

“With presumptuousness comes only contention”

Solomon says **only** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [With presumptuousness one should expect contention]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 13:10 (#3)

וְאֵת-נְנוּעֵצִים חֵכְמָה

“but with those who are counseled, wisdom”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but with those who are counseled comes wisdom]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:10 (#4)

נְנוּעֵצִים

“those who are counseled”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [those whom people counsel]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:10 (#1)

רִק-בְּבִדּוֹן יִתְּנוּ מִצָּחָה & חֵכְמָה

“With presumptuousness comes only contention & wisdom”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **presumptuousness**, **contention**, and **wisdom**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **presumptuousness** in 11:2 and **wisdom** in 1:2. Alternate translation: [When people are presumptuous they only make people contend with each other ... being wise]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:11 (#3)

וְקִבֵּץ עַל־יָדָיו

“but one gathering by hand”

Here, **gathers by hand** could refer to: (1) gathering something gradually in small amounts as if one were gathering it in one’s **hand**. Alternate translation: [but one who gathers gradually]; (2) working hard to gather something, as if one were using one’s hands to do the work. Alternate translation: [but one who gathers by laboring]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:11 (#2)

וְקִבֵּץ עַל־יָדָיו

“but one gathering by hand”

Solomon is speaking of people who gather **by hand** in general, not of one particular person **gathering by hand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but any person who gathers by hand]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:11 (#1)

מִהֶתֶבֶל

“from emptiness”

Here, **from emptiness** refers to obtaining something easily or without effort. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [obtained easily] or [that someone gains without effort]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:11 (#4)

וַיִּרְבֶּה

“will increase”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [will increase wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:12 (#4)

תִּשְׁחָלָה בָּאָה

“a desire fulfilled”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desire**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when people get what they have wanted for a long time, it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:12 (#2)

מִתְחַלֵּשׁ וּבָאָה

“deferred & fulfilled”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that does not yet become reality ... that becomes reality] or [that does not happen ... that does happen]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:12 (#1)

תוֹחָלָה

“Hope”

See how you translated the abstract noun **hope** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:12 (#3)

מִחֲלֵה־לֵב

“makes a heart sick”

This phrase is an idiom that refers to someone despairing or feeling sad. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use an equivalent idiom in your language. Alternate translation: [makes a person sad] or [breaks a person’s heart]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 13:12 (#5)

וַיַּעַן הַחַיִּים

“but & is} a tree of life”

See how you translated **a tree of life** in 3:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:13 (#3)

יִשְׁחָלָה לָּוִי

“it will go badly for him”

The pronoun **it** here refers to the situation of **despising a word**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [by doing that, bad things will happen to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 13:13 (#2)

לִלְדָּר

“a word”

Here, **word** refers to instructions or advice that people say by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [instruction] or [people instructing him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:13 (#4)

הַהוּא יִשְׁלַם

“that one will be rewarded”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will reward that person]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:13 (#1)

כִּבְזָה

“One despising”

Solomon is speaking of people who despise advice in general, not of one particular person **who despises**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Anyone who despises]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:14 (#4)

לִלְסוֹר מִמִּפְקָשׁ מָוֶת

“to turn away from the snares of death”

Here Solomon speaks of someone avoiding dangerous situations that could result in that person dying as if that person were physically turning away from deadly **snares** that were in his path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to avoid deadly situations] or [to avoid dangers that are like traps that cause death]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:14 (#5)

לִלְסוֹר

“to turn away”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the law of the wise turns people away]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:14 (#2)

הַחֲכָמִים

“the wise”

Here Solomon is using the adjective **wise** as a noun to mean **wise** people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the wise ones]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 13:14 (#3)

מִקְקוֹר חַיִּים

“is} a fountain of life”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:11.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:14 (#1)

תּוֹרַת

“The law of”

The law here does not refer to any specific **law** but refers to lessons or instructions in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural phrase. Alternate translation: [The instruction of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:15 (#4)

אֵיתָן

“is} permanent”

Here the word translated **permanent** refers to something that is unrelenting or unchanging. The idea would be that treacherous people are obstinate in their sin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternatively, many scholars

think that a different word should be here, meaning “their destruction.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. Alternate translation: [is unrelenting] or [does not change]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:15 (#3)

וְדֶרֶךְ

“but the way of”

See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:15 (#2)

שָׂקַל & חָסֵן

“insight & favor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **insight** in 1:3 and **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:15 (#1)

שָׂקַל-טָטוּב יִתֵּן-חָסֵן

“Good insight gives favor”

Here Solomon speaks of a person receiving **favor** because that person has **Good insight** as if the **insight** were a person who could give **favor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Good insight causes the person who has it to be favored by others]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:16 (#3)

יִפְרֹשׁ אֱוִלָּה

“displays folly”

Here Solomon implies that **a stupid one displays folly** by how he acts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [displays his folly by what he says and does]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:16 (#2)

יִפְרֹשׁ אֱוִלָּה

“displays folly”

Here Solomon refers to **a stupid person** allowing other people to know how foolish he is as if his **folly** were objects that he could spread out for other people to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [makes it obvious that he is foolish]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:16 (#1)

בְּדַעַת & אֱוִלָּה

“with knowledge & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:17 (#5)

מְרַפֵּא

“causes} healing”

Here, Solomon is speaking as if the mental well-being that **an envoy of faithfulness** causes were physical **healing**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes peace] or [gives his senders confidence]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:17 (#4)

וְצִיר אֱמוּנָה

“but an envoy of faithfulness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe an **envoy** that is characterized by **faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but a faithful envoy]

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:17 (#3)

בְּרָע

“into evil”

Here, **evil** refers to trouble that someone might experience as a result of **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into trouble]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:17 (#2)

יִפְּסֵל בְּרָע

“falls into evil”

Here Solomon refers to someone experiencing **evil** as if it were a place into which that person **falls**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [experiences evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:17 (#1)

מלאַךְ הַרָשָׁע

“A wicked messenger”

Here, **wicked messenger** specifically refers to a **messenger** who is unreliable. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [An unreliable messenger]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:18 (#2)

פּוֹרֵעַ & וְשׁוֹמֵר

“are for} one avoiding & but one keeping”

Here, **one avoiding** and **one keeping** refer to people who do these things in general, but not to any specific **one**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [are for those who avoid ... but those who keep]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:18 (#4)

יִכְבֹּד

“will be honored”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will honor]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:18 (#1)

הָרִישׁ נִזְקָלוֹן & מוֹסָר & תּוֹכֵחַת

“Poverty and shame & correction & a rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Poverty** in 6:11, **shame** in 6:33, and **correction** and **rebuke** in 3:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:18 (#3)

וְשׁוֹמֵר

“but one keeping”

Here Solomon refers to someone accepting **a rebuke** from someone else as if **a rebuke** were an object that one **keeps**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who accepts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:19 (#3)

וְתוֹעֵבָה כְּסִילִים

“but the abomination of the stupid”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe an **abomination** that relates to **stupid** people. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [but what stupid people consider to be an abomination]

See: Possession

Proverbs 13:19 (#4)

סָוֵר מֵרָע

“is} turning away from evil”

See how you translated “turn away from evil” in 3:7.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:19 (#1)

לְנַפְשׁוֹ

“to the self”

Here Solomon implies that **self** refers to the same person who has the **desire** mentioned earlier in the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to one's self]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:19 (#2)

וְתוֹעֵבָה & מֵרָע

“but the abomination of & from evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **abomination** in 3:32 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:20 (#3)

יָרוּעַ

“will be harmed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will experience harm]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:20 (#1)

הלוך & ורעָה

“One walking & but one associating with”

One walking and **one associating with** refer to people who do these things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Those who walk ... but those who associate with]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:20 (#2)

הלוך

“One walking”

See how you translated the same use of “walk” in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:21 (#2)

תִּרְדֹּף

“will pursue”

Here Solomon refers to **sinners** experiencing **Evil** as if **Evil** were a person who could **pursue** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will happen to] or [will be experienced by]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:21 (#3)

יִשְׁלַם

“will reward”

Here Solomon refers to **righteous ones** experiencing **goodness** as if **goodness** were a person who could **reward** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will happen to] or [will be experienced by]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:21 (#1)

רַעָה & טוֹב

“Evil & goodness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Evil** and **goodness**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **Evil** in 1:16. Alternate translation: [What is evil ... what is good]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 13:22 (#4)

וְצַפּוֹן לְלִצְדִּיק הַחַיִּל חוֹטָא

“but the wealth of a sinner is stored up for the righteous”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but the righteous will receive the wealth that a sinner has stored up] or [but the wealth that a sinner has stored up will go to the righteous]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:22 (#2)

יְהִי חַיִּל בְּנֵי־בְנֵי

“will cause sons of sons to inherit”

Solomon is leaving out words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the next clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [will cause sons of sons to inherit his wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:22 (#1)

טוֹב & לְלִצְדִּיק חוֹטָא

“The good & a sinner & for the righteous”

The good, **a sinner**, and **the righteous** refer to types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any good person ... any sinner ... for righteous people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:22 (#3)

בְּנֵי־בְנֵי

“sons of sons”

Here Solomon implies that **sons of sons** refers to the grandchildren of **The good** mentioned earlier in the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [their sons of sons]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 13:23 (#2)

וַיִּשָּׁשׁ בְּנִסְפָּהּ

“but there is {food} being swept away”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but there is the poor ones' food being swept away]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 13:23 (#3)

בְּנִסְפָּהּ בְּלֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“being swept away by no justice”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that injustice sweeps away]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 13:23 (#4)

בְּנִסְפָּהּ

“being swept away”

Here, **swept away** refers to completely removing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that is removed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:23 (#5)

בְּלֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“by no justice”

Here Solomon refers to **no justice** as if it were a person who causes the food of poor people to be **swept away**. He means that injustice results in poor people lacking food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of injustice] or [because people act unjustly]

See: Personification

Proverbs 13:23 (#1)

בְּנִי

“is in} the unplowed field of”

An **unplowed field** is a **field** that has not been prepared for growing crops. If your readers would not be familiar with plowing fields for farming, you could use the name of a similar farming practice in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is in the field that has not been prepared for food production by]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 13:24 (#4)

שֶׁחֵרְרוּ מוֹסֵר

“diligently seeks him {with} discipline”

Here Solomon refers to a parent **diligently** disciplining that parent's child as if that parent were **diligently** seeking that child **with discipline**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [diligently disciplines him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 13:24 (#2)

שׂוֹנֵא

“hates”

Solomon says **hates** here as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [acts unlovingly toward]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 13:24 (#3)

בְּנִי וְאִהְבֹּהוּ שֶׁחֵרְרוּ

“his son, but one who loves him diligently seeks him”

Although the term **son** and **him** are masculine, Solomon is using those words in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [his child, but one who loves that child diligently seeks that child]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 13:24 (#1)

חֹשֶׁשֶׁד שֶׁשָּׁבֵטוֹ שׂוֹנֵא בְּנִי וְאִהְבֹּהוּ שֶׁחֵרְרוּ מוֹסֵר

“One who withholds his rod hates his son, but one who loves him diligently seeks him {with} discipline”

Here the terms **One who withholds, his, one who loves**, and **him** do not refer to specific people, but refer to these types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Those who withhold their rods hate their sons, but those who love them diligently seek them with discipline]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:25 (#1)

צדִיק & נפשִׁו

“A righteous {one & his appetite”

A righteous one and **his** here do not refer to specific people, but refer to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any righteous one ... that person's appetite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 13:25 (#3)

וּבֶטֶן רְשָׁעִים תִּחָסֵר

“but the stomach of the wicked will lack”

Here Solomon refers to **the wicked** always being hungry as if their stomachs **lack**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the wicked ones will not have enough] or [but the hunger of the wicked ones will not be satisfied]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 13:25 (#2)

וּבֶטֶן

“but the stomach of”

The word **stomach** represents stomachs in general, not one particular **stomach**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but the stomachs of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 14 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 14 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism

Except for 14:7, 10, 13, 17, 26, 27, and 34, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 14:1 (#2)

בְּנִתָּה בִּיתָהּ

“builds her house”

Here Solomon refers to a woman making her family prosper as if she were building a **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes her family to prosper]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:1 (#1)

חֲכָמוֹת נָשִׁים בְּנִתָּה בִּיתָהּ

“The wisest of women builds her house”

The wisest of women and **her** here do not refer to a specific person, but refer to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Those women who are most wise build their houses]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:1 (#4)

תִּהְרֹסָנָהּ

“tears it down”

Here Solomon refers to a woman ruining her family as if she were tearing **down** a house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [harms it] or [destroys it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:1 (#3)

וְאִנּוּלִית בְּיָדֶיהָ תִּהְרֹסָנָהּ

“but a foolish woman tears it down with her hands”

Here, **a foolish woman** and **her** do not refer to a specific person, but refer to a type of person in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [but those women who are foolish tear it down with their hands]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:1 (#5)

בְּיָדֶיהָ

“with her hands”

Here, **hands** refers to what a person does, which often involves using **hands**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by her deeds] or [by what she does]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:2 (#1)

הוֹלֵלֵךְ בְּבִישׁוֹ & וְנִלְלֹז דְּרָכָיו

“The one walking in his uprightness & but the one crooked in his ways”

One walking, his, and the one crooked refers to types of people in general, not to any specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who walks in uprightness ... but any person who is crooked in his ways]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:2 (#2)

הוֹלֵלֵךְ בְּבִישׁוֹ

“The one walking in his uprightness”

Here Solomon refers to someone behaving in an upright manner as if that person were **walking in his uprightness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [One who conducts his life in an upright manner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:2 (#3)

וְנִלְלֹז דְּרָכָיו

“but the one crooked in his ways”

Here Solomon uses the phrase **crooked in his ways** to refer to someone who acts deceptively. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **crooked** in 2:15. Alternate translation: [but one who is deceptive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:3 (#1)

בְּפִי־אַוִּיל הַחִטָּר גִּאְוֹנָה

“In the mouth of a fool {is} a rod of pride”

In this clause, Solomon refers to what **a fool** says with his **mouth** resulting in him being punished with **a rod** as if he were offering the rod for his punishment along with the words that come out of his mouth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Because of what a fool says, he is punished for pride] or [A fool is punished because of the proud things he says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:3 (#2)

בְּפִי־אַוִּיל

“In the mouth of a fool”

Here, **mouth** represents what a person says with his mouth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In what a fool says]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:3 (#3)

הַחִטָּר גִּאְוֹנָה

“{is} a rod of pride”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **rod** that is used to punish someone for having **pride**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is a rod for punishing proud people]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:3 (#4)

וּשְׂפָתָיו

“but the lips of”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:3 (#5)

תִּשְׁמְרוּם

“will preserve them”

Alternate translation: [will keep them from harm] or [will keep them safe]

Proverbs 14:4 (#6)

שׁוֹר

“an ox”

Here, the word **ox** represents oxen in general, not one particular **ox**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression, as in the UST.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:4 (#2)

אֲבִיבִים

“is} a trough of”

A **trough** is a container that holds food for domesticated animals such as **cattle**. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal food container, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is a food container of]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 14:4 (#1)

אֲבִיבִים כְּבֵר

“is} a trough of cleanness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **trough** that is characterized by **cleanness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is a clean trough]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:4 (#3)

וְרֵב

“but an abundance of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abundance** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:4 (#4)

בְּכֹחַ שׁוֹר

“is} by the strength of an ox”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is produced by the strength of an ox]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 14:4 (#5)

בְּכֹחַ שׁוֹר

“is} by the strength of an ox”

Here, **strength** refers to the work **an ox** does that involves using **strength**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is by the work done by a strong ox]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:5 (#3)

וַיִּפְּחֵהּ כִּכְנֹבָיִים

“but & breathes out lies”

See how you translated **breathes out lies** in 6:19.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:5 (#2)

עֵדֵד שֶׁקֶר

“a witness of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:19.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:5 (#1)

עֵדֵד אֱמֻנָּה

“A witness of faithfulness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **witness** who is characterized by **faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A faithful witness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:6 (#2)

בְּקֵשׁ

“seeks”

Here, **wisdom** is described as if it were an object that people, trying to be wise, could “seek.” See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:6 (#3)

חֵכְמָה וְיֹדְעַת

“wisdom & but knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:6 (#1)

לִלְזֹן & לְבַבּוֹן

“A mocker & for the understanding one”

See how you translated **a mocker** in 9:7 and **the understanding one** in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:6 (#5)

וְדַעַת

“but knowledge”

Solomon is leaving out a word that, in many languages, a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but finding knowledge] or [but acquiring knowledge]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 14:6 (#4)

וְאֵין

“and there is none”

Here Solomon means that **a mocker** cannot acquire **wisdom**, not that **wisdom** does not exist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he cannot find it] or [and there is no wisdom for him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:7 (#1)

לֵלֶךְ מִמֶּנֶּגֶד לְאִישׁ כְּסִיּוֹל וּבִלְאִי־דַעַת שְׁפֹתֵי־דָעַת

“Go before a man of stupidity, and you will not know lips of knowledge”

Here, **Go** is an imperative, but it begins a conditional statement rather than a command. It is a warning; it is not something that Solomon wants anyone to do. Use a form in your language that communicates a conditional statement. Alternate translation: [If you go before a man of stupidity, then you will not know lips of knowledge]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 14:7 (#2)

לֵלֶךְ מִמֶּנֶּגֶד

“Go before”

Here, **Go before** means to go into the presence of this person, not to go somewhere in front of this person or to go somewhere in advance of this person. Alternate translation: [Go into the presence of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:7 (#5)

שְׁפֹתֵי־דָעַת

“lips of knowledge”

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by moving their **lips**. Solomon is referring to words that express **knowledge**. See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [words that express knowledge]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:7 (#4)

לְאִישׁ

“a man of”

Here, **a man** represents a type of people in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any person of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:7 (#3)

לְאִישׁ כְּסִיּוֹל

“a man of stupidity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **stupidity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a stupid man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:8 (#4)

כְּסִילִים

“the stupid”

Solomon is using the adjective **stupid** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [foolish people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 14:8 (#3)

דרכו

“his way”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:8 (#1)

הַכְּמָמָה וְהַאֲנִלּוּת & מְרָמָה

“The wisdom of & but the folly of & is} deceit”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2, **folly** in 5:23, and **deceit** in 11:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:8 (#2)

עָעָרוֹם

“a prudent {one”

See how you translated this phrase in 12:16.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 14:9 (#3)

רָצוֹן

“is} favor”

Here Solomon implies that this **favor** is from Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is Yahweh’s favor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:9 (#1)

אֲשָׁמָם

“the guilt offering”

Mocking **the guilt offering** implies that **The foolish mock** the need for people to offer **the guilt offering** in order to ask Yahweh to forgive them for sinning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [offering guilt offerings to Yahweh for forgiveness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:9 (#2)

רָצוֹן

“is} favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:10 (#1)

לֵלֶב

“A heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The inner being of a person]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:10 (#2)

מִרְרָתָהּ & וּבִשְׂמֵחֶתָהּ

“the bitterness of & and in its joy”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **bitterness** and **joy**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [how bitter it is ... and in its feeling joyful,]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:11 (#3)

יִפְרֹחַ

“will flourish”

Here Solomon refers to a family prospering as if it were a plant with blooming flowers that **flourish**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will prosper]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:11 (#2)

יִשְׁמָד

“will be destroyed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will destroy]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:11 (#1)

בֵּיתָהּ & וְאֹהֶלָהּ

“The house of & but the tent of”

In this verse, **house** and **tent** refer to the people who live in them. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The household of ... but the household of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:12 (#1)

דִּרְדָּר יָשָׁר

“a straight road”

Solomon is speaking of how a person lives as if that were a **road** or path that the person was walking along. Here, **straight** refers to the road being easy rather than being morally right. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [an easy way to live]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:12 (#4)

וְאַחֲרֵיהֶתָּה

“but its end”

Here, the **end** of this **road** refers to the final result of living in this way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but its result]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:12 (#5)

דִּרְכֵי־מָוֶת

“is} the ways of death”

Here Solomon uses **ways** to refer to the destiny of those people who live according to what they have chosen as **a straight road**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the destiny of death]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:12 (#2)

לִפְנֵי־אָדָם

“to the face of a man”

Here, **to the face of** refers to what is directly in front of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [right in front of a man]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:12 (#3)

אָדָם

“a man”

The word **man** represents a person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:12 (#6)

דִּרְכֵי־מָוֶת

“is} the ways of death”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the ways** that are **death**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is the ways that are death] or [is the destiny that is death]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:13 (#2)

לֵב

“a heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person's feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [a person's inner being]

Proverbs 14:13 (#1)

בְּשִׂחָחוֹק & שְׂמֵחָה תוֹגֶה

“in laughter & joy {may be} grief”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **laughter**, **joy**, and **grief**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [when laughing ... feeling joyful may be feeling sad]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:14 (#1)

סָסוּג לֵב & אָדָם טוֹב

“A backsliding heart & a good man”

A backsliding heart and **a good man** each refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person backsliding in heart ... any good person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:14 (#2)

סָסֹג לֵלֶב

“A backsliding heart”

Here Solomon refers to the person who has stopped behaving righteously and is now behaving wickedly as if that person were a **backsliding heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The person who stops living righteously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:14 (#5)

מִדְרָכָיו

“from his ways”See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:14 (#4)

יִשָּׁבַע

“will be filled”

In this clause, the word translated **filled** implies that the person who has decided to live unrighteously will fully experience the negative consequences of **his ways**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will experience all the consequences] or [will be fully repaid]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:14 (#3)

יִשָּׁבַע

“will be filled”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will fill]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:14 (#6)

וְאִמְעָלָיו אֲאִישׁ טוֹב

“but a good man, from his deeds”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language.

Alternate translation: [but a good man will be filled from his deeds]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 14:15 (#3)

לְאִשְׁרוֹ

“his step”

Here, **step** refers to a person's behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his behavior] or [his actions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:15 (#2)

דְּבָרָה

“word”See how you translated the same use of **word** in 12:25.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:15 (#1)

פֶּסֶתִי & וְאִשְׁרָיוֹם

“A naive one & but a prudent {one}”

A naive one and **a prudent one** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a prudent one** in 12:16. Alternate translation: [Any naive person ... but any prudent person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:16 (#2)

וְסִסָּר מִרָגַע

“and turns away from trouble”

Solomon is speaking as if **trouble** were an object that **A wise one** physically **turns away** to walk in a different direction from. He means that he decides not to join in situations that could get him into trouble. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and does not take part in troubling situations]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:16 (#3)

מִתְעַבְּבֵר וּבֹטָח

“interferes and is confident”

The phrase **interferes and is confident** expresses a single idea. The word **confident** tells more about how the stupid one **interferes**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [carelessly intrudes] or [overconfidently interferes]

See: Hendiadys

Proverbs 14:16 (#1)

הַכֹּכֵם & הַיָּסוּסִיל

“A wise {one & but a stupid {one”

See how you translated **a wise one** in 1:5 and **a stupid one** in 10:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:17 (#3)

אִנּוּלִית

“folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:17 (#1)

קִצְר־אַפִּים

“One} short of nostrils”

The phrase **short of nostrils** is an idiom that refers to a person who becomes angry quickly. The word **nostrils** means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose, causing his **nostrils** to open wide. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [One who easily vents his spleen] or [One who becomes angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:17 (#4)

וְאִישׁ קִמְזֻמּוֹת

“and a man of schemes”

See how you translated **a man of schemes** in 12:2.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:17 (#5)

יִשְׁנֵא

“is hated”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language, as in the UST.

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:17 (#2)

קִצְר־אַפִּים & וְאִישׁ קִמְזֻמּוֹת

“One} short of nostrils & and a man of schemes”

One short of nostrils and **a man of schemes** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a man of schemes** in 12:2. Alternate translation: [Any person short of nostrils ... and any person of schemes] or [Any person who gets angry quickly ... and any person who schemes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:18 (#2)

אִנּוּלִית & דַּעַת

“folly & knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **folly** in 5:23 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:18 (#1)

נְחֻלָּו & אִנּוּלִית

“inherit folly”

Here Solomon speaks of **Naive ones** becoming foolish as if **folly** were property or wealth that they could **inherit** from a family member. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **inherit** in 3:35. Alternate translation: [become foolish]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:18 (#3)

יְכִתְּרוֹ דַּעַת

“will wear a crown of knowledge”

Here Solomon speaks of people being rewarded with **knowledge** as if **knowledge** were a **crown** they **will wear**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [will be rewarded with knowledge]

or [will be rewarded with knowledge as if it were a crown that they wore]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:19 (#2)

לפני

“to the face of”

Here, the word **face** represents the presence of a person by association with the way people can see the **face** of someone who is present. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:19 (#5)

צדיק

“the righteous one”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 10:3.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:19 (#4)

על-שערי

“at the gates of”

Here, **gates** refers to the doorway of the house of **the righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [at the gates of the house of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:19 (#1)

שהתו

“will bow down”

To **bow down** is a symbolic action that shows humble respect or submission to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [will bow down to show respect]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 14:19 (#3)

וירשעים על-שערי צדיק

“and the wicked at the gates of the righteous one”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be

complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the wicked will bow down at the gates of the righteous one]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 14:20 (#2)

גם-לרעהו יושב רגש

“One who is poor is hated even by his neighbor”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Even a poor person's neighbor hates him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:20 (#1)

לרעהו & רגש & עשיר

“One who is poor & by his neighbor & the rich”

The expressions **One who is poor**, **his neighbor**, and **the rich** each refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who is poor ... by that person's neighbors ... any rich person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:21 (#1)

כי-לרעהו חוטא ומחונן עניים אשריו

“The one despising his neighbor sins, but the one who shows favor to the lowly, happy {is} he”

The one despising, **his neighbor**, **the one who shows favor**, and **he** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who despises that person's neighbors sins, but any person who shows favor to lowly people, happy is that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:21 (#2)

ומחונן

“but the one who shows favor to”

Here, **shows favor** refers to being kind to someone, not to favoring one person over another. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but the one who is compassionate to]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:22 (#3)

וְהַחֲסִיד וְהַאֲמִינָה חֲרָשֵׁי טוֹב

“But covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness {are} devisers of good”

The relationship between **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness** and **devisers of good** is unspecified. This line could mean: (1) **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness** are characteristics of the **devisers of good**. Alternate translation: [But devisers of good show covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness] or (2) **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness** are benefits that **devisers of good** will receive from others. Alternate translation: [But covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness will benefit devisers of good]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:22 (#1)

הֲלוֹא־יִיָּתְעוּ חֲרָשֵׁי רָעָה

“Do not devisers of evil go astray”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Devisers of evil certainly go astray!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 14:22 (#2)

רָעָה וְהַחֲסִיד וְהַאֲמִינָה & טוֹב

“evil & But covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness & good”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **evil** in 1:16, **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** in 3:3, and **good** in 11:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:23 (#4)

וְדִבְרֵי־שִׁשְׁפֹּתַיִם

“but the word of lips”

Here, **the word of lips** represents what people say by using their lips. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25. Alternate translation: [but just talking]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:23 (#1)

עֲצָב & מוֹתָר & לְמַחְסוֹר

“toil & profit & is & for lack”

See how you translated the abstract nouns “toils” in 5:10, **profit** in 3:14, and **lack** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:23 (#2)

וְדִבְרֵי־שִׁשְׁפֹּתַיִם

“but the word of lips”

Here Solomon implies that this refers to **the word of lips** without any **toil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but the word of lips without toil] or [but the word of lips by itself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:23 (#3)

וְדִבְרֵי־שִׁשְׁפֹּתַיִם

“but the word of lips”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the word** that is spoken with **lips**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but the word spoken by lips]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:23 (#5)

אֲדָ־לְמַחְסוֹר

“is} only for lack”

Here, **is only** indicates that **lack** is the result of the preceding phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [results only in lack]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 14:24 (#1)

עֲטָרָה

“The crown of”

Here Solomon speaks of the reward of **the wise ones** as if it were a **crown** they wear. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated the similar use of **crown** in 14:18. Alternate translation: [The reward of] or [The reward that is like a crown of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:24 (#3)

אִנּוּלַת & אִנּוּלַת

“the folly of & is} folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:24 (#2)

אִנּוּלַת כְּסִילִלִים

“the folly of stupid ones”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:8.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:25 (#3)

קְזָבִים

“lies”

The implication is that these **lies** are false accusations that harm people. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:25 (#2)

וַיִּפְּסֶם קְזָבִים

“but & breathes out lies”

See how you translated **breathes out lies** in 6:19.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:25 (#1)

עֵד אֱמֻנָה

“A witness of truth”

See how you translated the same use of **A witness of** in 14:5.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:26 (#4)

וְלִבָּנָיו

“and for his sons”

Here, **his** refers to any person who fears Yahweh. Alternate translation: [and for the sons of the person who fears Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:26 (#6)

יְהוָה מְחֻסָּה

“he will be a refuge”

The pronoun **he** refers to: (1) Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will be a refuge] or (2) the fear of Yahweh. Alternate translation: [that fear will be their refuge]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:26 (#2)

בִּירְאֵאת יְהוָה

“In the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:26 (#3)

מִבְטָח

“is & confidence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **confidence** in 3:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:26 (#5)

וְלִבָּנָיו

“and for his sons”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, Solomon is using the word here in a generic sense that could refer to either male or female children. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and for his children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 14:26 (#1)

בִּירְאֵאת יְהוָה מִבְטָח-עֹז

“In the fear of Yahweh {is} strong confidence”

Here Solomon refers to someone having **confidence** because that person has **the fear of Yahweh** as if **the fear of Yahweh** were a location in which **confidence** resided. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [People who fear Yahweh have strong confidence in him] or [By fearing Yahweh, people have strong confidence in him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:26 (#7)

מחסה

“a refuge”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **refuge**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [someone who protects them]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:27 (#3)

לססור ממקשי מות

“to turn away from the snares of death”

See how you translated the same clause in 13:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:27 (#1)

יראת יהוה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7 and in the previous verse.

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:27 (#2)

מקור חיים

“is} a fountain of life”

See how you translated **a fountain of life** in 10:11 and 13:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:28 (#1)

ברב-עם הדרת-מלך

“With the abundance of people {is} the majesty of a king”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **abundance** and **majesty**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [An abundant number of people is what makes a king majestic]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:28 (#2)

מלך & רזון

“a king & the ruler”

Here, **a king** and **the ruler** both refer to people who rule over others in general, not to specific kings. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any king ... any ruler]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:28 (#3)

ובאפס

“but with the end of”

Here, **end** refers to a lack of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but with the decline of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:29 (#5)

מרים

“lifts up”

Here Solomon speaks of someone publicly showing **folly** as if **folly** were an object that someone **lifts up** for everyone to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [publicly displays] or [lets everyone observe]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:29 (#3)

תבונה & אולת

“understanding & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **understanding** in 1:2 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:29 (#1)

אחד אפים & יצר-רר

“One long of nostrils & but one short of spirit”

One long of nostrils and **one short of spirit** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person long of nostrils ... but any person short of spirit]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:29 (#4)

יצר-רר

“but one short of spirit”

The phrase **short of spirit** is an idiom that refers to a type of person who gets angry quickly. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but a short-tempered person] or [but one who becomes angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:29 (#2)

אֶאָרֶךְ אַפִּים

“One long of nostrils”

The phrase **long of nostrils** is an idiom that refers to a type of person who does not become angry quickly. The word “nostrils” means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose, causing his nostrils to open wide. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [One who does not easily vent his spleen] or [One who does not become angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 14:30 (#2)

לֵלֶב מִרְפָּא

“A heart of healing”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer to a person’s inner being or mind. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [A peaceful liver] or [A tranquil mind]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 14:30 (#5)

וְיִקְרַב עֲצָמָיו קִנְיָה

“but envy {is} the decay of bones”

Here Solomon is saying that **envy** harms a person’s health like a disease that causes **the decay of bones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but envy ruins a person’s health] or [but

envy harms one’s health like disease decays one’s bones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:30 (#4)

חַיִּי בְּבָשָׂרִים

“{is} life to bodies”

Here, **life to bodies** refers to a something being healthy for a person’s **body**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is healthy for one’s body] or [causes one’s body to be healthy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:30 (#6)

קִנְיָה

“envy”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **envy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [being envious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:30 (#1)

לֵלֶב מִרְפָּא

“A heart of healing”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **heart** that is characterized by **healing**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A healed heart] or [A sound heart]

See: Possession

Proverbs 14:30 (#3)

לֵלֶב

“A heart of”

A heart of healing refers to people’s hearts in general, not to a specific **heart**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any heart of ... any body]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:31 (#3)

חִרְרָה עֲשֵׂהוּ

“taunts his maker”

Since God made the lowly person in his image, to disrespect God's work is to disrespect God. So in that sense, oppressing a lowly person is the same as taunting God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [disrespects the one who made him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:31 (#4)

עשֶׂהוּ

“his maker”

The pronoun **his** refers to the **lowly one**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the one who made the lowly one]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:31 (#2)

דָּדֵל

“a lowly one”

The phrase **lowly one** refers to a poor person. See how you translated the same use of “lowly ones” in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:31 (#7)

חֲנֹן

“one showing favor to”

See how you translated the same use of “shows favor to” in 14:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:31 (#6)

וְיִמְכַבְּדוּ

“but & honors him”

Here, **him** refers to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but ... honors Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:31 (#1)

עֹשֶׂה דָּדֵל & חֲנֹן אֶבְיוֹן

“An oppressor of a lowly one & his maker & one showing favor to a needy one”

An oppressor, a lowly one, his, one showing favor, and a needy one refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could

use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any oppressor of any lowly person ... that person's maker ... any person who shows favor to any needy person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:31 (#5)

עֹשֶׂהוּ

“his maker”

Here, **maker** refers to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [God, his maker] or [his maker, who is God] or [his Maker]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 14:32 (#3)

יִדְחֵהוּ

“is thrust down”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [thrusts himself down]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:32 (#4)

יִדְחֵהוּ

“is thrust down”

Here Solomon refers to a person's life becoming ruined or destroyed as if that person were **thrust down**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “thrown down” in 10:8. Alternate translation: [is destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:32 (#2)

בְּרָעָתוֹ & בְּמוֹתוֹ

“By his evil & in his death”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **evil** in 1:16 and **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:32 (#6)

בְּמוֹתוֹ

“in his death”

Here Solomon speaks of the time when someone dies as if **death** were a place where that person enters. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when dying]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:32 (#5)

וְחִסְטָה & צְדִיק

“but the righteous {one} finds refuge”

Here Solomon speaks of **refuge** as if it were an object that someone **finds**. He means that someone becomes safe or protected. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the righteous one is protected]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:32 (#1)

בְּרָעוֹתָיו & רְשָׁעוֹתָיו & צְדִיק

“By his evil the wicked {one & the righteous {one & in his death”

Here, **his**, **the wicked one**, and **the righteous one** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **the wicked one** in 3:33 and **the righteous one** in 10:16. Alternate translation: [By the evil of any wicked person that person ... any righteous person ... in that person's death]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:33 (#4)

תִּדְרַע

“she will be known”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will know her]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 14:33 (#3)

חִכְמָה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:33 (#1)

בְּלִבְּךָ נִבְנוֹן תִּנְנוּחַ חִכְמָה

“In the heart of the understanding one rests wisdom”

Here Solomon refers to **the understanding one** thinking wisely as if **wisdom** were an object that **rests** inside that person's **heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [The understanding one thinks with wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:33 (#5)

תִּדְרַע

“she will be known”

Here, **she** refers to **wisdom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wisdom will be known]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 14:33 (#2)

נִבְנוֹן

“the understanding one”

See how you translated **the understanding one** in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 14:34 (#1)

צְדִיקָה & יִחְסִיד & חַטָּאת

“Righteousness & but sin {is} shame”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Righteousness** in 1:3, **sin** in 5:22, and **shame** in 6:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:34 (#3)

לְאֻמִּים

“for peoples”

The plural use of **peoples** here refers to several groups of people that could also be called “nations” or “countries.” See how you translated “people” in 11:14.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 14:34 (#2)

תְּרוֹמָם-גָּגוּי

“raises a nation”

Here Solomon refers to a **nation** becoming great as if it were an object that **Righteousness raises** up. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “raised up” in 11:11. Alternate translation: [makes a nation great]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 14:35 (#1)

רָצוֹן & מִשְׁכָּכִיל וְאִעֲבֹרְתָתוֹ

“The delight of & who has insight, but his rage”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **delight** in 8:30, **insight** in 1:3, and **rage** in 11:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 14:35 (#2)

מֶמֶלֶךְ לְעֶעֱבֹד & וְאִעֲבֹרְתָתוֹ תִּהְיֶה מְבִישׁ

“a king {is} for the servant & but his rage is {for} one who acts shamefully”

Here, **a king**, **the servant**, **his**, and **one who acts shamefully** refer to types of people, not to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any king is for any servant ... but any king's rage is for any person who acts shamefully]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 15 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 15 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Contrasting parallelism

Except for 15:3, 10-12, 16-17, 23-24, 30-31, and 33, all the proverbs in this chapter consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other.

Proverbs 15:1 (#3)

יִשְׁשִׁיב חֲמָמָה

“turns back heat”

The phrase is an idiom that refers to decreasing a person's anger as if that anger were **heat** that someone **turns back**. The word **heat** means “anger” by association with the way that an angry person's body increases in **heat**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [decreases anger] or [causes an angry person to become calm]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:1 (#5)

יִעֲלֶה-אָף

“lifts up a nose”

The phrase is an idiom that refers to increasing a person's anger. The word **nose** means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his **nose**. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [increases anger] or [causes an angry person to become angrier]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:1 (#2)

מִצְנֵה-רִרְדָּה & וּדְבַר-עֲטָעָב

“A gentle answer & but a word of pain”

A gentle answer and **a word of pain** refer to types of things people say, not to a specific **answer** or **word**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any gentle answer ... but any word of pain]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:1 (#4)

וּדְבַר-עֲטָעָב

“but a word of pain”

The phrase **a word of pain** refers to something that is spoken harshly, as if what is spoken would cause **pain** to the listener. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but what is spoken harshly] or [a hurtful word]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:1 (#1)

מִצְנֵה-רִרְדָּה יִשְׁשִׁיב חֲמָמָה וּדְבַר-עֲטָעָב יִעֲלֶה-אָף

“A gentle answer turns back heat, but a word of pain lifts up a nose”

In this verse, Solomon implies that the **gentle answer** and **word of pain** are spoken to an angry person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A gentle answer spoken to an angry person turns back that person's heat, but a word of pain spoken to an angry person lifts up that person's nose]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:2 (#1)

לְשׁוֹן חָכְמִים & וּפְּהִי כֹסִילִלִים

“The tongue of the wise & but the mouth of the stupid”

The **tongue of the wise ones** and the **mouth of stupid ones** refer to what these types of people say using their tongues and mouths, not to a specific **tongue** or **mouth**. See how you translated similar phrases in 12:18 and in 10:6. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:2 (#4)

וּפְּהִי כֹסִילִלִים יִבְבֵּיעַ אֲנָלָה

“but the mouth of the stupid gushes forth folly”

Here Solomon refers to **stupid** people always saying foolish things as if their mouths were places from which **folly gushes forth** like flowing water. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the mouths of stupid ones are always speaking folly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:2 (#2)

חֵטִיב דָּעָה

“makes knowledge good”

The phrase **makes knowledge good** refers to speaking **knowledge** in a way that **makes knowledge** pleasant or attractive to others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [makes knowledge pleasing to others]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:2 (#3)

דָּעָה & אֲנָלָה

“knowledge & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:3 (#2)

רָעִים וְטוֹבִים

“the evil and the good”

Solomon is using the adjectives **evil** and **good** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases, as in the UST.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:3 (#1)

בְּכָל־מְקוֹם עֵינֵי יְהוָה

“The eyes of Yahweh {are} in every place”

Here Solomon refers to Yahweh's ability to see everything as if Yahweh had **eyes** that were located **in every place**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh sees what is happening everywhere]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:4 (#2)

מְרַפֵּא לְלִשׁוֹן

“A healing tongue”

A **healing tongue** refers to what someone says that soothes the listener. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **tongue** in 6:17. Alternate translation: [The comforting thing someone says]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:4 (#3)

עֵץ חַיִּים

“is} a tree of life”

See how you translated **a tree of life** in 3:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:4 (#5)

שִׁשְׁבֶּר בְּרוּחַ

“**is} a breaking in the spirit**”

The phrase **a breaking in the spirit** is an idiom that refers to making a person despair. If it would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [makes a person feel down in the dumps] or [makes a person despair]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:4 (#4)

וְסִגְלָה בִּבְיָה

“**but crookedness in it**”

Here Solomon refers to deceitful speech as if it were a crooked tongue. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the deceitful thing someone says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:4 (#1)

מְרַפֵּא לְלִשׁוֹן & וְסִגְלָה בִּבְיָה שִׁשְׁבֶּר בְּרוּחַ

“**A healing tongue & but crookedness in it {is} a breaking in the spirit**”

A healing tongue, it, and a breaking in the spirit do not refer to specific things but represent these things in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any healing tongue ... but crookedness in any such tongue is what breaks spirits]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:5 (#2)

מוֹסֵר & תּוֹכֵחַת

“**the correction of & rebuke**”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** in 3:11 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:5 (#3)

וְשִׁמְמָה תּוֹכֵחַת

“**but one who keeps rebuke**”

See how you translated **one who keeps rebuke** in 13:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:5 (#1)

אִוִּיל & אָבִיו וְשִׁמְמָה תּוֹכֵחַת

“**A fool & his father, but one who keeps rebuke**”

A fool, his, and one who keeps rebuke do not refer to specific people but represent types of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any fool ... that fool's father, but any person who keeps a rebuke]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:6 (#1)

בֵּית צַדִּיק & וּבְתוֹבָאֵת רִשָּׁע

“**The house of the righteous & but in the harvest of the wicked**”

The house of the righteous and **the harvest of the wicked** do not refer to specific things and people, but represent those things and types of people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any house of righteous people ... but any harvest of wicked people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:6 (#2)

וּבְתוֹבָאֵת רִשָּׁע נִצְכָּרַת

“**but in the harvest of the wicked is being troubled**”

Here Solomon refers to **the harvest of the wicked** causing **the wicked** to be **troubled** as if **being troubled** were an object located **in the harvest**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the harvest of the wicked causes them trouble]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:7 (#3)

דַּעַת

“**knowledge**”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:7 (#4)

וְלֵב כְּסִילִים

“**but the heart of the stupid**”

See how you translated **the heart of stupid ones** in 12:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:7 (#2)

יִזְרֹי דְדָעַת

“scatter knowledge”

Here Solomon refers to teaching other people knowledge as if **knowledge** were the seeds that a farmer scatters to plant in a field. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [teach others knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:7 (#1)

שִׁפְתֵי תֵי חֲכָמִים

“The lips of the wise”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:3.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:8 (#1)

תָּזִבַּח & וְתַפְלִילָה

“The sacrifice of & but the prayer of”

The sacrifice and **the prayer** represent sacrifices and prayers in general, not one particular **sacrifice** or **prayer**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any sacrifice of ... but any prayer of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:8 (#4)

רְצוֹנוֹ

“is} his delight”

See how you translated the abstract noun **delight** in 11:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:8 (#2)

תָּזִבַּח רָשָׁעִים & וְתַפְלִילָה יִשְׁרָיִם

“The sacrifice of the wicked & but the prayer of the upright”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **sacrifice** and **prayer**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation:

[What the wicked ones sacrifice ... but what the upright ones pray]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:8 (#3)

תוֹעֲבַבֶת יְהוָה

“is} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated **an abomination to Yahweh** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:9 (#1)

תוֹעֲבַבֶת יְהוָה

“An abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:9 (#2)

דֶּרֶךְ

“is} the way of”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:9 (#5)

צְדִיקָה

“righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:9 (#4)

וּמְרַדְדֵי צְדִיקָה

“but a pursuer of righteousness”

Here Solomon refers to someone being diligent to live righteously as if that person were **a pursuer** of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but someone who strives to be righteous]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:9 (#3)

רֶשָׁע וּמְרַדְדֵי

“the wicked, but a pursuer of”

Here, **the wicked** and **a pursuer** represent types of people, not one particular **wicked** person or **pursuer**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [all wicked ones ... but everyone who pursues]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:10 (#1)

מוֹסֵר & תּוֹכֵחַת

“discipline & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **discipline** in 13:24 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:10 (#2)

לְעֹזֵב & שׁוֹנֵא

“is} for one who forsakes & one who hates”

Here, **one who forsakes** and **one who hates** represent types of people, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is for any person who forsakes ... any person who hates]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:10 (#3)

לְעֹזֵב אֶת־הַדֶּרֶךְ

“is} for one who forsakes the path”

Here Solomon refers to a person who is no longer behaving righteously, but behaving wickedly, as if that person **forsakes** the righteous **path**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is for one who stops living righteously]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:11 (#3)

לִבָּוֹת

“the hearts of”

See how you translated the same use of “heart” in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:11 (#4)

בְּנֵי־אָדָם

“the sons of man”

See how you translated this phrase in 8:4.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 15:11 (#1)

שְׁאֵוֹל וְאַבְדּוֹן

“Sheol and Abaddon”

Sheol and **Abaddon** both refer to the place where people’s spirits go when they die. Solomon is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. See how you translated **Sheol** in 1:12. Alternate translation: [the place where the spirits of dead people dwell] or [the place of the dead]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 15:11 (#2)

נִגְנָד

“are} before”

Here Solomon refers to **Yahweh** knowing everything about **Sheol and Abaddon** as if they were in front of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are fully known by]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:12 (#2)

לֹא יֶאֱהָב

“does not love”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [really hates]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 15:12 (#1)

לֹא יֵלֵךְ הַמִּוֹכֵחַ לְלוֹ & לֹא יֵלֵךְ

“A mocker & one who rebukes him & he will not go”

A mocker, **one who rebukes**, **he**, and **him** represent types of people, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any mocker ... any person who rebukes that person ... that person will not go]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:12 (#3)

לֹא יֵלֶךְ

“he will not go”

Here Solomon implies that going **to the wise ones** is in order to get advice from them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will not go to receive their advice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:13 (#4)

רִירוֹת נִכְאָה

“a spirit {is} stricken”

Here Solomon refers to a person despairing as if that person’s **spirit** were hit or crushed by something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a person feels despair]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:13 (#1)

לֵב שִׂמְחָה

“A joyful heart”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer a person’s inner being or mind. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:13 (#3)

וּבְעֵצָב־לֵב

“but by pain of heart”

Here Solomon refers to a person who is feeling sad as if that person has **pain of heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but by feeling sad]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:13 (#2)

יֵטֵב פָּנָיו

“makes a face glad”

Here Solomon speaks as if a person’s face were glad. He means that the person is smiling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes one to smile]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:14 (#5)

כִּסְיֵלִים

“the stupid”

Solomon is using the adjective **stupid** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [stupid people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:14 (#3)

יִבְקֹשׁ

“seeks”

See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:14 (#2)

לֵב & וּפִי

“The heart of & but the mouth of”

In this verse, **heart** and **mouth** refer to the whole person. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:18 and **mouth** in 4:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:14 (#6)

יִרְעֶעָה

“feeds on”

Here Solomon refers to **stupid ones** being satisfied with **folly** as if **folly** were something they feed on like cattle feed on grass. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are satisfied by]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:14 (#4)

דָּעַת & אִוִּלָּה

“knowledge & folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:14 (#1)

לֵב נִנְבֹן וּבִקְשׁ-דָּעַת וּפִי כִסְיֵלִים יִרְעֶעָה

“The heart of the understanding one seeks knowledge, but the mouth of the stupid feeds on”

The heart, the understanding one, and the mouth represent these things and type of people in general, not one particular **heart, understanding one, or mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [The hearts of the understanding ones seek knowledge ... but the mouths of the stupid feed on]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:15 (#2)

עֲנִי

“the afflicted”

Solomon is using the adjective **afflicted** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [afflicted people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:15 (#6)

מִשְׁתַּתָּה תִּמְדִּיד

“has} a feast continually”

Here Solomon refers to a person enjoying life as if that person is always eating at a **feast**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a simile or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [lives as if he is continually feasting] or [is always enjoying life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:15 (#1)

כָּל־יְמֵי עֲנִי

“All the days of the afflicted”

All the days here represents what happens during the time that **the afflicted** are alive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The things that happen during all the days that the afflicted are alive]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:15 (#4)

רָעִים

“are} evil”

Here, **evil** refers to what is miserable or troublesome. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are troublesome ones] or [are troublesome]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:15 (#5)

וְטוֹב־לֵלֵב

“but the good of heart”

Here, **the good of heart** refers to a person who feels happy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the one who feels happy]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:15 (#3)

עֲנִי & וְטוֹב־לֵלֵב

“the afflicted & but the good of heart”

Here, **the afflicted** and **the good of heart** represent types of people, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any afflicted one ... but any person who is good of heart]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:16 (#5)

וְמִדְּהוּמָה בּוֹ

“and anxiety with it”

Here Solomon refers to feeling **anxiety** as if that **anxiety** were an object that someone could have with **much treasure**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and having anxiety] or [and being anxious]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:16 (#4)

בִּירְאֵת יְהוָה

“with the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:16 (#3)

בִּירְאֵת יְהוָה

“with the fear of Yahweh”

Here Solomon refers to fearing **Yahweh** as if that **fear** were an object that someone could have **with** even a **little** of whatever they have. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while having fear of Yahweh] or [and fearing Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:16 (#2)

מְעַט

“is} a little”

Here Solomon is using the adjective **little** as a noun to refer to a small amount of something. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [is having a small amount]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:16 (#6)

וּמְהֵרָה

“and anxiety”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **anxiety**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and being anxious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:16 (#1)

מְעַט & מְאֹדָּהּ רַב

“is} a little & than much treasure”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is having a little ... than having much treasure]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:17 (#3)

וְשִׂנְאָה & וְאַהֲבָה

“and love & and hatred”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **love** and **hatred** in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:17 (#2)

אֶרְחֹתַי יֵרֶק

“is} a portion of vegetables”

Here, **a portion of vegetables** refers to a small meal without much food. This kind of meal would be eaten by someone who cannot afford to buy meat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is very little food] or [is a poor person's meal]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:17 (#1)

אֶרְחֹתַי יֵרֶק וְאַהֲבָה & מִשְׁשׁוֹר אֶאֱבֹס וְשִׂנְאָה

“is} a portion of vegetables and love & than a fattened ox and hatred”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is having a portion of vegetables and having love ... than having a fattened ox and having hatred]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:17 (#4)

מִשְׁשׁוֹר אֶאֱבֹס

“than a fattened ox”

Here, **a fattened ox** refers to a large meal including meat such as **a fattened ox**. This kind of meal would be eaten by a wealthy person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [than very much food] or [than a wealthy person's meal]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:17 (#5)

וְשִׂנְאָה־בּוֹ

“and hatred with it”

Here Solomon refers to feeling **hatred** as if that **hatred** were an object that someone could have **with a fattened ox**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while having hatred]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:18 (#2)

אִישׁ חֹמָה

“A man of heat”

A man of heat refers to someone who gets angry easily. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **heat** in 6:34. Alternate translation: [A person who becomes angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:18 (#7)

יִשְׁקֵט רִיב

“will quiet a dispute”

Here Solomon refers to someone causing people who are arguing to become calm and stop arguing as if that person were causing the **dispute** to become **quiet**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will calm disputing people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:18 (#4)

מִדְּוֹן & רִיב

“a quarrel & a dispute”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **quarrel** and **dispute**, you could express the same ideas in another way. See how you translated “quarrels” in 6:14. Alternate translation: [quarreling ... disputing]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:18 (#5)

מִדְּוֹן וְאֶאֱרָר אֲפָפִים & רִיב

“a quarrel, but one long of nostrils & a dispute”

Here, **a quarrel**, **one long of nostrils**, and **a dispute** represent events and a type of person in general, not a specific event or person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [quarrels, but any person long of nostrils ... disputes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:18 (#3)

יִגְרָה

“stirs up”

Here Solomon refers to starting **a quarrel** as if it were something that a person **stirs up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [starts] or [causes]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:18 (#1)

אִישׁ חֹמָה

“A man of heat”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [A person of heat]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 15:18 (#6)

וְאֶאֱרָר אֲפָפִים

“but one long of nostrils”

See how you translated **one long of nostrils** in 14:29.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:19 (#2)

דִּדְרָךְ עֲצֵל כַּמְשֻׁשְׁכַת הַחֹדֶק וְאֶאֱרָר יִשְׁרָיִם סֶלֶה

“The way of the lazy {is} like a hedge of briar, but the path of the upright {is} a built-up highway”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of a person living his life as though he were walking on a **way**, **path**, or **highway**. This refers to a person’s progress throughout that person’s lifetime. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The way that the lazy live blocks their progress in life like a hedge of briar, but the way that the upright live results in a life of great progress]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:19 (#3)

עֲצֵל & יִשְׁרָיִם

“the lazy & the upright”

Solomon is using the adjectives **lazy** and **upright** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [lazy ones ... upright ones]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:19 (#1)

דִּדְרָךְ עֲצֵצַל כְּמִשְׁשֶׁכֶת הַחֲדָק וְאַרְחָה יִשְׂרָרִים סֶלְהָ

“The way of the lazy {is} like a hedge of briar, but the path of the upright {is} a built-up highway”

The way of the lazy and the path of the upright do not refer to specific things and people, but represent those things and types of people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **the lazy** in 10:26. Alternate translation: [The ways of lazy ones are like a hedge of briar, but the paths of the upright ones are a built-up highway]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:19 (#4)

כְּמִשְׁשֶׁכֶת הַחֲדָק

“is} like a hedge of briar”

Here Solomon compares the difficult and unproductive lifestyle of a **lazy** person with a **hedge of briar** that prevents someone from walking down a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [is difficult]

See: Simile

Proverbs 15:19 (#5)

כְּמִשְׁשֶׁכֶת הַחֲדָק

“is} like a hedge of briar”

The phrase **hedge of briar** refers to a dense group of bushes that contains sharp thorns. Because the **hedge** is thick and has thorns, people cannot walk through it. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of plant, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [is like a large thorn bush] or [is like a thorny plant that blocks the way]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 15:19 (#6)

סֶלְהָ

“is} a built-up highway”

Here Solomon refers to the productive lifestyle of **the upright ones** as if it were a **highway** that was well-made and easy to walk on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is productive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:20 (#2)

וּכְסִיִּיל אֲאָדָם בּוֹזֵזָה אִמּוֹ

“but a stupid man despises his mother”

Although a **stupid man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that can include both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [but it is a stupid person who despises his or her mother]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 15:20 (#1)

בִּבְנוֹ הַחֲכָם יִשְׂמַח־אָאָב

“A wise son gladdens a father”

See how you translated this clause in 10:1.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:21 (#2)

לְחֶסֶד־לֵב

“to the lacking of heart”

See how you translated **the lacking of heart** in 9:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:21 (#3)

וְאִישׁ תְּתִיבוּנָה

“but the man of understanding”

See how you translated **man of understanding** in 10:23.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:21 (#5)

יִישֶׁר־לֶכֶת

“makes to go straight”

Here Solomon speaks of a person doing what is right as if he were walking **straight** ahead on a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does the right thing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:21 (#4)

יִישֶׁר־לֶכֶת

“makes to go straight”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [makes himself to go straight]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:21 (#1)

אִלְמָלֵךְ שִׁמְחָה & תִּתְבּוֹנֶנָה

“Folly {is} a joy & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Folly** in 5:23, **joy** in 10:28, and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:22 (#2)

סִדּוּר

“counsel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:22 (#3)

תִּקּוּם

“it will stand”

The pronoun **it** refers to the **Plans** in the previous clause. If this is not clear for your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those plans will stand]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 15:22 (#1)

הַפֶּסֶד מִמַּחֲשָׁבוֹת

“Plans are broken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Plans fail]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 15:22 (#4)

תִּקּוּם

“it will stand”

Here Solomon refers to **Plans** that are successful as if they were a person who would continue to **stand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they will be successful]

See: Personification

Proverbs 15:23 (#7)

וְדַבָּר בְּעֵתוֹ מֵהֵטוֹב

“and how good {is} a word in its time”

The phrase **a word in its time** represents the message that **the man** spoke at the appropriate time. See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and how good is a message spoken at the appropriate time]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:23 (#5)

בְּמַעֲנֵה־פִּי

“in the answer of his mouth”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe an **answer** that someone says with **his mouth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [in the good answer he says] or [in what he says well in reply]

See: Possession

Proverbs 15:23 (#3)

שִׁמְחָה

“Joy”

See how you translated the abstract noun **joy** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:23 (#4)

בְּמַעֲנֵה־פִּי

“in the answer of his mouth”

The phrase **a word in its time** in the second clause implies that **the answer** in the first clause is a good or fitting **answer**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the good answer of his mouth] or [in the fitting reply of his mouth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:23 (#6)

וְדַבָּר בְּעֵתוֹ מֵהֵטוֹב

“and how good {is} a word in its time”

This clause is a positive exclamation that emphasizes that something spoken at the right time is very good. If it would be helpful in your language, you could show this by making it a separate sentence and using a positive exclamation that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A word in its time is very good!]

See: Exclamations

Proverbs 15:23 (#1)

שְׂמֵחָהּ לְאִישׁ בְּמַעֲנֵה־פִּי

“Joy {is} for the man in the answer of his mouth”

Solomon is speaking of an answer as if it were a container, and he is speaking of **Joy** as if it were an object that could be inside that container. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The man has joy because of the answer of his mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:23 (#2)

שְׂמֵחָהּ לְאִישׁ בְּמַעֲנֵה־פִּי

“Joy {is} for the man in the answer of his mouth”

Here, **the man**, **the answer**, and **his** refer to a type of people and answers in general, not a specific **man** or **answer**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person has joy because of an answer of that person’s mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:24 (#2)

אֶנְרַח חַיִּים לְמַעַלָּה

“The path of life {is} upward”

Here Solomon speaks of a lifestyle that results in a good, long life as if it were a **path** that goes **upward**. This is opposite from the path that leads down to Sheol. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The right way of living results in a good and long life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:24 (#3)

חַיִּים

“life”

Here, **life** refers to both quality and length of **life**. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:24 (#6)

מִשְׁאֲוֹל מָטָה

“from Sheol below”

The Israelites referred to dying as going down to **Sheol**, which is the place where people’s spirits go when they die. Here Solomon refers to **Sheol** as if it were **below** the place where living people are. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. See how you translated **Sheol** in 1:12. Alternate translation: [from the place where the spirits of dead people dwell] or [from the place of the dead]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:24 (#1)

אֶנְרַח חַיִּים לְמַעַלָּה לְמַשְׁכָּל

“The path of life {is} upward for the insightful one”

The path of life and **the insightful one** represent paths and insightful people in general, not a specific **path** or **insightful one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [The paths of lives are upward for those who are insightful]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:24 (#4)

לְמַמְעַן סֹרֵר

“in order to turn away”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [in order for the insightful one to turn away]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:24 (#5)

לְמַמְעַן סֹרֵר מִשְׁאֲוֹל

“in order to turn away from Sheol”

Here Solomon speaks of avoiding **Sheol** as if **Sheol** were a place that a person could **turn away from**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in order to avoid going to Sheol]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:25 (#4)

גָּאִים

“the proud”

Solomon is using the adjective **proud** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [proud people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 15:25 (#2)

בֵּית גָּאִים & גְּבוּל אֶלְמָנָה

“the house of the proud & the boundary of the widow”

Here, **the house**, **the proud**, **the boundary**, and **the widow** refer to houses, proud people, boundaries, and widows in general, not one particular **house**, **proud** person, **boundary**, or **widow**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [the houses of any proud ones ... the boundaries of any widows]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:25 (#7)

אֶלְמָנָה

“the widow”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **the widow** is helpless and poor because widows were some of the poorest people in ancient societies. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the helpless widow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:25 (#5)

וַיִּצָּב

“but he will set up”

Here Solomon refers to Yahweh protecting or maintaining **the boundary of the widow** as if it were an object that he **set up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but he will protect]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:25 (#3)

בֵּית

“the house of”

Here, **house** refers to both the building someone lives in and the items within that **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the property of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:25 (#1)

יִסֹּחַ

“will tear down”

Here Solomon refers to Yahweh destroying **the house of the proud ones** as if he were tearing it **down**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will ruin]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:25 (#6)

גְּבוּל

“the boundary of”

The word **boundary** refers to stones that were used to mark the borders of the land that a person owned. Here Solomon uses **boundary** to refer to all the land and possessions within the **boundary** of the land that **the widow** owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the property of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:26 (#2)

אִמְרֵי-נֹעַם

“words of pleasantness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **words** that are characterized by **pleasantness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [pleasant words]

See: Possession

Proverbs 15:26 (#1)

תוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated **an abomination to Yahweh** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:26 (#3)

אִמְרֵי

“words of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:27 (#3)

בֵּיתוֹ

“his house”

See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:27 (#4)

וְשׂוֹנֵא מִתְּבִנָּה

“but one who hates bribes”

The phrase **one who hates bribes** refers to a person who refuses to receive **bribes** that someone else might offer them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but one who refuses to accept bribes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:27 (#1)

בֵּיתוֹ בּוֹצֵצַע & שׂוֹנֵא

“One who unjustly gains & his house, but one who hates”

One who unjustly gains, **his**, and **one who hates** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who unjustly gains ... that person's house, but any person who hates]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:27 (#2)

בּוֹצֵצַע בְּבָצַע

“One who unjustly gains unjust gain”

See how you translated the similar emphatic use of “unjustly gain unjust gain” in 1:19.

See: Poetry

Proverbs 15:27 (#5)

יָחִיָּה

“will live”

Here, **live** refers to living a good, long life. See how you translated the same use of **live** in 9:6.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:28 (#2)

לֵב

“The heart of”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person's thoughts exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:18. Alternate translation: [The mind]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:28 (#5)

יִבְרִיעַ

“gushes forth”

See how you translated the same use of **gushes forth** in 15:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:28 (#3)

לְעֹנֶה

“to answer”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to answer a person]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 15:28 (#1)

לֵב צַדִּיק יִהְיֶה & וּפִי רָשָׁעִים יִבְרִיעַ

“The heart of the righteous considers {how & but the mouth of the wicked gushes forth”

The **heart**, the **righteous**, and the **mouth** represent things and a type of people in general, not a specific **heart**, **righteous** person or **mouth**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The hearts of any righteous ones consider how ... but the mouths of the wicked ones gush forth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:28 (#6)

רָעוֹת

“evils”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evils**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [evil things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:28 (#4)

וּפְּקִי

“but the mouth of”

See how you translated the same use of **the mouth of** in 10:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:29 (#2)

וּתְפִלָּה

“but the prayer of”

The word **prayer** represents prayers in general, not one particular **prayer**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [but the prayers of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:29 (#3)

וּתְפִלָּה

“but the prayer of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **prayer** in 15:8.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:29 (#1)

רַחֲחוּק יִהְיֶה מִרְשָׁעִים

“Yahweh {is} far from the wicked”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh not listening to **the wicked** as if he were physically **far** away from them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh does not heed wicked people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:29 (#4)

יִשְׁמַע

“he hears”

Here, **hears** implies that Yahweh not only hears but also responds to what he **hears**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he hears, and he responds to that prayer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:30 (#2)

מְאוֹר־עֵינַיִם

“The luminary of the eyes”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that he is referring to someone seeing **The luminary of the eyes**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Seeing the luminary of the eyes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:30 (#4)

לֵב

“the heart”

Here, **heart** refers to the whole person. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:18.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:30 (#6)

תִּדְשֵׁן-עֲצָם

“fattens the bone”

Here Solomon refers to **good news** making people feel healthy as if it **fattens** their bones. The word **bone** here refers to a person’s whole body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes people to feel healthy]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 15:30 (#3)

מְאוֹר־עֵינַיִם

“The luminary of the eyes”

Here Solomon refers to a joyful facial expression as if the person’s **eyes** shined brightly like a **luminary** body, such as the sun. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A cheerful expression]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 15:30 (#5)

שְׂמוֹעַ טוֹבָה

“good news”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that he is referring to someone hearing **good news**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [hearing good news]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 15:30 (#1)

מְאוֹר-עֵינַיִם יְשַׂחֲלֵלֵב & עֲצָם

“The luminary of the eyes gladdens the heart & the bone”

The luminary, **the heart**, and **the bone** represents those things in general, not one particular **luminary**, **heart**, or **bone**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Luminaries of the eyes gladdens hearts ... bones]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:31 (#5)

בְּקֶרֶב הַכְּמִיִּם תִּלֵּן

“will lodge in the midst of the wise ones”

Here Solomon refers to a person being considered wise as if that person were dwelling with **the wise ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be considered one of the wise ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:31 (#4)

תּוֹכַחַת

“the rebuke of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:31 (#2)

אֶזְנִי

“An ear”

Here, **ear** refers to the whole person who listens. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A listener]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:31 (#3)

תּוֹכַחַת חַיִּים

“the rebuke of life”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **rebuke** that results in **life**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the rebuke that leads to life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 15:31 (#1)

אֶזְנִי & תּוֹכַחַת

“An ear & the rebuke of”

An ear and **the rebuke** represent those things in general, not one particular **ear** or **rebuke**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Ears ... the rebukes of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:32 (#2)

מְמוּסָר & תּוֹכַחַת

“correction & rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** in 3:11 and **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:32 (#5)

לֵב

“heart”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer to a person’s ability to think. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 6:32.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:32 (#4)

נַפְשִׁי

“his life”

Here, **his life** refers to the person himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [himself]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 15:32 (#1)

פִּרְרָעַ & נִפְשִׁשׁוּ וְשׁוֹמֵמָה

“One who avoids & his life, but one who hears”

One who avoids, **his**, and **one who hears** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who avoids ... that person's life, but any person who hears]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 15:32 (#3)

מוֹאֵאִס

“rejects”

Solomon says **rejects** here as an overstatement for emphasis. He means that someone who **avoids correction** is doing what will ruin **his life**, as if he actually **rejects his life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [behaves as if he does not care about]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 15:33 (#4)

וְלִפְנֵי כְבוֹד עֲנִיָּה

“and to the face of honor {is} humility”

Here Solomon is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **to the face of** in 8:25. Alternate translation: [and humility must come before honor] or [and humility precedes honor]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 15:33 (#1)

יִרְאַתַּת יְהוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 15:33 (#2)

מוֹסֵסֶר הַחֵמָה & כְּבוֹד

“{is} instruction of wisdom & honor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **instruction** in 1:2 and **honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:33 (#5)

עֲנִיָּה

“{is} humility”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **humility**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is being humble]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 15:33 (#3)

מוֹסֵסֶר הַחֵמָה

“{is} instruction of wisdom”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **instruction** that results in **wisdom**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is instruction that results in wisdom]

See: Possession

Proverbs - Chapter 16 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 16 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 10–15 mostly contain proverbs that consist of two parallel clauses that contrast with each other. Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 16 also contains contrasting parallelism (16:1, 2, 9, 14, 22, 33) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (16:11, 16, 18, 30). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 16:1 (#1)

לֹאֲדָם מִצָּרִי־לֵב וְיִמְיָהוּהָ מִצְנָנָה לְשׁוֹן

“The arrangements of the heart {are} a man’s, but the answer of the tongue {is} from Yahweh”

Here, **the heart**, **a man’s**, **the answer**, and **the tongue** refer to these things and people in general, not a specific thing or person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The arrangements of any man’s heart belongs to that man, but the answers of any man’s tongue are from Yahweh]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:1 (#4)

לֵב

“the heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:1 (#8)

וּמִי־יְהוָה

“but & is} from Yahweh”

Here, the phrase **is from Yahweh** indicates that **Yahweh** is who determines **the answer of the tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is determined by Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:1 (#3)

מִעֲרֵב־לֵב

“The arrangements of the heart”

The arrangements of the heart here could mean: (1) **arrangements** about what to say, which is suggested by the phrase **the answer of the tongue** in the next clause. Alternate translation: [The arrangements of the heart regarding what to say]; (2) human **arrangements** in general. Alternate translation: [The arrangements of the heart about something]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:1 (#2)

מִעֲרֵב־לֵב & מַעֲנֶנָה לְשׁוֹן

“The arrangements of the heart & the answer of the tongue”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **arrangements** and **answer**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how

you translated **answer** in 15:1. Alternate translation: [Things that the heart arranges ... what the tongue answers]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:1 (#5)

לֵאדָדִים

“are} a man’s”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **arrangements** that are determined by the person who makes them. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are determined by a man] or [are determined by those who make them]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:1 (#6)

מִצְנֶנָה לְשׁוֹן

“the answer of the tongue”

Here, **the answer of the tongue** refers to **the answer** that someone speaks by using **the tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17. Alternate translation: [what one says in reply] or [the spoken answer]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:1 (#7)

מִצְנֶנָה לְשׁוֹן

“the answer of the tongue”

Here, **the answer of the tongue** could refer to: (1) an **answer** related to the **arrangements** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [the answer of the tongue about those arrangements]; (2) an **answer** in general. Alternate translation: [any answer of the tongue]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:2 (#3)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in his eyes”

See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:2 (#5)

רוּחַתָּו

“spirits”

Here, **spirits** refers to the thoughts and motives of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people’s thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:2 (#1)

דרכי

“the ways of”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:2 (#4)

וְהַכֵּן & יְהוָה

“but Yahweh examines”

Here, **examines** refers to judging or evaluating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but Yahweh judges]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:2 (#2)

אָיִשׁ & בְּעֵינָיו

“a man & in his eyes”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [any person ... in that person’s eyes]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 16:3 (#2)

מַעֲשֵׂי יָדָיו & מַחְשַׁבְתֵּיהֶם

“your works & your plans”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **works** in 8:22 and **plans** in 1:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:3 (#1)

גָּגַל אֶל־יְהוָה מַעֲשֵׂי יָדָיו

“Roll to Yahweh your works”

Here Solomon refers to people depending on Yahweh for the outcome of their **works** as if those **works** were

objects that one could **Roll to Yahweh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Depend on Yahweh to direct your works]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:3 (#4)

וְיָכֻלְנוּ

“and & will be established”

Here Solomon uses **established** to refer to something being achieved or successful. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and ... will be successful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:3 (#3)

וְיָכֻלְנוּ מִחְשַׁבְתֵּיהֶם

“and your plans will be established”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will establish your plans]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:4 (#5)

לְיוֹם רָעָה

“for the day of evil”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **day** that is characterized by **evil**. This refers to a time when Yahweh will punish **wicked** people, either in this life or on the final day of judgment. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for the time of their punishment]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:4 (#3)

וְגַם־רָשָׁע

“and even a wicked {one}”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh has even made a wicked one]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 16:4 (#4)

רָשָׁע

“a wicked {one}”

See how you translated this phrase in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:4 (#2)

לְמַעַנְהוּ & רָעָה

“for its purpose & evil”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **purpose** and **evil**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **evil** in 1:16. Alternate translation: [for what they will accomplish ... what is evil]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:4 (#1)

כָּל & לְמַעַנְהוּ

“all for its purpose”

Solomon is using the adjective **all** as a noun to mean everything that exists. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [all things for their own purposes]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 16:5 (#3)

יָד לְיָד

“hand to hand”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:21. Alternate translation: [As sure as the sun comes up] or [Assuredly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:5 (#1)

תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה

“An abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:5 (#5)

לֹא יִזְקֶה

“he will not remain blameless”

See how you translated **will not remain blameless** in 11:21.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 16:5 (#2)

גִּבְהַ-לֵּב

“one high of heart”

Here Solomon refers to a proud person as if that person had a **heart** that was **high**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one who is proud] or [arrogant one]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:5 (#4)

לֹא יִזְקֶה

“he will not remain blameless”

Although the term **he** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [that person will not remain blameless]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:6 (#2)

בְּהִתְחַסֵּד וּבְאֵמֶת יִכַּפֵּר עֲוֹן

“By covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness, iniquity is atoned {for}”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. This appears to mean that a person shows that he has repented of his **iniquity** by his **covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness**. In response, Yahweh forgives him of his iniquity. Since both the person and Yahweh are involved in the atoning, use the passive construction if possible. Alternate translation: [Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness atone for iniquity] or [A person atones for his iniquity by being faithful to his responsibilities to others and by being trustworthy]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:6 (#3)

בְּהִתְחַסֵּד וּבְאֵמֶת

“By covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** in 3:3, **iniquity** in

6:12, and **evil** in 1:16. Alternate translation: [By being faithful and by being trustworthy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:6 (#4)

וּבִירְאָתָהּ יְהוָה

“and by the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:6 (#5)

סָוִיר מִרָע

“one turns away from evil”

See how you translated **turns away from evil** in 14:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:6 (#1)

בְּחֻסְדֵּי נֹאמָת וְכַפָּר צִוּן

“By covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness, iniquity is atoned for”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [By a person having covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness, a person's iniquity is atoned for]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 16:7 (#1)

דִּרְכֵי

“the ways of”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:7 (#2)

אִישׁ גַּם־אֹיְבָיו & אִתּוֹ

“a man & even his enemies & with him”

Although **man**, **his**, and **him** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... even that person's enemies ... with that person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 16:8 (#1)

טוֹב־מִמְעַט בְּצִדְקָה מִרְבִּי תִתְּבוּאֹת בְּלֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“Better {is} a little with righteousness than an abundance of produce with no justice”

The author assumes that his readers will understand that **a little** refers to the things needed to maintain life. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [It is better for a person to have a little of what they need with righteousness than for a person to have an abundance of produce with no justice] or [A person who has a little of what they need with righteousness is better off than a person who has an abundance of produce with no justice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:8 (#2)

טוֹב־מִמְעַט

“Better {is} a little”

See how you translated this phrase in 15:16.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 16:8 (#4)

מִרְבִּי תִתְּבוּאֹת בְּלֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“than an abundance of produce with no justice”

See how you translated **an abundance of produce** in 14:4 and **no justice** in 13:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:8 (#3)

בְּצִדְקָה

“with righteousness”

Here Solomon refers to being righteous as if that **righteousness** were an object that someone could have **with a little**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while having righteousness] or [while being righteous]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:8 (#5)

בְּלֹא מִשְׁפָּט

“with no justice”

Here Solomon refers to a lack of **justice** as if **justice** were an object that someone did not have **with an abundance of produce**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and not having justice] or [while having no justice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:9 (#4)

יִכְנֶן צֶדֶקוֹ

“establishes his step”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh determining the individual events related to the working out of a person’s plans as if Yahweh were guiding that person where to **step**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [determines how that plan proceeds]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:9 (#3)

דֶּרֶכְיוֹ

“his way”

Here Solomon refers to what a person wants to do as if it were a **way** he walks on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what he wants to do]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:9 (#1)

לֵב

“The heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:9 (#2)

אָדָם & דֶּרֶכְיוֹ & צֶדֶקוֹ

“a man & his way & his step”

Although **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... that person’s way ... that person’s step]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 16:10 (#6)

לֹא יִמְעַל-פִּיו

“his mouth must not act unfaithfully”

Solomon is using **his mouth** to represent what **a king** says by using his mouth to announce his judgment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he must not speak unfaithfully]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:10 (#2)

קִדְקִים & בְּבִמְשָׁפֶט

“Divination & in judgment”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Divination** and **judgment**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [God’s message ... when he judges]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:10 (#4)

מֶלֶךְ

“a king”

This verse describes the traits of an ideal, righteous **king**, not any **king** in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [an ideal king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:10 (#5)

מֶלֶךְ & פִּיו

“a king & his mouth”

Here, the words **king** and **his** represent righteous kings, not one particular **king**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any good king ... that king’s mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:10 (#3)

שְׂפָתַי

“the lips of”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:10 (#1)

קִדְּוָם | עַל־שִׁפְתֵי־מֶלֶךְ

“Divination {is} on the lips of a king”

Divination usually refers to the practice of trying to get information from spirits, which is a practice that Yahweh prohibited. However, Solomon uses the word here to refer to **a king** correctly communicating God’s decisions as God’s representative. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Divinely inspired decisions are on the lips of a king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:10 (#7)

לֹא יִמְעַל

“must not act unfaithfully”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning by using positive words. Alternate translation: [will certainly act faithfully]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 16:11 (#4)

פָּפְלָם | וּמֵאֲזַנֵּי

“A scale with the two balances of”

A **scale** is an instrument that is used for determining the weight of an object or comparing the weight of two objects. The **two balances** are the pans that hang from either end of the bar of the scale. This bar sits on a middle support, so that when the weights in the two pans are equal, the pans stay level with each other. A merchant who sells things by weight would use a scale to determine their value. he would have stones that were of a standard weight to place on one side of the scale, and the article for sale on the other. A dishonest merchant might use stones that were lighter than the standard and thus cheat his customer, against Yahweh’s design. See how you translated **scales** in 11:1. Alternate translation: [Weighing instruments of]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 16:11 (#2)

פָּפְלָם | וּמֵאֲזַנֵּי מִמֶּשֶׁשֶׁשְׁהוּ לִיהוָה מִמֶּשֶׁשְׁהוּ כָּל־אֲבִנֵי־כִּסִּי

“A scale with the two balances of justice {belong} to Yahweh; all the stones of the bag {are} his work”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A scale with its two balances of justice belong to Yahweh; yes, all the stones of the bag are his work]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 16:11 (#6)

כָּל־אֲבִנֵי־כִּסִּי

“all the stones of the bag”

The phrase **stones of the bag** refers to the weights that were placed on the **scales** in order to determine the weight of an object. These **stones** were carried by merchants in a **bag**. The **scales** consisted of a central post with a crossbar from which two pans were hung. An object would be placed in one pan and these **stones** that had specific weights were placed in the other pan until the crossbar remained level, meaning that both pans contain an equal weight. If your readers would not be familiar with this method of determining weight, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [all the weights] or [all the stones used for determining weight]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 16:11 (#5)

לִיהוָה מִמֶּשֶׁשְׁהוּ

“belong} to Yahweh & are} his work”

In this verse, the phrases **belong to Yahweh** and **are his work** indicate that the idea of honest weighing instruments originated with him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [come from Yahweh ... are his design] or [originated with Yahweh ... are designed by him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:11 (#1)

פָּפְלָם | וּמֵאֲזַנֵּי מִמֶּשֶׁשֶׁשְׁהוּ לִיהוָה מִמֶּשֶׁשְׁהוּ כָּל־אֲבִנֵי־כִּסִּי

“A scale with the two balances of justice {belong} to Yahweh; all the stones of the bag {are} his work”

The implication of the references to a **balance**, **scales**, and **stones** in this verse is that God wants people to be honest when selling or buying things. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [A scale with its two balances of justice belong to Yahweh; all the stones of the bag are his work, so be honest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:11 (#3)

פְּסָלִים | וּמֵאזְנֵי מִשְׁכָּלָם

“A scale with the two balances of justice”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **scale with its two balances** that are characterized by **justice**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A just scale with its two balances]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:12 (#1)

תוֹעֲבָתָהּ & רָשָׁע בְּבִצְדָקָהּ

“An abomination of & wickedness & by righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abomination** in 3:32, **wickedness** in 4:17, and **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:12 (#4)

יִכְוֹן כִּסֵּא

“is a throne established”

Here, **established** refers to a king having stable and enduring authority over his people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is a throne made secure] or [is a throne made to endure]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:12 (#3)

יִכְוֹן כִּסֵּא בְּבִצְדָקָהּ

“by righteousness is a throne established”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [righteousness establishes a throne]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:12 (#2)

מִמְלָכִים

“kings”

This verse describes the traits of ideal, righteous **kings**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [ideal kings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:12 (#5)

כִּסֵּא

“a throne”

Here, **throne** refers to a king's authority, which is represented by the **throne** or royal chair upon which a king sits. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a king's authority]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:13 (#1)

רִצְצִיּוֹן מִמְלָכִים שְׂפִתֵי צֶדֶק וְדִבְרֵי יִשְׁרָאִים יֶאֱהֵב

“The delight of kings {is} lips of righteousness, and he loves one who speaks upright things”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [The delight of kings is lips of righteousness, yes, he loves one who speaks upright things]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 16:13 (#4)

שְׂפִתֵי צֶדֶק

“{is} lips of righteousness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **lips** that are characterized by **righteousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is righteous lips]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:13 (#2)

רִצְצוֹן & צֶדֶק

“The delight of & righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **delight** in 14:35 and **righteousness** in 8:20.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:13 (#3)

מַלְכִּים

“kings”

This verse describes the traits of ideal, righteous **kings**, not any **kings** in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [ideal kings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:13 (#7)

וְדַבֵּר

“and & one who speaks”

Here, **one who speaks** refers to a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [and ... any person who speaks]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:13 (#6)

יֶאֱהֵב

“he loves”

Here, **he** refers to the **kings** in the previous clause, not one particular king. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [kings love]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:13 (#5)

שִׁפְתָּי

“is} lips of”

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by moving their **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is sayings of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:14 (#5)

מָמוּת

“death”

See how you translated the abstract noun **death** in 2:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:14 (#1)

חֶמֶת

“The heat of”

See how you translated the same use of **heat** in 6:34.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:14 (#3)

מִלְאָכֵי־מָמוּת

“is} messengers of death”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **messengers** who cause **death**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is messengers who cause death]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:14 (#6)

יִכְפֹּרָנָה

“will atone {for} it”

Here, **atone for it** refers to doing something that will cause an angry **king** to stop being angry. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [pacify the king's anger] or [do what he can stop the king from being angry]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:14 (#2)

מֶלֶךְ & יָאִישׁ חָכָם

“a king & but a wise man”

Here, **a king** and **a wise man** represent these types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any king ... but any wise man]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:14 (#4)

מְלָאכֵי־מָמוֹת

“is} messengers of death”

Here Solomon speaks of an angry king causing people to die as if his anger were **messengers** whom he sends out to kill someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [puts people to death] or [causes death]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:15 (#3)

מֶלֶךְ & וִירָצוֹנוֹ

“the king & and his favor”

The words **the king** and **his** represent kings in general, not one particular **king**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any king ... and that king's favor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:15 (#5)

כְּעָנַב מִלְקוֹשׁ

“is} like a cloud of spring rain”

Here Solomon compares the king showing **favor** toward someone with a **cloud** that brings **rain** in the **spring** to enable the crops to grow. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [benefits a person] or [refreshes a person like clouds bring rain in springtime to refresh the crops]

See: Simile

Proverbs 16:15 (#1)

בְּאוֹר־פְּנֵי־מֶלֶךְ חַיִּים

“In the light of the face of the king {is} life”

Here Solomon refers to people staying alive as if **life** were an object that is located **In the light of the face of the king**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The light of the face of the king causes people to stay alive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:15 (#2)

בְּאוֹר־פְּנֵי

“In the light of the face of”

Here Solomon refers to **the king** smiling because he is happy as if it were **the light of the face**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [In the smile of] or [In the happiness of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:15 (#4)

וִירָצוֹנוֹ

“and his favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:16 (#1)

קִנְיָה־חֵכְמָה מִה־טָטִיב מִתְרִוץ וְקִנְיָה־בִּינָה נִבְחָר מִכָּסֶּף

“How much better {it is} to acquire wisdom than gold, and to acquire understanding is to be chosen {more} than silver”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [How better it is to acquire wisdom than gold, yes, to acquire understanding is to be chosen more than silver]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 16:16 (#3)

וְקִנְיָה־בִּינָה נִבְחָר

“and to acquire understanding is to be chosen”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people should choose to acquire understanding]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:16 (#2)

חֵכְמָה & בִּינָה

“wisdom & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2 and **understanding** in 2:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:17 (#5)

שממר בנפשו וצִיָּר דָּרְכוֹ

“one who protects his life guards his way”

The implication is that guarding his way is necessary in order to protect his life. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in order to protect his life, he must guard his way]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:17 (#1)

מסלֵלָת

“The highway of”

Here Solomon speaks of **upright** behavior as if it were a well-built **highway** that is free of obstacles. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The behavior of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:17 (#7)

נִצִּיר דָּרְכוֹ

“guards his way”

Here Solomon refers to a person being careful about how he behaves as if his behavior were a **way** that he **guards**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [behaves carefully] or [is careful in how he behaves]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:17 (#3)

מִרְגָּע & בְּנִפְשׁוֹ

“from evil & his life”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **evil** in 1:16 and **life** in 10:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:17 (#4)

שממר בנפשו וצִיָּר דָּרְכוֹ

“one who protects his life guards his way”

Here, **one who protects** and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who protects his own life guards his way]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:17 (#2)

סִוִּיר מִרְגָּע

“turns away from evil”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:17 (#6)

שממר בנפשו

“one who protects his life”

Here Solomon speaks of a person who wants to stay alive as if **his life** were something that he **protects**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one who keeps himself alive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:18 (#2)

לִפְנֵי־שֹׁשֶׁר גֵּאֲוֹן

“To the face of a breaking {is} pride”

Here Solomon is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **To the face of** in 8:25. Alternate translation: [Before a breaking there is pride]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:18 (#6)

וְלִפְנֵי כִכְשָׁלֹן גִּגְבַּהַּ רוּחַ

“and to the face of a stumbling {is} a height of spirit”

Here Solomon is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **to the face of** in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [and before a stumbling there is a height of spirit]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:18 (#9)

גִּבְהַת רוּחַ

“is} a height of spirit”

Here Solomon is using **a height of spirit** as a common expression of his culture to mean “proud.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is a swelled head] or [is arrogance]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:18 (#1)

לִפְנֵי־שֹׁשֶׁבֶר גָּאֹוֹן וְלִפְנֵי כִכְשָׁלּוֹן גִּבְהַת רוּחַ

“To the face of a breaking {is} pride, and to the face of a stumbling {is} a height of spirit”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [To the face of breaking is pride; yes, to the face of a stumbling is a height of spirit]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 16:18 (#5)

גָּאֹוֹן

“is} pride”

See how you translated the abstract noun **pride** in 8:13.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:18 (#7)

וְלִפְנֵי כִכְשָׁלּוֹן גִּבְהַת רוּחַ

“and to the face of a stumbling {is} a height of spirit”

Here Solomon implies that **a height of spirit** results in **stumbling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and a height of spirit results in a stumbling]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:18 (#4)

שֹׁשֶׁבֶר

“a breaking”

Here Solomon refers to a person being destroyed as if they experience **breaking**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a destruction] or [being destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:18 (#8)

כִּכְשָׁלּוֹן

“a stumbling”

Here Solomon refers to a person being destroyed as if they experience **stumbling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a destruction] or [being destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:18 (#3)

לִפְנֵי־שֹׁשֶׁבֶר גָּאֹוֹן

“To the face of a breaking {is} pride”

Here Solomon implies that **pride** results in **a breaking**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Pride results in a breaking]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:19 (#1)

שְׁפַל־רוּחַ

“to be lowly of spirit”

Here Solomon is using **lowly of spirit** as a common expression of his culture to mean “humble.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is being down-to-earth] or [to be humble]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:19 (#2)

מִחֲלֵק שְׂטֵלֶלֶל אֶת־גֵּאִים

“than to share a portion {of} spoil {with} proud ones”

Here Solomon uses **share** to imply that the one who is sharing **a portion of spoil** is also one of the **proud ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [than to be one of the proud ones and share a portion of their spoil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:19 (#3)

שְׂשֹׁלָלָהּ

“spoil”

The word **spoil** refers to things that victorious soldiers take from the enemies they have defeated. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [goods taken in battle] or [loot]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:20 (#4)

אֲשֶׁרֵי

“he {is} happy”

The pronoun **he** refers to the **one who trusts in Yahweh**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [that person who trusts in Yahweh is happy]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 16:20 (#3)

יִמְצָא-טוֹב

“will find good”

Here Solomon refers to someone prospering as if they found **good**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will prosper]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:20 (#1)

מְשַׁכֵּיל & וְבוֹטֵחַ & אֲשֶׁרֵי

“One who comprehends & and one who trusts & he {is} happy”

One who comprehends, **one who trusts**, and **he** here represent types of people in general, not particular people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who comprehends ... and any person who trusts ... that person is happy]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:20 (#2)

מְשַׁכֵּיל עַל-דָּבָר

“One who comprehends concerning a matter”

This phrase could refer to: (1) someone who acts wisely in various matters. Alternate translation: [One who acts sensibly]; (2) someone who heeds instruction, in which case the word translated **matter** would refer to instruction. Alternate translation: [One who heeds instruction]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:21 (#1)

לֵּלֶב

“heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:21 (#3)

נִבְיָוֹן

“an understanding one”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:21 (#5)

שִׁשְׁפֹּתֵי-לִפְתִּי

“lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:21 (#4)

וּמִמָּתְקַ שִׁשְׁפֹּתֵי-לִפְתִּי

“and the sweetness of lips”

Here Solomon speaks of kind or pleasant speech as if it were **sweetness** that comes from what people say by speaking with their **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and pleasant speech]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:21 (#2)

לְחֵכֶם-לֵּלֶב יִקְרָא נִבְיָוֹן

“The wise of heart will be called an understanding one”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will call the wise of heart an understanding one]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:22 (#3)

ומוססר אִוְלָלִים אִנְלָת

“but the instruction of fools {is} folly”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **instruction** that is given by **fools**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [but fools can only teach foolishness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:22 (#1)

מִקְקוֹר חַיִּים

“A fountain of life”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:11.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:22 (#2)

שִׁשְׁכָּל & ומוססר & אִנְלָת

“{is} the insight of & but the instruction of & is} folly”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **insight** in 1:3, **instruction** in 1:2, and **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:23 (#4)

יִסְסִיף לִקְחָ

“it increases learning”

The pronoun **it** refers to what **the wise** says. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [what he says increases what other people learn]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 16:23 (#2)

לֵּלֶב

“The heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:23 (#1)

לֵּלֶב הַחֲכָמִים יִשְׁכִּיל פִּיָּהוּ וְעַל־שִׁשְׁפֹּתָתָיו יִסְסִיף לִקְחָ

“The heart of the wise makes his mouth insightful, and on his lips it increases learning”

The **heart of the wise**, **his**, and **it** here refer to these things and people in general, not a specific **heart** or **wise** person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The hearts of wise people make their mouths insightful, and on their lips they increase learning]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:23 (#3)

פִּיָּהוּ & שִׁשְׁפֹּתָתָיו

“his mouth & his lips”

See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 10:11 and **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:24 (#1)

צוּף־דְּבַשׁ

“a honeycomb of honey”

Here Solomon is speaking of **words of pleasantness** as if they were **a honeycomb of honey**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [extremely pleasing] or [pleasing like a honeycomb]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:24 (#2)

אִמְרֵי־נֹעַם

“Words of pleasantness {are}”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **words** that are characterized by **pleasantness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. See how you translated **words of pleasantness** in 15:26. Alternate translation: [are pleasant words]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:24 (#4)

מִתְתּוֹק לַנֶּפֶשׁ

“sweet to the soul”

Here, the **soul** represents where a person's feelings and desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [pleasing to the inner person] or [making a person feel good]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:24 (#3)

מתתיוק ללנפש ומרפא לעצם

“sweet to the soul and healing to the bone”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [such words are sweet to the soul and healing to the bone]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 16:24 (#5)

ומרפא לעצם

“and healing to the bone”

Here, **bone** refers to a person's whole physical body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of **bone** in 15:30. Alternate translation: [and healing to the body]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 16:25 (#1)

יש דרך ישר לפני־איש ואחריתיה דרכי־מוֹת

“There is a straight road to the face of a man but its end {is} the ways of death”

See how you translated the identical sentence in 14:12.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:26 (#2)

נִפְשׁ

“The appetite of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **appetite** in 6:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:26 (#4)

פִּיהוּ

“his mouth”

Here, **mouth** refers to the desire to eat, which involves using one's **mouth**. It has the same meaning as **appetite** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his hunger] or [his desire to eat]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:26 (#3)

עֵמֶלָה לָלוּ

“labors for him”

Here Solomon speaks of **The appetite of the laborer** benefitting **the laborer** as if **The appetite** were a person who **labors** on his behalf. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [benefits him] or [is like a person who helps him while he is working]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:26 (#1)

נִפְשׁ עֵמֶל עֵמֶלָה לָלוּ כִּי־אֹכֵל עֲלֵיו פִּיהוּ

“The appetite of the laborer labors for him, for his mouth presses on him”

The appetite, the laborer, him, and **his** here refer to appetites and laborers in general, not to any particular **appetite** or **laborer**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The appetites of laborers labor for them, for their mouths press on them]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:26 (#5)

אֹכֵל עֲלֵיו פִּיהוּ

“his mouth presses on him”

Here Solomon is using **presses on him** as a common expression of his culture to mean “urges him on.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his mouth is his master] or [being hungry urges him to keep working]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:27 (#6)

כְּאֵשׁ צָרָבָה

“it is} like a scorching fire”

Solomon is saying that the **evil** things that **A man of worthlessness** says are **like a scorching fire** because both can hurt people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [it hurts people like a scorching fire]

See: Simile

Proverbs 16:27 (#2)

אִישׁ בְּבִלְיָעַל & שְׁפָתָיו

“A man of worthlessness & his lips”

A man of worthlessness and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of worthlessness ... that person's lips]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:27 (#5)

וְעַל-שְׁפָתָיו כְּאֵשׁ צָרָבָת

“and on his lips {it is} like a scorching fire”

Here, **on his lips** refers to what a person says while moving his **lips**. See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:13. Alternate translation: [and what he says is like a scorching fire]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:27 (#1)

אִישׁ בְּבִלְיָעַל

“A man of worthlessness”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:12.

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:27 (#4)

רָעָה

“evil”

Here, **evil** refers to trouble or harm that someone experiences as a result of the planning done by **A man of worthlessness**. See how you translated the same use of **evil** in 12:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:27 (#3)

כִּנְרָה רָעָה

“digs up evil”

Here Solomon speaks of a person planning how to harm other people as if that person were digging **evil** out of the ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [plans how to harm people] or [plans how to harm people as if he were digging up evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:28 (#3)

יִשְׁלַח מִדָּוִן

“lets loose strife”

Here Solomon refers to **A man of perverse things** causing **strife** between other people as if **strife** were an animal that he **lets loose**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes strife]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:28 (#2)

אִישׁ תַּתְּהַפְכוֹת

“A man of perverse things”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by saying **perverse things**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A perverse man] or [A man who says perverse things]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:28 (#4)

מִדָּוִן

“strife”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **strife**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [arguments] or [confrontations]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 16:28 (#5)

וְלִנְרָגֵל

“and a murmurer”

Here Solomon calls a person who gossips or tells harmful rumors about people **a murmurer** because that person speaks quietly when he gossips. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a gossip] or [and one who whispers gossip]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:28 (#6)

מִפְרִיד

“separates”

Here Solomon refers to causing friends to no longer be friends as if someone **separates** them from each other. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is one who destroys the friendships of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:28 (#1)

אִישׁ מְתַקְפָּכוֹת & וְזֹנֶה מִפְרִיד אֶלּוֹף

“A man of perverse things & and a murmurer separates the friendly”

A man of perverse things, a murmurer, and the friendly here refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any man of perverse things ... and any murmurer is a person who separates close friends]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:28 (#7)

מִפְרִיד אֶלּוֹף

“separates the friendly”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that this phrase refers to separating people who were **friendly** from each other. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [is one who separates a close friend from his friend] or [is one who separates close friends]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:29 (#5)

לֹא-טוֹב

“that is} not good”

Here Solomon is using a figure of speech that emphasizes the meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with **good**, which is a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. He does this to emphasize how bad this **road** is. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the meaning

without “not” in another way. Alternate translation: [that is very bad]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 16:29 (#2)

אִישׁ הַחֶמֶס

“A man of violence”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:31.

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:29 (#3)

וְהוֹלִיכֵהוּ בַדֶּרֶךְ

“and he leads him on a road”

Here Solomon refers to **A man of violence** causing **his neighbor** to behave in a manner **that is not good** as if he were leading **his neighbor** along **a road**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **road** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [and he causes him to behave in a manner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:29 (#1)

אִישׁ הַחֶמֶס & רֵעֵהוּ וְהוֹלִיכֵהוּ

“A man of violence & his neighbor, and he leads him”

A man of violence, his neighbor, he, and him here refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of violence ... that person’s neighbor, and that person leads that neighbor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:29 (#4)

בַּדֶּרֶךְ לֹא-טוֹב

“on a road {that is} not good”

This could refer to: (1) behavior **that is not good**. Alternate translation: [to behave in a manner that is not good]; (2) behavior that results in something **not good** happening to that person. Alternate translation: [to behave in a manner that causes results which are not good]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:30 (#2)

עֲצָה עֵינָיו & קִרְרִין שְׁשִׁפְתָּתָיו

“One who shuts his eyes & one who compresses his lips”

The phrases **shuts his eyes** and **compresses his lips** both describe facial gestures which people could use to signal to others that they were about to do something **evil** that they had planned. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the meaning of these actions in the text or in a footnote or use similar facial expressions that do have that meaning. Alternate translation: [One who signals to others by shutting his eyes ... one who signals to others by compressing his lips] or [One who winks his eyes ... one who extends his tongue]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 16:30 (#3)

רָעָה

“evil”

Here, **evil** refers to an evil action that **one who compresses his lips** had planned to do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [an evil act he had planned]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:30 (#1)

עֲצָה עֵינָיו לְהַשְׁמִיךְ & קִרְרִין שְׁשִׁפְתָּתָיו כְּלֵלָה רָעָה

“One who shuts his eyes plans & one who compresses his lips brings evil to completion”

One who shuts his eyes and **one who compresses his lips** here refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [People who shut their eyes plan ... people who compress their lips bring evil to completion]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:31 (#2)

עֲטֻטָּת תְּפָאֶרֶת

“{is} a crown of splendor”

Here Solomon refers to the honor of being an old person as if the old person's **Gray hair** were a **crown of splendor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning or use a simile. See how you translated **a crown of splendor** in 4:9. Alternate

translation: [is a great honor] or [is like a crown of splendor on an old person's head]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:31 (#1)

שֵׂיבָה

“Gray hair”

Gray hair here refers to old age, which is when people's **hair** usually becomes **Gray**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Old age]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 16:31 (#4)

בְּדֶרֶךְ צְדִיקוּתָהּ

“on the road of righteousness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **road** that is characterized by **righteousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [on the righteous road]

See: Possession

Proverbs 16:31 (#3)

בְּדֶרֶךְ

“on the road of”

See how you translated the same use of **road** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:31 (#6)

תִּמְצָא

“it is found”

Here Solomon refers to becoming old, which **Gray hair** represents, as if it were an object that a person could find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it is obtained]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:31 (#5)

תִּמְצָא

“it is found”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another

way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a person finds it]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:32 (#6)

מִלְכָּד עִיר

“than one capturing a city”

Here Solomon speaks of a person conquering a **city** and capturing the people who live in it as if the **city** were a person who could be captured. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [than one who conquers a city]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:32 (#4)

וּמִשְׁנֵל בְּבְרוּחָהּ

“and one ruling his spirit”

Here Solomon speaks of a person controlling **his spirit** as if it were a person who could be ruled over. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and one who controls his spirit]

See: Personification

Proverbs 16:32 (#7)

מִלְכָּד עִיר

“than one capturing a city”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **one who captures a city** is very **mighty**. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [than one mighty enough to capture a city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:32 (#5)

בְּבְרוּחָהּ

“his spirit”

Here, **spirit** refers to a person’s emotions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his emotions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 16:32 (#3)

וּמִשְׁנֵל בְּבְרוּחָהּ

“and one ruling his spirit”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and better is one ruling his spirit]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 16:32 (#1)

אַאֲרָךְ אֲפִים מִגִּבּוֹר וּמִשְׁנֵל בְּבְרוּחָהּ מִלְכָּד

“is} one long of nostrils than a mighty one, and one ruling his spirit than one capturing”

Here, **one long of nostrils**, **a mighty one**, **one ruling his spirit**, and **one capturing** represent these types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is any person long of nostrils than any mighty person, and any person who rules over his own spirit than any person who captures]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:32 (#2)

אַאֲרָךְ אֲפִים

“is} one long of nostrils”

See how you translated **one long of nostrils** in 14:29.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 16:33 (#3)

בְּבַחֵיק יוֹטֵטֵל אֶת־הַגּוֹרֵל

“Into the lap a lot is cast”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A person throws a lot into a lap]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 16:33 (#1)

בְּבַחֵיק יוֹטֵטֵל אֶת־הַגּוֹרֵל

“Into the lap a lot is cast”

The terms **a lot**, **the lap**, and **its** refer to these things in general, not to a specific **lot** and **lap**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Lots are cast into people’s laps]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 16:33 (#4)

כָּל־מִשְׁפָּטָיו

“its every judgment”

Here, **judgment** refers to the decision that is made based on the result of casting lots. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [its every decision] or [whatever happens with the lot]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 16:33 (#2)

בַּבְּחִיק יוֹטֵטֵל אֶת־הַגּוֹרָרִל

“Into the lap a lot is cast”

A **lot** was a marked stone that was thrown or rolled on the ground in order to help decide something. People believed that God would guide the **lot** so that it showed them what to do. If your culture has a similar object, you could use the word for that in your language here. Alternate translation: [A marked stone is cast into the lap] or [People throw dice]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs - Chapter 17 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 17 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 17 also contains contrasting parallelism (17:9, 22, 24) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (17:21, 28). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 17:1 (#4)

מִמִּבְבִּית מְלֵאָה

“than a house full of”

Here Solomon refers to a **house** in which people frequently eat meat from **sacrifices** as if the **house** were **full of sacrifices**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [than a house in which people frequently have]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:1 (#6)

זִבְחֵי־רִיב

“sacrifices of quarreling”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe feasts that are characterized by **quarreling**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [feasts characterized by quarreling]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:1 (#3)

וְשִׁלוֹה־בְבֶהָ

“and ease with it”

Here Solomon refers to feeling peaceful as if that **ease** were an object that someone could have **with a dry morsel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while feeling ease] or [while feeling peaceful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:1 (#1)

פֶּפֶת הַחֹרֶבֶת & מִמִּבְבִּית מְלֵאָה

“is} a dry morsel & than a house full of”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. See how you translated the same use of these phrases in 15:16–17. Alternate translation: [is having a dry morsel ... than having a house full of]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:1 (#2)

וְשִׁלוֹה־

“and ease”

Here, **ease** refers to a situation in which someone feels peaceful because there is no **quarreling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and a peaceful situation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:1 (#5)

זִבְחֵי

“sacrifices of”

Here, **sacrifices** refers to feasts in which Israelites would eat the meat from the **sacrifices** they had offered to Yahweh at the temple in Jerusalem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [feasting on meat with]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:2 (#1)

בִּבְנוֹן מִבְּיֹשׁ & אֲחֵהֶם

“a shameful son & brothers”

Here Solomon implies that **a son** and **brothers** refer to the children of the master who owns the **servant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [his master’s shameful son ... the brothers of his master’s son]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:2 (#3)

נַחֲלָה

“an inheritance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **inheritance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what people inherit]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:2 (#2)

וּבִתְנוּךְ אֲחֵהֶם

“and in the midst of brothers”

Here Solomon refers to the **servant** having equal status with these **brothers** as if he were **in the midst** of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and as an equal of the son’s brothers]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:3 (#6)

לִבָּבוֹת

“hearts”

See how you translated the same use of “heart” in 2:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:3 (#1)

מִצֹּרֶרֶךְ לְלִפְסֵף וְכִנּוֹר לְזֹהָב

“The smelting-pot {is} for the silver and the furnace {is} for the gold”

The terms **The smelting-pot**, **the silver**, **the furnace**, and **the gold** represent these things in general, not any specific things. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any smelting-pot is for silver and any furnace is for gold]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:3 (#5)

וּבִחְסֹן לִבָּבוֹת יְהוָה

“and Yahweh tests hearts”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh evaluating what people think as if their **hearts** were metal that he was testing to discover impurities. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh evaluates people’s hearts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:3 (#4)

וּבִחְסֹן לִבָּבוֹת יְהוָה

“and Yahweh tests hearts”

Solomon uses **and** here to indicate that he is making a comparison between the first clause and the second clause. How **Yahweh tests hearts** is similar to how **The smelting-pot** and **furnace** are used to test **silver** and **gold** to see how pure they are. If this connection is not clear, you may want to use a connecting word to show how this statement relates to what came before it. Alternate translation: [likewise, Yahweh tests hearts]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Proverbs 17:3 (#3)

מִצֹּרֶרֶךְ לְלִפְסֵף וְכִנּוֹר לְזֹהָב

“The smelting-pot {is} for the silver and the furnace {is} for the gold”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that the **smelting-pot** and **furnace** are used to refine and test the purity of **silver** and **gold**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The smelting-pot is for testing and refining the silver, and the furnace is for testing and refining the gold]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:3 (#2)

מַצְרִיף

“The smelting-pot”

A **smelting-pot** is a container in which metals are melted at a very high temperature so that impurities may be discovered and removed from the metal. Since the second clause mentions **tests**, most likely Solomon is referring to using the pot to discover impurities. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of container, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [The pot used for testing and refining metal]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 17:4 (#3)

שִׁפְתָּ

“the lips of”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 16:13.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:4 (#6)

לְשׁוֹן

“a tongue of”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:4 (#1)

מַמְרֵעַ & שִׁפְתֵי-אֲוָן & לְשׁוֹן הָיִת

“The evildoer & the lips of iniquity; a liar & a tongue of destruction”

The **evildoer**, the **lips of iniquity**, a **liar**, and a **tongue of destruction** represent types of people and things in general, not specific people or things. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any evildoer ... any lips of iniquity; any liar ... any tongues of destruction]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:4 (#4)

מַעֲזִיב

“gives ear”

The phrase **give ear** refers to listening carefully to what someone is saying as if the listener were giving his **ear** to the person speaking. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a similar expression from your language or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [listens carefully]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:4 (#5)

לְשׁוֹן הָיִת

“a tongue of destruction”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **tongue** that is characterized by **destruction**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a destructive tongue]

See: Possession

Proverbs 17:4 (#2)

שִׁפְתֵי-אֲוָן

“the lips of iniquity”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **lips** that are characterized by **iniquity**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [sinful lips]

See: Possession

Proverbs 17:5 (#2)

מַחֲרִיף עֲשֵׂהוּ

“taunts his maker”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:31.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:5 (#4)

לֹא יִבָּקֶה

“will not remain blameless”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 17:5 (#3)

לְאֵיִד

“at calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:5 (#1)

לַעֲעֹג לְלֹדֶשׁ הַחֲרִירָה עֲשֵׂהוּ שְׂמִמָּה לְלֹאֲאִיד

“A mocker of one who is poor taunts his maker; one glad at calamity”

The terms **A mocker**, **one who is poor**, **his**, and **one glad at calamity** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any mocker of any poor person taunts that person’s maker; any person glad at calamity]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:6 (#3)

בְּנֵי בְנִים & בְּנֵי אֲבוֹתָם

“{is} sons of sons & sons {is} their fathers”

Although **sons** and **fathers** are masculine, here Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [are children of children ... children is their parents]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 17:6 (#1)

עֲטֹטָרָה

“The crown of”

Here Solomon speaks of honor as if it were a **crown** upon the heads of **old ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated a similar use of **crown** in 4:9. Alternate translation: [The honor of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:6 (#4)

וְהַפְּאֹאֲרָה בְּנִים אֲבוֹתָם

“and the splendor of sons {is} their fathers”

Since the word translated as **splendor** is parallel to **crown** in the previous clause, here **the splendor of sons** refers to the honor or pride that **sons** feel for **their fathers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the honor that sons feel is for their fathers]

See: Possession

Proverbs 17:6 (#2)

עֲטֹטָרַת זִקְנִים בְּנֵי בְנִים

“The crown of the old {is} sons of sons”

The crown of the old could refer to: (1) the honor or pride that **the old** feel for their **sons of sons**. Alternate translation: [The honor that old people feel is for their sons of sons]; (2) the honor that **the old** receive from others because they have **sons of sons**. Alternate translation: [Old people are honored because of their sons of sons] or [Sons of sons cause others to honor old people]

See: Possession

Proverbs 17:7 (#1)

לְנֹבֵל & לְנֹדֵדִים

“for a worthless {one & for a noble”

Here **a worthless one** and **a noble** represent these types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [for worthless ones ... for nobles]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:7 (#2)

שִׁפְתֵי יִיתָר

“A lip of excess”

The phrase **lips of excess** refers to excellent or eloquent speech that people say by moving their lips. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Fine speech] or [Speaking excellently]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:7 (#3)

שִׁפְתֵי שֶׁקֶר

“a lip of falsehood”

See how you translated the same use of “a lip of falsehood” in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:8 (#3)

יִשְׁכִּיל

“he succeeds”

Here, **he succeeds** refers to what the **owner** of a **bribe** thinks would happen as a result of giving people bribes. It does not refer to something that is true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he thinks that he succeeds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:8 (#4)

אֵל-כָּל-אֲשֶׁר יַפְנֶה

“to all that he turns”

Here Solomon refers to everything that the a person does as if it were **all** the places **that he turns** toward. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in whatever he does]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:8 (#1)

אֶבֶן-חַיִּית

“A stone of favor”

A stone of favor refers to an object that someone thinks is magical and will make **its owner** successful. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A lucky rabbit's foot] or [A charm]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 17:8 (#2)

בְּעֵינָי

“in the eyes of”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:9 (#5)

וְשֹׁנֶה בְּדֹדְכָר

“but one who repeats a matter”

The phrase **one who repeats a matter** refers to someone who repeatedly speaks about a past situation in which that person or a friend was hurt or offended. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but one who repeatedly mentions a past offense]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:9 (#4)

מִבְּקֶשׁ

“seeks”

See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:9 (#3)

פֶּשַׁע & אֲדֹכְבָה

“a transgression & love”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **transgression** in 10:19 and **love** in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:9 (#2)

מְכַסֶּה

“One who covers”

Here Solomon speaks of forgiving someone for a **transgression** as if it were an object that someone **covers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who forgives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:9 (#1)

מְכַסֶּה-פֶּשַׁע & וְשֹׁנֶה בְּדֹדְכָר & אֱלֹוֹי

“One who covers a transgression & but one who repeats a matter & a close friend”

One who covers, a transgression, one who repeats, a matter, and a close friend represent these things and people in general, not specific things or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who covers any transgression ... but any person who repeats any matter ... close friends]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:9 (#6)

מִפְרִיד אֱלֹוֹי

“separates a close friend”

See how you translated this phrase in 16:28.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:10 (#3)

תִּתַּחַת & בְּמִכְבָּיו

“goes down into an understanding one”

Here Solomon refers to **an understanding one** learning from a **rebuke** as if it were an object that **goes down into** that person's mind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [teaches an understanding one]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:10 (#4)

מהבקות כססיל מאה

“more than striking a stupid one a hundred {times}”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [more than striking a stupid one a hundred times goes down into that stupid one] or [more than striking a stupid one a hundred times teaches that stupid one]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:10 (#2)

געררה

“A rebuke”

See how you translated the abstract noun **rebuke** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:10 (#1)

געררה במבבין & כססיל

“A rebuke & into an understanding one & a stupid one”

Here, **a rebuke**, **an understanding one**, and **a stupid one** represent this thing and these types of people in general, not one particular **rebukey** or person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [Any rebuke ... into any understanding person ... any stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:11 (#5)

ימלאאד אאקוררי ישלח

“and a cruel messenger will be sent”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and someone will send a cruel messenger]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 17:11 (#6)

ישלח-בו

“will be sent against him”

Here, **against him** implies that the **messenger** will punish the **evil one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will be sent to punish him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:11 (#2)

אד-מררי יבקש

“seeks only rebellion”

See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:11 (#1)

גרע ומלאאד אאקוררי & בו

“An evil one & and a cruel messenger & against him”

An evil one, **a cruel messenger**, and **him** represent types of people in general, not one particular **evil one** or **messenger**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any evil person ... and any cruel messenger ... against that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:11 (#3)

מררי

“rebellion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rebellion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [being rebellious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:11 (#4)

ימלאאד אאקוררי

“and a cruel messenger”

Here, **and** introduces the result of an **evil one** rebelling. Use the most natural way in your language to

indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence.
Alternate translation: [As a result, a cruel messenger]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 17:12 (#3)

פגגוש דדב שפכיל באאיש ואל-כפסיל באולתו

“Let a female bear robbed of offspring meet a man and not a stupid one in his folly”

Solomon is making this comparison between an angry bear and a fool as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Sometimes it seems like it would be better to meet a female bear robbed of offspring than to meet a stupid person doing something stupid]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 17:12 (#5)

דדב שפכיל

“a female bear robbed of offspring”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a female bear from which someone has stolen offspring]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 17:12 (#2)

פגגוש דדב שפכיל באאיש ואל-כפסיל באולתו

“Let a female bear robbed of offspring meet a man and not a stupid one in his folly”

In this verse, Solomon implies that meeting **a female bear robbed of offspring** is better than meeting **a stupid one in his folly**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A female bear robbed of offspring meeting a man is better than a stupid one in his folly meeting the man]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:12 (#8)

באולתו

“in his folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:12 (#6)

דדב

“a female bear”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **a female bear robbed of offspring** would be extremely angry and violent. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [an angry female bear]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:12 (#4)

דדב & באאיש & כפסיל באולתו

“a female bear & a man & a stupid one in his folly”

Here, **a female bear**, **a man**, **a stupid one**, and **his** represent bears and types of people in general, not one particular **bear** or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any female bear ... any person ... any stupid person in that person's folly]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:12 (#1)

פגגוש דדב שפכיל באאיש ואל-כפסיל באולתו

“Let a female bear robbed of offspring meet a man and not a stupid one in his folly”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words to the second clause from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Let a female bear robbed of offspring meet a man. Do not let a stupid one in his folly meet a man]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:12 (#7)

שפכיל

“robbed of offspring”

Although the word **offspring** is singular in form, here it refers to all of a bear's cubs as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [robbed of cubs]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:13 (#3)

רעה & טובבה & רעה

“evil & good, evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **evil** in 1:16 and **good** in 11:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:13 (#5)

מִבֵּיתוֹ

“his house”

See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:13 (#4)

לֹא־תִמְּשֵׁשׁ רָעָעָה מִבֵּיתוֹ

“evil will not depart from his house”

Here Solomon speaks of **evil** affecting someone's family as if **evil** were a person who would not leave the person's **house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [evil will not stop affecting his house]

See: Personification

Proverbs 17:13 (#2)

מְשֻׁשִׁיב & מִבֵּיתוֹ

“One who returns & his house”

One who returns and **his** represent a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who returns ... that person's house]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:13 (#1)

מְשֻׁשִׁיב רָעָה תִּתְּנָה טוֹבָה לֹא־תִמְּשֵׁשׁ רָעָעָה מִבֵּיתוֹ

“One who returns evil for good, evil will not depart from his house”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Evil will not depart from the house of one who returns evil for good]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 17:14 (#3)

הָרָגִיב נָטוּשׁ

“leave the dispute”

Here Solomon refers to stopping a **dispute** before it begins as if **the dispute** were a place that someone could **leave**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [avoid the dispute] or [end the dispute]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:14 (#1)

מִדְּוֶן & הָרָגִיב

“a quarrel & the dispute”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **quarrel** and **dispute** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:14 (#4)

הִתְגַּלְלַע

“it breaks out”

Here Solomon refers to a **quarrel** starting as if it were water that suddenly **breaks out** of a container or dam. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it suddenly begins]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:14 (#2)

פְּפוּטָר מַמִּים

“is} the releasing of water”

Here Solomon speaks of the difficulty in stopping a **quarrel** after it starts as if the **the beginning of a quarrel** were **water** that began to leak from a container or dam. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is difficult to stop] or [is as difficult to stop as water leaking from a container]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:15 (#2)

מִצְדִּיק רָשָׁע וּמִרְשָׁעִי צִדִּיק

“One who declares a wicked one righteous and one who declares a righteous one wicked”

In this verse **wicked** refers to being guilty of doing something **wicked**, and **righteous** refers to being innocent of doing something **wicked**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meanings plainly. Alternate translation: [One who declares a guilty one innocent and one who declares an innocent one guilty]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:15 (#3)

תועבבת יהוה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated **an abomination to Yahweh** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:15 (#1)

מצדיק רשע ומרשש צדיק & גם שניהם

“One who declares a wicked one righteous and one who declares a righteous one wicked, even the two of them”

One who declares, a wicked one, a righteous one, and the two of them represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who declares any wicked person righteous and any person who declares any righteous person wicked, even both types of people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:16 (#3)

מחזיר ביד-כסיל

“A payment {is} in the hand of a stupid one”

Here Solomon refers to a **stupid one** trying to buy **wisdom** as if he were holding in his **hand** the money with which to buy it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A stupid one tries to pay money]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:16 (#4)

חכמה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:16 (#2)

מחזיר ביד-כסיל

“A payment {is} in the hand of a stupid one”

Here, a **payment**, the **hand**, and a **stupid one** represent these things and people in general, not specific things or people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [payments are in the hands of stupid people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:16 (#5)

ולב-אין

“but there is no heart”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer to a person’s ability to reason. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar phrase “lacking of heart” in 6:32. Alternate translation: [but he has no ability to reason]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:16 (#1)

למה-זוה מחזיר ביד-כסיל לקנות חכמה ולב-אין

“Why {is} this: A payment {is} in the hand of a stupid one to acquire wisdom, but there is no heart”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize how nonsensical it is for a **stupid** person to try to buy **wisdom**. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is ridiculous that a payment is in the hand of a stupid one to acquire wisdom but there is no heart!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 17:17 (#4)

ואח

“and a brother”

Although the term **brother** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and a sibling]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 17:17 (#5)

ללצרה

“for distress”

Here Solomon indicates that one purposes for which a **brother is born** is to help his siblings when they are in **distress**. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of helping during a time of distress]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:17 (#2)

הַרֵעַ

“the friend”

Here, **the friend** refers to friends in general, not a specific **friend**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any friend]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:17 (#3)

אֱהֵב

“loves”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [loves his friends]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:17 (#1)

בְּכָל־עֵת

“At every time”

Alternate translation: [At all times] or [All the time]

Proverbs 17:17 (#6)

לְצָרָה

“for distress”

See how you translated the abstract noun **distress** in 1:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:18 (#2)

חֲסֵר־לֵב

“lacking of heart”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 7:7.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:18 (#3)

תִּקְקַע כַּף

“is} one who clasps a palm”

See how you translated the same idiom in 6:1.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 17:18 (#1)

אָדָם & תִּקְקַע כַּף & עֲטָרְכָּהּ & רֵעֵהּ

“A man & is} one who clasps a palm & a pledge & his neighbor”

A man, one who clasps, a palm, a pledge, and his refer to types of people and things in general, not specific people or things. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person ... is a person who clasps palms ... any pledge ... that person's neighbor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:18 (#4)

לְפָנַי

“to the face of”

This could refer to: (1) being in the presence of **his neighbor**, as in 14:19. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]; (2) doing something on the behalf of **his neighbor**. Alternate translation: [on behalf of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:19 (#3)

מִגְבִּייהַ פִּתְחוֹ

“one who makes his opening high”

This phrase could refer to: (1) someone who speaks proudly, as if his mouth were an **opening** located at a **high** place above others. Alternate translation: [one who speaks proudly]; (2) someone who makes a fancy doorway for his house, as if he put the doorway at a **high** place. Alternate translation: [one who makes his doorway fancy]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:19 (#2)

פֶּשַׁע & מִצָּעָה

“transgression & contention”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **transgression** in 10:19 and **contention** in 13:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:19 (#1)

אִתָּהּ & מִגְבִּיָּה פֶּתַח חֵיו

“One who loves & one who makes his opening high”

One who loves, one who makes his doorway high, and **his** refer to types of people and things in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who loves ... any person who makes his opening high]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:19 (#4)

מִבְקֵשׁ-שֹׁכֵר

“seeks a breaking”

Here Solomon speaks of a person doing something that will cause that person to be destroyed as if that person **seeks** for someone to break his bones. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes himself to be destroyed] or [causes his own ruin]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:20 (#3)

לֹא יִמְצָא-טוֹב

“will not find goodness”

Here Solomon refers to someone experiencing **goodness** as if **goodness** were an object that a person can **find** by searching for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not experience goodness]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:20 (#2)

עָקֹשׁ-לֵב

“One crooked of heart”

See how you translated **crooked of heart** in 11:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:20 (#4)

טוֹב & בְּרָעָה

“goodness & into evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **goodness** in 13:21 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:20 (#1)

עָקֹשׁ-לֵב & וְנִהְפָּךְ בְּלִשְׁוֹנוֹ

“One crooked of heart & and one who is turned away in his tongue”

One crooked of heart, one who is turned away, and **his** refer to types of people and things in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person crooked of heart ... and any person who is turned away in his tongue]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:20 (#5)

וְנִהְפָּךְ בְּלִשְׁוֹנוֹ

“and one who is turned away in his tongue”

Here Solomon refers to a person who speaks deceitfully as if that person **is turned away in his tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and one who speaks perversely] or [and one who speaks wickedly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:20 (#6)

יִפּוּל בְּרָעָה

“will fall into evil”

See how you translated “falls into evil” in 13:17.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:21 (#5)

וְלֹא-יִשְׂמַח

“and & will not rejoice”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that emphasizes the meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the meaning without “not” in another way, as in the UST.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 17:21 (#2)

יִלְד כָּסִיל & לֵו & אָבִי נָכַל

“One who begets a stupid one & for him & the father of a worthless one”

One who begets, a stupid one, him, the father, and a worthless one refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18 and **a worthless one** in 17:7. Alternate translation: [Any person who begets a stupid person ... for that person ... any father of a worthless one]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:21 (#4)

לתנוגה

“it is} for grief”

See how you translated the abstract noun **grief** in 10:1.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:21 (#1)

יִלְדָּד כְּכַסִּיל לְתַתְנוּגָה לָלוֹ וְלֹא־יִשְׁמַח אָבִיו בְּכֵל

“**One who begets a stupid one, {it is} for grief for him, and the father of a worthless one will not rejoice**”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [One who begets a stupid one, it is for grief for him; yes, the father of a worthless one will not rejoice]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 17:21 (#3)

לתנוגה

“it is} for grief”

Here, **it is for** indicates that what follows is the result of begetting **a stupid one**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [it results in grief]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 17:22 (#1)

לֵב שְׂשׂוּמָה

“A joyful heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 15:13.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:22 (#4)

תִּיבֶשׂ-גָרֶם

“dries up bone”

Here Solomon refers to people becoming unhealthy as if their bones were drying up. The word **bone** here refers to a person’s whole body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar phrase “decay of bones” in 14:30. Alternate translation: [causes that person to be unhealthy]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:22 (#2)

יִטְטֵב גְּהֵרָה

“makes healing good”

Here, **make healing good** refers to causing the person with a **joyful heart** to become healthy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will make that person healthy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:22 (#3)

וְרִרוּחַ נִנְכָּאָה

“but a broken spirit”

Here, **a broken spirit** refers to feeling sad. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but being depressed]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:23 (#3)

לְלִהְטוֹת אֶרְחָחוֹת מִשְׁפָּט

“to bend the paths of justice”

Here Solomon refers to causing judges to make an unjust verdict as if the legal process had **paths** that a person could **bend**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to prevent justice from being rendered] or [to prevent judges from giving just verdicts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:23 (#1)

שֹׁשֶׁהָד מִמֶּחִיק רֶשֶׁעַ יִקָּחָה

“A wicked one takes a bribe from the bosom”

A wicked one, a bribe, and the bosom represent these things and people in general, not specific things or people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any wicked person takes a bribe from any bosom]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:23 (#4)

מִשְׁפָּט

“justice”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:23 (#2)

מִמְחֵיב

“from the bosom”

Here, **from the bosom** indicates that **a bribe** is given to someone secretly, as if it were hidden in a person's clothes near that person's **bosom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in secret]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:24 (#3)

אֶת-פָּנָיו

“is} with the face of”

Here Solomon refers to **an understanding one** always paying attention to **Wisdom** as if **Wisdom** were in front of **the face** of that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is in the mind of] or [is the focus of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 17:24 (#1)

חִכְמָה

“Wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **Wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:24 (#2)

מִבְּרִין & כְּסִיף

“an understanding one & a stupid one”

See how you translated **an understanding one** in 17:10 and **a stupid one** in 10:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:24 (#4)

וְעֵינָיו כְּכִסְיָל בְּקֶצֶה-אָרֶץ

“but the eyes of a stupid one {are} at the end of the earth”

Here Solomon refers to **a stupid one** being unable to pay attention to anything as if that person's **eyes** were **at the end of the earth**. If it would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but a stupid one's mind is all over the place] or [but a stupid one is not able to focus his thoughts]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 17:25 (#3)

כִּכְעַס & וְאִמְרָמוֹר

“is} a grief & and bitterness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **grief** in 10:1 and **bitterness** in 14:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:25 (#2)

כִּכְעַס לְאָבִיו

“is} a grief to his father”

Here Solomon speaks of a **son** causing his father to feel **grief** as if that **son** himself were that **grief**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes grief for his father] or [causes his father to feel grief]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:25 (#1)

לְאָבִיו בֶּן כִּסְיָל & לְיֹלְדָתוֹ

“A stupid son & to his father & to her who bore him”

A stupid son, his, her, and him represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated a **stupid son** in 10:1. Alternate translation: [Any stupid son ... to that person's father ... to the mother who bore that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:25 (#4)

וּמִקְמָר לְיֹדְדָתוֹ

“and bitterness to her who bore him”

Here Solomon speaks of a **son** causing his mother to feel **bitterness** as if that **son** himself were that **bitterness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and causes bitterness for her who bore him] or [and causes her who bore him to feel bitter]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:26 (#1)

עֲנֹשׁ לְצַדִּיק

“to fine the righteous”

Here, **fine** refers to requiring a **the righteous** to pay money as a penalty for a crime that **the righteous** did not do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to wrongly require the righteous to pay a penalty]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:26 (#5)

יָשָׁר

“uprightness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **uprightness** in 4:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:26 (#3)

לֹא־טוֹב

“is} not good”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [is evil]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 17:26 (#4)

לְהַכּוֹת נְדִיבִים

“to strike nobles”

The parallelism with the previous clause indicates that Solomon is referring to striking **nobles** who did not do anything wrong. Here, **nobles** refers to people who

have a position of ruling and also have noble character. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to wrongly strike noble people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 17:26 (#2)

לְצַדִּיק

“the righteous”

Solomon is using the adjective **righteous** as a noun to mean **righteous** people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the righteous ones] or [people who act righteously]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 17:27 (#3)

דָּדַעַת & תְּבוּנָה

“knowledge & understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **knowledge** in 1:4 and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 17:27 (#4)

וּקְרִירָרוּת

“and the cool of spirit”

Here, **the cool of spirit** is an idiom that refers to someone who controls their emotions. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the coolheaded person] or [and someone who controls his emotions]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 17:27 (#1)

חֹשֶׁשׁ & יוֹדָע & וּקְרִירָרוּת אִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

“One restraining & is} one knowing & and the cool of spirit {is} a man of understanding”

One restraining, **one knowing**, **knowledge**, **the cool of spirit**, and **a man of understanding** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **One who restrains** in 10:19 and **a man of understanding** in 10:23. Alternate translation: [Any person who restrains

... is a person who knows ... and any person who is cool of spirit is a person of understanding]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:27 (#2)

אֲמָרִי

“his words”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:28 (#5)

אִטְטִים שְׁפִתָּי נָבוֹן

“one shutting his lips—understanding”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [one shutting his lips will be considered understanding]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 17:28 (#6)

אִטְטִים שְׁפִתָּי

“one shutting his lips”

Here Solomon refers to someone who refrains from speaking unnecessarily as if that person **shuts his lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one who does not speak unnecessarily]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 17:28 (#2)

אֲוִיל & אִטְטִים שְׁפִתָּי נָבוֹן

“a fool & one shutting his lips—understanding”

Here, **a fool** and **one shutting his lips** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a fool** in 7:22. Alternate translation: [any fool ... any person who shuts his lips—an understanding person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 17:28 (#1)

גַּם אֲוִיל מִמְּחֵרֵשׁ הֵכֶם יִהְיֶה אִטְטִים שְׁפִתָּי נָבוֹן

“Even a fool keeping silent will be considered wise; one shutting his lips—understanding”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Even a fool keeping silent will be considered wise; yes, one shutting his lips—understanding]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 17:28 (#4)

יִהְיֶה

“will be considered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will consider to be]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 17:28 (#3)

מִמְּחֵרֵשׁ

“keeping silent”

This phrase refers to someone who refrains from speaking unnecessarily. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who does not speak unnecessarily]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs - Chapter 18 Introduction

Chapter 18 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 18 also contains contrasting parallelism (18:2, 12, 14, 23, 24) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (18:7, 15, 20). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 18:1 (#1)

לְתֹאמָה יִבְקַק נְפֹרֵד & יִתְגַּלֵּעַ

“One who separates himself seeks for desire & he breaks out”

One who separates himself and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [People who separate themselves seek for desire ... those people break out]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:1 (#4)

בְּכָל-תַּתְּוֹשִׁיָּהּ יִתְגַּלֵּעַ

“against all sound wisdom, he breaks out”

Here Solomon describes a person who **breaks out** into a quarrel with anyone who offers him **sound wisdom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **breaks out** in 17:14. Alternate translation: [he breaks out into a quarrel with anyone who speaks to him with sound wisdom]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:1 (#5)

בְּכָל-תַּתְּוֹשִׁיָּהּ

“against all sound wisdom”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sound wisdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [against anything that is soundly wise]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:1 (#3)

לְלִתְאֹהֶה יִבְקֶשׁ

“seeks for desire”

Here Solomon implies that this person **seeks** to fulfill his own **desire**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [seeks to fulfill his own desire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:1 (#2)

וַיִּפְרֹד

“One who separates himself”

Here Solomon implies that this person **separates himself** from other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alter-

nate translation: [One who keeps away from other people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:2 (#5)

בְּהַתְּגַלְלוֹת לִבּוֹ

“in his heart revealing itself”

Here Solomon refers to a **stupid one** telling people what he thinks as if his **heart** were **revealing itself**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [in telling people his opinion]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:2 (#4)

בְּהַתְּגַלְלוֹת לִבּוֹ

“in his heart revealing itself”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [a stupid one delights in his heart revealing itself]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 18:2 (#2)

לֹא-יִתְפַּפֵּץ & בְּהִבְוִינָהּ

“does not delight in understanding”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [detests understanding]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 18:2 (#1)

בְּכָסִיל & לִבּוֹ

“A stupid one & his heart”

A stupid one and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any stupid person ... that person's heart]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:2 (#3)

בְּתוֹבוֹנָה

“in understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:3 (#4)

וְעִם־קָלְלוֹן תִּרְפָּה

“and with shame, reproach”

Here Solomon speaks of a shameful person coming as though **shame** itself were coming, and of people acting reproachfully toward that person as though **reproach** were also a person that was arriving. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and when a shameful person comes, people will reproach that person]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:3 (#3)

וְעִם־קָלְלוֹן תִּרְפָּה

“and with shame, reproach”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and with shame comes reproach]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 18:3 (#2)

בְּבוֹז & קָלְלוֹן תִּרְפָּה

“contempt & shame, reproach”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **contempt**, **shame**, and **reproach**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **contempt** in 12:8 and **shame** in 6:33. Alternate translation: [feeling contemptuous ... feeling shameful, being reproached]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:3 (#1)

בְּבוֹז גַּם־בְּבוֹז

“contempt also comes”

Here Solomon speaks of experiencing **contempt** as if it were a person who can come to a location. This could mean: (1) people show **contempt** towards a **wicked one**. Alternate translation: [people feel contempt for him]; (2) a **wicked one** shows **contempt** for others. Alternate translation: [he shows his contempt for other people]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:4 (#7)

נַחֲלַל נִגְבַּחֵץ מִקְקוֹר חֲכָמָה

“a fountain of wisdom {is} a gushing stream”

Here Solomon speaks of a wise person having plentiful **wisdom** as if wisdom sprang out of him like water out of a **fountain** that became a **gushing stream**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [he speaks wise sayings in abundance] or [He is a source of plentiful wisdom like a fountain that produces a gushing stream]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:4 (#6)

חֲכָמָה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:4 (#4)

מַמִּים עֲמֻמִּים

“are} deep waters”

Here Solomon speaks of a wise man’s words being profound as if they were **deep waters**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [are profound] or [are deep like deep waters]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:4 (#3)

פִּי־אָדָם

“the mouth of a man”

Here, **the mouth** and **a man** represent mouths and people in general, not one particular **mouth** and **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [the mouths of people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:4 (#1)

דְּבַרְיֵי פִי־אָדָם

“The words of the mouth of a man”

This phrase refers to the **words** that **a man** says by using his **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The words that a man says with his mouth]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:4 (#5)

מִקְקוֹר חָכְמָה

“a fountain of wisdom”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **fountain** that gives **wisdom**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a fountain that gives wisdom]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:4 (#2)

דְּבַרְיֵי פִי־אָדָם

“The words of the mouth of a man”

The second clause indicates that Solomon is referring to wise **words** spoken by a wise **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The wise words of the mouth of a wise man]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:5 (#5)

רָשָׁע וְצַדִּיק

“the wicked & the righteous”

Solomon is using the adjectives **wicked** and **righteous** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [wicked people ... righteous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 18:5 (#6)

לְהַטּוֹת

“to turn aside”

Here, **to** marks **turn aside** as the goal or purpose of lifting **the face of the wicked one**. Use a natural way in your language to express a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of turning aside]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 18:5 (#2)

שִׂיאָת פְּנֵי־רָשָׁע וְצַדִּיק בַּמִּשְׁפָּט

“to lift the face of the wicked & the righteous in the judgment”

Here, **the face**, **the wicked**, **the righteous**, and **the judgment** represent these things and people in general, not specific things and people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [to lift the faces of the wicked ones ... the righteous ones in the judgments]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:5 (#7)

לְהַטּוֹת

“to turn aside”

Here, depriving an innocent person of a just **judgment** is spoken of as if **the righteous one** were made to **turn aside** when judged in court. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to deprive of justice]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:5 (#1)

לֹא־טוֹב

“It is} not good”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [It is surely bad]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 18:5 (#8)

בַּמִּשְׁפָּט

“in the judgment”

Here, **the judgment** refers to the verdict of a judge in a legal case. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation:

[regarding the verdict of his case] or [when his case is decided]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:5 (#4)

רָשָׁע וְצַדִּיק

“the wicked & the righteous”

In this verse, **the wicked** refers to someone who is guilty of doing something **wicked** and **the righteous** refers to someone who is innocent of doing something wicked. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **wicked** and **righteous** in 17:15. Alternate translation: [the guilty one ... the innocent one]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:5 (#3)

שֹׂאֵת פָּנָי

“to lift the face of”

Here, **to lift the face** is an idiom that means “to show partiality” or “to favor”. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to show favoritism to] or [to be partial to]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 18:6 (#2)

יִבְאֹוּ בְּרִיב

“enter into a dispute”

Here Solomon speaks of what a **stupid one** says with his **lips** causing that person to start a **dispute** as if his **lips** were a person who could **enter into a dispute**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [results in him starting an argument]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:6 (#3)

וּפִיו לְמַדְלִמּוֹת יִקְרָא

“and his mouth calls for blows”

Here Solomon speaks of what a **stupid one** says with **his mouth**, causing people to want to beat him as if he were inviting them with **his mouth** to strike him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what he says causes people to want to beat him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:6 (#1)

כְּכִסִּיל & בְּרִיב וּפִיו

“a stupid one & into a dispute, and his mouth”

Here, **a stupid one**, **a dispute** and **his** refer to stupid people and disputes in general, not one particular **stupid one** or **dispute**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any stupid one ... into disputes, and that person’s mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:7 (#5)

נַפְשׁוֹ

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:7 (#4)

מוֹקֵקֶשׁ נַפְשׁוֹ

“are} a snare of his life”

Here Solomon speaks as if **his lips** were a **snare** that traps **a stupid one** when speaking of how what he says with **his lips** causes him trouble. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [will threaten his life] or [are like a snare that traps him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:7 (#2)

פִּי & וּפִתְּחוֹתָיו

“The mouth of & and his lips”

See how you translated the same use of **mouth** and **lips** in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:7 (#3)

מַחֲתָה לָלוֹ

“is} ruin for him”

Here, **is** indicates that what follows is the result of what **a stupid one** says. Use the most natural way in

your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [causes ruin for him] or [will result in his ruin]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 18:7 (#1)

פִּי־כָכָסִיל מַחֲתָה־לָּלוּ וְיִשְׁפֹּתֻנִּיו מִזְקָקָשׁ נִפְשׁוֹ

“The mouth of a stupid one {is} ruin for him, and his lips {are} a snare of his life”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [The mouth of a stupid one is ruin for him, yes, his lips are a snare of his life]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 18:8 (#4)

וְהֵלֵאִם יִרְדְּדוּ

“and they themselves go down into”

The intensive pronoun **themselves** represents the pronoun “they” that Solomon uses in the original even though the verb translated as **go down** already includes this meaning. Doing this emphasizes how significant it was that what murmurers said was listened to by others. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [and those very words go down into]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 18:8 (#2)

כְּמִתְלַהֲמָמִים

“are} like things swallowed greedily”

Solomon is saying that the **words of a murmurer** are like **things swallowed greedily** because people are eager to hear gossip. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [are listened to eagerly]

See: Simile

Proverbs 18:8 (#5)

חֲדָרֵי־בֶטֶן

“the rooms of the belly”

Here, **the rooms of the belly** refers to the innermost part of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the innermost part of a person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:8 (#1)

דְּבָרָיו

“The words of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:8 (#3)

וְהֵלֵאִם יִרְדְּדוּ חֲדָרֵי־בֶטֶן

“and they themselves go down into the rooms of the belly”

Here Solomon speaks of the **words of a murmurer** staying in a person’s mind and affecting that person’s thoughts as if they were food that goes **down into** a person’s stomach. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they enter a person’s mind and affect his thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:9 (#3)

לְבַבְעַל מִשְׁחִית

“to an owner of destruction”

Here Solomon refers to a person who destroys things as if that person were **an owner of destruction**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to a person who destroys everything] or [to someone who is always destructive]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 18:9 (#2)

אָחָה

“is} a brother”

Here Solomon speaks of the **one who slacks** being similar to **an owner of destruction** as if **he** were that person’s **brother**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is closely related] or [is very similar]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:9 (#1)

מתרפפה במקלאכתו אאח זהוא לבבעל משחית

“one who slacks in his work, he {is} a brother to an owner of destruction”

Here, **one who slacks**, **his**, **a brother**, and **an owner of destruction** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who slacks in that person's work, that person is a brother to any owner of destruction]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:10 (#3)

מגדל-עז & בור-רוץ צדיק ונשגב

“{is} a tower of strength; the righteous {one} runs into it and is set on high”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh protecting his people as if he were a **tower** into which they could run and take refuge **on high** above their enemies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [protects righteous people and keeps them safe from their enemies] or [protects his people like a strong tower provides protection for those who are inside]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:10 (#2)

מגדל-עז

“{is} a tower of strength”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **tower** that is characterized by **strength**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is a tower characterized by strength]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:10 (#4)

צדיק

“the righteous {one}”

Here, **the righteous one** represents **righteous** people in general, not one particular **righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:10 (#5)

ונשגב

“and is set on high”

Here Solomon speaks of a person being safe as if that person were **set on high** at the top of a tower where no one could harm him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and is secure]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:10 (#1)

שנים יהוה

“The name of Yahweh”

Here, **name of Yahweh** refers to **Yahweh** himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:11 (#1)

הון עשיר קרית עוז

“The wealth of the rich one {is} the city of his strength”

See how you translated the same clause in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:11 (#2)

וכחוממה נשגב

“and like a wall set on high”

Solomon is saying that the **wealth of a rich one** is like **a wall set on high** because **the rich one** thinks that his **wealth** will protect him from enemies, as a **high wall** protects. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and it will protect him like a wall set on high]

See: Simile

Proverbs 18:11 (#3)

במשכיתו

“in his imagination”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **imagination**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [according to what he imagines]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:12 (#1)

לפני־שֹׁשֶׁבֶר

“To the face of breaking”

Here and in the next clause Solomon is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” Here, **breaking** refers to being ruined or destroyed. See how you translated this phrase in 16:18. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Before he is ruined]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:12 (#3)

לב

“the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:12 (#2)

יִגְבֶּהָ לֵב־אָדָם

“the heart of a man is exalted”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a man exalts his heart]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 18:12 (#4)

אָדָם

“a man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 18:12 (#5)

וְלִפְנֵי כְבוֹד וְעָנָה

“but to the face of honor—humility”

See how you translated the same clause in 15:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:13 (#3)

דָּבָר

“a word”

See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25. Alternate translation: [an answer]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:13 (#2)

מִשְׁשִׁיב דָּבָר

“One who returns a word”

Here, **returns** refers to replying to what someone has said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who replies with an answer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:13 (#4)

אִנּוּלֵת & וְכִלְמָה

“is} folly & and shame”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **folly** in 5:23 and **shame** in 6:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:13 (#1)

מִשְׁשִׁיב דָּבָר בְּטֶטֶרֶם יִשְׁמָעַע & לֹא

“One who returns a word before he listens & to him”

One who returns, a word, he, and **him** refer to a type of person and **word** in general, not one particular person or **word**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who returns any word before listening ... to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:14 (#2)

יִכְלֹכֵל

“will endure”

Here Solomon implies that a person’s **spirit** enables that person to **endure his illness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will enable him to endure]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:14 (#1)

רוח & וררניה נִכְבָּאָה

“The spirit of & but a crushed spirit”

In this verse, **spirit** refers to a person's attitude. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The attitude of ... but a crushed attitude]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:14 (#5)

יִשְׁאָנָה

“can lift it”

Here Solomon refers to helping a depressed person feel better as if one could **lift** that person's **spirit**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [can restore it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:14 (#4)

מִמִּי יִשְׁאָנָה

“who can lift it”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize the difficulty of helping a depressed person feel better. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [surely no one can lift it!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 18:14 (#3)

וְרוּחַ נִכְבָּאָה

“but a crushed spirit”

Here Solomon refers to a person who desponds as if that person's **spirit** were **crushed** by something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 15:13. Alternate translation: [but an attitude of despair]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:15 (#3)

לֵב נִבְוִן יִקְנֶה

“The heart of an understanding one acquires”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person's intentions and desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 15:14. Alternate translation: [An understanding one desires to acquire]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:15 (#5)

וְאָזְנוֹ הַחֲכָמִים תִּבְקֹשׁ

“and the ear of the wise seeks”

Here, **ear** refers to the way that a person learns by listening. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the wise ones seek to hear]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:15 (#1)

לֵב נִבְוִן יִקְנֶה דָּדָעַת וְאָזְנוֹ הַחֲכָמִים תִּבְקֹשׁ-דָּעַת

“The heart of an understanding one acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks knowledge”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [The heart of an understanding one acquires knowledge, yes, and the ear of the wise ones seeks knowledge]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 18:15 (#2)

לֵב נִבְוִן יִקְנֶה דָּדָעַת וְאָזְנוֹ הַחֲכָמִים תִּבְקֹשׁ-דָּעַת

“The heart of an understanding one acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks knowledge”

The heart, **an understanding one**, and **the ear** represents these things and type of people in general, not specific things or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The hearts of understanding ones acquire knowledge, and the ears of the wise seek knowledge]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:15 (#6)

תִּבְקֹשׁ

“seeks”

See how you translated the same use of **seeks** in 11:27.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:15 (#4)

דָּדַעַת & דָּעַת

“knowledge & knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:16 (#4)

וְלִפְנֵי

“and before the face of”

See how you translated the same use of **before the face of** in 14:19.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:16 (#2)

מִתְּתֵן אָדָם

“The gift of a man”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **gift** that is given by **a man**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [What a man gives]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:16 (#3)

יִרְהִיב

“will make room”

Here, **make room** is an idiom that means “create an opportunity.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will open doors] or [will create an opportunity]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 18:16 (#5)

יִבְהִיגוּ

“it will guide him”

Here **it** refers to **The gift**. Solomon speaks of this gift as if it were a living thing that could **guide** the person who gives it. He means that giving a gift could result in a person meeting **great ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it will enable him to go]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:16 (#1)

מִתְּתֵן אָדָם & לָלוּ & יִבְהִיגוּ

“The gift of a man & for him & it will guide him”

The gift, a man, him, and **it** refer to gifts and people in general, not one particular **gift** or person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [A gift of any person ... for that person ... it will guide that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:17 (#4)

יִבְאֵר רֵעֵהוּ

“then his neighbor comes”

Solomon implies that there is a contrast between the idea of the previous clause and this clause. Solomon implies that the results of examining the **first one** will be that **his case** is not **right**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [but then his neighbor comes]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 18:17 (#3)

הָרִאשׁוֹן

“The first one”

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [Person one]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Proverbs 18:17 (#2)

הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּרִיבּוֹ & רֵעֵהוּ וְחִקְרוּ

“The first one with his case & his neighbor & and examines him”

The first one, his, and **him** refer to a type of person, not a particular **first one**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who first brings his case ... that person's neighbor ... and examines that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:17 (#1)

צדדיק הראשון בריבגו יבא־ירצעהו וחקרו

“The first one with his case {is} right; then his neighbor comes and examines him”

This verse refers to a dispute in which one person states **his case** that seems to be **right** until that person’s **neighbor examines him** by asking him questions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When people dispute, the first one states his case and seems to be right. Then his neighbor comes and questions what he said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:18 (#3)

ממדוניים

“quarrels”

See how you translated the abstract noun **quarrels** in 6:14.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:18 (#4)

יפריד

“it makes a separation”

The phrase **makes a separation** refers to discerning which of the **mighty ones** is correct in an argument. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [it discerns who is correct]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:18 (#1)

הגורל

“The lot”

The **lot** refers to casting lots in general, not a specific **lot**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Casting lots]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:18 (#2)

הגורל

“The lot”

See how you translated **lot** in 16:33.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 18:19 (#5)

בברית ארמון

“are} like the gate bar of a fortress”

This could mean: (1) **quarrels** cause people to stay away from each other as though a **bar** blocking the **gate** of a **fortress** were between them. Alternate translation: [separate people like the gate bar of a fortress]; (2) resolving **quarrels** is as difficult as trying to enter a **fortress** that has a **bar** across its **gate**. Alternate translation: [are as difficult to resolve as breaking the gate bar of a fortress]

See: Simile

Proverbs 18:19 (#4)

ומדוניים

“and quarrels”

See how you translated the abstract noun **quarrels** in 6:14.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:19 (#3)

מקרי־עץ

“is} more than a city of strength”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **city** that is characterized by **strength**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is more than a strong city]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:19 (#1)

אָח

“A brother”

Here, **brother** refers to any relative or close friend. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A relative]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:19 (#2)

מקרי־עץ

“is} more than a city of strength”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word or phrase if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is more unyielding than a city of strength] or [is more difficult to approach than a city of strength]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 18:19 (#6)

מְכַרְיָהּ

“are} like the gate bar of”

A **gate bar** was a large piece of metal or wood that was placed across a **gate** in order to make the **gate** difficult to break down or open. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of **bar**, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [are like the large beam placed across the gate of]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 18:20 (#3)

מִפִּי־אִישׁ

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man”

See how you translated this phrase in 12:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:20 (#5)

תְּבוּאָתָא שִׁפְתָּתָיו יִשְׂבֹּעַ

“with} the produce of his lips, he is satisfied”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the produce of his lips satisfies him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 18:20 (#4)

תִּשְׂבֹּעַ בְּטֶנְגוֹ

“his belly is satisfied”

Here Solomon is using one part of a person, his **belly**, to mean all of him in the act of being satisfied with fruit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will eat enough to feel satisfied]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 18:20 (#1)

מִפִּי־אִישׁ תִּשְׂבֹּעַ בְּטֶנְגוֹ תְּבוּאָתָא שִׁפְתָּתָיו יִשְׂבֹּעַ

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man his belly is satisfied; {with} the produce of his lips, he is satisfied”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [From the fruit of the mouth of a man his belly is satisfied; yes, with the produce of his lips, he is satisfied]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 18:20 (#6)

תְּבוּאָתָא שִׁפְתָּתָיו

“with} the produce of his lips”

Here Solomon refers to what a person says as if it were **produce** from that person's **lips**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with what he says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:20 (#2)

מִפִּי־אִישׁ תִּשְׂבֹּעַ בְּטֶנְגוֹ

“From the fruit of the mouth of a man his belly is satisfied”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The fruit of the mouth of a man satisfies his belly]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 18:21 (#3)

בְּיָד

“are} in the hand of”

Solomon is using **in the hand of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “determined by.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are determined by] or [are in the power of]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 18:21 (#5)

וְאִתְּהֶבְרִיָּה יֹאכֵל פְּרִיָּהּ

“and those who love it will eat its fruit”

Here, **it** refers to **the tongue**, which represents what someone says by using the tongue. Solomon speaks of having respect for what one says and speaking well as loving the tongue. Those who speak well, recognizing and using well the power of their words, will **eat** the **fruit** of speaking well. Eating the **fruit** represents receiving the consequences for what they say, as also in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and those who speak well will benefit from the words that they say]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:21 (#4)

לְשׁוֹן

“the tongue”

See how you translated the same use of **tongue** in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 18:21 (#1)

מָמוֹת וְחַיִּים בְּיַד־לְשׁוֹן

“Death and life {are} in the hand of the tongue”

Here Solomon speaks of a person’s **tongue** as if it were a person who held **Death and life** in his **hand**. He means that what people say can cause people to die or stay alive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A person’s death and life can be determined by what a person says]

See: Personification

Proverbs 18:21 (#2)

מָמוֹת וְחַיִּים

“Death and life”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Death** in 2:18 and **life** in 8:36.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:22 (#4)

רִצְצוֹן

“favor”

Here, **favor** could refer to: (1) Yahweh being pleased with the man **who finds a wife**, as in the identical phrase in 8:35. Alternate translation: [approval]; (2) the **wife** mentioned in the previous clause, in which case **favor** would mean “gift.” Alternate translation: [a gift]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:22 (#3)

טָוֹב וְרִצְצוֹן

“good & favor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **good** in 11:27 and **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 18:22 (#2)

מִצְצָא & מְצָא

“He who finds & finds”

Obtaining **a wife** and something **good** are spoken of as if they are objects that a person **finds** by searching. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He who obtains ... obtains]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:22 (#1)

מִצְצָא אִשָּׁה & וְיִפְקֶה

“He who finds a wife & and he obtains”

He who finds, **a wife**, and **he** refer to people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who finds a wife ... and that person obtains]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:23 (#2)

תְּחַנּוּגִּים יִדְבֹּר

“speaks pleas”

The phrase **speaks pleas** refers to someone humbly asking or begging for mercy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [pleads for mercy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:23 (#3)

יִעֲנֶה

“answers”

Here Solomon implies that **a rich one answers** the **pleas of One who is poor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [answers the poor one]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:23 (#1)

רַגֵּשׁ וְנָעַשׂ שִׁיר

“One who is poor & but a rich one”

One who is poor and **a rich one** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any poor person ... but any rich person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:24 (#2)

אָמִישׁ רַרְעִים

“A man of companions”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who has **companions**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A man with companions]

See: Possession

Proverbs 18:24 (#6)

דָּבִקָּב מֵאָח

“clinging more than a brother”

Here Solomon refers to a person's friend being more loyal than **a brother** as if that friend were **clinging** to him **more than a brother** would cling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [more faithful than family]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 18:24 (#1)

אָמִישׁ רַרְעִים & אֹהֶב & מֵאָח

“A man of companions & one who loves & more than a brother”

A man, **one who loves**, and **a brother** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of

companions ... any person who loves ... more than any brother]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 18:24 (#5)

לְהִתְרַעֵץ

“is} to be broken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will experience ruin]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 18:24 (#3)

אָמִישׁ רַרְעִים

“A man of companions”

This phrase could refer to: (1) a person who has false or unreliable **companions** who harm him, which contrasts with **one who loves** in the next clause. Alternate translation: [A man with unreliable companions]; (2) a person who has too many **companions**. Alternate translation: [A man with too many companions]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 18:24 (#4)

לְהִתְרַעֵץ

“is} to be broken”

Here Solomon refers to a person being destroyed as if he were **broken**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will experience destruction] or [will be destroyed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs - Chapter 19 Introduction**Structure and Formatting**

Chapter 19 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter**Parallelism**

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 19 also contains contrasting parallelism (19:4, 12, 14, 16, 21)

and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (19:5, 9). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 19:1 (#4)

מַעֲקָשׁ שֶׁשִּׁפְתָּיו תִּי

“than one who is crooked {in} his lips”

Here Solomon uses the phrase **crooked in his lips** to refer to someone who speaks deceptively. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **crooked** in 2:15. Alternate translation: [than one who speaks with deception]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:1 (#3)

בְּתִמְמוֹ

“in his integrity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:1 (#2)

הוֹלֵךְ בְּתִמְמוֹ

“who walks in his integrity”

Here Solomon speaks of a person behaving with **integrity** as if **integrity** were a place that person **walks in**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [who behaves with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:1 (#1)

רָשׁ & בְּתִמְמוֹ מַעֲקָשׁ שֶׁשִּׁפְתָּיו תִּי וְהָיָה כְּסִיל

“is} one who is poor & in his integrity than one who is crooked {in} his lips and he {is} a stupid one”

Here, **one who is poor**, **his**, **one who is crooked**, **he**, and **a stupid one** all refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [is a poor person ... in that person's integrity than a person who is crooked in that one's lips and is a stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:2 (#2)

זֵאֵל

“zeal”

Here, the word translated as **zeal** could refer to: (1) a person's desire or emotions. Alternate translation: [desire]; (2) a person's life. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:2 (#5)

וְאֶחָד בְּרַגְלָיו חוֹטֵא

“and one who hurries with feet misses {the way}”

Here Solomon speaks of a person doing something too hastily with the result that he makes mistakes as if he **hurries** by running **with his feet** and so he **misses the way** that he should have gone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and one who acts too quickly makes mistakes]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:2 (#3)

דִּידָעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:2 (#4)

לֹא-טוֹב

“is} not good”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [is extremely bad]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 19:2 (#1)

וְאֶחָד

“and one who hurries”

Here, **one who hurries** refers to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [and any person who hurries]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:2 (#6)

חוטא

“misses {the way”

Here the word translated as **misses the way** could refer to: (1) someone making a mistake. Alternate translation: [makes a mistake] or [errs]; (2) someone acting sinfully, which this word often means in other contexts. Alternate translation: [acts sinfully]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:3 (#5)

וְעַל-יְהוָה יִצְעַק לְבוֹ

“and his heart will rage against Yahweh”

Here Solomon implies that the foolish **man** rages **against Yahweh** because he blames **Yahweh** for his destruction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and his heart will rage against Yahweh because he blames Yahweh for his destruction]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:3 (#1)

אִנּוּלִית

“The folly of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:3 (#4)

דֶּרֶכְכֵּן

“his way”

Here, **way** refers to a person’s life circumstances. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:3 (#2)

אָדָם & דֶּרֶכְכֵּן & לְבוֹ

“a man & his way & his heart”

Although **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes

both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... that person’s way ... that person’s heart]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:3 (#6)

לְבוֹ

“his heart”

Here, **heart** refers to the whole person, with emphasis on that person’s emotions. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 15:14.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 19:3 (#3)

תַּסְלִיף

“will lead astray”

Here, **folly** is spoken of as if it were a person who could **lead** someone **astray**. This expression means that foolish people will ruin their lives because they act foolishly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will result in ruining]

See: Personification

Proverbs 19:4 (#3)

וְלִדְלוֹ

“but a lowly one”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:4 (#4)

וְלִדְלוֹ & יָפָרַד

“but a lowly one is separated”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but poverty separates a lowly one]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 19:4 (#2)

וְלִדְלוֹ מִרֵּעֵהוּ

“but a lowly one & from his companions”

Here, **a lowly one** and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific lowly one. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [but any lowly person ... from that person's companions]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:4 (#1)

הַהוֹן יוֹסִיף רַעֲעִים רַבִּים

“Wealth adds many companions”

Here Solomon implies that a person who is wealthy will have **many companions** because **wealth** attracts people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Wealth causes a person to have many friends]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:4 (#5)

מִרְרָעָהוּ יִפְרָד

“is separated from his companions”

Solomon implies that **a lowly one is separated from** his friends because of his poverty. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is separated from his friends because of his poverty]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:5 (#5)

וְיִפְפִּיחַ כְּזָבָבִים

“and he who breathes out lies”

See how you translated **breathes out lies** in 6:19.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:5 (#3)

עֵד שְׁשֻׁקְרִים

“A witness of falsehoods”

See how you translated this phrase in 12:17.

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:5 (#1)

עֵד שְׁשֻׁקְרִים לֹא יִזְקֶקָה וְיִפְפִּיחַ כְּזָבָבִים לֹא יִמָּלֵט

“A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless, and he who breathes out lies will not escape”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second phrase emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect

the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless; yes, he who breathes out lies will not escape]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 19:5 (#2)

עֵד שְׁשֻׁקְרִים & וְיִפְפִּיחַ כְּזָבָבִים

“A witness of falsehoods & and he who breathes out lies”

A witness of falsehoods and **he who breathes out lies** refer to types of people, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any witness of falsehoods ... and any person who breathes out lies]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:5 (#7)

לֹא יִמָּלֵט

“will not escape”

Here Solomon implies that someone **who breathes out lies will not escape** punishment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will not escape punishment]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:5 (#6)

לֹא יִמָּלֵט

“will not escape”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will certainly be caught]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 19:5 (#4)

לֹא יִזְקֶקָה

“will not be blameless”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that

is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will certainly be guilty]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 19:6 (#4)

נָדָבִיב

“a noble”

Here, the word translated as **noble** can refer to someone who has noble character as well as to someone who is a member of the nobility, or ruling class. See how you translated the same use of “nobles” in 17:26.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:6 (#2)

פְּנֵי־נָדָבִיב & הָהָרֵץ לְאִישׁ מִתֵּן

“the face of a noble & is} the friend of a man of gift”

Here, **the face**, **a noble**, **the friend**, and **a man of gift** refer to faces and types of people in general, not a specific **face** or person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [the faces of any noble ... is any friend of any man of gift]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:6 (#3)

פְּנֵי־נָדָבִיב

“the face of a noble”

The phrase **face** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the noble person]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 19:6 (#5)

וְכָל

“and everyone”

Solomon says **everyone** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and almost everyone]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 19:6 (#7)

לְאִישׁ מִתֵּן

“of a man of gift”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by giving gifts. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [of a man who gives gifts]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:6 (#6)

הָהָרֵץ

“is} the friend”

Here Solomon implies that **everyone** wants to be **the friend of a man of gift**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wants to be the friend]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:6 (#1)

רַבִּים

“Many”

Here Solomon uses the adjective **many** as a noun to mean “many people.” Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [Many people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 19:7 (#1)

כָּל־אֶחָיִךְ־רָשׁ | שֹׂנְאָהוּ

“All the brothers of one who is poor hate him”

Solomon says **All the brothers hate the one who is poor** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Even the relatives of a poor man often disdain him]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 19:7 (#3)

רָשׁ | שֹׂנְאָהוּ & מְרַעְהוּ & מִמְּנוּ מְרַדְּף

“one who is poor hate him & his friends & from him! He pursues”

Here, **one who is poor**, **him**, **his**, and **He** refer to a type of person in general, not one particular **poor** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated

one who is poor in 14:20. Alternate translation: [any person who is poor hate that person ... that person's friends ... from that person! That person pursues]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:7 (#5)

מְרַדֵּף אֶמְרָרִים

“He pursues {with} words”

Here Solomon refers to someone pleading for help from his **brothers** and **friends** as if he were using **words** to chase them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He pleads with them for help]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:7 (#2)

אָחִי

“the brothers of”

Although the term **brothers** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. See how you translated the same use of **brothers** in 6:19.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:7 (#4)

מְרַדֵּף אֶמְרָרִים לֹא־הֵמָּה

“He pursues {with} words; they {are} not”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [He pursues them with words, but they are not there]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:7 (#6)

אֶמְרָרִים

“with} words”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:8 (#4)

נִפְשָׁו

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:8 (#5)

שׁוֹמֵר תְּבוּנָה

“the one keeping understanding”

Here Solomon speaks of someone preserving or remembering **understanding** as if it were an object that someone is **keeping**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “keep” in 5:2. Alternate translation: [one who preserves understanding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:8 (#3)

אֹהֵב נַפְשׁוֹ

“is loving his life”

Here, **loves his life** has the positive meaning of taking care of oneself or doing what is best for one's well-being. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [does what benefits his life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:8 (#2)

קִנְיַת־לֵב

“The one acquiring heart”

Here Solomon uses **heart** to refer to a person's ability to reason. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who acquires the ability to reason]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:8 (#6)

תְּבוּנָה

“understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:8 (#1)

קִנְיַת נַפְשׁוֹ שׁוֹמֵר

“The one acquiring & his life; the one keeping”

The **one acquiring, his**, and **the one keeping** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **one who keeps** in 10:17. Alternate translation: [any person who acquires ... that person's life ... any person who keeps]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:8 (#7)

למצא

“is} to find”

Here, **is to find** means “is destined to achieve” or “is certain to obtain.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is destined to find] or [is certain of finding]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:8 (#8)

למצא-טוב

“is} to find good {fortune”

See how you translated **find good** in 16:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:9 (#1)

עַד שֶׁשִּׁקְרִים לֹא יִנְקָה וַיִּפְּיחַ כִּזְבִּים יָאֵבֵד

“A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless, and one who breathes out lies will perish”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless; yes, one who breathes out lies will perish]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 19:9 (#2)

עַד שֶׁשִּׁקְרִים לֹא יִנְקָה

“A witness of falsehoods will not be blameless”

See how you translated this clause in 19:5.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 19:9 (#3)

וַיִּפְּיחַ כִּזְבִּים

“and one who breathes out lies”

See how you translated **breathes out lies** in 6:19 and 19:5.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:10 (#1)

תַּעֲנוּג

“Luxury”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **Luxury**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [What is luxurious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:10 (#2)

לְכַסְסִּיל & לְעֶבֶד

“for a stupid one & for a slave”

See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18 and **a slave** in 11:29.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:10 (#3)

אֵאָף כִּי־לְעֶבֶד

“how much less for a slave”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [how much less suitable is it for a slave]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:11 (#3)

הָאֲרִיז אִפְּו

“makes his nose long”

Here Solomon is using a **long nose** as a common expression of his culture to mean “slow to anger.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression “long of nostrils” in 14:29. Alternate translation: [causes him to not easily vent his spleen] or [causes him not to become angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:11 (#5)

פֶּשַׁע

“a transgression”

Here, the word **transgression** represents transgressions in general, not one particular **transgression**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any transgression]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:11 (#2)

אָדָם & אָפִקוֹ וְהַתְפָּאֲרָתוֹ

“a man & his nose & and his splendor”

Although **a man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... that person's nose ... and that person's splendor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:11 (#1)

שִׁשְׁקָל & הַתְפָּאֲרָתוֹ & פֶּשַׁע

“The insight of & and his splendor & a transgression”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **insight** in 1:3, **splendor** in 4:9, and **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:11 (#6)

פֶּשַׁע

“a transgression”

Here Solomon implies that this is **a transgression** that someone has committed against the person who passes **over** it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a transgression that someone has committed against him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:11 (#4)

עָבָר עַל

“is} to pass over”

Here Solomon refers to a person ignoring or forgiving **a transgression** as if that person passes **over** it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is to ignore] or [is to forgive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:12 (#3)

בְּנֵהֶם כְּבִכְפִּיר

“is} a growling like the young lion”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [is a growling like the growling of the young lion]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:12 (#1)

זַעַר & רָצוֹנוֹ

“The rage of & his favor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **rage** in 11:23 and **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:12 (#5)

וּכְטֹטַל עַל-עֵשֶׂב רָצוֹנוֹ

“but his favor {is} like dew on vegetation”

Solomon is saying that a king's **favor** is like **dew on vegetation** because both are refreshing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [but his favor is refreshing like dew on vegetation]

See: Simile

Proverbs 19:12 (#2)

כְּבִכְפִּיר & מֶלֶךְ & רָצוֹנוֹ

“a king & like the young lion & his favor”

Here, **a king**, **the young lion**, and **his** refer to kings and young lions in general, not to a specific **king** or **young lion**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any king ... like any young lion ... that king's favor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:12 (#4)

נָהָם כַּכֶּפִּיר

“is} a growling like the young lion”

Solomon is saying that **The rage of a king** is like the **growling of the young lion** because both frighten people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [is frightening like the growling of the young lion]

See: Simile

Proverbs 19:13 (#2)

הוֹנֵת לְאָבִיו

“is} destruction to his father”

Here Solomon refers to a **stupid son** ruining the life of **his father** as if he were his father’s **destruction**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [ruins the life of his father] or [ruins the happiness of his father]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:13 (#6)

מְדִינְגִי אִשָּׁה

“the quarrels of a wife”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **wife** who is characterized by **quarrels**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. The implication is that these are **quarrels** between **a wife** and her husband. Alternate translation: [a quarrelsome wife] or [the arguments that a wife has with her husband]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:13 (#1)

לְאָבִיו בֶּבֶן כְּסִסִּיל

“A stupid son & to his father”

Although **son** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using those words in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [A stupid child ... to that child’s father]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:13 (#5)

מְדִינְגִי

“the quarrels of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **quarrels** in 6:14.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:13 (#7)

אִשָּׁה

“a wife”

See how you translated **a wife** in 18:22.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:13 (#4)

וְדִדְגָלָף טָטְרִיד

“and a continual dripping”

Here Solomon speaks of **the quarrels of a wife** being annoying as if they were continually **dripping** water. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and endlessly bothersome] or [and as annoying as a continual dripping of water]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:13 (#3)

וְדִדְגָלָף טָטְרִיד מְדִינְגִי אִשָּׁה

“and a continual dripping, the quarrels of a wife”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a continual dripping is the quarrels of a wife]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:14 (#2)

נִחְלָלָת & מִשְׁכָּלָת

“are} the inheritance of & who has insight”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **inheritance** in 17:2 and **insight** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:14 (#1)

בְּבֵית נֶהוֹן נִחְלָלָת אֲבֹתָ & אִשָּׁה מִשְׁכָּלָת

“A house and wealth {are} the inheritance of fathers & is} a wife who has insight”

A house, **the inheritance**, and **a wife** here do not refer to specific things or people, but refer to these things and people in general. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Houses and wealth are the inheritances of fathers ... are wives who have insight]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:15 (#2)

וְנִפְשׁ רְמִיָּה תִרְעַב

“and a life of idleness is hungry”

Many proverbs have two parts that have a relationship to each other. The second part may strengthen the first part, give more details about the first part, or say something that is a contrast to the first part. Here the second line strengthens and adds to the first part. Alternate translation: [and a lifestyle of laziness results in being hungry]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 19:15 (#5)

וְנִפְשׁ

“and a life of”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36. Alternate translation: [and a person of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:15 (#4)

וְנִפְשׁ רְמִיָּה

“and a life of idleness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **life** that is characterized by **idleness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and an idle life]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:15 (#3)

עֲצֵלָה & רְמִיָּה

“Laziness & idleness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Laziness** and **idleness**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **idleness** in 10:4. Alternate translation: [Being lazy ... being idle]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:15 (#1)

עֲצֵלָה תִפְקִיל תְּרֹדְמָמָה

“Laziness causes deep sleep to fall”

Here Solomon speaks of a lazy person sleeping deeply as if **Laziness** were something that **causes deep sleep to fall** on that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Laziness makes a person sleep deeply] or [A lazy person sleeps deeply]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:16 (#6)

דְּרָכָיו

“his ways”

The pronoun **his** could refer to: (1) God. In this case, the **ways** refer to the **commandment**, which would also be from God, as in the UST. Or (2) the person. In this case, the person does not control his own conduct. Alternate translation: [controlling the way that he lives]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 19:16 (#2)

מִצְוָה

“a commandment”

See how you translated the abstract noun **commandment** in 6:20.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:16 (#5)

דְּרָכָיו

“his ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:16 (#3)

שׁוֹמֵר נַפְשׁוֹ

“keeps his life”

See how you translated this phrase in 13:3.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:16 (#4)

בְּיוֹזָה דְּרָכָיו יוֹמֵת

“one who despises his ways will die”

The content of this clause is in strong contrast to the content of the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, one who despises his ways will die]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 19:16 (#1)

שומר מצוה שממר נפשיו בזה דרכיו

“One who keeps a commandment keeps his life; one who despises his ways”

One who keeps, a commandment, his, and one who despises here do not refer to specific things or people, but refer to these things and people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Ones who keep commandments keep their lives; ones who despise their ways]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:17 (#2)

דל

“a lowly one”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:17 (#5)

ישלם לו

“he will repay to him”

Here Solomon speaks of Yahweh rewarding someone for being **gracious to a lowly one** as if Yahweh were repaying a debt to him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will reward him for]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:17 (#3)

מלגנה יהוה

“lends {to} Yahweh”

Here Solomon speaks of someone doing something kind for which Yahweh will reward that person as if that person **lends** something **to Yahweh** that **he will repay**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [does this on behalf of Yahweh] or [is like one who lends to Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:17 (#1)

חתונן דל ואגמלוו ישלם לו

“One who is gracious {to} a lowly one & and his dealing he will repay to him”

One who is gracious, a lowly one, him, and his here refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who is gracious to any lowly person ... and that gracious person's dealing he will repay to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:17 (#4)

ואגמלוו

“and his dealing”

Here, **dealing** refers to what the person did to be **gracious to a lowly one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and his gracious deed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:18 (#4)

ואל-הנהמתו אל-תששא נפשך

“and do not lift up your soul to put him to death”

The implication is that by failing to discipline the child, the parents would be acting like they want the son to die, because he would grow up to be the kind of person that everyone hates. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:18 (#1)

בבןך & הנהמתו

“your son & put him to death”

Although **son** and **him** are masculine, Solomon is using those words in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [your child ... put that child to death]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:18 (#3)

וְאַל־יִהְיֶה מִיתָתוֹ אֶל־תְּשׁוּעָא בְּכַשְׁדָּךְ

“and do not lift up your soul to put him to death”

Here, the phrase **lift up your soul** is an idiom that refers to being determined to do something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and do not set your heart on putting him to death] or [and do not be determined to put him to death]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:18 (#2)

כִּי־יֵשׁ תִּקְוָה

“when there is hope”

Here, the phrase **when there is hope** refers to the time when a child is still willing to accept discipline from his parents. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [while he can still be taught]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:19 (#2)

גִּרְל־חֲחָקָה

“One great of heat”

One great of heat refers to someone who is extremely angry. Here, **heat** refers to anger, which causes the angry person’s body to become hot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **heat** in 6:34. Alternate translation: [An extremely angry person]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:19 (#1)

גִּרְל־חֲחָקָה

“One great of heat”

One great of heat represents a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any person great of heat]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:19 (#3)

בְּכַשְׁדָּךְ אֶל־תְּשׁוּעָא

“lifts up a fine”

Here Solomon speaks of a person experiencing the consequences for what happens when he gets angry as if those consequences were a **fine** that he **lifts up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [must experience the consequences]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:19 (#4)

עֲנָשׁ

“a fine”

Here Solomon implies that this **fine** is for something bad that the extremely angry person has done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a fine for what he does when he is angry]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:19 (#5)

אִם־תִּתְּצֵיל

“if you rescue”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [if you rescue him from paying a fine] or [if you rescue him from trouble]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:20 (#1)

עֲצָה & מוֹסָסָר

“counsel & instruction”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **counsel** in 1:25 and **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:20 (#3)

בְּאַחֲרֵיתָךְ

“in your afterwards”

This could refer to: (1) the future in general. Alternate translation: [in the future] or [after you are taught]; (2) the time near the end of one’s life. Alternate translation: [when your life is almost over]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:20 (#2)

לְלַמֵּצֵן תִּהְיֶינָם

“so that you will become wise”

Here, **so that** indicates that what follows is the purpose for obeying the commands in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to express a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of becoming wise]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 19:21 (#4)

וְעִצָּצֹת

“but the counsel of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **counsel** in the previous verse.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:21 (#2)

אָדָם

“a man”

Although **man** is masculine, here it refers to any person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:21 (#5)

הָיָא תִקּוּם

“it will stand”

Here Solomon refers to **counsel** that is successful as if it were a person who could **stand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same phrase in 15:22. Alternate translation: [it will be successful]

See: Personification

Proverbs 19:21 (#3)

וְעִצָּצֹת יְהוָה

“but the counsel of Yahweh”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **counsel** that **Yahweh** gives. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but the counsel that Yahweh gives]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:21 (#1)

מִחֲשַׁבּוֹת בִּלְבָב

“are} the plans in the heart of”

Here Solomon speaks of **the plans** that a person thinks about as if they were objects located **in** that person’s **heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of heart in 2:2. Alternate translation: [are the plans thought about by]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:22 (#2)

אָדָם חֲסִידָיו & רָרִישׁ מֵאֱמִישׁ בָּזָב

“a man {is} his covenant faithfulness & is} one who is poor than a man of lying”

Here, **a man**, **his**, **one who is poor**, and **a man of lying** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [a person is that person’s covenant faithfulness ... is a person who is poor than a person of lying]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:22 (#3)

חֲסִידָיו

“is} his covenant faithfulness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **covenant faithfulness** in 3:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:22 (#4)

מֵאֱמִישׁ בָּזָב

“than a man of lying”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **lying**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [than a man characterized by lying] or [than a liar]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:22 (#1)

תַּאֲוַת אָדָם

“The desire of a man”

This phrase could mean: (1) what **a man** desires for himself. Alternate translation: [What a man desires]

or (2) what others desire **a man** to be like. Alternate translation: [What people desire in a man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:23 (#3)

ושבבֵּעַ לַלַּיִל

“and the satisfied {one} will stay overnight”

The phrase **stay overnight** here is an idiom that refers to resting or sleeping. The idea is that the person who fears Yahweh will have satisfying rest through the night. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and this person will rest satisfied]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 19:23 (#4)

ושבבֵּעַ

“and the satisfied {one}”

Solomon is using the adjective **satisfied** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and the satisfied person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 19:23 (#1)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“The fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:23 (#2)

לְחַיִּים

“is} to life”

See how you translated this phrase in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:23 (#5)

בְּלִי־יִפְקֹד רָע

“he will not be visited by evil”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [evil will not visit him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 19:23 (#6)

בְּלִי־יִפְקֹד רָע

“he will not be visited by evil”

Here Solomon speaks of a person experiencing **evil** as if **evil** were a person who could visit him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will not experience evil]

See: Personification

Proverbs 19:23 (#7)

רָע

“evil”

Here, **evil** refers to trouble that someone might experience as a result of **evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [trouble]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:24 (#2)

טֹמֵמֵן & יָדוֹ בַּצִּלְחָה

“hides his hand in the dish”

In Solomon’s culture, people usually ate with their hands and put their hands **in a dish** in order to pick up food and eat it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [puts his hand in the dish in order to pick up food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:24 (#1)

עֲצָצַל יָדוֹ & גַּם־אֶל־פִּמִּיהוֹ לֹא יָשִׁיבָנָה

“A lazy one & his hand & he will not even return it to his mouth”

A lazy one, **his**, and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. See how you translated **A lazy one** in 10:26. Alternate translation: [Any lazy one ... that person’s hand ... that person will not even return it to that person’s own mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:24 (#3)

גַּם־אֶל־פִּמִּיהוֹ לֹא יָשִׁיבָנָה

“he will not even return it to his mouth”

Here Solomon implies that **A lazy one** does not **return** his hand **to his mouth** because he is too lazy to do so. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but he is too lazy to even bring his hand up to his mouth to feed himself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:25 (#3)

וּפְּתִי יִצְרָרִים

“and a naive one will become prudent”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **a naive one will become prudent** as the result of seeing someone **Strike a mocker**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and a naive one will see this happen and become prudent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:25 (#1)

לִלְיֵן תִּתְקֶה

“You strike a mocker”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **Strike** refers to a way of punishing **a mocker**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Punish a mocker by striking him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:25 (#4)

דָּעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:25 (#2)

לִלְיֵן & וּפְּתִי & לְיִנְבֹּן יִבְרִין

“a mocker and a naive one & an understanding one—he will understand”

Here, **a mocker**, **a naive one**, **an understanding one**, and **he** refer to a types of person in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a mocker** in 9:7, **a naive one** in

14:15, and **an understanding one** in 17:10. Alternate translation: [any mocker and any naive one ... any understanding one—that person will understand]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:26 (#2)

מִשָּׁדָד

“One who does violence”

One who does violence here refers to this type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who does violence]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:26 (#4)

בִּיָּן

“is} a son”

Although **son** is masculine, Solomon is using those words in a generic sense that could refer to either a male or female child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [is a child]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:26 (#1)

מִשָּׁדָד & מִבְּרִישׁ וּמִחָפִיר

“One who does violence & who causes shame and causes embarrassment”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **violence**, **shame**, and **embarrassment**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **violence** in 3:31 and **shame** in 6:33. Alternate translation: [One who is violent ... who shames and embarrasses]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:26 (#3)

אָאָב & אָאָם

“to} a father & a mother”

Solomon implies that **father** and **mother** here refer to the **father** and **mother** of the **One who does violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to his father ... his mother] or [to that person's father ... that person's mother]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 19:27 (#2)

תִּדָּל & לִשְׁמֹרֶץ מוֹסֵס לְלִשְׁגוֹת מֵאִמְרֵי־דָעַת

“cease to hear instruction to stray from the words of knowledge”

Here Solomon is using an imperative sentence to introduce a condition. He is pointing out that if his son ceases to hear instruction, the result will be a life without knowledge. If a speaker of your language would not use an imperative to introduce a condition, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if you cease to hear instruction, you will stray from the words of knowledge] or [do not cease to hear instruction, and you will not stray from the words of knowledge]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 19:27 (#3)

מוֹסֵס

“instruction”

See how you translated the abstract noun **instruction** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:27 (#4)

דָּעַת

“knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:27 (#5)

לְלִשְׁגוֹת

“to stray”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is the purpose of doing what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate that this is the ironic purpose of refusing to hear instruction. Alternate translation: [in order to stray] or [and then you will be far]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 19:27 (#8)

מֵאִמְרֵי

“from the words of”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23. Alternate translation: [from the sayings of] or [from the messages of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 19:27 (#1)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 19:27 (#6)

לְלִשְׁגוֹת מֵאִמְרֵי־דָעַת

“to stray from the words of knowledge”

Here Solomon refers to a person straying or wandering from the **words of knowledge** to mean that the person is no longer heeding those **words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to stop accepting the words of knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:27 (#7)

מֵאִמְרֵי־דָעַת

“from the words of knowledge”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **words** that are characterized by **knowledge**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [from the words that give knowledge]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:28 (#3)

בְּבִלְיָעַל & מִשְׁפָּסֵט & אָוֹן

“worthlessness & justice & iniquity”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **worthlessness** and **iniquity** in 6:12 and **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:28 (#4)

וּפְפִי רָשָׁעִים יִבְלַע־אָוֹן

“and the mouth of the wicked ones swallows iniquity”

Here Solomon speaks of **the wicked ones** enjoying doing **iniquity** as if **iniquity** were delicious food that they could swallow with their mouths. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [the wicked ones enjoy iniquity] or [the wicked enjoy doing iniquity as much as they enjoy eating food]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 19:28 (#2)

עֵד בְּבִלְעֵל

“A witness of worthlessness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **witness** who is characterized by **worthlessness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a worthless witness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 19:28 (#1)

עֵד בְּבִלְעֵל & וּפִי רָשָׁעִים יִבְלַע

“A witness of worthlessness & and the mouth of the wicked ones swallows”

A witness of worthlessness and **the mouth** here refer to this type of people and mouths in general, not a specific **witness** or **mouth**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any witness of worthlessness ... and the mouths of the wicked ones swallow]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 19:29 (#2)

וְהַמְלָמָה

“and blows”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and blows are prepared]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 19:29 (#1)

נִכְוֹנוּ לְעֵצִים שְׁפֹטִיטִים

“Judgments are prepared for the mockers”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **Judgments**, you could express the same

idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is prepared to judge mockers]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 19:29 (#3)

לִגְגֹי

“for the back of”

The word **back** represents the backs of **stupid ones** in general, not one particular **back**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [for the backs of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 20 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 20 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 20 also contains contrasting parallelism (20:3, 6, 14, 15, 17, 29) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (20:23). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 20:1 (#1)

לִיז הַבַּיִין

“The wine {is} a mocker”

Here Solomon speaks of people who drink too much **wine** as if they were **wine** itself. Alternate translation: [Someone who drinks too much wine is a mocker]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:1 (#2)

הַמְּמָה שֶׁכֵּכֵר

“beer {is} a brawler”

Here Solomon speaks of people who drink too much **beer** as if they were **beer** itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [someone who drinks too much beer is a brawler]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:1 (#5)

לֹא יָחָכֵם

“is not wise”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [is quite foolish]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 20:1 (#3)

שֹׁטְטָה

“who staggers”

Here, **staggers** refers to someone who **staggers** because they are intoxicated. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who staggers drunkenly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:1 (#4)

בִּי

“by it”

Here, **it** refers to **wine** and **beer**, both mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by drinking too much alcohol]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 20:2 (#2)

כִּכְפִּיר & מִמֶּלֶךְ מִמֶּלֶךְ הַטֵּטָה נִפְשׁוֹ

“a king & like the young lion; one who infuriates him {is} one who wrongs his life”

Here, **a king**, **the young lion**, **one who infuriates**, **him**, and **his** refer to types of people and young lions in general, not to specific people or a specific **young lion**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any king ... like any young lion ... any person who infuriates that king forfeits that person's own life]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:2 (#3)

נִגְהָם כִּכְפִּיר

“{is} a growling like the young lion”

See how you translated the same expression in 19:12.

See: Simile

Proverbs 20:2 (#1)

אַיִמָּה

“The terror of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **terror** in 10:24.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:2 (#4)

הוֹטֵטָה נִפְשׁוֹ

“{is} one who wrongs his life”

Here, in a polite way Solomon refers to causing one's own death by using the phrase **wrongs his life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [will cause his end] or [will cause himself to be killed]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 20:3 (#2)

לְאִישׁ

“for a man”

The word **man** represents people in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [for a person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:3 (#3)

יִתְגַּלֵּעַ

“breaks out”

Here Solomon refers to a **fool** eagerly starting an argument as if the argument were something that suddenly **breaks out**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [eagerly gets into an argument] or [welcomes a quarrel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:3 (#1)

כְּבָבוֹד & שְׁשֻׁבַת מִרְגִּיב

“Honor & {is} cessation from strife”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Honor**, **cessation** and **strife**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [Being honorable ... is ceasing to strive]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:4 (#1)

עֲצֹצֹל & יִשְׁאֵל

“A lazy one & and he begs”

A **lazy one** and **he** here refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any lazy person ... and that person begs]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:4 (#5)

בְּקֶצֶר

“in the harvest”

Here, **the harvest** refers to the time of year when farmers **harvest** their crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [during the time of year when farmers harvest crops]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:4 (#2)

מִמְחֹרֶף

“from winter”

The phrase **from winter** refers to the time when the people in Solomon’s area would prepare their fields to grow crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [during the proper time to plow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:4 (#3)

יִשְׁאֵל

“and he begs”

Here, **Then** introduces the result of what happened in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [and, because of that, he begs]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:4 (#4)

יִשְׁאֵל

“and he begs”

Here Solomon refers to a **lazy one** looking carefully for crops in his field as if he were begging the field to provide crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he searches his fields carefully for crops]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:4 (#6)

וְאֵין

“but there is nothing”

Here Solomon implies that **there is nothing** for the **lazy one** to harvest **in the harvest**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but has nothing to harvest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:5 (#1)

עֲצָצָה

“Counsel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **Counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:5 (#2)

בְּלֵב

“in the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:5 (#4)

מַמִּים עֲמֻקִּים & יִדְלֹגָה

“is} deep waters & will draw it out”

Here Solomon speaks of how difficult it is to discern a person’s **Counsel** as if it were **waters** that one must **draw out** from a deep well. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is difficult to understand ... is able to understand it] or [is as difficult to obtain as deep water ... is able to draw it out]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:5 (#5)

וְאִישׁ תְּבוּנָה

“but a man of understanding”

See how you translated **a man of understanding** in 10:23.

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:5 (#3)

אִישׁ וְאִישׁ

“a man & but a man of”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... and a person of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 20:6 (#4)

וְאִישׁ אֱמָנוּתִים

“but a man of faithful acts”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by doing **faithful acts**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but a man who does faithful acts]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:6 (#2)

חֶסֶדְךָ

“his covenant faithfulness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **covenant faithfulness** in 3:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:6 (#3)

וְאִישׁ אֱמָנוּתִים מִמִּי יִמְצָא

“but a man of faithful acts, who can find”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize how few people act faithfully. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [but it is very difficult to find a man of faithful acts!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 20:6 (#1)

אִדָּם & אִישׁ חֶסֶדְךָ וְאִישׁ

“a man & each} man, his covenant faithfulness, but a man of”

Although **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person ... each person, that person's covenant faithfulness, but a person of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 20:7 (#4)

אַחֲרָיו

“after him”

Here, **after him** means that **his sons** were born **after** he was born. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who exist after him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:7 (#3)

בְּתַמְמוֹ

“in his integrity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:7 (#1)

בְּתַמְמוֹ צְדִיק & בְּנֵי אֲחֵרָיו

“A righteous {one & in his integrity & are} his sons after him”

A **righteous one**, **his**, **sons**, and **him** refer to people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated a **righteous one** in 9:9. Alternate translation: [Any righteous person ... in that person's integrity ... are that person's children after that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:7 (#2)

מֵתְהַלֵּךְ בְּתַמְמוֹ

“walks about in his integrity”

Here Solomon speaks of a person behaving with **integrity** as if **integrity** were a place in which that person **walks about**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar phrase in 19:1. Alternate translation: [who behaves with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:8 (#4)

דִּין & רֶעַ

“judgment & evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **judgment** in 16:10 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:8 (#3)

כִּסֵּא־דִין

“the throne of judgment”

This phrase could refer to: (1) a **throne** that a **king sits on** for the purpose of **judgment**. Alternate translation: [the throne for judgment]; (2) a **throne** that is characterized by “justice,” which is another possible translation for the word **judgment**. Alternate translation: [the just throne]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:8 (#5)

מְזַרֶה

“is} one who winnows”

Here Solomon speaks of a **king** removing **evil** from his kingdom as if that **evil** were chaff that a farmer **winnows** out of the grain. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is one who removes] or [is one who removes like someone winnowing grain]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:8 (#6)

בְּעֵינָיו

“with his eyes”

Here, **eyes** refers to seeing, and seeing is a metaphor for perceiving something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to his perception] or [according to what he perceives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:8 (#2)

מֶלֶךְ & כִּסֵּא־דִין מְזַרֶה בְּעֵינָיו כָּל־רָעַ

“A king & the throne of judgment {is} one who winnows all evil with his eyes”

A **king**, the **throne**, **one who winnows**, and **his** refers to righteous kings and their thrones, not a specific **king** or **throne**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any good king ... the throne of judgment is a king who winnows all evil with his eyes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:8 (#1)

מֶלֶךְ

“A king”

This verse describes the traits of an ideal, righteous **king**, not any **king** in general. See how you translated the same use of **king** in 16:10.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:9 (#4)

לִבִּי

“my heart”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:9 (#6)

מִחֻטְאִי

“from my sin”

See how you translated abstract noun **sin** in 5:22.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:9 (#5)

טָהוֹרָתִי מִחֻטְאִי

“I am clean from my sin”

Here Solomon refers to a person who no longer sins as if that person were **clean from** his **sin**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I no longer sin]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:9 (#1)

מִי־יֹאמַר זִכְרֹתַי לִבִּי טָהוֹרִיתִי מִחַטָּאתִי

“Who can say, ‘I have made my heart pure; I am clean from my sin’”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize that no one is sinless. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Certainly no one can say, “I have made my heart pure; I am clean from my sin”!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 20:9 (#2)

מִי־יֹאמַר זִכְרֹתַי לִבִּי טָהוֹרִיתִי מִחַטָּאתִי

“Who can say, ‘I have made my heart pure; I am clean from my sin’”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [Who can say that he has made his heart pure, that he is clean from his sin]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 20:9 (#3)

זִכְרֹתַי לִבִּי

“I have made my heart pure”

Here Solomon refers to a person who no longer thinks sinfully as if that person **made** his **heart pure**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Now I only have good thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:10 (#4)

תוֹעֲבָה לְיְהוָה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:10 (#3)

אֵיפֶפֶה וְאֵיפֶפֶה

“ephah and ephah”

An **ephah** is a measurement of volume equivalent to 22 liters of dry solids (such as grain). However, Solomon is using the word here to refer to volume measurement in general. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could use a general expression in your translation for volume measurement. Alternatively. Alternate translation: [measurement and measurement]

See: Biblical Volume

Proverbs 20:10 (#2)

אֵאָכֵל וְנֹאֲכָל אֵיפֶפֶה וְאֵיפֶפֶה

“Stone and stone, ephah and ephah”

Solomon implies that these unequal weights and measurements are used to benefit the dishonest person who uses them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Unequal weights and unequal measurements that people use dishonestly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:10 (#1)

אֵאָכֵל וְנֹאֲכָל אֵיפֶפֶה וְאֵיפֶפֶה

“Stone and stone, ephah and ephah”

Stone and stone here refers to two different stones used for weighing goods (See this use of **stone** in 11:1). The phrase **ephah and ephah** refers to two different measurements used for measuring amounts of grain. Solomon is referring to different weights and measurements that a merchant pretends are the same in order to deceive a customer. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Unequal weights and unequal measurements]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 20:10 (#5)

שְׁנֵיהֶם

“the two of them”

This phrase refers to the unequal weights and measurements called **Stone and stone** and **ephah and ephah** earlier in the verse. However, Solomon does not mean that **Yahweh** actually hates these weights and measurements. Rather, he means that **Yahweh** hates people using these things dishonestly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of these dishonest practices]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:11 (#1)

בְּבִמְעָלָיו יִתְנַכֵּר-נִגְעָר & פֶּעֱלֹו

“a young man will make himself known by his deeds & is} his behavior”

Here, **a young man**, **himself** and **his** refer to a young person in general, not a specific **young man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [youths will make themselves known by their deeds ... is their behavior]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:11 (#2)

יְהוֹנָדָה

“will make himself known”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will make other people know him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:12 (#1)

אֵזְנוֹן שִׁמְעָה וְעֵינֵי רֹאֶהָ & גַּם-שְׁנֵיהֶם

“A hearing ear and a seeing eye & both the two of them”

Here, **ear** and **eye** represent these body parts in general, not one particular **ear** and **eye**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Hearing ears and seeing eyes ... all of them]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:13 (#4)

פִּקְחָה עֵינָיו

“Open your eyes”

Here Solomon implies that the person who opens his **eyes** does so in order to work. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Open your eyes to do your work]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:13 (#6)

לֶחֶם

“bread”

Here, **bread** is used to refer to food in general. See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 20:13 (#1)

אַל-תִּאְהָב שְׁנָה

“Do not love sleep”

The phrase **love sleep** means to sleep a lot because one enjoys sleeping. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not sleep a lot]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:13 (#5)

שָׂבַע-לֶחֶם

“be satisfied {with} bread”

This phrase states the result of obeying the command to **open your eyes** in the previous phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [you will be satisfied with bread]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:13 (#2)

פִּקְחָה עֵינָיו שָׂבַע-לֶחֶם

“Open your eyes; be satisfied {with} bread”

The idea of this clause is in contrast with the idea of the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [Instead, open your eyes; be satisfied with bread]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 20:13 (#3)

פִּקְחָה עֵינָיו

“Open your eyes”

Here Solomon says **open your eyes** to refer to staying awake. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [remain awake]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:14 (#5)

וְאִתָּה לֵלֹא אָמַר וְהִתְלַל

“but when he departs on his way, then he praises himself”

Here Solomon implies that **the buyer** bought the item and boasts to his friends about the good price he paid for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but

when he departs on his way after buying that thing, he boasts about the bargain that he got]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:14 (#1)

רָרַע רָרַע יֹאמֵר הַקּוֹנֵן

“Bad! Bad!” says the buyer”

Here, a **buyer** is criticizing the quality of something that he wants to buy in order to get the seller to decrease its price. **Bad** refers to bad quality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [“These goods are bad quality! Bad quality!” says the buyer criticizing the seller’s goods]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:14 (#2)

רָרַע רָרַע יֹאמֵר הַקּוֹנֵן

“Bad! Bad!” says the buyer”

Solomon is repeating the same word twice for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [“It is really bad quality!” says the buyer]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 20:14 (#3)

רָרַע רָרַע יֹאמֵר הַקּוֹנֵן

“Bad! Bad!” says the buyer”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [The buyer says that it is very bad]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 20:14 (#4)

הַקּוֹנֵן וְאַחַר לָלוּ אָז יִתְהַלֵּל

“the buyer, but when he departs on his way, then he praises himself”

Here, **the buyer**, **he**, **his**, and **himself** represent buyers in general, not one particular **buyer**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any buyer, but when that buyer departs on his way, then that buyer praises himself]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:15 (#3)

שִׁפְתֵי־דָעַת

“lips of knowledge”

See how you translated this phrase in 14:7.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:15 (#2)

וּבְלִי יִקְוָר שִׁפְתֵי־דָעַת

“but lips of knowledge {are} a vessel of preciousness”

Here Solomon speaks of the value of **lips of knowledge** as if they were a **vessel of preciousness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but lips of knowledge are as valuable as a vessel of preciousness]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:15 (#1)

פְּרִיגִים

“corals”

See how you translated **corals** in 3:15.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 20:15 (#5)

וּבְלִי יִקְוָר

“but & are} a vessel of preciousness”

Solomon contrasts **abundance** in the previous clause with **preciousness** in this clause in order to imply that **lips of knowledge** are rarer and more valuable than **gold** and **corals**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but ... are a vessel that is even more precious than those]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:15 (#4)

וּבְלִי יִקְוָר

“but & are} a vessel of preciousness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **vessel** that is characterized by **preciousness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but ... are a precious vessel]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:16 (#6)

חבלהו

“hold it in pledge”

Here, **it** refers to **his garment** in the previous clause. Solomon is referring to the practice of holding on to something that someone has given as a **pledge** to repay someone's debt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [hold onto his garment as a guarantee of repayment]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 20:16 (#4)

עָעָרַב זָזָר

“he has pledged {for} a stranger”

See how you translated the same use of “he pledges for a stranger” in 11:15.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:16 (#1)

לְקַח-בִּגְדוֹ כִּי-עָעָרַב זָזָר וּבָעֵד נָכְרִים חַבְלָהוּ

“Take his garment when he has pledged {for} a stranger, and on behalf of a foreign woman hold it in pledge”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Take his garment when he has pledged for a stranger, yes, on behalf of a foreign woman hold it in pledge]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 20:16 (#2)

בִּבְגְדוֹ כִּי-עָעָרַב זָזָר וּבָעֵד נָכְרִים

“his garment when he has pledged {for} a stranger, and on behalf of a foreign woman”

Here, **his**, **he**, **a stranger** and **a foreign woman** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [a person's garment when that person has pledged for any stranger, and on behalf of any foreign woman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:16 (#5)

וּבְעֵד נָכְרִים

“and on behalf of a foreign woman”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and when he has pledged on behalf of a foreign woman]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 20:16 (#3)

לְקַח-בִּגְדוֹ כִּי-עָעָרַב זָזָר

“Take his garment when he has pledged {for} a stranger”

When someone borrowed money in Solomon's culture, the lender would take something such as a **garment** from the borrower as a guarantee of repayment. The lender would return the **garment** after the money was repaid. If the borrower was too poor, someone else could give something to the lender as a pledge for the poor person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Take a garment as security from the one who guarantees that what a stranger has borrowed will be paid back]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:17 (#4)

לֶלֶחֶם

“is} bread of”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 20:17 (#5)

שְׁאֵקָר

“falsehood”

See how you translated the abstract noun **falsehood** in 6:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:17 (#3)

לֶלֶחֶם שְׁאֵקָר

“is} bread of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **bread** that is obtained by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [bread obtained by falsehood]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:17 (#1)

עֲרֵב

“Sweet”

Here Solomon speaks of a person being pleased by eating **bread of falsehood** as if the **bread** were **Sweet**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Pleasant] or [Pleasant like something sweet]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:17 (#2)

לְלִאִישׁ & פִּיָּהּ

“to a man & his mouth”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [to a person ... that person’s mouth]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 20:17 (#6)

יִמְלֵא־פִיָּהּ חֶצֶץ

“his mouth will be filled {with} gravel”

Here Solomon speaks of a person experiencing bad results because of eating **bread of falsehood** as if **his mouth** were **filled with gravel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [he will experience unpleasantness] or [he will have bad results as if his mouth were filled with sand]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:18 (#3)

וְאִתְּחַבְּלֹת

“and by guidance”

The first half of this verse provides the reason for the conclusion in the second half. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that the second half is

a purpose or conclusion from the first half. Alternate translation: [so, by guidance]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:18 (#2)

בְּעֵצָה

“by counsel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:18 (#4)

וְאִתְּחַבְּלֹת עֲשֵׂה מִלְחָמָה

“and by guidance make war”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **guidance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and let others guide you when you make war]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:18 (#1)

מִמַּחְשְׁבוֹת בְּעֵצָה תִּכְנֶן

“Plans by counsel are established”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Counsel establishes plans]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:19 (#3)

וְלִפְתָּתָהּ

“and with one who opens”

This clause states what Solomon wants people to do as a result of what he said in the previous clause. Use the most natural way to express an intended result in your language. Alternate translation: [therefore, with one who opens]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:19 (#2)

רִכְכִּיל

“a gossip”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:13.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 20:19 (#4)

וּלְפִתָּתָהּ שִׁשְׁפֹּתֶיהָ

“and with one who opens his lips”

See how you translated **one who opens his lips** in 13:3.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 20:19 (#1)

גִּזְלָהּ־סֵסוּד הוֹלִיךְ רֶכֶּכֶּיִל וּלְפִתָּתָהּ שִׁשְׁפֹּתֶיהָ

“One who goes about {as} a gossip reveals a secret, and with one who opens his lips”

One who goes about, a gossip, a secret, and **one who opens his lips** refer to types of people and secrets in general, not a specific person or **secret**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who goes about as a gossip reveals secrets, and with any person who opens his lips]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:20 (#2)

יִדְעֶעֱד נִרְרֹו

“his lamp will be extinguished”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will extinguish his lamp]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:20 (#3)

יִדְעֶעֱד נִרְרֹו

“his lamp will be extinguished”

See how you translated the same use of **lamp** and **will be extinguished** in 13:9.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:20 (#4)

בְּאִישׁוֹן חֹשֶׁךְ

“in the pupil of darkness”

Here Solomon refers to a very dark place as if it were **in the pupil**, which is the dark circle in the center of an eye. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the darkest darkness] or [in the deepest dark place]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:20 (#1)

מִמֶּקֶלֶל אָבִיו וְאִמּוֹ & נִרְרֹו

“One who curses his father and his mother, his lamp”

One who curses and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who curses that person’s father and mother, that person’s lamp]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:21 (#1)

נִנְחָלָה

“An inheritance”

See how you translated the abstract noun **inheritance** in 17:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:21 (#3)

וְאִתְּחִיתָהּ

“its end”

See how you translated the same use of **its end** in 14:12.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:21 (#2)

בְּרֵאשִׁיתָהּ

“in the beginning”

The phrase **in the beginning** refers to a person receiving his **inheritance** before he is supposed to receive it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [before the right time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:21 (#4)

לֹא־יִבָּרֵךְ

“will not be blessed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will not bless]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:22 (#6)

וַיִּשַׁע לְךָ

“and he will save you”

Here, **and** introduces the result of obeying the command stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. Alternate translation: [and it will result in him saving you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:22 (#7)

וַיִּשַׁע לְךָ

“and he will save you”

Here Solomon uses **he will save you** to mean that **Yahweh** will resolve the situation mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he will make it right]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:22 (#3)

רָעָה

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:22 (#5)

קָנָה לַיהוָה

“Wait for Yahweh”

This could mean: (1) **Wait for Yahweh** to resolve the situation. Alternate translation: [Wait for Yahweh to take care of the issue]; (2) Trust Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Trust Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:22 (#2)

אֲשַׁלְמָה רָרָע

“I will repay evil”

Here Solomon refers to doing wrong to someone who has done wrong to **you** as if **you** were paying them back for something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will avenge evil] or [I will harm people who have harmed me]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:22 (#4)

קָנָה לַיהוָה וַיִּשַׁע לְךָ

“Wait for Yahweh, and he will save you”

The idea of this clause is in contrast with the idea of the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [Instead, wait for Yahweh, and he will save you]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 20:22 (#1)

אַל־תֹּאמַר אֲשַׁלְמָה־רָרָע

“Do not say, “I will repay evil”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [Do not say that you will repay evil]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 20:23 (#1)

תוֹעֵבֶבֶת יְהוָה אֲבָבֶן וְאֲבָבֶן וּמֵאֲזִנֵּי מִרְמָה לֹא־טוֹב

“Stone and stone {are} an abomination to Yahweh, and scales of deceit {are} not good”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Stone and stone are an abomination to Yahweh; I say again, scales of deceit are not good]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 20:23 (#4)

וּמֵאֲזִנֵּי מִרְמָה

“and scales of deceit”

See how you translated **scales of deceit** in 11:1.

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:23 (#2)

אֲבָבֶן וְאֲבָבֶן

“Stone and stone”

See how you translated this phrase in 20:10.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 20:23 (#3)

תועבבת יהוה

“are} an abomination to Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 20:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:23 (#5)

לא־טוב

“are} not good”

See how you translated the same use of **not good** in 16:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 20:24 (#5)

דרכו

“his way”

The pronoun **his** refers to **a man**, not to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [his own way]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 20:24 (#1)

מַעֲדֵי & דְּרָכֹוּ

“are} the steps of & his way”

In this verse, **steps** and **way** refer to the things that people experience during their lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “path” in 4:18. Alternate translation: [are the life experiences of ... his life experiences]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:24 (#3)

וְאִי־דָם מִה־יִּבְרִין דְּרָכֹוּ

“so how can a man understand his way”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [so surely a man cannot understand his way!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 20:24 (#2)

גִּבּוֹר וְאִי־דָם & דְּרָכֹוּ

“a strong man, so & a man & his way”

Here, **a strong man**, **a man**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not to a specific **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any strong person, so ... a person ... that person’s way]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:24 (#4)

וְאִי־דָם מִה־יִּבְרִין

“so how can a man understand”

Here, **so** introduces the result of what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Therefore, how can a man understand]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 20:25 (#3)

אָאָדָם יִלֵּעַ

“a man: He says rashly”

Although **a man** and **he** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person: that person says rashly]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 20:25 (#1)

מוֹקֵשׁ אָאָדָם יִלֵּעַ

“A snare of a man: He says rashly”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A snare of a man is when he says rashly]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 20:25 (#2)

מוֹקֵשׁ

“A snare of”

Here Solomon refers to something a person says that can cause him trouble as if what he says were a **snare** that traps him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated the same use of **snare** in 18:7. Alternate translation: [What is dangerous for]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:25 (#4)

קִדְּשׁ

“It is} holy”

Here Solomon implies that this person has dedicated something to Yahweh by declaring it to be **holy**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I declare this thing to be holy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:25 (#5)

נִדְרִים

“vows”

Here, **vows** refers to declaring that something is holy and dedicated to Yahweh, which this person does in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [dedicating it to Yahweh] or [declaring it holy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:25 (#6)

לִבְקֹר

“considers”

Here Solomon implies that this person **considers** the rash vow he just made in a negative way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [reconsiders what he just vowed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:26 (#2)

מְזַרְרָה רֶשָׁעִים מִמֶּלֶךְ חָכָם וַיֵּשֶׁב עָלֵיהֶם אוֹפֵן

“A wise king {is} one who winnows the wicked, and he brings back a wheel over them”

Here Solomon speaks of a **king** discovering and punishing **the wicked** as if he were a farmer and they were his grain crop. He imagines separating the wicked from the good people as a farmer separates

the chaff from the grain, then he crushes the wicked by bringing the threshing wheel back over them again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. See how you translated the same use of **winnows** in 20:8. Alternate translation: [A wise king discovers the wicked people and he severely punishes them] or [A wise king separates out the wicked people and severely punishes them as though they were a grain crop that he winnows and crushes under a wheel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:26 (#3)

מְזַרְרָה רֶשָׁעִים מִמֶּלֶךְ חָכָם וַיֵּשֶׁב עָלֵיהֶם אוֹפֵן

“A wise king {is} one who winnows the wicked, and he brings back a wheel over them”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A wise king {is} one who winnows wicked ones; in fact, he brings back a wheel over them]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 20:26 (#4)

אוֹפֵן

“a wheel”

Here, **wheel** refers to a “threshing wheel.” This is a tool that farmers used to crush grain and help separate it from the straw and chaff. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of **wheel**, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a grain-crushing tool]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 20:26 (#1)

מְזַרְרָה & מִמֶּלֶךְ חָכָם וַיֵּשֶׁב

“A wise king {is} one who winnows & and he brings back”

A **wise king**, **one who scatters**, and **he** refer to a type of kings in general, not a specific **king**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any wise king is one who scatters ... and that king brings back]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:27 (#1)

גִּנְרַיִהוּהָ נִשְׁמַמַּת אֲדָמָה חֹפֶפֶשׁ כָּל־חֲדָרֵי־בֶטֶן

“The breath of a man {is} the lamp of Yahweh, searching all the rooms of the belly”

Here, **a man**, **the lamp**, and **the belly** refer to these things and people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [The breath of any person is a lamp of Yahweh, searching all the rooms of that person’s belly]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:27 (#3)

גִּנְרַיִהוּהָ

“is} the lamp of Yahweh”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **lamp** that belongs to **Yahweh**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is Yahweh’s lamp]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:27 (#5)

חֲדָרֵי־בֶטֶן

“the rooms of the belly”

See how you translated this phrase in 18:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:27 (#2)

נִשְׁמַמַּת

“The breath of”

Here, **breath** refers to the inner life force of a human being, which Yahweh gave to the first **man** by breathing it into him (Genesis 2:7). If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The breath of life of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:27 (#4)

גִּנְרַיִהוּהָ & חֹפֶפֶשׁ כָּל־חֲדָרֵי־בֶטֶן

“is} the lamp of Yahweh, searching all the rooms of the belly”

Here Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** knowing what is inside a person as though he were using a person’s **breath** as a **lamp** that allows him to search all the inner **rooms** of that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [penetrates his entire inner being, like Yahweh’s ability to know his innermost thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:28 (#1)

הַחֶסֶד נֹאמָת יִצְרוֹ־מִלְכֹּךְ וְסֻעָד בְּהַחֶסֶד כִּסְאוֹ

“Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness guard a king, and his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness guard a king; yes, his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 20:28 (#2)

הַחֶסֶד נֹאמָת & בְּהַחֶסֶד

“Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness & by covenant faithfulness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Covenant faithfulness** and **trustworthiness** in 3:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:28 (#7)

וְסֻעָד בְּהַחֶסֶד כִּסְאוֹ

“and his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness”

Here Solomon refers to a **king** maintaining his authority by acting with **covenant faithfulness** as if **covenant faithfulness** were a person who could sustain him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate transla-

tion: [and acting with covenant faithfulness enables him to maintain his authority]

See: Personification

Proverbs 20:28 (#5)

וְסֵעֵד בְּהִתְסָד כְּסָאוֹ

“and his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and covenant faithfulness sustains his throne]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 20:28 (#4)

מֶלֶךְ & כְּסָאוֹ

“a king & his throne”

Here, **a king** and **his throne** refer to righteous kings and their thrones, not a specific **king** or **throne**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any good king ... that king's throne]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 20:28 (#3)

יָצַר מֶלֶךְ

“guard a king”

Here Solomon refers to a **king** protecting himself by acting with **Covenant faithfulness and trustworthiness** as if those two things were people who **guard** him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [enables a king to be protected]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:28 (#6)

וְסֵעֵד בְּהִתְסָד כְּסָאוֹ

“and his throne is sustained by covenant faithfulness”

Here, **throne** refers to a king's authority, which is represented by the **throne** that a king sits on. See how you translated the same use of **throne** in 16:12.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:29 (#1)

תְּפַאֲרֶת & לְהַחֵם

“The splendor of & is} their strength”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **splendor** in 4:9 and **strength** in 5:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:29 (#3)

וְהִדְוִיר

“and the adornment of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **adornment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and what adorns]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:29 (#4)

שִׁיבָה

“is} gray hair”

Here, **gray hair** refers to the wisdom or experience often found in people who have lived long enough to have **gray hair**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is their wisdom]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 20:29 (#2)

וְהִדְוִיר זְקֵנִים שִׁיבָה

“and the adornment of old ones {is} gray hair”

The idea of this clause is in contrast with the idea of the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [However, the adornment of old ones is gray hair]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 20:30 (#3)

בָּרָע

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 20:30 (#5)

תְּדַרְיִי-בֶטֶן

“the rooms & the belly”

See how you translated this phrase in 18:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 20:30 (#1)

חֲבֵרֹת פֶּצַע

“Blows of a wound”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe severe **Blows** that cause **a wound**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Blows that cause a wound]

See: Possession

Proverbs 20:30 (#2)

תִּמְרִיק בְּרָעַע

“cleanse away evil”

Here Solomon refers to beatings that cause a person to stop doing **evil** things as if the beatings were cleaning away the **evil** from the person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [stop a person from doing evil]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 20:30 (#4)

וְאִמְכֹּלוֹת חֲדָרֵי־בֶטֶן

“and strikes, the rooms of the belly”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and strikes cleanse away evil from the rooms of the belly]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs - Chapter 21 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 21 continues the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 21 also contains contrasting parallelism (21:2, 5, 8, 15, 17, 20, 26, 28, 29, 31) and parallelism in which both clauses

have the same meaning for emphasis (21:14). (See: Parallelism)

Proverbs 21:1 (#2)

לֵב

“The heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:1 (#3)

פִּלְגֵי־מַמִּיִּם & בְּיַד־יְהוָה & יִטָּנוּ

“is} channels of water in the hand of Yahweh; he steers it”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **Yahweh** using the **heart of a king** to accomplish his purposes as if the **heart** were water streams that **he steers** to go to the places where he wants them to go. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a synonym. Alternate translation: [is controlled by Yahweh to do] or [is controlled by Yahweh like a farmer controls streams to act]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:1 (#1)

לֵב־מֶלֶךְ

“The heart of a king”

The heart of a king refers to the **heart** of any **king** in general, not a specific **king**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The heart of any king]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:2 (#1)

דֶּרֶךְ

“way of”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:2 (#2)

אָאִישׁ & בְּעֵינָיו

“a man & in his eyes”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make

this clear. Alternate translation: [any person ... in that person's eyes]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 21:2 (#5)

לבבות

“hearts”

See how you translated the same use of **hearts** in 15:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:2 (#4)

ותכנן & יהוה

“but Yahweh examines”

See how you translated this phrase in 16:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:2 (#3)

ישׁשר בעיניו

“is} right in his eyes”

See how you translated the same phrase in 12:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:3 (#1)

צדקה ומשפט & מזבח

“righteousness and justice & more than a sacrifice”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** and **justice** in 1:3 and **sacrifice** in 15:8.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:3 (#2)

נבחר ליהוה

“is preferred to Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh prefers]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 21:4 (#4)

נר רשעים

“the lamp of wicked ones”

Here, the word translated as **lamp** could refer to: (1) the sins mentioned in the previous clause being like a **lamp** that shows **wicked ones** what to do. Alternate translation: [what guides the wicked ones]; (2) the sins in the previous clause being like “uncultivated ground” (another possible meaning for the Hebrew word used here) that produces nothing good. Alternate translation: [the fruitlessness of the wicked ones]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:4 (#3)

נר רשעים

“the lamp of wicked ones”

This phrase gives further information about the two sins described in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the relationship between these phrases clearer. Alternate translation: [that is, the lamp of the wicked ones]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Proverbs 21:4 (#2)

ורחב-לב

“and broadness of heart”

Here, **broadness of heart** refers to thinking arrogantly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and thinking arrogantly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 21:4 (#1)

רום-עינים

“Height of eyes”

Here Solomon refers to pride as **Height of eyes**, which is a characteristic facial expression of proud people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression “uplifted eyes” in 6:17. Alternate translation: [Pride]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:5 (#4)

אָץ

“hurrying about”

Here, **hurrying about** refers to doing things more quickly than they should be done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who hurries about too quickly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:5 (#3)

לְמוֹתֶתָר & לְמַחְסוֹר

“to profit & to lack”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **profit** in 3:14 and **lack** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:5 (#2)

לְמוֹתֶתָר & לְמַחְסוֹר

“to profit & to lack”

Here, the phrases **are to** and **is to** indicate that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [result in profit ... results in lack]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 21:5 (#1)

הַחֲרוּץ

“the diligent {one}”

The phrase **the diligent one** represents diligent people in general, not one particular **diligent one**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any diligent one]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:6 (#5)

מְבַקְשֵׁי-מָוֶת

“seekers of death”

Here Solomon speaks of people doing something that will kill them as if they were **seekers of death**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [leading such people to their deaths] or [they act as though they are seeking death]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:6 (#1)

פֶּפֶצֶל אֲזוּצֹת

“The making of treasures”

Here Solomon speaks of acquiring wealth as if it were **treasures** that someone makes. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Acquiring wealth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:6 (#4)

מְבַקְשֵׁי-מָוֶת

“seekers of death”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they that seek such treasures are seekers of death]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:6 (#2)

בְּלִשְׁשׁוֹן שִׁשְׁקָר

“by a tongue of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:17.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:6 (#3)

הַתָּבֵל נִנְדָּף

“{is} scattered vapor”

Here Solomon speaks of the disappearance of **treasures** as if they were a **vapor** that quickly goes away. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [will cause them to disappear quickly] or [will be as unsuccessful as trying to hold scattered vapor]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:7 (#1)

שָׁד & מִשְׁפָּט

“The violence of & justice”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **violence** in 3:31 and **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:7 (#2)

שָׁד־רָשָׁעִים

“The violence of the wicked”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe the **violence** done by **the wicked**. If your language

would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [The violence done by wicked people]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:7 (#3)

יִגְרְמוּ

“will drag them away”

Here Solomon speaks of **the wicked** being destroyed because they act violently as if their **violence** were a person who could **drag them away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will cause others to take them away]

See: Personification

Proverbs 21:8 (#1)

דִּדְרָה

“is} the way of”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:8 (#2)

אִישׁ נָכוֹן וְיָשָׁר כְּעָלָיו

“a guilty man, but the pure {one}, upright {is} his behavior”

Here, **a guilty man**, **the pure one**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any guilty man, but any pure person, upright is that person's behavior]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:9 (#2)

מֵאֲשֶׁת מְלַחֲמִים

“than {with} a woman of quarrels”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** who is characterized by **quarrels**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [than with a quarrelsome wife]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:9 (#1)

פְּנֵת־גִּגְגִּי

“the corner of a roof”

Houses in Solomon's time had flat roofs on which people could walk. Sometimes residents would build a shelter on a **corner** of the **roof**, providing an additional place in which a person could sleep. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a note. Alternate translation: [the corner of a flat roof]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:9 (#3)

וּבֵּית חֶבֶר

“and a house of companionship”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **house** in which people live together. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and live together in one house]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:10 (#5)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in his eyes”

Here, **in his eyes** refers to the person's judgment or attitude. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of this attitude] or [by him]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 21:10 (#2)

רָשָׁע & בְּעֵינָיו רָעָהוּ

“the wicked {one & his neighbor & in his eyes”

Here, **the wicked one**, **his**, and **neighbor** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **the wicked one** in 3:33. Alternate translation: [any wicked person ... that person's neighbor ... in that person's eyes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:10 (#3)

רָעָה

“evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:10 (#1)

נַפֶּשׁ

“The soul of”

Here, **soul** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 21:10 (#4)

לֹא־יָחֵן בְּעֵינָיו רָעָהוּ

“his neighbor is not shown grace in his eyes”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [his eyes do not show grace to his neighbor]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 21:11 (#4)

וּבְהִשְׁכִּיל & דָּעַת

“and when giving insight & knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **insight** in 1:3 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:11 (#1)

לֵלֵךְ & פֶּתִי & לְהַכְכֵּם

“a mocker, a naive one & to a wise one”

See how you translated **a mocker** in 9:7, **a naive one** in 14:15, and **a wise one** in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:11 (#3)

וּבְהִשְׁכִּיל

“and when giving insight”

Here Solomon speaks of someone teaching **insight to a wise one** as if **insight** were an object that a person gives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and when teaching insight]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:11 (#5)

יָקַח־דָּעַת

“he receives knowledge”

Here Solomon speaks of someone learning **knowledge** as if it were an object that a person **receives**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he learns knowledge]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:11 (#2)

יִחְכַּם־פֶּתִי

“a naive one becomes wise”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **a naive one** will become **wise** as the result of seeing someone **fining a mocker**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a naive one will see this happen and become wise]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:12 (#3)

רָשָׁע

“a wicked {one}”

See how you translated **the wicked one** in 10:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:12 (#1)

צַדִּיק

“A righteous {one}”

A righteous one could refer to: (1) a righteous person in general. Alternate translation: [Any righteous person]; (2) Yahweh, who is the Righteous One. Alternate translation: [The Righteous One]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:12 (#5)

לָרָע

“to evil”

Here, **evil** refers to trouble that someone might experience as a result of **evil**. See how you translated the similar use of **evil** in 12:21.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:12 (#2)

לְבַיִת

“the house of”

Here, **house** refers to the family who lives in that **house** and what they do. See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:12 (#4)

מְסַלֵּף רְשָׁעִים לָרַע

“**overturning the wicked to evil**”

Here Solomon refers to a righteous one causing the **the wicked** to experience disaster as if he were **overturning** them **to evil**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causing the wicked to experience disaster]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:13 (#4)

דָּגַל

“**a lowly one**”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:13 (#6)

וְלֹא יִעֲנֶה

“**but will not be answered**”

Here, **answered** refers to the person who hears the cry responding by helping the person who cries out. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but will not be helped by anyone]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:13 (#3)

מִזְעָקָת & יִקְרֹא

“**from the outcry of & will cry out**”

Here Solomon implies that **outcry** and **cry out** refer to someone crying out for help. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from the cry for help of ... will cry for help]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:13 (#1)

אֵטֶטֶם אֲזָנוֹ מִזְעָקֵת-דָּדָל גַּם-הֵהוּא

“**One who shuts his ears from the outcry of a lowly one, he also**”

One who shuts, his, a lowly one, and he refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who shuts his ears from the outcries of lowly ones, that person also]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:13 (#5)

וְלֹא יִעֲנֶה

“**but will not be answered**”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but no one will answer him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 21:13 (#2)

אֵטֶטֶם אֲזָנוֹ

“**One who shuts his ears**”

Here Solomon refers to someone refusing to listen as if that person were shutting **his ears** so that he does not hear someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who will not listen]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:14 (#3)

יִכְפֹּה-אָאָרְ

“**subdues nose**”

Here, **subdues nose** refers to stopping a person from being angry. The word **nose** here means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes angry people to stop being angry]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 21:14 (#5)

בְּבִהֶם

“**in the bosom**”

Here, **in the bosom** indicates that a **bribe** is given to someone secretly, as if it were hidden in a person’s

clothes near that person's **bosom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of "from the bosom" in 17:23. Alternate translation: [in secret]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:14 (#4)

וששחד בבחורק חממה עזה

"and a bribe in the bosom, strong heat"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a bribe given in the bosom subdues strong heat]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:14 (#1)

מתנתו בבסתר יכפה-אף ויששחד בבחורק חממה עזה

"A gift in secrecy subdues nose, and a bribe in the bosom, strong heat"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A gift in secrecy subdues nose; yes, a bribe in the bosom, strong heat]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 21:14 (#6)

חממה עזה

"strong heat"

Here, **strong heat** refers to extreme anger, which causes the angry person's body to become hot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [rage]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:14 (#2)

מתנתו בבסתר

"A gift in secrecy"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be

complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A gift given in secrecy]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:15 (#2)

שמחה & משפט ומהתנה & און

"A joy & justice, but a terror & iniquity"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **joy** in 10:28, **justice** in 13:23, **terror** in 10:24, and **iniquity** in 12:21.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:15 (#3)

והמהתנה לפפצלי און

"but a terror for doers of iniquity"

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but doing justice is a terror for doers of iniquity]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:15 (#1)

שמחה ללצדיק & מהתנה

"A joy for the righteous & but a terror"

A joy, the righteous, and **a terror** refer to these things and people in general, not to specific things or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Joy is for righteous ones ... but terror]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:16 (#3)

בקהל רפאים ינוח

"will rest in the assembly of the spirits of the dead"

In this clause, Solomon refers to a person dying. The phrase **the assembly of the spirits of dead ones** refers to the place where people's spirits go when they die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will end up in the place where the spirits of dead people dwell] or [will end up dead]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:16 (#2)

תַּתְּוֹעָה מִדֶּרֶךְ הַשְׂכָּל

“wandering from the way of understanding”

Here Solomon refers to a person who stops behaving wisely as if the right way to behave were a **way** that he wanders from. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **way** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [no longer living wisely]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:16 (#1)

אָדָם

“A man”

A **man** refers to people in general, not to a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:17 (#5)

יַיִן-וְשֵׁשֶׁן

“wine and oil”

wine and **oil** represent good food and drink. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [rich food and drink]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:17 (#3)

אָדָם מִמְּחֶסֶר

“A man of lack”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by lacking wealth. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A man who lacks goods] or [A man characterized by poverty]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:17 (#4)

שִׂמְחָה

“joy”

Here, **joy** refers to things and activities that cause people to feel **joy**. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what pleases him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:17 (#1)

אָדָם מִמְּחֶסֶר אֶהָב שִׂמְחָה אֶהָב יַיִן-וְשֵׁשֶׁן לֹא יֵעָשִׂיר

“A man of lack loves joy; a lover of wine and oil will not become rich”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A man of lack loves joy; yes, a lover of wine and oil will not become rich]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 21:17 (#2)

אָדָם & אֶהָב

“A man of & a lover of”

A **man** and a **lover** refer to types of people in general, not to a specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of ... any lover of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:18 (#4)

בֹּגֵד

“one who acts treacherously”

Here, **one who acts treacherously** represents this type of people in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who acts treacherously]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:18 (#3)

וְתַתָּה יִשְׂרָאֵל בֹּגֵד

“and instead of the upright, one who acts treacherously”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and instead of upright ones, one

who acts treacherously is a ransom] or [and instead of upright ones, one who acts treacherously is punished]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:18 (#2)

לְצַדִּיק רְשָׁעִים

“for the righteous {one} {is} a wicked {one}”

See how you translated **the righteous one** in 10:3 and **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:18 (#1)

כִּפְּרִי לְצַדִּיק רְשָׁעִים

“A ransom for the righteous {one} {is} a wicked {one}”

Here Solomon refers to a **wicked one** who is punished instead of **the righteous one** as if a **wicked one** were a **ransom** that is paid on behalf of **the righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A wicked one is punished instead of a righteous one]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:19 (#2)

מֵאֲשֶׁת מְדוֹנִים

“than {with} a woman of quarrels”

Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** that is characterized by **quarrels and vexation**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. See how you translated **a woman of quarrels** in 21:9. Alternate translation: [than with a woman who constantly argues and complains]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:19 (#1)

בְּאַרְצֵי-מִדְבָּר

“in a land of wilderness”

Since the **wilderness** is a place without people, Solomon implies dwelling alone in that place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [by oneself in a land of wilderness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:20 (#3)

יִבְלַעְנָו

“swallows it up”

The pronoun **it** refers to the treasure and the oil. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [swallows them up] or [wastes them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 21:20 (#2)

יִבְלַעְנָו

“swallows it up”

Here Solomon refers to a **stupid** person wasting all his wealth as if it were something he **swallows**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wastes it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:20 (#1)

חָכָם וְכִסְיִל אֲדָמָה

“a wise {one}, but a stupid man”

See how you translated **a wise one** in 1:5 and **a stupid man** in 15:20.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:21 (#3)

צִדְקָה וְחֶסֶד & חַיִּים צִדְקָה וְכָבוֹד

“righteousness and covenant faithfulness & life, righteousness, and honor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **righteousness** in 1:3, **covenant faithfulness** in 3:3, **life** in 10:16, and **honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:21 (#2)

רֹדֵף

“A pursuer of”

See how you translated the same use of **pursuer** in 15:9.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:21 (#4)

יִמְצָא

“will find”

See how you translated the same use of **find** in 8:35.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:21 (#1)

רֹדֵף

“A pursuer of”

A **pursuer** represents a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any pursuer of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:22 (#4)

הַיֹּדֵד

“and he brings down”

Here, **brings down** refers to the **wise one** leading his soldiers to destroy the fortifications that protect the **city** mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he causes his soldiers to destroy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:22 (#3)

עִיר גִּבּוֹרִים

“a city of mighty ones”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **city** that is defended by **mighty ones**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a city defended by mighty ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:22 (#5)

עֶזְרַת מְבִטָּה

“the strength of its confidence”

Here, **strength** refers to the strong walls and towers around the **city** mentioned in the previous clause. Here, **its** refers to the people in the city. They have **confidence** in the walls and do not think anyone will be able to destroy them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the strong fortifications in which they are confident]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:22 (#2)

עִיר & עָלָה

“ascends a city of”

Here, **ascends** refers to attacking a city and climbing over its wall. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [successfully attacks a city of] or [overruns a city of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:22 (#1)

עִיר & הַכֶּכֶם הַיֹּדֵד

“A wise {one & a city of & and he brings down”

A **wise one**, a **city**, and **he** represent a type of person and city in general, not one particular person and city. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any wise one ... any city of ... and that person lowers]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:23 (#2)

שֹׁמֵר

“One who keeps”

Here Solomon refers to a person being careful about what he says with **his mouth and his tongue** as if they were objects that he **keeps**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who is careful with]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:23 (#4)

נַפְשׁוֹ

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [himself]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:23 (#3)

פִּי וּלְשׁוֹנִי

“his mouth and his tongue”

The terms **mouth** and **tongue** mean similar things. They both refer to what a person says. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the

emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [whatever he says]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 21:23 (#5)

מִצָּרָה

“from distress”

See how you translated the abstract noun **distress** in 1:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:23 (#1)

שֹׁמֵר פִּי וּלְשׁוֹנוֹ שֹׁמֵר & נַפְשׁוֹ

“One who keeps his mouth and his tongue keeps his life”

One who keeps and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not one specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who keeps that person's own mouth and tongue keeps that person's life]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:24 (#4)

בְּעִבְרֵת זָדוֹן

“with the rage of presumption”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **rage** or **presumption**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [in an arrogantly furious manner]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:24 (#2)

שִׁמְמוֹ

“is} his name”

Here, **name** refers to what people call a **presumptuous, haughty one**, not that person's actual **name**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is what people call him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:24 (#1)

זָדוֹן יִהְיֶה & שִׁמְמוֹ

“A presumptuous, haughty one & is} his name”

A presumptuous, haughty one and **his** represent a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any presumptuous, haughty one ... is that person's name]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:24 (#3)

בְּעִבְרֵת זָדוֹן

“with the rage of presumption”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **rage** that is characterized by **presumption**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [with presumptuous rage]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:25 (#1)

עֲצֵל תְּמִיתָנוּ & יָדָיו

“the lazy one causes him to die & his hands”

Here, **the lazy one**, **him**, and **his** refer to lazy people in general, not one specific **lazy one**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any lazy one causes that person to die ... that person's hands]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:25 (#2)

מֵאֲנֵי יָדָיו

“his hands refuse”

Here, **hands** refers to the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he refuses]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 21:26 (#2)

הִתְאַוָּה תִּתְאַוָּה

“he desires desire for himself”

Here, **desires desire** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [he adds desire onto desire for himself] or [he constantly desires things for himself]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 21:26 (#5)

אִתְּתֵן וְלֹא יִקְשֹׁךְ

“gives and does not withhold”

The terms **gives** and **does not withhold** mean the same thing. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [gives freely]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 21:26 (#3)

צַדִּיק

“but a righteous {one}”

See how you translated **a righteous one** in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:26 (#4)

אִתְּתֵן וְלֹא יִקְשֹׁךְ

“gives and does not withhold”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [gives what he has and does not withhold it]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:26 (#1)

הַתְּאֵמָה תִּאְמָנָה

“he desires desire for himself”

Here, **he** and **himself** refer to the lazy person mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the lazy person desires desire for himself]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 21:27 (#6)

בְּזִמְמָה

“with a wicked plan”

Here, **plan** refers to a purpose or motive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explic-

itly. Alternate translation: [with a wicked purpose] or [with wicked intent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:27 (#3)

תוֹעֲבָה

“is} an abomination”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abomination**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is abominable]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:27 (#2)

זֶבַח

“The sacrifice of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **sacrifice** in 15:8.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:27 (#5)

בְּזִמְמָה

“with a wicked plan”

Here Solomon speaks of someone having **a wicked plan** while bringing a **sacrifice** as if the **plan** were an object that he brought **with** him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while having a wicked plan]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:27 (#1)

זֶבַח & תוֹעֲבָה & בְּזִמְמָה יָבִיאָהּ

“The sacrifice of & is} an abomination & he brings it with a wicked plan”

The sacrifice, an abomination, he, it, and a wicked plan refer to things and a type of person in general, not to a specific person or thing. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [The sacrifices of ... are abominations ... they bring them with wicked plans]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:27 (#4)

אֵלֶּכָּה כִּי

“how much more when”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [how much more of an abomination is it when] or [how very abominable is it when]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 21:28 (#3)

לִנְצַח יִדְבֵּר

“will speak to perpetuity”

The context of this proverb is a legal setting, warning against witnesses who lie and commending the person who listens carefully to what the witnesses say. This last clause may be referring to the person listening to the lying witness in order to catch him in his lies, or it may be referring to the person listening to all of the witnesses in order to understand what happened. In either case, what this person says decides the case. The word translated as **to perpetuity** could mean: (1) for the duration, that is, until the end of the case. Alternate translation: [will speak until the end] or (2) successfully. Alternate translation: [will speak successfully]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:28 (#1)

עֵד־קִזְבָּרִים & וְאִישׁ שֹׁמֵר מִצַּעַר

“A witness of lies & but a listening man”

A witness of lies and **a listening man** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any witness of lies ... but any person who listens]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:28 (#2)

עֵד־קִזְבָּרִים

“A witness of lies”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **a witness** who tells **lies**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A lying witness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:29 (#4)

דַּרְכֵּיו

“his ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 21:29 (#1)

הַעֲלֹז אִישׁ רָשָׁע בְּפָנָיו וְיֹשֵׁר הָרוּא יִכִּין דַּרְכֵּיו

“A wicked man strengthens his face, but an upright one, he considers his ways”

A wicked man, **his**, **an upright one**, and **he** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **A wicked man** in 11:7. Alternate translation: [Any wicked person strengthens his own face, but any upright person considers his own ways]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 21:29 (#3)

יִכִּין דַּרְכֵּיו

“considers his ways”

Many ancient manuscripts read **he considers his ways**, as in the ULT. Other ancient manuscripts read “he establishes his way.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Proverbs 21:29 (#2)

הַעֲלֹז & בְּפָנָיו

“strengthens his face”

Here, **strengthens his face** means that the **wicked man** acts boldly and stubbornly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar expression from your language or express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression “strengthens her face” in 7:13. Alternate translation: [puts on a bold front] or [appears confident]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 21:30 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“in front of”

The word translated **in front of** could mean: (1) “before” or “in the presence of.” In this sense, all human

wisdom is useless compared to Yahweh's wisdom. Alternate translation: [that can stand before Yahweh] or [that compares to that of Yahweh]; (2) "in opposition to." In this sense, there is no true wisdom that contradicts the wisdom of Yahweh. Alternate translation: [that contradicts the wisdom of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 21:30 (#1)

הַחֵכְמָה & תְּבוּנָה & עֲצָצָה

"wisdom & understanding & counsel"

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2 and **counsel** in 1:25.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 21:31 (#5)

הַתְּשׁוּעָה

"the salvation"

Here, **the salvation** refers to being saved from defeat in **battle**, which is another way of saying "the victory." If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the victory] or [being saved from defeat]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:31 (#2)

סוּס מְמוּרָן

"A horse is made ready"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A soldier makes a horse ready]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 21:31 (#3)

סוּס

"A horse"

A **horse** is a large animal that armies used to pull carts from which soldiers would fight. Armies with horses were usually more powerful than armies without horses. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term for something that soldiers use for fighting. Alternate translation: [An animal used for fighting] or [Fighting equipment]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 21:31 (#6)

לַיהוָה

"but & is} of Yahweh"

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to indicate that **Yahweh** is the source of **the salvation**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [but ... is from Yahweh]

See: Possession

Proverbs 21:31 (#4)

לַיּוֹם מִלְחָמָה

"for the day of battle"

Here, **day** refers to a point in time when something happens. It does not refer to a 24-hour length of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for the time of battle]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 21:31 (#1)

סוּס & לַיּוֹם מִלְחָמָה

"A horse & for the day of battle"

A **horse** and **the day of battle** refer to these things in general, not a specific **horse** or **day of battle**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any horse ... for any day of battle]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 22 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Proverbs from Solomon (10:1-22:16)
2. Sayings from wise men (22:17-24:22)
 - Introduction to the sayings (22:17-21)
 - The sayings (22:22-24:22)

Chapter 22 concludes the section of the book written by Solomon that is filled mainly with short, individual proverbs. Solomon wrote all 375 proverbs in 10:1-22:16. In 22:17-21, it seems that Solomon himself introduces a section of proverbs written by an unknown group of people called "the wise ones." Most of the proverbs of "the wise ones," found in 22:22-24:22, are longer

than one verse. Each of these longer proverbs will be marked in the notes.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 16–22 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 22 also contains contrasting parallelism (22:3, 12) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (22:1, 24, 26). (See: Parallelism)

Rhetorical questions

In 22:20–21 and 27, the author uses rhetorical questions to emphasize the importance of what he is saying. (See: Rhetorical Question)

Proverbs 22:1 (#5)

מְכַכֵּסָּף וְאִמְזִהָבָה הַחֵן טוֹב

“favor {is} better than silver and than gold”

Here Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [having favor is better than having silver and gold] or [choosing favor is better than choosing silver or gold]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:1 (#1)

נִבְהָתָר שֵׁשֶׁם מֵעֶשֶׂר רָרִב מְכַכֵּסָּף וְאִמְזִהָבָה הַחֵן טוֹב

“A name is to be chosen more than abundant riches; favor {is} better than silver and than gold”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A name is to be chosen more than abundant riches; yes, favor is better than silver and than gold]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 22:1 (#4)

מְכַכֵּסָּף וְאִמְזִהָבָה הַחֵן טוֹב

“favor {is} better than silver and than gold”

This clause could also be translated as “good favor more than silver and than gold,” with **is to be chosen**

implied from the previous clause. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. Alternate translation: [good favor is to be chosen more than silver and than gold] or [people should choose being favored by others rather than having silver and gold]

Proverbs 22:1 (#2)

שֵׁשֶׁם

“A name”

Here, **name** refers to a person’s reputation. Solomon implies that it is a good reputation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A good reputation]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:1 (#6)

הַחֵן

“favor”

See how you translated **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:1 (#3)

נִבְהָתָר שֵׁשֶׁם

“A name is to be chosen”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A person should choose having a good name]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:2 (#2)

נִפְגַּגְשׁוּ

“meet together”

Here Solomon speaks of people having something in common as if those people **meet together**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have something in common]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:2 (#1)

עֲשִׂירִי וְרָרִשׁ

“A rich one and a poor one”

A rich one and **a poor one** represent types of people in general, not a particular **rich one** and **poor one**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any wise person and any rich person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:3 (#3)

עָבַרְךָ

“pass on”

Here, **pass on** contrasts with **sees evil and hides himself** in the previous clause to indicate that **naive ones** walk right into a dangerous situation without noticing that they are in danger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [unknowingly walk into a dangerous situation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:3 (#4)

וְנִעְנְשׁוּ

“and they are fined”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they pay a penalty]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:3 (#1)

עָרוֹם

“A prudent {one}”

See how you translated this phrase in 12:16.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:3 (#5)

וְנִעְנְשׁוּ

“and they are fined”

Here, **fined** refers to experiencing the negative consequences of not avoiding danger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and they experience the consequences]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:3 (#2)

רָעָה

“evil”

Here, **evil** refers to danger caused by something **evil** happening. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [danger]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:4 (#3)

יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“the fear of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 22:4 (#5)

וְחַיִּים

“and life”

Here, **life** refers to a **life** that is long and good. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:4 (#4)

עֲשֹׁר וְכְבוֹד

“{is} riches and honor”

See how you translated **riches and honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:4 (#1)

עֲנָוָה יִרְאַת יְהוָה

“humility, the fear of Yahweh”

This could mean: (1) **humility** here refers specifically to **the fear of Yahweh**, as also suggested by the parallelism of these expressions in 15:33. Alternate translation: [humility, that is, the fear of Yahweh]; (2) **humility** and **the fear of Yahweh** are two different things. Alternate translation: [humility and the fear of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:4 (#2)

עֲנָוָה

“humility”

See how you translated the abstract noun **humility** in 15:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:5 (#5)

שומֵּמֵר נַפְשׁוֹ

“one guarding his life”

Here Solomon speaks of a person who wants to stay alive as if **his life** were something that he is **guarding**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar phrase “protects his life” in 16:17. Alternate translation: [one who tries to keep himself alive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:5 (#6)

מֵהֶם

“from them”

Here, **them** refers to the **Thorns** and **traps** mentioned in the previous phrase. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from those thorns and traps]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 22:5 (#3)

עֲקָשׁ

“the crooked”

Here Solomon uses the word **crooked** to refer to being deceptive. See how you translated the same use of **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:5 (#2)

צָנָנִים פְּפָחִים בְּדֶרֶךְ עֲקָשׁ

“Thorns, traps {are} in the way of the crooked”

Here Solomon speaks of bad things that **the crooked** will experience during their lifetimes as if their lives consisted of a path with **Thorns** and **traps** on it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **way** in 15:19. Alternate translation: [The crooked will experience many troubles during their lifetimes] or [Crooked people will have a difficult life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:5 (#1)

בְּדֶרֶךְ עֲקָשׁ שׁוֹמֵמֵר נַפְשׁוֹ

“are} in the way of the crooked; one guarding his life”

Here, **the way**, **the crooked**, and **one guarding his life** represent ways and types of people in general, not a specific **way** or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [are in the ways of the crooked ones; those who guard their lives]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:5 (#4)

שׁוֹמֵמֵר נַפְשׁוֹ

“one guarding his life”

The content of this clause is in contrast to the content of the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, one guarding his life]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 22:6 (#2)

עַל־פִּי דִרְכּוֹ

“upon the mouth of his way”

Solomon is using **upon the mouth of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “according to.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to his way]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:6 (#3)

עַל־פִּי דִרְכּוֹ

“upon the mouth of his way”

Here, Solomon is speaking of the proper behavior of a child as **his way**, as in 1:15. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to live how he should live] or [to live in the right way]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:6 (#1)

לְנֶעֱר & דִרְכּוֹ & הַיָּלֵד לֹא־יָסוּר

“the boy & his way & he is old, he will not turn away”

Here, **the boy**, **his**, and **he** refer to children in general, not a specific **boy**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate

translation: [any child ... that child's way ... that person is old, that person will not turn away]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:6 (#4)

לֹא־יִסְטוּר מִמֶּנּוּהָ

“he will not turn away from it”

Here Solomon speaks of a person continuing to behave a certain way as if that person were not turning **away from** the right path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the phrase **turn away from** in 3:7. Alternate translation: [he will continue behaving that way]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:7 (#3)

וְעֶבֶד לְלוֹנֶה לְאִישׁ מְלוֹה

“and a borrower {is} a slave to a man who lends”

Here, Solomon is speaking as if a person who borrows money or goods actually became **a slave** to the lender. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a borrower comes under the control of the man who lends to him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:7 (#1)

עֲשִׂיר & וְעֶבֶד לְלוֹנֶה לְאִישׁ מְלוֹה

“A rich one & and a borrower {is} a slave to a man who lends”

A rich one, a borrower, a slave, and a man who lends all refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any rich person ... and any borrower is a slave to any person who lends]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:7 (#2)

וְעֶבֶד לְלוֹנֶה לְאִישׁ מְלוֹה

“and a borrower {is} a slave to a man who lends”

Here Solomon implies that the **borrower** is borrowing money. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and a borrower of money is a slave to a man who lends money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:8 (#4)

וְשִׁשְׁבֶּט עֲבָרָתוֹ

“and the rod of his rage”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **rod** that a **sower of iniquity** uses to express his **rage** by oppressing people. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and the rod he uses to oppressively express his rage]

See: Possession

Proverbs 22:8 (#5)

וְשִׁשְׁבֶּט

“and the rod of”

Here Solomon refers to a person's authority over other people as if it were a **rod**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the authority of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:8 (#3)

עֲוֹלָה

“iniquity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **iniquity** in 6:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:8 (#1)

זֹרֵרַע עֲוֹלָה & עֲבָרָתוֹ

“A sower of iniquity & his rage”

A sower of iniquity and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any sower of iniquity ... that person's rage]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:8 (#2)

זֹרֵרַע עֲוֹלָה יִקְצֹר־אָזָן

“A sower of iniquity will reap disaster”

Here Solomon speaks of someone who does **iniquity** experiencing **disaster** as if **iniquity** were a seed that he plants and **disaster** were the plant that the seed

becomes and that he harvests. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [A doer of iniquity will experience the consequences of that iniquity] or [A doer of iniquity will experience disaster as though he had planted disaster as a seed and harvested it as a crop]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:9 (#5)

לְדָל

“to the lowly one”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:9 (#4)

מִלֶּחֶמְמוֹ

“from his bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 22:9 (#1)

טוֹב־עֵינִי הֵהוּא & נָתַתָּן מִלֶּחֶמְמוֹ

“The one good of eye, he & he gives from his bread”

The one good of eye, he, and his refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person good of eye, that person ... that person gives from that person's own bread]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:9 (#3)

הֵהוּא יְבָרְכֶה

“he will be blessed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who will do the action, it is clear from the context that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will bless him]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:9 (#2)

טוֹב־עֵינִי

“The one good of eye”

Here, **good of eye** refers to seeing what other people need and generously helping them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The generous one] or [The person who is generous to those in need]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:10 (#4)

דִּיּוּן

“judgment”

Here, **judgment** could refer to: (1) arguments or quarrels in general. Alternate translation: [arguments]; (2) lawsuits in a legal court. Alternate translation: [lawsuits]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:10 (#1)

לֵלֵךְ

“a mocker”

See how you translated **a mocker** in 9:7

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:10 (#2)

מִדִּיּוֹן & וְקִלְיוֹן

“strife & and dishonor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **strife** in 16:28 and **dishonor** in 3:35.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:10 (#3)

וַיִּצְאָ מִדִּיּוֹן

“and strife will go out”

Here Solomon speaks of **strife** as if it were a person who could **go out** from a place. He means that **strife** will cease. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and strife will stop]

See: Personification

Proverbs 22:11 (#2)

אֲהַבְתָּ טְהוֹר־לֵב

“One who loves a pure heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person's thoughts and motives exist. Having a **pure heart** means to have good motives and thoughts about others. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2. Alternate translation: [One who wants to have good thoughts and motives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:11 (#1)

אֱהָבָה & שִׁשְׁפֹּתֶיךָ רֵעֶהוּ מִלֵּךְ

“One who loves & his lips & the king {is} his friend”

One who loves, his, and the king refer to these types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who loves ... that person's lips ... any king is that person's friend]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:11 (#3)

שִׁשְׁפֹּתֶיךָ

“his lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:12 (#1)

עֵינֵי יְהוָה

“The eyes of Yahweh”

This phrase refers to **Yahweh** himself, giving the sense of his watchfulness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 22:12 (#2)

נִגְזְרוּ דְדָעַת

“guard knowledge”

Here Solomon speaks of **knowledge** as if it were an object that Yahweh guards. He means that **Yahweh** maintains true **knowledge** against those who would want to promote lies, as in the following line. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [watch over those who speak what is true] or [give success to those who have true knowledge]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:12 (#3)

וְיִסְלֹף

“but he overturns”

Here Solomon refers to **Yahweh** preventing **the words** of **treacherous** people from accomplishing their purposes as if **he overturns** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he prevents the success of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:12 (#4)

דְּבָרָיו

“the words of”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:12 (#5)

בָּגֵד

“a treacherous one”

Here, **a treacherous one** refers to this type of person in general, not a specific treacherous person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural phrase in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who is treacherous]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:13 (#3)

אָמַר

“says”

In this verse, Solomon implies that what the **lazy one** says is not true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [says falsely]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:13 (#2)

אָמַר & אֶרְבִּי בַחֲצוֹן בְּתוֹךְ רִחְבּוֹת אֶרֶץ

“says, “A lion {is} outside! I will be killed in the midst of the open areas”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate trans-

lation: [says that a lion is outside and he will be killed in the midst of the open areas]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 22:13 (#1)

עֲצֵל

“A lazy one”

See how you translated this phrase in 13:4.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:13 (#5)

אֲרֻצָּה

“I will be killed”

Here, the **lazy one** implies that he **will be killed** if he goes outside. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [If I go outside, then I will be killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:13 (#4)

אֲרֻצָּה

“I will be killed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The lion will kill me]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:14 (#5)

זָעֵעִים יְהוָה

“one who is cursed of Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [one whom Yahweh has cursed]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 22:14 (#2)

פִּי

“The mouth of”

Here, **mouth** refers to the seductive things that **a strange woman** says with her **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The seductive speech of]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:14 (#4)

שׁוֹחֲטָה עֲמֻקָּה & יְפֹל־נָשָׁם

“is} a deep pit & will fall there”

Here Solomon speaks of the danger of obeying the seductive speech of **a strange woman** as if it were **a deep pit** that a person could **fall** into and die if they obeyed that speech. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is extremely dangerous ... will die because of it] or [is dangerous like a deep pit ... will fall there and die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:14 (#3)

זָרָה

“a strange woman”

See how you translated this phrase in 2:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:14 (#1)

פִּי זָרָה וְזָעֵעִים יְהוָה

“The mouth of a strange woman & one who is cursed of Yahweh”

The **mouth**, **a strange woman**, and **one cursed of Yahweh** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Mouths of strange women ... people who are cursed of Yahweh]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:15 (#5)

שֵׁשֶׁבֶט מִמּוֹסָף

“the rod of discipline”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **rod** that is used to **discipline** someone. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the rod used for discipline]

See: Possession

Proverbs 22:15 (#3)

בְּלִב

“in the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:15 (#6)

עֵשֶׂבֶת

“the rod of”

See how you translated the same use of **rod** in 10:13 and 13:24.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:15 (#4)

בְּנֵי אָדָם & מִבְּנֵי

“a boy & from him”

Here, **a boy** and **him** refer to a child in general, not a specific boy. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any child ... from that child]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:15 (#1)

אֲדֹנָיִת & מִמּוֹסָר

“Folly & discipline”

See how you translate the abstract nouns **Folly** in 5:23 and **discipline** in 13:24.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:15 (#7)

יִרְחִיקֶנָּה מִמֶּנּוּ

“will cause it to be far away from him”

Here Solomon speaks of **discipline** causing a child to stop being foolish as if **Folly** were an object that **the rod of discipline** could cause to go **far away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will result in him ceasing from folly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:15 (#2)

קָשׁוּרָה בְּלֵב

“is bound up in the heart of”

Here Solomon refers to **a boy** inherently thinking foolishly as if **Folly** were an object **bound up** in that person's **heart**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is inherently within the mind of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:16 (#4)

לְהַרְבִּיבוֹת לָלוּ

“to increase for him”

The pronoun **him** refers to: (1) the person who is oppressing the lowly one. Alternate translation: [to increase for himself]; (2) the lowly person. In this case, the statement describes an unexpected result of **oppressing a lowly one**, just as **surely will be to lack** is the unexpected result of giving to the rich. Alternate translation: [yet increases for him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 22:16 (#2)

לְדָל

“a lowly {one}”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:16 (#1)

עֲשֶׂשֶׂק דָּדָל לְהַרְבִּיבוֹת לָלוּ נִתְּנוּ לְלִעְשֵׁשִׁיר

“One oppressing a lowly {one} to increase for him, one giving to the rich”

One oppressing, **a lowly one**, **one giving**, and **the rich** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural phrases in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who oppresses any lowly person to increase for himself, any person who gives to any rich person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:16 (#6)

לְמַחְסוֹר

“will be} to lack”

Here, **will be to** indicates that what follows is the result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [will result in poverty]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 22:16 (#5)

נִתְּנוּ לְלִעְשֵׁשִׁיר

“one giving to the rich”

Solomon is leaving out some words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context and previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [one who gives gifts to a rich one to increase wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 22:16 (#3)

להרבבות

“to increase”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to increase wealth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 22:17 (#2)

דבררי חכמים

“the words of the wise ones”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:17 (#4)

לדעתי

“to my knowledge”

Here, **knowledge** refers to the **knowledge** that Solomon wants his readers to know. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [to what I want you to know]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:17 (#1)

התט אָזְנְךָ וּשְׁמַע

“Incline your ear and hear”

This phrase means “listen carefully.” See how you translated the same use of the shorter phrase **Incline your ear** in 4:20.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:17 (#3)

וְלִבְךָ תִּשְׁשִׁית לְדַעְתִּי

“and you must set your heart to my knowledge”

Here, **set your heart to** is an idiom that means “think carefully about.” The word **heart** here refers to a person’s mind, as in 2:2. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you must think carefully about my knowledge]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:18 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 22:18 (#2)

תִּשְׁמְרֵם בְּבִטְנוֹתֵיכֶם

“you keep them in your inner parts”

Here Solomon speaks of remembering something as if it were an object that someone should **keep** inside that person’s **inner parts**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you remember them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:18 (#5)

יִכְלְנוּ יַחְדָּם עַל־שִׁפְתֵיךָ

“they are ready together on your lips”

Here Solomon speaks of someone always being able to repeat “the words of the wise” as if they were objects **on** someone’s **lips** that **are ready** to come out. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and if you are prepared to say them all]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:18 (#3)

תִּשְׁמְרֵם & יִכְלְנוּ

“you keep them & they are ready”

Here, **them** and **they** refer to “the words of the wise” and “my knowledge” in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this ex-

plicitly. Alternate translation: [you keep those words ... those words are ready]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 22:18 (#4)

יִכְכְּנוּ יַחְדָּדוּ עַל־שִׁפְתֶיךָ

“they are ready together on your lips”

This clause refers to an additional condition for it being **pleasant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:19 (#1)

לְהִינִיּוֹת בְּבִיהֶנָּה מִכְּטָהֶיךָ הוֹדַעְתִּיךָ הַיּוֹם אֲף־אֶתָּה

“For} your trust to be in Yahweh, I have caused you to know today, even you”

The first clause of this verse is the purpose for the second clause. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the second clause before the first clause and connect them in a way that makes it clear that **For your trust to be in Yahweh** is the purpose of the teaching. Alternate translation: [I have caused you to know these things today, even you, in order for your trust to be in Yahweh]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 22:19 (#4)

אֲף־אֶתָּה

“even you”

Here Solomon repeats the pronoun **you** to emphasize to whom he is teaching these proverbs. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Yes, this is for you]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 22:19 (#3)

הוֹדַעְתִּיךָ

“I have caused you to know”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from 22:17 if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I have caused you to know the words of the wise]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 22:19 (#2)

הוֹדַעְתִּיךָ

“I have caused you to know”

Solomon uses the past tense here in order to refer to something that is happening while he is writing these verses, which is the time he calls **today**. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the present tense. Alternate translation: [I am causing you to know]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 22:20 (#3)

שְׁלֹשִׁים

“30 things”

The word translated as **30 things** could also refer to a type of military officer, which might imply that these are “excellent things.” Some translations follow that interpretation. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 22:20 (#2)

הֲלֹא כָתַבְתִּי

“Have I not written”

Solomon uses the past tense here in order to refer to something that is happening while he is writing these verses, which is the time he calls **today** in the previous verse. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the present tense. Alternate translation: [Am I not writing]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Proverbs 22:20 (#4)

בְּמִוְעֶצֶת וְדָעַת

“with counsels and knowledge”

Here, **counsels and knowledge** refer to what the **30 things** are. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that are counsels and knowledge]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:20 (#1)

הֲלֹא כָתַבְתִּי

“Have I not written”

This phrase indicates that Solomon is using the question form in this verse and the next verse in order to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I have surely written]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:20 (#5)

בְּמִוְצָצִית וְדַעַת

“with counsels and knowledge”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **counsels** and **knowledge**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **knowledge** in 1:4. Alternate translation: [that can counsel you and make you knowledgeable]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:21 (#1)

לְהוֹדִיעַךָ

“to cause you to know”

This verse continues the rhetorical question that began in the previous verse. If you divide these two verses into separate sentences, then you will need to repeat part of the previous sentence. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form to explain the purpose of writing something, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation rather than as a question. Alternate translation: [I have surely written these things to cause you to know]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:21 (#7)

לְשִׁלְחֶיךָ

“to one who sent you”

Here Solomon implies that he is speaking to a messenger whom his master has **sent**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to your master who sent you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:21 (#3)

אֱמָרָי אֱמָמָה

“the words of trustworthiness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **words** that are characterized by **trustworthiness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the trustworthy words]

See: Possession

Proverbs 22:21 (#2)

קִרְשָׁט & אֱמָמָה

“the truth of & trustworthiness”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **truth** in 8:7 and **trustworthiness** in 3:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:21 (#6)

לְהַשְׁבִּיב

“to return”

Here Solomon refers to replying to someone with **trustworthy words** as if they were objects that one returns to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to reply with]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:21 (#5)

לְהַשְׁבִּיב

“to return”

Here, **to** indicates that what follows is a second purpose for Solomon writing these “words of the wise”. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a second purpose. Alternate translation: [and to return]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:21 (#4)

אֱמָרָי & אֱמָרָיִם

“the words of & words”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:22 (#3)

דָּל & דָּל

“a lowly {one & is} a lowly {one}”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:22 (#5)

בְּשַׁעַר

“at the gate”

Here, **the gate** refers to the place in a city where people settled legal arguments (see Ruth 4:1–12). If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [at the place for settling legal arguments]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:22 (#1)

אַל־תִּגְזֹל־דָּדָל כִּי דָל־הוּא וְאִל־תִּדְכָּא עֲנִי בְשַׁעַר

“Do not rob a lowly {one} because he {is} a lowly {one}, and do not crush an afflicted {one} at the gate”

22:22–23 is Saying 1 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 22:22 (#4)

וְאִל־תִּדְכָּא

“and do not crush”

Here the writer refers to oppressing **an afflicted one** as if someone were crushing that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:22 (#2)

דָּדָל & דָּל־הוּא & עֲנִי

“a lowly {one & he {is} a lowly {one & an afflicted {one}”

Here, **a lowly one**, **he**, and **an afflicted one** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any lowly person ... that person is lowly ... any afflicted person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:23 (#4)

וְקִבֵּעַ & נֶפֶשׁ

“and he will plunder of life”

Here, the writer refers to **Yahweh** killing a person who tries to **plunder** a poor person as if he were a thief who plunders that person’s **life**. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will cause to die]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:23 (#3)

רִיבָם

“their dispute”

See how you translated the abstract noun **dispute** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 22:23 (#2)

רִיבָם & אֶת־קִבְעֵיהֶם

“their dispute & those who plunder them”

In this verse, **their** and **them** refer to the afflicted and poor people referenced in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the dispute of poor people ... those who plunder poor people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 22:23 (#1)

יְהוָה יִרְיֵב רִיבָם

“Yahweh will plead their dispute”

Here, the writer refers to **Yahweh** protecting “an afflicted one” as if he were a lawyer defending that person in court. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will protect them] or [Yahweh will protect them like a lawyer who defends them in court]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:24 (#5)

אִישׁ הַחֵמוֹת

“a man of heat”

See how you translated this phrase in 15:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 22:24 (#1)

אַל־תִּתֵּן־חֵרֶע אֶת־בִּבְעֵל אָזְנָךְ וְאֶת־אֲזָיִשׁ חֲמוֹת לֹא תְּבֹא

“Do not befriend an owner of nose, and do not go {with} a man of heat”

22:24–25 is Saying 2 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 22:24 (#4)

אֶת־בִּבְעַל אָאָף

“an owner of nose”

The phrase is an idiom that refers to a person who is characteristically angry. The word **nose** means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [an angry person]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:24 (#3)

אֶת־בִּבְעַל אָאָף & אִישׁ חֵם

“an owner of nose & a man of heat”

Here, **an owner of nose** and **a man of heat** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any owner of nose ... any person of heat]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:24 (#2)

אֶל־תִּתְּרַע אֶת־בִּבְעַל אָאָף וְאֶת־אִישׁ חֵם לֹלֵא תְּבוּא

“Do not befriend an owner of nose, and do not go {with} a man of heat”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Do not befriend an owner of nose, yes, do not go with a man of heat]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 22:25 (#1)

פֶּן־תִּלְמַדְךָ אֶרְחֻו וְלִקְחֶתָּ מִקְדָּשׁ לְנַפְשְׁךָ

“lest you learn his paths and you take a snare for your life”

Here, **lest** introduces an outcome that the speaker does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives his hearers in verse 24 an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your lan-

guage that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction of verse 24. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Do not do that, so that you do not learn his paths or take a snare for your life]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 22:25 (#3)

וְלִקְחֶתָּ מִקְדָּשׁ לְנַפְשְׁךָ

“and you take a snare for your life”

Here, the writer speaks of a person causing his life to be in danger as if that person were an animal that gets caught in a **snare**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and you will put your life in danger] or [and you will be like an animal that gets caught in a snare and cannot escape]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:25 (#2)

תִּלְמַדְךָ אֶרְחֻו

“you learn his paths”

Here, the writer speaks of someone behaving like someone else as if that person **learns** the **paths** that the other person walks on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **paths** in 2:15. Alternate translation: [you behave like him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:26 (#5)

בְּתֻקְעֵי־כַף

“among those who clasp a palm”

See how you translated the same idiom in 6:1 and 17:18.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:26 (#2)

אֶל־תִּהְיֶה בְּתֻקְעֵי־כַף בְּבַעֲרֵי־מִשְׁאֹת

“Do not be among those who clasp a palm, among those who pledge for loans”

In the second clause, the writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Do not be

among those who clasp a palm; do not be among those who pledge for loans]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 22:26 (#6)

בַּבְּעֶרְבִים

“among those who pledge for”

See how you translated the same use of **pledge** in 6:1.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:26 (#3)

אַל־תִּהְיֶה בְּתִקְעֵי־כַּף בַּבְּעֶרְבִים מִשְׁאֹת

“Do not be among those who clasp a palm, among those who pledge for loans”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Do not be among those who clasp a palm; yes, do not be among those who pledge for loans]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 22:26 (#4)

אַל־תִּהְיֶה בְּתִקְעֵי־כַּף

“Do not be among those who clasp a palm”

The phrase **do not be among** could refer to: (1) not participating in what **those who clasp a palm** do, which is promise to pay the debts of others. Alternate translation: [Do not be like those who clasp a palm] or [Do not clasp a palm]; (2) not associating with **those who clasp a palm**. Alternate translation: [Do not associate with those who clasp a palm]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:26 (#1)

אַל־תִּהְיֶה בְּתִקְעֵי־כַּף בַּבְּעֶרְבִים מִשְׁאֹת

“Do not be among those who clasp a palm, among those who pledge for loans”

22:26–27 is Saying 3 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 22:27 (#3)

לֵלְמָה יִקְחָה מִמֶּשְׁכַּבְּךָ מִתְּחִיד

“why should he take away your bed from under you”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize what will happen if a person cannot repay a loan for someone else. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [surely he will take away your bed from under you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:27 (#2)

אִין־לְדָךְ לְשַׁלֵּם

“there is nothing to you to make payment”

Here, the writer is referring to repaying the loans mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [there is no money for you to repay the loan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:27 (#1)

אם

“if”

This verse gives a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do those things because if]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 22:27 (#4)

יִקְחָה מִמֶּשְׁכַּבְּךָ מִתְּחִיד

“should he take away your bed from under you”

This clause refers to a person who loaned money taking away the **bed** of someone because that person was unable to pay the loan that he had promised to pay for someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [should the lender take away your bed from under you because you were not able to repay the loan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:28 (#4)

אֲבוֹתֶיךָ

“your fathers”

Here, **fathers** means “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 22:28 (#1)

אל־תַּתְּסֵג גְּבוּל עוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר עָשׂוּ אֲבוֹתֶיךָ

“Do not move the ancient boundary that your fathers made”

22:28 is Saying 4 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 22:28 (#3)

גְּבוּל עוֹלָם

“the ancient boundary”

The phrase **ancient boundary** refers to stones that people used to mark the boundaries of the land that they owned. These boundaries were **ancient** because they were originally placed by the landowner’s ancestors. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of **boundary** marker, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the stones placed long ago that mark the borders of someone’s land]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 22:28 (#2)

אל־תַּתְּסֵג גְּבוּל עוֹלָם

“Do not move the ancient boundary”

The writer implies that someone moves the **ancient boundary** in order to cheat the landowner by changing the boundaries of his land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do not cheat a landowner by moving the ancient boundary]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 22:29 (#4)

לִפְנֵי יְהִי צָב בְּלִי־יָחִיצָב לִפְנֵי

“He will station himself before the face of & he will not station himself before the face of”

The phrase **station himself before the face of** is an idiom that means “to enter the service of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will enter the service of ... he will not enter the service of]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 22:29 (#3)

אִישׁ מְמַהֵר בְּמַלְאָתוֹ & יִתְצָב בְּלִי־יָחִיצָב

“a skilled man in his work. He will station himself & he will not station himself”

Here, **a skilled man**, **his**, **he**, and **himself** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [people skilled in their work; those people will station themselves ... they will not station themselves]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 22:29 (#2)

הֲזֵיתָ אִישׁ מְמַהֵר בְּמַלְאָתוֹ

“You see a skilled man in his work”

Although the Hebrew text is not worded as a question, several translations make this clause into a rhetorical question. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this as a question. Alternate translation: [Have you seen a man skilled in his work?]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 22:29 (#1)

הֲזֵיתָ אִישׁ מְמַהֵר בְּמַלְאָתוֹ לִפְנֵי־מְלָכִים יִתְצָב בְּלִי־יָחִיצָב לִפְנֵי חֲשָׁכִים

“You see a skilled man in his work. He will station himself before the face of kings; he will not station himself before the face of obscure ones”

22:29 is Saying 5 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs - Chapter 23 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Sayings from wise men (22:17–24:22)

• Introduction to the sayings (22:17–21)

• The sayings (22:22–24:22)

Chapter 23 continues the section of 30 sayings by “the wise ones” that began in 22:22. This chapter mostly contains longer proverbs, except for 23:9 and 23:12.

Proverbs 23:1 (#3)

אֵת־אֲשֶׁר

“what”

This could refer to: (1) the food that is put in front of you. Alternate translation: [what food] or [the food

that]; (2) the person seated in front of you. Alternate translation: [who] or [the person who]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:1 (#1)

כִּי־תֵנֵשֵׁב לֶחֱתוֹם אֶת־מוֹשֵׁל בְּגִין תִּתְּבִין אֶת־אֲשֶׁשׁ לִפְנֶיךָ

“When you sit to eat {with} a ruler, consider carefully what {is} before your face”

23:1–3 is Saying 6 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:1 (#2)

מוֹשֵׁל

“a ruler”

The word **ruler** represents rulers in general, not one particular **ruler**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any ruler]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:2 (#2)

בְּבֶעַל גִּנּוּפֶשׁ

“are} an owner of appetite”

The phrase **an owner of appetite** refers to a person who likes to eat a lot. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have a big appetite] or [are a person who likes to eat]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:2 (#1)

וְשִׁמְתָּ שֶׁכֶּיִן בְּלַעְיֶיךָ

“and you should put a knife at your throat”

This phrase is an idiom that means “restrain yourself.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you should cut down your appetite] or [and you should control yourself]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:3 (#4)

לֶחֶם

“bread of”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 23:3 (#3)

לֶחֶם קְזָבִים

“bread of lies”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to refer to **bread** that someone gives for the purpose of **lies**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is bread for deception]

See: Possession

Proverbs 23:3 (#2)

וְהֵהוּא

“for it {is}”

Although **it** is singular, it refers to the **delicious morsels** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this with a plural form. Alternate translation: [for they are]

Proverbs 23:3 (#1)

לְמַטַּעַמֵּי־חֵיָוִי

“his delicious morsels”

Here, **his** refers to the “ruler” mentioned in 23:1. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that ruler’s delicious morsels]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 23:4 (#2)

מִבִּינְתְּךָ חָדָל

“from your understanding, cease”

This phrase could mean: (1) because you have **understanding**, you should **cease**. Alternate translation: [cease because of your understanding]; (2) you should cease from having an incorrect understanding, which would be thinking that it is good to weary yourself to gain riches. Alternate translation: [cease from your wrong understanding about gaining riches]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:4 (#1)

אַל־תִּיגַע לְהַעֲשִׂיר מִבִּינְתְּךָ חָדָל

“Do not weary yourself to gain riches; from your understanding, cease”

23:4–5 is Saying 7 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:5 (#2)

הַתְּעוּף עֵינֶיךָ בָּבוֹ

“Will you cause your eyes to fly to it”

Here, the writer speaks of someone looking at riches as if his **eyes** were a bird that could **fly** to the riches. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Will you look at it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:5 (#3)

בָּבוֹ וְאֵלַיִן בָּבוֹ & יַעֲשֶׂה לָּלוֹ & וְעִיף

“to it, but it is not there & it will make & for itself & it will fly {into}”

In this verse, **it** and **itself** refers to the riches mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the riches, but they are not there ... those riches will make ... for themselves ... those riches will fly into]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 23:5 (#6)

עֲשֵׂה יַעֲשֶׂה לָּלוֹ כְּכַנְפֵּי כְּכַנְפֵּי וְעִיף הַשָּׁמַיִם

“making, it will make wings for itself; like an eagle, it will fly {into} the sky”

Here, the writer speaks of a person quickly losing his wealth as if that wealth made **wings for itself** and flew away **into the sky like an eagle**. Just as eagles fly quickly, the wealth will disappear quickly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [it will surely disappear quickly] or [it will surely disappear as if it had wings and flew away quickly, as an eagle flies into the sky]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:5 (#7)

כְּכַנְפֵּי

“like an eagle”

An **eagle** is a bird that can fly rapidly. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [like a quick bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 23:5 (#5)

עֲשֵׂה יַעֲשֶׂה

“making, it will make”

The writer is repeating the verb **make** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [it will surely make]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 23:5 (#4)

וְאֵלַיִן בָּבוֹ

“but it is not there”

The writer implies that a person loses his wealth as soon as he sees it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but it is lost]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:5 (#1)

הַתְּעוּף עֵינֶיךָ בָּבוֹ וְאֵלַיִן בָּבוֹ

“Will you cause your eyes to fly to it, but it is not there”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize how easily wealth is lost. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You will surely cause your eyes to fly to it, but it will not be there!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 23:6 (#2)

אֶת־לֶחֶם

“the bread of”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 23:6 (#1)

אֶל־תֹּלַחֲחִים אֶת־לֶחֶם רַרְעַ עֵינְךָ וְאֶל־תֹּארוֹ לְמִטְעַמְתֵּי

“Do not eat the bread of {one} evil of eye, and do not desire his delicious morsels”

23:6–8 is Saying 8 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:6 (#5)

למטעמתי

“his delicious morsels”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:3.

Proverbs 23:6 (#4)

ררע עיני

“one} evil of eye”

The phrase **one evil of eye** is an idiom that means “a stingy person.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [one who is stingy]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:6 (#3)

ררע עיני & למטעמתי

“one} evil of eye & his delicious morsels”

Here, **one evil of eye** and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person evil of eye ... that person’s delicious morsels]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:7 (#3)

בנפשיו

“in his soul”

Here, the writer uses **soul** to refer a person’s inner being or mind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in his inner being] or [in his mind]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:7 (#1)

בכי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do those things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 23:7 (#5)

וילבבו בלעמך

“but his heart {is} not with you”

The phrase **his heart is not with you** is an idiom that means “he is not being sincere with you.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but he is not speaking sincerely to you] or [but he is not being honest with you]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:7 (#2)

כמו־שער

“like one who calculates”

The writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like one who calculates the cost of the food]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:7 (#4)

אכל וישתה יאמר לך

“Eat and drink!” he will say to you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [He will tell you to eat and drink]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 23:8 (#4)

והחלה

“and you will ruin”

Here, the writer refers to speaking **words** in vain as if they were objects that one could **ruin**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and that will negate]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:8 (#5)

דבר־יד הנעים

“your pleasant words”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:8 (#3)

פִתְיוֹד

“your morsel”

Here, **morsel** most likely refers to a small amount of food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [your bit of food] or [your small amount of food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:8 (#1)

פִתְיוֹד־אֶכְכֶּלְתָּ תִקְוִי־אֲנִי

“You will vomit up your morsel you ate”

This clause could mean: (1) the person feels like vomiting, in which case this clause is an exaggeration. Alternate translation: [You will feel like vomiting up what you ate]; (2) the person feels so bad that he actually vomits.

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 23:8 (#2)

תִקְוִי־אֲנִי

“You will vomit up”

The writer could imply that the person vomits or feels like vomiting because he is so disgusted at the attitude of the stingy person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [You will feel disgusted with him and vomit up]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:9 (#2)

בְּאָזְנוֹי & אֶל־תִּדְבֹּר

“Do not speak in the ears of”

The phrase **speak in the ears** refers to speaking directly to someone so that the person can clearly hear with his **ears** what is being said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not speak directly to]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:9 (#5)

מִלִּי

“your words”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:9 (#3)

כְּכִסִּיל & יִבְבוֹ

“a stupid {one & he will show contempt”

See how you translated the same use of **a stupid one** and **he** in 10:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:9 (#4)

לְשִׁשְׁכָּל

“for the insight of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **insight** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:9 (#1)

בְּאָזְנוֹי כְּכִסִּיל אֶל־תִּדְבֹּר כִּי־יִבְבוֹ לְשִׁשְׁכָּל מִלִּי

“Do not speak in the ears of a stupid {one}, for he will show contempt for the insight of your words”

23:9 is Saying 9 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:10 (#4)

יָתוֹמָמִים

“fatherless ones”

The phrase **fatherless ones** refers to children who have lost their fathers and so do not have anyone to protect them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [children without fathers to protect them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:10 (#3)

וּבְשָׂדֵי יָתוֹמָמִים אֶל־תֵּבֵא

“and do not enter into the fields of fatherless ones”

The connection with the previous clause indicates that the phrase **enter into** here refers to taking over or using the land that belongs to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [do not take over the fields of fatherless ones] or [do not encroach on the fields of fatherless ones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:10 (#1)

אַל־תַּתְּסֵג גְבוּל עוֹלָם וּבְשִׁדְדֵי יְהוֹמָמִים אַל־תִּבָּא

“Do not move an ancient boundary, and do not enter into the fields of fatherless ones”

23:10-11 is Saying 10 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:10 (#2)

אַל־תַּתְּסֵג גְבוּל עוֹלָם

“Do not move an ancient boundary”

See how you translated this clause in 22:28.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:11 (#3)

הוּא־יִרְרֵיב

“he himself will plead”

The writer uses the word **himself** to emphasize how significant it was that Yahweh defends the defenseless. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [he indeed will plead]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 23:11 (#1)

גֹּאֲלָם

“their redeemer”

Here, **their redeemer** refers to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [their redeemer, Yahweh,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:11 (#4)

אֶת־רִיבָם

“their dispute”

See how you translated the abstract noun **dispute** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:11 (#2)

הוּא־יִרְרֵיב אֶת־רִיבָם אִתְּךָ

“he himself will plead their dispute against you”

Here, the writer refers to Yahweh protecting “the fatherless ones” as if he were a lawyer who defends them in a legal **dispute**. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he himself will defend the orphans against you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:12 (#6)

וְאָזְנוֹךָ

“and your ear”

See how you translated the same use of **ear** in 22:17.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:12 (#4)

הִבְרִיאתָ לְמוֹסֵר לְבָבְךָ

“Bring your heart to correction”

Here, **bring your heart to** is an idiom that means “think carefully about.” The word **heart** here refers to a person’s mind, as in 2:2. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of the phrase “set your heart to” in 22:17. Alternate translation: [Think carefully about correction]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:12 (#1)

הִבְרִיאתָ לְמוֹסֵר לְבָבְךָ וְאָזְנוֹךָ לְאִמְרֵי־דַעַת

“Bring your heart to correction and your ear to words of knowledge”

23:12 is Saying 11 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:12 (#5)

לְמוֹסֵר

“to correction”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **correction** in 3:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:12 (#7)

לְאִמְרֵי־דַעַת

“to words of knowledge”

See how you translated **words of knowledge** in 19:27.

See: Possession

Proverbs 23:12 (#3)

הַבְּרִיָּאָה לְמוֹסֶסֶר לְבָבְךָ וְאָזְנוֹךָ לְאִמְרֵי־דַעַת

“Bring your heart to correction and your ear to words of knowledge”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Bring your heart to correction; yes, bring your ear to words of knowledge]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:12 (#2)

הַבְּרִיָּאָה לְמוֹסֶסֶר לְבָבְךָ וְאָזְנוֹךָ לְאִמְרֵי־דַעַת

“Bring your heart to correction and your ear to words of knowledge”

The writer is leaving out a word in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply the word from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Bring your heart to correction and bring your ear to words of knowledge]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:13 (#3)

מוֹסֶסֶר

“discipline”

See how you translated the abstract noun **discipline** in 13:24.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:13 (#4)

מִנְנֵעַר & תִּכְכְּנוּ & לֹא יָמוּת

“from a boy & you strike him & he will not die”

Here, **a boy**, **him**, and **he** refer to children in general, not to a specific **boy**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated the same use of **boy** and **he** in 22:6. Alternate translation: [from any child ... you strike that child ... that child will not die]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:13 (#5)

תִּכְכְּנוּ בַבֶּשֶׁשׁ־בֵּט

“you strike him with the rod”

This phrase refers to a form of punishment that involved hitting a person with a wooden stick of some kind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a general expression for physical punishment. Alternate translation: [you punish him physically] or [you punish him by hitting him with a stick]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:13 (#2)

אַל־תִּמְנֹעַ & מוֹסֶסֶר

“Do not withhold discipline”

Here, the writer speaks of refusing to **discipline** a child as if **discipline** were an object that a parent refuses to give to his child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not hold back discipline]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:13 (#1)

אַל־תִּמְנֹעַ מִנְנֵעַר מוֹסֶסֶר כִּי־תִכְכְּנוּ בַבֶּשֶׁשׁ־בֵּט לֹא יָמוּת

“Do not withhold discipline from a boy; when you strike him with the rod, he will not die”

23:13–14 is Saying 12 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:14 (#1)

אַתָּה

“You”

Here, the speaker includes the pronoun **you** even though the verb translated as **strike** already includes this meaning. Doing this adds emphasis to what he is saying. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [You must consider this]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 23:14 (#2)

בֶּשֶׁשׁ־בֵּט תִּכְכְּנוּ

“with the rod you will strike him”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:14 (#4)

וְנִפְשֵׁוֹ מִשְׁאֵאֹל תִּצִּיל

“and you will rescue his life from Sheol”

Here, the writer speaks of someone preventing his child from dying as if he were rescuing **his life from Sheol**, which was considered to be the place where people’s spirits go when they die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will keep him alive]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:14 (#3)

וְנִפְשֵׁוֹ & תִּצִּיל

“and you will rescue his life”

Here, **and** introduces the result of doing what was stated in the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [If you do this, then you will rescue his life] or [This will result in you rescuing his life]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 23:15 (#3)

לִבִּי & לִבִּי

“your heart & my heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:15 (#2)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 23:15 (#1)

בְּנִי אִם-תִּירָאֵם לִבִּי יִשְׂמַח לִבִּי גַם-אֲנִי

“My son, if your heart {is} wise, my heart, even myself, will be glad”

23:15–16 is Saying 13 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:16 (#1)

כְּלִי־תִי

“my inner parts”

Here, **inner parts** is used as a parallel expression to “heart” in the previous verse, and so it also represents where a person’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [my inner being]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:16 (#2)

שִׁפְתֵי־תִי

“your lips”

Here, **lips** represent the person in the act of speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:17 (#2)

לִי־לֵב

“your heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts, feelings, and desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [yourself]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:17 (#3)

כִּי אִם-בִּירְאַת-יְהוָה

“but rather in the fear of Yahweh”

The writer is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but rather, continue in the fear of Yahweh] or [but rather, let your heart be in the fear of Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:17 (#4)

בִּירְאַת־יְהוָה

“in the fear of Yahweh”See how you translated **the fear of Yahweh** in 1:7.

See: Possession

Proverbs 23:17 (#1)

אֶל־יִקְנָא לְלִבְךָ בַּחַטָּאִים כִּכִּי אִם־בִּירְאַת־יְהוָה כָּל־הַיּוֹם

“Do not let your heart be envious of sinners, but rather in the fear of Yahweh all the day”

23:17–18 is Saying 14 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:18 (#2)

יֵשׁ אַחֲרַיִת

“there is a future”

Here, the writer implies that the **future** is good and is for the person addressed as **your** in the next clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [there is a good future for you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:18 (#4)

וְהַתְקוּתֶיךָ

“and your hope”See how you translated the abstract noun **hope** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:18 (#1)

כִּכִּי אִם־יֵשׁ אַחֲרַיִת

“Surely there is a future”

Here the writer implies that the contents of the verse are true if the person has “the fear of Yahweh” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [If you have the fear of Yahweh, then surely there is a future]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:18 (#3)

וְהַתְקוּתֶיךָ לֹא תִכָּרֵת

“and your hope will not be cut off”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will not cut off your hope]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 23:18 (#6)

לֹא תִכָּרֵת

“will not be cut off”

The writer is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [will surely become reality]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 23:18 (#5)

לֹא תִכָּרֵת

“will not be cut off”

Here, the writer speaks of hope as if it were an object that could be cut off. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will not remain unfulfilled] or [will not fail to become reality]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:19 (#3)

וְהִזְכֵּכֶם

“and be wise”

Here, **and** introduces the purpose for listening. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. See how you translated this phrase in 6:6.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 23:19 (#4)

וְאִשְׁשֵׁר בְּדֶרֶךְ לִבְךָ

“and lead your heart in the way”

Here the writer refers to a person deciding to think about the right way to behave as if that person were leading his **heart** to go on a certain path. The word **heart** here refers to a person’s thoughts, as in 2:2, and **way** refers to right human behavior. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and decide to think about right behavior]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:19 (#1)

שמע־את־תּוֹרַת בְּנִי וְחַכְמָם וְאַשְׁרֵר בְּדַרְדָּר לִבְךָ

“Listen, you my son, and be wise, and lead your heart in the way”

23:19–21 is Saying 15 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:19 (#2)

בְּנִי

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 23:20 (#1)

אַל־תִּהְיֶה בְּסָבִיא

“Do not be among drinkers of much”

See how you translated the same use of **Do not be among** in 22:26.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:20 (#3)

בְּשָׂר

“flesh”

Here, **flesh** refers to meat, which is animal **flesh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 23:20 (#2)

בְּזִלְזָלִי בְּשָׂר

“among gluttonous eaters of flesh”

The writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and do not be among gluttonous eaters of flesh]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:21 (#4)

וְיִקְרַעְעֵים תְּלַבְבִּישׁ נֹמָה

“and slumber will clothe {with} rags”

Here, **clothe with rags** indicates that a person is so poor that they only have **rags** for clothing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and slumber will make one so poor that he only has rags to wear]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:21 (#1)

סַבִּבָּא נְזִזְלִל

“one who drinks much and one who eats gluttonously”

Here, **one who drinks much** and **one who eats gluttonously** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who drinks much and any person who eats gluttonously]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:21 (#3)

וְיִקְרַעְעֵים תְּלַבְבִּישׁ נֹמָה

“and slumber will clothe {with} rags”

Here, the writer refers to people becoming poor because they sleep too much as if **slumber** were a person who clothes those people **with rags**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will be clothed with rags because they slept too much]

See: Personification

Proverbs 23:21 (#2)

סַבִּבָּא נְזִזְלִל

“one who drinks much and one who eats gluttonously”

The writer implies that these people drink too much wine and gluttonously eat too much meat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated the similar phrases “drinkers of much wine” and “gluttonous eaters of flesh” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [one who drinks too much wine and one who gluttonously eats too much meat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:22 (#2)

וְאַל-תִּתְּבֹזֶז

“and do not despise”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **despise**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [and respect]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 23:22 (#1)

שְׁמַע לְאָבִיךָ יְיָהּ יִלְדֶּיךָ וְאַל-תִּתְּבֹזֶז כִּי-זָקְנָה אִמְךָ

“Listen to your father, this {one} begot you, and do not despise your mother when she {is} old”

23:22–25 is Saying 16 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:23 (#3)

וְאַל-תִּמְכֹּר

“and do not sell”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **sell**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [and keep it]

See: Double Negatives

Proverbs 23:23 (#1)

אֲמַתְתָּ קִדְנָה וְאַל-תִּמְכֹּר

“Acquire truth and do not sell”

Here the writer speaks of learning and remembering **truth** as if it were an object that someone can **Acquire** and **sell**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Learn truth and do not forget it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:23 (#2)

אֲמַתְתָּ & חֵכְמָה וּמוֹסָר וּבִינָה

“truth & wisdom and instruction and understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **truth** in 8:7 and **wisdom**, **instruction**, and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:23 (#4)

חֵכְמָה וּמוֹסָר וּבִינָה

“wisdom and instruction and understanding”

The writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and acquire wisdom and instruction and understanding]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 23:24 (#2)

אָבִי צַדִּיק יוֹלֵד חָכְמָה & בֶּן

“The father of a righteous one & and one who begets a wise one & in him”

The father, a righteous one, one who begets, a wise one, and him refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any father of any righteous person ... and any person who begets any wise person ... in that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:24 (#3)

גוֹל יִגוֹל

“rejoicing, will rejoice”

The writer is repeating the verb **rejoice** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [he will greatly rejoice]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 23:24 (#4)

בֶּן

“in him”

The word translated as **in** indicates that what follows is the reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [on account of him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 23:24 (#1)

גול יגול אבִי צַדִּיק וְיִלְלֵד הַחֲכָמִים יִשְׂמַח־בּוֹ

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: גול יגול אבִי צַדִּיק וְיִלְלֵד הַחֲכָמִים יִשְׂמַח־בּוֹ”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [The father of a righteous one, rejoicing, will rejoice; yes, one who begets a wise one, he will be glad in him]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:25 (#2)

יִשְׂמַח־אֲבִירִיד וְאִמִּי וְיִלְלֵד יִלְדֶּתָּ

“May your father and your mother be glad, and may she who bore you rejoice”

The writer is using an appeal statement to give a command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command form. Alternate translation: [Cause your father and your mother to be glad, and cause she who bore you to rejoice]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Proverbs 23:25 (#1)

יִשְׂמַח־אֲבִירִיד וְאִמִּי וְיִלְלֵד יִלְדֶּתָּ

“May your father and your mother be glad, and may she who bore you rejoice”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [May your father and your mother be glad; yes, may she who bore you rejoice]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:25 (#3)

יִשְׂמַח־אֲבִירִיד וְאִמִּי

“May your father and your mother be glad”

This verse states the intended result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is what should be the result of what came before. Alternate translation: [Therefore, may your father and your mother be glad]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 23:26 (#4)

וְעֵינֶיךָ & תִּרְצֶנָּה

“and may your eyes watch”

Here, **eyes** represent the ability of a person to learn through observation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and may you look carefully at]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:26 (#1)

תִּנְהַ־בְּנִי לִבִּי לְגִי וְעֵינֶיךָ דְּרֹכֶי תִרְצֶנָּה

“My son, give your heart to me, and may your eyes watch my ways”

23:26–28 is Saying 17 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:26 (#5)

דְּרֹכֶי

“my ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:26 (#3)

וְעֵינֶיךָ דְּרֹכֶי תִרְצֶנָּה

“and may your eyes watch my ways”

The writer is using an appeal statement to give a command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command form. Alternate translation: [and make your eyes watch my ways]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Proverbs 23:26 (#2)

תִּנְהַ & לִבִּי לְגִי

“give your heart to me”

Here, the writer refers to paying careful attention to someone as if the **son** were to **give** his **heart** to him.

The word **heart** here refers to a person's thoughts, as in 2:2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [pay careful attention to me]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:27 (#4)

נְכַרִּיָּה

“a foreign woman”

See how you translated this phrase in 2:16. As there, the woman is “strange” or **foreign** not because she is from a different ethnic group, but because she belongs to another man; she is a foreigner to the son's own marriage. Alternate translation: [the wife of another man]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:27 (#3)

שְׂוִתְחָה עֲמֻקָּה

“is} a deep pit”

See how you translated this phrase in 22:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:27 (#2)

שְׂוִתְחָה עֲמֻקָּה זֹנֶגָה וּבָאֵאָר צָצְרָה נְכַרִּיָּה

“a prostitute {is} a deep pit, and a foreign woman {is} a narrow well”

Here, **a prostitute**, **a deep pit**, **a foreign woman**, and **a narrow well** refer to these things and types of people in general, not to specific things or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any prostitute is a deep pit, and any foreign woman is a narrow well]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 23:27 (#1)

כִּי־שְׂוִתְחָה עֲמֻקָּה זֹנֶגָה וּבָאֵאָר צָצְרָה נְכַרִּיָּה

“For a prostitute {is} a deep pit, and a foreign woman {is} a narrow well”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something

additional. Alternate translation: [For a prostitute is a deep pit: yes, a foreign woman is a narrow well]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:27 (#5)

וּבָאֵאָר צָצְרָה

“and & is} a narrow well”

Here, the writer speaks of the inescapable danger of **a foreign woman** as if she were a **narrow well** that a person could fall into and not get out of. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and ... is dangerous] or [and ... is dangerous like a narrow well]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:28 (#4)

בְּאֶדָּם

“among man”

In this verse, the word **man** is singular in form, but it refers to all men as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly, as in the UST.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 23:28 (#2)

הִיא & תִּשְׁתָּרֵב

“she herself lies in wait”

The writer uses the word **herself** to emphasize who it is who harms men. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [she is the very one who lies in wait]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 23:28 (#3)

וּבֹגְדִים & תּוֹסֵף

“and she adds to the treacherous ones”

Here the writer speaks of an immoral woman causing men to act unfaithfully as if she were adding them to a group of **treacherous ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she increases the number of those who betray their wives]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:28 (#1)

הִיא כִּהְתֵּתָה תִּשְׁתָּרֵב

“she herself lies in wait like a robber”

Here, the writer compares an immoral woman to a **robber** who **lies in wait** to actively attack him and take something from him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. See how you translated **lies in wait** in 7:12. Alternate translation: [she herself lies in wait like a robber to take from a man what is valuable]

See: Simile

Proverbs 23:29 (#4)

חֲכָלֵל לַיּוֹת עֵינַיִם

“is} dullness of eyes”

The phrase **dullness of eyes** refers to **eyes** that look red because a person drank too much alcohol. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is red eyes, like the color of blood] or [is bloodshot eyes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:29 (#3)

לְמָמִי אֶאֱוִי לְמָמִי אֶבְבֹּי לְמָמִי מְדוֹנִים | לְמָמִי שְׂשִׁיחַ

“For whom {is} woe? For whom {is} sorrow? For whom {are} quarrels? For whom {is} a lament”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **woe**, **sorrow**, **quarrels**, and **lament**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [Who is woeful? Who is sorrowful? Who is quarrelsome? Who laments?]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 23:29 (#1)

לְמָמִי אֶאֱוִי לְמָמִי אֶבְבֹּי לְמָמִי מְדוֹנִים | לְמָמִי שְׂשִׁיחַ לְלָמִי פִצְעָעִים
חֲנָנִים לְלָמִי חֲכָלֵל לַיּוֹת עֵינַיִם

“For whom {is} woe? For whom {is} sorrow? For whom {are} quarrels? For whom {is} a lament? For whom {are} wounds without reason? For whom {is} dullness of eyes”

23:29–35 is Saying 18 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 23:29 (#2)

לְמָמִי אֶאֱוִי לְמָמִי אֶבְבֹּי לְמָמִי מְדוֹנִים | לְמָמִי שְׂשִׁיחַ לְלָמִי פִצְעָעִים
חֲנָנִים לְלָמִי חֲכָלֵל לַיּוֹת עֵינַיִם

“For whom {is} woe? For whom {is} sorrow? For whom {are} quarrels? For whom {is} a lament? For

whom {are} wounds without reason? For whom {is} dullness of eyes”

The writer uses these questions to prepare the reader for the point he is about to make about “those who linger over wine” in the next verse. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I will tell you what kind of person has woe, sorrow, quarrels, lament, wounds without reason, and dullness of eyes.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 23:30 (#4)

מִמְסָד

“mixed wine”

In ancient Israel, people often prepared **wine** for drinking by mixing it with water. See how you translated “mixed her wine” in 9:2 and the similar expression in 9:5.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:30 (#2)

לְמֵאחֲרָיִם עַל־הַיַּיִן

“For those who linger over wine”

Here the writer refers to people who spend a lot of time drinking a lot of wine as if they were lingering **over wine**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [For those who spend many hours drinking wine] or [For those who drink more and more wine]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:30 (#1)

לְמֵאחֲרָיִם עַל־הַיַּיִן

“For those who linger over wine”

This verse answers the rhetorical questions in the previous verse. If you did not use questions in the previous verse, then you may need to adjust this sentence. Alternate translation: [The kind of people who do these things are those who linger over wine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:30 (#3)

לְבָאֵאִים לְחִקְוָר מִמְסָד

“for those coming to search out mixed wine”

Here, the writer implies that these people **search out mixed wine** in order to drink it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [for those coming to search out and drink mixed wine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:31 (#1)

אַל־תִּתְרֹא יַיִן

“Do not look [at] wine”

The writer says **Do not look at wine** as an overstatement for emphasis. He is warning the reader not to be enticed by the attractive qualities of wine that he describes here. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Do not be enticed by the attractiveness of wine]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 23:31 (#3)

יִתֵּן בְּכִים עֵינָיו

“its eye gives in the cup”

The phrase **its eye gives** refers to the way **wine** gleams or reflects light inside a **cup**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [it gleams in the cup]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 23:31 (#2)

כִּפִּי יִתְאַדָּגֶם כִּי־יִתֵּן בְּכִים עֵינָיו אִתְּהֶלֶל בְּמִישָׁרִים

“when it is red; when its eye gives in the cup, it goes with evenness”

These three clauses give reasons why someone is tempted to drink **wine**, in contrast to the command to **not look at** it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this contrast more explicit. Alternate translation: [despite it being red, giving its eye in the cup, and going with evenness]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 23:31 (#4)

אִתְּהֶלֶל בְּמִישָׁרִים

“it goes with evenness”

Here, the writer implies that the **wine goes** down a person’s throat smoothly when he drinks it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this

explicitly. Alternate translation: [it flows down one’s through smoothly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:32 (#3)

כְּנֶחֱשׁ יִשְׁשֹׁד וְכַצַּפְעַנְגִּי יִפְרֹשׁ

“bites like a snake, and it stings like a viper”

The writer is saying that the result of drinking too much wine is **like a snake** or **a viper** biting the person, because it is painful and harms that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [hurts as badly as a snakebite]

See: Simile

Proverbs 23:32 (#1)

אַחֲרֵיתוֹ כְּנֶחֱשׁ יִשְׁשֹׁד וְכַצַּפְעַנְגִּי יִפְרֹשׁ

“Its end bites like a snake, and it stings like a viper”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Its end bites like a snake; yes, it stings like a viper]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:32 (#2)

אַחֲרֵיתוֹ

“Its end”

Its end refers to the result of drinking too much wine. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The result of drinking too much of it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:33 (#1)

עֵינֶיךָ

“Your eyes”

In this verse, **eyes** refers to the capability of a person to see. In this case, the person will see things that are not there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 23:26.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 23:33 (#2)

וְלִבְךָ יִדְבֹּק מִתְּפִכּוֹת

“and your heart will speak perverse things”

Here, **heart** refers to the person’s thoughts, in which case the person is thinking or imagining things that are not real. Alternate translation: [and you will think things that are not real] or [and your mind will be confused]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 23:33–35 (#1)

עֵינֶיךָ יִרְאוּ זָרִים

“Your eyes will see strange things”

The writer implies that what is described in these verses is what someone experiences when he drinks too much alcohol. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [These things will happen if you drink too much wine: your eyes will see strange things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:34 (#1)

וְהָיִיתָ כְּשֹׁכֵב בְּלִבֵּי יָם וְכְשֹׁכֵב בְּרֹאשׁ חֵבֶל

“And you will be like one who lies down in the heart of the sea and like one who lies down at the head of a mast”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And you will be like one who lies down in the heart of the sea; yes, like one who lies down at the head of a mast]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 23:34 (#5)

בְּרֹאשׁ חֵבֶל

“at the head of a mast”

The phrase **head of a mast** refers to the top of a long, wooden pole to which a very large cloth, called a sail, was attached. Wind blown into the sail propelled the ship. The top of the mast would sway back and forth more than any other part of the ship, so someone **at**

the head of a mast could easily become dizzy and nauseated. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of mast, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [at the highest point on a ship]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 23:34 (#2)

כְּשֹׁכֵב בְּלִבֵּי יָם

“like one who lies down in the heart of the sea”

The writer is saying that a drunk person is like someone **who lies down in the heart of the sea** because that person feels dizzy, nauseous, and unsteady, like someone on a boat in the middle of the ocean. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [dizzy and nauseous]

See: Simile

Proverbs 23:34 (#4)

וְכְשֹׁכֵב בְּרֹאשׁ חֵבֶל

“and like one who lies down at the head of a mast”

The writer is saying that a drunk person is like someone **who lies down at the head of a mast**, because that person feels dizzy and stumbles like someone who sways back and forth at the top of the mast of a ship in the ocean. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and swaying from side to side]

See: Simile

Proverbs 23:34 (#3)

בְּלִבֵּי יָם

“in the heart of the sea”

Here, **heart** refers to the middle of **the sea**, which is far away from land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the middle of the sea] or [far out in the ocean]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:35 (#7)

אֲזַסְסֶיךָ אֶבְקֶשׁ שָׁנָּה עוֹד

“I will add, I will seek it again”

The drunk person implies that he will **seek** more wine and drink it to **add** to the wine he has already drunk. If

it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I will seek more wine to drink again]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 23:35 (#2)

הכּוֹנֵן בְּלִי-הִלִּיתִי

“They struck me. I was not hurt”

The drunk person implies a strong contrast between the first clause and the second. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [They struck me. However, I was not hurt]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 23:35 (#3)

הִלְמִמוֹנִי בְלִי-יִדְדָדָתִי

“They beat me. I did not know”

The drunk person implies a strong contrast between the first clause and the second. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [They beat me. However, I did not know]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 23:35 (#1)

הכּוֹנֵן

“They struck me”

This verse describes what a drunk person would say. That person was referred to as “you” in the previous two verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 23:35 (#6)

אֲוִסְסִיף אֶבְקֶשׁ שָׁנֹו עוֹד

“I will add, I will seek it again”

The words **add** and **seek it again** express a single idea. The word **add** emphasizes the repetition of seeking more wine to drink. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [I will seek it yet again]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 23:35 (#5)

מִתְתִּי אֶקְרִי

“When will I awake”

Here, **wake up** refers to the drunk person becoming sober again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When will I become sober]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 23:35 (#4)

מִתְתִּי אֶקְרִי

“When will I awake”

The drunk person uses a question in order to emphasize his desire to be **awake**. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I want to wake up!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs - Chapter 24 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Sayings from wise men (22:17–24:22)

- Introduction to the sayings (22:17–21)
- The sayings (22:22–24:22)

1. More sayings from wise men (24:23–34)

24:1–22 finishes the section of 30 sayings by “the wise ones” that began in 22:22. This section mostly contains longer proverbs, except for 24:7 and 24:10.

24:23–34 contain an additional short collection of sayings by “the wise ones.” This section contains proverbs of varying lengths, the longest being 24:30–34.

Proverbs 24:1 (#3)

בְּאִנְשֵׁי

“of men of”

Although the term **men** is masculine, the writer is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [of people of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:1 (#1)

24:1–2 is Saying 19 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:1 (#2)

בְּאִשְׁשׁוֹי רָעָה

“of men of evil”

Here the writer is using the possessive form to describe **men** who are characterized by **evil**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [of evil men]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:2 (#2)

לִבָּם

“their heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and intentions exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly, as in the UST. Alternate translation: [their mind]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:2 (#4)

שִׁפְתֵיהֶם

“their lips”

Here, **lips** represents what people say with their lips. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:2 (#3)

עוֹשֵׂה

“violence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **violence** in 3:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:2 (#1)

יִהְיֶה לִבָּם

“their heart plots”

Although **heart** is singular, it refers to all the hearts of the people who plot **violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form. Alternate translation: [their hearts plot]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 24:2 (#5)

וְצָמְחָה

“and & trouble”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **trouble**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and ... what troubles people]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:3 (#1)

בְּחָכְמָה יִבְנֶה בַּיִת וּבִתְבוּנָה יִתְכַּוֵּן

“By wisdom a house is built, and by understanding it is established”

24:3–4 is Saying 20 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:3 (#2)

בְּחָכְמָה & וּבִתְבוּנָה

“By wisdom & and by understanding”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** and **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:3 (#3)

יִבְנֶה בַּיִת & יִתְכַּוֵּן

“a house is built & it is established”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone builds a house ... someone establishes it]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:3 (#4)

יִתְכַּוֵּן

“it is established”

Here, the word translated as **established** refers to being stable and secure. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [it is secure]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:4 (#2)

וְהָדָרִים יִמְלֵאוּ

“the rooms are filled”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone fills the rooms]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:4 (#1)

וְיִמְלֵךְ

“And by knowledge”

See how you translated the abstract noun **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:4 (#3)

הַדִּרְרִים

“the rooms”

The writer implies that these are **the rooms** in the house described in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the rooms of that house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:5 (#3)

גִּבּוֹר־הַחֵכֶם

“A man of wisdom”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **wisdom**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A wise man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:5 (#1)

24:5–6 is Saying 21 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:5 (#5)

וְאִישׁ־דִּלְעָה

“and a man of knowledge”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **knowledge**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and a knowledgeable man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:5 (#2)

גִּבּוֹר־הַחֵכֶם & וְאִישׁ־דִּלְעָה

“A man of wisdom & and a man of knowledge”

Although the term **man** is masculine, the writer is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [Any person of wisdom ... and any person of knowledge]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:5 (#4)

הַחֵכֶם בְּעֶזְרוֹ & דִּלְעָה & כֹּחַ

“wisdom {is} with strength & knowledge & power”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **wisdom**, **strength**, **knowledge**, and **power**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4. Alternate translation: [what is wise is with what is strong ... what is knowledgeable ... what is powerful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:6 (#2)

תַּעֲשֶׂה־לְךָ מִלְחָמָה

“you make war for yourself”

The writer implies fighting a successful **war**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you successfully make war for yourself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:6 (#1)

בְּתִתְּךָ בָּלוֹת

“by guidance”

See how you translated **guidance** in 20:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:6 (#3)

וְאִתְּשׁוּעָה בְּרֹב יוֹעֵץ

“and salvation {is} in an abundance of counsel”

See how you translated the same clause in 11:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:7 (#2)

רַאמְמוֹת לְאִוִּיל

“are too} high for a fool”

Here, **high** is an idiom that means “too difficult to understand.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are over the head of a fool] or [are too difficult for a fool to understand]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:7 (#5)

לֹלֵא יִפְתַּח-פִּיהוּ

“he will not open his mouth”

Here, **open his mouth** refers to a person speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will not speak]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:7 (#3)

לְאִוִּיל & לֹלֵא יִפְתַּח-פִּיהוּ

“for a fool & he will not open his mouth”

Here, **a fool**, **he**, and **his** represent fools in general, not a specific **fool**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [for any fool ... that person will not open that person's own mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:7 (#1)

24:7 is Saying 22 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:7 (#4)

בְּבִשְׁעֵר

“at the gate”

See how you translated the same use of **gate** in 22:22.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:8 (#2)

מִחֲשֵׁיב & לֵלֹ

“One who plans & him”

One who plans and **him** represent a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful,

you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who plans ... that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:8 (#1)

24:8–9 is Saying 23 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:8 (#3)

לְהַרְעַ

“to do evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:8 (#4)

בְּעַל-מְזֻמּוֹת

“an owner of schemes”

Here the writer refers to a person who has many **schemes** as **an owner of schemes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a person with many schemes] or [a troublemaker]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:9 (#4)

לְאָדָם

“to man”

The word **man** represents people in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [to mankind]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:9 (#2)

זִמְמַת אִנּוּלָה

“A scheme of folly”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **scheme** that is characterized by **folly**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A scheme characterized by folly]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:9 (#1)

זִמְמַת אִנּוּלָה & לֵן

“A scheme of folly & a mocker”

A **scheme of folly** and a **mock**er refer to schemes and mockers in general, not a specific **scheme** or **mock**er. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any scheme of folly ... any mocker]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:9 (#3)

אָנוּלֶת & וְהוֹעֵבֶבֶת

“folly & and & is} an abomination”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **folly** in 5:23 and **abomination** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:10 (#2)

הִתְרַפִּיתִי

“If} you make yourself slack”

The word **yourself** indicates that the object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person fills two roles in the sentence. Alternate translation: [If you falter]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 24:10 (#1)

24:10 is Saying 24 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:10 (#5)

צָרָה & כֹּחֶקָה

“distress, your strength”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **distress** in 1:27 and **strength** in 5:10.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:10 (#4)

בְּיוֹם צָרָה

“in the day of distress”

Here, **day** refers to a point in time when something happens. It does not refer to a 24-hour length of time. See how you translated the same use of **day** in 21:31.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:10 (#6)

צָרָה

“is} narrow”

Here, the writer refers to **your strength** being restricted or limited as if it were **narrow**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is restrained]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:10 (#3)

בְּיוֹם צָרָה

“in the day of distress”

Here, **the day of distress** refers to this type of **day** in general, not a particular **day of distress**. If it would be helpful, you could use a different expression in your language. Alternate translation: [in any day of distress]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:11 (#2)

הַנִּצֵּל לְקַחְתִּים לְמָמוֹת וּמַטְטִים לְלִהְרֹג אִם־תִּחְשָׁדוּ

“Rescue those being taken for the death, and those staggering to the slaughter if you hold back”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Rescue those being taken for the death, yes, those staggering to the slaughter if you hold back]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 24:11 (#6)

וּמַטְטִים לְלִהְרֹג

“and those staggering to the slaughter”

The writer is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply this word from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and rescue those staggering to the slaughter]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 24:11 (#3)

לְקַחְתִּים לְמָמוֹת וּמַטְטִים לְלִהְרֹג

“those being taken for the death, and those staggering to the slaughter”

The writer implies that these people are wrongfully **taken to the death** and **stagger to the slaughter**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those who are wrongfully take to the death, and those who stagger to wrongful slaughter]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:11 (#4)

לְקַחְתִּים

“those being taken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [those whom people take]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:11 (#1)

24:11–12 is Saying 25 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:11 (#5)

לְמָוֶת & לְלֶהָרֶג

“for the death & to the slaughter”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **death** in 2:18 and **slaughter** in 7:22.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:11 (#7)

אִם־תִּחְשָׁוּךְ

“if you hold back”

Here, the writer refers to allowing the **slaughter** of these people as if one were holding oneself back from helping them. You may have a similar expression in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [if you do nothing] or [if you do not stop it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:12 (#6)

הִתְחַכֵּן לִבְבוֹת

“the examiner of hearts”

Here, the writer speaks of one who discerns what people are thinking as if he were an **examiner of hearts**. The word **hearts** here refers to human minds, as in 15:11. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the discerner of minds]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:12 (#3)

זֶה

“this”

Here, **this** refers to what is happening to “those who are taken for the death,” who are also “those who stagger to the slaughter” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that those people were being taken to die] or [that those people were being unjustly killed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 24:12 (#5)

הֲלֹא־תִתְּכֵן לִבְבוֹת | הוּא־יִבְרִין וְנִצָּצַר בְּנִפְשָׁךְ הֵוא יִדְדֶּעַ וְהִשְׁשִׁיב

“does not he, the examiner of hearts, understand, and he, the guard of your life, know, and he, give back”

In this verse, **he** refers to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [does not Yahweh, the examiner of hearts, understand, and Yahweh, the guard of your life, know; and Yahweh will give back]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 24:12 (#7)

וְנִצָּצַר בְּנִפְשָׁךְ הֵוא

“and he, the guard of your life”

Here, the writer speaks of someone who keeps a person alive as if he were **the guard** of that person's **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he, the one who preserves your life]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:12 (#8)

וְהִשְׁשִׁיב לְאָדָם

“and he, give back to a man”

Here, the writer refers to Yahweh causing **a man** to receive what he deserves for **his work** as if Yahweh were giving something **back** to that **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will make sure a man receives what is due to him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:12 (#1)

כִּי־תֹאמַרְךָ

“If you say”

Here, the writer implies that the speaker did **know** and is lying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [If you lie by saying]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:12 (#9)

לְאָדָם כְּפָעֻלוֹ

“to a man according to his work”

Although **man** and **he** are masculine, the writer is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [a person according to that person's work]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:12 (#4)

הֲלֹא־תִתְכַנֵּן לַפְּבוֹת | הוּא־יִכְבִּין וְנִצְצֵר נִנְפֶשֶׁד הוּא יִדְעַ וְהִשְׁשִׁיב לְאָדָם כְּפָעֻלוֹ

“does not he, the examiner of hearts, understand, and he, the guard of your life, know, and he, give back to a man according to his work”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [he, the examiner of hearts, surely understands, and he, the guard of your life, surely knows, and he will surely give back to a man according to his work!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 24:12 (#2)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

The speaker is using the term **Behold** to focus attention on what he is about to say, which is an objection to an unspoken accusation. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Listen] or [But look]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:13 (#1)

24:13–14 is Saying 26 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:13 (#2)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 10:1.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:14 (#1)

כִּנּוּן

“is} thus”

Here, **thus** indicates that the writer is comparing **wisdom** with honey, which was mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [is similar to honey]

See: Simile

Proverbs 24:14 (#2)

חֵכְמָה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:14 (#3)

לְנִפְשְׁךָ

“for your soul”

See how you translated the same use of **soul** in 2:10.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 24:14 (#4)

מֵמָצְאָה

“you find {it”

See how you translated the same use of **find** in 16:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:14 (#5)

וַיֵּשׁ אַחֲרֶיהֶם וְהִתְקַוּוּהֶם לֹלֵא תִכְרֹת

“then there will be a future and your hope will not be cut off”

See how you translated the same clauses in 23:18.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:15 (#1)

24:15–16 is Saying 27 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:15 (#3)

רָשָׁע & צַדִּיק

“like} a wicked {one & the righteous”

See how you translated **a wicked one** in 9:9 and **the righteous** in 10:3.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:15 (#2)

אֶל־תִּאָרֵב רָשָׁע לְנֶמְלָה צַדִּיק

“Do not lie in wait {like} a wicked {one} against the abode of the righteous”

Here, the writer implies that someone would **lie in wait** in order to attack **the abode of the righteous one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do not lie in wait like a wicked one to attack the abode of the righteous one]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:16 (#1)

שִׁבְעַ

“seven {times”

Here, **seven times** is used to refer to multiple occurrences in general, not specifically **seven**. In Hebrew, **seven** often symbolizes the idea of completion. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [numerous times]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:16 (#2)

צַדִּיק

“a righteous {one”

See how you translated **a righteous one** in 9:9.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:16 (#4)

יִכְשְׁלֵנוּ בְרָעָה

“stumble into calamity”

Here, the writer speaks of someone experiencing **calamity** as if that person stumbled into it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [experience calamity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:16 (#5)

בְרָעָה

“into calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:16 (#3)

יִפְּוֹל & יִקָּם

“falls and rises up”

Here, the writer speaks of someone experiencing disaster as if that person **falls**, and he speaks of recovering from that disaster as if that person **rises up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will experience disaster and recover from it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:17 (#4)

לִבְךָ

“your heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [your spirit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:17 (#2)

בְּנִפְּלֹא אוֹיְבֶיךָ אֶל־תִּשְׂמָחָה וּבִכְשָׁלָיו אֶל־יִגְּגַל לִבְךָ

“When your enemy falls, do not be glad, and when he stumbles, do not let your heart rejoice”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it

would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [When your enemy falls, do not be glad; yes, when he stumbles, do not let your heart rejoice]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 24:17 (#1)

24:17–18 is Saying 28 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:17 (#3)

בְּנִפְּלֹא אוֹיְבֶיךָ & וְאִבְקָשְׁלָלוּ

“When your enemy falls & and when he stumbles”

Here, **falls** and **stumbles** both refer to experiencing disaster. See how you translated the same use of **falls** and “stumble” in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:18 (#1)

פֶּן־יִרְאֶאֱתָה יְהוָה וְרָרַע בְּעֵינָיו וְהִשְׁשִׁיב מִעַלְלֹו אָפוֹ

“lest Yahweh see, and {it be} evil in his eyes, and he turn away his nose from upon him”

Here, **lest** indicates that what follows is what the writer does not want to happen, but it would happen if someone does not obey the instruction of verse 17. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise, Yahweh will see, and it will be evil in his eyes, and he may turn away his nose from upon him]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 24:18 (#5)

וְהִשְׁשִׁיב מִעַלְלֹו אָפוֹ

“and he turn away his nose from upon him”

Here, **nose** refers to anger, as in 15:1. It also implies the punishment that Yahweh does to those with whom he is angry. Alternate translation: [and he ceases from being angry with him] or [and he ceases punishing him]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:18 (#2)

יִרְאֶאֱתָה יְהוָה

“Yahweh see”

Here, **see** refers to perceiving something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh perceive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:18 (#4)

וְהִשְׁשִׁיב

“and he turn away”

Here, **and** introduces the result of something being **evil in his eyes**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [As a result, he will turn away]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 24:18 (#3)

וְרָרַע בְּעֵינָיו

“and {it be} evil in his eyes”

The phrase **evil in his eyes** refers to having a negative opinion about something or someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **in his eyes** in 3:4. Alternate translation: [and he will think negatively of it]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:19 (#2)

אַל־תִּתְחַמֵּר

“Do not make yourself hot”

Here, **hot** refers to an intense emotion, which causes a person’s body to become **hot**. This emotion could be: (1) worry or anxiety. Alternate translation: [Do not make yourself fret]; (2) anger, as does “heat” in 6:34. Alternate translation: [Do not make yourself angry]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:19 (#1)

24:19–20 is Saying 29 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:20 (#4)

נֵר רְשָׁעִים יִדָּעַד

“the lamp of the wicked will be extinguished”

See how you translated the same clause in 13:9.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:20 (#2)

אֲחֵרִית

“a future”

Here, the writer refers to **a future** that is good. See how you translated the same use of **future** in 23:18.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:20 (#3)

לְרָע

“for an evil {one}”

See how you translated **an evil one** in 17:11.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:20 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here indicates that what follows is a reason for the commands in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do not do these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 24:21 (#3)

וּמֶלֶךְ

“and the king”

See how you translated **the king** in 16:15.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:21 (#1)

24:21–22 is Saying 30 of the 30 “words of the wise ones.”

Proverbs 24:21 (#4)

שֹׂנוֹנִים

“ones who change”

Here, **ones who change** refers to people who **change** from respecting authorities, such as **Yahweh and the king**, to rebelling against them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [ones who rebel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:21 (#2)

בְּנִי

“My son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:22 (#4)

וּפְּרִיד שֹׁשְׁנֵיהֶם

“and & the destruction of the two of them”

the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **destruction** that is brought about by **the two of them**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how destructive the two of them can be]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:22 (#5)

שֹׁשְׁנֵיהֶם

“the two of them”

This phrase refers to “Yahweh and the king” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh and the king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:22 (#2)

יִקְרֹם

“will arise”

Here, the writer speaks of **calamity** occurring as if it were an object that arises. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will occur]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:22 (#3)

וּפְּרִיד שֹׁשְׁנֵיהֶם מִמִּי יוֹדֵעַ

“and who {is} knowing the destruction of the two of them”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize how terrible the **destruction** will be. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [and no one

knows how terrible the destruction will be from the two of them!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 24:22 (#1)

אִידָם

“their calamity”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:23 (#4)

בִּלְטוֹב

“is} not good”

See how you translated the same use of **not good** in 16:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 24:23 (#3)

בְּמִשְׁפָּט

“in judgment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when judging]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:23 (#2)

הִכִּיר-פָּנִים

“Recognizing faces”

Recognizing faces is an idiom that means “to show partiality” or “to favor” someone. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “lift the face” in 18:5. Alternate translation: [Giving pride of place to certain people] or [Being partial to certain people]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:23 (#1)

גַּם-אֵלֶּה לְחֻכְמָמִים

“These also {are} of the wise ones”

These here refers to a new collection of proverbs that continues from this verse to the last verse of this chapter. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The following proverbs are additional sayings of the wise ones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:24 (#1)

אֲמַמִּיר | לְרָשָׁעִי & יִקְבְּהוּ & יִזְמַמְוּהוּ

“One saying to a wicked {one & will curse him & will denounce him”

One who says, the wicked one, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who says to any wicked person ... will curse that person ... will denounce that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 24:24 (#2)

אֲמַמִּיר | לְרָשָׁעִי צַדִּיק אֶתָּה

“One saying to a wicked {one}, “You {are} righteous”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [One who says to a wicked one that he is righteous]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 24:24 (#5)

לְאֻמִּים

“nations”

Here, **nations** refers to the people who live in those **nations**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [entire nations of people]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:24 (#3)

לְרָשָׁעִי צַדִּיק

“to a wicked {one & are} righteous”

In this verse, **wicked** refers to being guilty of doing something **wicked** and **righteous** refers to being innocent of doing something **wicked**. See how you translated the same use of **wicked** and **righteous** in 17:15.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:24 (#4)

עַמִּים

“peoples”

See how you translated the same use of **peoples** in 14:34.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 24:25 (#3)

וְעָלֵיהֶם תָּבֹא בְרַכְת־טוֹב

“and over them will come a blessing of goodness”

Here, the writer refers to people experiencing a **blessing** as if it were a large covering that could **come over** those people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will experience a blessing of goodness]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:25 (#2)

יָדְעָם

“it will be pleasant”

Here, **it** refers to the lives of **the rebukers**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [life will be pleasant]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 24:25 (#1)

וְלַמּוֹכִיחִים

“But for the rebukers”

Here, **the rebukers** refers to judges who rightly condemn guilty people for the wicked things they have done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [But for those who convict the guilty ones]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:25 (#4)

בְּרַכְת־טוֹב

“a blessing of goodness”

Here, the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **blessing** that is characterized by **goodness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a good blessing]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:26 (#1)

שֹׁפְתֵי-יָשָׁק

“He kisses lips”

Here, kissing someone’s **lips** is a symbolic action to show true friendship and loyalty. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [He confirms his loyalty by kissing one’s lips]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 24:26 (#2)

מִי־שֹׁשִׁיב דְּבָרִים גְּדוּלִים

“who returns straightforward words”

Here the writer refers to someone speaking an honest reply to someone else as if he were returning **straightforward words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who speaks an honest reply]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:27 (#1)

הִתְכַּנֵּן בַּחוּץ | מְלֹאכְתְּךָ וְצִמְדְּךָ בַּשָּׂדֶה לְךָ

“Prepare your work in the outdoors, and make it ready for yourself in the field”

The implication in this verse is that the primary work of men is farming. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Do your job outside and prepare your fields for farming]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:27 (#2)

אַחֲרָיו וּבְנֵיָהּ

“and after, you will build”

Solomon is using a future statement to give an instruction or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command or instruction form. Alternate translation: [and only after, build]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Proverbs 24:28 (#2)

בְּשִׁפְתֶּיךָ

“with your lips”

Here, **lips** refers to what people say by using their **lips**. See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [through the things you say]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:28 (#1)

וְהִתְחַתִּיתִּי בִשְׁפָתַי

“And would you deceive with your lips”

The writer is using the question form to emphasize what a person should not do. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And you should surely not deceive with your lips!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 24:29 (#2)

עָשָׂה & לָלוּ & לְאִישׁ כְּפָעִלוֹ

“he did & to him & to the man according to his deed”

Although **he**, **him**, **the man**, and **his** are masculine, the writer is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful, you could use phrases that make this clear in your language. Alternate translation: [a person did ... to that person ... to that person according to that person's deed]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 24:29 (#3)

עָשָׂה & אֶעֱשֶׂה & כְּפָעִלוֹ

“he did & I will do & according to his deed”

The speaker implies that this **deed** was something bad or harmful to the person speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he did something bad ... I will do something bad ... according to his bad deed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:29 (#1)

אֶל־תֹּאמַרְמִר כְּאִשְׁשֹׁר עָשָׂה־לִּי כִּכְן אֶעֱשֶׂה־לָּלוּ אֲשִׁיב לְאִישׁ כְּפָעִלוֹ

“Do not say, “Just as he did to me, so I will do to him; I will return to the man according to his deed”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [Do not say that you will do to him just as he

did to you, or that you will return to the man according to his deed]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 24:30 (#2)

אָדָם חָסֵר־לֵב

“a man lacking of heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 17:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:30 (#1)

עַל־שׂדֵה אִישׁ־עֲצֵל עֲבַרְתִּי וְעַל־כְּפָרִם אָדָם חָסֵר־לֵב

“I passed over the field of a lazy man and over the vineyard of a man lacking of heart”

Verses 24:30–24:34 are one long proverb that warns against being lazy.

Proverbs 24:31 (#2)

עָלְלָה כָּלֵלוֹ | קִמְשְׁנָיִם

“all of it went up {with} thorns”

SPEAKER is using **all of it went up** as a common expression of his culture to mean “it was all overgrown.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of it was overgrown with thorns] or [thorns had grown up everywhere]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:31 (#6)

וַיִּגְדֹּר אֲבָנָיו

“and the wall of its stones”

Here the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **wall** that is made of **stones**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and the wall made of stones]

See: Possession

Proverbs 24:31 (#1)

וַהֲבִיֵּה

“And behold”

Here, **behold** is a term meant to focus the attention of the reader to what is about to happen next in the

story. See how you translated the same use of **behold** in 7:10.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 24:31 (#3)

כָּלֵלּוֹ & פָּגְנִי

“all of it & its face”

Here, **it** and **its** refer to all the land that includes both the field and vineyard mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [all of that land ... that land’s face]

See: Pronouns – When to Use Them

Proverbs 24:31 (#7)

נִהָרְסָה

“was torn down”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [had collapsed]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:31 (#5)

פָּגְנִי

“its face”

Here, **face** refers to the surface of the ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [its surface]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 24:31 (#4)

כִּסְסוּ פָּגְנִי חֲרָלָלִים

“its face was covered {with} weeds”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [weeds covered its face]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 24:32 (#5)

לִקְקַחְתִּי מוֹסֵר

“I received instruction”

The writer assumes that his readers will understand that what follows in the next two verses is the **instruction** he refers to here. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I received the following instruction] or [I learned the following lesson]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 24:32 (#2)

וְאִחְזַח אֲנִי

“And I myself looked”

Here, the writer uses the word **myself** to emphasize the significance of his observations about the lazy person’s land. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [And I looked with my own eyes]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 24:32 (#3)

אֲשַׁתִּי לִבִּי

“I set my heart”

See how you translated the same use of “set your heart” in 22:17.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 24:32 (#4)

לִקְקַחְתִּי מוֹסֵר

“I received instruction”

See how you translated the same use of **instruction** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 24:32 (#1)

וְאִחְזַח אֲנִי & רָאִיתִי

“And I myself looked & I saw”

The writer is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous two verses if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And I myself looked at that field and vineyard ... I saw them]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 24:33 (#1)

מַעֲשֵׂת שְׁשָׁנוֹת מַעֲשֵׂת תְּנוּמָמוֹת מַעֲשֵׂת | חֲבֵק יָדַיִם לְשֹׁכֵב

“A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to lie down”

See how you translated the same clauses in 6:10.

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 24:34 (#1)

וְכִּי-מִתְהַלֵּל רִישׁוֹ וְיִמְחֹס רִגְלֵי כְּאִישׁ מְגֹן

“and your poverty will come {like} one who walks around, and your needs like a man of shield”

See how you translated the almost identical clauses in 6:11.

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs - Chapter 25 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah's proverbs from Solomon (25:1-29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1-27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1-29:27)

Chapter 25 begins the section of the book containing proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of Hezekiah. This section contains two parts, the first part in 25:1-27:27 mostly contains proverbs that warn or admonish.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 25-27 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 25 also contains one instance of contrasting parallelism (25:2). (See: Parallelism)

Metaphors

Solomon uses many different metaphors in this chapter to warn his readers against acting unwisely. (See: Metaphor)

Proverbs 25:1 (#2)

מִשְׁלֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“are} proverbs of Solomon”

See how you translated **proverbs of Solomon** in 1:1.

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:1 (#4)

הִנֵּה עֲתִידִיקוֹ

“copied”

Here, **copied** implies that **the men of Hezekiah copied** these **proverbs** from a scroll that was written by **Solomon** or one of his scribes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [copied from a scroll written by Solomon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:1 (#1)

גַּם-אֵלֶּה מִשְׁלֵי שְׁלֹמֹה

“These also {are} proverbs of Solomon”

These here refers to a new collection of proverbs that continues from this verse to the last verse of chapter 29. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The following proverbs are additional sayings of Solomon]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:1 (#3)

אֲנָשִׁי חִזְקִיָּה

“the men of Hezekiah”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **the men** who served **Hezekiah**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the men who served Hezekiah]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:2 (#4)

תִּקְוֶה דָּבָר

“is} to search out a matter”

Here Solomon speaks of **kings** explaining **a matter** that is mysterious or difficult to understand as if they **search** for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is to explain a mysterious matter]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:2 (#1)

כְּבוֹד & וְכְבוֹד

“The glory of & but the glory of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [What is glorious about ... but what is glorious about]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:2 (#3)

דְּבַר & דְּבַר

“a matter & a matter”

The word **matter** represents matters in general, not one particular **matter**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any matter ... that matter]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:2 (#2)

הַסְתִּיר דְּבַר

“is} to hide a matter”

Here Solomon speaks of God making **a matter** that is mysterious or difficult to understand as if he were hiding it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is to make a matter mysterious]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:3 (#4)

וְלֵב מִמְּלָכִים אֵין חָקֵר

“and the heart of kings is not searchable”

The word **heart** represents the hearts of kings in general, not one particular king's **heart**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [and the hearts of kings are not searchable]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:3 (#1)

שָׁמַיִם לְרוֹם וָאָרֶץ לְעֵמֶק

“Heavens for height and earth for depth”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Heavens are an example of height and earth is an example of depth]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:3 (#5)

וְלֵב

“and the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of “hearts” in 15:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:3 (#2)

לְרוֹם & לְעֵמֶק

“for height & for depth”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **height** and **depth**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [for what is high ... for what is deep]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:3 (#3)

וְלֵב מִמְּלָכִים

“and the heart of kings”

Here, **and** introduces a comparison between what follows and what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **the heart of kings** cannot be fully known, just like the extent of the **Heavens** and **earth** cannot be fully known. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way the heart of kings]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:3 (#6)

אֵין חָקֵר

“is not searchable”

Here Solomon speaks of it being difficult to understand **the heart of kings** as if it were something that could not be searched for. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is difficult to comprehend]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:4 (#1)

סִיגִים

“dross”

The word **dross** refers to material in metal that people do not want, so **the refiner** removes the impurities by melting the metal and taking the **dross** out of the melted metal. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of process, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the unwanted material]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 25:4 (#2)

וַיֵּצֵא וְכֵל

“and a vessel comes out”

The word translated **and** at the beginning of this clause indicates that the event in the previous clause happens before the event in the second clause can happen. Use a natural form in your language to introduce the next event in a story. Alternate translation: [before a vessel comes out] or [so then a vessel can come out]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Proverbs 25:4 (#4)

לְצִרְרֵר

“for the refiner”

Here, **the refiner** refers to someone who removes unwanted material from metal by melting the metal and taking the **dross** out of the melted metal. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of person, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the person who removes unwanted material from metal]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 25:4 (#3)

וַיֵּצֵא לְצִרְרֵר כֵּל

“and a vessel comes out for the refiner”

Here Solomon refers to **the refiner** making **a vessel** from the **silver** mentioned in the previous clause as if that **vessel comes out** from the **silver**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a vessel is made by the refiner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:5 (#1)

הִגֵּד

“Remove”

In this verse, Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous verse. In the same way that “dross” must be removed from silver in order to make a vessel, **a wicked one** must be removed from **before the face of the king** in order for that king’s **throne to be established by righteousness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could

state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Similarly, remove] or [So also remove]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:5 (#2)

רָשָׁע וְמֶלֶךְ & כִּסֵּא

“a wicked one & the king & his throne”

Here, **a wicked one**, **the king**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not to specific people. See how you translated the same use of **a wicked one** in 9:7 and **the king** and **his** in 16:13.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:5 (#4)

וַיִּכְּסֶה בְּצִדִּיק כִּסֵּאוֹ

“and his throne will be established by righteousness”

See how you translated the similar phrase “by righteousness is a throne established” in 16:12.

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 25:5 (#3)

לְפָנַי

“to the face of”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 14:19.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:6 (#2)

לְפָנַי־מֶלֶךְ

“to the face of the king”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:6 (#1)

אַל־תְּהַדְדֵר לְפָנַי־מֶלֶךְ וּבִמְקוֹם גְּדֹלִים אַל־תַּעֲמֵד

“Do not honor yourself to the face of the king, and in the place of the great ones do not stand”

The two clauses in this verse say similar things, but the phrases in the second clause are in reverse order. This is a literary device called a chiasm. Here, the writer does this in order to emphasize the importance of not honoring yourself in front of kings. See the discussion of chiasms in the book introduction.

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 25:6 (#3)

וּבְמִקְוֵהוֹם גָּדוֹלֵלִים אַל-תַּעֲמֹד

“and in the place of the great ones do not stand”

This could refer to: (1) considering oneself to be a **great** person who belongs to a group of **great ones**. Alternate translation: [and do not consider yourself to be one of the great ones] or [and do not consider yourself to be a great one]; (2) standing among a group of **great ones**. Alternate translation: [and among the great ones do not stand]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:7 (#8)

עֵינֶיךָ

“your eyes”

Here, **eyes** represents the ability of a person to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly, as in the UST. See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 23:26.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:7 (#6)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:7 (#5)

מִמֶּה שֶׁפָּרִילְךָ

“than to humiliate you”

Solomon implies that this humiliation is due to someone telling the person to move farther away from the king in order for more important people to be near him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [than to humiliate you by telling you to take a lower place]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:7 (#4)

מִמֶּה שֶׁפָּרִילְךָ

“than to humiliate you”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [than for a person to humiliate you]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:7 (#2)

לְךָ עֲלֵה הַהֶנָּה

“to you, “Come up here”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [to you that you should come up there]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 25:7 (#7)

אֲשֶׁשָׁר רָאָהוּ עֵינֶיךָ

“whom your eyes have seen”

This clause could refer to: (1) the **noble** mentioned in the previous clause. Alternate translation: [whom your eyes have observed]; (2) what someone sees that causes them to begin the dispute mentioned in the next verse, in which case **whom** would be translated as “what,” and this clause would start a new sentence that continues into the next verse. Alternate translation: [What your eyes have witnessed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:7 (#3)

עֲלֵה הַהֶנָּה

“Come up here”

Come up here means to move to a place near the king, which is a great honor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Come up here, near the king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:7 (#1)

טוֹב אֶמְרֶיךָ

“better to say to you”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [it is better for a person to say to you] or [it is better for the king to say to you]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:8 (#2)

מה־תַּתְּעֶשֶׂה בְּאַחֲרֵיתָהּ בְּהַכְלִים אֶת־דָּרֶךְ רֵעֶךָ

“what will you do in its end when your neighbor humiliates you”

Solomon is using the question form to make the reader consider what would happen if they lose the **dispute**. The way in which the neighbor might put the reader to shame can be stated plainly. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [you will not know what to do in its end when your neighbor humiliates you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 25:8 (#3)

בְּהַכְלִים אֶת־דָּרֶךְ רֵעֶךָ

“when your neighbor humiliates you”

Solomon implies that **your neighbor humiliates you** because **you** lose the legal dispute. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [when you lose and your neighbor humiliates you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:8 (#1)

לִרְיָב

“to dispute”

Here, **dispute** refers to arguing a legal case against someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to argue a legal case against your neighbor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:9 (#1)

הִרִיבֵךְ רֵיבִיב

“Dispute your dispute”

Here, **Dispute your dispute** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that both come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis.

See: Poetry

Proverbs 25:9 (#4)

וְסֵקֶר אֶת־חֵטְרְ אֲלֵי־תִגְל

“and the secret of another do not uncover”

Here, **another** could refer to: (1) **your neighbor**. Alternate translation: [and the secret of that neighbor]; (2) someone other than **your neighbor**, which would indicate telling someone else’s **secret** to win the **dispute** against one’s **neighbor**. Alternate translation: [and the secret of another person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:9 (#2)

הִרִיבֵךְ רֵיבִיב

“Dispute your dispute”

Dispute is an imperative, but it introduces a conditional situation. Use a form in your language that communicates this, such as in the UST.

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 25:9 (#3)

וְסֵקֶר אֶת־חֵטְרְ אֲלֵי־תִגְל

“and the secret of another do not uncover”

See how you translated the similar phrase “uncovering a secret” in 11:13.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:10 (#4)

לֹא תָשׁוּב

“not turn back”

Here Solomon speaks of a **rumor**, meaning the news that a secret has been betrayed, as if it were a person who continues to travel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [spreads continually]

See: Personification

Proverbs 25:10 (#5)

לֹא תָשׁוּב

“not turn back”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the posi-

tive meaning. Alternate translation: [will keep going] or [will continue to spread]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 25:10 (#3)

וְדִבְהֶדָּר

“and the rumor {of} you”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rumor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and what is rumored about you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:10 (#2)

שִׁמְעָה

“one who hears”

Here, **one who hears** represents a type of person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [anyone hears]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:10 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Here, **lest** indicates that what follows would be an undesirable outcome of doing what Solomon prohibited in the previous verse. See how you translated the same use of **lest** in 24:18.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 25:11 (#6)

דִּבְרָה

“spoken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone speaks]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 25:11 (#7)

עַל־אִפְנֵי

“according to its circumstance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **circumstance**, you could express the same

idea in another way. Alternate translation: [appropriately]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:11 (#4)

בְּמַשְׁכִּיּוֹת כֶּסֶף

“in sculptures of silver”

Here, the word translated as **sculptures** refers to **silver** that someone carved into a beautiful shape. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in beautiful carvings of silver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:11 (#5)

דִּבְרָה

“is} a word”

Here, **word** refers to what someone speaks by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is something] or [are words]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:11 (#1)

תְּפֹאֲחֵי זָהָב בְּמַשְׁכִּיּוֹת כֶּסֶף דִּבְרָה דִּבְרָה עַל־אִפְנֵי

“Apples of gold in sculptures of silver {is} a word spoken according to its circumstance”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A word spoken according to its circumstance is apples of gold in sculptures of silver]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:11 (#3)

תְּפֹאֲחֵי זָהָב בְּמַשְׁכִּיּוֹת כֶּסֶף

“Apples of gold in sculptures of silver”

Here Solomon is using possessive forms to describe **Apples** made from **gold** and **sculptures** made from **silver**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use different expressions. Alternate translation: [Apples made of gold in sculptures made of silver]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:11 (#2)

תְּפֹאֲחֵי זָהָב בְּמַשְׁכִּיּוֹת כֶּסֶף

“Apples of gold in sculptures of silver”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a word spoken according to its circumstance** pleasing those who hear it as if it were **Apples of gold in sculptures of silver**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very pleasing] or [Like apples of gold in sculptures of silver]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:12 (#5)

אֵאָזֶן שֹׁמֵעַת

“a listening ear”

Here, **a listening ear** refers to someone who not only hears the rebuke, but accepts it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **ear** in 18:15. Alternate translation: [someone who accepts it]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:12 (#3)

נָנִים זָהָב וְחֵלִי-כֶּכֶתָם

“A ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold”

Here Solomon is using possessive forms to describe a **ring** made from **gold** and **jewelry** made from **fine gold**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use different expressions. Alternate translation: [A ring made of gold and jewelry made of fine gold]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:12 (#4)

מוֹכִיחַת הָחֶכֶם עַל

“{is} a wise rebuke to”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rebuke**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [is when someone wisely corrects]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:12 (#2)

נָנִים זָהָב וְחֵלִי-כֶּכֶתָם

“A ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a wise rebuke** being valuable to those who hear it as if it were **A ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold**. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very valuable] or [Like a ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:12 (#1)

נָנִים זָהָב וְחֵלִי-כֶּכֶתָם מוֹכִיחַת הָחֶכֶם עַל-אֵאָזֶן שֹׁמֵעַת

“A ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold {is} a wise rebuke to a listening ear”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A wise rebuke to a listening ear is a ring of gold and jewelry of fine gold]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:13 (#2)

בַּיּוֹם קָצִיר

“in the day of harvest”

Here, **day** refers to a period of time when something happens. It does not refer to a single 24-hour length of time. This probably refers to the time of the wheat and barley harvest in May-June, when the weather is hot and snow very unlikely, which is why it would be welcome and refreshing. See how you translated the same use of **day** in 21:31.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:13 (#4)

וַיָּבֹא אֲדֹנָיו יָשׁוּב

“and he brings back the life of his masters”

The phrase **brings back the life** is an idiom that refers to causing a tired person to feel refreshed or strong again. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he causes his masters to feel refreshed]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 25:13 (#1)

בַּצֶּנֶת-שֶׁשֶׁלֶג | בַּיּוֹם קָצִיר

“Like the coolness of snow in the day of harvest”

Here Solomon compares **a faithful envoy** to **the coolness of snow on the day of harvest** because both are refreshing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly: Alternate transla-

tion: [Very refreshing] or [Refreshing like the coolness of snow in the day of harvest]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:13 (#3)

צִיר נֶאֱמָן לְשִׁלְחָיו וְנִפְשׁ אֲדֹנָיו יֵשִׁיב

“is} a faithful envoy for his senders, and he brings back the life of his masters”

Here, **a faithful envoy**, **his**, and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is any faithful envoy for that person’s senders, and that brings back the life of that person’s masters]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:14 (#2)

נְשִׂאִים וְרוּחַ וְגֶשֶׁם אֵין

“Clouds and wind but without rain”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **the man who boasts in a gift of falsehood** being disappointing as if he were **Clouds and wind but without rain**. Clouds and wind usually indicate that there will also be rain, so **Clouds and wind without rain** would disappoint farmers who need rain for their crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very disappointing] or [Like clouds and wind but no rain]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:14 (#4)

בְּמַתַּת־שֶׁקֶר

“in a gift of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **gift** that is characterized by **falsehood**. This refers to a **gift** the someone promises to give but does not give. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [in a false gift] or [in a gift that he falsely promises to give]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:14 (#3)

אָיִשׁ

“is} the man”

The word **man** represents people in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use

a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [is any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:14 (#1)

נְשִׂאִים וְרוּחַ וְגֶשֶׁם אֵין אִישׁ מִמֶּתֶלֶל בְּמַתַּת־שֶׁקֶר

“Clouds and wind but without rain {is} the man who boasts in a gift of falsehood”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [The man who boasts in a gift of falsehood is clouds and wind but without rain]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:15 (#1)

בְּאֵרֶךְ אָפִים

“By length of nostrils”

The phrase **length of nostrils** refers to being patient and not getting angry quickly. The word **nostrils** means “anger” by association with the way that a person who is angry breathes heavily through his nose, causing his **nostrils** to open wide. Your language and culture may also associate anger with a particular part of the body. If so, you could use an expression involving that part of the body in your translation. You could also use plain language. See how you translated the similar phrase “long of nostrils” in 14:29. Alternate translation: [By keeping a cool head] or [By not getting angry quickly]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 25:15 (#5)

תִּשְׁבֹּר־עֹצֶם

“can break a bone”

Here Solomon speaks of overcoming strong opposition as if someone were breaking **a bone**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [can overcome strong opposition]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:15 (#4)

וְלִשְׁוֹן רַרְכָּה

“and a soft tongue”

Here Solomon is speaking of something spoken in a gentle manner as if someone were speaking with a **soft tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and speaking gently]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:15 (#2)

יִפְתָּתָהּ קֶצֶץ

“a commander may be persuaded”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone may persuade a commander]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 25:15 (#3)

קֶצֶץ וְלִשְׁוֹן רִכְכָּה תִשְׁבֵּר-גֵּרָם

“a commander & and a soft tongue can break a bone”

Here, **a commander**, **a soft tongue**, and **a bone** refer to these people and things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any commander ... and any soft tongue can break bones]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:16 (#3)

כִּן-תִּתֵּשְׁבַע עָנִי וְהִקְאִתּוּ

“lest you become satiated with it and you vomit it up”

Solomon is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise you will become satiated with it and vomit it up]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 25:16 (#1)

דְּבַבְשׁ מִמַּצְאֵת

“if you find honey”

Here Solomon refers to someone unexpectedly discovering **wild honey**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [If you happen to come across honey]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:16 (#4)

תִּתֵּשְׁבַע עָנִי

“you become satiated with it”

Here, the word translated as **satiated** refers to someone overeating to the degree that he becomes sick. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [you eat yourself sick with it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:16 (#2)

אֲכַל דִּמְיָה

“eat enough {for} you”

Here Solomon implies that someone should only **eat enough** and not more than that. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [only eat enough for you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:17 (#5)

יִשְׁבַּעְדָּךְ

“he become satiated with you”

Here, Solomon is comparing the visitor to a food of which the neighbor has eaten too much. This expression refers to people being annoyed with someone because that person visits them too frequently. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. If your language has a word that can be used for both this occurrence of **satiated** and the occurrence in the previous verse, consider using it here. Alternate translation: [he become sick of you] or [he become tired of seeing you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:17 (#4)

מִבֵּית רֵעֶךָ כִּן-יִשְׁבַּעְדָּךְ

“from the house of your neighbor, lest he become satiated with you”

Here, **your neighbor** and **he** refer to neighbors in general, not a specific **neighbor**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [from any house of any of your neighbors, lest that neighbor become satiated with you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:17 (#2)

הַקָּקֵר רַגְלֶךָ מִבֵּית רֵעֶךָ

“Make rare your foot from the house of your neighbor”

Alternate translation: [Prevent your foot from frequently being in the house of your neighbor]

Proverbs 25:17 (#1)

הַקָּקֵר

“Make rare”

In this verse, Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous verse. In the same way that a person must not eat too much honey, a person must also avoid visiting his neighbor's house too frequently. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Similarly, make rare] or [So also make rare]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:17 (#3)

רַגְלֶךָ

“your foot”

Here, **foot** represents the whole person. See how you translated the similar use of **foot** in 1:15.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 25:18 (#2)

מַפְּיִז נֹחֵרֵב וְחֹמֶץ שֶׁנִּגּוֹן

“A hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a man who answers a testimony of falsehood against his neighbor** being deadly as if he were **A hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very deadly] or [Like a hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:18 (#3)

אִישׁ עֲנִיָּה בִּכְרִיעָהּ

“is} a man who answers & against his neighbor”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this

clear. Alternate translation: [is a person who answers ... against that person's neighbor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 25:18 (#4)

עֲנִיָּה בִּכְרִיעָהּ עֵד שֶׁקֶר

“who answers a testimony of falsehood against his neighbor”

In the original language, the words translated as **answers** and **against** mean “testifies against.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who testifies against his neighbor with a testimony of falsehood]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:18 (#1)

מַפְּיִז נֹחֵרֵב וְחֹמֶץ שֶׁנִּגּוֹן אִישׁ עֲנִיָּה בִּכְרִיעָהּ עֵד שֶׁקֶר

“A hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow {is} a man who answers a testimony of falsehood against his neighbor”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A man who answers a testimony of falsehood against his neighbor is a hammer and a sword and a sharp arrow]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:18 (#5)

עֵד שֶׁקֶר

“a testimony of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **testimony** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a false testimony]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:19 (#3)

מִבְטָחָהּ

“is} confidence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **confidence** in 3:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:19 (#4)

בְּבוֹגָדָהּ

“in} one who acts treacherously”

See how you translated **one who acts treacherously** in 21:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:19 (#5)

בְּיוֹם צָרָה

“in the day of distress”

See how you translated this phrase in 24:10.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:19 (#2)

שֵׁשֶׁן רֶצֶה וְרִגְלָה מוֹעֲצָה

“A broken tooth and a shaky foot”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of the uselessness of having **confidence** in a treacherous person as if that **confidence** were **A broken tooth and a shaky foot**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very useless] or [Like a broken tooth and a shaky foot]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:19 (#1)

שֵׁשֶׁן רֶצֶה וְרִגְלָה מוֹעֲצָה מִבִּטְטָה בְּיוֹם צָרָה

“A broken tooth and a shaky foot {is} confidence {in} one who acts treacherously in the day of distress”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Confidence in one who acts treacherously in the day of distress is a broken tooth and a shaky foot]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:20 (#4)

חֹמֶץ עַל-נֶגְתָּר

“vinegar on natron”

The substance **natron** is a naturally-occurring mineral salt that is mostly sodium carbonate. In the ancient world, it was used for cleaning and some other things. When mixed with **vinegar**, it causes a violent chemical reaction. Therefore, this clause refers to two things that should not be put together. If your readers would not be familiar with these two materials, you could use the names of similar things in your area, or you

could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [chemicals that react violently when put together]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 25:20 (#8)

לִב-רָע

“a heart of misery”

Here, **heart** represents where a person's thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [a miserable person]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:20 (#1)

מִמְעָדָה בְּבֹגֶד | בְּיוֹם קֶזֶרָה חֹמֶץ עַל-נֶגְתָּר וְשֵׁשֶׁן בְּבִשְׂרִים עֵל

“One removing a garment on a cold day, vinegar on natron, so {is} a singer with songs to a heart of misery”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who sings with songs to a heart of misery is like one who removes a garment on a cold day, vinegar on natron]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:20 (#3)

מִמְעָדָה בְּבֹגֶד

“One removing a garment”

Here Solomon implies that **a garment** is removed from someone's body. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who removes a garment from someone's body]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:20 (#7)

לִב-רָע

“a heart of misery”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **heart** that is characterized by **misery**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a miserable heart]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:20 (#6)

וְשֹׁשֶׁר בְּבִשְׂרָיִם

“so {is} a singer with songs”

Here, **sings with songs** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis.

See: Poetry

Proverbs 25:20 (#5)

וְשֹׁשֶׁר בְּבִשְׂרָיִם עֹלֵל לִב־רָע

“so {is} a singer with songs to a heart of misery”

Solomon is saying that **one who sings with songs to a heart of misery** is like **One who removes a garment on a cold day** and like **vinegar on natron**, because all of these are inappropriate and unhelpful when put together. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [so also is one who sings with songs to a heart of misery inappropriate]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:20 (#2)

מִמַּעֲדָה בְּבִגְדָא וְשֹׁשֶׁר & לִב־רָע

“One removing a garment & so {is} a singer & a heart of misery”

One who removes a garment, **one who sings**, and **a heart of misery** refer to types of people and hearts in general, not specific people or a specific **heart**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who removes a garment ... so is any person who sings ... any heart of misery]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:21 (#1)

שֹׂשֶׁן אֶדָּה הָאֵכְלָהּוּ & הִשְׁקָהוּ מֵיִם

“one who hates you & cause him to eat & cause him to drink water”

Here, **one who hates you** and **him** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who hates you ... cause that person to eat ... cause that person to drink water]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:21 (#2)

לֶחֶם

“bread”

Here, **bread** is used to refer to food in general. See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 25:22 (#1)

גָּחַל לֵאמֹר אֶתְּהָהּ חֲתָתָהּ עַל־רֹאשׁוֹ

“you are heaping embers on his head”

Here, Solomon is speaking of causing an enemy to feel the pain of shame and embarrassment as if he were causing the physical pain of **heaping embers on his head**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [you are causing him to feel ashamed for what he has done] or [you are making him feel ashamed, as if you were heaping embers on his head]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:22 (#2)

יִשְׁלֹם־לְךָ

“will repay to you”

See how you translated the same use of **repay** in 19:17.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:23 (#1)

רִיחַ צָפוֹן

“The wind of the north”

Here, **wind of the north** refers to cold **wind** that came from **the north**. In Israel, this type of **wind** often brought rain. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The cold wind that comes from the north]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:23 (#4)

וּפְגָנִים בְּנְזָעֵמִים

“and indignant faces”

Here, **faces** refers to the people whose faces show that they are **indignant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and indignant people]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 25:23 (#3)

וּפְנֵי־מַיִם בְּזָעֲמַיִם

“and indignant faces”

In this verse, Solomon compares **The wind of the north** bringing **rain** to **a tongue of secrecy** bringing **indignant faces**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly: Alternate translation: [and similarly, indignant faces]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:23 (#2)

וּפְנֵי־מַיִם לְשׁוֹן סֵתֶר

“and indignant faces, a tongue of secrecy”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. Here, the first phrase is the result of the second phrase. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a tongue of secrecy brings forth indignant faces] or [and a tongue of secrecy causes indignant faces]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:23 (#5)

לְשׁוֹן סֵתֶר

“a tongue of secrecy”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **a tongue** that tells the secrets of others. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a tongue that tells the secrets of others]

See: Possession

Proverbs 25:23 (#6)

לְשׁוֹן סֵתֶר

“a tongue of secrecy”

Here, **tongue** refers to the person who speaks with his tongue. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a person who tells secrets]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 25:24 (#1)

טוֹב שְׁשֻׁבָּת עַל־פִּנְת־גִּגַּי מֵאֲשֶׁת מְדוּנִים וּבְרִית חָרָה

“Better to dwell on the corner of a roof than {with} a wife of quarrels and a house of companionship”

See how you translated the same sentence in 21:9.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:25 (#2)

נִפְשׁ עֵיפָפָה

“a weary soul”

Here Solomon implies that this **soul** is **weary** with thirst. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [a soul weary from thirst]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:25 (#4)

וְשִׂמּוּעָה טוֹבָבָה מֵאֲרִיז מְרַחֵק

“so {is} good news from a distant land”

Solomon is saying that **good news from a distant land** is like **Cool water over a weary soul** because both of these are refreshing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [so also is good news from a distant land refreshing]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:25 (#3)

נִפְשׁ

“a & soul”

See how you translated the same use of **soul** in 2:10.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 25:25 (#1)

מִמֵּי קְדָרִים עַל־נִפְשׁ עֵיפָפָה וְשִׂמּוּעָה טוֹבָבָה מֵאֲרִיז מְרַחֵק

“Cool water over a weary soul, so {is} good news from a distant land”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Good news from a distant land is like cool water over a weary soul]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:25 (#5)

וְשִׂמּוּעָה טוֹבָבָה

“so {is} good news”

See how you translated **good news** in 15:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 25:26 (#5)

מָמַט

“swaying”

Here, **swaying** refers to **a righteous one** yielding to the influence of **a wicked one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who yields] or [who gives in]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:26 (#2)

מַעֲיִן נִנְרָפֶשׁ וּמִקְקוֹר מְשֻׁחָת

“A spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a righteous one swaying before the face of a wicked one** being bad as if that person were **A spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very bad] or [Like a spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:26 (#1)

מַעֲיִן נִנְרָפֶשׁ וּמִקְקוֹר מְשֻׁחָת צִצְדִּיק מָמַט לְפָנֵי רָשָׁע

“A spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled {is} a righteous {one} swaying to the face of a wicked {one}”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A righteous one swaying before the face of a wicked one is a spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 25:26 (#4)

צִצְדִּיק & רָשָׁע

“is} a righteous {one & a wicked {one}”

See how you translated **a righteous one** in 9:9 and **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 25:26 (#6)

לְפָנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated the same use of **to the face of** in 14:19.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:26 (#3)

מַעֲיִן נִנְרָפֶשׁ וּמִקְקוֹר מְשֻׁחָת

“A spring muddied by trampling and a fountain spoiled”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [A spring someone muddied by trampling and a fountain someone spoiled]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 25:27 (#3)

וְחִטְקֹר

“also the searching out {of}”

In this verse, Solomon compares eating **much honey** to **searching out** one's own **honor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly: Alternate translation: [and similarly, the searching out of]

See: Simile

Proverbs 25:27 (#1)

לֹא-טוֹב

“is} not good”

See how you translated the same use of **not good** in 16:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 25:27 (#4)

וְחִטְקֹר כְּבֹדָם

“also the searching out {of} their honor”

Here Solomon speaks of someone trying to get other people to **honor** him as if **honor** were an object that a person could search for. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and trying to make other people honor you]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:27 (#2)

וְחִסְקָר בְּבִדְדָם כְּבוֹד

“also the searching out {of} their honor, honor”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the searching out of their honor is not honor]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 25:28 (#2)

עֵינֵי פְּרוּצָה אֵין חֻמָּה

“A breached city without a wall”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a man who has no restraint for his spirit** being defenseless or unprotected as if that person were **A breached city without a wall**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very defenseless] or [Like a breached city without a wall]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:28 (#3)

עֵינֵי פְּרוּצָה אֵין חֻמָּה

“A breached city without a wall”

Here Solomon implies that there is no **wall** because it was broken down when people **breached** the **city**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [A city whose walls an army has knocked down]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 25:28 (#5)

אִשׁוּר אֵין מַעְצָר לְרוּחוֹ

“who has no restraint for his spirit”

Here Solomon refers to someone who lacks self-control as if that person were not able to restrain **his spirit**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who has no self-control]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 25:28 (#4)

אִישׁ & לְרוּחוֹ

“is} a man & for his spirit”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear in your language. Alternate translation: [is a person ... for that person's spirit]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 25:28 (#1)

עֵינֵי פְּרוּצָה אֵין חֻמָּה אִישׁ אִשׁוּר אֵין מַעְצָר לְרוּחוֹ

“A breached city without a wall {is} a man who has no restraint for his spirit”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A man who has no restraint for his spirit is a breached city without a wall]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs - Chapter 26 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah's proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1–27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1–29:27)

Chapter 26 continues the section of the book containing proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of Hezekiah. This section contains two parts, the first part in 25:1–27:27 mostly contains proverbs that warn or admonish.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 25–27 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 26 contains only this type of parallelism. (See: Parallelism)

Similes

Solomon uses many different similes in this chapter to warn his readers against acting unwisely. (See: Simile)

Proverbs 26:1 (#1)

כַּשֵּׁלֶג בַּקֵּיץ וְכַמָּטֶר בַּקִּיץ כֵּן לֹא-נִאֲנֶה לְכַסִּיל כְּבוֹד

“Like the snow in the summer and like the rain in the harvest, so honor {is} not suitable for a stupid one”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate transla-

tion: [Honor is not suitable for a stupid one like the snow in the summer and like the rain in the harvest]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:1 (#3)

כְּשֶׁשֶׁלֶג אֶבְקָרִיז וְכַמְטָר בְּקַצֵּיר

“Like the snow in the summer and like the rain in the harvest”

The words **Like** and **so** in this verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **snow in the summer** and **rain in the harvest** with **honor for a stupid one**. The point is that all three of these are **not suitable** or inappropriate. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [Just as the snow in the summer or the rain in the harvest are not suitable]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:1 (#2)

כְּשֶׁשֶׁלֶג אֶבְקָרִיז וְכַמְטָר בְּקַצֵּיר & לְכִסְסִיל

“Like the snow in the summer and like the rain in the harvest & for a stupid one”

Here, **the snow, the summer, the rain, the harvest**, and **a stupid one**, refer to these things and that type of person in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [Like any snow in any summer and like any rain in any harvest ... for any stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:1 (#4)

כְּבוֹד

“honor”

See how you translated the abstract noun **honor** in 3:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:2 (#6)

לֹא תָבֹא

“does not come”

Here Solomon speaks of a person not being affected by **a curse** as if that **curse** were a person who **does not come**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does not occur]

See: Personification

Proverbs 26:2 (#5)

כְּדֶרְדֹר

“like the swallow”

A **swallow** is a small bird that quickly flies back and forth. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [as the quickly moving small bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:2 (#4)

כְּצַפְפֹּר לְלִנּוּד כְּדֶרְדֹר לְעֵיּוֹף

“Like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying”

The phrases **the bird for fluttering** and **the swallow for flying** mean similar things. Solomon is using the two phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [As birds that are flying around]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 26:2 (#2)

כְּצַפְפֹּר לְלִנּוּד כְּדֶרְדֹר לְעֵיּוֹף כִּנְזֵן קִלְקִלִת

“Like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying, so a curse”

Here, **the bird, the swallow**, and **a curse** refer to these things in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Like any bird for fluttering, and like any swallow for flying, so any curse]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:2 (#3)

כְּצַפְפֹּר לְלִנּוּד כְּדֶרְדֹר לְעֵיּוֹף

“Like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying”

The words **Like** and **so** in this verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **the bird for fluttering** and **the swallow for flying** with **a curse without cause**. The point is that **a curse** does not affect a person who does not deserve it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate

translation: [Just like the fluttering bird and the flying swallow do not land]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:2 (#1)

כַּצִּפּוֹר לְלִנּוּד כְּדֶרְדֹר לְעֵפוֹף כִּכֵּן קִלְלַת הַחֲנָנִים לֹא תָבֹא

“Like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying, so a curse without cause does not come”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A curse without cause does not come, like the bird for fluttering, like the swallow for flying]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:3 (#2)

שִׁשׁוּט לְלִסּוּס מִמֶּתֶּג לְחֻמָּמוֹר וְלִשְׁשֶׁבֶט לִגְגּוֹ כְּסִילִים

“A whip for the horse, a bridle for the donkey, and a rod for the back of stupid ones”

A whip, the horse, a bridle, the donkey, a rod, and the back refer to these things and animals in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Whips are for horses, bridles are for donkeys, and rods are for backs of stupid ones]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:3 (#1)

שִׁשׁוּט לְלִסּוּס מִמֶּתֶּג לְחֻמָּמוֹר וְלִשְׁשֶׁבֶט לִגְגּוֹ כְּסִילִים

“A whip for the horse, a bridle for the donkey, and a rod for the back of stupid ones”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A whip is for the horse, a bridle is for the donkey, and a rod is for the back of stupid ones]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 26:3 (#4)

וְלִשְׁשֶׁבֶט לִגְגּוֹ

“and a rod for the back of”

See how you translated the same use of **rod for the back** in 10:13.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:3 (#3)

וְלִשְׁשֶׁבֶט

“and a rod”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that people must hit **stupid ones** with a **rod** in order to control them, just like they must use a **whip** to control horses and a **bridle** to control donkeys. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way a rod]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:4 (#4)

פֶּן־תִּשְׁוֶה־לְלוֹ גַם־אַתָּה

“lest you yourself also become like him”

Solomon is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the instruction to **not answer a stupid one** so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise you might become like him]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 26:4 (#3)

כְּאֻלְתָּתּוֹ

“according to his folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:4 (#1)

כְּכִסִּיל כְּאֻלְתָּתּוֹ & לְלוֹ

“a stupid one according to his folly & him”

Here, **a stupid one**, **his**, and **him** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [any stupid person according to that person's folly ... that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:4 (#5)

תִּשְׁוֶה & גַם־אַתָּה

“you yourself also become like”

Solomon uses the word **yourself** to emphasize how important it is to not **become like a stupid one**. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [even you become like]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 26:4 (#2)

בְּאוֹלְתָּו

“according to his folly”

This could mean: (1) **according to** the reasoning of **a stupid one**. Alternate translation: [according to his foolish reasoning]; (2) in the same manner as **a stupid one**. Alternate translation: [in a foolish manner]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:4–5 (#1)

אַל־תַּתֵּעַן בְּכִסִּיל בְּאוֹלְתָּו & עֲנֵה כְּכִסִּיל בְּאוֹלְתָּו

“Do not answer a stupid one according to his folly & Answer a stupid one according to his folly”

These two proverbs appear to contradict each other. It may be that we are to understand the command in 24:4 to apply in some situations and the command in 24:5 to apply in other situations. Or it may be that we are to understand **according to his folly** in different senses in the two verses, such as “Do not answer a stupid one with more of the same foolishness” in verse 4, and “Answer a stupid one who is saying foolish things” in verse 5. But it appears that Solomon intended his readers to read the same words and to ponder how both could be true.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:5 (#3)

פֶּן־יִהְיֶה חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“lest he become wise in his eyes”

Solomon is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the instruction to **Answer a stupid one** so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise he might become wise in his eyes]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 26:5 (#2)

כְּכִסִּיל בְּאוֹלְתָּו

“a stupid one according to his folly”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:5 (#4)

חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“wise in his eyes”

See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:7.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:5 (#1)

כְּכִסִּיל בְּאוֹלְתָּו פֶּן־יִהְיֶה חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“a stupid one according to his folly, lest he become wise in his eyes”

Here, **a stupid one**, **his**, and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [any stupid person according to that person’s folly, lest that person become wise in that person’s own eyes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:6 (#1)

מִקְצָצָה רַגְלִים חֲמָס שִׁתְּתָה שְׁלַח דְּבָרִים בְּיַד־כִּסִּיל

“One cutting off feet, one drinking violence, [is] one sending words by the hand of a stupid one”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who sends words by the hand of a stupid one is one who cuts off feet, one who drinks violence]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:6 (#7)

בְּיַד־כִּסִּיל

“by the hand of a stupid one”

Here, **hand** represents the control that a person has. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the care of a stupid one]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 26:6 (#5)

חֲמָס

“violence”

See how you translated the abstract noun **violence** in 3:31.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:6 (#2)

מִקְצָצָה רַגְלִים חֲמָס שִׁתְּתָה שְׁלַח דְּבָרִים בְּיַד־כְּסִיל

“One cutting off feet, one drinking violence, {is} one sending words by the hand of a stupid {one}”

One who cuts off, one who drinks, one who sends, the hand, and a stupid one refer to types of people and hands in general, not specific people or a specific **hand**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [Any person who cuts off feet, any person who drinks violence, is any person who sends words by a hand of any stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:6 (#6)

שְׁלַח דְּבָרִים

“{is} one sending words”

Here Solomon refers to a message that is communicated by using **words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is one who sends a message]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:6 (#3)

מִקְצָצָה רַגְלִים חֲמָס שִׁתְּתָה

“One cutting off feet, one drinking violence”

Here Solomon implies that a person **cuts off** his own **feet** and **drinks violence** against himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who cuts off his own feet, one who drinks violence against himself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:6 (#4)

מִקְצָצָה רַגְלִים חֲמָס שִׁתְּתָה

“One cutting off feet, one drinking violence”

Here Solomon refers to someone who does something that harms himself as if that person **cuts off** his own **feet** and **drinks violence**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [One who harms himself] or [Like one who cuts off his feet or drinks violence]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:7 (#1)

דָּלִי'וֹ

“dangle”

Here Solomon implies that these **Legs dangle** uselessly because the legs of **a lame one** do not function. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [dangle uselessly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:7 (#3)

וְחִמְשָׁל

“and a proverb”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **a proverb in the mouth of stupid ones** is like the **Legs** of **a lame one** because it is useless. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way a proverb]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:7 (#4)

וְחִמְשָׁל בְּפִי

“and a proverb in the mouth of”

Here, **a proverb** and **the mouth** refer to proverbs and mouths in general, not a specific **proverb** or **mouth**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any proverb in the mouths of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:7 (#2)

וְחִמְשָׁל

“and a proverb”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would

be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a proverb dangles]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 26:7 (#5)

וּמִשְׁשָׁל בְּפִי

“and a proverb in the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** refers to what a person says by using his **mouth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a proverb spoken by]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:8 (#2)

בְּצִרְרוֹר אֶאָבֵן בְּמִרְגָּמָה

“Like tying a stone in a sling”

The words **Like** and **so** in this verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **tying a stone in a sling** with giving **honor to a stupid one**. The point is that both of these are useless. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [Just as tying a stone in a sling is useless]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:8 (#3)

בְּצִרְרוֹר אֶאָבֵן בְּמִרְגָּמָה

“Like tying a stone in a sling”

A **sling** is a weapon used to throw **a stone** at someone. The act of **tying a stone in a sling** would make that **sling** useless. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of weapon, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [Like tying an arrow to a bow] or [Like a weapon that cannot hurt anyone]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:8 (#5)

לְכֶסֶסִּיל

“to a stupid one”

See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:8 (#4)

נֹתֵתֵן & קְבוֹד

“**is** one who gives honor”

Here Solomon refers to honoring someone as if **honor** were an object that someone **gives** to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is one who honors]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:8 (#1)

בְּצִרְרוֹר אֶאָבֵן בְּמִרְגָּמָה כִּי-נֹתֵתֵן לְכֶסֶסִּיל קְבוֹד

“Like tying a stone in a sling, so **{is}** one who gives honor to a stupid one”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who gives honor to a stupid one is like tying a stone in a sling]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:9 (#2)

וּמִשְׁשָׁל

“and a proverb”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a proverb goes up]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 26:9 (#1)

תִּחְוֶה עֲלֵלָה בְּיַד-שֹׁכְכָר

“A thorn goes up into the hand of a drunkard”

This could refer to: (1) **a drunkard** picking up a thorn or a thorn bush to swing it at people (the word translated as **thorn** could also refer to a thorn bush). Alternate translation: [A thorn bush waved around in the hand of a drunkard]; (2) a thorn pricking the hand of **a drunkard**. Alternate translation: [A thorn pricking the hand of a drunkard]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 26:9 (#4)

וּמִשְׁשָׁל בְּפִי כְסִילִים

“and a proverb in the mouth of stupid ones”

See how you translated this clause in 26:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:9 (#3)

וּמִשְׁפָּל

“and a proverb”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **a proverb in the mouth of stupid ones** is like **A thorn that goes up into the hand of a drunkard** because it is harmful. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way a proverb is harmful]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:10 (#2)

מְחֹלֶל-כָּל

“piercing everyone”

Here Solomon implies that the **archer** shoots arrows at **everyone** and those arrows pierce them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who shoots arrows at everyone that pierce them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:10 (#4)

וְשֹׁכֵר כָּסֶסִּיל

“so {is} one hiring a stupid {one}”

Here, **one who hires** and **a stupid one** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [so is any person who hires any stupid person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:10 (#3)

וְשֹׁכֵר כָּסֶסִּיל וְשֹׁכֵר עֲבָרִים

“so {is} one hiring a stupid {one} and hiring passersby”

The word **so** here indicates that Solomon is comparing **An archer piercing everyone** with **one hiring a stupid one and hiring passersby**. The point is that both of these are dangerous. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [so one who hires a stupid one and hires those passing by is dangerous]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:10 (#1)

רַב מְחֹלֶל-כָּל וְשֹׁכֵר כָּסֶסִּיל וְשֹׁכֵר עֲבָרִים

“An archer piercing everyone, so {is} one hiring a stupid {one} and hiring passersby”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One hiring a stupid one and hiring passersby is like an archer piercing everyone]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:11 (#5)

בְּאִלְתּוֹ

“his folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:11 (#2)

כִּכְרָב שָׁשׁב עַל-קִיאָיו כָּסֶסִּיל שׁוֹנֶנֶה בְּאִלְתּוֹ

“Like a dog returning to its vomit {is} a stupid {one} who repeats his folly”

Here, **a dog**, **its**, **a stupid one**, and **his** refer to dogs and a type of person in general, not a specific **dog** or person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [Like any dog that returns to that dog’s vomit is any stupid person who repeats that person’s own folly]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:11 (#1)

כִּכְרָב שָׁשׁב עַל-קִיאָיו כָּסֶסִּיל שׁוֹנֶנֶה בְּאִלְתּוֹ

“Like a dog returning to its vomit {is} a stupid {one} who repeats his folly”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A stupid one who repeats his folly is like a dog that returns to its vomit]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:11 (#4)

שָׁשׁב עַל-קִיאָיו

“returning to its vomit”

Here Solomon implies that the **dog returns to its vomit** in order to eat it. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that returns to eat its vomit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:11 (#3)

כְּכֶלֶב

“Like a dog”

A **dog** is an animal that is considered to be unclean and disgusting by Jews and many cultures of the Ancient Near East. Therefore, comparing someone to a dog is insulting. If dogs are unfamiliar to your culture and you have a different animal that is considered unclean and disgusting or whose name is used as an insult, you could use the name of that animal instead.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:12 (#5)

תִּקְוָה

“There is more} hope”

See how you translated the abstract noun **hope** in 10:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:12 (#2)

אִישׁ חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו & לְכֹסֵף לִמְנוֹ

“a man wise in his eyes & for a stupid {one} than for him”

Here, **a man**, **his**, **a stupid one**, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a stupid one** in 10:18. Alternate translation: [any person wise in that person’s eyes ... for any stupid person than that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:12 (#1)

רֹאִיתָ אִישׁ חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“You see a man wise in his eyes”

Although the Hebrew text is not marked as a question, many translations consider this clause to be a rhetorical question. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this as a question. See how you translated the similar use of **You see** in 22:29. Alternate translation: [Have you seen a man wise in his eyes?]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 26:12 (#4)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in his eyes”

See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:7.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:12 (#3)

חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו

“wise in his eyes”

Here Solomon implies that this **man** is not actually **wise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wise in his eyes who is not really wise]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:13 (#3)

אָמַר

“says”

In this verse, Solomon implies that what the **lazy one** says is not true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [says falsely]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:13 (#2)

אָמַר & שָׁחַל בְּדֶגֶד אֶרְוִי בֵּין הַרְחָבוֹת

“says, “A young lion {is} on the road! A lion {is} between the open areas”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. See how you translated the similar phrases in 22:13. Alternate translation: [says that a lion is on the road and a lion is between the open areas]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 26:13 (#1)

עָצֵל

“A lazy {one}”

See how you translated this phrase in 13:4.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:14 (#3)

וְעִצְצָל עַל־מִטָּתוֹ

“and a lazy {one} on his bed”

See how you translated “a lazy one, his” in 13:4.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:14 (#4)

וְעִצְצָל

“and a lazy {one}”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **a lazy one on his bed** is like a **door** that **turns on its hinge** because both move without going anywhere. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way, a lazy one]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:14 (#1)

הַחֲדָלָת תִּפְסֹב עַל־צִירָהָ

“The door turns on its hinge”

A **hinge** is a metal or leather piece attached to a **door** in order to allow the **door** to swing back and forth. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of item, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [The door swings back and forth] or [The door swings open and shut]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:14 (#2)

וְעִצְצָל עַל־מִטָּתוֹ

“and a lazy {one} on his bed”

Solomon is leaving out a word that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and a lazy one turns on his bed]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 26:15 (#1)

טֹמֵמֵן עֵצָל יָדוֹ בְּצִלְחָת נִלְאָאָה לְהַשִּׁיבָהּ אֶל־פִּי

“A lazy {one} hides his hand in the dish; he is {too} weary to return it to his mouth”

See how you translated the nearly identical sentence in 19:24.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:16 (#5)

מִמִּשְׁבֵּעָה

“than seven”

Here, **seven** is used to refer to multiple people, not specifically **seven** people. In Hebrew, **seven** often symbolizes the idea of completion. If it would be helpful, you could use a similar expression in your language, or you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [than a dozen] or [than a whole group of people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:16 (#7)

מִשְׁשִׁיבֵי טַעַם

“returning discernment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **discernment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [who answer discerningly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:16 (#2)

הִכְכֵּם & בְּעֵינָיו

“is} wiser in his eyes”

Here Solomon implies that **A lazy one** is not actually wise. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [wrongly considers himself wiser]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:16 (#1)

עֵצָל בְּעֵינָיו

“A lazy {one} & in his eyes”

See how you translated **A lazy one** and **his** in the previous verse.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:16 (#6)

מִשְׁשִׁיבֵי טַעַם

“returning discernment”

Here Solomon refers to people speaking a reply with **discernment** to someone else as if they were returning **discernment**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of “returns” in 24:26. Alternate translation: [who speak a discerning reply]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 26:16 (#4)

מִשְׁבָּעֵנָה

“than seven”

Solomon is using the adjective **seven** as a noun to mean “seven people.” Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [seven people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 26:16 (#3)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in his eyes”

See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 26:12.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:17 (#5)

עֹבֵר מִמֶּתְעַבֵּר

“passing by {is} one infuriating himself”

Some translators consider **passing by** to apply to **one infuriating himself** rather than to **a dog**. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. Alternate translation: [is one passing by, infuriating himself]

Proverbs 26:17 (#1)

מִחֲזִיק בְּאָזְנוֹי־כֶּלֶב עֹבֵר מִמֶּתְעַבֵּר עַל־רֵיב לֹא־לוֹ

“One grabbing the ears of a dog passing by {is} one infuriating himself over a dispute not for him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [One who infuriates himself over a dispute not for him is one who grabs the ears of a dog passing by]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:17 (#4)

כֶּלֶב

“a dog”

See how you translated **dog** in 26:11.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 26:17 (#2)

מִחֲזִיק בְּאָזְנוֹי־כֶּלֶב עֹבֵר

“One grabbing the ears of a dog passing by”

In this verse, Solomon refers to someone **infuriating himself over a dispute not for him** as if that person were **One grabbing the ears of a dog passing by**. Both clauses are examples of a reckless or foolish act that would only harm the person who does it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [One who foolishly harms himself] or [Like one who grabs the ears of a dog passing by]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:17 (#6)

לֹא־לוֹ

“not for him”

Alternate translation: [not about him] or [that he has nothing to do with]

Proverbs 26:17 (#3)

מִחֲזִיק בְּאָזְנוֹי־כֶּלֶב עֹבֵר

“One grabbing the ears of a dog passing by”

Here Solomon implies that grabbing **the ears of a dog** is a reckless or foolish act because the dog will react by biting the person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who foolishly causes a dog to bite him by grabbing its ears]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:18 (#2)

זִקְלִים הַצָּצִים וּמָוֶה

“firebrands, arrows, and death”

The words **firebrands**, **arrows**, and **death** are used together here to emphasize a single idea. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [burning arrows that kill] or [deadly, burning arrows] or [deadly arrows, even burning ones]

See: Hendiadys

Proverbs 26:18 (#1)

כְּמִתְלַהֵלֶה הַיִּרְגָה זִקְלִים חֲצָצִים וּמִוֶּת

“Like an insane {one} shooting firebrands, arrows, and death”

Like in this verse and **so** in the next verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **an insane one who shoots arrows, firebrands, and death** with **a man who deceives his neighbor and says, “Was I not joking?”** The point is that these are harmful and dangerous acts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [Just as an insane one who shoots firebrands, arrows, and death is reckless]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:18–19 (#1)

כְּמִתְלַהֵלֶה הַיִּרְגָה זִקְלִים חֲצָצִים וּמִוֶּת: כִּן־אֲאִישׁ רִמְיָהוּ אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ
וְאִמְמַר הֲלֹא־מִשְׁחַתְּתִי אֲנִי

“Like an insane {one} shooting firebrands, arrows, and death,so {is} a man who deceives his neighbor and says, “Was I not joking”

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine 26:18 and 26:19 into a verse bridge, as the UST does, in order to keep this sentence together.

See: Verse Bridges

Proverbs 26:18–19 (#2)

כְּמִתְלַהֵלֶה הַיִּרְגָה זִקְלִים חֲצָצִים וּמִוֶּת: כִּן־אֲאִישׁ רִמְיָהוּ אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ
וְאִמְמַר הֲלֹא־מִשְׁחַתְּתִי אֲנִי

“Like an insane {one} shooting firebrands, arrows, and death,so {is} a man who deceives his neighbor and says, “Was I not joking”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A man who deceives his neighbor and says, “Was I not joking?” is like an insane one who shoots firebrands, arrows, and death]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:19 (#2)

וְאִמְמַר הֲלֹא־מִשְׁחַתְּתִי אֲנִי

“and says, “Was I not joking”

Here, **a man who deceives** is using this question to emphasize that he was **joking**. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language,

you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [and says, “Just kidding!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 26:19 (#1)

אֲאִישׁ & אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ

“is} a man & his neighbor”

Although the terms **man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use phrases that make this clear. Alternate translation: [is a person ... that person's neighbor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 26:19 (#3)

וְאִמְמַר הֲלֹא־מִשְׁחַתְּתִי אֲנִי

“and says, “Was I not joking”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and says that he was joking]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 26:20 (#2)

וּבְאֵין

“and when there is no”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that **a fire goes out** when there are no more **wood pieces**, **a quarrel stops** when there is no **murmurer**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and similarly, when there is no]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:20 (#1)

בְּאֵאֵפֶס

“With the end of”

Here, **end** refers to a lack of **wood pieces**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated the similar use of **With the end of** in 14:28. Alternate translation: [With the lack of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:20 (#4)

מִדּוֹן

“a quarrel”

See how you translated the abstract noun **quarrel** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:20 (#3)

יִשְׁתַּתֵּק מִדּוֹן

“a quarrel becomes silent”

Here Solomon speaks of **a quarrel** ceasing as if it were a person who **becomes silent**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a quarrel ceases]

See: Personification

Proverbs 26:21 (#6)

רִיב

“a dispute”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **dispute** in 15:18.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:21 (#3)

וְאִישׁ מִדּוֹנִים & רִיב

“so a man of quarrels & a dispute”

Here, **a man of quarrels** and **a dispute** refer to a type of people and disputes in general, not a specific **man** or **dispute**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [and any person of quarrels ... any dispute]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:21 (#1)

שָׂהָתָם לְלִנְתָּלִים וְעֵצִים לְאֵשׁ

“Charcoal to burning coals and wood to fire”

Solomon assumes that his readers will understand that **Charcoal** helps **burning coals** burn and **wood** helps **fire** burn. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [As charcoal is fuel for coals to burn, and wood feeds a fire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:21 (#5)

לְתַרְחֵר־רִיב

“is to kindling of a dispute”

Here Solomon refers to causing a **dispute** to continue as if it were a fire to which someone adds small, highly flammable sticks of wood, called **kindling**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is to starting an argument]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:21 (#2)

וְאִישׁ מִדּוֹנִים

“so a man of quarrels”

Here, **so** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that **Charcoal** helps **burning coals** burn and **wood** helps **fire** burn, **a man of quarrels** produces disputes among other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way, a man of quarrels]

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:21 (#4)

וְאִישׁ מִדּוֹנִים

“so a man of quarrels”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **quarrels**. See how you translated “a woman of quarrels” in 21:9.

See: Possession

Proverbs 26:22 (#1)

דְּבַרְבִּי נִגְרָגוּ כַּמִּתְלַחֲמִים וְהֵלֵם יִרְדְּדוּ חֲדָרֵי־בֶטֶן

“The words of a murmurer {are} like things swallowed greedily, and they themselves go down into the rooms of the belly”

See how you translated the identical sentence in 18:8.

See: Simile

Proverbs 26:23 (#4)

מִצְפֹּפֶה

“overlaid”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that someone overlaid]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 26:23 (#6)

שִׁפְתֵי־דֹלְקִים

“are} burning lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in 10:18.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:23 (#9)

וְלֵב

“and a heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:23 (#3)

כֶּכֶסֶף סִיגִים

“Silver of dross”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **dross** that is removed from **silver** when someone refines it. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Dross from silver]

See: Possession

Proverbs 26:23 (#7)

דֹּלְקִים

“burning”

Here Solomon refers to something being emotional or fervent as if that thing were **burning**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [passionate]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:23 (#2)

כֶּכֶסֶף סִיגִים מְצַפֵּה עַל־הַחֶרֶשׁ

“Silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel”

Here Solomon refers to **burning lips and a heart of evil** as if they are **Silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel**. The point is that both are deceptive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very deceptive] or [Like silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:23 (#8)

וְלֵב־רָע

“and a heart of evil”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **heart** that is characterized by **evil**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and an evil heart]

See: Possession

Proverbs 26:23 (#1)

כֶּכֶסֶף סִיגִים מְצַפֵּה עַל־הַחֶרֶשׁ שִׁפְתֵי־דֹלְקִים וְלֵב־רָע

“Silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel {are} burning lips and a heart of evil”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [Burning lips and a heart of evil are silver of dross overlaid on a clay vessel]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 26:23 (#5)

שִׁפְתֵי־דֹלְקִים וְלֵב־רָע

“are} burning lips and a heart of evil”

Here, **and** indicates that someone has both **burning lips and a heart of evil** at the same time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [are burning lips with a heart of evil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:24 (#4)

יִשְׁנֵית מְרִמָּה

“he sets deceit”

Here Solomon speaks of the **one who hates** planning how to deceive someone as if **deceit** were an object that **he sets within him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he secretly plans to deceive]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:24 (#5)

מְרִמָּה

“deceit”

Here Solomon implies that the **one who hates** plans to deceive the person whom he **hates**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [deceit for the one whom he hates]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:24 (#3)

יִנְכָּר וְיִדְבָּק בִּבְבוֹ

“disguises himself, but within him”

Here, **himself** and **within him** refer to what the **one who hates** is thinking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [disguises what he is thinking, but in his mind]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:24 (#1)

בשפתו יִנְכָּר שׁוֹנֵא וְיִדְבָּק בִּבְבוֹ יִשְׁשִׁית מְרָמָה

“With his lips one who hates disguises himself, but within him he sets deceit”

Here, **his**, **one who hates**, **himself**, **him**, and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [With the lips of any person who hates, that person disguises himself, but that person sets deceit within that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:24 (#2)

בשפתו

“With his lips”

See how you translated the same use of **lips** in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:25 (#5)

בְּלִבּוֹ

“are} in his heart”

See how you translated **in his heart** in 6:14.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:25 (#3)

שְׁשִׁיעַ תּוֹעֲבֹת

“seven abominations”

Here Solomon uses **seven** to refer to multiple **abominations**, not specifically **seven**. See how you translated **seven abominations** in 6:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:25 (#4)

תּוֹעֲבֹת

“abominations”

As in the rest of Proverbs, the word **abominations** here refers to what Yahweh considers to be abominable acts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [things that are abominable to Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:25 (#2)

קוֹלוֹ

“his voice”

Here, **voice** refers to what the person says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what he says]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:25 (#1)

יִחַנֵּן קוֹלוֹ & בְּבוֹ & בְּלִבּוֹ

“he makes his voice gracious & in him & are} in his heart”

In this verse, **he**, **his**, and **him** refer to the type of person “who hates,” as stated in the previous verse. See how you translated these words in the previous verse.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:26 (#5)

תִּגְלֶלָה רָעַתָּו בְּקָהֶל

“his evil will be uncovered in the assembly”

This clause is a strong contrast to the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [however, his evil will be uncovered in the assembly]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 26:26 (#4)

תִּכְסֹּף & תִּגְלֶלָה

“is covered & will be uncovered”

Here Solomon refers to **Hatred** being concealed as if it were an object that **is covered**, and he refers to **evil** being revealed as if it were an object that is **uncovered**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of “covers” in 10:6. Alternate translation: [is concealed ... will be revealed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:26 (#7)

רָעוּתוֹ

“his evil”

See how you translated the abstract noun **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:26 (#3)

שִׂנְאָה

“Hatred”

Solomon implies that this **Hatred** belongs to the person with “a heart of evil,” who is described in 26:23–26. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [His hatred]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:26 (#2)

שִׂנְאָה בְּמַשְׁאֵוִן

“Hatred & by guile”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Hatred** and **guile**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated the abstract noun **hatred** in 10:12. Alternate translation: [Hating someone ... by deceiving others]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 26:26 (#1)

תִּכְסֶּסָה שִׂנְאָה בְּמַשְׁאֵוִן

“Hatred is covered by guile”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Guile covers hatred]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 26:26 (#6)

תִּגְלֶלָה רָעוּתוֹ

“his evil will be uncovered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will discover his evil]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 26:27 (#1)

כָּרֵה־שִׁשְׁחָת בְּבֹהַ יִפְּלֹ

“One who digs a pit will fall into it”

Here Solomon uses **One who digs a pit** to refer to anyone who tries to harm another person, and he uses **fall into it** to refer to that person being harmed as a result. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [One who tries to harm someone will be harmed instead] or [One who tries to harm someone is like one who digs a pit and falls into it]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:27 (#3)

כָּרֵה־שִׁשְׁחָת & וְגִלְגֵּל אֶבֶן אֶל־יוֹ

“One who digs a pit & and one who rolls a stone & to him”

One who digs a pit, one who rolls a stone, and him refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who digs a pit ... and any person who rolls a stone ... to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 26:27 (#2)

כָּרֵה־שִׁשְׁחָת בְּבֹהַ יִפְּלֹ

“One who digs a pit will fall into it”

Here Solomon implies that the person **digs a pit** in order to trap someone in it, but then ends up falling **into** that pit himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [One who digs a pit to trap someone will fall into that pit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:27 (#4)

וּגְגֵלֶל אֶאָבֵן אֶלְיוֹ תָשׁוּב

“and one who rolls a stone, it will come back to him”

Here Solomon uses **one who rolls a stone** to refer to anyone who tries to harm another person. Solomon uses **come back to him** to refer to that person being harmed as a result. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning carefully or use a simile. Alternate translation: [and one who tries to harm someone will be harmed instead] or [One who tries to harm someone is like one who rolls a stone, and the stone comes back to him]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:27 (#6)

אֶלְיוֹ תָשׁוּב

“it will come back to him”

Here Solomon implies that the person himself will be crushed by the **stone** that he rolled up a hill to crush someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [it will roll down and crush him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:27 (#5)

וּגְגֵלֶל אֶאָבֵן

“and one who rolls a stone”

Here Solomon implies that the person pushed a large **stone** up a hill so that it would roll down and crush someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and one who rolls a stone up a hill so that it will roll down and crush someone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 26:28 (#1)

לְשׁוֹן־שָׁקֶר

“A tongue of falsehood”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **tongue** that is characterized by **falsehood**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. See how you translated the similar use of this phrase in 6:17. Alternate translation: [A false tongue]

See: Possession

Proverbs 26:28 (#4)

הַחֹלֵק

“smooth”

Here Solomon speaks of this person speaking flatteringly as if he were making what he says **smooth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [flattering]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 26:28 (#2)

לְשׁוֹן & דִּבְכִּי

“A tongue of & its oppressed ones”

Here, **tongue** and **its** refer to what a person says with his tongue. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A person speaking with ... that person's oppressed ones]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:28 (#3)

וּפְּהַּ הַחֹלֵק

“and a smooth mouth”

As with **tongue**, **mouth** also refers to what a person says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 4:5. Alternate translation: [and a person who speaks smoothly]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 26:28 (#5)

מַדִּיקָה

“calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs - Chapter 27 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah's proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1–27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1–29:27)

Chapter 27 continues the section of the book containing proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of Hezekiah. This section

contains two parts, the first part in 25:1–27:27 mostly contains proverbs that warn or admonish.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Chapters 25–27 mostly contain proverbs in which the second of two parallel clauses completes, emphasizes, or qualifies the idea of the first clause. Chapter 27 also contains contrasting parallelism (27:3, 27:4, 6, 7, 12) and parallelism in which both clauses have the same meaning for emphasis (27:2, 23). (See: Parallelism)

Similes

Solomon uses many different similes in this chapter to warn his readers against acting unwisely. (See: Simile)

Proverbs 27:1 (#1)

יָגִיד יוֹם

“a day will bring forth”

Here Solomon refers to what will happen on a certain **day** as if that **day** were a person who brings **forth** that event. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what will occur on a day]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:2 (#4)

פִּיךָ & שְׂפָתֶיךָ

“your mouth & your lips”

In this verse, **mouth** and **lips** refer to what a person says using his mouth and lips. See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 4:5 and **lips** in 23:16.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:2 (#2)

יְהַלְלֶךָ זָר וְלֹא־פִיךָ נִזְכָּרִי וְאֶל־שְׂפָתֶיךָ

“Let a stranger praise you and not your mouth, a foreigner and not your lips”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Let a stranger praise you and not your mouth; yes, let a foreigner praise you and not your lips]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 27:2 (#1)

יְהַלְלֶךָ זָר וְלֹא־פִיךָ נִזְכָּרִי וְאֶל־שְׂפָתֶיךָ

“Let a stranger praise you and not your mouth, a foreigner and not your lips”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words in the second clause that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the first clause. Alternate translation: [Let a stranger praise you and not your mouth; let a foreigner praise you and not your lips]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 27:2 (#3)

זָר & נִזְכָּרִי

“a stranger & a foreigner”

Here, **a stranger** and **a foreigner** refer to unfamiliar people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any stranger ... any foreigner] or [any other person ... any outsider]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:3 (#1)

כִּבְד־אֲבָבִן וְנִבְטָל הַחֹמֶל

“The heaviness of a stone and the weightiness of the sand”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to state that **a stone** is heavy and **sand** is weighty. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A stone is heavy and sand is weighty]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:3 (#2)

וְכִבְעָס אֲוִיָּל כְּבֵבֶד מִשְׁנִיָּהֶם

“yet the vexation of a fool {is} heavier than the two of them”

Here Solomon refers to how vexing fools are to other people as if the **vexation** they cause were **heavier than** the weight of **a stone** and **sand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [yet the vexation of a fool is harder to tolerate than lifting either of them] or [yet the vexation of a fool is like something heavier than the two of them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:3 (#3)

וְכַעַס אֶאָזִיל

“yet the vexation of a fool”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe **the vexation** that is caused by **a fool**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [yet how vexing a fool can be]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:4 (#3)

וְשֹׁטֵף אֶאֱרָה

“and a flood of nose”

Here Solomon speaks of the destructive power of anger as if it were **a flood**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and anger destroys like a flood]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:4 (#2)

חֹמֶה & אֶאֱרָה

“heat & nose”

Here, **heat** and **nose** refer to anger. See how you translated the same use of **heat** and **nose** in 15:1.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:4 (#1)

אֶכְזֹר יוֹת חֹמֶה וְשֹׁטֵף אֶאֱרָה

“Cruelty of heat and a flood of nose”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe **heat** that is characterized by **Cruelty** and **nose** that is characterized by **a flood**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Heat is cruel and nose is a flood]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:4 (#5)

יִעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי

“can stand to the face of”

Here, **stand to the face of** means “resist.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [can successfully oppose]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 27:4 (#6)

קִנְיָה

“jealousy”

See how you translated the abstract noun **jealousy** in 6:34.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:4 (#4)

וּמִי יִעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי קִנְיָה

“but who can stand to the face of jealousy”

Solomon is using the question form to emphasize how dangerous **jealousy** is. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [but surely no one can stand before the face of jealousy!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 27:5 (#1)

מְגֵלְהָ & מְסֻתֶּרֶת

“open & hidden”

Here, **open** refers to a **rebuke** that someone notices, while **hidden** refers to **love** that someone does not notice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [noticeable ... unnoticeable]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:5 (#2)

תּוֹכֵחַת & מֵאֲהָבָה

“is & rebuke than & love”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **rebuke** in 1:23 and **love** in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:6 (#3)

פְּצָעֵי אֹהֶב

“are} the wounds of one loving”

Here Solomon speaks of the sadness that a person feels when **one loving** rebukes that person as if it were **wounds**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate

translation: [is the sadness caused by one who loves and rebukes]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:6 (#1)

נְאֻמֵּי אֱהָבָה

“Faithful {are} the wounds of one loving”

Here Solomon speaks of the faithfulness of the **one loving** as if the **wounds** he causes were a **Faithful** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The wounds of one who loves show his faithfulness] or [The wounds of one who loves show how faithful he is]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:6 (#2)

פְּצָעֵי אֱהָבָה

“are} the wounds of one loving”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **wounds** that are caused by **one loving**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are the wounds caused by one who loves]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:6 (#5)

וְנִצְתָּרֹת

“but deceptive”

The word translated as **deceptive** can also mean “excessive.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 27:6 (#7)

נְשִׁיקוֹת

“are} the kisses of”

Here, **kisses** is a symbolic action that shows friendship and loyalty. See how you translated the same use of the word in 24:26.

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 27:6 (#6)

נְשִׁיקוֹת שׂוֹנֵא

“are} the kisses of one hating”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **kisses** that are given by **one hating**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are the kisses given by one who hates]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:6 (#4)

וְנִצְתָּרֹת נְשִׁיקוֹת שׂוֹנֵא

“but deceptive {are} the kisses of one hating”

Here Solomon speaks of the deceptiveness of the **one hating** as if the **kisses** themselves were being **deceptive**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but the kisses of one who hates show his deceptiveness] or [but the kisses of one who hates show how deceptive he is]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:7 (#2)

נִבְכָּשׁ שְׂשֻׁבָּעָה

“A satiated appetite”

Here, **appetite** refers to the whole **satiated** person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A person who is satisfied] or [A person who has eaten enough to be full]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 27:7 (#3)

נִבְכָּשׁ & וְנִבְכָּשׁ

“appetite & but {for} the appetite of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **appetite** in 6:30.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:7 (#4)

תִּבְבֹּס נֶחֱם & מְתוֹק

“tramples fresh honey & is} sweet”

Here Solomon implies that the **satiated** person **tramples fresh honey** because he is not hungry and does not want to eat it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [shuns fresh honey because he is not hungry]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:7 (#5)

וּנְגַפֵּשׁ רָעֵבֶכָּה

“but {for} the appetite of a hungry one”

Here, **appetite** refers to the whole **hungry one**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but a person who is hungry]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 27:7 (#6)

כֹּל-מִמֶּר מְתוּק

“everything bitter {is} sweet”

Here, **bitter** and **sweet** refer to how things taste. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [everything that usually tastes bitter seems to taste sweet]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:7 (#1)

וּנְגַפֵּשׁ רָעֵבֶכָּה & וּנְגַפֵּשׁ שָׂבִיעָה

“A satiated appetite & but {for} the appetite of a hungry one”

A satiated appetite and **the appetite of a hungry one** refers to these appetites in general, not specific appetites. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any satiated appetite ... but for any appetite of any hungry person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:8 (#1)

כְּצִפּוֹר נוֹדְדֹת מִן-קִנְיָהּ כִּן-אִישׁ נוֹדֵד מִמְּקוֹמוֹ

“Like a bird wandering from her nest, so {is} a man who wanders from his place”

The point of this comparison is that just as it is not good for **a bird** to wander far from its nest, so it is not good for **a man** to wander far from his home and family. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Just as it is dangerous for a bird to wander from her nest, so it is for a man to wander from his place]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:8 (#2)

אִישׁ & מִמְּקוֹמוֹ

“{is} a man & from his place”

See how you translated the same use of **a man** and **his** in 6:27.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:9 (#6)

מִצֵּצַת-רוּחַ

“{is} from the counsel of the soul”

The phrase **counsel of the soul** could refer to: (1) sincere advice. Alternate translation: [is from sincere counsel]; (2) one's own (internal) advice. Alternate translation: [is better than one's own counsel]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 27:9 (#3)

וּמִמֶּתְקִי

“and the sweetness of”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that **Oil and incense gladden the heart, the sweetness of his friend is from the counsel of the soul**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and similarly, the sweetness of]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:9 (#4)

וּמִמֶּתְקִי

“and the sweetness of”

Here Solomon speaks of the kindness of a **friend** as if it were **sweetness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the kindness of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:9 (#2)

יִשְׂמַח-לֵב

“gladden the heart”

Here Solomon speaks of a person feeling glad as if that person's **heart** were a person who could be gladdened. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [make a person happy]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:9 (#1)

שִׁשְׁמֹן וְזִקְתָּרֵת

“Oil and incense”

Oil and incense here refers to pleasant-smelling substances that are put on a person’s skin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Pleasant-smelling oils and perfumes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:9 (#5)

רִצְעָהוּ

“his friend”

Although **his** is masculine, here it refers to a person in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [any person’s friend]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:10 (#2)

בַּיּוֹם

“in the day of”

Here, **day** refers to a time when something happens. It does not refer to a 24-hour length of time. See how you translated the same use of **day** in 21:31.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:10 (#1)

רַעְדֶּךָ וְרַעָה & וּבִגְדִית אֶחָיִיד אֶל־תִּתְּבוֹא & שְׂכֵנְךָ קָקֶרְרֹב מֵאַחָה רְחֹק

“your friend and the friend of & and do not enter the house of your brother & is} a nearby inhabitant than a distant brother”

Here, **friend**, **house**, **brother**, **a nearby inhabitant**, and **a distant brother** represent these things and people in general, not specific things or people. In this verse, **brother** refers to relatives in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any friend of yours and any friend of ... and do not enter any house of any relative of yours ... is any nearby inhabitant than any distant relative]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:10 (#4)

שְׂטוֹב שְׂכֵנְךָ קָקֶרְרֹב מֵאַחָה רְחֹק

“Better {is} a nearby inhabitant than a distant brother”

Here Solomon implies that this situation is true **in the day of your calamity**, as mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When you need help, a nearby inhabitant is better than a distant brother]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:10 (#3)

אִידֶּךָ

“your calamity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **calamity** in 1:26.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:11 (#2)

וְשִׂמְחָה לִבִּי

“and gladden my heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [make my spirit happy]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 27:11 (#3)

וְאִשְׁשִׁיבָה & דְּבָר

“and I shall return a word”

Here Solomon refers to replying to someone as if the **word** spoken were an object that one returns to that other person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I shall reply with a word]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:11 (#4)

וְאִשְׁשִׁיבָה

“and I shall return”

Here, **and** introduces the result of the **son** being **wise**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [As a result, I shall return]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 27:11 (#6)

חֶרֶפְךָ

“to one reproaching me”

Here, **one who reproaches me** represents a person in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [to any person who reproaches me]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:11 (#5)

דָּבָר

“a word”

See how you translated the similar use of **word** in 12:25.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:11 (#1)

בְּנִי

“my son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:12 (#1)

עָרְוִים רָאָה רָעָה נִסְתָּתֵר פִּתְתָּאִים עָבְרוּ נִעְנְשׁוּ

“A prudent one sees evil, he hides himself; naive ones pass on, they are fined”

See how you translated the nearly identical sentence in 22:3.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:13 (#1)

קַח-בִּבְגְדֹו כִּי-עָרַב זָר וּבְעֵד נְכַרְיָה חֲבֵלָהּ

“Take his garment when he has pledged {for} a stranger, and on behalf of a foreign woman hold it in pledge”

See how you translated the identical sentence in 20:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:14 (#1)

מִבְּרֹךְ רֵעֵהוּ & בִּבְרֹךְ הַשִּׁכְּכִים & לוֹ

“One who blesses his neighbor & in the rising morning & to him”

One who blesses, his neighbor, the rising morning, and him represent types of people and mornings in general, not a specific people or **morning**. If it would

be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who blesses any neighbor ... in any rising morning ... to that neighbor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:14 (#3)

בִּבְרֹךְ הַשִּׁכְּכִים

“in the rising morning”

Here Solomon refers to the early **morning** as if it were **rising** because the sun appears to rise on the horizon at dawn. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at dawn]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:14 (#4)

קָלָל לֵלֶה תַּחֲשֹׁב לוֹ

“it will be considered a curse to him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that neighbor will consider it to be a curse]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 27:14 (#2)

בְּקוֹל גָּדוֹל

“with a great voice”

Here, **great** refers to the **voice** being loud. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [with a loud voice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:15 (#2)

וְאִשָּׁת מְדוֹנִים

“and a woman of quarrels”

See how you translated **a woman of quarrels** in 21:9.

Proverbs 27:15 (#1)

דִּדְלָף טָטוּרַד בְּיּוֹם סִגְרִיר וְאִשָּׁת מְדוֹנִים נִשְׁתֵּמָה

“A continual dripping on a day of steady rain and a woman of quarrels are alike”

Here, **alike** indicates that Solomon is comparing **a woman of quarrels** to continually **dripping** water on a rainy **day** because both are annoying. If it would

be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **dripping** in 19:13. Alternate translation: [Both-ersome as a continual dripping on a day of steady rain is a woman of quarrels] or [As annoying as a continual dripping of water on a rainy day is a woman of quarrels]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:16 (#2)

צִפְנִיָּהּ

“The one hiding her”

Here, **her** refers to “a woman of quarrels” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [The one who hides a woman of quarrels]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 27:16 (#3)

צִפְנִיָּהּ & יְמִינוֹ

“The one hiding her & his right hand”

The one who hides and **his** represent any man with a quarrelsome wife in general, not a specific man. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who hides her ... that person’s right hand]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:16 (#1)

צִפְנִיָּהּ צִפֵּן

“The one hiding her hides”

The word translated as **hiding** and **hides** in this verse is considered by some scholars to also mean “restrains.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 27:16 (#4)

צִפֵּן רֵיחַ וְשֶׁמֶן יִמְצְאוּ יָדָהּ

“hides the wind, and oil meets his right hand”

Here Solomon speaks of hiding a quarrelsome woman as if one were trying to hide **the wind** or grasp **oil** in his hand, both of which are impossible tasks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is doing something impossible] or [is like one

who tries to hide the wind or grasp oil in his right hand]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:17 (#4)

יִתְחַד פָּנָיו

“sharpens the face of”

Here Solomon uses **sharpens** to refer to developing or improving someone, and **face** to refer to a person’s character or how a person thinks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [helps to improve the character of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:17 (#3)

וְאִישׁ וְרֵעֵהוּ

“and a man & his neighbor”

Although **a man** and **his** are masculine, Solomon is using the words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful, you could use phrases that make this clear in your language. Alternate translation: [and a person ... that person’s neighbor]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:17 (#2)

בְּרֹזֶל בְּבִרְזֵל יִתְחַד וְאִישׁ בְּפָנֵי רֵעֵהוּ

“Iron sharpens against iron, and a man sharpens the face of his neighbor”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A man sharpens the face of his neighbor as iron sharpens against iron]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 27:17 (#1)

בְּרֹזֶל בְּבִרְזֵל יִתְחַד וְאִישׁ בְּפָנֵי רֵעֵהוּ

“Iron sharpens against iron, and a man sharpens the face of his neighbor”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what he says in the second clause to what he says in the first clause. In the same way that **Iron sharpens against iron, a man sharpens the face of his neighbor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Iron sharp-

ens against iron; similarly, a man sharpens the face of his neighbor]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:18 (#3)

יִכָּבֵד

“will be honored”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that master will honor]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 27:18 (#2)

וְשָׁמַר

“and one protecting”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. Solomon is saying that **one protecting his master** is like **One guarding a fig tree** because both receive a reward for their work. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and in the same way, one who protects]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:18 (#1)

נֹצֵר תְּתֹאֲנָה יֹאכֵל פְּרִיָּהּ וְשָׁמַר אֲדֹנָיו

“One guarding a fig tree will eat its fruit, and one protecting his master”

One guarding, a fig tree, its, one protecting, and his represent fig trees and types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who guards any fig tree will eat the fruit of that tree, and any person who protects that person's master]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:19 (#1)

כַּכְּמִים הַפָּנִים לַפָּנִים כֵּן לִב־הָאָדָם לָאָדָם

“As the water, the face to the face, so the heart of the man, to the man”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alter-

nate translation: [As the water reflects the face to the face, so the heart of the man reflects to the man]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 27:19 (#4)

לֵב

“the heart of”

See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 2:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:19 (#3)

כַּכְּמִים הַפָּנִים לַפָּנִים כֵּן לִב־הָאָדָם לָאָדָם

“As the water, the face to the face, so the heart of the man, to the man”

Here, **the water, the face, the heart, and the man** refer to things and people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [As water reflects any face to itself, so any person's heart reflects to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:19 (#2)

כַּכְּמִים הַפָּנִים לַפָּנִים כֵּן לִב־הָאָדָם לָאָדָם

“As the water, the face to the face, so the heart of the man, to the man”

The words **As** and **so** in this verse indicate that Solomon is comparing **water** with **the heart of a man**. The point is that both reveal what someone really is. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this more explicit. Alternate translation: [Just like the water shows the face to the face, so the heart of a man shows to the man who he really is]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:20 (#3)

לֹא תִשְׂבֶּעַנָּה

“are not satisfied”

Here Solomon speaks of **Sheol and Abaddon** never lacking room for more dead people as if those places were people who **are not satisfied** with what they already have. He means that there will always be people who die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [never lack space] or [always have room for more]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:20 (#5)

וְעֵינֵי הָאָדָם לֹא תִשְׂבַּעַנָּה

“and the eyes of the man are not satisfied”

Here **the eyes** refers to desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and the desires of the man are not satisfied]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:20 (#4)

וְעֵינֵי הָאָדָם לֹא תִשְׂבַּעַנָּה

“and the eyes of the man are not satisfied”

Here, **and** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that **Sheol and Abaddon are not satisfied**, **the eyes of the man are not satisfied**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and similarly, the eyes of the man are not satisfied]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:20 (#1)

שְׁאֵל וְאַבְדּוֹן

“Sheol and Abaddon”

See how you translated this phrase in 15:11.

See: Doublet

Proverbs 27:20 (#2)

לֹא תִשְׂבַּעַנָּה & לֹא תִשְׂבַּעַנָּה

“are not satisfied & are not satisfied”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one can satisfy ... no one can satisfy]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 27:20 (#6)

הָאָדָם

“the man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person] or [any person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 27:21 (#4)

לִפְּי מְהַלֵּל

“for the mouth of one who praises him”

Solomon implies that **a man** is tested by **the mouth of one who praises him**, just as **silver** and **gold** are tested by someone melting them in a **smelting-pot** or **furnace**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [tested by the mouth of one who praises]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:21 (#1)

מִצְרֶרֶת לְלֶכֶסֶף וְכִכּוּר לְזָהָב

“The smelting-pot {is} for the silver and the furnace {is} for the gold”

See how you translated the identical clause in 17:3.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:21 (#5)

לִפְּי

“for the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** refers to what the person **who praises him** says. See how you translated the same use of **mouth** in 10:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:21 (#2)

הָאָדָם

“so {is} a man”

Here, **so** indicates that Solomon is comparing what follows to what he said in the previous clause. In the same way that the **smelting-pot** reveals the impurities in **silver** and the **furnace** reveals the impurities in **gold**, the character of **a man** is revealed by how he responds to **the mouth of one who praises him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the same way, a man is]

See: Simile

Proverbs 27:21 (#3)

הָאָדָם לִפְּי מְהַלֵּל

“so {is} a man for the mouth of one who praises him”

Here, **a man** and **one who praises him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [so is any person for the mouth of any person who praises that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:22 (#1)

אִם תִּכְתוֹשׁ-אֶת-הָאֱוִיל׃ בַּמִּכְתֵּשׁ בְּתֵנוּךְ הִהְרִיפֹת בְּעֵלְיִ

“Even if you pound a fool in a mortar with a pestle in the midst of ground grains”

Solomon introduces an imaginary situation to help explain how futile it is to try to stop **a fool** from being foolish. Use a natural method in your language for introducing an imaginary situation. Alternate translation: [Suppose you were to pound a fool in a mortar with a pestle in the midst of ground grains]

See: Hypothetical Situations

Proverbs 27:22 (#5)

אוֹלְתּוֹ

“his folly”

See how you translated the abstract noun **folly** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 27:22 (#2)

תִּכְתוֹשׁ-אֶת-הָאֱוִיל׃ בַּמִּכְתֵּשׁ בְּתֵנוּךְ הִהְרִיפֹת בְּעֵלְיִ

“you pound a fool in a mortar with a pestle in the midst of ground grains”

The terms **mortar** and **pestle** refer to hard tools that are smashed together to crush **grains**. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of tool, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [you pound a fool with tools used for crushing grain]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 27:22 (#3)

אֶת-הָאֱוִיל׃ & מִמַּעַלְלֵי אוֹלְתּוֹ

“a fool & his folly & from on him”

Here, **a fool**, **his**, and **him** refer to fools in general, not one particular **fool**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any fool ... that fool's folly ... from on that fool]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 27:22 (#4)

לֹא-תִסְקֹר מִמַּעַלְלֵי אוֹלְתּוֹ

“his folly will not turn away from on him”

Here Solomon speaks of a person being unable to stop behaving foolishly as if **his folly** were a person who **will not turn away from on him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will not stop his folly]

See: Personification

Proverbs 27:23 (#3)

צֹאֲנֶךָ

“your flock”

In this verse, the word **flock** is singular in form, but it refers to all sheep or goats as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [your group of sheep]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 27:23 (#1)

יָדָעַתְּ תַּתְדַע פָּנֶי צֹאֲנֶךָ שְׁשִׁית לְלִבְךָ לַעֲדָרִים

“Know well the faces of your flock; set your heart to the herds”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Know well the faces of your flock; yes, set your heart to the herds]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 27:23 (#4)

שְׁשִׁית לְלִבְךָ

“set your heart”

See how you translated this phrase in 22:17.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 27:23 (#5)

לַעֲדָרִים

“to the herds”

The parallelism with the previous clause indicates that Solomon is referring to the condition of **the herds**. If

it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the condition of the herds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:23 (#2)

פָּנֵי

“the faces of”

Here, **faces** refers to what the animals in the **flock** look like, which would indicate the condition of their health. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the condition of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 27:24 (#2)

לְדֹר דּוֹר

“for generation and generation”

This is an idiom that means “forever.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 27:24 (#1)

כִּיָּוֶן

“a crown”

Here, **crown** refers to a king’s rule over his kingdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a king’s rule]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 27:25 (#4)

עֲשֻׁבּוֹת הָהָרִים

“the herbs of the mountains”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe **the herbs** that grow on **the mountains**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the herbs that grow on the mountains]

See: Possession

Proverbs 27:25 (#1)

גִּלְלָה תִּחְצִיר

“The grass disappears”

Here Solomon implies that the **grass disappears** because the farmer harvested it in order to feed it to livestock. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Then grass disappears when you harvest it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:25 (#2)

וְנִרְאָה דִּדְשָׁא

“and fresh grass is seen”

The word translated **and** at the beginning of this phrase indicates that this event happened after the event described in the previous phrase. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the next event in a series of events. Alternate translation: [and next, fresh grass is seen]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Proverbs 27:25 (#3)

וְנִרְאָה דִּדְשָׁא וְאִנְאִסְפּוּ עֲשֻׁבּוֹת הָהָרִים

“and fresh grass is seen, and the herbs of the mountains are gathered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and you see fresh grass, and you gather the herbs of the mountains]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 27:25–26 (#1)

גִּלְלָה תִּחְצִיר וְנִרְאָה דִּדְשָׁא וְאִנְאִסְפּוּ עֲשֻׁבּוֹת הָהָרִים: כְּבִשְׂשִׁים לְבִישָׁשׁ וּמַחְתִּיר שְׂשֻׁדָּה עֲתוּדִים

“The grass disappears, and fresh grass is seen, and the herbs of the mountains are gathered; lambs {will be} for your clothing, and male goats the price of a field”

These two verses are one conditional sentence. If the conditions in 27:25 are met, then the situation in 27:26 will occur. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate conditional statements.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Proverbs 27:26 (#2)

וּמַחְתִּיר שְׂשֻׁדָּה עֲתוּדִים

“and male goats the price of a field”

Here Solomon implies that the **male goats** will be sold for an amount of money that will be enough to buy **a field**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and selling your goats will provide enough money to pay the price for a field]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:26 (#1)

כְּבָשִׁים לְבֹשֶׁשֶׁךָ

“lambs {will be} for your clothing”

Here Solomon implies that the **lambs** will provide the wool that is used to make **clothing**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [lambs will provide the wool for your clothing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:27 (#1)

וְחַיִּים לְנַעֲרוֹתֶיךָ

“and life for your young women”

Here Solomon implies that there will also be enough **milk of female goats** to provide **life for your young women**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and there will be enough goat’s milk to sustain the life of your young women]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 27:27 (#2)

וְחַיִּים

“and life”

Here, **life** refers to the nourishment needed to sustain **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and nourishment]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs - Chapter 28 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah’s proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1–27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1–29:27)

Chapter 28 begins the second part of this section of the book that contains proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of

Hezekiah. This part in 28:1–29:27 mostly contains general proverbs that use contrastive parallelism.

Proverbs 28:1 (#1)

רָשָׁע וְצַדִּיקִים

“The wicked & but the righteous”

Solomon is using the adjectives **wicked** and **righteous** as nouns to mean **wicked** and **righteous** people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these words with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [Wicked people ... but righteous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 28:1 (#2)

וְאֵין־רֹדֵף

“and there is no pursuer”

Here, **and** indicates a contrast between the previous phrase and the next phrase. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [despite their being no pursuer]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 28:2 (#6)

נֶאֱרִיד

“it will endure”

The pronoun **it** refers to the **land**, meaning the government of that land. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the government of that land will endure]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 28:2 (#5)

מִבֵּין יֹדֵעַ

“who understands, who knows”

The words **understands** and **knows** mean the same thing. Solomon is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [who really understands]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 28:2 (#2)

בְּפֶשַׁע

“By the transgression of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:2 (#4)

וּבְאֶדְוָם

“but by a man”

Here Solomon implies that **a man** is a ruler. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but by a ruler]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:2 (#1)

בְּפֶשַׁע אֶרֶץ רַב־בָּיִם שָׁרִידָהּ

“By the transgression of a land many {are} its rulers”

By here indicates that having **transgression** is one reason why **a land** has **many rulers**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a reason. Alternate translation: [Transgression is one reason why a land has many rulers]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 28:2 (#3)

אֶרֶץ & שָׁרִידָהּ

“a land & are} its rulers”

Here, **land** and **its** refer to the people who live in a **land**. If it would be helpful, you could express the meaning plainly in your language. Alternate translation: [the people in a land ... are their rulers]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 28:3 (#6)

לֶחֶם

“bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 28:3 (#4)

מִטְטֵר

“{that} washes away”

Here Solomon implies that the **rain washes away** all the crops. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that washes all the crops away]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:3 (#2)

דִּלְלִים

“the lowly”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:3 (#3)

מִטְטֵר מִסִּחְחֹף וְאֵינִן לֶחֶם

“is} a rain {that} washes away, and there is no bread”

Here Solomon refers to **A man who is poor and who oppresses the lowly ones** as if that person were **a rain that washes away**. The point is that both are destructive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is very destructive] or [is like rain that washes away, and there is no bread]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:3 (#1)

גִּבּוֹר

“A man”

A man here refers to this type of person in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:3 (#5)

וְאֵינִן

“and there is no”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [and it results in their being no]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 28:4 (#3)

רָשָׁע

“the wicked”

See how you translated **the wicked** in 3:25.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Proverbs 28:4 (#1)

עֲזָבָרִי

“Those forsaking”

See how you translated the same use of **forsake** in 1:8.

See: Personification

Proverbs 28:4 (#4)

וּשְׁמֶרֶי

“but those keeping”

Here Solomon speaks of obeying **the law** as if it were an object that someone can **keep**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:4 (#2)

תְּנוּרָה & תַּתְּנוּרָה

“the law & the law”

Here, the word **law** is singular in form, but it refers to several laws as a group. In this verse, **law** could refer to: (1) Yahweh’s laws. Alternate translation: [the laws of Yahweh ... his laws]; (2) wise instruction in general. Alternate translation: [wise instructions ... those instructions]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 28:4 (#5)

בָּם

“against them”

Here, **them** refers to **wicked** people, who are called **the wicked** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [against those wicked people]

See: Pronouns – When to Use Them

Proverbs 28:5 (#4)

וּמְבַקְשֵׁי

“but seekers of”

Here Solomon refers to trying to know and please **Yahweh** as if he were an object that people can seek. See how you translated the similar use of “seeks” in 11:27. Alternate translation: [but people who try to please]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:5 (#2)

אֲנָשִׁי

“Men of”

Although the term **men** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [People of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 28:5 (#3)

מִשְׁפָּט

“justice”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:5 (#5)

כֹּל

“everything”

Here Solomon implies that the people **understand everything** about **justice**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [completely understand what is just]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:5 (#1)

אֲנָשֵׁי-רָע

“Men of evil”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **men** who are characterized by **evil**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Evil men]

See: Possession

Proverbs 28:6 (#5)

דִּרְכֵי-כֹלִים

“ways”

See how you translated the same use of **ways** in 3:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:6 (#3)

בְּתַמְמוֹ

“in his integrity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **integrity** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:6 (#4)

מַעֲקָשׁ

“than one crooked of”

See how you translated the same use of **crooked** in 2:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:6 (#2)

הוֹלֵלֵךְ בְּתִמְמוֹ

“who walks in his integrity”

Here, **walks** refers to how a person behaves, in this case behaving with **integrity**. See how you translated the similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [who behaves with integrity]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:6 (#1)

רָשׁ הוֹלֵלֵךְ בְּתִמְמוֹ מַעֲקָשׁ דִּדְרָכָיו וְהָיָה

“one who is poor who walks in his integrity than one crooked of ways, yet he”

Here, **one who is poor**, **his**, **one crooked of ways**, and **he** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person who is poor who walks in that person’s integrity than any person who is crooked of ways, yet that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:7 (#2)

נוֹצֵצֵר

“One who guards”

Here Solomon speaks of obeying **the law** as if it were an object that someone **guards**. See how you translated the same use of “keep” in 28:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:7 (#1)

נוֹצֵצֵר & וְרָעָה & אָבִיו

“One who guards & but one who associates with & his father”

One who guards, **one who associates**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who guards ... but any person who associates with ... that person’s father]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:7 (#3)

תִּתְּנוּרָה

“the law”

See how you translated the same use of **the law** in 28:4.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 28:7 (#4)

בֵּן

“is} a son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 28:8 (#5)

דָּלִלִים

“the lowly”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:8 (#3)

יִקְבְּצֵנוּ

“gathers it”

Here Solomon implies that the **One who increases his wealth** unknowingly **gathers** his **wealth** for someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [unknowingly gathers it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:8 (#1)

מְרַבֵּה הָרוּבוֹ & לְחֻנְנוֹ

“One increasing his wealth & for one showing favor to”

One who increases, his, and **one who shows favor** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who increases that person's own wealth ... for any person who shows favor]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:8 (#4)

לְחֹנֵן

“for one showing favor {to}”

See how you translated the same use of **shows favor** in 14:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:8 (#2)

בְּנִשְׁדָּה וּבִתְרִבִּית

“by interest and usury”

The two words **interest** and **usury** express a single idea. The word **usury** indicates that this person is charging an unreasonably large amount of **interest** to those who borrow money from him. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [by charging extra money to borrow]

See: Hendiadys

Proverbs 28:9 (#1)

מִסְסִיר אָזְנוֹ & תִּפְלֵתוֹ

“One turning away his ear & his prayer”

One turning away and **his** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who turns away that person's own ear ... that person's prayer]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:9 (#2)

מִסְסִיר אָזְנוֹ מִשְׁמִיעַ

“One turning away his ear from hearing”

The phrase **turning away his ear** is an idiom that refers to refusing to listen to what someone is saying as if the listener were turning **his ear** from the person speaking. If this phrase does not have this meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who refuses to listen to]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:9 (#3)

תּוֹרָה

“the law”

See how you translated the same use of **the law** in 28:4.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 28:9 (#5)

תּוֹעֵבָה

“is} an abomination”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abomination** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:9 (#4)

תּוֹעֵבָה

“is} an abomination”

As in the rest of Proverbs, **abomination** here refers to what Yahweh considers to be an **abomination**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is what is abominable to Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:10 (#6)

יִנְחִלוּ-טוֹב

“will inherit good”

Here Solomon speaks of **the blameless** receiving many **good** things as if **good** were property or wealth that they could **inherit** from a family member. See how you translated the same use of **inherit** in 3:35.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:10 (#5)

וְלֹא-תִמְאָמִים

“but the blameless”

See how you translated **the blameless** in 2:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:10 (#1)

משגגה ישרים & בשחיתותו הוא יפול

“One leading the upright astray & into his pit he himself will fall”

One leading, **his**, **he**, and **himself** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who leads upright ones astray ... into that person's own pit that person will fall]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:10 (#7)

טוב

“good”

See how you translated the abstract noun **good** in 11:27.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:10 (#2)

משגגה ישרים | בדדרכו רע

“One leading the upright astray in the way of evil”

Here Solomon refers to someone causing **the upright** to behave in a manner that is **evil** as if he were leading those people down a path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of “lead them astray” in 12:26 and **way** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [One who causes upright ones to behave in an evil manner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:10 (#4)

בשחיתותו הוא יפול

“into his pit he himself will fall”

Here Solomon refers to a person unintentionally destroying himself by trying to harm someone else as if that person falls **into his pit** that he dug to trap someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will end up destroying himself by his behavior]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:10 (#3)

בדדרכו רע

“in the way of evil”

See how you translated **way of evil** in 2:12.

See: Possession

Proverbs 28:11 (#3)

ודל

“but a & lowly {one}”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:11 (#1)

בבעיניו איש עשיר ודל & יחקרנו

“A rich man & in his eyes, but a & lowly {one} will search him out”

A rich man, **his**, **a lowly one**, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any rich person ... in that person's eyes, but any lowly one ... will search that person out]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:11 (#2)

הכם בבעיניו

“{is} wise in his eyes”

See how you translated **wise in his eyes** in 26:5.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:11 (#4)

יחקרנו

“will search him out”

The phrase means that **a lowly one** will be able to investigate and determine if **A rich man** is not really **wise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [can determine if he is not truly wise]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:12 (#3)

ובקום רשעים

“but when the wicked arise”

Here Solomon speaks of **wicked ones** becoming powerful as if they were objects that could **arise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but when wicked ones become prosperous]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:12 (#1)

רַב־בָּהוּ תִפְאָאֶרֶת

“there is} great splendor”

Here, **splendor** could refer to: (1) people rejoicing or celebrating that **righteous ones** have become powerful. Alternate translation: [there is great celebration]; (2) the rule of the **righteous ones** being glorious. Alternate translation: [it is very glorious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:12 (#2)

בְּעֶלְיָן צַדִּיקִים

“When the righteous exult”

Here Solomon implies that **the righteous exult** because they have become prosperous or powerful. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [When the righteous become prosperous]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:12 (#4)

יִחְפֹּשׂ אָדָם

“a man is searched for”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people search for a man]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:12 (#6)

יִחְפֹּשׂ אָדָם

“a man is searched for”

Here Solomon implies that **a man is searched for** because every good person has hidden himself to escape from the powerful **wicked** people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [every good person hides from them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:12 (#5)

יִחְפֹּשׂ אָדָם

“a man is searched for”

Here, **a man** refers any good person in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any good person is searched for]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:13 (#4)

וּמוֹדָה וְעִזָּב

“but one confessing and forsaking”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but one who confesses and forsakes his transgressions]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 28:13 (#1)

מִכְסֹּה פִּשְׁעָיו & וּמוֹדָה

“One covering his transgressions & but one confessing”

One covering, **his**, and **one confessing** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who covers that person’s own transgressions ... but any person who confesses]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:13 (#2)

מִכְסֹּה

“One covering”

Here Solomon refers to someone concealing **his transgressions** as if **transgressions** were objects that someone is **covering**. See how you translated **covers** in 10:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:13 (#3)

פִּשְׁעָיו

“his transgressions”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgressions** in 10:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:13 (#5)

יִרְחַם

“will be shown mercy”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will show mercy to]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:14 (#2)

מִפְּחָדֵי תָמִיד

“fearing continually”

Here, **fearing** could refer to: (1) being cautious in the way that a person lives so as not to **fall into evil**, as also in 14:16. Alternate translation: [who is continually on guard about his behavior]; (2) reverently fearing Yahweh. Alternate translation: [who reveres Yahweh continually]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:14 (#4)

יִפְּוֹל בְּרָעָה

“will fall into evil”

See how you translated the nearly identical phrase “falls into evil” in 13:17.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:14 (#1)

אֲדָם & וּמִקְשָׁנָה לִלְבָּבוֹ

“is a man & but one hardening his heart”

Here, **a man**, **one hardening**, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is any person ... but any person who hardens that person’s own heart]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:14 (#3)

וּמִקְשָׁנָה לִלְבָּבוֹ

“but one hardening his heart”

Here Solomon speaks of a person stubbornly deciding to live by his own rules as if he made **his heart** hard. The word **heart** here refers to a person’s mind and will, as in 2:2. If the heart is not the body part

your culture uses to refer to a person’s will, consider using whichever organ your culture would use for this image. If a translation is available in your language, see how it translated a similar expression in Exodus 7:3. Alternate translation: [but one who stubbornly decides to live in his own way]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:15 (#4)

דָּל

“lowly”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:15 (#2)

אַרְיֵי־נִגְהָם וְדֹב שׁוֹקֵקֵק

“A lion growling and a bear charging”

In this verse, Solomon speaks of **a wicked ruler over a lowly people** being frightening and dangerous as if he were **A lion growling and a bear charging**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Very dangerous] or [Like a lion growling or a bear charging]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:15 (#3)

מִשְׁנֵטֶל רָרֵשׁ שֹׁשֶׁעַ עֹלֵל עַם־דָּל

“is a wicked ruler over a lowly people”

Here, **a wicked ruler** and **a lowly people** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [is any wicked ruler over any lowly people]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:15 (#5)

עַם

“a & people”

See how you translated the same use of **people** in 11:14.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 28:15 (#1)

אַרְיֵי־נִגְהָם וְדֹב שׁוֹקֵקֵק מִשְׁנֵטֶל רָרֵשׁ שֹׁשֶׁעַ עֹלֵל עַם־דָּל

“A lion growling and a bear charging {is} a wicked ruler over a lowly people”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [A wicked ruler over a lowly people is a lion growling and a bear charging]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 28:16 (#3)

וְרַב מִצְשָׁקוֹת

“is} also abundant of oppressions”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe an **abundant** number of oppressive acts. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [does many oppressive acts]

See: Possession

Proverbs 28:16 (#6)

יִאָרְרֵךְ יָמִים

“will lengthen days”

See how you translated the similar phrase “length of days” in 3:2.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:16 (#4)

שֹׂנְאִי

“one hating”

This clause is a strong contrast to the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [however, one who hates]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 28:16 (#5)

בְּצָעַ

“unjust gain”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:16 (#2)

תְּתַבּוֹנוֹת

“understanding”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:16 (#1)

נִגְיִיד & שֹׂנְאִי

“A leader & one hating”

A **leader** and **one hating** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any leader ... any person who hates]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:17 (#8)

אֶל־יִתְמֵכוּבּוֹ

“let them not support him”

Here, **them** refers to any people in general who may think about helping the murderer, and **him** refers to the murderer. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [let no one support such a person] or [no one should assist the murderer]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 28:17 (#3)

צִשְׁטָק בְּדָם־נֶפֶשׁ

“oppressed by the blood of a life”

Here, **oppressed** refers to a person being guilty of murdering someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [guilty for the blood of a life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:17 (#5)

נֶפֶשׁ

“a life”

Here, **life** refers to a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 28:17 (#2)

צִשְׁטָק בְּדָם־נֶפֶשׁ

“oppressed by the blood of a life”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom the blood of a life oppresses]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:17 (#1)

אָדָם & נֶפֶשׁ & בְּבוֹר & בּוֹ

“A man & a life & a pit & him”

A man, a life, a pit, and him refer to a type of person and these things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person ... any life ... any pit ... that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:17 (#4)

בָּדָם

“by the blood of”

Here, **blood** refers to violently murdering someone, which usually causes **blood** to come out of the person who is murdered. See how you translated the same use of **blood** in 1:11.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 28:17 (#6)

יִבְנוּ

“will flee”

Here, **flee** implies that the murderer is fleeing from punishment for what he has done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will flee from punishment] or [will flee from those who want to punish him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:17 (#7)

בְּבוֹר

“a pit”

Here, **pit** could refer to: (1) death, which is when that person would be buried in a **pit**. Alternate translation: [the grave] or [death]; (2) a deep hole or well where the murderer would try to hide. Alternate translation: [a pit to hide in]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 28:18 (#6)

בְּאֵהָרָה

“into one”

Here, **into one** could refer to: (1) falling into a pit, so **one** would refer back to “pit” in the previous verse. This continues the idea of the person walking in a crooked manner. Alternate translation: [into a pit]; (2) one moment, which emphasizes the suddenness of falling. Alternate translation: [at once]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:18 (#4)

וְנִצְקָהּ דְּדֶרֶךְ כְּלָיִם

“but one crooked of ways”

See how you translated **one crooked of ways** in 28:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:18 (#5)

יִפּוֹל

“will fall”

See how you translated the same use of **fall** in 11:5.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:18 (#2)

הוֹלֵךְ תָּתִים

“One walking blameless”

Here Solomon refers to someone behaving in a blameless manner as if that person **walks blameless**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated a similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [One who conducts his life in a blameless manner]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:18 (#1)

הוֹלֵךְ & וְנִצְקָהּ

“One walking & but one crooked of”

The phrases **One walking** and **one crooked of ways** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who walks ... but any person who is crooked]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:18 (#3)

יִשָּׁעַ

“will be saved”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context implies that Yahweh will do the action. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will save]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:19 (#1)

עֲבֵד אֲדָמָתוֹ יִשְׂכַּע-לֶחֶם

“One working his ground will be satisfied {with} bread”

See how you translated the identical clause in 12:11.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:19 (#2)

וּמְרַדְדֵי רִיקָנִים

“but one pursuing empty things”

See how you translated the identical phrase in 12:11.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:19 (#4)

רִישׁ

“with} poverty”

See how you translated the abstract noun **poverty** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:19 (#3)

יִשְׂכַּע-רִישׁ

“will be satisfied {with} poverty”

Here Solomon is using irony. By doing so, Solomon actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of his words. The **one who pursues empty things** is spoken of as being **satisfied with poverty**, but **poverty** is not satisfying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will only have poverty]

See: Irony

Proverbs 28:20 (#2)

אִישׁ אֱמֻנָה

“A man of faithfulness”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A faithful man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 28:20 (#3)

רַב

“has} an abundance of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abundance** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:20 (#4)

לֹא יִנָּקֶה

“will not remain blameless”

See how you translated this phrase in 6:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 28:20 (#1)

אִישׁ אֱמֻנָה & וְאֶחָד מְהֵרָה

“A man of faithfulness & but one hurrying”

A man of faithfulness and **one who hurries** refer to these types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of faithfulness ... but any person who hurries]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:21 (#3)

וְעַל-פֶּת-לֶחֶם

“yet for a bit of bread”

Here, **a bit of bread** is an extreme statement for emphasis, exaggerating how tiny the reward is that some people will accept for doing something evil. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [yet for a very small bribe] or [yet for just a small amount of food]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 28:21 (#2)

לא־טוֹב

“is} not good”

See how you translated the same use of **not good** in 16:29.

See: Litotes

Proverbs 28:21 (#5)

יִפְשַׁע

“will transgress”

Here Solomon implies that this person **will transgress** by **Recognizing faces**, as mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [will transgress by recognizing faces] or [will transgress by unjustly favoring someone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:21 (#1)

הִכָּר-פָּנִים

“Recognizing faces”

See how you translated this phrase in 24:23.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:21 (#4)

גִּבּוֹר

“a man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Solomon is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 28:22 (#2)

גִּבְהֵתָל לְהֵוֹן

“One hurrying to the wealth”

Here Solomon implies that this person **hurries to** obtain **wealth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated the similar phrase “one who hurries to become rich” in 28:20. Alternate translation: [One who hurries to gain wealth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:22 (#4)

הִתְקַר

“lack”

See how you translated the abstract noun **lack** in 6:11.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:22 (#5)

הִתְקַר יְבֹאֵנוּ

“lack will come to him”

Here Solomon speaks of experiencing **lack** as if “lack” were a person who could **come** to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will experience lack]

See: Personification

Proverbs 28:22 (#1)

גִּבְהֵתָל & אֲאִישׁ & וְלֹא-יָדַע & יְבֹאֵנוּ

“One hurrying & is} a man of & but he does not know & will come to him”

One hurrying, **a man**, **he**, and **him** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who hurries ... is a person of ... but that person does not know ... will come to that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:22 (#3)

אֲאִישׁ רָרַע עֵינָיו

“is} a man of an evil eye”

See how you translated the similar phrase “one evil of eye” in 23:6.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:23 (#4)

הִתֵּן

“favor”

Here Solomon implies that **One who rebukes will find favor** with the person whom he rebukes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [favor with the one he rebuked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:23 (#2)

ימצא

“will find”

See how you translated the same use of **find** in 16:20.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:23 (#1)

מְמוֹכְרֵי אֲדָמָה & מְמַחְלֵיק לְשׁוֹן

“One rebuking a man & more than one making the tongue smooth”

One rebuking, a man, one making and **the tongue** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who rebukes any other person ... more than any person who makes that person's own tongue smooth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:23 (#3)

חֶסֶד

“favor”

See how you translated the abstract noun **favor** in 3:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:23 (#5)

מְמַחְלֵיק לְשׁוֹן

“more than one making the tongue smooth”

Here Solomon refers to someone speaking flatteringly as if that person **makes** his **tongue smooth**. Here, **tongue** refers to speaking, as in 6:17. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [more than one who flatters by what he says]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:24 (#3)

פָּשַׁע

“transgression”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:24 (#1)

גִּזְזֵל | אֶבְרִי וְאִמּוֹ & הָיוּ לְאִישׁ מִשְׁחִית

“One robbing his father and his mother & he & of a man of destruction”

One robbing, his, he, and a man refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who robs that person's own mother and father ... that person ... of a person of destruction]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:24 (#4)

חֶבֶר & לְאִישׁ מִשְׁחִית

“is} the companion of a man of destruction”

Here, **companion** refers to being just like **a man of destruction**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the same kind of person as a man of destruction]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:24 (#2)

וְאִמָּר אֵין-פָּשַׁע

“and says, “There is no transgression”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and says that there is no transgression]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 28:24 (#5)

לְאִישׁ מִשְׁחִית

“of a man of destruction”

The phrase **man of destruction** can refer to a person who destroys people and property. In this case, the property is being removed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of a vandal]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 28:25 (#3)

יִגְרָה

“stirs up”

Here Solomon refers to starting **strife** as if it were something that a person **stirs up**. See how you translated the same use of this phrase in 15:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:25 (#4)

מִדָּוִן

“**strife**”

See how you translated the abstract noun **strife** in 16:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:25 (#1)

רָחֵב-בֶּטֶן & וְאֶחָד אֲשֶׁר יִטְרֹף

“**One wide of appetite & but one who trusts**”

One wide of appetite and **one who trusts** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person wide of appetite ... but any person who trusts]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:25 (#5)

יִדְשֵׁן

“**will be fattened**”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he will fatten]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 28:25 (#6)

יִדְשֵׁן

“**will be fattened**”

See how you translated the same use of **fattened** in 11:25.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:25 (#2)

רָחֵב-בֶּטֶן

“**One wide of appetite**”

The phrase **wide of appetite** refers to being greedy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A greedy one]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:26 (#2)

בְּלִבּוֹ

“**in his heart**”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts, feelings, and intentions exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [in his own brain] or [in his own thoughts and feelings]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:26 (#5)

הֵרָחַק יָמָלָט

“**he himself will flee**”

Solomon uses the word **himself** to emphasize the kind of person who **will flee**. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [that very person will flee]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 28:26 (#4)

בְּבִקְחָהּ מְחִמָּה

“**in wisdom**”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:26 (#6)

הֵרָחַק יָמָלָט

“**he himself will flee**”

Here Solomon implies that this person **will flee** from danger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he himself will flee from danger]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:26 (#3)

וְהוֹלֵךְ

“**but one walking**”

Here Solomon speaks of a person behaving with **wisdom** as if **wisdom** were a place that person **walks in**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated

a similar use of “walk” in 3:23. Alternate translation: [who behaves with wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:26 (#1)

בוטטת בבלבו ההוא כססיל והולך בִּבְחֻכְמָהּ ההוא יִמָּלֵט

“One trusting in his heart, he {is} a stupid one, but one walking in wisdom, he himself will flee”

One trusting, his, he, a stupid one, one walking, and **himself** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who trusts in that person’s own heart, that person is stupid, but any person who walks in wisdom, that person will flee]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:27 (#6)

רַב־מְאֹרוֹת

“an abundance of curses”

Here, **an abundance of curses** could mean: (1) many people will curse the person **who hides his eyes**. Alternate translation: [many people will curse him]; (2) Yahweh will curse the person abundantly **who hides his eyes**. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will curse that person abundantly]

Proverbs 28:27 (#3)

מִחֶסֶד וְרַב

“lack & an abundance of”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **lack** in 6:11 and **abundance** in 5:23.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 28:27 (#5)

וּמַעֲלֵלִים עֵינָיו

“but one hiding his eyes”

Here, **hides his eyes** refers to ignoring the needs of poor people as if one closes his **eyes** to avoid seeing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who refuses to notice]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 28:27 (#2)

אֵין מִחֶסֶד

“there is no lack”

Solomon is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [has plenty]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 28:27 (#1)

נוֹתֵן לָרֶשׁ & וּמַעֲלֵלִים עֵינָיו

“One giving to the one who is poor & but one hiding his eyes”

One who gives, the one who is poor, one who hides, and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [Any person who gives to any person who is poor ... but any person who hides that person’s own eyes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 28:27 (#4)

וּמַעֲלֵלִים עֵינָיו

“but one hiding his eyes”

Here Solomon implies that this person **hides his eyes** from seeing **the one who is poor**, who is mentioned in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but one who hides his eyes so that he does not see the poor] or [but one who hides his eyes from seeing the poor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 28:28 (#1)

בְּקִיּוֹם רָרָשָׁעִים

“When wicked ones arise”

See how you translated the same use of **arise** in 28:12.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 28:28 (#2)

יִסְתַּתֵּר אָדָם

“a man will hide himself”

Here, **a man** and **himself** refer to people in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [any person will hide]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs - Chapter 29 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Hezekiah's proverbs from Solomon (25:1–29:27)

- Warnings and admonitions (25:1–27:27)
- Contrastive wise sayings (28:1–29:27)

Chapter 29 finishes the second part of this section of the book that contains proverbs written by Solomon that were copied by scribes during the reign of Hezekiah. This part in 28:1–29:27 mostly contains general proverbs that use contrastive parallelism.

Proverbs 29:1 (#2)

אִישׁ תְּתוֹכְחוֹת

“A man of rebukes”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to describe **A man** who has received many **rebukes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A man who is often rebuked]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:1 (#1)

אִישׁ תְּתוֹכְחוֹת

“A man of rebukes”

A man of rebukes here represents a type of person in general, not one particular **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of rebukes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:1 (#3)

מִקְשָׁה-לְעֹרֶף

“who stiffens the neck”

Here Solomon speaks of a person becoming stubborn as if that person **stiffens** his **neck**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who becomes stubborn] or [who refuses to listen]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:1 (#4)

פֶּתַעַת יִשְׁבֵּר וְאֵין מְרַפָּא

“will suddenly be broken and without healing”

See how you translated the same clause in 6:15.

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 29:2 (#2)

הָעָם & הָעָם

“the people & a people”

In this verse, the word **people** is singular in form, but it refers to multiple **people** as a group. See how you translated the same use of **people** in 11:14.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 29:2 (#4)

הָאֲנָה

“groans”

Here, **groans** refers to the sound **people** make to express that they are miserable, which is the opposite of **rejoice** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [groans in misery]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:2 (#1)

בְּרִבְבוֹת צַדִּיקִים

“When the righteous increase”

Here, **increase** could refer to: (1) the **righteous ones** increasing in power or authority. This fits the parallelism with the second line. Alternate translation: [When righteous ones increase in power] or [When righteous ones become more powerful]; (2) the number of **righteous ones** increasing. Alternate translation: [When righteous ones increase in number] or [When righteous ones multiply greatly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:2 (#3)

רָשָׁעִים

“a wicked {one}”

See how you translated **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:3 (#4)

וְאֵבֶד הֶון

“destroys wealth”

Here, **destroys wealth** implies that this person has wasted all his money. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [squanders his wealth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:3 (#3)

וְרֵעֵה

“but one who associates with”

Solomon is referring to a person having sex with **prostitutes** in a polite way by using the phrase **associates with**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [but one who sleeps with] or [but one who has sexual relations with]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 29:3 (#2)

חֵכְמָה

“wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:3 (#1)

אִישׁ & אָבִיו וְרֵעֵה

“A man & his father, but one who associates with”

A man, **his**, and **one who associates** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person ... that person's father, but any person who associates with]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:4 (#5)

וְאִישׁ תְּרוֹמָמוֹת

“but a man of contributions”

This refers to a leader who demands money from people. This could refer more specifically to: (1) someone who demands bribes. Alternate translation: [but a man who demands bribes]; (2) a ruler who demands excessive taxes from the people he rules over. Alternate translation: [but a man who demands tribute] or [but a man who extorts his people]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:4 (#6)

וְאִישׁ

“but a man of”

The parallelism between the two clauses in this verse indicates that the phrase **a man** here refers to a **king** or leader in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but a ruler of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:4 (#1)

מֶלֶךְ & וְאִישׁ תְּרוֹמָמוֹת

“A king & but a man of contributions”

A king and **a man of contributions** refer to a types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any king is one who scatters ... but any man of contributions]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:4 (#3)

אֶרֶץ & יְהִרְסָנָה

“the land & tears it down”

Here, **land** and **it** refer to the people who live in a **land**. See how you translated the same use of these words in 28:2.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:4 (#2)

בְּמִשְׁפָּט

“by justice”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:4 (#7)

יְהִרְסָנָה

“tears it down”

Here Solomon refers to the people of **the land** failing as if someone **tears** them **down**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes the people of the land to fail]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:4 (#4)

יַעֲמִיד אֶרֶץ

“causes the land to stand”

Here Solomon refers to the people of **the land** being successful as if they would continue **to stand**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes the land to be successful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:5 (#1)

גִּבּוֹר וְרַעְיָהוּ & פֶּעֱמִי

“A man & his neighbor & his steps”

A man and **his** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person ... that person's neighbor ... that person's feet]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:5 (#2)

מְחַלְלֵיק עַל־רַעְיָהוּ

“who makes smooth for his neighbor”

Here Solomon writes of someone speaking flatteringly as if that person were making their speech **smooth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who flatters his neighbor]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:5 (#3)

רֹאשֶׁת פּוֹרֶרֶשׁ עַל־פֶּעֱמִי

“spreads out a net for his steps”

Here Solomon refers to deceiving a person as if someone **spreads out a net** in order to trap their neighbor by **his steps**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [is actually his enemy] or [is like someone who spreads out a net where he knows that his neighbor will walk]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:6 (#1)

בְּפִשְׁעוֹ

“In the transgression of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:6 (#2)

אִישׁ רָרַע & יִצְדִּיק

“an evil man & but a righteous {one}”

Here, **an evil man** and **a righteous one** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a righteous one** in 9:9. Alternate translation: [any evil person ... but any righteous person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:6 (#3)

מִקְקָשׁ

“a snare & is”

Here Solomon speaks of a person causing his life to be in danger as if he were an animal that gets caught in **a snare**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. See how you translated **snare** in 22:25. Alternate translation: [he endangers his life] or [there is danger]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:7 (#4)

דָּלִים

“the lowly”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:7 (#1)

צַדִּיק וְרָשָׁע

“A righteous {one} & a wicked {one}”

See how you translated **A righteous one** in 9:9 and **a wicked one** in 9:7.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:7 (#3)

דִּין

“the legal claim of”

Here, **legal claim** refers to the legal rights of **lowly ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [justice for]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:7 (#5)

רָשָׁע

“a wicked {one}”

This clause is a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, a wicked one]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 29:7 (#2)

יָדָע & דָּעַת

“knows & knowledge”

In this verse, **knows** and **knowledge** refer to having concern for **the legal claim of lowly ones**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is concerned about ... concern]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:8 (#4)

יָשׁוּבוּ אָף

“turn away nose”

Here Solomon refers to people ceasing to feel angry as if they were turning their noses away from the person with whom they are angry. See how you translated the similar phrase “turns away his nose” in 24:18. Alternate translation: [stop others from being angry]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:8 (#1)

אֲנָשִׁי לִלְצוֹן

“Men of mockery”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **Men** who are characterized by **mockery**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Men who are mockers]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:8 (#2)

יִפְתִּיחוּ

“inflammation”

Here Solomon refers to people causing the people in **a city** to become angry and violent as if they were setting the **city** on fire. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [enrage] or [cause turmoil in]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:8 (#3)

קְרִייה

“a city”

Here, **city** refers to the people who live in a **city**. See how you translated the same use of **city** in 11:10.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:9 (#4)

וְאֵין נִחָה

“and there is no rest”

This could mean: (1) there will be no resolution to the **judgment**. Alternate translation: [and they will not be able to settle the problem]; (2) the **foolish** person will not be quiet. Alternate translation: [and will not stop doing so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:9 (#1)

אִישׁ-חָכָם & אִתְּ-אִישׁ אֲוִיל וְרָגַז

“A wise man & with a foolish man, but he rages”

A wise man, **a foolish man**, and **he** represent types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **A wise man** in 16:14. Alternate translation: [Any wise person ... with any foolish person, but that foolish person trembles]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:9 (#3)

וְיִשְׁחַחֵק

“and he laughs”

Here, **laughs** refers to laughing in a mocking manner, not joyful laughter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he laughs mockingly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:9 (#2)

וְרָגַז

“but he rages”

Here, **rages** refers to the **foolish** person gesturing violently because he is angry. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but he gestures violently]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:10 (#3)

אִישׁ־רָאִים יִבְקֹשׁוּ בְנִפְשׁוֹ

“but upright {ones} seek his life”

Here, the phrase **seek his life** refers to: (1) **upright ones** seeking the **life** of a **blameless one** in a good way, that is, desiring to protect his life. Alternate translation: [but upright ones want to protect his life]; (2) **Men of bloodshed** desiring to kill **upright ones**. This would allow the phrase **seek his life** to have its normal meaning of “want to kill him,” but it would force the singular pronoun **his** to refer to the plural phrase, **upright ones**. Alternate translation: [as for upright ones, him they want to kill]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:10 (#1)

אֲנִישֵׁי דָדִמִּים

“Men of bloodshed”

Here Solomon uses the possessive form to refer to **Men** who shed the blood of other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [Men who shed the blood of others] or [Men who kill others]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:10 (#2)

הַתָּם

“a blameless {one}”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:5 and “blameless ones” in 2:21.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:11 (#1)

כִּסְסִיל וְאִחְכָּם

“A stupid {one} & but a wise {one}”

See how you translated **A stupid one** in 10:18 and **a wise one** in 1:5.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:11 (#2)

כָּל־רוּחוֹ יוֹצֵא

“brings out all his spirit”

Here Solomon refers to a person openly expressing **all** of his emotions as if his emotions were a **spirit** that he **brings out** of himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [openly expresses all his emotions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:11 (#3)

בְּאַחֲזֹר יִשְׁבֹּקֶנָה

“soothes it backward”

Here Solomon refers to a person controlling the expression of his emotions as if he **soothes** those emotions so that they go **backward** into him. The meaning of this phrase is the opposite of the meaning of **brings out all his spirit** in the previous clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [restrains himself from openly expressing his emotions]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:12 (#3)

דְּבַר־שֶׁשֶׁקֶר

“a word of falsehood”

See how you translated this phrase in 13:5.

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:12 (#2)

מִקְשֵׁיב עַל

“who listens attentively to”

Here, **listens attentively** implies that this **ruler** believes what he **listens** to. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [who believes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:12 (#1)

מִמְשָׁל & דְּבַר־שֶׁשֶׁקֶר & מִשְׁרֵתְתִי

“A ruler & a word of falsehood & his servants”

A ruler, **a word of falsehood**, and **his** refer to people and false words in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any ruler ... any word of falsehood ... that person's servants]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:13 (#2)

וְאִישׁ תְּכַכְּבִים

“and a man of oppression”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by oppressing other people. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [a man who oppresses others]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:13 (#4)

מִמַּאִיר-עֵינַי שְׁנֵיהֶם

“the one enlightening the eyes of the two of them”

Here, **enlightens the eyes** is an idiom that means “gives life to someone” or “makes someone alive” If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who enables both of them to live]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:13 (#3)

נִפְגְּגוּ

“meet together”

See how you translated the same use of **meet together** in 22:2.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:13 (#1)

רָשׁ וְאִישׁ תְּכַכְּבִים

“A poor one and a man of oppression”

One who is poor and **a man of oppression** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use different more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who is poor and any man of oppression]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:14 (#2)

דָּלִים

“the lowly”

See how you translated the same use of **lowly** in 10:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:14 (#4)

כִּסְאוֹ וְיָכוֹן

“his throne will be established”

See how you translated this phrase in 25:5.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:14 (#1)

מֶלֶךְ וְכִסְאוֹ

“A king & his throne”

A king and **his** refer to kings in general, not a specific king. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **A king** in 29:4. Alternate translation: [Any king ... that king's throne]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:14 (#5)

לְעַד

“to perpetuity”

Solomon uses the phrase **to perpetuity** here as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [for a very long time]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 29:14 (#3)

בְּאֵמֶת

“with truth”

See how you translated the abstract noun **truth** in 8:7.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:15 (#4)

וְתוֹכַחַת וְחִכְמָה & מִבְּרִישׁ

“and rebuke & wisdom & causes & shame”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **rebuke** in 1:25, **wisdom** in 1:2, and **shame** in 6:33.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:15 (#3)

שִׁשְׁבֶּט

“A rod”

See how you translated the same use of **rod** in 10:13 and 13:24.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:15 (#1)

שִׁשְׁבֶּט וְתוֹכַחַת יִתְּנוּ חֵכְמָה

“A rod and rebuke give wisdom”

Solomon is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the next clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A rod and rebuke give a boy wisdom]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 29:15 (#2)

שִׁשְׁבֶּט וְתוֹכַחַת יִתְּנוּ חֵכְמָה

“A rod and rebuke give wisdom”

Here Solomon speaks of people using a **rod and rebuke** to make someone wiser as if a **rod and rebuke** were people who could **give** something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Through discipline and correction parents give a boy wisdom]

See: Personification

Proverbs 29:15 (#5)

וּבִנְעָר & אִמּוֹ

“but a boy & his mother”

Here, **a boy** and **his** refer to children in general, not a specific **boy**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [but any child ... that child’s mother]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:15 (#6)

מִן־שִׁלָּה

“let loose”

Here, **let loose** is an idiom that refers to permitting someone do whatever that person wants to do. If it

would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who is left to himself] or [who is unrestrained]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:15 (#7)

מִן־שִׁלָּה

“let loose”

The expression **let loose** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom his parents let go] or [whom his parents do not discipline]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 29:16 (#3)

בְּמַפְלֵתָם

“see their downfall”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **downfall**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [them being destroyed] or [it when they can no longer rule]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:16 (#2)

פְּשָׁע

“transgression”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:16 (#1)

בְּרִבְבוֹת הָרָשָׁעִים

“When the wicked increase”

Here, **increase** could refer to: (1) **the wicked** increasing their influence or authority in society. Alternate translation: [When wicked ones increase in authority]; (2) the number of **the wicked** increasing. Alternate translation: [When wicked ones increase in number] or [When wicked ones multiply greatly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:16 (#4)

בְּמַפְלֵתָם

“see their downfall”

Here, **downfall** refers to **the wicked** losing the power and influence that is described in the first line of this verse as when they **increase**. Therefore, **downfall** here would have a meaning similar to “fall” in 11:5. Alternate translation: [their loss of power] or [their destruction]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:17 (#2)

יִסְסֵר בְּבֶנֶךָ וְיִנְחָלְךָ

“Discipline your son, and he will cause you to rest”

The word translated as **Discipline** is an imperative, but it communicates a condition rather than a command. If your language does not use an imperative in this way, then use a form in your language that communicates a condition. Alternate translation: [If you discipline your son, then he will cause you to rest]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 29:17 (#4)

וְיִנְחָלְךָ

“and he will cause you to rest”

Here, Solomon is speaking as if being free from worry were actually resting. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will put you at ease] or [and he will make you feel peaceful]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:17 (#6)

לְנַפְשְׁךָ

“to your soul”

See how you translated the same use of **soul** in 2:10. Alternate translation: “to your inner being” or “to you”

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:17 (#3)

וְיִנְחָלְךָ

“and he will cause you to rest”

Here, **and** introduces the result of disciplining one’s **son**. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate result. You may need to start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [As a result, he will cause you to rest]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 29:17 (#5)

וְיִתְּנֶנּוּ מְצֻדָּנִים לְנַפְשְׁךָ

“and he will give delights to your soul”

Here Solomon speaks of a **son** causing his parents to feel delighted as if **delights** were objects that he can **give** to them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: “and he will delight you”

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:17 (#1)

בְּבֶנֶךָ

“your son”

See how you translated the same use of **son** in 1:8.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 29:18 (#5)

וְשָׁמַר תּוֹרָה

“but one keeping the law”

See how you translated the similar phrase “keep the law” in 28:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:18 (#2)

עָמָם

“the people”

See how you translated the same use of **people** in 11:14.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 29:18 (#3)

יִפְּרֹעַ

“are let loose”

Here Solomon refers to **people** acting disorderly or uncontrollably, as if they were **let loose** from being restrained. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [act disorderly] or [are out of control]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:18 (#4)

וְשָׁמַר תּוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר־הוּא

“but one keeping the law, happy {is} he”

Here, **one keeping** and **he** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [but any person who keeps the law, happy is that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:18 (#1)

תְּחִיּוֹן

“vision”

Here, **vision** refers specifically to information that Yahweh reveals to prophets so that they can tell it to **the people**. It is also called “prophecy” or “divine revelation”. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [prophecy] or [revelation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:19 (#4)

מַעֲנָה

“answer”

Here, **answer** refers to the servant responding by obeying. Alternate translation: [obedient response]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:19 (#2)

לֹא־יִנְסָר עֶבֶד

“A servant will not be instructed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [No one can instruct a servant]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 29:19 (#3)

בְּדִבְרֵים

“by words”

See how you translated the similar use of **words** in 1:23.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:19 (#1)

עֶבֶד & יָבִין

“A servant & he understands”

A servant and **he** refer to servants in general, not a specific **servant**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any servant ... that person understands]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:20 (#2)

אִישׁ אֶאֱזֵן בְּדַבְרָיו

“a man hurrying in his words”

See how you translated **a man** and **his** in 6:27.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 29:20 (#1)

הֲזִיתָ אִישׁ אֶאֱזֵן בְּדַבְרָיו

“You see a man hurrying in his words”

Although the Hebrew text is not marked as a question, many translators consider this clause to be a rhetorical question. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this as a question. See how you translated the similar use of **You see** in 22:29. Alternate translation: [Do you see a man hurrying in his words?]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 29:20 (#4)

תִּקְוָה לְכֹסֶסִּיל מִמֶּנּוּ

“There is more} hope for a stupid one than him”

See how you translated this sentence in 26:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:20 (#3)

אִישׁ בְּדַבְרָיו

“hurrying in his words”

Here, **hurrying in his words** is an idiom that means “speaking before thinking about what to say.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [talking off the cuff] or [who speaks without thinking]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:21 (#2)

מִפְּנֵיךְ מִנְעַר עֶבְדְּךָ

“Pampering his servant from youth”

The pronoun **his** refers to the master of the servant, who has not been stated in the verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [If a master pampers his servant from youth]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 29:21 (#3)

מִנְעֹר

“from youth”

See how you translated the abstract noun **youth** in 2:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:21 (#4)

וְאַחֲרֵיתוֹ

“then his end”

Here, **end** refers to the result. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated the same use of **end** in 14:12.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:21 (#1)

מִנְעֹר

“from youth”

Here Solomon implies that **youth** refers to the **youth** of the **servant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [from that servant's youth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:21 (#5)

מָנוֹן

“insolence”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **insolence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [acting disrespectfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:22 (#4)

יִגְרָה מִדִּדּוֹן

“stirs up strife”

See how you translated the same phrase in 15:18.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:22 (#6)

פָּשַׁע

“transgression”

See how you translated the abstract noun **transgression** in 10:19.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:22 (#3)

אִישׁ-אָאָף & וּבִבְעַל הַחֲמָה

“A man of nose & and an owner of heat”

See how you translated the same use of **nose** and **heat** in 22:24.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 29:22 (#2)

אִישׁ-אָאָף & וּבִבְעַל הַחֲמָה

“A man of nose & and an owner of heat”

A man of nose and **an owner of heat** refer to a type of person in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any person of nose ... and any owner of heat]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:22 (#1)

אִישׁ-אָאָף יִגְרָה מִדִּדּוֹן וּבִבְעַל הַחֲמָה רַב-פָּשַׁע

“A man of nose stirs up strife, and an owner of heat, much transgression”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first clause by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** that indicates that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A man of nose stirs up strife; indeed, an owner of heat stirs up much transgression]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 29:22 (#5)

וּבִבְעַל הַחֲמָה רַב-פָּשַׁע

“and an owner of heat, much transgression”

Solomon is leaving out some words in the second clause that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words

from the first clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and an owner of heat stirs up much transgression]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 29:23 (#5)

רָוִיחַ

“spirit”

Here, **spirit** refers to a person’s attitude. See how you translated the same use of **spirit** in 18:14.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:23 (#4)

וְשֹׁפֵל־רָוִיחַ

“but {one} lowly of spirit”

Here, **lowly** refers to being humble. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but one humble of spirit]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:23 (#1)

גִּאְוֹנֹת

“The pride of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **pride** in 8:13.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:23 (#6)

יִתְמַמְדֵּךְ כְּבוֹד

“will grasp honor”

See how you translated this phrase in 11:16.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:23 (#3)

תִּשְׁפִּילֶנּוּ

“will make him low”

Here, **low** refers to being humiliated or ashamed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will make him ashamed]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:23 (#2)

אָדָם תִּשְׁפִּילֶנּוּ וְשֹׁפֵל־רָוִיחַ

“a man will make him low, but {one} lowly of spirit”

Here, **a man**, **him**, and **one** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person will make that person low, but any person lowly of spirit]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:24 (#2)

חֹלֶלֶק עִם־גָּנֵב

“One who shares with a thief”

Here, **shares** implies that this person helps **a thief** and that **thief** gives him part of what he has stolen. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One who helps a thief and shares in his spoil] or [An accomplice of a thief]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:24 (#4)

נַפְשׁוֹ

“his life”

Here, **life** refers to the person himself. See how you translated the same use of **life** in 8:36.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:24 (#3)

שׂוֹנֵא

“hates”

Here Solomon refers to a person doing what is harmful to himself as if he hates himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [harms] or [acts as if he hates]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:24 (#1)

חֹלֶלֶק עִם־גָּנֵב שׂוֹנֵא נַפְשׁוֹ אֶלֶלָּהּ יִשְׁמָע

“One who shares with a thief hates his life; he hears the oath”

One who shares, **a thief**, **his**, and **he** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in

your language. Alternate translation: [Any person who shares with any thief hates that person's own life; that person will hear an oath]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:24 (#5)

אֵלֶּה יִשְׁמָעַע

“he hears the oath”

Here, **oath** refers to the curse that would be spoken against someone who did not speak the truth or reveal important information in a criminal case, as described in Leviticus 5:1–6. The witness who hears this **oath** knows that Yahweh will punish him if he does not speak the truth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he will hear the curse spoken against those who keep silent about the crime] or [he will hear and know that he will be cursed if he does not say anything]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:24 (#6)

וְלֹא יִגִּיד

“but does not tell”

Here Solomon implies that this person **will not tell** anything about the crime that he knows the **thief** has committed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [but will not say what the thief did]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:25 (#1)

חֲרָדָת

“The anxiety of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **anxiety** in 15:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:25 (#3)

יִתֵּן מִקְלָשׁ

“sets a snare”

Here Solomon speaks of someone causing trouble for himself as if his **anxiety** were a person who **sets a snare** that traps him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [causes him to get into trouble] or [is like someone who sets a trap]

See: Personification

Proverbs 29:25 (#2)

אִישׁ וְאֶחָד וְכֹסֵם

“a man & but the one trusting”

Here, **a man** and **one trusting** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any person ... but any person who trusts]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:25 (#4)

יִשָּׁב

“will be set on high”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will set him on high]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 29:25 (#5)

יִשָּׁב

“will be set on high”

See how you translated the same use of **set on high** in 18:10.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:26 (#1)

מְבַקְשֵׁי פְנֵי־מוֹשֵׁל

“are} those who seek the face of a ruler”

Here Solomon implies that these people **seek the face of a ruler** in order to ask him to help them in some way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [are those who seek the face of a ruler to ask for his help]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 29:26 (#5)

מִשְׁפַּט־אִישׁ

“is} justice of a man”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe **justice** that is for the benefit of **a man**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you

could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is justice for a man] or [is justice on behalf of a man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:26 (#4)

מוֹשֵׁל & אִישׁ

“a ruler & a man”

Here, **a ruler** and **a man** refer to rulers and other people in general, not a specific **ruler** or **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any ruler ... any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:26 (#2)

מִבְקֹשִׁים פָּנֵי

“are} those who seek the face of”

Here Solomon speaks of people trying to meet **a ruler** as if the ruler’s **face** were an object that people **seek** to find. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are those who try to meet]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 29:26 (#6)

מִשְׁפָּט

“is} justice of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **justice** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:26 (#3)

פָּנֵי

“the face of”

Here, **face** refers to being in the presence of the person. See how you translated the same use of **face** in 7:15.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 29:27 (#4)

יֵשׁ-דָּרֶךְ

“is} {one} upright of way”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **way** that is characterized by being **upright**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this,

you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is one whose way is upright]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:27 (#1)

תּוֹעֵבָה & תּוֹעֵבָה

“An abomination to & but an abomination to”

See how you translated the abstract noun **abomination** in 3:32.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 29:27 (#2)

אִישׁ צָדִיק וְתוֹעֵבָה רָשָׁע יֵשׁ-דָּרֶךְ

“is} a man of injustice, but an abomination to the wicked {is} {one} upright of way”

Here, **a man of injustice**, **a wicked one**, and **one upright of way** refer to types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. See how you translated **a wicked one** in 9:7. Alternate translation: [is any person of injustice, but an abomination to any wicked person is a person upright of way]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 29:27 (#3)

אִישׁ צָדִיק

“is} a man of injustice”

Here Solomon is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **injustice**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [is an unjust man]

See: Possession

Proverbs 29:27 (#5)

דָּרֶךְ

“way”

Here Solomon uses **way** to refer to how people behave. See how you translated this use of **way** in 1:15.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs - Chapter 30 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Sayings from Agur (30:1–33)

• Agur’s confession and prayer (30:1–9)

- Seven numerical sayings (30:10–31)
- Concluding warning (30:32–33)

Chapter 30 is the chapter in this book written by Agur, who is only mentioned here in the Bible.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Numerical sayings

In Proverbs 30:10–31, Agur uses a rhetorical device in which he names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If your language does not use numbers in this way, then consider more natural ways to express the emphasis. Although he does not state the number of illustrations in 30:10–14, he does state the number of illustrations for the sayings in 30:15–16, 18–19, 21–23, 24–28, and 29–31.

Proverbs 30:1 (#1)

דְּבָרִי

“The words of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:1 (#5)

לְאִיתִיָּאֵל לְאִיתִיָּאֵל וְאֶקַּל

“to Ithiel, to Ithiel and Ucal”

All Hebrew manuscripts read **to Ithiel, to Ithiel and Ucal**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient translations of this text read “I am weary, O God. I am worn out and weary, O God,” which is based on a possible meaning for the Hebrew words. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 30:1 (#4)

הַחֲזָקִי

“the strong man”

Here, **the strong man** refers to **Agur**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Agur, the strong man,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:1 (#2)

אֶגְגֹּר & יִקְלָהּ & לְאִיתִיָּאֵל לְאִיתִיָּאֵל וְאֶקַּל

“Agur & Jakeh & to Ithiel, to Ithiel and Ucal”

Agur, Jakeh, Ithiel, and Ucal are names of men.

See: How to Translate Names

Proverbs 30:1 (#3)

הַמְחִשָּׁא

“the burden”

Here, **burden** refers to a warning message that Yahweh reveals to prophets so that they can tell the warning to other people. Because this message contained a warning or threat, it was considered to be a **burden** to the person who heard it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the warning from Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:2 (#2)

כִּנְיָ

“Surely”

30:2–33 is a long quotation of what Agur said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Proverbs 30:2 (#5)

בִּינְנָה

“the understanding of”

See how you translated the abstract noun **understanding** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 30:2 (#1)

בְּבֶעַר אֲנֹכְכִי מֵאִישׁ וְלֹא־בִינְנָה אֲדִידָם לִי

“I {am} more stupid than a man, and the understanding of man {is} not mine”

Agur says these two clauses as extreme statements for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [I feel like I am more stupid than a man, and that the understanding of mankind is not mine]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 30:2 (#3)

בְּבֶעַר אֲנֹכְכִי מֵאִישׁ וְלֹא־בִינְנָה אֲדִידָם לִי

“I {am} more stupid than a man, and the understanding of man {is} not mine”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I am more stupid than a man; indeed, the understanding of mankind is not mine]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:2 (#4)

מֵאִישׁ & אָדָם

“than a man & man”

In this verse, **man** refers to people in general, not to a specific **man**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [than any person ... any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:3 (#2)

חֵכְמָה וְדַעַת

“wisdom, nor the knowledge of”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **wisdom** in 1:2 and **knowledge** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 30:3 (#3)

קִדְשִׁים

“holy ones”

Here, **holy ones** could refer to: (1) Yahweh as the Holy One, in which case the plural form is used to emphasize his greatness. Alternate translation: [the Holy One]; (2) heavenly beings, including God and angels. Alternate translation: [holy beings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:3 (#1)

וְלֹא-לִמְדָתִי חֵכְמָה וְדַעַת קִדְשִׁים אָדָּע

“And I have not learned wisdom, nor the knowledge of holy ones do I know”

Agur says these two clauses as extreme statements for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And I feel like I have not learned wisdom, nor the knowledge of holy ones do I know]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 30:4 (#1)

מִי עָלָה-שָׁמַיִם | וַיֵּרֵד מִי אֲסַף-רִירוֹה | בְּהַפְנֹי מִי צִרְרֵי-מַמִּים | בְּשִׁמְלָלָה מִי הַקִּיקִים כָּל-אַפְסֵי-אֲרָץ מִה-שָׁמַיִם וּמִה-שָׁמַיִם

“Who has ascended {to} heaven and descended? Who has gathered the wind in the hollow of his hands? Who has wrapped waters in the cloak? Who has raised up all the ends of the earth? What {is} his name? And what {is} the name of his son”

In this verse, the writer uses the question form six times to emphasize how much greater Yahweh is than people. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation, as in the UST.

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 30:4 (#6)

מִי הַקִּיקִים כָּל-אַפְסֵי-אֲרָץ

“Who has raised up all the ends of the earth”

Here, Agur speaks of setting the boundaries of the dry land on **the earth** as if the **ends of the earth** were something that a person could raise **up**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has set up the limits for where the land ends] or [has marked the boundaries for the ends of the earth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:4 (#3)

מִי אֲסַף-רִירוֹה | בְּהַפְנֹי

“Who has gathered the wind in the hollow of his hands”

Here, Agur speaks of controlling **the wind** as if it were something that a person could catch and hold in the palm of one's hand. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Who has controlled the wind]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:4 (#4)

בְּהַפְנֹי

“in the hollow of his hands”

Here, the word translated **hollow** refers to the palm of someone's hand. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [in the palms of his hands]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:4 (#5)

מִי צָרַר־מַיִם | בְּשִׁמְלָה

“Who has wrapped waters in the cloak”

Here, Agur speaks of storing rainwater in clouds as if the **waters** were something that a person could wrap inside a **cloak**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. If a translation is available in your language, see the similar use of **waters** in Job 26:8. Alternate translation: [Who has stored the water in clouds]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:4 (#2)

עֲלֶה־שָׁמַיִם | וְיֵרֵד

“has ascended {to} heaven and descended”

Here, Agur speaks of someone going to the place where God dwells and returning from there as if **heaven** were a place that someone could go up to or come down from. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has gone to and returned from the place where Yahweh dwells]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:4 (#7)

מִה־שֵׁמוֹ וּמִה־שֵׁם־בָּבִנוּ כִּי תֵדַע

“What {is} his name? And what {is} the name of his son? Surely you know”

Agur uses irony here to emphasize that no one knows of any person who can do those things described earlier in the verse, because such a person does not exist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Surely, none of you knows the name of someone who has done this or the name of his son, so you cannot claim to know a lot about God]

See: Irony

Proverbs 30:5 (#1)

צָרֻפָּה

“is refined”

Here Agur speaks of the truth of God's words as if his sayings were metal that contained no impurities. See how you translated the phrase “refined gold” in 8:19. Alternate translation: [is tested and proven to be true]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:5 (#2)

מִגֵּן ה'וּא

“he {is} a shield”

Here, Agur speaks of **God** protecting people as if he were a **shield**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he is a protector]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:5 (#3)

לְחַסְסִים בּוֹ

“for those who take refuge in him”

Here, Agur speaks of people trusting **God** to protect them as if he were a shelter in which people **take refuge**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for those who rely on him to protect them]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:6 (#1)

אַל־תִּתְּסֶה עַל־דְּבָרָיו

“Do not add upon his words”

Here, Agur refers to someone claiming God said something that he did not say as if that person were adding more **words** to what God has said. Here, **words** refers to what is said, as in 1:23. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not claim that God has said something that he did not really say]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:6 (#2)

וְנִבְזָה

“and you be shown a liar”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he show you to be a liar]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:7 (#1)

מֵאִתְּךָ

“from with you”

The pronoun **you** refers to God. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Use the form of address that is appropriate for addressing God in your language. Alternate translation: [from you, God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 30:7 (#2)

אַל־תִּמְנַע

“do not withhold”

This phrase is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please do not withhold]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 30:7 (#3)

אַל־תִּמְנַע

“do not withhold”

Agur is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [do not withhold these two things I request]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 30:7–9 (#1)

שְׁתֵּים שְׂאֵלְתִי מֵאִתְּךָ

“Two things I ask from with you”

These three verses are a prayer that Agur prays to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Two things I ask from you, O Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:8 (#10)

לֶלֶם

“the bread of”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 30:8 (#3)

שְׁוֵא

“Emptiness”

Emptiness here refers to dishonesty or deception. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Dishonesty]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:8 (#2)

שְׁוֵא | וְדִבַּר־כְּזָב הִרְחַק מִמֶּנִּי

“Emptiness and the word of a lie put far away from me”

Here, Agur speaks of **Emptiness** and **the word of a lie** as if they were objects that could be **put far away from** a person. He means that he wants God to prevent him from acting or speaking with **Emptiness and the word of a lie**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Keep me from acting with emptiness and speaking the word of a lie]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:8 (#6)

רִבְאֵשׁ נֹעֵשׂר אֶל־תִּתֶּן־לִּי הִסְטִיר־פָּנֶי לֶלֶם חֶקִי

“Do not give to me poverty or riches; cause me to receive the bread of my portion”

These two clauses are imperative clauses, but they communicate polite requests rather than commands. Use a form in your language that communicates polite requests. It may be helpful to add expressions such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please do not give to me poverty or riches; please cause me to receive the bread of my portion]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 30:8 (#7)

רִבְאֵשׁ נֹעֵשׂר אֶל־תִּתֶּן־לִּי

“Do not give to me poverty or riches”

Here, Agur speaks of being poor or rich as if **poverty** and **riches** were physical objects that someone could **give** to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not allow me to be poor or rich]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:8 (#5)

וְדָבַר

“and the word of”

See how you translated the same use of **word** in 12:25.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:8 (#1)

שְׁשׂוּאָהּ | וְדָבַר-קִזְזָב הִרְחַלְתָּ מִמֶּנִּי

“Emptiness and the word of a lie put far away from me”

This is an imperative clause, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please put far away from me emptiness and the word of a lie]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Proverbs 30:8 (#8)

לֶלֶחֶם חֲקִי

“the bread of my portion”

This could refer to: (1) an amount of **bread** that Yahweh has allotted for Agur. Alternate translation: [the bread you have apportioned for me]; (2) the amount of **bread** Agur needs to live. Alternate translation: [the bread I need]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:8 (#4)

וְדָבַר-קִזְזָב

“and the word of a lie”

Here, Agur is using the possessive form to describe a **word** that is a **lie**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and a lying word]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:8 (#9)

הִתְקַרִּיפֶנִּי

“cause me to receive”

This clause is a contrast to the previous clause. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [rather, cause me to receive] or [cause me to receive instead]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 30:9 (#1)

פָּנֹן אֶשְׂבֹּעַ | וְכַחֲשֵׁיתִי וְאֶמְרֵתִי

“Lest I be satiated, and I deny and say”

Agur is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first makes a request of God so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the request. Alternate translation: [otherwise I may become satiated and deny and say]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 30:9 (#6)

וּפְדֵי-אֲוִרָיִךְ וְגִנְגַּבְתִּי וְחִתְפֹּפְשֵׁתִי

“And lest I become dispossessed and steal, and I seize”

Agur is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first makes a request of God so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the request. Alternate translation: [otherwise I may become dispossessed and steal and seize]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 30:9 (#2)

אֶשְׂבֹּעַ

“I be satiated”

Here, **satiated** refers to having too much food and possessions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I possess too much]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:9 (#7)

אֲוִרָיִךְ

“I become dispossessed”

Here, **dispossessed** refers to someone becoming so poor that he loses everything that he owns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [I become so poor that I own nothing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:9 (#8)

וְחִתְפֹּפְשֵׁתִי

“and I seize”

Here, **and** introduces the result of stealing. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate results. Alternate translation: [and so I seize]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 30:9 (#10)

שֵׁטֶם

“the name of”

Here, **name** refers to a person’s reputation. See how you translated the same use of **name** in 22:1.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:9 (#9)

וְהִתְפַּשְׁתִּי

“and I seize”

Here, Agur speaks of disgracing **the name of my God** as if **the name** were an object that someone could violently **seize** and hurt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I might disgrace]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:9 (#3)

וְכִחַשְׁתִּי

“and I deny”

Agur is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I deny Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 30:9 (#5)

מִי יִהְיֶה

“Who {is} Yahweh”

Agur is using the question form to emphasize what might happen to him if he became too rich. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I do not know Yahweh!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 30:9 (#4)

וְאָמַרְתִּי מִי יִהְיֶה

“and say, ‘Who {is} Yahweh’”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and ask what importance Yahweh has.]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 30:10 (#1)

עֶבֶד אֶל־אֲדֹנָיו & יְקַלְלֶךָ

“a slave to his master & he curse you”

Here, **a slave**, **his**, and **he** refer to slaves in general, not a specific **slave**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any slave to that slave’s master ... that slave curse you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:10 (#2)

וְאִשְׁמָתָהּ

“and you be found guilty”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people consider you to be guilty]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:10 (#3)

וְאִשְׁמָתָהּ

“and you be found guilty”

Agur implies that this person is **guilty** of slandering. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and you be found guilty of slander]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:11 (#3)

אֲבִירִי יְקַלְלֵל וְאֵת־אִמִּי מִלֹּא יְבָרֵךְ

“it curses its father and does not bless its mother”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine these clauses and express the emphasis in another

way. Alternate translation: [it regularly curses its father and mother]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:11 (#2)

דָּוֹר אֲבִיבֵי יִקְלָלִל & אִמָּמוֹ

“There is} a generation, it curses its father & its mother”

In this verse, the words **generation**, **it**, and **its** are singular in form, but they refer to some people as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [There is a group of people, those people curse their fathers ... their mothers]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 30:11 (#1)

דָּוֹר אֲבִיבֵי יִקְלָלִל וְאֵת־אִמָּמוֹ לֹא יְבָרֵךְ

“There is} a generation, it curses its father and does not bless its mother”

30:11-14 is the first of six numerical sayings in this chapter, even though this saying does not state the number of illustrations. See the discussion of this in the introduction for this chapter.

Proverbs 30:12 (#2)

טָהוֹר

“clean”

Here, Agur speaks of people being innocent of doing anything wrong as if those people were **clean**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [innocent]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:12 (#3)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in its eyes”

See how you translated the same use of **eyes** in 3:4.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:12 (#4)

וְאִמָּצָאתָ לֹא רָחֵץ

“but it is not washed from its excrement”

Here, Agur speaks of people being guilty of doing something wrong as if those people were **not washed**

and as if the wrong things they did were **excrement**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but it is guilty of doing bad things] or [but it is guilty, as if it has not washed off its excrement]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:12 (#5)

לֹא רָחֵץ

“it is not washed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [it has not washed itself]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:12 (#1)

דָּוֹר & בְּעֵינָיו וְאִמָּצָאתָ לֹא רָחֵץ

“There is} a generation & in its eyes, but it is not washed from its excrement”

See how you translated the same use of **generation**, **it**, and **its** in the previous verse.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 30:13 (#2)

מִה־רָמְמוֹ עֵינָיו וְאִעָפְפוּ יְנֵשָׁאוּ

“how its eyes are raised up, and its eyelids are lifted up”

Here, **how** indicates that what follows is an exclamation that emphasizes the pride of this **generation**. Use an exclamation that would communicate that meaning in your language. Alternate translation: [its eyes are so raised up, and their eyelids are so lifted up]

See: Exclamations

Proverbs 30:13 (#1)

דָּוֹר & עֵינָיו וְאִעָפְפוּ יְנֵשָׁאוּ

“There is} a generation & its eyes & and its eyelids”

See how you translated the same use of **generation** and **its** in 30:11.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 30:13 (#4)

רָמְמוֹ עֵינָיו וְאִעָפְפוּ יְנֵשָׁאוּ

“its eyes are raised up, and its eyelids are lifted up”

The phrases **eyes are raised up** and **eyelids are lifted up** mean similar things. Agur is using the two phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [how completely proud they are]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:13 (#3)

רממו עיניו וְעָפְפוּ עָיוֹ יְנִשְׂאוּ

“its eyes are raised up, and its eyelids are lifted up”

Here, Agur refers to pride as **eyes** that **are raised up** and **eyelids** that **are lifted up**, which is are characteristic facial expressions of proud people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [proud they are, and they are arrogant]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:14 (#2)

תִּרְבֹּבוּת שִׁנָּיו וְמַאֲכָלֹת מִתְלַעֲעֵתָיו לֶאֱכָל

“its teeth {are} swords and its fangs {are} knives for devouring”

Here, Agur refers to people who oppress **the afflicted** and **the needy** as if they were wild animals that are **devouring** those people by using **teeth** or **fangs** that are dangerous like **swords** or **knives**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [it cruelly oppresses] or [it oppresses others like a wild animal that uses sword-like teeth or knife-like fangs to consume]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:14 (#4)

עֲנִיִּים מֵאֶרֶץ וְאַבְיוֹנִים מֵאָדָם

“the afflicted from the earth and the needy from man”

The phrases **afflicted ones from the earth** and **needy ones from man** mean the same thing. Agur is using the two phrases together for emphasis. Here, **the afflicted** and **the needy** both refer to poor people. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [poor people from the world]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:14 (#1)

דָּדוֹר & שִׁנָּיו מִתְלַעֲעֵתָיו

“There is} a generation, its teeth & its fangs”

See how you translated the same use of **generation** and **its** in 30:11.

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 30:14 (#3)

תִּרְבֹּבוּת שִׁנָּיו וְמַאֲכָלֹת מִתְלַעֲעֵתָיו

“its teeth {are} swords and its fangs {are} knives”

The phrases **its teeth are swords** and **its fangs are knives** mean the same thing. Agur is using the two phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [its teeth are very sharp]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:14 (#5)

מֵאָדָם

“from man”

Here, **man** refers to all people in general, not a specific **man**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [from mankind] or [from all human beings]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:15 (#6)

לֹא תִשְׂבֶּעַנָּה

“are not satisfied”

The expression **are not satisfied** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [never have enough for themselves]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:15 (#2)

לְעִלּוֹקָה

“are} to the leech”

A **leech** is a type of worm that attaches itself to the skin of a person or animal in order to suck blood. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Al-

ternate translation: [are for the blood-sucking animal]
or [are for the parasite]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:15 (#4)

שְׁלֹשׁ הַהֲנָה לֹא תִשְׂבַּעְנָה אֲרֻבָּע לֹא-אֶמְרוּ הֵן

“There are} three, they are not satisfied; four, they do not say, ‘Enough”

The second half of 30:15 and all of 30:16 are the second of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the Chapter Introduction.

Proverbs 30:15 (#3)

הֵבֵב | הֵבֵב

“Give! Give”

This could refer to: (1) the names of the **Two daughters**. Alternate translation: [they are named Give and Give]; (2) what the **Two daughters** say. Alternate translation: [they say, ‘Give! Give]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:15 (#5)

שְׁלֹשׁ הַהֲנָה לֹא תִשְׂבַּעְנָה אֲרֻבָּע לֹא-אֶמְרוּ הֵן

“There are} three, they are not satisfied; four, they do not say, ‘Enough”

To make a comprehensive statement, Agur is using a poetic form in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. Since the meaning of both clauses is the same, you could also combine them into one clause. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [These four things are absolutely never satisfied]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:15 (#1)

לְעֹלֵקָהּ | שְׁתֵּי בָנוֹת

“Two daughters {are} to the leech”

Here, Agur speaks of greedy people as if they were **daughters** of a **leech**. Leeches and greedy people are similar because they both live off of what they take from others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Greedy people always say] or

[Greedy people are like a leech with two daughters that say]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:16 (#3)

וְעֵצָר רָחֵם

“and the closure of the womb”

Here, **the closure of the womb** refers to the inability of the woman to conceive or bear a child. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a woman unable to bear a child]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:16 (#1)

וְעֵצָר רָחֵם אֲרִיז לֹא-שִׂבְעָה מַיִם וְאֵשׁ

“and the closure of the womb, a land not satisfied with water, and a fire”

Here, **the womb**, **a land**, and **a fire** refer to these things in general, not specific things. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [and the closure of any womb, any land not satisfied with water, and any fire]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:16 (#2)

וְעֵצָר

“and the closure of”

Here Agur refers to a woman being unable to bear children as if her **womb** were closed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the barrenness of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:16 (#5)

וְאֵשׁ לֹא-אֶמְרָה הֵן

“and a fire—it does not say, ‘Enough”

Here, Agur speaks of **fire** requiring fuel to keep burning as if it were a person who never says **Enough**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a fire that never stops needing fuel to keep burning]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:16 (#4)

אֲרֶץ לֹא־שִׂבְעָה מַמִּים

“a land not satisfied with water”

Here, Agur speaks of **land** that does not have enough **water** to grow crops as if it were a person who does not have enough water to drink. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a land that never gets enough water to grow crops]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:17 (#2)

עֵיִן

“An eye”

Here, **eye** represents the attitude of a person, as displayed in the eyes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Anyone who has an evil eye and so] or [A person who]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:17 (#5)

יִקְרְרוּהָ עֲרֵבֵי־נִגְחַל וַיֹּאכְלֶיהָ בְּנֵי־נָשָׁר

“the ravens of the valley will peck it out, and the sons of the vulture will eat it”

Here, Agur is continuing to speak about the mocking and contemptuous **eye** as if it were the problem, rather than the person with those attitudes. If you have chosen to refer to the person directly rather than to the eye of the person in this verse, you could also state the meaning of this part of the verse plainly. Alternate translation: [he will be eaten by scavengers] or [this person will be punished severely]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:17 (#6)

יִקְרְרוּהָ עֲרֵבֵי־נִגְחַל

“the ravens of the valley will peck it out”

Since **ravens** and vultures usually eat dead animals, Agur implies here that this person will be killed before the birds eat him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that person will die and the ravens of the valley will peck out that person's eye]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:17 (#4)

עֲרֵבֵי־נִגְחַל & נָשָׁר

“the ravens of the valley & the vulture”

Both **the ravens** and **the vulture** refer to large birds that eat dead animals. If your readers would not be familiar with these types of birds, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [birds that scavenge in the valley ... other birds that scavenge] or [scavenger birds ... scavenger birds]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:17 (#1)

עֵיִן | תִּלְעַעַג לְאָבִי

“An eye mocks a father”

Agur is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Concerning an eye that mocks a father]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 30:17 (#3)

לְאָבִי & לְאִמִּי

“a father & to} a mother”

Here Agur implies that **a father** and **a mother** are the parents of the person who **mocks** and **shows contempt**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that person's father ... to that person's mother]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:17 (#7)

בְּנֵי־נָשָׁר

“the sons of the vulture”

Here Agur refers to young vultures as if they were **sons** from the **vulture** family. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the young vultures]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:18 (#2)

שְׁלֹשָׁה הֵמָּה נִפְלְאוּ מִמֶּנִּי וָאַרְבַּע

“Three things, they {are} too wonderful for me, and four”

This is poetic language. If your language has a way to indicate poetry, you could use it here. To make a comprehensive statement, Agur is using a poetic form in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar use of **Three things** and **four** in 30:15. Alternate translation: [These four things are absolutely too wonderful for me]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 30:18 (#1)

שְׁלֹשָׁה הַהִמָּה נִפְלְאוּ מִמֶּנִּי וָאַרְבַּע לֹא יָדַעְתִּים

“Three things, they {are} too wonderful for me, and four, I do not understand them”

30:18–19 is the third of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the Chapter Introduction.

Proverbs 30:19 (#7)

וְדֶרֶךְ גִּבּוֹר בְּעֶלְמָה

“and the way of a young man with a young woman”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that **a young man** interacts **with a young woman**. This refers to a young couple’s loving relationship, which would include sexual relations. Alternate translation: [and the way that a young man lovingly interacts with a young woman]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:19 (#6)

בְּלִב־יָם

“in the heart of the sea”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:34.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:19 (#5)

דֶּרֶךְ־אֲנִיָּה

“the way of a ship”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that **a ship** sails **in the heart of the sea**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the way that a ship sails]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:19 (#1)

דֶּרֶךְ & דֶּרֶךְ & דֶּרֶךְ & וְדֶרֶךְ

“the way of & the way of & the way of & and the way of”

In this verse, **way** refers to the manner of doing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the manner of ... the manner of ... the manner of ... and the manner of]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:19 (#4)

דֶּרֶךְ נָחָשׁ עַל־לֵי צִוִּיר

“the way of a snake on a rock”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that **a snake** slithers **on a rock**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the way that a snake slithers on a rock]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:19 (#3)

דֶּרֶךְ הַנֶּנֶשֶׁר | בַּשָּׁמַיִם

“the way of the eagle in the sky”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **the way** that **the eagle** flies **in the sky**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [the way that the eagle flies in the sky]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:19 (#2)

הַנֶּנֶשֶׁר & נָחָשׁ & אֲנִיָּה & יָם & גִּבּוֹר בְּעֶלְמָה

“the eagle & a snake & a ship & the sea & a young man with a young woman”

These phrases refer to these things or people in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any eagle ... any snake ... any ship ... any sea ... any young man with any young woman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:20 (#3)

אֲכָלָה וּמָחָהָהּ פִּיָּהּ

“She eats and wipes her mouth”

Agur is referring to an adulterous **woman** easily committing **adultery** as if she were eating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [she commits adultery easily] or [she is like a woman who eats and wipes her mouth]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:20 (#2)

אִשָּׁה וְאָכְלָה וּמָחָה פִּיהָ & אִשָּׁה

“a woman & She eats and wipes her mouth”

Here, **a woman**, **she**, and **her** refer to a type of women in general, not a specific **woman**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any woman ... that woman eats and wipes her mouth]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:20 (#1)

דֶּרֶךְ

“is} the way of”

See how you translated the same use of **way** in the previous verse.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:20 (#4)

וְאָמְרָה לֹא־פָעַלְתִּי אֵוֹן

“and says, ‘I have not done iniquity’”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and says that she has not done iniquity]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Proverbs 30:20 (#5)

אֵוֹן

“iniquity”

See how you translated the abstract noun **iniquity** in 6:12.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 30:21 (#3)

וְתַתַּח & וְתַתַּח

“Under & and under”

Here, Agur is speaking of several things that people cannot tolerate as if they were standing **under** them.

Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Regarding ... and regarding]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:21 (#4)

רָגְזָה אֶרֶץ & לֹא־תִכְבֵּל שָׂאָה

“the earth quakes & it is not able to hold up”

Here, Agur is speaking as if **the earth quakes** and **is not able to hold up** to express how much people in general dislike the things he is about to mention. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people shudder ... they cannot endure]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:21 (#1)

תַּתַּח שְׁשָׁלוֹשׁ רָגְזָה אֶרֶץ וְתַתַּח אַרְבָּע לֹא־תִכְבֵּל שָׂאָה

“Under three things the earth quakes, and under four it is not able to hold up”

30:21–23 is the fourth of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the introduction for this chapter.

Proverbs 30:21 (#2)

תַּתַּח שְׁשָׁלוֹשׁ רָגְזָה אֶרֶץ וְתַתַּח אַרְבָּע לֹא־תִכְבֵּל שָׂאָה

“Under three things the earth quakes, and under four it is not able to hold up”

This is poetic language. If your language has a way to indicate poetry, you could use it here. To make a comprehensive statement, Agur is using a poetic form in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Since the meaning of both clauses is similar, you could also combine them into one clause. See how you translated the similar use of **three things** and **four** in 30:15. Alternate translation: [Under these four things the earth truly shakes]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 30:22 (#1)

תַּתַּח

“under”

See how you translated **under** in 30:21.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:22 (#4)

לֶחֶם

“bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 30:22 (#2)

עֶבֶד כִּי יִמְלֹךְ וְאִנּוֹכִי כִּי יִשְׂבֹּעַ

“a slave when he becomes king and a worthless one when he is satisfied with”

Here, **a slave**, **he**, and **a worthless one** refer types of people in general, not specific people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any slave when that slave becomes king, and any worthless one when that person is satisfied with]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:22 (#3)

יִשְׂבֹּעַ

“he is satisfied with”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he gets enough]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:23 (#4)

תִּירַשׁ גְּבֵרָתָהּ

“she dispossesses her mistress”

Here, **dispossesses** refers to **a female servant** replacing her master’s wife as the lead woman of the household. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she becomes her master’s wife in place of her mistress]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:23 (#2)

שְׂשֻׁנוּאָה כִּי תִבְעַעַל וְאִשָּׁה־לִּירֶשׁ כִּי־תִירַשׁ גְּבֵרָתָהּ

“a hated woman when she is married and a female servant when she dispossesses her mistress”

Here, **a hated woman**, **she**, and **a female servant**, and **her** refer to types of women in general, not specific women. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any hated woman when that woman is married, and any female servant when that servant dispossesses her mistress]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:23 (#3)

כִּי תִבְעַעַל

“when she is married”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when someone marries her]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 30:23 (#1)

תַּתֶּחַת

“under”

See how you translated **under** in 30:21.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:24 (#2)

קִטְנֵי־אָרֶץ

“are} small things of the earth”

Here Agur is using the possessive form to describe **small things** that exist on **the earth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [are small things that exist on the earth]

See: Possession

Proverbs 30:24 (#3)

הַכְּמִיִּים מְהֻמָּיִם

“are} wise things, being made wise”

Here, **wise things, being made wise** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [are wise, very skilled]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 30:24 (#1)

אַרְבַּעַת הָהֶם קְטַנֵּי־אָרֶץ וְהֵלֶכֶה חֲכָמִים מֵחֲכָמִים

“Four things, they {are} small things of the earth but they {are} wise things, being made wise”

30:24-28 is the fifth of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the Chapter Introduction.

Proverbs 30:25 (#2)

וַיַּכְיֶנּוּ בַקֶּיֶץ לֶחֶם

“but they prepare their food in the summer”

See how you translated the similar phrase “prepares its bread in the summer” in 6:8.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:25 (#1)

עַם

“are} a people”

Here Agur refers to the whole species of **ants** as if they were a group of **people**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are a species]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:26 (#1)

שִׁשְׁפִּינִים

“Rock badgers”

Rock badgers are small animals also called “hyraxes” that live in the cracks between rocks in the wilderness. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [Small mammals that live among rocks]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:26 (#4)

בֵּיתָם

“their house”

Here Agur refers to the places where **Rock badgers** live as if those places were houses such as humans live in. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their dwelling places] or [their holes]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:26 (#3)

בֵּיתָם בְּתֵלָה

“their house in the cliff”

Although **house** and **the cliff** are singular, they refer to these things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [their houses in the cliffs]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:26 (#2)

עַם

“are} a people”

See how you translated the same use of **people** in the previous verse.

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:27 (#1)

לְאַרְבֵּבָהּ & כָּלֹו

“for the locust & each of it”

Here, **the locust** and **it** represent locusts in general, not one particular **locust**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [for locusts ... every one of them]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:27 (#2)

וַיֵּצֵא הַצֵּבִי

“but & goes out divided {into groups”

Here Agur speaks of the orderly ways that locusts travel as if they were an army of soldiers who **go out divided into groups**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [but ... move together in an organized manner] or [but ... march ahead like ranks of soldiers]

See: Personification

Proverbs 30:28 (#1)

שִׁשְׁמִית & וְהֵיאָהּ & מֶלֶךְ

“a lizard & yet it & the king”

Here, **a lizard**, **it**, and **the king** represent lizards and kings in general, not one particular **lizard** or **king**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any lizard ... yet any lizard ... any king]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:28 (#2)

שִׁשְׁמִית

“a lizard”

A **lizard** is a small animal that crawls on the ground and can hide in houses. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a gecko] or [a small crawling reptile]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:29 (#4)

שְׁלֹשָׁה הֵמָּה מִיִּטְטִיבִי צָצַעַד וְאֶרְבֻּעָה מִיִּטְטִיבִי לָכֵת

“Three things, they are doing well of step, and four are doing well of walking”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Three things, they are doing well of step, indeed, four are doing well of walking]

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 30:29 (#2)

שְׁלֹשָׁה הֵמָּה מִיִּטְטִיבִי צָצַעַד וְאֶרְבֻּעָה מִיִּטְטִיבִי לָכֵת

“Three things, they are doing well of step, and four are doing well of walking”

This is poetic language. If your language has a way to indicate poetry, you could use it here. To make a comprehensive statement, Agur is using a poetic form in which the speaker names a number that should be sufficient to illustrate his point and then increases that number by one for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Since the meaning of both clauses is the same, you could also combine them into one clause. See how you translated the similar use of **Three things** and **four** in 30:15. Alternate translation: [These four things truly walk well]

See: Poetry

Proverbs 30:29 (#3)

מִיִּטְטִיבִי צָצַעַד & מִיִּטְטִיבִי לָכֵת

“are doing well of step & are doing well of walking”

The phrases **doing well of step** and **doing well of walking** both refer to animals or people who walk impressively. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [walk in an impressive manner ... stride in a stately manner]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 30:29 (#1)

שְׁלֹשָׁה הֵמָּה מִיִּטְטִיבִי צָצַעַד וְאֶרְבֻּעָה מִיִּטְטִיבִי לָכֵת

“Three things, they are doing well of step, and four are doing well of walking”

30:29–31 is the sixth of six numerical sayings in this chapter. See the discussion of numerical sayings in the Chapter Introduction.

Proverbs 30:30 (#1)

לֵיִשׁ & וְלֹא־יִשְׁטוּב

“a lion & it will not turn away”

Here, **a lion** and **it** refer to lions in general, not a specific **lion**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any lion ... and that lion will not turn away]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:30 (#3)

וְלֹא־יִשְׁטוּב מִפְּנֵי

“and it will not turn away from the face of”

Here, **turn away from the face** means “does not run away from” because one would have to **turn** one’s face away from the **face** of someone in order to run away from that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will not run away from]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 30:30 (#2)

גִּבּוֹר בְּבֵהֵמָה

“mighty among the animals”

Here, **mighty among the animals** refers to being the mightiest animal among them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the mightiest animal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 30:31 (#2)

וְרוֹזֵזִיר מִתְנַנִּים

“a rooster of loins”

Many scholars believe that the word translated as **a rooster** refers to a fighting cock, which is a type of rooster. Roosters are male birds that walk around in a proud manner and some are trained to fight each other. Some have coloring that makes them appear to be wearing protective fighting clothing, which may explain the phrase **of loins**, which would refer to a man prepared for battle. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Other scholars believe that this word may refer to some other animal. If a Bible translation exists in your region, you may want to use the translation that it uses. Alternate translation: [strutting roosters] or [a male bird that struts proudly]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 30:31 (#3)

אֶלְקָקִים עֲמֹו

“against whom one does not rise up”

The phrase translated as **against whom one does not rise up** could also be translated as “whose army is with him.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

Proverbs 30:31 (#1)

וְרוֹזֵזִיר מִתְנַנִּים אִו־תִּתִּישׁ וְאֶלְקָקִים עֲמֹו

“a rooster of loins, or a male goat, and a king against whom one does not rise up”

Here, **one girded of loins, a male goat, a king**, and **one** refer to animals or people in general, not specific animals or people. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [those girded of loins, or any male goat, and any king against whom any person does not rise up]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 30:32 (#2)

יֵד לִפִּי

“a hand {be} to mouth”

Here Agur uses the phrase **a hand be to mouth** to refer to telling someone to stop doing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [stop doing those things]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:32 (#1)

כִּהֲתַנְשִׁיא

“by lifting up yourself”

Here Agur speaks of someone honoring himself as if he were **lifting up** himself for everyone to see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by honoring yourself]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:33 (#2)

מִמֵּיִן חִלְלָב יִוצֵאִי תַמְאָה וּמִי־אַאֲף יִוצֵאִי דָם וּמִמֵּיִן אֶאֱפִים יִוצֵאִי רִיב

“the squeezing of milk brings out butter, and the squeezing of the nose brings out blood, and the squeezing of nostrils brings out strife”

Here, Agur mentions three cause-and-effect relationships in order to teach that doing what he described in the previous verse will have bad results. The third phrase is what will happen if a person continues to do the things mentioned in verse 32. That is, if he continues to exalt himself or make evil schemes, people will become angry with him and start to fight with him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a simile. Alternate translation: [just like the squeezing of milk brings out butter, and the squeezing of the nose brings out blood, and the squeezing of nostrils brings out strife, that is what will happen if you keep doing these things]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:33 (#4)

וּמִמֵּיִן אֶאֱפִים

“and the squeezing of nostrils”

Here, the phrase **squeezing of nostrils** is a common expression of the culture that means that the person is becoming angry. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation:

[and making people foam at the mouth] or [and angering people]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 30:33 (#5)

יִזְצִיחַ רִיב

“brings out strife”

Here, Agur refers to causing people to argue as if **strife** were an object that someone **brings out**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes strife between people]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 30:33 (#6)

רִיב

“strife”

See how you translated the abstract noun **strife** in 16:28.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 30:33 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

For here introduces the reason for obeying the command stated in the previous verse. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate reason. Alternate translation: [Stop doing these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Proverbs 30:33 (#3)

מִמֵּיץ הַחֵלֶב יִזְצִיחַ הַמָּאֵה

“the squeezing of milk brings out butter”

Here, Agur refers to stirring liquid milk until it thickens into a solid food substance called **butter**. If your readers would not be familiar with milk or the process for making **butter**, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [stirring some liquids causes them to harden]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs - Chapter 31 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Sayings from Lemuel (31:1-9)

2. Description of a good and capable wife (31:10-31)

Chapter 31 is the chapter in this book written by Lemuel, who wrote down the advice that his mother told him. Within the Bible, here is the only place that Lemuel is mentioned.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Acrostic poem

Proverbs 31:10-31 is an acrostic poem, that is, a poem in which each line begins with a successive letter of the alphabet in the original language. Using every letter of the language in that way expresses the idea of comprehensiveness and also helps people memorize the poem. In 31:10-31 the acrostic poem emphasizes that virtuous women demonstrate their virtue in everything that they do. If using the letters of your alphabet in this way would not communicate that this is a poem, you could use a different way in your language to indicate that these verses are one poem about the same topic. (See: Poetry)

Proverbs 31:1 (#1)

הַדְּבָרִי

“The words of”

See how you translated the same use of **words** in 1:6.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:1 (#2)

מִנְשָׂא

“a burden”

See how you translated the same use of **burden** in 30:1.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:2 (#3)

מַה־בְּבָרִי וְמַה־בְּרִבְּוֹנִי וְיִמָּה־בְּרִבְּוֹנִי וְיִמָּה־בְּרִבְּוֹנִי

“What, my son? And what, son of my womb? And what, son of my vows”

These three questions could be: (1) rhetorical questions that Lemuel’s mother asks in order to emphasize that her **son** should listen to what she is about to say. Alternate translation: [This is what I should tell you, my son! And this is what I should tell you, son of my womb! And this is what I should tell you, son of my vows!]; (2) exclamations in which **What** is not introducing a question. Alternate translation: [O, my son! O, son of my womb! O, son of my vows!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 31:2 (#2)

מה־בְּבָרִי ומה־בְּבִטְנִי וזֶמָה בְּרִנְדָּרִי

“What, my son? And what, son of my womb? And what, son of my vows”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [What should I say to you, my son? And what should I say to you, son of my womb? And what should I say to you, son of my vows?]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:2 (#1)

מה־בְּבָרִי

“What, my son”

31:2-31 is a long quotation of what Lemuel’s mother told him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Proverbs 31:2 (#4)

בְּרִבְטִנִּי

“son of my womb”

Here, Lemuel’s mother is using the possessive form to describe a **son** whom she had carried in her **womb**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [son whom I carried in my womb]

See: Possession

Proverbs 31:2 (#5)

בְּרִנְדָּרִי

“son of my vows”

Here, **vows** could mean: (1) the promise Lemuel’s mother made to dedicate her **son** to God if he allowed her to have a child. Alternate translation: [son whom I dedicated to Yahweh]; (2) Lemuel is the result of God hearing his mother’s **vows**, in which case **vows** would refer to prayers. Alternate translation: [son for whom I prayed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:3 (#1)

אַל־תַּתֵּתִן לנָשִׁים חֵילָךְ

“Do not give to women your strength”

Lemuel’s mother is referring to sex in a polite way by using the phrase **give your strength to women**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not tire yourself out with women] or [Do not waste your energy on having sex with women]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 31:3 (#3)

למַחֲחוֹת מְלָכִין

“to cause kings to be wiped out”

The parallelism between this clause and the previous clause indicates that this phrase refers to **women** who **cause kings to be wiped out**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to those women who cause kings to be wiped out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:3 (#2)

וְאִדְרָכָיִךְ

“or your ways”

Here, **your ways** could mean: (1) the same as **your strength** in the previous clause, which is parallel to this clause. Alternate translation: [or your vigor]; (2) a person’s regular behavior, which is what **ways** usually means in Proverbs. Alternate translation: [or what you do]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:4 (#1)

אַאֵל לְמַלְכִּים | לְמוֹאֵאֵל אַאֵל לְמַלְכִּים

“It is} not for kings, Lemuel, {it is} not for kings”

Here, Lemuel’s mother repeats the same phrase for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could use one phrase and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [It is absolutely not for kings, Lemuel]

See: Reduplication

Proverbs 31:4 (#2)

אַאֵל לְמַלְכִּים & אַאֵל לְמַלְכִּים

“It is} not for kings & it is} not for kings”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [It is not appropriate for kings ... it is not appropriate for kings]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:4 (#3)

או

“or”

Some ancient copies and translations say that the word translated as **or** is a different word that means “desire” or “crave,” which makes sense because of the parallelism with **drink wine** in the previous clause. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider using the reading in that translation. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, you may wish to follow the reading of the UST.

See: Textual Variants

Proverbs 31:5 (#1)

פן־ישתה

“Lest he drink”

Lemuel’s mother is using the word translated as **Lest** to introduce an outcome that she does not want to happen. Because of this, she first gives Lemuel an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [Otherwise he may drink]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 31:5 (#5)

דָּדָיו כָּל־בְּנֵי־עָנִי

“the legal claim of all the sons of the afflicted one”

Here, **the legal claim** and **the afflicted one** refer to claims and afflicted people in general, not a specific **claim** or **afflicted one**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any legal claim of all the sons of any afflicted person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:5 (#2)

יִשְׁתֶּה

“he drink”

Here, **he** refers to the kings and dignitaries mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [those kings or dignitaries drink]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 31:5 (#4)

וַיִּשְׁבֹּה דָדָיו

“and pervert the legal claim of”

Here, **pervert the legal claim** refers to depriving people of their legal rights. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and deny the legal rights of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:5 (#6)

בְּנֵי־עָנִי

“the sons of the afflicted one”

Here, **the sons of the afflicted one** refers to all afflicted people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [afflicted people]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 31:5 (#3)

מִחֲקָרָה

“what has been decreed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. This phrase refers to the laws of the country that these kings or dignitaries rule over. Alternate translation: [what the law decrees] or [their laws]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 31:6 (#3)

לְמַמְרֵי נֶפֶשׁ

“to those bitter of soul”

Here, Lemuel’s mother refers to people who feel miserable as if their souls are **bitter**. Here, **soul** refers to a person’s inner being or mind, as in 23:7. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to those who are miserable]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:6 (#2)

וְיִינִי

“and wine”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and give wine]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:6 (#1)

לְאוֹבֵדִים

“to the perishing one”

Here, **the perishing one** refers to dying people in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [to any perishing person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:7 (#1)

יִשְׁתֶּה וְיִשְׁכַּח רִישָׁו וְנִצְמָלָיו לֹלֵא יִזְכֶּר-עוֹד

“He will drink and forget his poverty, and his trouble he will not remember again”

He and **his** refer to “the perishing one” and “those bitter of soul,” who are mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Those dying and miserable people will drink and forget their poverty, and their trouble they will not remember again]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 31:7 (#3)

רִישָׁו וְנִצְמָלָיו

“his poverty, and his trouble”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **poverty** in 6:11 and **trouble** in 24:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:7 (#2)

יִשְׁתֶּה

“He will drink”

Lemuel’s mother implies that **He will drink** wine or some other intoxicating drink, as mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [He will drink wine or intoxicating drink]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:8 (#4)

בְּנֵי הַלּוֹי

“the sons of the one passing away”

See how you translated the same use of **the sons of** in 31:5.

See: Idiom

Proverbs 31:8 (#1)

פֶּתַח-פִּיךָ לְאֵלִים

“Open your mouth for a mute one”

Open your mouth refers to doing so in order to say something to defend someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Open your mouth to speak on behalf of a mute one]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:8 (#5)

הַלּוֹי

“the one passing away”

Lemuel’s mother is referring to death in a polite way by using the phrase **passing away**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more normal polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [the dying one]

See: Euphemism

Proverbs 31:8 (#2)

לְאֵלִים אֶל-דִּדְיִן כָּל-בְּנֵי הַלּוֹי

“for a mute one, for the legal claim of all the sons of the one passing away”

Here, **a mute one**, **the legal claim**, and **the one passing away** refer to these people and things in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [for any mute person, for any legal claim of all the sons of any person passing away]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:8 (#3)

אֶל-דִּדְיִן

“for the legal claim of”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence or use a connecting word if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [open your mouth for the legal claim of] or [and for the legal claim of]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:9 (#2)

פתח־פִּיךָ

“Open your mouth”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:9 (#4)

וְאֶדְוֶה עֲנִי וְאֶבִּינִי

“and plead the legal case of the afflicted one and poor one”

Here, **the legal case**, **the afflicted one**, and **poor one** refer to legal cases and types of people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [and plead any legal case of any afflicted person and any poor person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:9 (#3)

צִדִּיק

“with} righteousness”

See how you translated the abstract noun **righteousness** in 1:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:9 (#1)

פֶּתַח־פִּיךָ שְׁפֹט־צִדִּיק

“Open your mouth, judge {with} righteousness”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the second clause if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Open your mouth for the afflicted one and poor one and judge them with righteousness]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:10 (#4)

הַחַיִּל

“worth”

Here, **worth** refers to both physical ability and moral **worth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [physical and moral worth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:10 (#3)

אִשְׁת־הַחַיִּל

“A woman of worth”

Here, Lemuel’s mother is using the possessive form to describe a **woman** who is characterized by **worth**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [A worthy woman]

See: Possession

Proverbs 31:10 (#2)

אִשְׁת־הַחַיִּל & מְכָרָהּ

“A woman of worth & her value”

A woman of worth and **her** refer to a type of **woman** in general, not a particular **woman**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any woman of worth ... that woman’s value]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:10 (#1)

אִשְׁת־הַחַיִּל מִמִּי יִמְצָא

“A woman of worth, who can find”

Lemuel’s mother is using the question form to emphasize the difficulty of finding a wife of **worth**. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Not many men can find a woman of worth!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Proverbs 31:10 (#5)

מִפְּנִינִים

“more than coral pearls”

See how you translated **coral pearls** in 3:15.

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:11 (#1)

לֵב בַּעֲלָהּ

“The heart of her husband”

Here, the **heart** represents where the husband’s thoughts and feelings exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same use of **heart** in 14:10. Alternate translation: [Her husband’s inner being]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:11 (#2)

וְשָׁלָלָהּ

“and spoil”

Although the word translated as **spoil** usually refers to wealth that soldiers seize after winning a battle or that thieves steal, here it refers to the valuable things that this **husband** gains because of his wife. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and great wealth from her]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:11 (#3)

לֹא יִחְסֹר

“he will not lack”

Lemuel’s mother is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [he will always have]

See: Litotes

Proverbs 31:12 (#1)

טָוִב וְלֹא־רָע

“good and not evil”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **good** in 11:27 and **evil** in 1:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:12 (#3)

תַּיִיה

“her life”

See how you translated the abstract noun **life** in 10:16.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:12 (#2)

טָוִב וְלֹא־רָע

“good and not evil”

The expressions **good** and **not evil** mean the same thing. Lemuel’s mother is using the two expressions together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [extremely good]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 31:13 (#5)

בְּתִחְלֹץ כַּפֶּיהָ

“with the delight of her palms”

Here, Lemuel’s mother speaks of this woman feeling **delight** while she uses **her palms** to make clothing as if **her palms** were feeling that **delight**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [delightfully with her palms]

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 31:13 (#2)

צֶמֶד

“wool”

The term **wool** refers to the hair of sheep, which was used to make warm clothing for winter. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of material, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [warm fabric] or [material to make into winter clothing]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:13 (#1)

הִדְרֹשָׁהּ

“She searches {for}”

The fact that she **works** in the next clause indicates that this woman finds what she **searches** for. If it

would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She finds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:13 (#4)

וְתַעֲשֶׂה

“and works”

Here, **works** refers to making clothing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and makes clothing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:13 (#3)

וּפְשָׁתַיִם

“and linens”

The term **linens** refers to a type of plant that was used to make cool clothing for summer. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of material, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [cool fabric] or [material to make into summer clothing]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:14 (#2)

הָיְתָה כְּאֵנִיּוֹת סוֹחֵר

“She is like the ships of a merchant”

The point of this comparison is that just as **ships** bring valuable things from far away, so does the “woman of worth.” If this is not clear from the second line, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [She travels far to get good things, like the ships of a merchant]

See: Simile

Proverbs 31:14 (#3)

לֶחֶם

“her bread”

See how you translated the same use of **bread** in 9:5.

See: Synecdoche

Proverbs 31:14 (#1)

הָיְתָה כְּאֵנִיּוֹת סוֹחֵר מִמְּרָחֶק תָּבִיא לֶחֶם

“She is like the ships of a merchant; she brings her bread from far away”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [She brings her bread from far away, like the ships of a merchant]

See: Information Structure

Proverbs 31:15 (#4)

וְחֶחֱקַ

“and a portion”

Here, **portion** refers to **a portion of food**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [and a portion of food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:15 (#1)

בְּעוֹר לַלַּיְלָה

“while still night”

Here, **while still night** refers to the time before the sun rises in the morning, not the middle of the night. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [while it is still dark] or [before the sun rises]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:15 (#3)

לְבֵיתָהּ

“to her house”

Here, **house** represents the family who lives in **her house**. See how you translated the same use of **house** in 3:33.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:15 (#5)

לְנַעֲרֶיהָ

“to her young women”

Here, **young women** refers to female servants who serve this woman and live in her home. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to her servant girls]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:15 (#2)

וְתַתֵּן

“and gives”

Here, **and** indicates that what follows is the purpose for the woman rising **while still night**. Use a connector in your language that indicates a purpose. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of giving]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Proverbs 31:16 (#2)

מִפְרֵי כַּפְּזֶיהָ

“from the fruit of her palms”

Here, **the fruit of her palms** refers to the money that the woman has earned by selling the clothing she made with **her palms** in 31:13. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the money she has earned]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:16 (#1)

זֹמְמָה שְׂשֹׂדָה

“She considers a field”

Here, **considers** refers to planning carefully before buying **a field**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She considers carefully about buying a field]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:17 (#1)

חֲגִירָהּ & מְחַנְגֶּיהָ

“She girds her loins”

Here, **strength** is spoken of as if it were a kind of clothing that could be girded around a persons **loins**, which refers to the hips and waist. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She puts on strength as though it were clothing] or [She strengthens her body]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:17 (#2)

וְחִתְּמָהּ זִרְעוֹתֶיהָ

“and she strengthens her arms”

Here, Lemuel’s mother implies that this woman **strengthens her arms** by working hard. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she strengthens her arms by doing hard work]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:18 (#1)

סְחָרָהּ

“her profit”

See how you translated the abstract noun **profit** in 3:14.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:18 (#2)

לֹא־יִכָּבֵדָה בַּלַּיִל נֶגְהָ

“her lamp does not go out in the night”

Here, Lemuel’s mother implies that this woman’s **lamp does not go out** because the woman is working. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [her lamp does not go out in the night because she is working]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:18 (#3)

לֹא־יִכָּבֵדָה בַּלַּיִל נֶגְהָ

“her lamp does not go out in the night”

Lemuel’s mother uses this clause as an overstatement in order emphasize that such a woman works until late at **night**, but not necessarily all night long. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [she uses a lamp to work until late at night]

See: Hyperbole

Proverbs 31:19 (#4)

סָלָה

“the spindle”

The word **spindle** refers to a piece of wood around which someone wraps the thread when making thread. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of tool, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the tool for holding thread]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:19 (#3)

בְּכִישׁוֹרָהּ

“at the distaff”

The word **distaff** refers to a thin rod with pointed ends that is used to make thread. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of tool, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [on the tool for making thread]

See: Translate Unknowns

Proverbs 31:19 (#1)

יָדֶיהָ שֶׁלֶחְתָּהּ בְּכִישׁוֹר וְחִכְפָּיָהּ תִּתְמַכּוּ פָלֶה

“She stretches out her hands at the distaff, and her palms grasp the spindle”

This verse refers to the process of making thread, which is used to make clothing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She stretches out her hands at the distaff, and she grasps the spindle in order to make thread]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:19 (#2)

יָדֶיהָ שֶׁלֶחְתָּהּ בְּכִישׁוֹר

“She stretches out her hands at the distaff”

Here, **stretches out her hands** means to holding something. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She takes hold of the distaff]

See: Idiom

Proverbs 31:20 (#2)

כַּבְפָּה פָּרִשָּׁהּ לַעֲנִי וְיָדֶיהָ שֶׁלֶחְתָּהּ לְאֶבְיֹן

“She spreads out her palm to the afflicted one, and she stretches out her hands to the poor one”

These two phrases **She spreads out her palm to the afflicted one** and **she stretches out her hands to the poor one** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way, as in the UST.

See: Parallelism

Proverbs 31:20 (#3)

לַעֲנִי & לְאֶבְיֹן

“to the afflicted one & to the poor one”

See how you translated **the afflicted one** in 15:15 and **poor one** in 13:8.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:20 (#1)

כַּבְפָּה פָּרִשָּׁהּ לַעֲנִי וְיָדֶיהָ שֶׁלֶחְתָּהּ לְאֶבְיֹן

“She spreads out her palm to the afflicted one, and she stretches out her hands to the poor one”

The phrases **spreads out her palm** and **stretches out her hands** both refer to helping someone by using one's hands to give something to that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She helps the afflicted one, and she helps the poor one]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:21 (#5)

שָׁנִים

“with} crimson”

Here, **crimson** refers to clothing that is made from expensive **crimson** cloth. The idea is that this family can afford the best clothing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have expensive, warm clothing]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:21 (#2)

לֹא־תִירָא לְבֵיתָהּ

“She does not fear for her house”

Here, Lemuel's mother implies that this woman **does not fear for her house** to become cold. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [She does not fear for her house to become cold]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:21 (#3)

מִשָּׁלֵג

“because of snow”

Here, **snow** refers to cold weather, which is the time when **snow** falls. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of cold weather] or [because of winter]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:21 (#4)

לְבָבָהּ שָׁנִים

“is clothed {with} crimson”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [she has clothed with crimson]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 31:21 (#1)

לְבֵיתָהּ & כָּל־בְּיָתָהּ

“for her house & all her house”

See how you translated the same use of **her house** in 31:15.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:22 (#2)

שֵׁשׁ וְאַרְגָּמָן לְבוּשָׁהּ

“fine linen and purple for her clothing”

Lemuel’s mother is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a clause would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [she wears fine linen and purple for her clothing]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:22 (#3)

שֵׁשׁ וְאַרְגָּמָן

“fine linen and purple”

Here, **fine linen** and **purple** both refer to very expensive cloth. Lemuel’s mother is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [very expensive materials]

See: Doublet

Proverbs 31:22 (#1)

מְרַבְּדִים

“coverings”

Here, **coverings** refers to pieces of cloth used to cover beds. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. See how you translated **coverings** in 7:16. Alternate translation: [blankets] or [cloth that covers beds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:23 (#3)

בְּשַׁעְרֵי

“at the gates”

Here, **the gates** refers to the place in a town or city where many people would gather and where the elders would sit to discuss matters and make legal decisions. See how you translated the same use of **the gates** in 1:21.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:23 (#1)

נוֹדָע & בְּעֵלְלָהּ

“Her husband is known”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [People know her husband]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 31:23 (#4)

בִּשְׁבָּתָתוֹ עִם

“when he sits with”

Here, **sits with** refers to sitting down **with the elders of the land** in order to make laws and resolve legal disputes. Someone who **sits with the elders** is actually one of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he sits down to make legal decisions with]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:23 (#5)

זְקֵנֵי־אֶרֶץ

“the elders of the land”

The phrase **the elders of the land** refers to the leaders of the town or city in which this woman lives with her **husband**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the town]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:23 (#2)

נוֹדָע

“is known”

Here, the phrase **is known** implies that this woman's **husband** is respected by many people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [is respected]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:24 (#2)

וּתְמַכְכֶּר

“and sells”

Lemuel's mother is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply this word from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and sells that garment]

See: Ellipsis

Proverbs 31:24 (#4)

לְכַנְעָנִי

“to the Canaanite”

Here, **Canaanite** refers specifically to **Canaanite** traders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the Canaanite trader] or [to someone who trades goods]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:24 (#3)

נָתַתָּהּ

“she gives”

Here, **gives** means that she supplies this **belt** to a **Canaanite** who is a merchant and so pays her for the item and then sells it to others. It does not refer to giving the **belt** away for free. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [she supplies]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:24 (#1)

וּתְמַכְכֶּר & וְהָלַךְ לְכַנְעָנִי

“a linen garment & and a belt & to the Canaanite”

Here, **a linen garment**, **a belt**, and **the Canaanite** refer to these things and people in general. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [linen garments ... belts ... to Canaanites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:25 (#2)

עֹז וְהַדָּדָר

“Strength and splendor”

See how you translated the abstract nouns **Strength** in 5:10 and **splendor** in 4:9.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:25 (#3)

וְהִתְשַׁחֲסָה לַיּוֹם אֲחֵרֹן

“and she laughs at a future day”

Here, the woman **laughs** because she feels confident and cheerful about what will happen in the future. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she is confident about a future day]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:25 (#4)

לַיּוֹם אֲחֵרֹן

“at a future day”

Here, **a future day** refers to what will happen in the future. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at what will happen in the future]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:25 (#1)

עֹז וְהַדָּדָר לְבוּשָׁהּ

“Strength and splendor {are} her clothing”

Here Lemuel's mother speaks of this woman having **Strength and splendor** that other people notice. It's as if she were wearing those qualities as **clothing** that other people could see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [Everyone notices her strength and splendor] or [People notice her strength and splendor as if they were her clothing]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:26 (#2)

בְּחָכְמָהּ

“with wisdom”

See how you translated the abstract noun **wisdom** in 1:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:26 (#5)

הַחֶסֶד

“covenant faithfulness”

See how you translated the same use of **covenant faithfulness** in 11:17.

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:26 (#3)

וְתוֹרַת־הַחֶסֶד

“and the law of covenant faithfulness”

Here, Lemuel’s mother is using the possessive form to describe **the law** that is characterized by **covenant faithfulness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different expression. Alternate translation: [and the law that is characterized by covenant faithfulness]

See: Possession

Proverbs 31:26 (#4)

וְתוֹרַת

“and the law of”

Although **the law** here is singular, it refers to what this woman teaches or instructs others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the instructions of] or [and the teachings of]

See: Collective Nouns

Proverbs 31:26 (#6)

עַל־לְשׁוֹנָהּ

“{is} on her tongue”

Here, **on her tongue** refers to her speaking, which involved using **her tongue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is spoken by her]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:26 (#1)

פִּיָּהּ פֹּתַח־חַיָּהּ

“Her mouth opens”

Here, **mouth opens** refers to speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [She talks]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:27 (#1)

הַלִּיכּוֹת בֵּיתָהּ

“the goings on of her house”

Here, **the goings on of her house** could refer to: (1) what happens inside her home. Alternate translation: [what happens in her home]; (2) what the people who live in **her house** do, in which case **her house** has the same meaning as in 31:15. Alternate translation: [what her family does]

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:27 (#2)

וְלֹא־תֹאכַל לֶחֶם עֲצֵלָלוֹת לֵלֵא תֹאכַל

“and the bread of laziness she does not eat”

Here, Lemuel’s mother speaks of someone being lazy as if **laziness** were **bread** that a person **eats**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and she does not act idly]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:28 (#2)

קָמָהּ

“rise up”

Here, the phrase **rise up** refers to a symbolic action to show respect for someone. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [stand to show respect]

See: Symbolic Action

Proverbs 31:28 (#1)

בָּנֶיהָ

“Her sons”

See how you translated the same use of **sons** in 4:1.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Proverbs 31:29 (#2)

בָּתָּנוֹת

“daughters”

Here, the woman’s husband uses **daughters** to refer to women in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly, as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Proverbs 31:29 (#3)

הַחַיִּל

“with} worth”

Here, **worth** refers to both physical ability and moral **worth**. See how you translated the same use of **worth** in 31:10.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:29 (#5)

וְאַתָּה עָלִית עַל

“but you yourself have ascended over”

Here, the woman’s husband speaks of his wife acting more admirably than all other woman as if she **ascended over** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but you yourself have acted more worthily than] or [but you yourself are more excellent than]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:29 (#4)

וְאַתָּה עָלִית

“but you yourself have ascended”

The woman’s husband uses the word **yourself** to emphasize how excellent his wife is. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [but you, yes, you have ascended]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 31:29 (#1)

רַבּוֹת בָּנוֹת עָשׂוּ חַיִּל וְאַתָּה עָלִית עַל־כָּלֵנָה

“Many daughters have acted {with} worth, but you yourself have ascended over all of them”

This verse is a quotation of what the woman’s husband said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Proverbs 31:30 (#8)

הִיא תִתְהַלֵּל

“she herself will be praised”

The intensive pronoun **herself** represents the pronoun “her” that Lemuel’s mother uses in the original even

though the verb translated as **she will be praised** already includes this meaning. Doing this adds emphasis to what she is saying. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [she will certainly be praised] or [people will certainly praise her]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Proverbs 31:30 (#6)

אִשָּׁה יִרְאֵת יְהוָה

“a woman fearful of Yahweh”

This half of the verse is a strong contrast with the previous half. Use the most natural way in your language to indicate a contrast. Alternate translation: [by contrast, a woman fearful of Yahweh]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Proverbs 31:30 (#4)

וְהַתְּכַל הַיָּפִי

“and the beauty {is} vapor”

Here, Lemuel’s mother speaks of the disappearance of **beauty** as if it were a **vapor** that quickly goes away. See how you translated the same use of **vapor** in 21:6.

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:30 (#2)

שִׁשְׁקָר הַחֵן וְהַתְּכַל הַיָּפִי

“The charm {is} falsehood and the beauty {is} vapor”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **charm**, **falsehood**, and **beauty**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. See how you translated **falsehood** in 6:17 and **beauty** in 6:25. Alternate translation: [What is charming is false and what is beautiful is vapor]

See: Abstract Nouns

Proverbs 31:30 (#3)

שִׁשְׁקָר הַחֵן וְהַתְּכַל הַיָּפִי

“The charm {is} falsehood and the beauty {is} vapor”

The parallelism between this half of the verse and the second half indicates that **charm** and **beauty** refer to the physical attractiveness of women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explic-

itly. Alternate translation: [A woman's charm can be deceptive and a woman's beauty is vapor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:30 (#5)

אִשָּׁה יִרְאַת־יְהוָה הִיא תִתְהַלֵּל

“a woman fearful of Yahweh, she herself will be praised”

Here, **a woman**, **she**, and **herself** refer to a type of **woman** in general, not a specific **woman**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [any woman fearful of Yahweh, that woman herself will be praised]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:30 (#1)

חֵן וְיָפִיּוּת

“The charm & the beauty”

Here, **The charm** and **the beauty** refer to these qualities in general, not any specific **charm** or **beauty**. If it would be helpful, you could use more natural expressions in your language. Alternate translation: [Any charm ... any beauty]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Proverbs 31:30 (#7)

הִיא תִתְהַלֵּל

“she herself will be praised”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will certainly praise her]

See: Active or Passive

Proverbs 31:31 (#4)

בְּשַׁעְרֵים

“at the gates”

See how you translated the same use of **the gates** in 1:21 and 31:23.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Proverbs 31:31 (#1)

לָהּ & יָדֶיהָ וְיַחַד לְהַלְלוּהָ & מַעֲשֶׂיהָ

“to her & her hands and let her works praise her”

In this verse, **her** refers to the “woman fearful of Yahweh” mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [to a woman fearful of Yahweh ... that woman's hands, and let that woman's works praise her]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Proverbs 31:31 (#2)

מִפְרֵי יָדֶיהָ

“from the fruit of her hands”

Here, **the fruit of her hands** could refer to: (1) any kind of reward that the woman deserves for her hard work. Alternate translation: [the reward for her work]; (2) the money that the woman has earned by selling the clothing she made in 31:13, like the nearly identical phrase “from the fruit of her palms” in 31:16. Alternate translation: [from the money she has earned]

See: Metaphor

Proverbs 31:31 (#3)

וְיַחַד לְהַלְלוּהָ & מַעֲשֶׂיהָ

“and let her works praise her”

Here, Lemuel's mother speaks of people praising this woman because of **her works** as if the **works** were people who were the ones praising her. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and let people praise her for her works]

See: Personification